Saved by Chance, Savior by Choice

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/39798477.

Rating:	Mature
Archive Warnings:	Graphic Depictions Of Violence, Major Character Death
Categories:	M/M, F/F
Fandom:	僕のヒーローアカデミア | Boku no Hero Academia | My Hero Academia
Relationships:	Bakugou Katsuki/Midoriya Izuku, Aizawa Shouta | Eraserhead/Yamada Hizashi | Present Mic, Shinsou Hitoshi/Original Character(s)
Characters:	Aoyama Yuuga, Ashido Mina, Asui Tsuyu, Iida Tenya, Uraraka Ochako, Ojiro Mashirao, Kaminari Denki, Kirishima Eijirou, Kouda Kouji, Satou Rikidou, Shouji Mezou, Jirou Kyouka, Sero Hanta, Tokoyami Fumikage, Todoroki Shouto, Hagakure Tooru, Bakugou Katsuki, Midoriya Izuku, Mineta Minoru, Yaoyorozu Momo, Class 1-A (My Hero Academia), Class 1-B (My Hero Academia), Aizawa Shouta | Eraserhead, Yamada Hizashi | Present Mic, Yagi Toshinori | All Might, Ishiyama Ken | Cementoss, Ectoplasm (My Hero Academia), Todoroki Enji | Endeavor, Takami Keigo | Hawks, Kayama Nemuri | Midnight, Nedzu (My Hero Academia), Snipe (My Hero Academia), Maijima Higari | Power Loader, Hatsume Mei, Toyomitsu Taishirou | Fat Gum, Shuuzenji Chiyo | Recovery Girl, League of Villains (My Hero Academia), Toga Himiko, Shigaraki Tomura | Shimura Tenko, Sensei | All For One, Garaki Kyuudai | Ujiko Daruma, Kurogiri (My Hero Academia), Okuta Kagerou | Giran, Bubaigawara Jin | Twice, Sako Atsuhiro | Mr. Compress, Iguchi Shuuichi | Spinner, Hikiishi Kenji | Magne
Additional Tags:	Midoriya Izuku Has a Quirk, Aizawa Shouta | Eraserhead Adopts Midoriya Izuku, Aizawa Shouta | Eraserhead Adopts Shinsou Hitoshi, Married Aizawa Shouta | Eraserhead/Yamada Hizashi | Present Mic, Shinsou Hitoshi is in Class 1-A, Insomniac Shinsou Hitoshi, Implied/Referenced Homophobia, Gay Male Character, Original Character(s), Shinsou Hitoshi Replaces Mineta Minoru, Angst and Hurt/Comfort, Hurt/Comfort, The Author Regrets Nothing, Angst, Heavy Angst, Mental Health Issues, Mental Breakdown, Suffering, Falling In Love, Major Original Character(s), Don't Like Don't Read, Fluff, Parental Kayama Nemuri | Midnight
Language:	English
Stats:	Published: 2022-06-21 Completed: 2023-02-15 Words: 180,824 Chapters: 63/63

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by guessitseraser

Summary

Izuku Midoriya was a quirkless, weakling kid who had the heart of a Pro-Hero. His mother, Inko, tried her best to protect her innocent child from her brutal, lame excuse of a husband. Throughout rigorous tests and experiments, he left once he couldn't force a quirk to his son. He missed one detail while tormenting his son. Why was he never injured for more than a day? What would come of his life when he tries to take it and a helping hand saves him?

|COMPLETED|
|OC HEAVY|
|EDITING IN PROCESS|

Chapter One

Chapter Summary

Izuku meets his savior, who had just caught him from falling off of a building. Then, he gets the offer of a life time.

// trigger warning, suicide warning!!

Chapter has been edited by beta on 6/6/23

Izuku felt the cool breeze brush against his face, cooling the tears that ran down his cheeks. He had just been saved by his favorite hero, All Might. That excitement crashed once that same hero told him he couldn't become a hero without a quirk. He was left stranded on the building that All Might had dropped him off at. He stood there, tears spilling from his broken eyes. He took a shaky step towards the edge, looking down. The world seemed to shift, the floor was slowly getting farther and farther away. Familiar words wrapped around his mind, deafening the sound of cars from below.

"You know, if you really want to be a hero that badly, there actually might be another way. Just pray that you'll be born with a quirk in your next life, and take a swan dive off the roof of the building."

More tears began to spill, as he lifted his arm to wipe the flowing tears with his sleeve. Maybe Kacchan was right. He had no hope left. His mom might've been waiting for him to return home, but he had already caused her so much pain. He was the reason her husband abandoned her, the reason he yelled and occasionally hit her. She would be better off having to provide for one person. Maybe even find love again, without Izuku there to mess up for her again. He took another step forward, loose gravel fell off the roof when his shoe hit them. His foot stood over half of the edge. A pain tugged at his heart, his lungs tightened.

"Sorry, mom.." His voice faltered, as he twisted his body. He let himself fall, his back stinging from the brute force of the wind. He closes his eyes, his body relaxing. Is this what it felt like to be free? His notebook slipped from his grasp, the pages fluttering in the wind. He felt his body plummeting faster, and he squeezed his eyes shut tightly. He held his breath, expecting to feel an impact.

It never comes.

Instead, arms wrapped around Izuku's body. He was pulled close to someone's chest, a hand resting against the back of his head in a soothing motion. Izuku's eyes began to tear up once more, and he felt the wind abruptly stop when he and his mystery savior landed on the ground. Safely. His savior stood tall, and held him tightly to his chest. Their heart was beating intensely, and their grip tightened on Izuku's knees and back.

"Jesus Christ!" They spoke, gently placing Izuku flat on the floor. "Are you alright?"

Those words stung into Izuku's heart and more tears began to spill. He began to sob, forcing himself to sit up so he could cover and wipe his tears the best he could. He felt a supportive hand on his back, assuming it was the person who saved him. They were speaking to him, but he wasn't sure what he was hearing. So much overwhelmed him, so many bad memories flooded his mind. All those pent up emotions were spilling out, in front of this bystander. It took Izuku a while to calm down, and once he finally did he looked up at the person who saved him.

"I, I'm so sorry I ha..had to bother you," Izuku whimpered, "You- you had to..to..-"

"Hey. Don't apologize. Here, this is yours, right?" They offered a hand to Izuku, his Hero Analysis book laid there. Izuku's eyes widened.

"You- You got my book..??" Izuku met the eyes of the person. They had a dark cloak on, and it covered their entire body. A mask covered their mouth and nose. They tilted their head concerned, and the light loomed on their face. A rigid, long scar laid across their right eye, and light freckles lined under their eyes. Their eyes were two different colors, a light green one, and a dark brown one.

"Of course I did. Are you hurt?" They were silent. "Physically, I mean."

"N-No.."

“Are you sure? Your sleeve is cut, and blood is soaked into it.”

“What?” Izuku looked down at his right arm. Sure enough, his sleeve was cut, and blood was soaked into the dark fabric. *That’s weird* , Izuku thought. *There’s not an obvious cut anywhere. That’s right! I had gotten cut when the sludge monster got me earlier…How could this happen? I should still be cut!*

“Uhh..do you have some sort of regeneration quirk?”

“What? No-! I..I’m quirkless,” Izuku blinks. “Wh-Wait, what..what are you? Are you a newer Pro-Hero? I don’t recognize you. You seem so young, I’m surprised! What’s your name and quirk so I can take note of it!” Izuku reached for a pen in his pocket and opened his book.

“...No, I’m- I’m no Pro-Hero. I’ve been named Cosmic by the public.”

“Cosmic..You- You mean THE Cosmic?!” Izuku sprung up, “You’re the vigilante none of the Pros can catch!”

“...You- know about me?” Cosmic quizzed, raising an eyebrow. “…I thought I was pretty underground..”

“I tried really hard to find information about you, but other than the occasional news article there’s nothing..!” Izuku smiles softly. If there's anything that made him feel better, and distract him from his pain, it’s heroes and vigilantes.

“..Can I ask why you..uh, jumped?” Cosmic changes the subject, “You seemed pretty confident in that fall.”

“…I don’t want to talk about it.” Izuku whispers, the events from earlier run through his mind. “..Cosmic?”

“Yes?”

“Can I be a hero without a quirk?”

Cosmic visibly paused, putting a hand to his chin. He started to mutter to himself, before finally looking at Izuku. “Anyone can be a hero. Have the heart of a hero, then all you need is to train like one. You are quite small, and thin...But I’m sure it’s possible. I fight quirkless… mostly.”

“S-So what do you think my chances would be..at UA?” Izuku asked, nervously rocking on his feet. His eyes were trained on the ground, afraid to look at Cosmic.

“UA High?” Cosmic asked, surprise lining his voice. “Realistically, in your state now..I don’t think you’d pass the physical exam.”

Izuku felt his heart break again. There it is. He can’t be a hero, Cosmic and All Might said so. It was pointless. He should’ve given up when he still had a chance. Izuku’s ill feelings were interrupted by Cosmic once again.

“Not without training. I could help you prepare your body physically. You’ve got a dream, I can see it. Your eyes sparkle.”

Izuku’s head shot up and he locked eyes with Cosmic. THE Cosmic, the uncapturable vigilante, just offered to help train Izuku. He went to speak, but no sound came out. He was baffled. Someone *wanted* to help him? Help him become a hero? Something he was told would never, ever happen by everyone he knew? “You would?! You would- you would train me..??”

“I know what it’s like to be excluded. Told how much of a failure you are..” Cosmic holds his breath. “You don’t deserve to have a bright future ripped from your hands. Quirks, they’re just an advantage. If you’re smart and strong enough, you CAN become a hero. Society would rather stand by and let the Pros do it all.” He scoffed. “If you want to be a hero, screw it. Be a hero. I’ll help you get into that school.”

“Oh, thank you..!” Izuku began to sob. Someone believed in his dream. Someone believed in *him* . Cosmic didn’t care that he didn’t have a quirk, he didn’t believe it was impossible. He had just restored Izuku’s hope, and his dream of becoming a hero. A hero on his own accord.

“I’m so sorry, I didn’t mean to make you cry,” Cosmic apologized, holding his hands out in front of him in a panicked manner. “Was- Was it something I said?”

“N-No, I’m...just a cry...crybaby and I’m so th-thankful..!” Izuku stuttered.

“..Oh! So this is a good cry.” Cosmic nods slowly.

After a while, Izuku’s tears come to a stop. He looks towards Cosmic and a slight panic set in.

“Oh! I’m Izuku Midoriya, I’m so sorry I didn’t introduce myself sooner.”

“Do you prefer Izuku or Midoriya?” Cosmic asks. “I...ask because I typically ask people to call me by my real first name,” He nervously rubs the back of his neck. He seemed gentle with Izuku, but also nervous. Almost like he never talks to people casually in his everyday life. The Cosmic that was plastered on the news was a smartass, cocky, and confident. This side of Cosmic was rarely ever seen, and Izuku might be the only one to see it.

“Either works..! Only one person really calls me Izuku…That’s my mom.”

“Then, Midoriya it is. I also wanted to clarify something,” Cosmic sighed, resting against the brick in the alleyway they were in. “If you get caught with me, or have anything to do with me…I’m afraid your chances at UA might be ruined. What I’m doing is technically illegal. You’d be assisting a criminal. Uh, wanted criminal.”

Izuku paused, thinking of this outcome. What would he do if he got caught? No one else has even offered to give Izuku a chance at training. This could be his make or break. Asking Cosmic to train him outside of his vigilante identity is just crazy, since they just met. That's off the table. So now Izuku had two options, either risk getting caught with Cosmic as Izuku, or mask his identity too. There was pent up anger towards the hero society, but he also yearned to be one. Maybe instead of waiting such a long time, he could finally prove that he was capable of saving others. That he, Izuku Midoriya, without UA, Pro-Hero training, or a quirk, could save lives.

"Can I become one too?"

"Become…what?"

"A vigilante."

Cosmic choked, standing up straight. "You want to be a vigilante?"

"Hypothetically speaking, hiding my own identity while you train me could be beneficial! Also, I want to prove I'm capable."

"Almost dying made you eager, didn't it?" Cosmic asks. "Wanting a second chance to prove yourself?"

"U-Uhm…I think. That *was* really scary.." Izuku gulps. "I don't think I want to die without trying to help anyone...Thank you for saving me, Cosmic.."

"You should be getting home, the sun will go down soon. I'll follow you, so I know where to go. When I get you for training. And...maybe you can think about your decision about being a vigilante, once the adrenaline completely wears off." Cosmic smiled, only obvious by the crinkle in his eyes.

"Okay! Um…I could just give you my address?"

“I want to learn the route. If that's okay,”

Izuku agrees, then starts on his walk home. A lot was running through his mind, the whole day had just been horrible. He was considering all his options, to the best of his abilities. Become a vigilante. He wanted to prove everyone wrong. He wanted to prove All Might wrong. He couldn’t be a hero, so be the next best thing. Sure, he still wanted to go to UA, but maybe this path in life would help his ability to become a hero. He didn’t need to wait for his adrenaline to pass. He had made up his mind. He was going to be a vigilante.

Izuku hummed in thought, only to be interrupted by a loud explosion and a scream. His head perked up, as he quickened his pace to look where it came from. He saw a group of people, and he pushed through the crowd to see what was happening. His heart dropped.

Bakugo was caught by the same monster that had gotten Izuku earlier. He felt his throat close, thoughts running through his mind. He looked at the Pro-Heroes who just stood there, feeling panic and anger set in. They were just standing there! Sure, none of their quirks could help, but they weren’t doing ANYTHING. It pissed Izuku off, but his heart ached knowing he wasn’t strong enough.

Bakugo looked over towards the crowd, and opened his eyes. Pain and fear glossed over the normal angry red eyes he had. And that’s when it happened. Izuku’s legs began to move, rushing past the barrier and heroes. Tears pricked his eyes, and he ran faster towards Bakugo.

“Kacchan!”

What would a hero do?! Right! Page 25! Izuku thought, and he ripped his bag off of his shoulder. He threw it at the sludge monster and a book punctured the villain's eye. He ignored the heroes calling out to him, but one voice managed to slip past his subconscious block out of the hero’s words. Cosmic’s.

“Midoriya!”

Izuku began to claw at the monster, and Bakugo managed to take a breath from the shock of its eye being injured.

“Deku, what are you doing here?!”

“I-I don’t know, my legs- they just started running!” Izuku looked at Bakugo with tearful eyes, “I couldn’t just let you die, Kacchan!”

Izuku heard something clatter on the ground next to him. He glanced down, seeing a small, mechanical device. He blinked through his tears, but was suddenly picked up by a pair of hands. Seconds later, a loud burst of wind erupted from the device. It caught the monster off guard. Izuku and Bakugo were thrown to the side, and Izuku ended up hitting an unconscious Bakugo's chest. Izuku blinked again, looking at the device. Instead, he saw Cosmic.

Cosmic’s hood flapped in the wind, miraculously staying fastened to his head. *The wind gadget must’ve been his invention* , Izuku thought. Cosmic stood tall, pulling something from his back. It looked no bigger than Cosmic’s hand, but a large staff suddenly extended from the small cylinder. Cosmic yelled out as he swung against the sludge monster with a surprising force, the staff seemed to recoil and send a second impact. The sludge monster’s body began to fall apart from the hit and the intense wind the gadget was making. One more final blow, and the sludge monster dissipated into nothing.

Cosmic breathed heavily, as everyone stood there in silence. Cosmic turned to Izuku, and ran over to him. He helped the unconscious Bakugo sit up, and gently shook him awake.

“Wh...What the- WHERE THE HELL AM I?!”

“Midoriya, I have to go. The Pros will try to grab me. Comfort your friend,” Cosmic said quickly, using his staff to pole jump onto the roof. He disappeared.

“YOU DAMN NERD, GET AWAY FROM ME!!” Bakugo yelled out, “I’M NOT WEAK, I DIDN’T NEED HELP!”

Izuku flinched, but his heart fluttered. Kacchan was okay, safe and sound. Even if he was still angry.

After an even longer day, Izuku finally went home.

Chapter Two

Chapter Summary

Izuku's trip home from school is interrupted by an unexpected visitor.

Chapter Notes

guys check bottom notes for trigger warning! (don't wanna spoil)

Chapter has been edited by beta on 6/6/23

See the end of the chapter for more notes

The next few days, Izuku didn't hear from Cosmic. He feared that Cosmic had lied about everything he said, and that he never truly believed in him. He had started watching more of the videos of Cosmic he could find. He payed attention to how he was saving people and his fighting skills. He couldn't find an obvious quirk anywhere. Maybe it was super speed? Cosmic did move quickly. Or some sort of super strength? None of it made sense. Izuku felt frustrated. Between the fear of Cosmic lying, the inability to find a quirk, and not hearing from Cosmic at all, he couldn't help but *be* frustrated.

Izuku walked home from school with his nose buried in his notebook. He was scribbling aggressively, trying to theorize about Cosmic's abilities. Cosmic *was* going to be his trainer after all. Izuku had reached the door to his apartment. His hand gently brushed against the door, which creaked open with no resistance.

That's weird. The door should be shut. Maybe not locked, but shut. Izuku thought, closing his journal. *Maybe mom just forgot to close it on her way in?* Izuku pushed the door open more, stepping inside.

"Mom?"

There was no response. Izuku furrowed his eyebrows, and he grabbed a free umbrella next to the door. He grips the handle like a baseball bat after a few minutes of silence. “Mom, answer me if you’re there!” Izuku called out into the dark apartment.

“No personal feelings, right kid?” A voice said from behind Izuku. Izuku turned quickly, a gasp escaping his lips. Before he can think, react, or talk, he’s out like a light. The last thing he remembered was an abrupt hit on the head, and a splitting headache. The feeling of a cool liquid dripped from his head.

“Midoriya! Hey, kid, c’mon!”

Izuku woke to someone shaking his shoulders. He blinked multiple times, squinting slightly. He tried to speak, but nothing came out. His lips felt dry and his head throbbed violently. He attempted to sit up, only to be refused that ability.

“No. Don’t move, you’ve got blood all over your face.”

Izuku recognized the voice. That was Cosmic, was it not?

“Cos...Cosmic?” Izuku tried to speak, his voice sounding like a nail against a chalkboard. He weakly lifted a hand to his throat.

“Shit. What the hell happened, Midoriya?” Cosmic asked, fumbling with a handful of paper towels. “I can’t find the wound. I have to call someone, okay?”

Izuku suddenly panicked. His mom. *Where was she? Is she okay? Cosmic said he had to call someone, does that mean he hasn’t already? If he found his mom, then he would’ve called already if she was hurt.* He looked towards Cosmic, who caught eye contact.

“My...My mom, is she okay?” Izuku muttered, getting his words out the best he could. He saw Cosmic visibly pause, and then watched as sorrow grew in his eyes. *No. Don’t tell me..*

“Uhm, Midoriya, I-” Cosmic starts. “…I’m really sorry, I am- I...We really need to call someone.”

Izuku stared at the ceiling as he relaxed his head. Thoughts ran through his mind, tiring him out. *My mom is hurt, isn’t she? Cosmic had that look. He looked at me like my only family left was dead. What the hell could I do now? There’s nothing I can do. Not a single thing. I wasn’t fast enough. Strong enough.*

“Er..sr..ead!” Cosmic’s voice barely came through to Izuku. He watched as the ceiling began to spin, swirling around his eyes. He tried to keep them open, but they slowly began to shut. He heard Cosmic’s calls for him, but they weren’t enough. Izuku’s eyes forcefully shut for the second time that night.

The next time Izuku woke, he heard beeping. It was consistent, and low. He took a shallow breath before he opened his eyes, breathing in a sterilized smell. His eyes crack open. *Where am I..?* Izuku questioned. He glanced around, the intense lights giving him an instant headache. *A hospital. I’m in a hospital..?*

“Good. You’re awake.” A voice said. Izuku lazily looked the way of the voice and saw a middle-aged doctor. “You’re going to be fine. Do you remember what happened last night?”

“…I was in- uh..my house...a-and I called out for my mom..” Izuku paused, before abruptly sitting up. “My mom! Is- Is she okay?!”

“Please, calm yourself.”

“No! Tell me she’s okay!”

“Midoriya.” A different, deeper voice spoke from the doorway. “Doctor, a moment.” The doctor walked out after hearing the orders from this unknown voice. Izuku focused harder.

That's Pro-Hero Eraserhead! He's an underground superhero who uses his quirk, Erasure, to stop villains! I can't believe he's standing here!

"Your mother was killed last night by a villain." Eraserhead spoke, walking to the edge of Izuku's hospital bed.

Wh...What?! Izuku froze, his heart monitor speeding up. His chest tightened, and tears welled in his eyes. He tried to breathe, but he couldn't. His breaths became shallow, and fast. He gripped his hospital gown in desperation, gasping instead of breathing now. He felt his face flush red, and tears began to stream down his cheeks. *My mom's…dead?*

"Kid." Eraserhead said, "Hey, I need you to look at me." He sat on the edge of Izuku's bed, gently grabbing his arm. "Look at me."

Izuku slowly turned towards Eraserhead, still panicking and unable to breathe. He tried his hardest to focus his eyes on Eraserhead, but they were distorted from the tears in his eyes.

"You're having a panic attack. Breathe in for four seconds. Hold it for seven. Exhale for eight. Can you try that?" Oddly, Eraserhead's personality of not caring seemed to disappear when he noticed a kid in desperate need of help.

Izuku nodded, trying to breathe in for four seconds. He could do it for three, and could only hold it for five. His exhaling lasted about six seconds. He tried again, and again, until he finally reached the requested numbers. Izuku hadn't even noticed he could finally breathe again, until he took a deep breath. He looked at Eraserhead again with broken eyes.

"I couldn't save her." Izuku's voice broke when speaking. "I failed..."

"What do you mean you couldn't save her?" Eraserhead's expression never changed, still giving that blank, tired stare.

“When I got home, I...Something was wrong, a-and I wasn’t fast enough.” Izuku began to cry. “I couldn’t save my mom.”

“Midoriya, that’s not your responsibility. It never has been. You’re a kid.” Eraserhead shakes his head. “I need to know something. I was called from an unknown number, telling me your location. Who was there?”

“What?” Izuku asked. *Cosmic was there. Surely Eraserhead knows that…*

“I need to know who found you.”

“I, I don’t know. I heard talking and-” Izuku gulped. He felt guilty for lying to Eraserhead, but Cosmic could be in trouble if he was honest.

“Fine.” Eraserhead mumbled, “Did you get a look at the villain?”

“N-No, sir. Not really...It was dark in my apartment.”

“One last question. Since your mom is dead,” *Ouch. He’s showing no remorse..* “Do you have any living family?”

“O-Oh! My-...my dad. He’s working abroad right now. He’s supposed to be back soon.” Izuku lied straight through his teeth. The only thing closest to a family he had now was Kacchan and his parents. No way in hell was he going to live with him. Hisashi Midoriya, Izuku’s father, had left him and his mom stranded once Izuku showed no quirk. Hisashi abused Izuku heavily trying to force a quirk to manifest, but no luck.

“I’m going to have you speak to the police regarding a living situation for you.” Eraserhead then left, not even saying goodbye. Izuku watched as a few officers and detectives came into the room, mentally trying to prepare himself.

Eraserhead, Shota Aizawa, had made his way out of the hospital. Somehow the kid had been knocked out since last night, and didn't wake up until after sunset. He grumbled as he looked at his phone, checking the recent call section on his phone. He knew who had called him. That damn slippery brat, Cosmic. He thought maybe since Cosmic was in Midoriya's apartment, he would know something. Aizawa didn't even want to speak to the kid, considering he was found inside an apartment with his dead mother. Cosmic didn't catch the villain either, that's what makes it suspicious to him. He hated the brat with all his heart, slipping under his grasp every time they interacted. But Aizawa had to give him credit. He caught whoever he was after. Since Cosmic didn't this time, it's a clear indication that Cosmic showed up *after* the attack was over.

Maybe Aizawa just had a long day with the kids at his school and it was making him overthink. There's no speculation that it was weird, but Cosmic was also more of a hero than any other vigilante. Cosmic prioritized saving lives over capturing a villain.

"You seem to be thinking hard, Eraser."

Aizawa turned, throwing his capture weapon at the streetlamp behind him. A body moved, jumping to a different streetlamp with ease, avoiding Aizawa's capture weapon. He huffed in distaste, turning his eyes to the streetlamp on the other side of him.

"Cosmic."

"Thought you had forgotten about me!" Cosmic audibly smiled condescendingly. There was a moment of silence between the two. "Is he okay?"

"The kid?"

"Yeah. He was bleeding a lot when I found him."

"He's fine. Shaken up, but fine. What were you doing in his apartment?" Aizawa tried to squeeze a story out of Cosmic.

“I was actually walking by as a normal civilian, and I heard his mom scream. I couldn’t just rush in there, so I had to change. It only took a second, but by the time I got there. Midoriya was on the floor and was gushing blood from his head somewhere. That’s when I called you.”

Aizawa paused. “Cosmic, how do you know his name?”

“Well first of all, his first name was on his bedroom door. Second of all- I stopped that sludge villain. The one that him and that boy, Katsuki Bakugo, got wrapped up in.”

“..Right.” Aizawa studied Cosmic’s body language. He stood squatted on the streetlamp, keeping his balance perfectly without even trying. The hell? Aizawa knew he could do it himself, but Cosmic always looked young to him. He looked like a teenager at most, and it took a while for Aizawa to master it himself.

“I should be going! See ya,” Cosmic jumped from the streetlamp, but was grabbed from the ground. Aizawa’s capture weapon wrapped around his body, pulling him to the ground quickly.

“Hey! No fair.” Cosmic jokingly pouts.

“Enough.” Aizawa let Cosmic lay on the ground. “You’ve run around too much, for too long.”

“…Mm. Have I?” Cosmic suddenly popped up from the ground. Aizawa’s capture weapon didn’t tighten around his body, “I know how to use that scarf of yours, Eraser. I can loosen myself freely.”

Aizawa growled through his teeth when Cosmic jumped away, immediately disappearing into the night. He sighed, putting a hand to his head.

“I need a nap.”

Chapter End Notes

trigger warnings: blood and death

sorry this chapter is kinda short i didn’t know where else to go with it :(

Chapter Three

Chapter Summary

Izuku leaves the hospital, and Cosmic finally agrees to train him. Cosmic talks about his own quirk, and we see Izuku's first night out as a vigilante.

Chapter has been edited by beta on 9/12/23

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

The police decided Izuku could live in his apartment until his father came home, since they couldn't get ahold of him. Only, Izuku never told them that his father had gone no contact for most of his life. He couldn't move, though. That apartment was his life, and harbored most of the opportunities he had. Besides, when his mom worked multiple shifts he could manage on his own. Any money he needed was supposed to come from his mother's life insurance. He only had access to a certain amount every week, for 'smart spending' they said. His father was also responsible for paying any bills regarding the apartment.

Izuku had been in the hospital for a couple of days, as they ran tests and looked over his body for injuries. Apparently he had been admitted into the hospital under a suspected head wound. They never found one. So they thought maybe all the blood on him came from somewhere else.

Thank god he encountered the villain on a Thursday afternoon, so he only missed one day of school, and had the weekend to spare. Izuku had walked home, and opened the door to his apartment. He sighed softly as the door creaked open.

"Hey, Midoriya!" A voice greeted from the inside. Izuku blinks, looking inside his apartment. "Oh, sorry for letting myself in."

"...Cosmic?"

“Yeah. I uh, know things might be hard for you right now so I made you dinner.” Cosmic rubbed the back of his neck. Izuku set his bag down at the door and walked inside. He paused when he saw Cosmic. He was in street clothes, only his mask and hood stayed on. The rest of his outfit was laid over the arm of the couch.

“Thank you, Cosmic, but...your costume?” Izuku asked.

“Well, if you’re going to be my trainee, I figured I should be more casual with you.” Cosmic set the food he made on the table and looked at Izuku. “Whenever you’re ready to start training, no rush, we can.”

Izuku felt hope spark in his heart for a second, a light in the dark path his life was headed towards. He would get into UA. He would become the best hero. For his mom, who had her life taken from her. He sat down across from Cosmic. He looked at his food. *Katsudon? Did he know it was my favorite?* Izuku looked at Cosmic.

“When can I start?”

“After we eat, if you want.”

“I want to train as much as possible. I need to become faster, so…what happened to my mom doesn’t happen again.” Izuku swallowed hard. *I have to be able to save more people. I can’t be useless.* Izuku thought, staring at his food.

“Of course, we can start there. We should focus on combat, especially if you want to be a vigilante before your hero career.” Cosmic looks at Izuku. “You have to be sure you want this.”

“I’m sure I want to. I really do.”

Cosmic watched Izuku’s eyes sparkle with determination. He smiled softly. “Then we’ll start after we eat.”

Once the two of them finished eating, Cosmic began to talk strategy. He showed Izuku some of his tactics and combat. He demonstrated it for Izuku, who was taking notes. His note taking was interrupted when Cosmic pulled him into a battle.

“You always have to keep your guard up, the unexpected can be what gets you killed.” Cosmic states, as he grabs Izuku’s arm, twists it, and flips him onto the ground. “Make sure you study your opponent, look for any obvious patterns.”

Izuku gasped for air when his back hit the floor. He struggled to breathe, but Cosmic pulled him up.

“How am I supposed to-” Izuku paused, “...Like how Kacchan always throws a right hook first.”

“I won't ask who that is, but yes. Paying attention to that when in a fight can literally save your life.”

This went on for most of the night. Actually, this pattern continued for a few months. Izuku would go to school, come home and do his work, meet with Cosmic once he finished his vigilante work, train, sleep, and then repeat. There were only four months left until the UA entrance exam, and Izuku had improved drastically. He was almost on the same level of Cosmic, who only held an advantage because of his quirk. A month into training, Cosmic had finally told Izuku a bit of his quirk.

Three Months Ago

Cosmic sat on the couch after a long training session, breathing heavily. He looked at Izuku, smiling as he wiped the sweat from his forehead.

“You’re not bad at this for just starting,” Cosmic’s took another breath. “..Is it that hero analysis thing you do? In your notebooks?” He quizzed, looking at an exhausted Izuku.

“My...My notes aren’t that impressive, they can’t really help me out since I'm quirkless..” Izuku sat next to Cosmic on the couch, letting his limbs sink into the cushions beneath him.

“I think they help you a lot.” Cosmic chuckled, “What’s your impression of me, Midoriya? I know you have to be trying to figure me out.”

Izuku blushed, “Was it that obvious?”

“Eh, yeah. You’re just that kind of person. Nothing wrong with trying to know as much as possible.” Cosmic looked at Izuku, “Go on, tell me what you have on me.”

“Um, well…You excel in creating gadgets. Seeing you in actual battle, I’ve noticed you come up with everything on the top of your head. Based on your physical ability, it couldn’t be your quirk. You move fast, but not abnormally quick, so that couldn’t be your quirk. Therefore, your quirk has to be mental. I’m not sure the specifics, but it seems to help you create things in your mind, then build them without any hesitation. You also seem to be able to predict others movements, almost being able to foretell them. I haven’t grasped the entire concept, and I don’t know if I’m close.”

“Huh...Not bad, Midoriya.” Cosmic smiled, “You're not far off.”

“I’m...not?”

“I named my quirk. It’s one of the rarer ones, I was told. Mind-Analyzation. Well, that’s what I call it now. Originally it was just called blueprint.” He looks at Izuku. “I could see any object made by a human and in my vision a holographic blueprint of the object would appear. It’s interactive, and it would separate the different parts. I could build anything almost exactly because of my quirk. For a while, I couldn’t control it once it manifested. I was always overwhelmed, and my brain was probably moving too fast for a kid my age.”

Izuku had picked up his notebook, and started taking notes.

“Once I managed to find an on and off switch for it, I became a curious kid. I probably rebuilt everything in my house. I used my quirk a lot. Overtime, I started to notice something changing in my quirk. I could see math equations that helped me predict the other people’s movements. It’s like I had started seeing blueprints of people's movements. Then I updated my quirk form, and that’s when they had me name it.” Cosmic relaxed against the couch. “So yeah, you’re not far off.”

“I- I have a question,” Izuku said, putting his pencil down.

“Shoot.”

“Do your parents know? Abo...About the vigilante thing.”

Cosmic visibly stiffened. He sat up, looking down at his shoes. Izuku watched his movements carefully, and went to apologize but was interrupted.

“No. I haven’t talked to my parents in a year or two. They kicked me out.”

“What-? That- That’s terrible..!”

“It’s fine.” Cosmic looks at Izuku. “I have...somewhat of a family now. It’s where my training came from, actually.”

“Wait, you were trained? By who-?”

“A story for another day, Midoriya! I should get going now.” Cosmic stood in a hurry, “I’ll see you tomorrow.” He walked over to the window and climbed out, disappearing.

Izuku blinked, *Maybe he doesn’t want to walk about it.*

Present Time

"Keep up!" Cosmic dashed along the rooftops, a clumsy Izuku following close behind him. "You're doing good!"

Izuku breathed heavily, trying to contain the adrenaline that was pumping through his blood. He had managed to convince Cosmic to take him in his patrol for the night. Izuku now regretted that, because now he was jumping from roof to roof following Cosmic. And holy shit was that boy was fast. Izuku knew he was quick, but seeing it in person is crazy.

Cosmic squatted on a ledge, pressing his earpiece into his ear a bit more. He looked at Izuku, smiling. "A rush, right?"

"More than a rush, it's scary!" Izuku complained, breathing heavily. He rested next to Cosmic, looking at him. "Do you do this everyday?"

"Mostly."

"Why-? I mean, I get why but," Izuku looks at the city under him. "You seem so smart, and...you spend your time doing something illegal."

"Honestly, Midoriya? I needed something to do."

"…What?"

"Remember when I told you about my quirk? How I was always overwhelmed, and my brain moving too fast at a young age? That path continued, I'm still like that." Cosmic glanced at Izuku. "My school even has this…special routine for me so my mind doesn't go into overdrive. The routine worked. It did for a while, it kept me busy. My mind at bay. Then

things were dying down, everyone was fine where they were and I wasn't needed as much. So I started doing this, just as a past time. I got more into it, more involved."

"Oh. I- I'm really sorry, Cosmic."

"Y'know, you're kind of in a nexus."

"A nexus?"

"A central link, a connection. It's like, you're standing in the middle of an intersection. Usually when people compare you to a nexus, you're pretty much in the middle of something."

"You think so..?"

"It's not a bad thing, it's just what you're going through. Pretty main character energy," Cosmic chuckled. A scream came from the alley below.

"Shit, follow me! And put your damn mask on." Cosmic said before jumping down. Izuku followed, stumbling from putting on his mask as he landed.

"Get back!!" A woman screamed, waving her purse at a group of men.

"C'mon lady. We just want the purse. Maybe a kiss on the cheek too." One teased.

Cosmic visibly gagged, before pulling something from his pocket. He pulled out a screwdriver and began to tweak the object in his hand.

"Cosmic?" Izuku whispered.

“Hold on,”

“I don’t think that lady has much time-”

“I got it, just breathe.” Cosmic said. A few seconds later, he threw the device into the alleyway.

“Hey, what’s that?” One of the men ask.

“Uh, no idea. It looks-”

POOF

A cloud of smoke filled the air, as the men started asking questions about what just happened.

“Now.” Cosmic said, before springing into action.

Izuku couldn’t even act before Cosmic had them all on the ground. Between the smoke, and how fast Cosmic moved, he hadn’t even realized it was over. Not until Cosmic called out to him.

“Hey, help me tie these guys up.”

Izuku blinked. He stared at the four guys that laid on the floor. “Uh- O...Okay.” He scrambled to grab the rope from Cosmic. He started tying them up as the lady began to thank Cosmic.

“Really, lady, it’s no issue. You should get going now, maybe to the police. File a report against these guys, say Cosmic sent you.” Cosmic waved the woman off. Once she left, Cosmic helped Izuku tie the guys to each other.

Cosmic and Izuku turned around to leave, but someone jumped down in front of them. Izuku felt a tight compression against his chest, while he watched Cosmic jump and flip back to avoid whatever got him.

“Cosmic. Who the hell is this?” A familiar, deep gruff voice said. Izuku focused his eyes and saw Eraserhead. He quickly put two and two together that he had been caught by his capture scarf.

“My sidekick, so if you’ll let him go that’d be great, Eraser.” Cosmic smiled, walking closer. “It’s his first night out, give him a shot.”

“Absolutely not. He’s coming to the station with me.”

“Ah, I’m sorry but I don’t think so.” Cosmic walked to Izuku, “Loosen this, yeah?”

“I can’t do that, Cosmic. You know that.”

“Then I will.” Cosmic tugged on the scarf, and it loosened. Aizawa grumbled, staring at Cosmic.

“When are you going to tell me where you learned that?”

“I’m smart, Eraser.” Cosmic smiled. “We’ll be on our way!”

“No, no. Not until you explain him.”

Izuku paused, gulping. “S-Sir, I’m really sorry-”

“Don’t apologize!” Cosmic huffed, “We talked about that.”

“Look, Cosmic. I have to book these guys. Don’t move,” Aizawa said, walking past both of them. Cosmic and Izuku glanced at each other. Cosmic leaped forward, pulling Izuku with him. Aizawa whipped around.

“Cosmic, I told you-!”

“Pish, posh, Eraser. See you later!” Cosmic jumped up onto the wall and jumped his way to the roof. He held a hand out to Izuku. “Jump!” Izuku did so, and Cosmic pulled him onto the roof.

“Cosmic, I’ll have you and your sidekick arrested.” Aizawa said tiredly.

“I...I have a name,” Izuku stuttered down to Aizawa.

“Yeah? Which is?” Aizawa asked halfheartedly.

“It’s...um. N...Nexus.”

Chapter End Notes

thank you guys for reading! you can leave headcanon suggestions here, or on my tiktok @eraserhkinnie !

Chapter Four

Chapter Summary

Aizawa thinks he might know who Cosmic is. Izuku is trained on a weapon Cosmic created just for him, and is told they would go out on another adventure together. What originally was an attempt to distract Izuku from his grief, it turns south and things get bloody.

trigger warning: blood mention

Chapter Notes

check my instagram, eraserhkinnie, for sneakpeaks to upcoming chapters!

check my insta for any major changes in the upload schedule

Chapter has been edited by beta on 9/12/23

Aizawa entered his apartment with a sigh, letting his shoulders drop. He walked into the kitchen, and started the coffee maker. He stared at it, pretty much falling asleep standing.

“Sho?”

“Hm.”

“It’s midnight. You don’t need coffee this late.” Aizawa turned around, looking at his husband, Present Mic. Hizashi walked closer to Aizawa, gently cupping his face. “Wanna tell me what happened on patrol?”

“Cosmic,” Aizawa muttered, putting his hand to Hizashi’s hand. “He managed to rope someone into joining him.”

“What? Really?” Hizashi quizzed, “Someone joined him?”

“Calls himself Nexus. He wears something similar to Cosmic, just…green.” Aizawa turned back to the coffee maker, taking the pot from it. He grabbed a mug and poured the coffee. “I don’t get it. Cosmic is tall but his voice tells me he’s in, or about to be in, high school. He’s really smart, he had managed to master my scarf in a matter of weeks. It took me six years.”

“Maybe it’s his quirk. Something intelligence related?” Aizawa watched Hizashi as he sipped his coffee, “It would explain those gadgets he makes in record time.”

“Do you think he’s a student?” Aizawa suddenly asked, “It’s been on my mind a while.”

“Any hero course student knows they couldn’t manage vigilante life and hero student life, Sho. Maybe only on the weekends. You and I both know you especially give them too much work for that.” Hizashi chuckled. “I think you should get some sleep.”

Aizawa paused, looking at Hizashi. He narrows his eyes, putting his coffee down. “Maybe he’s not a hero course student. What if he’s in the support course? That could be plausible.”

“Sho, you tell me you see his face. Bad scar, different colored eyes. Wouldn’t you recognize someone like that?”

“I would, if we could see their face.” Aizawa grinned, “I know a handful of students who don’t show their face. One in particular is smart enough to be Cosmic.”

“You don’t mean…But, he’s smart enough to know it’s illegal!” Hizashi bargained, “C’mon, that kid helps me make my English plans-”

“We’ll talk to Nezu on Monday.”

-

A few days later, Cosmic jumped into Izuku's window. He held a bag over his shoulder, landing quietly in the living room. Izuku had been in the kitchen, and turned to place a dish away. He jumped and screamed when he saw Cosmic.

"AH!" Izuku breathed hard, "Cosmic! Don't do that!"

"Sorry, I tried to make noise." Cosmic dismissed Izuku, "I have a few things for you." Cosmic threw the bag onto the couch. He dug through the bag, before picking up a newspaper. He cleared his throat, smiling.

" ***Vigilante Cosmic seen taking down villain with an unknown person. They assisted Cosmic in the recuse and capture, then proceeded to leave with them. Who is this mystery person, and are they Cosmic's new sidekick? Does Musutafu have another Vigilante to deal with?*** " Cosmic reads dramatically, falling onto the couch. "So, what do you think about your first media coverage?"

"Um…It's a little weird, to be honest. I wonder what they'd think if they found out I was quirkless." Izuku swallowed hard, "They'd probably think I was useless. Just how I was with that group of men. I did nothing to help you," Izuku looked off to the side, sadness in his eyes. Cosmic sat up and looked at him, lips parted in surprise.

"What? Midoriya, that's not true. You distracted them, threw them off. And even if you didn't do anything physical, you're new. That was your first time, and I don't expect you to be fast. Not yet." Cosmic looked at his bag, "C'mere. I wanted to give you a weapon."

"A wea-weapon?!"

"...Well yeah. I can create my gadgets, but you can't. You need some advantage. I was thinking maybe one of my staffs," Cosmic went through the bag, as Izuku walked over. "I really think it'll fit you." He pulled out a staff ranging from 110 to 125cm (3-4 feet), and handed it to Izuku.

“Wait, but...It looks normal.”

“Exactly. This is made from Tungsten. It’s the strongest type of metal, it’s from Sweden. It’s coated in a rubber coating, but it’s not that soft like texture, like regular rubber. It’s like that to help protect the user from electrocution.”

“Electrocution?!”

“...Yeah. So on this end,” Cosmic pointed to the tip of the staff. “It becomes a taser. The staff has buttons that only the user will know. They’re placed where the hand grips are so it’s discreet. Where your index finger lays on the hand grips, that turns on the taser. The middle finger position initiates the second impact mode. Remember when I fought that sludge villain? I used it then. The ring finger placement turns the staff into either nunchucks with a chain in the middle, or just a handle with a chain that would act as a capture weapon or whip. It has over 8 feet of chain. Press once for nunchucks, twice for the chain. The pinky finger placement releases a smoke screen. It produces enough to where it can cover about 20 feet. Lastly, the thumb turns the staff into projectiles. It’ll become four pieces. Three of them will automatically initiate a second impact when hitting a target. Your handle, which will also become a projectile, will act as a net to catch your suspect. The net is big enough to catch someone bigger than Fatgum.”

Izuku stared at Cosmic in amazement as he rambled about the staff, watching as Cosmic went under a trance. After about ten minutes of Cosmic’s ramblings, he stopped and looked at Izuku.

“Sorry.” Cosmic apologized, face reddening.

“You’re even more incredible than I thought…” Izuku said, “Can you repeat all that while I take notes?” Izuku pulled out his notebook and pen with an eager smile. Cosmic blinked, smiling softly.

“Of course, listen well. I won't repeat it again, *Nexus* .” Cosmic teased. Soon after, he started talking again. The two talked and made notes for hours, and eventually began to train on the staff use. Cosmic had probably been tazed about six times, hit in the nose three times, and

will most definitely have bruises formed tomorrow. At least Izuku hit hard, which was good for handing villains their own ass. Cosmic told Izuku to be ready earlier in the morning, since they'd be on their second official trip together.

The morning came and Izuku rolled out of bed, quite literally. He hit the floor with a thud, and whined in pain. He forced himself up, and sluggishly walked to his kitchen. He paused when he got there, pressing his lips together. The silence in his apartment was deafening. There was no mom to wake him up, there was no mom making breakfast. There was no mom. He swallowed hard, sitting on the couch. He didn't feel like eating breakfast, especially since his mom wasn't cooking it. He missed Inko a lot. Cosmic had helped him through most of the first stages of grief. Denial, Anger, Bargaining and a little bit of the depression part. He was still in that stage, slowly coming to acceptance. He'd find who killed Inko, and he'd make them pay. Not very heroic, he knows. He doesn't plan to kill them, but enough to make him wish he was dead.

Izuku had spaced out, wrapped in his own thoughts when he felt a hand on his shoulder. He reacted, grabbing the arm of the person and flipping them onto the ground. He twisted their arm, placing a foot on their back. He paused once the natural reaction wore off.

"Ow! Good one, but ow!" Cosmic said, "Could you let go?"

"Oh my goodness, Cosmic! I am so, so sorry. Please forgive me!" Izuku panics, letting him go and helping him up.

"My training's done you good, hasn't it?" Cosmic offered a smile, and brushed himself off. "I wasn't going to get here so early, but then I figured I would make you breakfast. A growing boy needs to eat." Cosmic ruffled Izuku's hair, and walked towards the kitchen. Cosmic knew deep down, Izuku was still hurting. He tried distracting Izuku as much as possible with the training, doing his best to make sure Izuku never had time to think of Inko. It was a weekend, so he knew Izuku would wake up to an empty house. He wanted to be there for him. The way he wanted to be treated, if someone had cared about him. Today was *that* day after all. The day he learned no one gives a shit about anyone but themselves.

Izuku nodded as a thank you to Cosmic, and he opened the staff he had been given the day before. He jumped when it extended quickly, back to the three to four foot frame it usually stands at. He held it, and began testing the buttons again. He wanted to master this as quickly

as possible, so Cosmic wouldn't have to clean up after him. Almost thirty minutes later, Cosmic sets their breakfast on the table. He calls Izuku over to eat, and the two eat in silence. Cosmic felt something tugging at his heart, and his attitude showed through his eyes.

"Cosmic?" Izuku asked softly. "Are you okay?"

"Yeah. Today's just the anniversary of a day I don't want to talk about." Cosmic poked his food. "I shouldn't be complaining. Hey, get ready. Nexus and Cosmic need to go on patrol." Cosmic smiled. Izuku found comfort in his smile, even though he couldn't actually see it. The way his eyes crinkled when he smiled, it showed sincerity. It helped ease wash over your body, it was a look that said you would be okay. Izuku didn't see that today. It was a sad look, a forced one. He decided he would question it later when he had the chance.

They finished their breakfast. Izuku admits, it was weird to see Cosmic turn every time he took a bite. He seemed very keen on keeping his identity a secret. Once Izuku got dressed, Cosmic handed him an earpiece.

"We'll be close, but if we get separated this is how you'll speak with me. Understood?"

"Understood."

"Then let's get going, Nexus." Cosmic jumped out of Izuku's window. Izuku followed, and the two started their day.

By the time dark came around, Izuku had helped Cosmic take down roughly twenty low-time villains. They had been too quick for any Pro-Hero to show up and stop the two of them, but they made sure to leave little notes saying they had been there. They also attached a slightly more hidden notes detailing the victim and the situation directly. Izuku managed to hear yelling coming from an alley and he called Cosmic's attention to it. So, Cosmic and Izuku found a spot above the alley, and watched the scene below.

"It's a couple who seem to be in their late thirties, with an infant who's exact age is undetermined," Cosmic reports aloud.

“Two men, a mugger and a lookout. Both armed, a gun in the lookout’s hand. The mugger seems to be holding a knife.” Izuku finishes, looking at Cosmic.

“Good. Nexus, you take the mugger. I’ll take the look out.” Cosmic said, “You ready?”

“As I’ll ever be.”

Cosmic jumped down, and grabbed the barrel of the gun. He redirected the gun to his right, snatching the weapon from the man. He turned the gun around, and hit him in the middle of his forehead. He went down immediately, and crumbled to the floor without a sound. Cosmic took the gun and clicked the safety on.

Izuku had jumped down as well. He landed on his feet, feeling slight pain shoot up his legs. He smiled at the sensation, it kick-started his adrenaline. The mugger looked at Izuku, pointing the knife at him. Izuku tilted his head, holding his hands up. The staff was in its smaller form, and Izuku watched the mugger carefully.

“Can I tell you something?” Izuku asked, masking his voice to be fearful.

“..What? I- Guess? Just spit it out!”

“Have you ever been tazed?”

With those words, Izuku sprung forward with the staff expanding. He hit the mugger in the ribs and he dropped the knife. He placed a foot onto the man’s chest, looking down at him. The mugger tried to react by grabbing Izuku’s legs and pulling him off. He pressed the staff’s tip to the man’s chest, and took his foot off of him. He tazed him for a second, enough to see the man go limp. Izuku turned his attention to the family.

“Are you okay??” He asked, giving them a comforting look.

“Yes, thank you boy..! Thank you so much,” The mother spoke, giving a sweet smile. “You saved us and our son, Kaizen!”

“I’m glad, ma’am. Um...Is...Is there a name we can have? To help with the report we do after a villain attack,” Izuku pulled out a notepad.

“Yes, we’re the Sakusei's. I’m Oto, and this is my wife, Anshin. Like she said before, this is our son Kaizen.” Oto said warmly, “Our bundle of joy.”

Cosmic walked over, assumedly after he tied up the lookout. He looked at Izuku, side glancing at the family. He began to speak.

“Do I need to tie this guy u-”

Cosmic visibly paused. His eyes locked with Anshin’s. He stared, his eyes darting around her face. His entire body had tensed, and he seemed vulnerable.

“Cosmic?” Izuku whispered. He then tried to place a comforting hand on his shoulder. “Hey, Cosmic. You’re being weird..”

Cosmic slowly turned to Izuku. “No. I...I’m fine. Perfectly wonderfully, okay and fine.”

Izuku looked at the family, “Please excuse Cosmic, they’ve had a tough day. Is there anything I can-”

A violent, uneasy sound echoed loudly throughout the alley.

Shnk!

Izuku felt his blood run cold. The blade that had pierced his side dug deep into his internal body. Blood began to soak into his outfit, once the knife was jaggedly removed from his side. He put a hand to where the pain had started to spread, and slowly fell to his knees. His knees collided with the ground, sending stiff shocks up his thighs. He took a sharp breath, feeling his face scrunch in pain.

" *Nexus!* " Cosmic yelled out, watching the blood pour through Izuku's fingers. "Shit, shit, shit, shit!" Cosmic turned to the mugger who laid on the ground with a sadistic smirk. He growled, grabbing the man by his hair.

For the first time in a long time, Cosmic let his rage power his punches.

After giving the mugger the beating of a lifetime, he ran to Izuku's side. He dropped to his knees, skidding on the hard pavement below him. He grabbed Izuku, and held him close to his body.

"Nexus? Nexus, can you hear me?"

"…Is that what being stabbed feels like?" Izuku asked, his voice weak. Cosmic paused for a brief moment, before nervously laughing.

"I, I guess, but Nexus you-"

"Don't cry, please. I can hear it..it in your voice. I-I'm okay, I...I'm losing a lot of blood…"

"I know! I'm...I'm so sorry for getting distracted, I'll get you somewhere-!"

"Cosmic..?"

“Yes? Yes, I’m right here.”

“Am I going to see my mom again?”

Cosmic broke down in tears, watching as Izuku’s eyes closed slowly. The shock from the stab, and the rush of adrenaline had overwhelmed Izuku’s body. He had passed out, still bleeding profusely as Cosmic held the wound tight.

“Nexus?” Cosmic asked. “Nexus, please,” He begged. “*Please* wake up, Nexus! You’re strong, please wake up. Wake up, wake up..!”

. . .

“Nexus!”

Chapter Five

Chapter Summary

A shocking discovery is made, and Cosmic opens up a bit more. Hizashi attempts to meet Cosmic after hearing about him all the time from Aizawa.

Chapter Notes

the next chapter will have a small timeskip to the entrance exam! i think i've put it off long enough
updates on wednesdays and sundays! <3

Chapter has been edited by beta on 9/12/23

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Soft humming echoed in Izuku's ears, waking him from his slumber. He sat up slowly in his bed and paused. He felt a rush go to his head, he placed a hand to his forehead. He felt…cold. Light, even. He stood slowly, looking at his feet. This felt so real that Izuku had forgotten he had been stabbed and passed out from the pain and adrenaline. He slowly inched towards his bedroom door, furrowing his eyebrows when the rest of his house seemed bright. He walked towards the kitchen, stopping abruptly when he saw someone standing over the kitchen.

"Oh! Afternoon, sweetie. I noticed you had fallen asleep so I cooked your favorite!" Inko turned to Izuku when she noticed him. "Go ahead and sit down, honey." She offered a large smile.

This isn't right, Izuku thought, struggling to reply to his very much alive mother. *Mom's dead.* Izuku couldn't find the words, so he just silently sat down. He studied Inko, watching her every move. He couldn't wrap his mind around why she was here. It was a normal day, and he had woken up just like he always did. Izuku looked at his hands, that's when he noticed something odd. His hands were transparent.

Wait, I was with Cosmic. We were talking to a family, and… Izuku felt his heart get heavy. *I was stabbed. Am I dead?*

"Oh, silly Izuku. Baby, you're not dead." Inko walked over, setting down the freshly cooked katsudon. "You aren't ready to be with me yet."

What? But I didn't say anything…? Izuku gulped, looking at Inko's face.

"Izuku, you might wake up very confused. Something that you never expect will happen when you wake up. Baby, I'm proud of you." Inko smiled, tears pricking her eyes. "I always will be."

"Midoriya!" A distant voice caught Izuku's attention.

Mom, I don't want to go yet. I miss you, please don't make me go! Izuku stood up quickly, tears spilling from his eyes. He hugged his mom tightly. *I wanna stay with you!*

Inko didn't respond, only hugging him back just a tight. The voice called out again.

"Midoriya, wake up!"

Izuku sobbed, holding his mom tighter. He begged and pleaded in his thoughts to not leave, telling Inko he wanted to stay with her. He felt a cool sensation on his face, which caused him to gasp.

Cosmic watched as Izuku shot up, and the cold rag he had placed on his face slid off. He grasped at his shirt, tears streaming down his cheeks. Cosmic let go of a breath he didn't know he was holding, he let his body relax.

"Oh thank god," Cosmic breathed, "You're not dead,"

Izuku looked at Cosmic, placing a hand to his side in a panic. Glancing around he noticed he was back at home, on the couch. He felt around the bandage Cosmic had used, “I-I saw my mom,” He spoke, voice barely audible. “She...she was here,”

Cosmic’s face softened, and he grabbed Izuku’s hand. “Did she say anything..?”

“She said…th-that something unexpected...w-would happen?” Izuku took a breath to calm down, “I don’t really...uh, understand wh-what she meant..”

Cosmic stared, eyes glancing down to Izuku’s bandage. “I think I know.”

“..What?”

“You remember being stabbed, right..?” Cosmic looked at Izuku. “You passed out pretty fast, but you probably lost about a pint of blood before I stopped the bleeding. It’s been about thirty minutes since then, and I brought you home too.”

“Ye-Yeah, I..I remember.” Izuku nodded.

“Let’s go look at your wound.” Cosmic offered a hand to Izuku, and helped him up. Izuku felt pins and needles in his side, but no pain. He walked to the bathroom with Cosmic, who slowly removed his bandage. Izuku felt sick, surprise and shock rushing through his body.

“...There’s nothing there.” Izuku said, looking at Cosmic.

“Nothing but a slight mark. That looks like it’ll disappear eventually.” Cosmic looked at Izuku. “You were stabbed with an army knife. Izuku, you were *stabbed* . And it’s gone. The wound is gone.”

Izuku felt his head spin, trying to reason with this new discovery. “It’s...It’s that guy's quirk, maybe?”

“Oh it’s a quirk,” Cosmic smiled into the mirror, Izuku looked at him through it. “It’s not his though.”

“Then...is it yours?”

“No, it’s yours, Midoriya!” Cosmic chuckled, “Remember when I saved you a few months ago? You had blood and torn clothes, but there wasn’t any wound. You have some form of a regeneration quirk.”

Izuku looked down at the wound, feeling confused. He ran a thumb over it, gulping softly. He had a quirk this entire time? His entire life, he had a quirk. It just was never fully seen, he had certainly never been cut or stabbed before.

“Do you remember what you said before you passed out?” Cosmic asked. Izuku shook his head. “You asked *‘Is this what being stabbed feels like?* ’.” Izuku laughed softly.

“Did I really?”

“Yes, you did. You scared the shit out of me, Midoriya.” Cosmic walked back into the living room, Izuku following while taking off the rest of the bandage. Cosmic threw him a hoodie, and Izuku slipped it on. “Honestly I thought you died, I know the stab wound wasn’t too bad but I was worried it hit an important organ and it killed you.”

“...Did you cry?” Izuku asked, teasingly lightly.

“What? Of course not. I knew you were going to pull through once I laid you on the couch.” Cosmic said. Izuku shared a look with him, before Cosmic sighed. “Okay, yeah. I did cry.”

“Aw you care about me!”

“Oh shut up-” Cosmic nudged him playfully. The two eventually fell into silence, and Izuku looked at Cosmic.

“Those people we saved,” Izuku started. “You froze when you saw them.” Izuku saw Cosmic visibly tense, the same way he did before. Cosmic swallowed hard.

“That…I’ve seen them before. I saved their son once.”

“What was his name…Kaizen?”

“No. Their first son. Riso. Or, I think that was his name.” Cosmic looked at his wrist, twisting the bracelet on it. “They kicked him out of their house. He...wasn’t good enough for them I guess. He needed help so I did that.”

“What? Did he do anything bad?” Izuku questioned.

“Nothing illegal or morally wrong.” Cosmic shook his head. “He brought home his partner.”

“Oh! Was she really rude or..?”

“*He* was really sweet.” Cosmic looked at Izuku, “I met the guy, he and I helped Riso move some of his things out of his house.” Izuku blinked.

“They threw him out because he wasn’t straight?” He asked, dumbfounded.

“Yeah. Then a week after, Riso’s boyfriend broke up with him when he had a freak-out and accidentally hurt him. Seeing…his parents hurts I guess. The fact that they seem like such

good people, it just stings."

Izuku frowned. "I guess you're right. I feel bad about it…He got kicked out for being himself."

"Yeah." Cosmic stood, "He's got a place to stay now. I check in on him occasionally."

-

Meanwhile, Aizawa stood in front of the security desk of the apartment building. He came to the scene where Nexus and Cosmic had been, where unknowingly to Aizawa currently, Nexus had been stabbed. His reaction to one of the men they took down was shocking. The mugger was beaten half to death, his face covered in blood. Aizawa thought it was abnormal to see a criminal so beaten, with Cosmic's name tag on him. He asked the security guard of the apartment building that was in the alley if he could see the tapes, figuring they might have a view. He watched the video start, cringing at the horrible quality.. He felt uneasy, watching the mainly harmless vigilante he knew so well punch with the thought to kill.

Nexus looked at the family, "Please excuse Cosmic, they've had a tough day. Is there anything I can-"

A violent, uneasy sound echoed loudly throughout the alley.

Shnk!

Nexus fell to his knees after a second, hand going to his side. The mugger pulled a knife from his side, it falling to the ground. The mugger had smiled up at Cosmic, who had yet to notice him.

"Nexus!" Cosmic yelled out, watching the blood pour through Izuku's fingers. "Shit, shit, shit, shit!" Cosmic turned to the mugger, and his shoulders tensed. He grabbed the man by his hair, pulling his face up enough to look him in the eyes.

The first punch caused a crack to sound from the man's face. His nose instantly began to pour blood. The next punch busted a cut into the man's cheek. Each punch was hard enough to be heard clearly on the footage. Cosmic didn't seem to hesitate as he kept punching. Once he seemed satisfied, he threw the man onto the ground. He didn't move and laid motionless on the ground. Cosmic turned to Nexus and ran to his side. They exchanged a few words, too soft to be caught on the camera. The only audible thing was Cosmic's cry out for Nexus.

"Nexus!" Came out in a sob, and Cosmic picked him up by his knees and held his back. He held the boy close, and quickly ran off.

Aizawa blinked, playing the video back. He watched Cosmic throw the punches a few times over and over again. He pulled out his phone, recording the rage induced punches. Pocketing the phone, he stood up.

"Thanks."

"Do you want me to turn this into the police?" The guard asked, stopping the tape.

Aizawa paused for a minute, before speaking. "No. Just keep an extra tape of that incase it's needed. It's not needed right now." Aizawa walked out the apartment, mentally scowling at himself. *God, Hizashi would tease me if he knew I hid evidence from the police,* Aizawa thought to himself. He couldn't help it. He had watched Cosmic get thrown through buildings, beaten, insulted and yelled at. Cosmic never, ever lost his cool enough to beat someone senseless. He'd let it slide. This time. *I'm not going to do this again. The kid has one chance, that's it.*

Aizawa was bombarded when he got home, arms wrapping around him the second he entered the door.

"Go on, tell me about it! There's already videos of Cosmic and his new sidekick!" Hizashi smiled wide. "I'm curious, did you run into them?" Aizawa sighed, craving coffee the moment he heard his husband speak.

“No, I never caught up with them.” Aizawa looked at Hizashi, “Can you let me go?”

“Oh, yes, sorry.” Hizashi separates himself from Aizawa. “Something’s bothering you, I can see it.” Aizawa looked at him, before rolling his eyes.

Hizashi stared at Aizawa’s phone in disbelief, watching Cosmic beat the criminal. “He- doesn’t normally react like that. Right?”

“He’s never done that. I wonder what makes Nexus different.” Aizawa sat at the kitchen island. He grabbed a cup of coffee Hizashi had already prepared for him.

“Maybe they’re lovers!” Hizashi teases.

“More realistically, Cosmic sees himself in Nexus.” Aizawa glares at Hizashi. “I think I would’ve heard from Cosmic if he had a lover. He talks a lot when we do manage to run into each other.”

“Or, he doesn’t trust you and I should talk to him!”

“No, Hizashi.” Aizawa shook his head. “We’re not switching patrols so you can run into Cosmic.”

“Please!” Hizashi pleaded, “You get to see all the fun stuff! I’m curious about this kid, he’s making your hair turn gray faster than your actual students!”

“No. I said no, Hizashi.”

They switched patrols for tomorrow.

Aizawa thought maybe it was the best compromise, Cosmic had seen Nexus get stabbed and probably was nursing him back to health. It wouldn't hurt to check hospitals tomorrow, but Hizashi's chances of meeting Cosmic were low. He didn't need his husband telling Cosmic something stupid.

After sundown the next day, Hizashi gave Aizawa a kiss before he went out for patrol. He understood why he was never chosen for night patrols, his quirk was literally being ungodly loud. He would try to keep people unbothered for the night. He ran into a few captured villains and criminals, and once he searched the body he found Cosmic's capture card.

Happy birthday! -Cosmic

Merry Christmas, this one belongs on the naughty list. -Cosmic

Is Eraser reading this? Cool, I was faster than you ;) -Cosmic

I have a joke. Knock, knock. Who's there? Cool. Cool who? Cooler than you! -Cosmic

The notes were quite funny to Hizashi, and they definitely lightened the mood. Hizashi felt hopeful, this meant Cosmic was active tonight. He almost walked past a villain attack if he hadn't heard the villain call out.

"What *is* that thing?!" The villain sounded confused, and screamed in pain. She was thrown against a wall, and fell into a pile of trash bags. Hizashi dashed over, ready to help anyone in need. He jumped back when he saw a flash of black run by him. He saw the villain jump up, and swing her arm towards the figure. From her arm, blades flew out. The figure jumped over them, hands busy making something.

"Mm, so close yet so far!" Something latched onto the girl's arm, as she desperately tried to shake it off.

“How are you making these?!” Her arm suddenly collided with the dumpster, sticking her to it. “Damn kid, did you just magnetize me to the dumpster?!”

“Well, trash belongs in the dumpster. Does it not?”

Ah. Cosmic. Hizashi thought, stepping behind the corner to watch.

Cosmic jumped onto the dumpster, looking down at the villain with a tilted head. “Give up yet? I’d stop now if I were you,”

“Fuck off!”

“Wrong answer.” Cosmic grabbed her head, and slammed it into the dumpster once. She fell limp, resting against the dumpster. Cosmic jumped down and started to write something on a piece of paper.

“Hey, hey!” Hizashi rounded the corner with a smile, “Nice catch!”

Cosmic jumped, throwing his pen at Hizashi. He managed to dodge, and he locked eyes with Cosmic.

“Present Mic? Your patrol is in the day! I am so sorry,” Cosmic apologized, putting away his notepad. “...Wait. What are you doing here?”

“I figured it was time I met the infamous Cosmic. You give Eraserhead a lot of trouble, you know that right?” Hizashi chuckled. “Don’t worry, my mission isn’t to catch you. Not yet at least.”

Cosmic walked towards Hizashi a little. “Okay. Uh…well, is there anything you want to know or..?”

“Yeah. How’s Nexus?” Cosmic paused when his name left Hizashi’s mouth.

“He’s okay. Why?”

“You seem to be close. Can I ask why?”

“That’s a loaded question.”

Hizashi chuckled at Cosmic’s hesitation. “Well, we’re just curious. Mainly I am. I saw the tape, of yesterday. What makes a mostly pacifist beat someone close to death?”

“He’s just someone who’s been mistreated. I know what that’s like, and I want to give him the chance I never had.” Cosmic answered shortly. “That’s none of your business, Mic. Nexus and I are just close friends. He’s someone I would do anything for. I have to go,” Cosmic cleared the wall, sighing softly.

“I’m sorry for being rude. But just because you don’t want to catch me, doesn’t mean I can trust you. I don’t even trust Eraser.”

Hizashi stood shocked as Cosmic dashed away. *I should ask Hound Dog about what kind of trauma that is. He doesn’t seem to like change much at all.*

Hizashi continued the patrol, seemingly two steps behind Cosmic every time. It’s not that Hizashi was bad at his job, it just proved Aizawa’s theory of Cosmic being a certain support course student even more.

If Sho is right, I don’t think any of us will be able to stop him.

Chapter End Notes

i'm open to any headcanon ideas since we haven't met class 1a yet! recommd ships or just headcanons at your will! i do have plans for this being a bakudeku fic and i have plans for shinso.
also, please feel free to tell me your opinions on Cosmic!

Chapter Six

Chapter Summary

Izuku competes in the entrance exam! Afterwards, him and Cosmic go on a patrol.

Chapter Notes

Not looking forward to having to write major parts in the show—so most of it probably won't be very accurate!

Chapter has been edited by beta on 1/20/24

See the end of the chapter for more notes

After more months of training, the UA entrance exam was finally upon Izuku. Izuku and Cosmic had gotten more in tune with each other, news of their partnership spreading. Nexus was just as well known as Cosmic, and Izuku was confident in his ability to perform in the entrance exam. For the past month, Cosmic had taken Izuku's staff. In the entrance exam, you weren't allowed support items unless you put in an official request beforehand.

Izuku felt nervous going into the exam anyway, he knew his newfound quirk wouldn't give him advanced agility, speed, or strength. His training with Cosmic would have to help him. It was all he had, and he had no idea what UA would throw at him. Cosmic gave him a supportive thumbs up and a small talk before he walked onto the UA campus.

"Midoriya, you're going to do great. I'm telling you. You're smart enough to pass the written part, and I guarantee these ten months of training we've been doing is going to pay off. Remember everything I told you, there are weak spots in any opponent. Good luck!"

Oh boy, was Izuku going to need it.

Izuku walked up to the steps of UA, hearing a voice call out to him.

“Stupid Deku. Get out of my way now! Before I set you on fire.” Bakugo growled, and Izuku stiffened.

“Ohheyg’morningumlet’sjustbothdoourbestsoutthereokay? Goodluck!” (Oh, hey g’morning um let’s just both do our best out there okay? Good luck!)

Bakugo walked past Izuku, barely batting an eye. Izuku took a breath, shaking his head. He had told Cosmic he would stop being scared of Bakugo, but he just couldn’t help it. Whenever Bakugo looked at him, his red eyes seemed to burn into fire. He felt like he was being burned by a curling iron every time they locked eyes. He wished Bakugo wasn’t so mean towards him, and was nicer like he was before his quirk manifested. Personally, Izuku thought his kindergarten teachers inflated his ego so much that he was top heavy. Not that Izuku would ever admit that. Izuku watched Bakugo walk away from himself, and he sighed softly.

He began to walk again, and immediately tripped on his feet. Oh c’mon, was he that nervous?

For the second time in Izuku’s life, he never hit the floor from the fall. He flailed his arms and legs quickly back and forth, a surprised scream coming from his lips. Arm wrapped around his body and sat him upright, onto his feet.

“Heh, sorry for using my quirk on you without asking! I figured you didn’t want to fall,” A girl with brown hair smiled at Izuku.

“Oh! Th-Thanks,” Izuku said softly. He matched the girl’s smile.

“In order to hide your identity from the public, it might be best to try to change your personality. Especially since Eraserhead is a teacher at UA. He’d be able to snuff you out immediately, I’m sure.”

Izuku needed to take Cosmic’s words seriously. He’d be in a lot of danger, and he could ruin his chances at becoming a hero.

“Isn’t this, like, totally nerve racking?” The girl asked, pressing her hands together.

“A-A little,” Izuku answered back, nodding slowly.

“Right? Anyway, I should get going! Nice talking with you!” She walked away, waving to Izuku. Izuku gulped, and walked into the school. He prepared himself for the written exam, feeling the time fly by. Before he knew it, they were being briefed on how the physical exam would work.

He cringed when he got put next to Bakugo, feeling his heart rate increase drastically. He tried to focus on what Present Mic was explaining, but kept finding his eyes drifting towards Bakugo. He got extremely embarrassed when a kid stood up and said a few words, calling Izuku’s hair messy in the process. He was beyond relieved when he noticed him and Bakugo were in two different testing locations.

He felt his hair on the back of his neck stand up while he stood up in front of the large door. He tried his best to ignore the stares and words being exchanged about him, but noting that everyone had already written him off and didn’t see him as a threat. He would change their views.

Present Mic stood above the wall, smiling. “Well?! What are you waiting for?? In the real world, there’s no bell!”

Izuku sprung into action before the rest of the group. He weaved his way between the people, finding himself to be the first in the fake city. He ran down the street, looking for the robots that would be giving points.

He hadn’t had any luck, everyone was being extremely aggressive. Izuku felt overwhelmed, and struggled to find a robot before others destroyed it. He heard someone softly cry out after the zero pointer showed itself, grunting as they tried to free themselves from rumble. Izuku’s head snapped in their direction, and his eyes widened. It was the girl from earlier, trapped under the rumble. She was trying to pull herself from it, but her legs were trapped.

Izuku didn’t take a second to dart over. He went straight for the zero pointer, knowing there was no time to pull her from the rubble without risking both their lives. He noticed a downed powerline, completely ripped from both ends. *Good. No electrical current if it’s not connected.* Izuku grabbed it, using his momentum to sling it around it's arm. He pulled it as tight as he could, and got a running start. It swung it's arm in an attempt to, most likely, kill Izuku. He held onto the cord tight, muttering prayers as it swung Izuku high in the air. He struggled to control himself in the air, but he landed on the back of the robot’s head. He held on, and tied the dead electrical cord to a loose bolt. He gulped, looking at the live wire that was zapping. He swung down, holding onto the cord as he slid down. He threw the cord with great precision as it hit the live wire.

The zero pointer began to jolt, sparks flying everywhere. Izuku smiled to himself when the red beaming lights the robot had for eyes died down. The body fell backwards, away from the girl. His smile faded when he realized he was free falling. He wouldn’t survive this fall, no matter the training he had. He looked around frantically, trying to find a way to land safely.

Funny. Just ten months earlier, Izuku was in this same position. Except, this time Izuku *wanted* to live and survive the fall.

He closed his eyes, expecting contact with the ground. He abruptly stopped inches from the ground, then gently dropped. He heard the girl, who had managed to pull herself free, speak.

“And release!” She huffed, lumping over the piece of rubble she was on top of. She began to throw up, and Izuku turned away from her. His muscles had locked up, and he was laying on the floor. He forced himself to his feet.

“I...I have to get at least one point,” Izuku muttered, his muscles stiff from taking down the zero pointer.

“Time’s up!” Present Mic yelled out, an alarm sounding throughout the battlegrounds. Izuku stiffened.

He had no points. He had *nothing.* There was no way he was getting into UA with zero points. No way. Izuku felt his body sway, and tears pricked to his eyes.

C'mon, Izuku! Don't cry because you didn't do good. You're not a crybaby anymore. Izuku told himself. He hadn't realized the headache he had from swinging in the air, or the fact that his limbs felt like Jell-O. He just had to accept that UA wasn't an option anymore. Cosmic tried, but Izuku failed. He wouldn't be surprised if Cosmic told him he couldn't be a vigilante with him anymore.

The walk home was brutal. Izuku had been calling himself useless, dumb, unworthy the entire way there. He let out a breath, walking up to his apartment door. He doesn't even deserve this stupid apartment. Or life. Why *did* Cosmic save Izuku? Maybe he would've been born with a more useful quirk if he was never saved from that fall.

"Midoriya!" Cosmic's voice snapped him out of his trance, and he looked over. Izuku's heart ached when he made eye contact.

"Hi," He said softly. He walked into the apartment after setting his things down at the door. Izuku sat on the couch, eyes on the ground.

"...What's wrong?" Cosmic sat next to him, putting a supportive hand on his back. "Did something happen?"

"I know I barely passed the written exam. But I didn't score any points in the physical exam."

"But you did amazing!" Cosmic paused, "...Not like I was watching or anything,"

"Cosmic, were you- there?" Izuku looked at him.

"I was watching from a distance. I mean, c'mon how could I not? I wanted to see how you did."

"Well I did horrible."

“That’s not true. You saved someone’s life, didn’t you? That’s gotta be worth something. UA is the most famous and successful school for Heroes. Their entrance exam can’t *just* be how many robots you can take down.” Cosmic theorized. “There has to be some reward for rescue, don’t you think?”

Izuku sighed. “No, they’re probably just testing how capable we are.”

“If I were a famous hero school, I’d want to see how many people prioritize rescue over brute force. I mean, like Thirteen? She’s just a rescue hero. People are good at different things, it’s not exactly fair to go based on how flashy their quirk is. Like, Eraserhead. He’s a Pro-Hero, right? He doesn’t have a flashy quirk and most of the time he fights quirkless.” Izuku stared at Cosmic, chewing on his bottom lip.

“You think I still have a chance?”

“Of course I think so, Midoriya. *I* trained you after all. So what about some Katsudon?” Cosmic stood. “Then we can go on patrol if you want.”

Izuku smiled. Cosmic really was his savior, wasn’t he?

After Cosmic finished cooking and the two finished their meal, they got ready to patrol. Izuku felt like he needed to get his mind off the fate of his Hero career, and just be the savior some other person might have needed. Cosmic flung himself out the window, Izuku following. Izuku had gotten faster, and could actually keep himself next to Cosmic as he sprung around.

Cosmic stopped, looking over a street. Throughout the street people were continuing with their night as usual. Something felt off about it to Cosmic, and he turned to Izuku.

“Do you feel it?”

“Feel what?”

“The tension. I mean, something doesn’t look right. Like there’s going to be an ambush.” Cosmic pulled something from his pocket, and tapped it. It buzzed to life, and flew down to the street.

“Is that a fly robot,” Izuku asked. “Do you actually have a fly robot?” He laughed a little, nudging Cosmic.

“Yes, I do! They are most effective.” Cosmic pressed his earpiece and Izuku heard the noise from the street come into his own earpiece. Cosmic really was a genius when it came to gadgets and spying.

“What should we have for dinner?”

“Mommy, mommy! Can we please get cake??”

“I wonder when the mailman will come with the new shipment of All Might merch…”

“Do you have the stuff?”

Cosmic stiffened when he heard this sentence. He listened closer.

“You don’t need it, idiot.”

“C’mon. The Americans use drugs, why can’t we?”

“You don’t know what that’ll do to your quirk.”

"Then let's find out!"

"Uh, no. Your quirk is already dangerous enough considering you like to win fights."

"Dude! Just because I can make people not want to hurt me, doesn't mean the drugs will change that to any degree!"

Cosmic shakes his head. "Sounds like his quirk makes people pacifist. Nexus, I need you to tase him so we can apprehend him without him using his quirk."

"Got it!"

Cosmic nods. He jumps down, and lands behind the two men. He easily knocks out the one who seemed to withhold the drugs from the other man. He was out cold, and didn't budge after he went down. Cosmic turned to the other guy, who had a smirk on his face.

Shit. His quirk probably works when he looks at you. I want to knock him out, but I…I can't. Cosmic cursed to himself as he just stood there. The guy stood tall, about 6'5". He had muscle, and looked naturally strong. He cracked his knuckles, tilting his head to crack his neck.

"You're that Cosmic kid, aren't ya? You took down my buddy the other day. I'll have you pay for that!" He swung at Cosmic, who jumped out of the way.

"Your quirk might make me a pacifist, but that doesn't mean I can't dodge!"

"How do you know that you little shit?!" He yelled out, grabbed a beer bottle that was on the ground. He threw it at Cosmic, who ducked barely at the right time. It shattered against the brick wall behind Cosmic, who whipped around to see the remaining glass on the floor. He cockily looked back at the villain.

“Missed me.” Cosmic snickers.

“You-!” The villain stopped talking when he felt a gust of wind from behind him. He turned around quickly, catching the staff that Izuku was about to hit him with. “Hey, kid. What do you think you’re doing with that?” Izuku visibly gulped.

Cosmic growled, grabbing the lid of a trash can. He kicked off the wall for momentum, and struck down hard on the villain. “Eat shit, asshole! That’s my partner you’re threatening to hurt!” The villain grunted in pain, and shook Cosmic off of his shoulder. He let go of the staff and turned to Cosmic. He raised his hand, and Izuku activated the taser and stuck it to the villain’s skin. He stiffened, shaking and falling to the ground. Izuku took a breath.

“That could’ve been bad.” He said softly, looking at Cosmic. “Are you okay?”

“Yeah, I am. Something still feels…off.” Cosmic glanced around, watching everyone’s movement. That’s when he saw it. He noticed a group of guys making their way to him and Izuku. One raised his hands, and threw a knife at them. “Shit, Nexus look out!” Cosmic dashed out in front of Izuku, pulling him back. He seethed in pain when the blade stuck into his hand, but he continued to pull Izuku from danger.

“Wha- Who was that?!” Izuku asked, then noticed the blade in Cosmic’s hands. “What the- Cosmic, your- your hand!”

“I’m fine.” Cosmic gritted his teeth. The group of men stopped when they found their way to the two of them.

“What’s your business taking down our friends, huh?”

“Well last time I checked, drug dealing is illegal.” Cosmic sassed. “What’s *your* business dealing illegal substances?”

“Listen here, kid,” The guy started to talk. “We won’t take any shit from fucking teenagers.”

In a quick few seconds, all of the guys were wrapped together in a gray flash. Cosmic quietly sighs of relief when he hears a familiar gruff voice.

“Then take it from a Pro-Hero.” Aizawa huffed, pulling his goggles away from his eyes. He also knocked them out for good measure. Aizawa hadn’t had a nap *or* coffee in a few hours, and he really didn’t want to deal with whiny villains. He turned to Cosmic and Nexus, and Cosmic smirked. His eyes crinkled differently when he smirked, and at this point Aizawa could hear it in his voice.

“Hey, Eraser!” He chirped, “You wouldn’t happen to need evidence, would you?”

“Technically.” Aizawa said, staring at him. He went to ask why, when Cosmic held up his hand. Sticking through it was a knife. Blood pooled around the wound, Cosmic’s gloves being cut by the sharp object. Aizawa blinked, and sighed.

“This counts, right?” Cosmic tilted his head curiously, but very clearly knowing the answer.

“Cosmic! That doesn’t hurt??” Nexus asked, concerned and slightly frantic.

“Cosmic.” Aizawa started. “I’m really tired. Can you just give it to me, or leave?” He would never admit it, but he was worried whenever Cosmic acted like this. It wasn't the first time, and Aizawa had seen it plenty of times. The kid liked to play his pain off in a way to let others know it doesn’t actually hurt, when in reality it does. Unless Cosmic has a pain tolerance quirk, he highly doubts a knife clean through his hand *doesn’t* hurt.

“Yeah,” Cosmic’s eyes fluttered slightly when he pulled the knife from his hand. Aizawa grabbed Cosmic’s hand instead of the knife. He pulled a bandage from his pocket and forced it into Cosmic’s hand.

“Put it on, apply pressure. Clean it, and if you’re stupid enough, ten pound fishing string works best for home-made stitches.” Aizawa said before leaving with the knife.

“Thanks, Eraser!”

The trip home consisted of a bunch of ‘are you okay?’ ‘that doesn’t hurt??’ ‘you should go to a hospital!’ from Izuku. Cosmic brushed off all the comments, and assured Izuku he was fine. When they finally got to Izuku’s apartment, Cosmic cleaned and bandaged the cut. He also put a bag of ice onto the wound.

“Midoriya, you did really well today. The entrance exam, the patrol. I don’t think you’ll have to worry about much.”

“You really think so..?”

“Of course. You should give yourself more credit. You’re destined for hero work. Hopefully you’ll be able to tell All Might to suck it, and even replace him on the charts.”

“What? No, I...I don’t think I could ever be the number one hero!” Izuku stuttered, shaking his head. “Besides, Kacchan would murder me...”

“ *Kacchan* can also suck it, Midoriya. You saved his life.”

“He only sees that as a challenge!”

“Then I dunno, want me to tase him?”

“No!”

Chapter End Notes

the wound Cosmic got is very important for later! I do plan on revealing Cosmic's true identity slowly, but I'm sure you guys will figure it out quickly <3

updates on wednesdays and sundays!

Chapter Seven

Chapter Summary

This includes Izuku's acceptance letter, and his first day of school! He meets an unexpected face on his first day.

Chapter Notes

this chapter jumps around a bit, sorry guys :(also i fucking adore it when you guys comment it makes me so so happy <3

Chapter has been edited by beta on 1/20/24

See the end of the chapter for more notes

The next couple of weeks were a long wait for UA's acceptance letter. In the time they waited, Cosmic never went to any medical professional for his hand. So he still had a bandage wrapped around it. He preferred to wear a glove over it so Izuku wouldn't bug him about the obvious injury. Izuku also took down two villains completely by himself because Cosmic accidentally got distracted by a cat. And the two of them got scolded by Aizawa, and almost taken to jail. A few very eventful days.

Cosmic burst in the door, looking at Izuku.

"They sent a letter!" He held up an envelope. "They sent a letter!!"

Izuku held his breath, grabbing it from Cosmic in a hurry. He looked at the seal, running a thumb over it. He looked at Cosmic, who ushered him to open it. Izuku sat on the couch, and stared at it. For a few seconds, he didn't move. Suddenly, he ripped it open and a disk clinked against the table. A hologram appeared and projected itself against Izuku's wall, and a loud voice spoke.

"I AM HERE!...As a projection!" All Might's chirpy voice pierced Izuku's ears.

“They had *him* do the stupid announcements?” Cosmic asked, irritation lining his voice.

“Truth is-” A cough erupted from his lips. “Apologies, young man! Truth is, I didn’t just come here to fight villains! You’re looking at the newest, best, faculty member of UA High!” Izuku and Cosmic cringed almost in sync, watching the number one Pro-Hero flex his muscles at the camera.

“Izuku Midoriya!” All Might straightened his posture. “You passed the written exam! As you’re aware, you scored zero combat points!”

“Why does he sound so happy saying that?” Cosmic sneered, “What an ass.”

“I know I didn’t score any points…That means I failed…” Izuku swallowed hard, forcing his tears back.

“But! I shall inform you, something nice happened! A young girl came to the staff about you!” All Might said, motioning to a second screen in which a video began to play.

“Um...Excuse me,” A girl said softly, walking in what Izuku and Cosmic could only assume was the staff room.

“Hey..! That’s the girl with the floating quirk..!” Izuku said, sitting forward. Cosmic tilted his head, watching on.

“Hey there! Is everything okay?” Present Mic’s voice came through the video.

“I...I wanted to talk about the kid that saved me. He has freckles, um…messy green hair. He looks pretty normal, doesn’t stand out much…? He...he saved me from that zero pointer,” She said, fumbling with her hands. “He mentioned something about scoring just one point, and…

and then he couldn't. Because of me…! So...So I was wondering if you could give him my points?? I owe it to him!" She seemed desperate, her face scrunching in determination.

"Hey, hey now! We appreciate your concern, but he already passed." Present Mic put a hand on her head. "That was very nice of you."

The video paused, and All Might took over the screen once again. "Did you hear that, Izuku Midoriya? The girl you saved was ready to give up her points for you!"

Izuku already had tears spilling from his eyes, a supportive hand on his back.

"The exam wasn't just based on combat skills! Rescue points were included in the final score, as that's what real heroes would do!" Izuku's eyes widened, as he continued to talk. "Teachers sit in a room, and they grade each rescue with a score out of ten! You, young Midoriya, earned 60 rescue points!"

"Wh...What?" Izuku asked softly, his eyes beginning to shine with happiness.

"You have successfully been accepted into UA Highschool! This is your hero academia, young Midoriya!"

Once the projection died, Cosmic slowly turned to Izuku. He studied his face slowly, and then smiled.

"I told you so!" Izuku looked at Cosmic in (happy) tears. He chuckled, wiping his cheek.

"What..?"

"I told you UA had more than just stupid combat points!"

The two shared a laugh, and Izuku smiled happily at Cosmic.

“I...I really got in. I’m going to UA High!”

“Hell yeah you are!” Cosmic smiled, nudging Izuku. “I’m so proud of you.”

-

While Cosmic and Izuku celebrated, something couldn’t leave Aizawa’s mind. He had been there when everyone witnessed Midoriya take down that bot. He was shocked, watching a teenager move with such grace under pressure. He would’ve expected elegance like that from a recommendation kid, like Shouto Todoroki, whose father was Endeavor. He definitely felt surprised, something he hadn’t felt while watching entrance exams. He did recognize the style though. That had Cosmic written all over it.

But then again, considering how torn up the kid was about his mothers death, he couldn’t manage to do anything vigilante related for a while. This kid wasn’t Cosmic either, he was too small. He could be Nexus, but Aizawa figured he would’ve shown himself in the movements more. Nexus also acted completely differently than what was shown on the security footage.

Izuku Midoriya was a shy, timid kid who had hard times talking to others. Nexus was a bold, reckless character who could take down anything if he tried hard enough. They didn’t match up.

Aizawa didn’t press the subject anymore after that day, and he surely wasn’t surprised when the kid got into the school. He was not looking forward to whatever teacher got him as a student.

Cosmic and Izuku had decided to chill together on the roof of his apartment building, as they talked back and forth.

“Hey, Zuku?” Cosmic asked softly.

“Yeah?”

“I saw you bump into that kid you saved. Katsuki Bakugo.” Cosmic started. “Why do you call him Kacchan again?”

“We were childhood best friends.” Izuku started, “I told you briefly before, but he got his quirk before I got mine.”

“And he bullied you, right?” Cosmic looked at him. “That’s why your notebook was burnt?”

“He didn’t mean it. Well, he did. But…I don’t know, Auntie Mitsuki is really mean to Kacchan. I know he was really mean to me but I still see the best in him.” Izuku fiddled with his sleeve. “Our teachers were no help either. Things were different for quirkless kids. No one minded, and it was probably weird *not* to pick on me.”

“You see the good in people, I don’t know how.” Cosmic admitted. “You’re always trying to find the good too. I would’ve done-”

“I know what you would’ve done, Cosmic!” Izuku snickers, “You’re just as bad as Kacchan when it comes to insults and threats.”

Cosmic gasped, “How dare you! I am much better than that idiot!”

“He wouldn’t like you saying that, you know.” Izuku laughed softly, punching Cosmic’s arm. “...Do you have a friend like Kacchan?”

“Honestly. You’re my only friend.” Cosmic voice seemed quiet. “I get bullied a lot. I think I told you this, maybe I didn’t. My closest thing to a friend is my teacher. I’m too different apparently. They think I’m a nerdy try hard. A teacher's pet.”

“I don’t think that..!”

“I’m different in a school setting. No one talks to me. I sit alone, sketch my designs, or in the lab creating. It’s hard. I know I act like I’ve got it all together. I just do *not* want that for you. UA might be a hero school, but kids are still mean. Kids will always be mean. I mean, that’s what haters are. Kids will always try to bring you down. And Zuku, I want you to know you’re better than that. You’re great at what you do as a vigilante. I could only imagine how great you’re going to become with proper training from Pro-Heroes. Maybe not All Might. Fuck that guy.”

Izuku smiled softly. “Yeah. Thank you, Cosmic. I mean it.”

“I’ve got a side mission for you.” Cosmic spoke after a few seconds of silence.

“Wait...you do?”

“While you’re living your life at UA, your detective skills will get better. It’s one of the minor things they talk about. I want you to find my true identity.”

“Wh...What?!” Izuku choked on air, “You…the Pro-Heroes haven't even been able to-!”

“You got my quirk, which they haven’t figured out yet. I think you’re capable.” Cosmic smirked. “Good luck, nerd.”

-

The first day of school approached Izuku way faster than he was ready for, and before he knew it he was putting his shoes on for school. Cosmic left a note in his shoe, encouraging his friend on his first day. Izuku laughed at the place, but he knew Cosmic put it there because that’s the only place he would find it.

Izuku's bus to the school couldn't be any longer. He was starting to feel the nerves creep up, and he didn't have anyone to confide in about his anxieties. He'd have to get used to Cosmic not being a shoulder's length away.

Eventually, Izuku made it on school grounds. He was walking the hallways, muttering his classroom's number to himself.

"Class 1A…Class 1A.."

Izuku stopped in front of a large door. *Do they need this door for giants? Jeez..* Izuku thought. He mentally prepared himself for what was behind the oversized wooden door.

He immediately wished he hadn't.

"You are disrespecting school property! Get your feet off of the desk!"

"Hah. Did your old school stick a pole up your ass?"

Izuku felt his blood run cold. *Kacchan's in my class.* He gulped, debating on turning around and running for the hills. But he remembered what Cosmic said, Bakugo was not a threat to him anymore. While Izuku was thinking to himself, the blue haired man with 'robot arms' beelined towards the door and directly at Izuku, capturing the attention of the entire class.

"I would like to give my sincerest apologies! I underestimated you and your ability to see through the UA entrance exam's scoring system. You have an insight I don't even have." He stated, bowing to him apologetically. "My name is Tenya Iida!"

Izuku blushed embarrassingly, rubbing the back of his neck. "Um...Izuku Midoriya.. An- and I didn't know they were going to be using recuse points.." He admitted.

“Oh hey! You’re the guy that saved me!” A girl ran over, smiling up at Izuku. “I meant to thank you, but then you kinda just disappeared.”

Izuku smiled nervously. “Heh...Well I think you trying to give me your points was a good enough thank you…”

“You saw that?? Well, how could I not? You taking down that zero pointer was incredible!!”

“It- It really wasn’t a big deal-!”

“Nonsense!! Besides, I can’t wait to meet all of our new teachers! I wonder what they’re all like!”

From behind them, in the hallway, a thump was heard. Izuku peered over the girl’s shoulder. He saw a bright yellow sleeping bag, and a very tired face. A *familiar* tired face. The man stood up, and stepped out of his sleeping back.

“If you’re here for friends, you can leave.” He adjusted his clothing. “Welcome to the Hero Course.”

For the second time, Izuku felt his blood run cold. His teacher was the exact guy he was running from in daily life? This couldn’t end well.

“It took you all eight seconds to shut up. That’s not good enough, and any rational student would realize time is precious.” The class stared at the man, who heavily resembled a homeless person right now, confused on who he was. “Hello. I’m Shouta Aizawa. Your teacher.”

Izuku, Iida, and the girl he hadn’t been able to place a name to, all watched in shock as he pulled out a gym uniform.

“Put these on and follow me.”

The class followed their teacher outside of the school, where there were markings on the ground. They were all different, and Izuku noted that it looked like an obstacle course. Cosmic had done something similar to Izuku, maybe he took inspiration from UA training methods. Izuku knew Cosmic could get access to that kind of thing, he was just that type of smart to be able to hack in somehow.

“Sir...aren’t we going to miss the orientation?” A girl with purple hair and jacks hanging from her ears said aloud. Izuku felt like Bakugo, mentally naming her ‘headphones’ until he learned her name.

“In real life, you don’t have time for that.” Aizawa said tiredly. “You came to UA to be a hero. Not sit in a room full of other kids to be debriefed on what life at UA will be like. I can show you that just fine.” The grin that found its way onto Aizawa’s face was scary, and unsettled all of the children.

“Bakugo.” Aizawa turned to the angry kid, who seemed to keep his emotions in line for now. Bakugo looked at Aizawa, raising an eyebrow instead of responding. “What’s the farthest you’ve ever thrown a baseball?”

“62 meters, or something.”

“What about with your quirk?”

The class looked at Aizawa puzzled. They exchanged glances with each other.

“Never tried. Quirk use wasn't allowed.” Bakugo said, his eyes seemingly glowed with anger at the fact he wasn’t allowed to use his quirk in his day to day life.

Aizawa handed him a baseball. “Try it. Your quirks are an extension of yourselves. You’ve been restricted your whole life. Let’s see what you can do.”

Bakugo looked at the ball, then at Aizawa to confirm he was allowed. Once Aizawa gave a small nod, Bakugo smirked. He flipped the ball in his hand, preparing to throw it.

"DIE!" He screamed out, throwing the ball. He added an explosion to the throw, and the ball ascended out of sight.

Aizawa held up a small machine, which displayed the number **705.2**.

The class let out gasps in amazement, a few even commenting aloud on how impressive that was.

"Today you'll be doing tests to see how much you quirk can help your basic abilities. Running, jumping, and more of the sort. You'll use your quirk to enhance your scores. I don't care how you do it, just do it. And hurry it up, I need a nap." Aizawa turned from the class, but then turned back. "Last place is getting expelled."

Aizawa then started the process, ignoring the uproar from the students. Izuku figured it would be easiest to just borrow others for their quirks, and he knew that was a genuine way to win because Aizawa told them directly 'I don't care how you do it' it opened that place for opportunity. But teamwork is more than just borrowing quirks. For the 50-meter dash, Izuku did it on his own. 6.79 seconds was his time. Then there was the grip test. There was no way to cheat on that one, so he stuck with his score.

When the ball throw came, he thought hard about how to make this work. He approached his newfound friend, who he still hadn't gotten the name of, and smiled gently at her. "Hi. Your quirk is gravity related?"

"That'd be right! Why, what are you gonna do?" She asked, tilting her head.

Izuku held out the ball. "Can you touch this for me?"

“But...we can’t share quirks, can we?”

“Mr. Aizawa never said we couldn’t.”

“…Well, okay!” She touched the ball with her quirk, and then Izuku walked back over to the proper placement. He only had her make it lighter, not completely weightless. Straining others for their entire quirk in a real life situation could lead to relying on others too much. Izuku was his own person, and he recognized that. He only needed assistance, not someone to do it for him.

Izuku threw the bar as hard as he could, and watched his plan work better than expected. He had also dislocated his elbow so he could use his arm as more of a catapult, rather than a throw. Sure, it was slightly painful, but with his regeneration quirk it seemed to take the pain away somehow. He felt eyes burning into the back of his head, as the number tracked up. Aizawa showed everyone the screen.

700.

Izuku silently thanked Cosmic for teaching him how to throw longer distances. The quirk helped carry his momentum for longer, and he told her the second she felt strain to stop using her quirk.

“OI, DAMN DEKU. WHAT THE HELL WAS THAT?! I’M GOING TO KILL YO-” Bakugo’s march towards Izuku was stopped by Aizawa’s capture scarf. Izuku didn’t catch what Aizawa said, as he was too busy staring at Bakugo. The wrapped capture scarf made him look dumb, and Izuku couldn’t help but let a giggle slip.

The rest of the test, Izuku applied the same logic. He knew his scores weren’t like his classmates, but scores aren’t everything. It’s the ability to plan, strategize, and adapt as best you can.

Aizawa knew this. That's why when he noticed the kid (who he hoped so desperately to not get) starting muttering, he knew that he had potential. He watched closely with his every move, occasionally asking for assistance relating to the current challenge. He was decently surprised, but almost proud that Izuku was using their help and not relying on them. That's part of what it takes to be a hero. Admitting defeat, and accepting help, but not giving up to let the other heroes do all the work.

Izuku was going to end up last, Aizawa knew it based on the scores. Aizawa couldn't find it in him to expel Izuku, especially since he had the best hero mentality out of all of his students so far. He was thinking outside the box, and Aizawa didn't want to expel him for that behavior. He expelled kids to teach a lesson, but Izuku didn't need this one to be taught. He already knew it.

"These are the scores. It's too much work to go over the individual scores." Aizawa watched as Izuku noticed his name at the bottom. He saw dread wash over the kid, but then watched as Izuku shook it off and stood tall. *He's just accepting that?* Aizawa thought. He shook his head, sighing. "Also. None of you are getting expelled. It was just a ruse to get you to do your best. There's a syllabus in the classroom, read it and be prepared for tomorrow." He muttered, walking away and leaving his class there.

Aizawa almost jumped out of his skin when he heard a voice after he rounded a building.

"Is that your new class??"

"Jesus fucking Christ, Riso." Aizawa muttered. "Yes. Why aren't you in yours?"

"Because PowerLoader told me to wait for orientation to be over. I watched the whole thing! You didn't expel the kid with the messy hair." Riso said, tilting his head. His hair swept to the side a little, but his eyes weren't visible as they were covered by his hair. Aizawa felt even more tired just looking at his bright pink hair. "Are you going soft?"

"No."

"Then you see potential?"

“Go to class.”

“But I wanna meet your students!”

“Go bother Midnight or something.”

“I’ve already bothered her, and Mic. And Vlad.”

“I don’t care, stay away from my students. You’re only going to make it worse.” Aizawa put a hand on Riso’s shoulder, and he guided him back into the building.

Once the day was over, Izuku started walking to the bus stop with Iida. He had been stopped by the girl from before, who called out to him.

“Oh hey! Deku, isn’t it?”

“Um..” Izuku sighs, “It’s actually Izuku Midoriya. Kacchan used to use it as an insult..”

“I’m sorry! I didn’t know..” She frowned slightly. “I’m Ochako Uraraka!”

“It’s okay,” Izuku nods, finally putting a name to her. “I don’t mind it. A friend of mine told me it could be like a hero name if I wanted to look at it positively.”

“Yeah! I think I like that.”

“I’ll admit, it is quite catchy…” Iida confirms, nodding his head. As the three continued to discuss what happened in class and their plans as heroes, someone bumped into Izuku.

“Sorry.” They muttered, continuing their walk. They had their face stuck in their notebook, but their bright pink hair was hard to miss. They paused, and slowly walked back. They looked up and locked eyes with Izuku. “You- You’re in Aizawa’s class!”

“…We- are?” Izuku nods, glancing at his new-found friends.

“I’m Riso! I actually watched your quirk apprehension test! From a distance, of course. Otherwise Aizawa would’ve never let me. It’s nice to meet you!”

Izuku studied Riso, trying to search his mind for why that name was familiar. Riso had longer pink hair that covered eyes, and a strip of white on his right side. He stood about 6’2”, but seemed to be a bundle of…happiness.

Uraraka was the first to speak. “Hi! I’m Ochako Uraraka! Why were you allowed to watch us? You’re in a uniform like the rest of us?” She quizzed.

“Oh! Funny story, actually. Apparently my brain is very busy, and in order to keep myself occupied I was allowed to skip orientation. I’m in the support course!”

“You’re a support student?” Iida asks. “…Are you a second year?”

“Technically, yes. But a few years ago I got bumped up a grade. So I’m your age.” Riso smiled, “I got to see some of the new hero course student costumes, they were so fun to make!”

“ *You* made our hero costumes?”

“I sure did!”

Izuku listened to his friends and the support course student talk back and forth. Something couldn't leave his mind. Where has he heard the name Riso? And why couldn't he remember? It was on the tip of his tongue, and he was racking his brain. On a usual day, he'd know right away. Today was already crazy enough, and he just wanted to go home and rest.

C'mon. Where do I know his name from?

Chapter End Notes

hey hey !! i'm looking for beta readers, just one or maybe two. if you want to be one, please be over 16+ and have either insta or discord! comment your insta/discord or dm me on insta (eraserhkinnie)!
next update is on sunday!

Chapter Eight

Chapter Summary

> Izuku comes home from his first day at UA, and something unexpected happens to Cosmic on his patrol alone.

Chapter Notes

> i'm very sorry this chapter is so short! i want to keep at least one chapter between arcs! the hero vs villains training will be next!
>
> Chapter has been edited by beta on 1/20/24

See the end of the chapter for more notes

The answer finally hit Izuku when he got home.

Cosmic knew him! He helped him move out! Izuku blinked. *Cosmic didn't tell me he went to UA!*

He set his bag down, and pulled off his blazer. He sets it on the table, and he turned to go to his room. He was met by Cosmic's face. Then Cosmic's face was met with a fist.

"I'm so sorry!" Izuku apologized.

"What a hell of a swing!" Cosmic snickered, rubbing his jaw. "I came to ask how your first day was."

"…Brutal." Izuku huffed. "You'll never guess who my teacher is."

“Is it All Might? I’ll kick his fucking ass, I swear-”

“…It’s Eraserhead.” Izuku interrupted him. “Shouta Aizawa.”

Cosmic was silent and stared at Izuku. He blinked slowly, before laughing lightly.

“No way.”

“Yeah. He- sleeps in a sleeping bag?? Just randomly? And he looks homeless!” Izuku whined. “I never would’ve thought he acted like that..”

“Oh yeah. Eraser loves his naps. He talked about how much I tired him out on patrol.” Cosmic sits on the couch. “Make any friends?”

“Kinda…There’s Iida and Uraraka.” Izuku followed, sitting next to him. “Oh! Kacchan’s in my class too.”

“Ugh. *Kacchan* . Zuku, you’re gonna kick his ass aren’t you?” Cosmic questions, looking at Izuku. He saw that Izuku had opened and began revising his notebook. Cosmic’s smiled softly.

“Maybe...I’m not sure I’m capable just yet. I will someday!” Izuku said, nodding with determination. “He’ll be a reminder to keep going.”

“That’s oddly sweet.”

“Hey! You didn’t tell me Riso went to UA!” Izuku suddenly remembered, shoving Cosmic playfully. “He accidentally bumped into me. The way you described him, I would’ve figured he was shorter. He’s almost as tall as you!”

Cosmic stiffened, then looked at Izuku. “You saw Riso?”

“Yeah. Bright pink hair, with a white bit? He doesn’t show his eyes for some reason- it’s covered by his hair. He’s really…happy. You didn’t tell me he was in the support course.”

“Huh. Must’ve just slipped my mind. Did he say anything?”

“He mentioned he helped create our hero costumes. None of us have seen them officially made yet.”

“They- let support course students make hero costumes?”

“Yeah! I trust them.”

“…What does yours look like?”

“Actually, I already have mine. My…My mom made it for me as inspiration, so I think I’m sticking with that.”

“You’re such a momma’s boy.” Cosmic teases, fluffing Izuku’s hair. “You know they’re probably going to change it?”

Izuku sighed. “I know. It’s one of the only things I have left of her, so I’d rather use that then...not at all. You know?” Izuku looked at Cosmic. “How was your first day back at school? Since you won’t tell me where you attend.”

“Then it’ll make your job of finding me easier, Zuku. It went well! Boring, but well.”

“C’mon! You can’t give me any hints?” Izuku whined, “It’ll be impossible to find you.”

“That’s the point.” Cosmic smirked. “Did you want to go on patrol tonight or did you want a break?”

“I’d like a break tonight. Aizawa really killed me…” Izuku huffed. “I’m sor-”

“Ah! What did I tell you about the ‘s’ word!” Cosmic had smacked Izuku in the back of the head. “Repeat after me. We do not apologize for things we cannot control.”

“Cosmic,”

“We do not apologize for things we cannot control. Say it, Zuku.”

Izuku sighed, before muttering. “We do not apologize for things we cannot control.”

“What was that?” Cosmic placed a hand to his ear, “Don’t mumble.”

“I said, We do not apologize for things we cannot control.”

“Good! Proud of you.” Cosmic smiled. “It’s alright that you want to rest, I’m sure Eraser can be difficult to deal with. If you need me, I’ll be out. You can call me whenever and I’ll answer!”

“Okay, be safe. Don’t get another knife in your hand, please.”

“Yeah yeah, fuck off.” Cosmic rolled his eyes playfully.

Cosmic said his goodbyes before leaving Izuku's apartment. He ran along the top of the buildings, looking for any villains to defeat. After a while of no luck, he sat himself on the side of a building. He let his feet dangle as he looked out at the quiet city below him. He sighed pulling down his mask, taking in a deep breath. He pulled out a few materials.

Cosmic began to work on putting the pieces together, his brain seemingly switching to auto-pilot. He sat in silence as he continued to work. He wasn't quite sure what he was trying to create, but it kept his hands busy. The sound of the city flowed through his ear, and it was interrupted when he heard talking from below him.

"Let's talk business. Shall we?" A voice spoke, and Cosmic looked down into the alleyway.

A man, dressed in a purple suit, was speaking with a guy in a black hoodie.

"How can I trust you?" The man in the black hoodie said, glancing around for any watchers. Cosmic quickly jumped back, and barely peeked his head over the side.

"I'm not here to sell out my only way of making money. Now. Don't waste my time, got it?" The man's voice was deep and gruff. "What are you looking to do? The League of Villains can only accept the best of members."

Cosmic felt his breath catch in his throat. *League of Villains? I've never heard that before, but it can't be good. This must be their recruiter.* Cosmic pulled out his phone, and dialed Aizawa.

" *What?* " A tired voice came through the phone.

"Eraser," Cosmic whispered. "I sent you my location, I need you here. There's this- guy and he seems to be recruiting people for this villain group."

"*...Cosmic? What do you- fine. I'll be there shortly.*"

Aizawa hung up and looked at the pinned location. He started making his way towards it, knowing it would take about three minutes. Aizawa prayed to himself that for once in Cosmic's damn life, he wouldn't intervene. The fact that Cosmic called him *first* showed that he knew it was a bigger threat than he could handle.

Aizawa landed in the middle of the alleyway when he saw no trace of anyone. He looked around, and his heart dropped. Cosmic was on the ground, sitting against the wall and leaning on the closest dumpster. Aizawa approached Cosmic, who looked up at him. The sight scared him.

Cosmic's mask was down, and he had blood running down the left side of his face. His hair was still slicked back and his hood was still in place. There were slight tears that were running down his face. Aizawa crouched down to Cosmic.

"Hey! Hey, what happened?"

Cosmic smiled weakly, shaking his head. "I...It's so foggy.."

"What do you mean?" Aizawa asked as he pulled out his first aid materials.

"The...there was a guy, I dropped something and- he saw me. He hit me, and..I- I don't know. Why don't I know..??" Cosmic said, more tears spilling out of frustration. "I'm so sorry."

"Why? You called me, I was willing to help."

"..I called you..?" Cosmic asked, flinching when Aizawa pressed a rag to his face.

"Yes. Let me take you to a hosp-"

“No! No hospitals. Please. I’ll recover, just let me..- help me to my feet.” Cosmic tried to force himself up onto his feet, but he slumped back against the wall. “Please.”

“Cosmic, you know I can’t just leave you like this.”

“Just let me go home.”

Aizawa stared at the clearly frightened kid. He seemed to be right in his theories, Cosmic didn’t look old enough to be a young adult. It was shocking how much a face mask did to cover his age. He had noted over the years that Cosmic wasn’t okay with not knowing something. He’d watch the kid secretly pout when he corrected his story, or even see tears well in his eyes.

Cosmic had a clear hate-hate relationship with the unknown. He was smart enough to already know basically everything, so when he didn’t, it messed with his emotions badly. If he was hit by a villain with an amnesia quirk, he could have a breakdown. Aizawa couldn’t just leave him alone, not like this.

“Let me bandage you, then I can help you get home.”

“No.” Cosmic shakes his head, wincing. “Just bandage me. Please. I- Please.”

Without anymore resistance, Aizawa bandaged the wound on Cosmic’s head. He helped the kid to his feet, and demanded he *walk* to his house. Once Cosmic agreed, Aizawa bit the inside of his cheek as he watched the kid walk away. He was mumbling, trying to make sense of his surroundings.

By the time Aizawa got home, he had already got himself caught up on the attack. When he stepped inside his place, he was met by a very eager Hizashi.

“Good evening, Sho! I made pancakes for breakfast.” A soft kiss was planted on Aizawa’s cheek.

“…Thanks.” Aizawa nodded once, sitting at the kitchen island. He opened his phone, and tapped the side of it nervously.

“…Uh oh. What’s wrong?”

“A lot. The world. We ran out of cat treats yesterday. Me not having coffee accessible right now.”

“Besides that!”

“Cosmic. He got hurt, it really messed with him. When I got to him, he had a gash on his head and was bleeding a lot.” Aizawa started. “He called me about a villain group he hadn’t heard of.”

“What? Is he okay?” Hizashi asked. “Did he say any names?”

“No.” Aizawa shook his head. “He was trying to be quiet on the phone call. After I got there, he didn’t remember a thing. He even started crying out of frustration.”

“…Shit. That can’t be good.” Hizashi’s face displayed sorrow and sympathy. “I wonder what he knew…Did you take him to a hospital?”

Aizawa hesitated, before he sighed. “No. He wouldn’t let me, and I made sure his wound was at least clean. He was too shocked to be forced. My capture weapon doesn’t even work on him. He knows how to get out.”

Hizashi sighed, sitting next to Aizawa. “What about classes today? I never got to ask.” He tried to redirect the subject as he gently massaged his husband’s shoulders.

“I got that kid. The one who took down the zero pointer.”

“You got him??” Hizashi smiled, “That’s good!”

“No. I can already feel more gray hair coming in.”

“Oh don’t be so dramatic, Sho.” Hizashi teases, grabbing Aizawa’s hand. “You’ll have a good class this year.”

“Absolutely not. Those kids are going to be the death of me.”

“You say that every year.”

“One of them already tried to kill the other.”

“…Yeah I see your point.”

Chapter End Notes

there is no need to worry about cosmic! the wound will simply leave a scar and help to identify him later, and realistically cosmic would’ve run into someone from the league before their major attack at the usj! but don’t worry about cosmic he’ll be okay! and no, he’s not a spy or anything <3 see you guys wednesday!

Chapter Nine

Chapter Summary

Izuku takes Bakugo head on in a battle during the heroics class!

Chapter Notes

please enjoy!
updates every sunday and wednesday! (est time)

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Izuku felt so bored during his classes. It was his first week at UA and the core classes were very easy to tune out, even if Present Mic was a teacher. It wasn't that he was bored, but rather understimulated a bit. He had hardly gotten anything wrong, and caught on quickly. Honestly, he'd be lying if he said Cosmic and his routine didn't spoil him.

He had to wait until the afternoon, when his heroics class was held. Then he'd get a little action. On the other hand, he wished it wasn't so late in the day. He would hate to leave Cosmic alone on patrol. He hadn't even heard from him since he left yesterday night to go on patrol.

It wasn't unusual, it had only been a day since. He'd see him later to ask about how to manage both UA and Vigilantism. He loved both, and he wanted to do both.

By the time Heroics class came, Izuku was nervously tapping his pen against his hand to lessen the noise. He wondered what they were doing today, or if it was anything important. Maybe just the basics? He wasn't sure. One thing he did know, he hated the voice that came ripping through the silence in the classroom.

"I AM HERE!….entering this classroom!" All Might barged into the classroom, and all Izuku's classmates started to gasp and yell in excitement.

I'd much rather be stabbed again than see his face. Izuku thought to himself, watching as the Pro-Hero walked up to the teachers podium.

"Today we will be conducting a battle trial! And who else is better to teach that than me!" All Might flexed, the fabric on his Silver-Age suit looked like it was going to burst at the seams. Izuku couldn't help but roll his eyes.

How could a Hero like him ever let an innocent, helpless kid think they'll never be anything. Then leave them on a rooftop. Izuku felt his hand grip tighten on his pen, a low simmering rage building up inside him. *Does he even recognize me?*

Izuku caught the end of what All Might was saying, and grabbed his hero costume case. He was hardly amazed at the hero costumes, since he heard from that support course student they made them all. He couldn't be amazed if it was All Might showing him.

He got dressed and met the rest of the class at Ground B. He trained his eyes on the ground after looking around for any quick exits in case of emergency. He did his best to listen to what All Might was telling him, and gather that there would be teams of two. One would play Hero, one would play Villain. There's a fake weapon the villains must protect and the heros have to either seize it or capture the villains.

He got paired with Uraraka. He was okay with her as a teammate, a little nervous considering he's never talked to girls much in his life. Something he *wasn't* okay with was the fact that his opponent was Bakugo.

Definitely fits the villainous role… Izuku thought, looking towards Bakugo. He was met with a glare, but he held his stare. Bakugo seemed taken back by Izuku's constant stare, and he visibly clenched his jaw. Bakugo looked away first, glaring at the floor like it was his sworn enemy. Izuku's glare softened, maybe he was too harsh.

It wasn't his fault he got bullied. He figured everyone around him was just as guilty, if not more. They let Bakugo's ego inflate. They never told him there's a possibility he wouldn't be the best. Izuku felt bad if he was being honest. He hated being the punching bag, sure. He

also knew Bakugo was never that way before everyone let him know his quirk was sooo great.

Izuku was pulled from his thoughts when Uraraka spoke to him.

“I wonder how we’re going to beat Iida and Bakugo...Do you have any idea on how?”

“Um..” Izuku looked at Uraraka. “If I’m right, Kacchan will go for me first. Most likely, he won’t even talk with Iida…You should try to keep away from any close combat with Kacchan. He doesn’t show mercy.”

“Got it! Avoid Bakugo!”

“Maybe..you focus on Iida. He might stay with the weapon if Kacchan doesn’t speak with him…Find that, do your best to get it while you wait for me.”

“Huh, did you come up with all this right now?”

“Yes…is- is it bad?”

“No! It’s incredible you can come up with a plan that fast!”

“In real life combat, I..I don’t think you have time to be slow with planning.”

“Good point!”

“Try to keep the damage to the building to a minimum, if this were real, lives would be at stake.”

“Of course! Um, quick question. I know you’re- super good at strategy but…Both Iida and Bakugo have flashy quirks. I haven’t even seen you use a quirk-”

“I know. But if we can win, or capture them, it’ll show you don’t need a flashy quirk. It also gives us an advantage that we know our opponents.”

Uraraka nodded, smiling. “We got this! You’re so smart, Deku.”

Izuku paused. Then he nodded with a smile. *She was right the other day. Deku is a good hero name.*

The timer started, and the two made their way into the building. Izuku felt his ears shift, adapting to the silence.

“Okay. It won’t be long before Kacchan comes for me. You should go, quickly before-” Izuku’s ears began ringing as he heard footsteps down the hall. He froze, knowing he couldn’t move fast enough to block any blast Bakugo threw at him.

“Uraraka, move!” Izuku shouted, turning and looking at Bakugo who had jumped around the corner. He locked eyes with him, seeing the same fiery red eyes burning with passion.

“YOU DAMN DEKU, ILL KILL YOU!”

Izuku gasped as he felt a blast connect with his face, the burning sensation rapidly disappearing. The blast burnt off his mask, leaving the rest to fall to his shoulders. He growled in frustration, taking a defensive stance as Bakugo landed on his feet.

“Deku!”

“I’m fine.” Izuku gritted his face. “Go! Find the weapon!”

“Hah! Why won’t you even look at me?! Do you think you’re THAT MUCH BETTER THAN ME?!” Bakugo yelled out, swinging his fists in anger. “FIGHT ME, DEKU!”

Izuku didn’t speak, but watched Bakugo curl his fist for a punch. He went to swing, and Izuku grabbed his right arm.

“You always throw a right hook to start a fight!” Izuku yelled out, using the momentum to throw Bakugo over his shoulder and slam him onto the ground. He heard Bakugo gasp for breath when he collided with the ground.

Izuku took in a sharp breath, taking a stance to fight Bakugo.

“You’re shaking in your damn boots.” Bakugo starts, after pushing himself to his feet. Izuku gulped and glanced at his feet, which were indeed shaking. “Yet you still want to fight me! You damn Deku, I HATE YOU!!”

“You can’t insult me anymore!” Izuku told him, “You have nothing over me!”

Bakugo jumped forward, swinging a kick at Izuku. Izuku deflected the kick by blocking with his hand in an ‘X’ formation, and he began to wrap the tape around his leg. He threw himself back when Bakugo moved to blast him again. Izuku started running down a hall as fast as he could, fighting the urge to jump out one of the windows like he would’ve done with Cosmic.

“GET BACK HERE, DEKU!!”

Izuku took a breath after rounding a corner and stopping, a hand grasping at his hero costume. He glanced around, trying to come up with a plan to take down Bakugo.

I need to disarm him. Those gauntlets on his arms can't be for show, they have to have some purpose. We don't have a lot of time left, I just need to get to Uraraka and avoid Kacchan as much as I can. I can't bring myself to fight him, not like this!

Izuku ripped a pipe off of an open pipeline, and held it in his hands. *I can use this like my staff. Minus all the cool gadget parts.* Izuku felt his blood run cold when he heard a voice call to him.

"What's the matter, Deku? You seem to be underestimating me! How strong can you be, you damn weakling?!" Izuku heard Uraraka come through his headphone piece

"Deku! I found the weapon but Iida found me!"

"Where are you?!"

"On the fifth floor! By the window!"

"Okay sit tight, you're right above me! Use your quirk on the ground by the window! I got a plan!"

Izuku took a deep breath. "I'm not underestimating you, Kacchan!"

"Oh yeah?! You see me as weak, don't you!? Well let's see if you can consider this weak!" Bakugo held up his gauntlet, and pointed it towards Izuku. He held his breath, expecting the worst. He heard Bakugo tell something to his earpiece, but he wasn't focused on that.

He was focused on not experiencing what third degree burns felt like.

Izuku tightened his grip onto the pipe, and once Bakugo pulled the pin—he jumped. Izuku jolted himself up with the pipe, just like he had done multiple times with Cosmic. He forced

his body forward, barely passing above the blast. He landed behind Bakugo, holding the pipe. He let out a breath, feeling his body cool from the intense heat it just felt.

Bakugo stood there, with a smirk on his face. He watched as the flames died down, but confusion hit when he didn't see his childhood friend standing anywhere in front of him. Smoke filled the blasted hallway, debris falling slowly.

Izuku let out a yell, taking the pipe in his hand and striking hard against the back of Bakugo's head. He wouldn't have been surprised if his hair stopped the metal pipe, since it looked so spiky. Izuku pulled the pipe back and swung again, knocking Bakugo to his knees.

Bakugo groaned in pain and surprise, touching the back of his head and his body trembled. Izuku wrapped the capture tape around Bakugo's arm, and forcefully pulled up. He reached over, and forcefully pulled the pin out. The blast was much weaker since he used the right gauntlet, but it broke the ceiling above,and nothing else. *Keep the damage to a minimum!* Izuku thought to himself, struggling against Bakugo. Pieces that would've come crumbling down, were floating because of Uraraka's quirk.

"Distract Iida!" Izuku screamed, being thrown back by Bakugo swinging his arm towards Izuku's body. He hit the wall down the hall, to which his breath caught in his throat. He fell to the floor, a hand grasping at his throat. He felt his world going dark. He had forgotten how strong Bakugo's blunt strength was.

Uraraka yelled out a response, signaling she understood. She flung the pieces towards Iida, using her quirk to swing herself towards the weapon. Once Iida had been busy not getting abused by debris, Uraraka found her arms around the fake weapon. She let out a sigh, hearing Iida yell out in frustration.

"We won!"

Izuku doesn't remember the rest of the match, other than those words and a few robot sounds, maybe a bit of Bakugo's yelling. He woke up in Recovery Girl's office, a sharp but subtle pain in his back. He forced himself to sit up, rubbing his eyes slightly. *I guess my quirk doesn't work with aches.*. Izuku thought quietly to himself, looking around. He felt slightly saddened, being alone in the school's nurse's office.

“You’re going to be a lot of trouble, aren’t you, boy!” Recovery Girl’s voice jolted Izuku out of his emotional state, as he looked over. To his surprise, she wasn’t talking to him. She was talking to someone else, who she was dragging in by the ear. Izuku immediately recognized him. *Is that Riso? What’s he doing here?*

“Ow! I’m sorry, I didn’t mean for it to fall on me!” Riso whined, trying to pull her grip off his ear. He sat on the bed in front of Izuku, his back facing him. Izuku watched as Recovery Girl pushed his bright pink hair out of his face, and kissed his forehead.

“That doesn’t matter! You need to stop creating such big things!”

“Hatsume wanted to see what it would-”

Izuku furrowed his eyebrows, watching the two bicker. Once Riso finally stopped arguing with Recovery Girl, she gently pressed an ice pack to his forehead. Riso shook his head, forcing his hair to, assumingly, cover his face once again. He replaced the ice pack in the same spot.

“How’s that scar on your forehead healing?” Recovery Girl asked. “I’m glad you came to me that night, deary.”

“Just fine! Thanks for asking.” Riso then turned, quickly, and looked at Izuku. He smiled, tilting his head. “Hi!”

Izuku flinched, his eyes widened. *He moved so fast!* Izuku thought, as he stammered out a hello.

“You look rough. Is everything okay?” Riso asked sweetly, sitting on bed backwards so he was facing Izuku.

“Um..Yeah. It was just..heroics-”

“Oh your costume too! That’s such a shame. I’ll have to fix it up for you! Those look like burns, we should definitely use fire resistant material!” Riso said, pulling out a journal and began scribbling down the information he was speaking. He was talking so fast, Izuku couldn’t even understand him anymore.

“Oh, I..I-”

“Riso! Quit that, you’re stressing the boy out. He needs to rest. You can leave, you’ll be okay.” Recovery Girl spoke, but Izuku stared.

“W-Wait! Recovery Girl, it’s okay, really! I need to- to speak with him! I want to!” Izuku stopped Riso, but he stood again and began to leave.

“No, no. She’s right. I should get back to my class. It was nice seeing you again, Midoriya!” Riso waved, walking out the door. Izuku stood, going to follow after him. He was so curious about this boy, who seemed to have a love for analyzing just like Izuku did.

“No!” Recovery Girl said, smacking Izuku on the head. “You lay and rest, boy!”

“Okay, okay..!” Izuku laid back in bed.

He’s the only one I’ve seen who carries a journal. He’s like me…I’m not weird! He seems so nice. I want to know him, I really do.

Izuku sighed, letting his thoughts wonder. He let his body rest, feeling his eyes slowly close. With that, he went to sleep.

Chapter End Notes

hope you guys liked it :) feel free to leave any comments and/or headcanons you might like to see!

Chapter Ten

Chapter Summary

> Izuku gets walked home by a new found friend, who opens up about his life at UA. Cosmic and Izuku play a fun little prank, but once Izuku's home and asleep he dreams of his childhood best friend.

Chapter Notes

> this chapter is very riso and cosmic heavy! next chapter will most likely be the USJ incident, so stick around for that :D

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Izuku let his body relax when he walked out of the school. The sun was setting, so everything around him had an orange glow. He walked slowly, mainly using his time to think. He tensed when he heard a familiar voice calling out to him.

"DEKU!! This does not mean you've beaten me!!" Bakugo's voice echoed, as he approached Izuku. He looked up at Bakugo, who looked over him, and he felt his face flush red. *Was he always that tall?*

"K-Kacchan.."

"I don't know how you did what you did in class! You will *never* be better than me! You're still just a lowly Deku!!"

Izuku shook his head. "That's not true, Kacchan.."

"What the hell do you mean?!"

“I can take care of myself now…I’m not weak..or..or alone. I may never be Number One… But I’ll be better than you ever will be.”

“WHAT DID YOU JUST SAY TO ME YOU DAMN DEKU?!” Bakugo growled, grabbing his collar. He pulled him close, almost lifting the smaller boy off the ground.

Izuku gulped, but gritted his teeth. He was going to stand his ground. He wasn’t going to be a punching bag. Not for Bakugo, not anymore.

“Hey! I don’t think that’s very heroic to be holding someone like that.” A cheery voice spoke from the side of them. Izuku glanced over, as well as Bakugo, who also dropped Izuku in the process. He turned to the person, raising his fist.

Izuku felt his eyes widened. *Riso? This is the third time I’ve seen you..*

“My, you sure like to pick fights.” Riso said, tilting his head with a smile. “I don’t think Mr. Aizawa would be very fond finding out you’re picking on other classmates.”

“Oi! Fuck off, this isn’t your business.”

“It is! Katsuki Bakugo, right? You have such a bright future. It would be such a shame getting in such trouble so early in the year. Mr. Aizawa doesn’t take kindly to bullying.” Riso spoke, a sinister smile on his face. Bakugo got close, a scowl on his face. Riso leaned down, and met Bakugo face to face.

Riso usually is so nice, and calm. All he needed was a slight change in his smile and his whole aura changed. It’s scary how much emotion he can convey without showing his eyes. Izuku thought, watching Riso taunt his childhood friend.

“Is that a threat, pinky-pie?!”

“It is. Now get lost before it becomes reality. Save your career while you can. UA won’t tolerate your bullshit.” Riso must’ve glared at Bakugo, because the air got more tense than it already was. Bakugo backed down, and grumbled. Izuku could’ve sworn he saw steam coming from Bakugo’s ears as he stomped away.

“Hi! How was the rest of school?” Riso asked, a genuine smile on his face. His voice was chipper, and he seemed to do a complete 180 in personality.

“…Good. Uh- What- What was that?”

“What was what?”

“You- were just so mean to him, but now you’re nice to me?” Izuku quizzed, looking up at Riso.

“He looked like he was going to hurt you. This is UA, a school that breeds heros. Not people like Endeavor. He’s the only one that UA failed. Anyway! How about I walk you home?” Riso pulled out his journal, scribbling a few things down.

“…Do I have much of a choice?”

“Nope!”

“Figured.” Izuku smiled a little, “You seem to be the persistent type..”

“So I’ve been told.” Riso chuckled lightly. “I never formally introduced myself! I’m Riso Sakusei!”

“That’s right, you spoke so fast our first time meeting, and only said your first name!” Izuku tilted his head, then introduced himself. “I’m Izuku Midoriya! It’s nice to meet you, Sakusei.”

“Oh- Please, just call me Riso! I prefer that, actually.”

“Then it’s nice to meet you, Riso. What are you writing about?”

“You.”

“..H-Huh..??”

“I’m going to be making your next suit. Most of the material you used for your costume was…weak. Sorry to say that,” Riso clicked his pen. “I’m creating something more suitable.”

“You..seem to love the support course..”

“Well, of course I do. I love creating. I’m already working on a few projects! I was so excited to start this year.”

“You said you’re a second year?”

“Mhm!”

“So you survived UA last year. What was it like?”

“Uhm…” Riso hesitated, and paused his writing. “The school year was fine.”

That's right. Based on what Cosmic told me, Riso had a pretty hard life for the past year or so. Got kicked out, broken up with.

"So..When we were in Recovery Girl's office, you said something fell on you?"

"Yeah! One of my inventions I created with a first year fell on me. It didn't hurt much, though it did break my arm."

"It broke your arm! It had to have hurt!"

"I've had worse!"

"That sounds really bad, though." Izuku couldn't help himself and he glanced over at Riso's journal. He tilted his head. The sketch was of an object, it looked circular. "Did you move on already?"

"Mhm. My brain moves really fast sometimes."

"You seem really smart, Riso. What's your quirk? If..I can ask."

"That's a secret."

"Huh? Why?"

"Principal Nezu tells me I can't tell anyone. That it'll just put a target on my back."

"You talk with Principle Nezu..?"

“Yep! We have tea together every Tuesday, Wednesday and Friday.”

Izuku blinked.

“…What?”

“Mhm.”

“Hold on, I- You have tea with our principal?”

“To be completely honest with you, my IQ is 186. Principal Nezu took intense interest in me, and apparently he watched me very closely my first year at UA. I had a…slight breakdown in class from being understimulated, and the teachers offered to help me with a special routine daily. So, I do my school work as normal, then I have physical training with Principal Nezu on days we don’t have tea, I spend a few hours with some of the teachers and I even help them with their lesson planning!” Riso smiled a bit. “It started off as me just gently suggesting certain tweaks. Mainly Present Mic, and Midnight enjoy my company.”

Izuku stared at Riso, his mouth slightly agape. He studied his relaxed nature, which helped Izuku deduce he was telling the truth.

“…Physically train?” Izuku asked.

“Mhm. It helps tire me out. Apparently if I don’t keep busy enough, I’ll fall into this mode where I just create, create and create and it’s almost like a trance. It’s actually my quirk overworking itself and it completely consumes everything I’m thinking. I don’t speak, or have respect for anyone around me when I’m in the trance. The teachers call it episodes. Aizawa tried to use his quirk to cancel mine and I passed out, I didn’t wake for the entire day. So we try to stick to snapping me out of the episode without using his quirk.”

Izuku blinked, writing this information in his journal. Izuku was beyond curious now. Riso’s quirk wasn’t to be spoken of because of Nezu’s orders, but yet it can completely shut his

body down and put him into a working mode. His quirk is intelligence related, boosting his IQ to make him profoundly gifted. He needs the teachers constant support to help keep his brain stimulated. Could Riso get any more interesting?

“You write pretty fast, Midoriya.”

Izuku looked up, his face flushing red. “I- I’m sorry! I didn’t mean to be rude..”

“It’s okay!” Riso ruffled Izuku’s hair, “You remind me of my first year at UA.”

Izuku looked off to the side, still blushing. He was easily embarrassed when complimented.

“S-So do you live this way?” Izuku asked when the two stopped at the train station to wait for their train.

“No. But I need to go this way for some groceries. There’s a specific shop I like to go to, it’s not super close to my house. Figured I’d walk you home first.”

Izuku and Riso continued to talk on the way to his house. They talked about their favorite heros, favorite moments said heros have had. Izuku mentioned his childhood with Bakugo, about his mom passing away. Izuku didn’t know why, but he felt like he could tell Riso things he didn’t want to talk about with anyone. It was nice to have someone who felt like a friend. He never mentioned Cosmic, though. That wasn’t his business to tell, even if Riso and Cosmic had met before.

When Izuku mentioned his mom, Riso tensed a little. He assumed it was from his hard life, and he felt like he should talk about that night when he ran into Riso’s family. It pained him, though. His family seemed so happy, without Riso. Izuku didn’t think he could ever admit that to Riso. Riso was sweet, sensitive, and let himself be vulnerable around others. He also seemed a bit oblivious, but that's besides the point.

The two stopped outside of Izuku’s front door once they exchanged phone numbers.

“Um..I- Have an animal inside. You should probably go before I open the door in case it gets out.” Izuku lied. He knew Cosmic could be on the other side of that door, and he didn’t want Riso to see him. He wasn’t completely lying though, Cosmic *was* a bit of an animal.

“Oh! That’s okay, I’ll get going now. Have a good night!” Riso said, and headed for the stairs. Once Izuku saw him disappear from his sight, he opened the door. He walked in, taking off his shoes. He approached the living room, and he felt a hand on his shoulder. He panicked, grabbed the person’s arm, and threw them over his shoulder. He gasped when he saw who it was.

“Cosmic!! Do you always have to scare me?!”

“Holy shit you’re strong now.” Cosmic whined, laying against the floor. “I think I’ll stay here. The floor is my home now.”

Izuku snickered and pulled him up to his feet. “Sorry..I didn’t mean to.”

“It’s no problem! So, how was school?”

“…Weird. I beat Kacchan in a fight. Um, I saw Riso again. He walked me home.”

“Riso did what.”

“…Walked me home?”

“He doesn’t live this way?” Cosmic raised an eyebrow, brushing himself off. “Huh. Well, anyway, I was going to-”

Izuku narrowed his eyes at Cosmic’s face. “What happened to your forehead?”

“..What?”

“The..Scar. Right here?” Izuku tapped his forehead, over a newish scar. “I don’t remember it being there.”

“I don’t want to talk about it. Did you want to patrol today?”

“I meant to ask about that. How am I going to be able to do both?”

“Uhhh you power through it?” Cosmic shrugs. “It’s easy for me.”

“I think I’ll try. Can we do something easier tonight?”

“The past couple of days haven’t been too eventful, so sure! Ooo, wanna prank Endeavor?”

“…Why would we do that?”

“Cause he sucks! C’mon! We can set up a feather trap, or something.”

“Feather trap?”

“Yeah! Cover him in something sticky and throw feathers on him?”

“You are evil.” Izuku said. “…I’m in.”

Cosmic smiled, his eyes reading nothing less than mischievous. “Good! Let’s get going, shall we?”

Cosmic and Izuku set out on their eventful night. They looked around for the right spot, running along the rooftops. They needed somewhere close, and somewhere Endeavor would actually go without knowing who sent the coordinates. Once they found a proper spot, Cosmic started creating something. He finished it almost instantly. He noticed Izuku’s curious glanced and waited for him to speak.

“..What’s that?”

“This will send our coordinates to Endeavor. So first, down the street I'll cover him in glue. I’ll lead him down here, and you’ll dump all the feathers on him. Got it?”

“Got it!”

Cosmic clicked the button on his gadget. “It's ready. I’ll see you soon, be ready!”

Cosmic took off down the street. He came to a stop, and pressed the button again. He placed it in his pocket and stood around for Endeavor. He kicked a few rocks and even threw one or two. He didn’t jump, but adrenaline spike through his body when he heard a certain voice.

“Who are you.”

“Ah! Endeavor!” Cosmic turned on his heel, meeting Endeavor’s eyes. “Great to see you.”

“Cosmic. You’re that damn vigilante.”

“Sure am! But I’m more than a vigilante.”

“So you’re a villain?!” Endeavor went to use a fire attack, but Cosmic held up a button. He paused.

“No. I’m a prankster.” Cosmic clicked the button and a large bucket of glue above Endeavor tipped over. White glue stuck to his body, as it trickled down from his head. When he went to heat his body up, the glue only got more sticky. He screamed in frustration.

“ILL GET YOU FOR THIS!” He yelled, dashing towards Cosmic. Cosmic smirked and waved before running towards Izuku’s position.

Cosmic let out a laugh as he ran past Izuku. Izuku dumped the bucket of feathers onto Endeavor. They ranged in all colors, glittery and plain. Cosmic also made sure they were fire resistant. Izuku snickered when he saw the grown man start to throw a tantrum. He was yelling, screaming, and flailing his arms around.

Cosmic landed next to Izuku, nudging him. “I recorded that.”

“What??” Izuku laughs. “No way!”

“Yep! Can’t wait to see this trending on Twitter.”

Sure enough, only a few seconds after it was uploaded on Twitter, it went viral. Cosmic and Izuku had made their way back to Izuku’s apartment, where they were reading the replies under the tweet.

Izuku eventually fell asleep, resting his head on Cosmic’s shoulder. Cosmic sigh softly, and gently laid Izuku on the couch. He covered him with a blanket, and ruffled his hair gently.

Cosmic smiles softly, watching the boy sleep soundly. He opened his phone to see a few texts from Aizawa.

Cosmic I swear to god. You pranked a PRO HERO?

of course i did. why wouldn't i?

It's dangerous. Now people are going to hate you.

uh, no. :3 people hate that fiery bastard.

when we meet again, I will beat you on the head with the closest object.

aw im so flattered! too bad you're stuck doing homeworkkk :p

Aizawa didn't text back. Cosmic was confident texting the older man, only because he knew he made his phone impossible to trace unless he wanted them to. He highly doubted anyone could find out his identity. Maybe one person, but they were busy enough as is. Cosmic left Izuku's house after turning off all the lights.

Izuku's dream was weird. He was a kid again, hanging out with Bakugo. Before he had gotten his quirk. They were over at Auntie Mitsuki's house, playing with All Might figures.

"Izuku!" Younger Bakugo said, placing his hands on Izuku's head. "Your hair is like broccoli!"

"Kacchan!! Mommy says you can't touch my hair cause you have sweaty hands!"

"Auntie Inko is dumb. I like your hair! It's soft, like a blanket. But looks like broccoli." Bakugo sat next to Izuku. "We're gonna be friends forever and forever right? And be heros together??"

“Yeah! We’re gonna have amazing quirks!” Izuku nodded, holding the All Might figure close to his chest.

“I’m gonna be number one! You can be number two. Okay, Izuku?”

“Okay!” Izuku giggled. “But how are we gonna stay together forever? What about big boy school?”

“It’s okay! I’ll protect you, from all the mean guys! And my dad says that if you wanna be with someone forever, you gots to marry them.”

“But marrying is for grown ups.”

“Then we’ll do that!”

“But it’s also for people in love! That’s what my mom says.”

“Really?”

“Uh-huh.”

“Your dad is mean though, Izuku. Auntie doesn’t like him, I heard her tell my mom that. They’re married.”

Izuku was quiet, before he started crying. The All Might figure clanked against the floor as tears began to spill out. The talk of his dad made him upset, and Bakugo knew it as soon as he spoke it. Bakugo hugged Izuku tightly, and pulled him close.

“It’s okay, Izuku! I’ll protect you. Heros don’t cry.” Bakugo wiped Izuku’s tears, and handed him back his All Might toy. “All Might will too!”

Izuku woke up, gasping for breath. He placed a hand to his heart and gripped the shirt he was wearing. He hadn’t realized, but he was crying. He swung his legs over the couch, and put a hand to his head.

None of what he said was true. Izuku told himself. *Both him and All Might never protected me.* He glanced over at the clock, squinting to read the time. It was about three in the morning. Izuku shook his head and went to his room to grab more comfortable clothing. *Cosmic must’ve put me to sleep on the couch. I need actual sleeping clothes..*

Izuku opened his dresser, and heard something clatter to the floor. He huffed, and leaned down and looked for what fell. He pulled the object and a dusty envelope from under his dresser and his heart ached when he pulled it to the light coming from the moon.

It was an All Might figure. Not just any, but the same one he had just dreamed about. He looked at the dusty envelope, and opened it. In shaky handwriting, it read as follows.

Mom told my dad that your dad has been mean to you about your quirk not showing up. She told him that he was trying to make it appear. I dunno what that means, but maybe All Might will help you be brave. Don’t say I never did anything for you, Deku.

-Kacchan

The writing had misspellings and was hard to read, but Izuku got the jist of it. He frowned, closing the paper and putting it back in the envelope. He placed it on his dresser, along with the All Might figure. He sighed, pulling clothes from his dressing and going to change.

How could you be so much different now, Kacchan? And why do I still think about you like we’re little kids?

Izuku felt hopeless, but he didn’t know that Bakugo was thinking the same thing. After the fight, Bakugo couldn’t think of anything else but Izuku. He knew he was so mean to Izuku. He couldn't feel bad, but then again he did. He was just as confused as Izuku about these thoughts. One thing they both thought couldn't be more wrong:

He’s probably not even thinking of me. I need to let it go.

They both rolled up in their blankets and fell asleep thinking of each other despite their best efforts.

Chapter End Notes

updates are every wednesday and sunday! <3

Chapter Eleven

Chapter Summary

The USJ incident!

Chapter Notes

this chapter is 5k words long, so it's long! i'm aware the USJ jumps around a bit but it was easier for me, because i really didn't want to split the usj into two chapters. enjoy! <3 (this chapter is heavy all might hate tbh)

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Walking up to UA always made Izuku's heart flutter, but today almost made his heart explode. The entrance was swarmed with the press, who were crowding other students. Izuku gulped and gripped his bag straps, walking towards the entranceway. He didn't know what the press was there for, but he didn't want to be any part of it. Unfortunately, it didn't end up like that.

"You! What's it like working with All Might?!" A lady shoved a microphone in Izuku's face, a stern look on her face.

Izuku froze. He didn't realize how much All Might's name upset him. He looked off to the side, putting his hand up and pushing the microphone closer to the woman.

"I have somewhere to be. Please get out of my way." He spoke calmly, pushing his way past the group of reporters. He passed the gates, and saw Aizawa walking towards the group. Trailing behind him was Riso, who was violently scribbling in his notebook. He was asking Aizawa questions, to which he wasn't responding.

Izuku stopped, and turned to look. He furrowed his eyebrows, watching them.

“Leave, now. You’ve all bothered the students enough.” Aizawa said, as everyone around him slowly backed away. Riso poked his head out from behind Aizawa, watching the press.

“Please just give us a comment, sir.” The press lady asked him softly.

“No.” Aizawa turned on his heel, walking back into the school. Riso smiled and waved at the reporters, before following Aizawa still. Izuku sighed, continuing his way into school. Something was tugging at his heart, telling him danger was lurking amongst that crowd. He shook it off.

The rest of the day was pretty boring and uneventful. Though, before lunch, Aizawa told the class there was something very important they needed to do.

“This will change the course of your time here at UA.”

Izuku sensed the class’ uneasiness, as he himself expected something bad. Relief washed over him when his teacher spoke again.

“You need to assign a class representative.”

The class erupted in chaos, people shouting that they would be best fit. Izuku watched Bakugo yell out to the class, and for some reason his heart fluttered. He looked down, embarrassed. *I have to stop feeling like this.*

“I propose a democratical way to defuse this situation! We should hold a vote! Whoever has the most will be the class representative!” Iida spoke, raising his hand in the air.

“I don’t care how you do it, just get it done before my nap is over.” Aizawa said, falling to the ground in his sleeping bag.

“Dude, it’s clear you want us to vote for you.” Kirishima huffed, crossing his arms.

“We’ve only known each other for a little bit, how are we supposed to know how to vote for?”

“Yeah! Won’t we just vote for ourselves?”

“That makes it more accurate. Whoever has the most votes must be the most fit!”

Izuku really didn’t expect to find himself at the podium, with the most votes. He expected Yaoyorozu, but not himself. He shook slightly, not appreciative of all the looks. Somehow, he was only stuck on Bakugo.

“Alright, who voted for him?!” Bakugo stood up, growling.

Lunch couldn’t come around any slower for Izuku, but by the time he had managed to get to the cafeteria he was exhausted. He was barely listening to Iida and Uraraka, who accompanied him for his lunch. He had his notebook open, staring at the empty pages. These two pages specifically were to find Cosmic’s identity. He had the basics down.

Cosmic

Quirk knowledge: Mind-Analyzation. Originally named Blueprint, but evolved into mapping out people’s possible movements. Boosts his IQ, as an intelligence quirk. Good at creating gadgets at fast speeds.

Physical ability: Fast, smooth movements, strong. He’s fast enough to confuse villains, he acts without thinking. His quirk helps make support items that enhance his physical ability.

Personality: He’s snarky, fun, but protective. He puts others first, and downplays his own achievements.

Backstory: Said his parents kicked him, but that’s all about his parents. He has a special routine in school, to keep his mind busy at all times. His quirk can be self destructive if pushed hard enough.

Looks: About 6’1” or 6’2”. He has a light green and a dark brown eye. Over his green eye, there’s a jagged and rough scar. Hair color is unknown, but I’ve seen a strand of white slip

from his hood only once. He has a newfound scar on his forehead.

Possible candidates:

Izuku narrowed his eyes at the page. *Wait. The scar on his forehead. Didn't Recovery Girl-* He was snapped out of his thoughts by Iida.

"Midoriya, I really do admire how you're able to think."

"Huh-?" Izuku looked over.

"In the entrance exam, you figured out there was more to the test than what you could see." Izuku held his breath.

"Well, I-"

"That's why I voted for Deku! He's so smart and he's a quick thinker!" Uraraka smiled.

"That's also the reason I voted for him."

"Wh..You guys voted for me?!" Izuku asked, blush rising to his cheeks. "I-! But-!"

"Yep!" Uraraka nodded. "Even though, I was surprised at Iida's reaction. You knew you voted for someone else," She told Iida, tilting her head.

"My brother would've done the same. The Iida family takes pride in being honest."

"..Iida family?" Izuku quizzed.

“Oo! Admit it, Iida! You’re filthy rich!” Uraraka giggled, a joking yet serious tone to her statement.

Iida’s eyes widened in surprise. “I..Yes. Are you two familiar with the hero Ingenium?”

“Of course!” Izuku nodded. “I know all about him!” He couldn’t help but spiral as he spewed information he knew about the hero. Iida smiles gently. “…Wait. Don’t tell me..”

“That’s my elder brother!”

Sirens started blaring. Iida glanced over at the kid next to him, who managed to tell him it had never happened in his three years of being at UA. Panic set in, and kids crowded the hallway. Izuku, Uraraka, and Iida all reached the hall together but got separated quickly.

I don’t know how to deal with this! I can hardly move my body! Izuku thought in a panic, trying to force his way out of the mob he found himself in.

Iida stuck himself to the window, looking outside to see what triggered the alarms.

Down below, a hoard of press and reporters were crowding the front door. Aizawa and Present Mic stood in the doorway, refusing to make any comment.

“No. With you people, you ask for an inch and then expect a mile.” Aizawa deadpanned. Hizashi leaned over to Aizawa, whispering in his ear.

“They are trespassing. That makes them kinda like villains. Can’t we just beat them to the ground?”

“Not unless you want your name dragged through the mud and then spit on.” Riso spoke up from behind Hizashi. “Aizawa would want you to wait for the cops.”

“I thought I told you to go back inside and not follow us.” Aizawa glared at Riso.

Back in the overly crowded hallway, Izuku flinched when he heard something crash against the wall and a familiar voice shout.

“EVERYONE! Please calm down, it’s just the press outside!” Iida yelled, “We are UA students! Please calm yourselves!”

That worked. Everyone began to calm, and even more relief settled in the mob when they heard the police sirens down below. After the commotion in the hallway, Izuku stood in front of his class in the classroom.

“I-I’d like to..say something.” Izuku stuttered, looking at his shaking hands. “I think Iida should be our class rep!”

There was silence. Then, Kirishma stood up in agreement.

“Yeah! I can handle that. He helped clam everyone down earlier! Totally manly.”

Denki nodded. “I’m okay with it.”

Izuku sighed with a smile and found his way into his seat. This wasn’t his responsibility anymore. Normally anyone would long to be in his shoes, but he couldn’t stand it. He liked knowing that if he could stay out of the spotlight, he could hide his identity better. It was also just too much for Izuku. Aizawa stood up from his bright yellow home, and addressed the class.

“We’ll be teaching you recuse. You’ll be going to an off campus facility, where you’ll meet me, Thirteen, and All Might. I know you’re excited about costumes, so hurry up and put them on.” Aizawa’s tone never changed from what Izuku calls ‘bored, gruff and blunt’. If Izuku hadn’t seen how he acted with Cosmic, he would’ve been much more intimidated by his teacher.

Izuku had to settle on his gym uniform. His hero costume hadn’t been officially remade yet, he fully expected Riso to be adding something to it. He waited by the bus, fixing his gloves. Uraraka approached him.

“Hi Deku! Where’s your hero costume?”

“You saw it after my fight with Kacchan..” Izuku rubbed the back of his neck nervously.

“Oh! Is it still getting repaired?”

“Yeah. Do you remember that super tall guy? Bright pink hair, white strip?”

Uraraka nodded.

“He said he was working on my new hero costume.”

“He seems really smart! I’d trust him with my hero costume!” Uraraka smiled and pressed her hands together. “His name was Riso, right?”

“Mhm. He walked me home yesterday, and we talked a lot.”

“Oh! Is he a fun person?”

“From what I heard, he’s a workaholic.”

Izuku and Uraraka got on the bus, per Iida’s request. The open layout destroyed his way of thinking, but it was of his least concern. He sat mostly in silence, until his classmates started talking about quirks.

One of the first people they started picking on was Bakugo, calling his brash personality violent and rude. Of course, his response was to start yelling. Izuku trained his eyes onto the floor.

Aizawa demanded the group of kids to knock it off because they were there. The unsettling, uneasy feeling set in with Izuku once again. The same one he felt with the press early that morning.

Getting off the bus, talking to Thirteen, most of it was a blur. Izuku’s ears were ringing, and his fingers had a nonexistent tingle. He kept glancing around, trying to find the source of the uneasiness. Aizawa noticed, looking at Izuku curiously. He never spoke, but picked up on the boy's survival instinct.

That’s when Aizawa’s own instinct kicked in. A chill went down his spin, as he turned behind him to look. His eyes twitched, seeing a warping portal spill out villains. Something suddenly clicked, two puzzle pieces fitting together. Cosmic had called him about someone recruiting people for a new villains group. This had to have been the same group.

“Wh-! I thought we were doing recuse training?!”

“Thirteen, protect the students!” Aizawa said, fixing his goggles onto his face. He heard a few of the students step forward. “Stay back! Those are real villains.”

“You specialize in stealth and one on one fights, you don’t do good against multiple opponents!” Izuku said, his voice laced with concern. Aizawa sighed, grabbing his capture weapon.

“You can’t be a Pro if you only have one trick up your sleeve.” With that, he leaped down the steps.

Izuku’s hand twitched as he watched his teacher fight the villains. Based on his analyses, the villains looked to be lowly thugs. There was a mass amount, but none of them seemed to be too skillful. Quantity over quality.

At UA, Nezu walked into the lounge where All Might was. Behind Nezu, was Riso.

“I’m very sorry our tea time will be interrupted with All Might, but I must speak with him first.” Nezu told Riso as the two walked in. Nezu climbed on the couch, and looked at All Might.

“I understand you’re a Pro-Hero, but I gave you this job to help hide your true form. You know you’re running on a time limit, yet you still spend your only hours doing hero work.” Nezu picked up a cup of tea. All Might tensed a little, and nodded.

“Yes sir, I understand.” All Might nodded, feeling his body smoking.

“Oh goodness, you’re smoking.”

Poof!

All Might noticed Riso’s stare. He felt the hair on the back of his neck stand, knowing the boy was glaring at him even if he couldn’t see his eyes. The tension and what All Might thinks is anger coming from Riso scared him slightly. He was the number one hero, why would this second year seem to hate him so much? Tea time couldn’t be *that* important.

“I would’ve thought you put your students over hero work.” Riso spoke, picking up a cup of tea that Nezu poured him. “You should be at the USJ with your students along with Aizawa and Thirteen, but here you are. You’re a teacher, now. Not just a Pro-Hero.”

All Might narrowed his eyes. A teenager was telling him how to live his life. The principal was allowing it at the same time.

“Young Riso,”

“Sakusei.” Riso corrected.

“…Sakusei. When you know of the real world and the dangers, you would see why I stopped to help those people.”

“You’re quite wrong, All Might. You were given the ability to help. Even though I think your knowledge is barely able to help any student other than ‘holding your head high’ and ‘never giving up’.” Riso gently sat down his tea. “You are teaching selflessness. Not everyone has a quirk that takes care of everything. Not everyone can just punch something once or twice and it be done. You are what we call lucky, All Might.” His calm, yet enraged tone struck All Might, who bit his tongue. He looked at Nezu, who just simply nodded.

“Simply, just prioritize your students.”

After a good amount of talking between Riso and Nezu, Nezu turned to All Might.

“Will you take Riso with you?”

“Sir, he’s not a hero course student,”

“You’re correct, but he is also one of the main students helping with hero costumes. Being able to observe hero students at work could help his research.”

“I..guess I will.” All Might looked at Riso. “Come with me, young Sakusei.”

“Don’t call me young.” Riso muttered, standing. “Thank you for the tea,” He smiled and waved at Nezu.

Back at the USJ, Tsuyu had just gently placed down Izuku, herself, and Mineta. She was a bit rough setting him down.

“We need to check on Mr. Aizawa! We’ll see if he needs help. Then we’ll leave. Okay?” Izuku said, running towards where Aizawa was. The three of them felt as if someone had just injected ice cold water into their veins. Their teacher was on the brink of death. There was nothing they could do to help. Izuku felt his hands shake in anger. He could barely overhear the conversation about it being ‘gameover’ and time to leave.

That uneasy gut feeling completely washed over Izuku as he watched the blue haired man covered in hands turn to him, Mineta and his newfound friend, Tsuyu.

“Let’s wreck his pride, and make it hurt.”

The man lunged towards the three of them, movements being insanely quick. Izuku had no reaction time, and could only replay the scene of watching his teacher’s arm decay. He saw Tsuyu’s head disappear and crumble under the man’s fingertips. Except, it never happened.

The man had his hand on her head, but he turned back and looked at Aizawa.

“Man. You really are cool, Eraserhead.”

Izuku saw Aizawa staring at the man, his eyes beaming a red he’d only seen hot metal achieve. *He canceled the quirk!* Izuku thought. Before anyone else could react, the man was tackled to the ground.

“Don’t you fucking touch them!” A familiar voice growled. Izuku’s head snapped over, and his heart dropped.

Cosmic?! No, he’ll kill you!

Izuku couldn’t speak his thoughts, but watched his mentor wrestle with the suspected leader of this attack. Cosmic pinned his arms to the ground, one of the hands falling off with a clank to the ground.

“You..You damn *brat* !” He screamed, fighting against Cosmic’s grip. Cosmic only punched the hand covering the man’s face, listening to him grunt in pain. “That’s right,” The man started, his speech resembling one of a toddler.

“What pathetic thing do you have to say now, asshole?!” Cosmic yelled out.

“You’re that useless kid Giran attacked..gave you that scar..How’s it feel to forget something so important?”

Cosmic froze. “Wh..what did you just..what did you just say..?!” His voice quivered, and shook slightly. His grip had loosened.

“Nomu.”

Cosmic was suddenly hit back violently by ‘Nomu’, and hit a support beam that was holding up a zone. His body slumped over, knocked out cold.

Izuku still couldn’t move from his frozen state. He had been so scared, his body locked up. He couldn’t understand why, as he had literally been stabbed before. Maybe it was the guy’s quirk that made him uneasy. The door to the USJ busted open, as a large figure began to walk down the steps. For the first time since the day he tried to kill himself, Izuku was relieved to see All Might.

It was unusual, as All Might didn't wear a smile that was always engraved in his face. If All Might almost ruined his life before, maybe he could finally make up for it by saving his teacher and classmates.

He jumped from the steps, taking down the villains that surrounded Aizawa. He picked him up swiftly, looking down at the beaten and broken man. He then saw Izuku, Mineta and Tsuyu. He dashes forward, picking the three up and holding Aizawa still. He put them on the ground, far from danger. The man's hand fell off his face, and he began to mumble to himself.

"No. He's just as fast. Father, I was lied to. You said he would be weaker! He landed a hit on me.." He placed the hand on his face and took a breath. "…I wasn't prepared. He wasn't as fast as I thought he would be..Not as fast as he *used* to be."

Izuku picked up Aizawa and rested him on his back as he carried him. Tsuyu gently helped by making sure he wouldn't fall. Izuku stopped, and turned to All Might.

"…He's strong, sir." Izuku gritted his teeth. "And I think they're using that monster to try and kill you."

"Young Midoriya!" All Might turned to him. "I got this."

Izuku continued to walk with Tsuyu, holding Aizawa. He made sure to keep his movements small. He got about halfway, when he turned to look back for Cosmic. Cosmic had told him during their early training to always put other people before him, because the health of the people was more important to him. He always said that he, as a 'hero', could be replaced, but innocent lives could not. Izuku couldn't stomach it, as he gave Aizawa to Mineta and Tsuyu, saying he would be right back.

Izuku started running, praying that by the time he got to Cosmic, he would still be breathing. Cosmic always bounced back from things the usual person could never, so it was concerning to Izuku that he hadn't gotten up yet. He reached Cosmic, and kneeled down beside him. He ignored the shaking ground and yells from the fight taking place so close to him, doing his best to focus on his fallen friend.

“Cosmic? Cosmic, wake up!” Izuku gently shook him. “Cosmic, please. I can’t get you help yet.” Izuku checked for a pulse and was relieved to feel it beat so strongly. *He was just knocked out. Just unconscious, that’s it.* Izuku thought to himself. He forced Cosmic onto his feet, and shook him again. “Cosmic! Please, please wake up. I can’t get you medical help, Recovery Girl might not treat you.”

Izuku glanced over when he heard Bakugo yell out, and he saw him grab ahold of the warping quirk guy by his…neck? *He has a physical body??* Izuku tried to quiet his thoughts, watching as Todoroki froze the Nomu.

Izuku shook his head and turned to help Cosmic, when he noticed he was no longer with him. Izuku paused. *Where did he..?* He immediately answered his thought when he looked over to the fight. There Cosmic was, jumping back into action. He landed next to Kirishima, who looked at him confusingly.

“Aren’t you a villain? Why are you-?” Kirishima started.

“I’m not a villain, now shut up and get ready to beat them!” Cosmic told him, standing guard in front of Bakugo. Kirishima nodded, and stood next to Cosmic with a battle stance.

“Kurogiri…how could you get caught by this brat?”

“It wasn’t hard to figure him out.” Bakugo smirked, his hand on Kurogiri’s neck guard. “You have a physical body, and the only reason we missed was because you covered your actual body with the mist you emit.”

Kurogiri shifted, and was met with an explosion to his neck.

“Move and I’ll blow your ass up so bad they’ll be piecing you together for weeks.” A glint, which could be mistaken for murderous, shined in Bakugo’s eyes.

“Woah, that doesn’t sound very heroic.” Kirishima noted, earning a glare from Bakugo.

“You’re all completely untouched..Even took down two of my strongest men..Kids these days really are amazing..” The man started to rant. “Nomu,”

Cosmic’s hand twitched, and he grabbed Bakugo’s collar. He quickly threw him back as soon as the man spoke. No one had even registered his movements.

“Get him.”

The Nomu darted towards Kurogiri to free him from Bakugo, who was already in the process of being moved out of the way. All Might flung forward, moving Cosmic out of the way and next to the other kids who had gotten blown away from the blast.

“Kacchan!” Izuku called, running over. He paused. “..Wait. You’re right here..?”

Cosmic huffed, glaring at All Might, but kept his mouth shut.

“These are kids, and you didn’t hold back?!” All Might asked, breathing heavy from the attack he just blocked against.

“I had no choice. They were endangering my men. But they’re not innocent either, All Might. The angry one threatened to kill a villain he had already captured. What kind of hero resorts to violence?” The man opened his arms, almost mocking the entire situation. “You know what, All Might? That pisses me off. Why is there a difference between heroic and villainous in violent actions? It accomplishes the same thing. Someone still gets hurt.”

“You just love doing this. Villains and criminals like you like to make your actions sound noble. They’re not! You’re a lunatic.”

“We’ve got them outnumbered.” Todoroki spoke, earning a nod from Izuku.

“Kacchan figured out the mist guy’s weakness.” Izuku glanced at Bakugo, who just stared forward with hatred.

“They’re not as tough as they act. With All Might, we can take him down.” Kirishma activated his quirk, ready to fight.

Cosmic stood there silently. He flipped out a staff, and placed it in Izuku’s hand. He never spoke, but Izuku knew it was *his* staff. The one he knew how to use so easily.

“Don’t attack them. Get out of here, children.”

“Without me, you would’ve died. You need our help.” Todoroki said, looking at All Might.

“This is different. Just sit back and watch a Pro at work!”

“Kurogiri, Nomu. Kill him. I’ll deal with the children.”

All Might ran forward, connecting his fist with the Nomu. The punch sent a wave of wind around them so strong that it knocked Izuku back. He was stopped by a hand he had thought was Cosmic’s, but was Bakugo’s. He hadn’t noticed the owner of the fist, since he was too busy watching All Might fight.

Izuku hated him. He really did. But he couldn’t help but admire the way the man fought. Each punch wasn’t random, it was clearly targeted. He didn’t stop for a second, or for a breath. He might be a horrible person, and was anything but a horrible hero.

All Might punched the Nomu into the ground, breaking the cement around it into squares.

“I’ll show you the true meaning behind this! Go beyond. PLUS ULTRA!” All Might’s punch sent Nomu out of the USJ, and he disappeared into the sky with a sparkle.

All Might stood in a cloud of smoke, looking on to the man and Kurogiri with pride. The man shook, visibly angry. He began to scratch at his neck, and his voice was raw.

“He cheated.”

The man scratched his neck more violently.

“Tomura Shigaraki. Do not fret. The children are frozen in fear. Our underlings are waking, All Might appears weakened and injured. Nomu’s attack worked. We still have time.”

Shigaraki stopped scratching. He smiled wickedly, and darted forward. “This is for destroying my Nomu!” He reached his hand out towards All Might.

Izuku let out a gasp when he saw that Cosmic had jumped to attack Kurogiri. Izuku could see Cosmic’s thought process. But his heart dropped when he saw Shigaraki’s hand come through a portal that manifested itself in front of Cosmic’s face.

Cosmic clenched his jaw, aware he was unable to dodge this attack since he was already in motion. He knew he could’ve let All Might die, but he was a symbol of peace. A sign of hope to kids, and people around. Cosmic knew his existence helped calm others, and as a person who wanted to have a world that knows peace, he understood All Might couldn’t die. Personal bias or not, he kept the people from hiding away in fear.

Cosmic stuck to his morals. His life for innocent lives. He winced when he felt Shigaraki’s fingers touch his skin. Unexpectedly, he was relieved when he heard a gunshot.

Shigaraki retracted his hand, yelling in pain. Cosmic fell to the ground, and he fixed his form so he immediately popped up. He put a hand to his forehead gently, feeling a small circle decay Shigaraki had caused. Cosmic clenched his jaw once again, wincing in pain. He shook

his hand, watching as Kurogiri circled Shigaraki. They disappeared, and Izuku ran up to Cosmic.

“Are you okay?! Your forehead!” He asked worriedly. Cosmic nodded, chuckling a little. “What? What’s so funny..??”

“I always seem to get a head injury, don’t I?”

Izuku glared, hitting Cosmic’s chest gently. “That’s not funny at all! Now come with me, you need medical attention..!!”

“Only if you can get me somewhere that’s not a hospital. Hate those places..” Cosmic sighed. He limped forward with Izuku’s help, and Kirishma ran over.

“Yo! That was so manly!! Do you need help getting up to the door?” He asked, and Izuku nodded.

“Yes please. He’s like a giant, I’d love the help. Thanks, Kirishma!”

Cosmic groaned. He hated feeling like he needed to be helped, but he was exhausted enough that he didn’t fight it. He walked with Kirishima and Izuku to the door, feeling his consciousness slip from his grasp. He gulped, squeezing his eyes shut. He opened them and looked down at the woman talking to him. He couldn’t understand much of what she was saying.

“Oh, dear! You look like you’re in a lot of pain. Let me help you. I’ll take you to my nurse’s office, in the school! I know you care about your identity, Cosmic.”

Izuku looked at Recovery Girl confused. “You- know him?”

“All heros do, deary. We’re supposed to take him into custody if we see him. But he saved All Might, did he not? He deserves medical attention, in a place where his identity will be safe.” Recovery Girl smiled at Izuku. It was a good thing EMTS had come to assist Cosmic, because as soon as the bed was in sight he passed out. Recovery Girl ordered them to not touch his mask or hood, and to just drive him to her office inside of the school.

Izuku let out a breath, sitting down. He tensed when he realized he had sat next to Bakugo. He slowly turned to him, expecting a glare. Instead, he saw curiosity inside the stare he gave Izuku.

“Who was that, Deku.” Bakugo asked, his tone harsh. Izuku knew that Bakugo was curious, so he didn’t take the harsh tone to heart.

“Cosmic. He’s a vigilante. Uh..remember that Endeavor prank that got posted and blew up on Twitter?” Izuku stumbled over his words periodically.

“Tsk. Yeah, I remember that.”

“He’s the guy that posted it. Uhm..And the one that helped save you from..you know.” Izuku glanced away, expecting an outburst.

“Huh?” Bakugo growls softly. “I bet he thinks he’s better than me. Damn scar-face, he even saved me in there earlier. Does he think I'm weak or something?!”

Izuku blinked. “Wait. I thought All Might saved you from that monster.”

“Whatever! I’m done talking to you, Deku. Don’t think this means you’re better than me!” Bakugo stood, walking away from Izuku.

Izuku watched Bakugo walk away. He looked at the staff Cosmic had given him, and pocketed it. The last thing he needed was some cop trying to use it as evidence against him or Cosmic. He looked up and watched the teachers confirm if his classmates were okay, and

locked eyes with Present Mic. He looked sad, and anxious. Izuku had guessed the two were close based on Cosmic's stories, but he had never seen Present Mic so upset.

Izuku stood up, and walked over to him slowly.

"Present Mic?" His voice came out softer and quieter than he had hoped. He hadn't realized until then, that he felt just as upset as Present Mic looked.

"Yes, little listener?" Present Mic responded, trying to cheer his voice to sooth the kid standing in front of him.

"Um..He..he saved Asui..I-I mean Tsu. He..even while hurt, he did his best. You looked so..so upset.. I wanted to tell you that." Izuku couldn't help it, but tears pricked his eyes. He enjoyed every moment he had with Aizawa or with him as Eraserhead. Aizawa was so gentle, yet firm. It killed him that he was so injured.

Present Mic stared down at Izuku, and felt tears of his own come to his eyes. He squatted a little, ruffling Izuku's hair. "Thank you."

Izuku let the tears spill, before he hugged Present Mic tight. He apologized almost instantly, but Present Mic hugged back. He understood Izuku's pain, that and more. There was one thing he knew of that gave him a bit of comfort.

His husband always managed to pull through any injury thrown his way.

Chapter End Notes

cosmic is supposed to help make up for izuku not having one for all! i did struggle a little trying to find ways to have izuku be without one for all but fuck all might 👆 updates every sunday and wednesday !

Chapter Twelve

Chapter Summary

A bit of a filler chapter! Shinso is finally introduced and Cosmic brings up his concern to Present Mic.

Chapter Notes

i hope you guys enjoy this <3 this chapter is purely cosmic and shinso!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

The air was thin. The glowing moon lit up the empty alleyways, reflections of dim emergency lights were projected onto the puddles on the ground. Cosmic rubbed his eye gently, as he walked in the rain slowly. He left Recovery Girl's office in the middle of the night, knowing if he stayed any longer his identity would be easier to find. Now he roamed the streets alone and tired, stumbling over himself occasionally.

Cosmic knew he should be at home, sleeping. Something was tugging at his heart, telling him to go out. Even injured, Cosmic couldn't ignore his danger senses. So for now he wandered around in the rain. He stopped when he heard yelling.

"YOU'RE USELESS."

Those words burned into Cosmic, causing him to freeze. A memory he thought he got over flashed in his mind briefly.

"You're so goddamn useless! You're not a man at all. Get the hell out of my house!"

Cosmic snapped back to reality as he heard the yelling continue.

“We told you not to talk! What’s so hard about that?! You villainous child! I don’t care if you’re in that hero school, you’ll always be a fucking villain!” The man’s voice filled the alleyway. Cosmic slowly peaked his head around the corner. He blinked, eyes softening at the sight.

A boy his age was kneeling in the middle of the alleyway, the rain beating against the vulnerable boy’s body as he hung his head low. The door that sat in front of him had two people standing there, looking down at him. A man, who was clearly in his 40’s, and a woman who couldn’t be older than 25. The woman was crying, and had lipstick smeared across her lips.

“Look at me boy!” The man threw a bottle on the ground, and the purple haired boy didn’t flinch. He slowly locked eyes with him. “You’re done. You hear me? DONE! No more living with us, you piece of shit!”

“Hey!” Cosmic called, storming over. Rage filled his veins, his eyes turning dark. “You take that back. He is not useless. Or a piece of shit, or villainous! You’re just a man who’s got nothing going for his fucking life!” Cosmic couldn’t stop the words from coming from his mouth. He stood face to face with the man.

“Excuse me?” The man growled. “I can say what I want! He’s my fucking son.”

“Foster. You’re fostering me.” The boy spoke blankly.

“I told you not to talk, you freak! I’ll bring out that damn muzzle you were sent with!” The woman shrieked, acting as if the sound of his voice ripped her ear drums.

“You’re his foster parents.” Cosmic said, then laughed. “You’ve got to be kidding me! You’re not even worth the breath.” He grabbed the door handle, and slammed the door to the house. The woman and man didn’t reopen the door. Cosmic turned, offering a sympathetic smile. He held out a hand to the boy.

“..Thanks.” He seemed to hesitate to speak, but took his offer to help him to his feet.

“You look cold.” Cosmic frowned. He hadn't noticed, but the boy only wore a short sleeve white button up and pants. He also wore a red tie, but it wasn’t worn correctly. *He must’ve fought with his foster parents.* Cosmic noted to himself.

“I’ll be fine.” He was visibly shivering, but dismissed Cosmic with a hand. Cosmic thought for a moment, then turned around to slip off his sweater he wore under the cloak (the main part of his costume). He turned back around, handing it to the boy.

“Here. You were literally shivering.” Cosmic smiled. Now he only wore a thin long sleeve under his cloak, but he would be fine.

“I don’t need it.” The boy still refused, shaking his head.

“Put the damn sweater on or I *will* force it on your body. Trust me, you don’t want that.”

“…Fine.” He slipped it over his head, it being slightly oversized. The boy looked at Cosmic curiously. “Who are you?”

“Cosmic!”

“You mean, you’re the vigilante that’s always on the news?”

“…Well I’d think so, yeah.”

He was quiet, as he studied Cosmic.

“Two questions.”

“Hm?” Cosmic tilted his head. He was curious what the boy in front of him had to say.

“One. Where’s your partner? Two, why does the media make you seem like an asshole when you’re far from it?”

“Great question! My partner doesn’t know I’m out right now. Therefore, not with me. Also it’s the media. I hate the way the media portrays me but there is nothing I can do!” Cosmic shrugged, “We should get out of the rain. Wanna walk with me?”

“You don’t even know me.”

“..Okay? Tell me your name and then I will know you.”

“What? No.”

“Then we’ll be strangers walking together.” Cosmic nodded, and started on his way to get shelter. He looked back at the purple-haired boy, and waved him over. “C’mon! Walk with me. We should find shelter,”

“…I’m only following because I have your sweater.”

“Good enough for me!”

The two walked together in mostly silence. To Cosmic, he just witnessed a boy be thrown out of his house for, what he assumed was, his quirk. Cosmic experienced something similar, and he knew how much it hurt to be alone during that time. That’s why he didn’t want to leave the boy alone.

“Hey look, there’s a cafe open! Wanna head in there?” Cosmic looked at the boy. He just nodded in return. Cosmic walked inside the cafe, holding the door for the boy. He really wished he would’ve told him his name, it would’ve made everything easier. Addressing him would result to ‘hey purple hair boy’ and Cosmic didn’t exactly want to call him that.

The two stood in the cafe, before the boy gasped softly.

“What? Are you okay?” Cosmic looked in his direction.

“This is a cat cafe.”

Cosmic pauses. “Oh my god it is.” The two stood at the glass door that led to the section filled with cats. Cosmic opened the door, and the boy pushed past him and walked in. He sat on the floor, and the cats swarmed him almost immediately. Cosmic huffed and sat next to him.

“You took all the cats.” Cosmic pouted jokingly.

“Sorry, I’m just better than you. The cats like me more.”

For the next hour, Cosmic and the purple haired boy played with the cats together. At some point, Cosmic ordered a coffee for himself and the boy. They didn’t speak much, but rather enjoyed each other’s company in silence. Eventually, the boy spoke up.

“Hitoshi Shinso.”

“Huh?”

“That’s my name.”

“It’s nice to meet you, Shinso.” Cosmic smiled at him. He had taken his mask off at some point, but he doubted Shinso would be able to memorize his face when he’s so involved with the cats.

“Why did you help me?”

“Uhm. Well..I went through something similar. Being kicked out I mean. It made me angry, I guess.”

“You don’t even know why I was kicked out. Yet you helped. I could be a bad person.”

“But you’re not. You currently have four cats on you and trying to climb you. No bad person would let cats do that. Not in my book at least.” Cosmic shrugged.

“…Oh.”

“Can I ask why you were kicked out?” Cosmic asked quietly. “You don’t have to tell me, but that old fuck was calling you villainous. And that woman mentioned a muzzle.”

Shinso visibly tensed, as he continued to pet the cat that curled up in his lap. The nametag on the cat read ‘Fluffball’, and Shinso definitely thought the name fit. He gently scratched Fluffball’s head, sighing softly.

“It’s my quirk.” Shinso started. “If someone answers a question of mine, I can brainwash them. I didn’t know how to control it when I went into foster care, so they had a muzzle to shut me up. I jumped from home to home quite often, but I had been with those two the longest. He didn’t like it when I got into UA. And- I don’t even know why I’m telling you this.”

“Well, I did ask. Besides, it’s okay to talk about horrible things that happened to you.” Cosmic picked up a cat and gently kissed its head. “Have you even told anyone that you’ve been *muzzled* before?”

Shinso shook his head. Cosmic looked down at the cat, feeling his heart ache.

“And you’re just going to be placed in another home or back with them. Aren’t you?”

“Probably. They’re the closest to UA.” Shinso didn’t look at Cosmic, focusing his attention on the cats. “I’ll be okay.”

“That’s not okay. At all, Shinso. You *shouldn’t* be okay. I know I’m not one to talk and insert myself into your life but it’s just not right. You’ve been muzzled, emotionally and verbally abused. You shouldn’t have to just take it! You won’t make it to your third year if you’re too busy being dead.”

“Why do you care anyway?”

“Because I know what it’s like to be singled out, beaten and broken mentally until I couldn't do it anymore. I’ve seen the face of some of the darkest demons there are, and to this day it still gives me shivers. That’s where you’re headed. Especially in that damn house I saved you from.”

“This isn’t your life, Cosmic. It’s mine. I said it’s fine.” Shinso stood up. “I should get going. Thanks for the coffee.” He per the cats gently, saying his goodbyes. He reached the door and looked back at Cosmic.

“I mean this. Don’t worry about me.”

Of course, Cosmic wasn’t going to listen. He had seen Shinso get abused, and yet he still says it’s fine. He was like that himself once, but he wasn’t going to let it happen to him. He already looked so tired. So Cosmic went to a certain apartment for help.

The knock on the apartment door was hesitant, but firm. Cosmic held his breath, watching it open. He watched the feet of the person in the doorway, not daring to look up.

"Hey, Mic." Cosmic muttered, "Bad time?"

"…You're not even looking at me, how do you know it's me?" Hizashi said, his voice had a slight rasp to it. He must've just woken up after crying.

"Eraser's still in the hospital. I need to talk to you." Cosmic looked up at Hizashi. "It's about one of the students at UA."

"Come in," Hizashi's hair was down, and was pulled into a loose ponytail. Cosmic had to admit, seeing *the* Present Mic without his signature hair was quite a sight.

Cosmic walked in, and took his mask off. He kept his hood on. He wanted Hizashi to know he was sincere. He sat at the kitchen island, and watched Hizashi pour himself and Cosmic a cup of coffee. He sat a cup in front of Cosmic.

"I'm sorry to bother you right now. I can't imagine how tough things are."

"Aren't you still injured too? I know you were there. Sho told me."

"He's awake?"

"Yes. What is it you needed? Something about a UA student?"

"He's being abused." Cosmic chewed on his lip nervously, tapping his coffee cup with his index finger. "Hitoshi Shinso."

“Do I need to ask how you know this, or just assume it’s your...magical powers?”

“I walked into it. They had thrown him outside in the rain, yelling at him and calling him villainous.” Cosmic tightened his grip on the mug. “They have a fucking muzzle to shut him up. A *muzzle* , Mic.”

“A fucking what?” Hizashi sets his coffee mug down. “Sorry. I didn’t mean to say that. Just- what? They’re muzzling him?”

“His quirk is brainwashing. He told me he couldn’t control it when he was first in foster care, so they sent a muzzle with him to each home. I helped him out when I saw the argument, we even went to a cat cafe to get out of the rain. Then he left, accepting the fact that it’s his life with that family because they’re the closest to UA.”

“He can’t go back there..”

“I know. The only thing that has me worried about trying to rehome him is UA. He was right when he told me they were the only ones close enough that lets him go to UA.” Cosmic sighed, sipping his coffee

“…That’s not entirely true.”

“What do you mean? I checked the records, I didn’t-”

“All Pro-Heros are required to have fostering licenses for emergency situations.”

“But how does that help us now?”

“That means,” Hizashi leaned down onto the counter, barely breaking a smile for the first time that night. “Sho and I can foster him.”

Chapter End Notes

yes, cosmic gave his sweater. yes, shinso never gave it back. yes, cosmic sees mic and aizawa as mentors, not necessarily “parents”.
updates every wednesday and sunday! <3

Chapter Thirteen

Chapter Summary

Cosmic visits Bakugo in his own home as the class prepares for the Sports Festival.

Chapter Notes

this chapter is super short and i was going to write the sports festival in this chapter but i totally ran out of time. been having major writers block! i'll try to get it out on sunday <3 thank you guys for being patient

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Izuku's body felt sore from the patrol he and Cosmic took on his day off. Since the USJ Incident, UA had given the students a day off for a bit of a break. Izuku couldn't stop thinking about everything that had happened, so he told Cosmic he wanted to patrol all day as a distraction. The last thing he needed was to get consumed in his thoughts and fears.

Though, he did heavily regret wanting to work so hard now that he was in class. He tried to ignore the slight throbbing headache he had, and listened to his classmates' conversations briefly.

"We're practically famous now!" Denki laughed, nudging Kirishima. "We were on TV and everything."

Izuku knew Denki was usually the class clown, the one making everyone laugh. He understood why he was trying to make light of the horrible thing that happened to them their first few days at school.

"Yeah we are! We already dealt with real villains, our classmates can't beat us!" Kirishima responded with a smile.

“Everyone sit in your seats! Class is about to start!” Iida announced aloud, interrupting any conversations that were happening. He waves his arms robotically as he talks, and stiffened when Mina called out to him.

“…You’re the only one not in your seat.”

Iida grumbled softly as he sat in his seat, shaking in possible anger and frustration. Izuku shook his head and looked back at the chalkboard that laid behind the podium. He sighed, resting his head on his hand. His eyes slowly drifted to the back of Bakugo’s head.

I wonder… His thoughts started. *Is Kacchan’s hair as soft as it used to be?*

Izuku suddenly blushed a bright red, forcing his thoughts to the back of his head. He mentally groaned at himself for being so stupid for thinking questions like that. He and the rest of his class looked towards the door when it slid open, and to their surprise it was Aizawa.

“Mister Aizawa?!” Majority of the students called out in confusion and concern. Their teacher was wrapped in bandages from head to toe.

“I’m so glad you’re okay!” Mina cried out, relief lining her voice.

“You call that okay?” Kirishima muttered, his attention still on his injured teacher.

“My condition doesn’t matter.” Aizawa spoke, walking up to the podium. “We have more important things to discuss. We need to prepare.” Aizawa couldn’t see clearly out of his bandages, but the look of fear and anxiety that crept onto his student’s face made him sick to his stomach. These kids were barely in school, and they were already experiencing the fear of another attack. Aizawa felt a breath get caught in his throat, and he sighed.

“The UA Sports Festival is soon.” The relief that came across the students' faces gave him a sense of peace.

“Wait, but is it really a good idea to have the sports festival after the villain attack?” Izuku spoke up.

“They believe if we hold the sports festival it’ll prove to the people that the villains didn’t affect UA the way they hoped. It’s going to prove UA won’t be stopped.” Aizawa’s voice proved he didn’t exactly believe this, and Izuku had picked up on it since he was used to having to read Cosmic’s feelings in the same way.

“Why is this so important anyway? It’s just a dumb festival.” Mineta said from behind Izuku, to whom turned and faced him.

“Do you really not know how important this is?” Izuku asked, a confused and puzzled look on his face. “Most Pro-Hero’s get accepted into agencies this way. There are recruiters watching from the stands, and they pick who they might want to work with in the future.”

“That’s correct.” Aizawa nods. “Class dismissed.”

The lunch bell rang, and most of the class began to talk between each other.

“Man, I’m pumped for these games!” Kirishima threw his fist into the air. “Aren’t you guys excited?!”

“I’m going to get first place for sure!” Denki snickered, wrapping his arm around Kirishima’s neck.

“We’re going to totally be pros!” Sero nodded. The more the class talked, the more lost in thought Izuku became. He didn’t listen to any of the encouragement his classmates were giving to each other, but he was interrupted when Uraraka spoke suddenly.

“Deku, Iida!” Her voice sounded strained, and when Izuku looked at her she had a scary look on her face. “Let’s do our best!”

Izuku walked to the lunch room with Uraraka and Iida once they all left the classroom. Izuku hummed softly to himself in thought, appreciative that he had a friend like Uraraka. She had explained to the two of them why she wanted to be a hero, and it was enough to almost bring Izuku to tears.

“Oh! Good afternoon, Riso.” Iida bowed politely at the tall boy, who visibly stiffened.

“..You remembered my name?” Riso asked, closing his sketchbook.

“Of course we did! It’s hard to forget the name of such an interesting guy! You were really nice too.” Uraraka offered a smile. “Would you like to have lunch with us?”

“If you wouldn’t mind.” Riso nodded softly, and he gave a smile to Izuku. “Is that okay, Midoriya?”

Izuku returned a nod.

The rest of the day went by in a flash, and Izuku felt his body beginning to cave in on itself. He just wanted to lay in bed with no more issues, and of course more issues had to come.

Uraraka had tried to open the door to the classroom, but it was crowded by people. Izuku felt his blood run cold, he immediately knew that they were here to scope out the competition. He glanced at Bakugo, who calmly stood up and threw his bag over his shoulder.

“What are they doing?!” Uraraka asked, her eyes widened with fear.

“Hey! Are you looking for a fight??” Kirishima hardened his fist, but Bakugo pushed past them both and stood in front of the large crowd.

“They’re scoping out the competition, idiots.” Bakugo glared at the crowd. “And they better get a good look, because they’re looking at the future number one hero.”

“Bakugo! Don’t make them our enemy!” Kirishima pleaded, as someone from the crowd pushed their way to the front.

“That's kind of pathetic.” He spoke, his voice rough. “Are you that full of yourself?” His purple hair stood out among the rest of them. Izuku blinked, narrowing his eyes curiously at the purple-haired boy.

That’s Shinso, isn’t it? Cosmic told me he ran into him, Izuku thought to himself. *I hope Kacchan doesn’t blast him to pieces for how he spoke to him.*

Instead of blowing up, Bakugo just scoffed and forced his way into the hallway. Izuku gulped, watching him walk away. He hoped that hadn’t caused any bad blood between the other classes and their class. (It did)

The next few days were training for the festival. Each student from class 1A worked themselves sore. During the training for Izuku, Cosmic had obviously helped him with anything he could.

One problem was Izuku kept getting distracted. Izuku swore to Cosmic he was just tired, and easily distracted. Cosmic knew otherwise. He knew Izuku was having problems with Bakugo, seeing him in a different light. So, Cosmic went to see Bakugo. Was it a bad idea? Probably, but that wasn’t going to stop him.

Bakugo walked into his room, a towel on his shoulders and head as he dried his hair with one hand. He let the towel fall around his neck and he opened his closet door. He grabbed a shirt, then shut the closet door. Behind the door, Cosmic was there leaning against the wall.

He immediately was met with a blast from Bakugo. Cosmic jumped back and out of the way, before sitting on his bed.

“Woah, man. You got great reflexes.” Cosmic said. “Try not to burn me?”

“Hah?! What the hell are you doing here, you extra??” Bakugo growled, his palm sparking.

“I just want to talk with you about something, that’s all. Really, I don’t come here to cause problems.”

Bakugo let his guard down slightly, stopping the sparking of his hands. He crossed his arms, glaring at the boy on his bed.

“How do you know Deku?”

“Deku? You mean Zuku? Well, I saved his life.”

“Deku hasn’t been in danger like that.”

“Oh, yes he was. I mean, are we talking about when he jumped off a building or when a villain brutally murdered his mother and tried to kill him too?” Cosmic questioned, sarcastically tapping his chin as if he was thinking.

“Deku didn’t jump off any building.”

“Mm, he did.”

“How the hell do you know that then?! Why do you know but I don’t??”

“To be fair, you *did* tell him to take a swan dive off of a roof.” Cosmic hummed. “I know he jumped because I caught him.”

Bakugo froze. He did say that. He was young, stupid, and angry at Izuku for not getting a quirk. He never truly meant it. Izuku was his best friend, but it was easier to make fun of him than comfort him because his mother taught him that’s how love worked.

Love? I don’t love that damn Deku. What am I thinking? Bakugo growled at his thoughts.

“Cat got your tongue, Kacchan?”

“Don’t call me that.”

“Let me ask you something.”

“No.”

“Why has Zuku been thinking of you so much recently?” Cosmic asked. “You’re not bullying him again, are you?”

“What? The fuck I’m not. I’m training to be a hero. You can’t be number one if you’re a damn bully!”

“I see..Well, let me make something very clear.” Cosmic stood, leaning down as his face was only inches from Bakugo’s. “If I find out you’re either lying, or if you hurt Zuku. Let’s just say, I’ll treat you like a filthy villain. And I take pride in the beatings I give them.”

The morning of the festival finally arrived, and Izuku was in the participant’s waiting room with his class. He tried focusing on his breathing to calm himself down.

“Awh man, I really wanted to wear my costume.” Mina pouted.

“Hey, at least everyone will be wearing the same thing? It’ll level out the playing field as most as they can.” Ojiro comforted her, giving her a small smile.

“Whatever is thrown our way, I’m sure we can handle it.” Tokoyami said, earning a nod from the class.

Suddenly, Todoroki stood up and walked over to Izuku.

“Midoriya.”

“Oh, hey Todoroki.” Izuku said nervously, not liking the intense look he had on his face.

“I think it’s clear I’m stronger than you. I will tell you, I plan on beating you.” Todoroki’s stern look didn't falter. He saw how well Izuku could fight, even if it was with no strong quirk.

“Uhm..Okay..” Izuku gulped, fidgeting with his hands. Todoroki turned and walked away, but Izuku could hear Bakugo burst out in a fit of anger. He couldn’t help but think to himself.

That was a declaration of war. Does he really see me as a threat?

Chapter End Notes

updates every wednesday and sunday <3

Chapter Fourteen

Chapter Summary

The UA Sports Festival takes place! Izuku ends the day off on a severely rough note.

Chapter Notes

i finished this chapter saturday but then it didn't save so i had to cram it all down again before today :(hope you guys enjoy!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Most of the class stood in shock as Todoroki walked away from Izuku. An intense pressure beat against Izuku's head, he shook it off and sat down. He didn't expect someone as strong as Todoroki to find him as a threat. Before he knew it, the classes were walking out to the field. Izuku held his breath, muttering things to himself to calm his brain. Afterall, this basically determines the rest of his life. Izuku felt his heart rate increase the louder the stadium got. He took a breath when someone bumped into him. He looked up, and was met with Bakugo's face.

"Calm down, you damn nerd." Bakugo didn't say anything else, and stood relaxed while he listened to Midnight speak. Izuku let a small smile crawl onto his face, and he crossed his arms across his chest as he stood slightly closer to Bakugo.

"Now we'll hear from this first years' representative!" Midnight smiled, waving her whip in the air. "Bakugo Katsuki!" Bakugo walked up to the stage, leaning into the microphone which gave a slight sound of feedback.

He did score the best in all of the Hero Course, of course Kacchan is the representative. Izuku thought, watching his childhood best friend stand in front of the microphone.

"I'm going to win." In the chaos that erupted, he walked down the stairs and back to his class.

“Don’t say that, Bakugo! You’re going to make them hate us!” Kirishima pleaded. He earned a ‘tsk’ in response from Bakugo.

Midnight began to explain the rules of the festival, with the first challenge being a race. Izuku felt confident. Something Cosmic trained him was how to dash around ‘like a bunny’ as he would explain it. Avoiding obstacles and knowing when to fight while running is important, and Izuku had the majority of that down.

Not to his surprise, Present Mic and Aizawa were the commentators. Most people would expect Aizawa to come as a surprise, but wherever Present Mic goes Aizawa follows. Izuku only knew that from Cosmic telling him they were married. He doubted it, but the signs were clearly there.

Izuku felt adrenaline rush through his veins when Present Mic started the race. He already predicted that UA would have some type of twist for the beginning of the race, the entrance exam proved that. He just didn’t know what it was.

A few moments later, Izuku found out. The robots from the entrance exam stomped onto the walkway. Izuku gritted his teeth, watching most of the fellow first years panic. Todoroki bolted up and covered everything in ice, making Izuku fall flat on his ass.

By the time he got back to his feet, he saw a robot coming down right on top of him. His eyes widened and he dashed forward, his legs burning from being pushed beyond his normal movements. He took a breath when it landed behind him. He paused, then turned back to look at one of the pieces of metal that was lodged into the ground.

“Do you have any tips for UA’s training?” Izuku asked, rubbing his sore shoulder.

“Mm, I’d say always trust your intuition. If it tells you to do something, you most likely will benefit from it.” Cosmic shrugged.

Izuku grabbed the metal piece that fell from the robot and tied it to his body without a second thought. He might need it, and if his intuition told him so then he would trust it and Cosmic's advice. He carried on forward, ignoring how far back he was. He just had to finish above forty. Doing the bare minimum was something Izuku hardly ever did, but in this case he had to.

He dodged most of the robots, and he took a breath when he reached the second area. He saw multiple islands with deep holes and rope connecting each island. He heard someone exclaim out in excitement.

"Now I can show off my babies!" Her voice was chipper, and she sounded slightly crazed. Her bright pink hair reminded him of Riso. He thought the two of them would get along nicely.

He tightened the rope holding the metal piece around him, and he grabbed onto the ropes. He inched his way quickly, yet safely, across the ropes. When he was almost finished, he heard explosions. He scrambled to finish and get on his feet, expecting Bakugo to be causing explosions or fighting others. Shockingly, Bakugo had just reached the third area. Everyone else who entered the area were being blown up by landmines placed in the ground.

Bakugo took off, using his blasts to make him fly. Izuku ran over to the edge, trying to think of a way to get across. He paused. *If I make a big enough explosion, I can get across.* Izuku told himself. *I need to gather the mines together then use the metal as a shield.*

He got to work. He pushed mines together and dug them into the ground. He was aware he was receiving weird looks but he ignored them and continued. He took a breath, and tightened his grip around the rope on the metal piece. He ran forward and jumped onto the pile. As expected, an explosion went off and he was sent into the air. He gulped, feeling the brute force of the air hitting his face.

In a brief moment, he thought about how a few months ago he was in this exact position except his goal was to end his life. Now he was doing it to win a race in a Hero school.

He let the adrenaline run his body's actions when he noticed he was heading for the ground. He swung the metal piece towards the ground, the momentum swinging his body to the

ground. He placed one foot each on Bakugo and Todoroki's shoulders. He was slung into the air once the metal hit the landmines, the blast sending Todoroki and Bakugo back.

He reached solid land again, and he started running to enter the stadium. His lungs were screaming in pain, but he pushed himself harder. Once he ran through the arch into the stadium, he bent down and rested his arms on his legs. Each breath felt like fire, ironic because that was his dad's quirk, he looked up slowly as confetti filled his eyes.

"In first place is…Izuku Midoriya!" Present Mic announced and Izuku could feel the tears flowing to his eyes. He forced them back, a small smile finding its way onto his face. He won. He beat Bakugo, Todoroki and every other student. Completely quirkless. Sure, he'd heal faster from his injuries but that doesn't affect his movements.

He got to relax as the rest of the students poured in. All of the students that passed the race huddled around Midnight as she congratulated everyone who made it to the next round. She pointed towards the board, explaining it would randomly choose a game.

Izuku didn't know what he was hoping for, but the Cavalry Battle was a little unexpected to him. He figured it would be easy, first place couldn't be worth a lot of points. Sure there were forty-two placements but it couldn't be too extreme. Izuku must have forgotten where he went to school in those brief moments.

"...Is worth a million points!" Midnight cheered, as a million appeared under Izuku's name. He gulped, feeling his heart sink. He nervously looked around, noticing everyone's competitive stare. He looked at the ground, swearing every single person was looming over him with glowing red eyes.

"You'll have fifteen minutes to find your team!"

Anyone Izuku approached, they ignored him. He didn't take it personally from his classmates, but he couldn't help but feel alone again. It felt like they were treating him that way because they didn't believe in him, or because he was basically quirkless. He tried to tell himself it was the points, but a nagging feeling in his heart told him otherwise. He snapped out his depressive thoughts when Uraraka approached him.

“Hey, Deku!” Uraraka smiled. “Do you wanna team?!” She asked, a determined look on her face.

Here come the waterworks.

Izuku began to cry, mumbling out words Uraraka couldn’t understand. Once his tears stopped, he looked at Uraraka.

“You..You want to team with me? My points don’t scare you..?”

“Not if we run the entire time! We can manage that, right? Let’s go ask Iida if he wants to join! Friends need to stick together, yknow?” Her smile calmed Izuku’s heart, and he nodded. The two approached Iida, and once Uraraka asked him Izuku got a response that broke his heart.

“Sorry, Midoriya. Todoroki made a good point back there, you're my friend but I need to separate myself from you.” Iida’s expression lacked mercy and empathy. Izuku felt a burn in his lungs, his lip quivering slightly.

Iida doesn’t believe in me. He doesn’t think I can keep the million points. He thinks I’m ***worthless*** *doesn’t he..?* Izuku fought the tears that were begging to spill.

“Oh..Okay.” Izuku nodded.

“Man, what’s with all the declarations of war recently?” Uraraka pouted. She yelped slightly when a girl appeared in front of the two of them.

“You’re the million points kid right?!” She asked, a sparkle in her eye.

“Um..yes?”

“I’m Mei Hatsume! We should team, my babies will get plenty of attention now!” Hatsume gushed, swinging her fists in excitement.

“You..really remind me of someone,” Uraraka says quietly. “Do you know Riso?”

“Riso?! Of course I do! He helps me create my babies all the time! So can we team?!” Izuku agreed.

Izuku approached Tokoyami next, asking him about his quirk. He asked if he wanted to join and help defend the time, and he was rather surprised when Tokoyami agreed. The boy seemed to have faith in Izuku and his plan.

Izuku explained the plan for how to run most of the time aloud. It was easy, Izuku being held by Uraraka and Hatsume. Uraraka having some of the support items Hatsume made and her quirk make them weightless. Tokoyami would be defense and offense. The four of them were immediately going to be targeted so they had to act fast. Izuku liked to imagine that Cosmic was standing over his team, helping him make split second decisions. He wasn’t going in alone. More negative thoughts tanked his attitude.

I’m not going to be able to do it. I’ll fail, and cost the three of them their whole future. This isn’t fair to them, I should just quit. Izuku tried to push them away, but they would be in the back of his head the rest of the time.

Midnight starts the timer, and Uraraka sends the four into the sky. This plan had to work for them to reach the finals. Izuku had people depending on him, and he was going to do his best to not let them down.

Izuku commanded and told them what to do, how to react, when to run and what way. They hadn’t given up on him yet. Izuku knew how to not break under pressure, but the simmering anxiety and negative feelings did not make his ability to react sharper. As expected, Todoroki blocked their team and Izuku’s team from the rest of them with a wall of ice.

“Stay on his left side.” Izuku said to his team, “It’ll slow his reaction time.”

“Got it!”

From then, everything happened so fast. Izuku had his headband stolen, and one of the headbands on Todoroki’s neck was taken. Iida showed a move no one had seen yet, and at the last second Bakugo’s team appeared out of nowhere. Once the whistle blew, signaling it was over, Izuku sighed and took a deep breath.

The one headband Izuku grabbed was too low of a score to put them on the leaderboard. He apologized over and over to his friends, blaming himself for the failure. He even began to cry before Tokoyami spoke up.

“Midoriya. I managed to steal this, it was hard to see the score.” He held up a headband that was worth more than six hundred points. Relief, and once again, tears came forth onto Izuku. He was going to the finals.

He wasn’t exactly happy when he found out who his opponent in the one on one tournament was. Hitoshi Shinso. The same person Cosmic had told him about. It wasn’t often Cosmic talked of other people, so he felt bad.

Ojiro warned Izuku about the properties of Shinso’s quirk, and Izuku listened to every word he said. He understood his quirk from when Cosmic talked about him, but Ojiro told him his own personal experience and he wanted anything that would help.

He thanked Ojiro for his help, and shortly after he went out to the middle of the stadium where the fight would take place. He stood where he was supposed to, and watched Shinso take his place. Izuku gulped. He didn’t want to lose, not yet.

Present Mic started the match with a few words, and Shinso began to talk just as Ojiro said he would.

“Tell me, what’s your quirk? I haven’t seen it in action yet.” Shinso’s hand remained in his pockets in a casual manner, as Izuku walked towards him. Izuku didn’t respond, knowing if he did he would be brainwashed.

“Not talking, huh? Did that classmate of yours tell you about my own quirk?”

Izuku took a breath, before starting a sprint towards Shinso.

“Your friend doesn’t seem as smart as you, he honestly was kind of an idiot for falling for it.”

Izuku tensed. His classmate Ojiro was half the reason he knew about Shinso’s quirk. It wasn’t fair for him to call Ojiro an idiot.

“Take it back!” Izuku’s mouth opened before he could tell himself not to, and his brain went empty.

Izuku knew he was brainwashed, but the feeling of absolute emptiness and nothingness in his brain gave him a little relief. But he wasn’t going to give up like this.

Izuku fought for control over his body, struggling as if it were a dream he couldn’t wake up from. Izuku regretted this, but he began to think about his mom. His mom and the man who murdered her. Anger welled inside his heart, and it skipped a bit. He thought harder, before he suddenly dropped to his knees and clutched his chest. Directly in front of him was the white line. *I broke free..and I’m not out!*

Izuku turned quickly and ran straight for Shinso, who looked panicked and shocked. He began to talk, clearly desperate to win a match.

Izuku grabbed Shinso’s arm when he used it to block a punch Izuku had begun to throw, which was a fakeout punch. He twisted it, and with a few swift movements he lifted him in the air and slammed on the ground, over his shoulder. Izuku won.

Izuku did his best to stay focused when it wasn't his match. He predicted a few outcomes, but his mind was filled with doubt. He had done so good, yet he kept telling himself he was horrible. A bad person, a failure. Those feelings kept him from paying much attention.

He hated that something like his mom had to be used to win something. He never genuinely talked about how he felt about his mom's death, but he blamed himself greatly. For the next couple of matches, Izuku was drowning in sorrow. He found himself close to tears. He walked away from his friends and approached Todoroki, who would be his next fight.

"Todoroki?" He asked softly.

"Midoriya. Is everything okay?"

"I won't..be able to do the match. But I wanted to speak with you." Izuku sighed. "I know you promised to never use your fire because it represents your father."

"What are you trying to say, Midoriya?"

"It's not his quirk. It's yours. Using your fire does not make you like him. Not using your full potential can hurt you in the future, and I know you'll be powerful. Your quirk, it's yours until the end of time. Show your father you're better than him and don't let him hold you back!" Izuku quickly walked away and into a bathroom that was close by. He shut and locked the door, leaning onto a sink.

Tears hit the white ceramic, and he slowly looked at himself in the mirror. His eyes were a strained red, and filled with tears. He wiped his eyes as he forced back sobs, and sat down in the corner of the bathroom. He let himself cry for the entirety of the remaining sports festival matches.

Izuku had never felt so helpless, and now he just wanted to get home.

Chapter End Notes

updates every wednesday and sunday! (also i adore when you guys comment it makes me so happy)

Chapter Fifteen

Chapter Summary

> Cosmic calms Izuku down from a panic attack. A special guest visits Class 1A, and after class Aizawa and Present Mic speak about adopting a certain purpled hair boy.

Chapter Notes

> i already know how cosmic's identity is going to be revealed and i'm so excited ^-^
>
> the start of this chapter is a panic attack, or something close to one! so please be careful when reading if it triggers you <3

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Cosmic knew something was wrong. He knew something was wrong the second Present Mic had announced that Izuku couldn't do the match so Todoroki was moved on without a fight. He rushed to Izuku's apartment after the sports festival was over. He had gotten held up on his way out.

Yes, Cosmic watched Izuku in person. As his true self, not his vigilante persona. He also couldn't make any suspicious movements so he ended up having to walk almost the entire way to Izuku's apartment.

He burst the door open, adrenaline pumping through his veins. He felt like something was off and he couldn't explain it.

He was right.

Izuku had collapsed in the hallway, sobbing violently. He was choking on his own tears, his hands trembling. Cosmic threw his mask off, and crouched next to Izuku.

“Zuku? Can you hear me?” Cosmic tried to keep his voice calm, but it was slightly shaky. He gently went to touch Izuku to comfort him, but then paused. “Hey, can I touch you?” Cosmic knew some people during panic attacks and crying fits that they’d rather be left alone.

Izuku didn’t respond, his crying only got worse. He slowly reached out his arms, asking for a hug silently. Cosmic immediately wrapped his arms around Izuku, and held him tight.

Cosmic just held Izuku tightly, letting the smaller boy sob into his arms. Cosmic felt bad, he knew Izuku had been acting slightly withdrawn recently and he should’ve reacted sooner.

Truth is, Cosmic wanted Izuku to find help. Izuku went through a lot of traumatic things. Cosmic was a teen, just like Izuku, so he wasn’t equipped to help. He wanted Izuku to have a loving family as well as a healthy living environment. Cosmic felt horrible knowing he wasn’t enough to help Izuku with all his existing problems, but he was going to try his best.

Cosmic cooked for Izuku often, and even brought groceries home for Izuku since his piece of shit dad neglected everything Izuku needed. Cosmic helped clean, and fix things around Izuku’s apartment. Cosmic didn’t want Izuku living there anymore, but he didn’t have much of a choice. His only option was to ask Present Mic who would try to put him in foster care, but he wasn’t going to put Izuku in that position.

For now, Cosmic’s worries were with the boy that was sobbing in his arms. He gently brushed Izuku’s hair back, as he whispered positive comments to Izuku.

“It’s okay, Zuku. Just breathe, okay? In..and out..” The way Cosmic spoke was soft, and comforting.

Izuku’s sobs quieted down over the next few minutes, and once the tears stopped he had fallen fast asleep. Cosmic picked him up gently, and laid him in his bed. He pulled the covers over Izuku, and brushed his hair out of his face.

“Please be okay,” Cosmic’s voice was barely audible, and it sounded as if he was about to cry himself. He left a note on the bedside table, and then left. He left Izuku to sleep the day away.

The next morning at school was dreadful. Izuku felt tired, beaten, broken and exhausted mentally. He sat in his seat with his head resting on his hand. He had visibly eyebags, which he didn't even attempt to cover. Bakugo turned around in his seat to look at Izuku, not saying anything to him. His silence and glance didn't alert Izuku, so he wasn't aware Bakugo was staring.

Bakugo was clearly worried for his childhood best friend, but he turned around and scoffed slightly. He twirled his pen in between his fingers.

Aizawa entered the room, no longer covered in any bandages. He sighed tiredly, standing at the podium.

"Mr. Aizawa, you're already healed?!" Hagakure asked.

"That's besides the point. Tomorrow all of your offers will come in for work studies. Before then, I have someone I'd like for you to meet." Aizawa mutters, motioning to the door. "Due to recent events, UA decided to have a support course student dedicated to each class before and after work studies to help create support items to fit your needs. During your work studies, you will be able to contact your class' support course student. On that note, everyone meet Riso Sakusei."

Riso slowly walked in, clutching onto his satchel tightly. He waved nervously, his hand shaking slightly.

"..Hi."

"Hi Riso!" Uraraka waved and smiled. Her smiled seemed to calm Riso's nerves.

"It's a pleasure to see you again." Iida nodded.

“Woah, you guys know him??” Kirishima asks. Izuku softly nodded.

“Yeah..I keep running into him..”

Riso gently bit his lip. “I watched all of the footage from the sports festival, and I have many ideas.”

“Riso also won the second year sports festival.” Aizawa said. “So talk, plan, do whatever. I’m going to sleep.”

“You won yours?! That’s so manly!”

“Are you that powerful?? You’re in the support course!” Denki asked, his eyes sparkling in amazement. He had stood up from his seat, indicating he was excited.

“Um, yes. It- Well it wasn’t a big deal..”

“Not a big deal?!” Mina asks, “That’s the sports festival!!”

“Hah. You think you’re better than me, pinky-pie?!” Bakugo growls and stands.

“Sit down.” Riso growled back. “I won’t tolerate being spoken to like that. I am better than you. I have more experience than you. The only thing I don’t have is a flashy quirk.” He walked closer, putting his hands on Bakugo’s desk.

“What the fuck did you just-”

“Watch your mouth. We’re the same age, but you having a flashy quirk does *not* scare me. Now sit down, and let me help you improve. Or so god help me, I will put an end to your

ego.”

The conversation couldn’t be heard by anyone else, as Riso made sure to whisper. Bakugo grunted and sat down, deciding that Riso wasn’t worth the fight. Their previous interaction also didn’t help him any.

Riso turned back to the class and smiled.

“Let’s get started, shall we?”

Riso talked with the class and helped them figure out where they wanted to be with their quirks and potential gadgets that would improve their quirk.

“So, you’re a second year?” Kirishima asked, looking over the sketch of his hero costume.

“Yes.”

“But you’re our age?” Denki leaned onto Kirishima’s desk.

“Yes.”

“So why are you above?” Denki asked, pouting slightly. “Is it wrong if I flirt with you?”

“Please don’t flirt with me, and I was moved up a grade before UA.”

“Why aren’t you in the hero course?” Denki asked another question.

“It’s not for me. Anyway, Kirishima-”

“Butttt what’s it’s like as a support course student?”

“Kamiari, please.” Riso asks. “I’m trying to help Kirishima,”

“But you’re cute!”

“Kamiari!” Izuku whines. “Please leave him alone, he’s trying to work. He’s easily distracted.”

“Cool! We have something in common.” Denki smiled. Riso blinked, shaking his head.

“I’m sorry, Kamiari. You’re..not really my type..”

“Am I not anyone's type??” Denki whined, resting his head on his desk.

“It’s okay, Denks!” Kirishima says. “Someone will be into you, you just gotta give it time!”

Finally, Riso made it to Izuku. He pulled a chair next to Izuku’s desk and smiled at him.

“Hi, Midoriya.”

“Hey, Riso. I know I probably don’t have much to go on..”

“You fight with a staff, right?”

Izuku went silent. He gulped, and nervously tapped his pen. “How do you know that?”

“Well, it's pretty obvious you’re Nexus. Remember what I said about my IQ? You weren’t hard to figure out.” Riso said in a hushed voice. “Besides, I think a staff specifically made for your hero work would be beneficial. Don’t want to carry around a staff Cosmic made, yeah?”

Izuku stared curiously.

“Why do you cover your eyes?” Izuku blurted out, and a hand clamped over his mouth. “I’m sorry, that was so rude-!”

It was Riso’s time to go silent. He sat back in his chair, tapping the back of his pen on his sketchbook. He bit his lip nervously and took a shallow breath.

“My parents. Uh..Nevermind, I don’t want to bore you.”

“No! Please, tell me. You..You can talk to me.” Izuku nods. He was beyond curious to know about Riso. He never spoke about his parents.

“Well..When I came out, my mother told me she never wished to see my face again. Then she stabbed me in the face with a knife. So, I don’t show my face because I don’t think anyone wants to see it. It’s an ugly scar, and I’d rather just not show anyone.”

“Riso..”

“It’s fine. Okay? Let’s talk about this staff.”

Aizawa couldn’t be more relieved when the class was finally over. His hellspawn of a class and Riso in the same room was *never* a good thing. He was the unlucky one and got stuck

with Riso as the class' support course student helper. He figured Nezu was up to something, so he had bit the bullet and dealt with it.

He had a choice to make, in the staff room. He was reviewing Shinso's foster file, and he didn't mind doing it in front of everyone else. He could care less, honestly.

"So?" Hizashi sat down at the desk in front of Aizawa's. "How does the file look?"

"Depressing. Really depressing. Why hasn't he been taken from this person's care?"

"Cosmic told me he doesn't want to leave. Otherwise, he'd lose his spot at UA."

"This is beyond abuse."

"I know, Sho." Hizashi sighs. "I think we need to foster him. Let the little listener know we're here for him."

"I think you're right." Aizawa admitted. "I'll start the paperwork."

"Oo, to what?" Riso asked, walking in with a stack of files. "Oh! These are for Snipe," He sat them down on Snipe's desk.

Aizawa groaned softly, putting a hand to his forehead. One thing he hated was the fact that Nezu told Riso he was allowed to interact with the teachers as much as he liked. Aizawa knew Riso was Nezu's personal favorite, and he also knew how dangerous Riso was if he was left unoccupied.

The last person who tried to break him out from an episode, broke three ribs. Aizawa also knew it was expected when Riso's apartment was through the staff area.

Yes. Riso lived at UA. Aizawa hated it. Riso was out of a house, doing amazing support work. Aizawa could care less about the specifics, but he knew Riso living at UA helped him. Gave him opportunities, kept him from trouble, but most importantly it kept him busy.

“Sho and I are gonna foster someone.” Hizashi says, smiling at Riso. “Have you seen Hitoshi Shinso?”

“The purple hair boy I've been dying to talk to about a support item? Yes.” Riso smiles, “Is he the one you're fostering?”

“…Shinso isn’t in the hero course.” Aizawa says.

“I know. I make support items for everyone. But back to fostering?”

“Mhm, he’s in a really bad household right now.” Hizashi nods. “That’s all we can legally say.”

“I think it's nice you’re gonna help him!” Riso sat at Midnight's desk. “Does he know?”

“Not yet.”

“…Well, speaking of him. I had a thought,” Riso opened his sketchbook. “Aizawa, you should train him.”

“Why would I do that.” Aizawa asks, sipping his coffee.

“He reminds me of you. At the sports festival, he lacked the ability to do one-on-one combat. I think he’d be a great hero like you are! He just needs help.”

“…He has a point, Sho.”

“We can also get rid of Mineta.” Riso mutters. “Kid freaks me out.”

“I will admit, Mineta is an interesting…person.” Aizawa mutters.

“C’mon! If you’re gonna foster him, might as well train him too! He’s got real potential.” Riso says, twirling a pen he picked up in his hand.

“You’re too demanding for your own good.” Aizawa sighs, “I’m not training him. I’m not taking on another kid.”

“You should, Sho! I agree with Riso, he did amazing in the sports festival!”

“Fuck off, Hizashi.”

Riso smiles. He took pride in helping others get their dreams. He felt a pair of hands touch his shoulders.

“Hey, pinky.” Midnight teases. “Talking with my friends, are you?”

“Hi Midnight! Aizawa and Present Mic are gonna foster a kid, and Aizawa’s gonna train him.”

“Oh really?”

“That’s not true, Nemuri. He’s just being..him.” Aizawa huffed. “Go to your apartment.”

“But why would I? I just love you guys soooo much.” Riso fake pouted.

“C’mon, Riso. Let’s go to your apartment.” Midnight said with a slight chuckle. “We can talk about any cute boys you’ve seen.”

As Riso and Midnight walked away, Aizawa thought real hard about what Riso said.

He’s right. Shinso has the potential to be a hero. Better than Mineta. I’ll talk with Nezu tomorrow morning.

Chapter End Notes

updates every wednesday and sunday! <3

Chapter Sixteen

Chapter Summary

Izuku has a break down with an surprising helper + the stain arc!

Chapter Notes

i will not lie to you — i hated writing stain's arc so i rushed past it as fast as i could without it being too broken up. hope you enjoy! <3

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Izuku saw a repeating pattern. Having a horrible night, and struggling the next day at school. He hoped his classmates hadn't noticed the repetitive schedule of emotions Izuku was on. Izuku felt exhausted, even after he slept all night. He found it unusual that Cosmic wouldn't let him out on patrol, so maybe Cosmic had noticed. He tiredly looked at the empty chalkboard at the front of the room. He sighed, leaning his head on his hand. Bakugo suddenly turned around.

"Why the fuck are you sighing so loud?" He growled, but under the angry tone he seemed concerned. He stared at Izuku with a glare, but Bakugo couldn't hide the softness in his eyes for him. Of course, Izuku couldn't see it. Everyone else could.

"Oh, I..I'm sorry Kacchan." Izuku said with a slight pout. "I'm just..I'm really tired, I'm sorry for bothering you." He stammered over his words slightly.

"Then get more fucking sleep, you damn nerd!" Bakugo flicked his forehead, then turned back to his desk.

Aizawa walked in, looking at his class with the same dead stare as always.

“Today you’ll be doing something that’ll determine the rest of your hero life.” Aizawa leaned on the podium slightly, feeling his eyes threatening to close. The class visibly tensed and held their breath. “You’re all deciding your hero names. Midnight’s here to help.” The class erupted in cheers.

Izuku took a breath, feeling at ease that today was going to be an easy day for everyone. Unfortunately for Izuku, he fell asleep as soon as he passed the boards on. He had a dream.

The room was dark, a single lightbulb lighting up a chair. Izuku inched towards it cautiously, gently running his hand along the back when he got to the chair. He felt a pair of hands grab his body and sling him into the chair, tying him to it. Izuku tried to wiggle out, and he even tried to scream. His throat felt closed as no sound came out. His mother and a tall shadow figure stood in front of him

“No boy of mine will be quirkless, Inko! Give me that lighter.” A familiar voice growled, a slight echo attached with his growl.

“No! Hisahi, please think about this..! That’s our son..!” Inko pleaded, but she was physically thrown to the side. Tears welled inside of Izuku’s eyes when he heard his mom’s voice. Hisahi took the lighter and held it to Izuku’s arm. Although it was a dream, Izuku remembered how it felt. He tried to scream again, but nothing came out. He started to kick, cry, and the chair fell back against the floor with him attached to it. Izuku tensed from the fall, before letting his head rest against the back of the chair and on the ground. He gasped for breath when a rag found its way over his face.

***No, no, no, no!** Izuku’s thoughts ran wild, as he tried to kick out again. Finally, his voice seemed to work.*

“Mom!”

His call for help was only met by Inko’s sobbing. Izuku struggled to breathe when the water was poured over the rag. He couldn’t feel his tears against the mass amounts of water that was running along his face. Once the torture was over, he felt a hand on shoulder. He shook him violently.

“Get up.” Hisahi growls. “Get up, Deku!”

Izuku jolted awake, grabbing the hand of the person grabbing him. He squeezed hard, feeling a crack or two from their knuckles. Izuku tensed again when he saw it was Bakugo. He stood abruptly, raising his hand, and hiding his tears with his other hand.

“Midnight, may I use the bathroom?” His voice was shaking, and his legs felt like jello. Midnight told him he could, while paying attention to the classmates giving hero names. Izuku quickly ran out, and found himself in the bathrooms. He ran into a stall, and sat on the ground. He wiped his tears violently, softly telling himself to get over it.

At least dad finally got what he wanted from me. Izuku thought bitterly, more tears spilling from his eyes. He held his knees close to his chest, and he ran his hands through his hair. He began to feel frustrated at himself for crying over something so little, and he started pulling at his hair.

“Stupid, stupid, stupid..!” Izuku mutters. He let his right hand loose from his hair, and he used the bottom of his hand and the beginning of his wrist to hit himself on the head as ‘punishment’. He held his breath when he heard the bathroom door open. He just had to keep the stall door shut, and that was it.

“Deku.” Bakugo’s voice wasn’t angry. “Where are you?” He sounded concerned, and worried. His voice alone made Izuku cry again. Bakugo walked down the line of stalls, and stopped at the one Izuku was in. He opened the door slowly, looking down at the crying boy. He sighed and grumbled to himself. “Nightmare?”

“I-I’m so sorry, Kacchan!” Izuku sobbed out to him, “You..You’re always dealing with me..!” Bakugo almost couldn't understand him, but he sat on the ground next to Izuku.

“Shut up. I’m being nice because I know you’ve been through shit. Don’t think anything of this.” Bakugo growled. “My mom told me alot. Is your dad hurting you again?”

Izuku bit his lip, looking away from Bakugo. “No. He’s not.”

“Then why are you being a crybaby? You stopped having those nightmares a while ago.”

“I don’t know. I don’t want to talk about it.”

“Too damn bad, Deku. Is it because Auntie is gone?”

“I said-”

“I don’t give a *shit* what you said, Deku. I’m helping you, you idiot. So either tell me, or fucking suffer alone.”

So that’s what Izuku did. He told his Kacchan everything that had happened to him, minus the vigilante parts. He explained he was living alone, with no one. His dad didn’t supply any money for him to live, he’s been tired for no reason. Bakugo knew he had been horrible to Izuku, but he also had never felt worse for Izuku. This was rock bottom, and he wasn’t going to let Izuku deal with these things alone.

“...Why haven’t you told anyone, idiot?? You’re a teenager, you can’t take care of yourself like that!” Bakugo growled. “How are you supposed to get good enough for us to fight if you don’t have a healthy environment?!”

“Sorry, Kacchan..”

“I’m going to talk to my mom. See if you could stay or something. You fucking Deku, thinking you can do all that by yourself.”

Once the two of them find their way out of the bathroom, Bakugo immediately turns sour towards Izuku again. He didn’t want to give the impression that he *actually* cared. The pep talk Bakugo had given Izuku gave him enough confidence to tell the class his hero name. Deku.

The next couple of days were easier for Izuku. He managed to get more sleep, and he felt better in the mornings. It did suck though, he hadn't seen Cosmic since the day Bakugo helped him in the bathroom. That slight sorrow was easily replaced by slight happiness when his teacher had offered for him to intern at his own agency. In his words,

"It's more the agency Present Mic is from, but no one else wanted to take you."

Sure, it hurt Izuku knowing that no one wanted him. He fought quirkless. So when Aizawa, one of the best Pro-Heros who fights quirkless, offered he had to agree. Not that he had much choice, but Izuku still felt privileged.

He was told by Aizawa they were going to Hosu to keep an eye on Iida, since Aizawa figured something was bothering him. Izuku gladly joined him, and was surprised when he saw a familiar face on the train.

"Riso?" Izuku asked.

"Oh! Hi, Midoriya!" Riso smiled, putting his sketchbook down. "You're the kid Aizawa took on?"

"I guess I am," Izuku sat next to him, "Why are you here?"

"Aizawa said I can't be trusted alone."

"Because you can't." Aizawa grumbled, sitting across the two. "Present Mic couldn't watch him, Midnight couldn't either. And he hates All Might."

Riso huffs, twirling his pen. "It's not my fault he's a shitty-"

“Language.”

“…crappy person.” Riso rolls his eyes. “I hate him! He’s so rude, and cocky- He thinks everyone is-”

“Please stop talking.” Aizawa sighs tiredly. “I’m going to sleep on the way there, you two keep quiet.”

“Yes sir!” Izuku nods. Aizawa fell asleep almost instantly. Riso opened his sketchbook again and started sketching. The ride was silent, paired with Riso’s occasional humming. Izuku glanced over at Riso’s sketchbook. A mask was drawn out in one corner, and the rest of the page was little notes and the blueprints for it.

“What are you sketching?”

The slight hum from the train seemed to be enough to make the silence not awkward.

“A mask.” Riso muttered. He visibly held back explaining.

“Can you explain it?”

Riso’s eyes lit up. He held his sketchbook in front of Izuku. “So, this right here-” He started explaining in detail about what it does. Izuku smiled softly, watching as his new-found friend lit up with joy. It was quite clear that not a lot of people let him explain, or shunned him for being annoying.

Izuku learned that the mask was meant for Shinso, the boy he fought against in the sports festival. It was supposed to mask his voice and project it as someone else’s with the right frequency changes. It was incredible how easily this idea came to Riso based on what he told Izuku, and the explanation came out like it was lines he memorized for a show.

Izuku listened closely to everything Riso said, and the two of them fell down a spiral of talking about support items for everyone in his class. They were enjoying themselves, trying to be quiet as Aizawa was still asleep next to them. Though, he was woken up anyway.

An explosion erupted a few feet away from their seats, shaking and causing the train to halt to a stop. Aizawa was on his feet before Riso and Izuku even registered what happened.

“Stay there!” Aizawa ran down the aisle and disappeared. The two looked at each other, before scrambling to their feet.

“Go! I’ll help the passengers!” Riso said, helping up a bystander that was hit by debris. Izuku nodded, and jumped out of the train, landing on a rooftop. He flipped out the staff and used it to boost himself up onto the rooftops. He felt his eyes widen when he saw the nomu, who were flying around and screaming. He noticed Manual, who wasn’t accompanied by his classmate. Izuku ran over to him along the rooftops and jumped off, rolling to soften the landing.

“Manual! Where’s Iida?!” Izuku asked frantically.

“I don’t know! I told him to call for help a while ago!” Manual grunted, slinging water at the nomu’s.

No..Iida couldn’t have gone after Stain..could he?

Izuku ran off into the alleyways, looking for any sign of Iida. He heard talking.

“You killed my brother! So I’ll kill you!”

Izuku dashed into the alleyway. He saw Stain striking down on Iida, so he threw his staff forward. It hit Stain in his chest, second impact knocking him back just enough to save Iida. Iida was stuck on the floor, unable to move. Izuku jumped in front of Iida, but instead of addressing Stain he started taking to his friend.

“Iida! This isn’t like you, at all! You’re a hero, not someone fueled by revenge!” Izuku called out to him. “This isn’t the way to avenge your brother!”

Stain stared at Izuku with a scowl.

“You wannabe heros…” He muttered. “You’re the closest to a hero I’ve seen.” His voice sounded like how Izuku imagined acid felt.

“You’re still killing people!” Izuku caught a glimpse of the hero Native, who also seemed unable to move. He held his breath and used his free hand to send his location to his contacts.

Everything moved fast. Izuku tried to fight and dodge everything he could, but got cut and felt his body tense. He fell to the ground, paralyzed from something. He quickly realized it was Stain’s quirk. He felt relief wash over him when a flash of fire came down the alleyway.

“You need to be more specific with your messages, Midoriya.”

“Todoroki!” Izuku called out. “Don’t let him taste your blood!”

Stain was pinned to the ground suddenly by someone dropping down.

“Piece of shit! Attacking kids and for what?!” Cosmic’s voice echoed in the alleyway.

“Cosmic,” Stain said. “Finally, a fucking worthy opponent.”

“Freeze him!” Cosmic yelled out to Todoroki.

Todoroki and Cosmic worked together to freeze and hold Stain in place, but somehow Stain had gotten a lick of Cosmic's blood. He fell to the ground, his body unable to move. When he fell, he hit his head against the wall. He was knocked out cold.

He woke up to Izuku shaking him, pleading for him to wake up.

"Cosmic! Cosmic, wake up!"

Cosmic forced himself up, ignoring the sluggish feeling running through his body. He looked at Izuku, then jumped to his feet, ready to attack and defend.

"Calm down..! We captured him..!" Izuku grabbed Cosmic's arm. "It's okay, you can relax."

"..Shit. Did I hit my head that hard..?"

"Yeah..Look, the Pros are-"

Izuku was caught off guard by a Pro-Hero announcing they were called for backup, and he glanced over. He panicked, and turned to tell Cosmic to run. But, Cosmic was already gone. Izuku was helped over by Native, and he was staring at Stain while they talked.

"I thought I told you to stay on that train." Aizawa growled, walking over to Izuku. Izuku yelped and immediately began to apologize.

It was short-lived when a nomu suddenly snatched Izuku off his feet. He screamed out, feeling his body be paralyzed once again but by fear.

Stain came to his feet, and ran after the flying Nomu. He licked the blood off of a Pro's cheek, and cut himself loose from the rope. He jumped in the air and brought the nomu down with a stab to the head.

Izuku heard Stain talk, giving a grand speech about a society with no true heros. He tried to listen as Stain explained what a true hero should be. He suddenly froze up, and stopped moving. Izuku heard calls for him before he promptly fell unconscious, his ears ringing and body aching from the trauma it had sustained in the past half hour.

The last thing he heard was Aizawa calling for him, and a pair of hands pulling him off the ground and into a warm, and what Izuku would consider a loving, embrace.

Chapter End Notes

cosmic identity reveal very soon >:3
updates every wednesday and sunday!

Chapter Seventeen

Chapter Summary

The aftermath of the Stain attack!

Chapter Notes

WOO WOO!! surprise chapter ;) have this angst!! dw there will still be an update on wednesday, i just didn't think this fit for the next chapter :)

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Cosmic's lungs burned, each new breath feeling like cold fire rushing down. He held his side in pain and felt the blood gush from the open wound. He sat himself on the rooftop, leaning against an AC unit. He scrunched his face in pain as he looked up at the night sky. Smoke and a light orange glow from the chaos below covered the beauty in the stars. He laughed to himself softly, coughing slightly.

"Shit," He muttered to himself. He felt sweat beads and blood trickle down the side of his face. He hadn't remembered getting stabbed in the side, but the busted head he *did* remember. Cosmic pulled his mask from his face, throwing it down onto the rough texture of the roof.

That motherfucker really got me. Cosmic thought to himself, using his free hand to loosen his utility belt. He shook the contents free and he grabbed a needle with a long piece of fishing string. He blew off the dust, snickering to himself softly. *Aizawa did say ten pound fishing string worked best. God, he'd kick my fucking ass right now if he could.*

Cosmic put the belt in his mouth, feeling his teeth grind against the rough texture. He pulled his shirt up, exposing the wound to the cool night air. He bit down on the belt when he winced in pain. He took a breath through his nose and let out a grunt when the needle pierced his skin.

I bet some Tyenol would help about now. I wonder what drug stores are open at this hour?

Cosmic felt tears slip from his eyes the longer he sewed the wound, his hand shaking violently as if it were begging to be doing anything else. He let his body relax against the AC unit when he tied off the last stitch. *Fuck, it burns so bad.* Cosmic thought, his eyes trained on the stars once again. The smoke had cleared a bit, and Cosmic could finally see the night sky he watched every night he struggled to sleep.

Cosmic pulled his hood down, letting his hair fall down. He pressed a hand to the back of his head, which was covered in blood. He whined softly.

"Are you kidding me? This is going to be a bitch to clean." Cosmic said aloud in disbelief. He put his hood back up, and glanced at the stars again. He stopped for a moment, letting tears come to his eyes again. He violently wiped his tears, smiling up at the sky.

If my shitty parents could see what their baby boy turned out to be. Anything's better than a gay son, right? Cosmic thought bitterly.

At the hospital the next day, Izuku felt his anxiety rise. He had sat through Todoroki standing up for himself, Iida apologizing, hearing that Endeavor was going to take credit for taking Stain down. There was one thing on his mind. He hadn't heard from Cosmic, Aizawa, or Riso. He knew Aizawa was okay, but Riso was on the bullet train and from his knowledge, hadn't been admitted to the hospital or came to see Izuku. He knows he's not that close to Riso, but the boy still would've come to check up on him. He knew that much.

Cosmic was what made him worry the most. He was covered in blood before he vanished, the blood was visible even against the black he wore. Izuku's worries were muffled when Aizawa walked in, and he sat up.

"Midoriya," Aizawa addressed him, sitting next to his bed. "Have you heard from Riso?"

"No sir," Izuku felt his voice quiver. Aizawa's eyes held a sorrowful sight, and he bowed his head a little in defeat.

“He’s missing.”

Those words shattered Izuku, and the other two boys who were listening in on the conversation.

“What?” Iida interrupted, “What do you mean he’s missing?”

“Witnesses said he disappeared off the train. A..woman even said she saw a nomu take a boy with pink hair.” Aizawa sucked in his breath. “If they can’t find him in the next few days, they’re going to assume he’s dead.”

“But Riso was supposed to help us be better heros.” Todoroki’s voice caught Aizawa off guard, not expecting the non-sociable boy to have an attachment to Riso.

“I know. I’m going to help search. If any of you hear from him, you contact us immediately.”

The next couple of days were hard for Izuku. No word from Cosmic still, or Riso. He feared the worst for the two of them. He heard the search for Riso was to be called off after tonight, and he would be presumed dead. Izuku ended up crumbling in Mitsuki’s arms when she and Masaru came to visit him. He cried to her silently, trying to explain his worry for his friend.

Riso was his age. Izuku felt his heart ache knowing a boy his age could be dead. He never should’ve left that train. He never should’ve left Riso alone.

In the field, Aizawa got flashbacks of Oboro. He hated that he could have potentially lost another young soul that would be gone and even forgotten. He saw the other Pro-Heros lose faith and passion in the search, slowly leaving the search one by one. He wasn’t going to give up on Riso. Not like everyone had always done to him. He just hoped he found him alive.

Aizawa and a few other Pros went to move a large piece of debris, and his heart dropped. From the side, a strand of bright pink hair stuck out. He ran over quickly, shoving the rocks that were extremely loose (or was that the adrenaline?) off his body.

“Hey, I found him!” Aizawa called, moving the rocks frantically. He gently wrapped his arms around the boy. His school uniform was ripped, cut, and the shoulders were covered in blood that had dropped from his head. The back of his head was drenched in blood, and Aizawa called out again. There was one worry that ran through Aizawa’s mind.

He couldn’t tell if he was breathing or not.

Chapter End Notes

hope you enjoyed! ;)

Chapter Eighteen

Chapter Summary

Cosmic's struggles finally are put on display.

Chapter Notes

PLEASE READ : this chapter confirms the use of the f slur used against the queer community (i'm gay and trans). if you'd like to skip the section it's used in, i've added a "*" at the beginning and end of the section. if it makes you uncomfortable, please skip that entire section. thank you! there are also heavy mentions of abuse in said section !!

DONT FORGET TO READ CHAPTER 17! i posted it monday morning as a surprise, so make sure you read it if you didn't :)

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Coming back from work studies was eventful for Izuku. Stepping into the classroom, he already knew that his classmates were staring at him and wanting to ask questions.

"Deku!" Uraraka called, hurrying over. She pulled him into a hug. "I'm so glad you're okay! I talked with Iida and Todoroki, I was worried you weren't going to show up today!" She pulled from the hug once he hugged back.

"I'm okay, Uraraka..A little tired but okay."

"I heard about Riso," Uraraka said quietly. "Please don't blame yourself."

"I don't want to talk about it." Izuku shook his head. He let a yelp escape his lips when he saw Bakugo standing in front of him.

“Four-eyes and icy hot told me scar-face was there.” Bakugo said. “Where the fuck was he when you were fighting, Deku?!”

“I..I don’t-”

“You’re not that strong yet, damn idiot! You could’ve fucking died. And then what?! Who am I supposed to fight then?! I can’t fight you if you’re fucking DEAD, Deku!”

“I’m sorry, Kacchan…He got hurt. You can’t blame him for that.”

“I thought you two were fucking friends. Friends just don’t pass out when the other is in danger!”

“What do *you* know about friends, Kacchan?” Izuku asked, feeling tears well in his eyes. He didn’t feel like arguing with Bakugo right now, he sat down at his desk. He rested his head against the table, sighing softly. His phone buzzed, which he pulled out from his pocket. It was from Cosmic!

I lived, bitch :p

Along with the text was a picture of Cosmic holding a peace sign, and showing off the wound and stitches he gave himself. Izuku was quick to reply.

Cosmic?? Are you okay?? You completely just disappeared the other night!

I know, sorry for totally disappearing. been trying to heal up over the past few days, stain really fucked me over :/

Is your head okay? I know you hit it pretty hard..

yeah, still got a splitting headache though. you're at school, right?

of course i am, i couldn't stay at the hospital forever

god i wish i could've had a hospital

i'm really worried for you

don't be! see you later tonight?

you're not doing any patrol until i get that wound looked at. recovery girl should be able to heal it

like she's gonna help me?

she would! she cares about everyone :(

okay, sure zuku. see you later!

Izuku set his phone down. He felt better knowing Cosmic was okay. He turned his attention to Aizawa, listening to the lesson. He found out final exams were soon, meaning he had to prepare for the written part and the physical part. He wasn't ready for that.

That afternoon, Izuku tried to contact Cosmic again to see if he wanted to meet.

Can we meet up? i'm worried about you.

seen 8:37pm

On the other side of the screen, Cosmic stared at the dim light that was being displayed from his phone. A tear dropped onto the screen, and Cosmic grumbled to himself in anger. *Stupid fucking tearducts.* He thought to himself. He pocketed the phone, and swung his legs back and forth. He sat on top of an apartment building, just above where he first met Izuku. He glanced up at the stars again, letting his back fall against the rooftop.

He always found the stars beautiful. As a kid he would read books about them, or about space in general. He smiled at the thought of his vigilante name. It was pure coincidence that the people of Japan named him Cosmic, but he had always imagined it was the universe's way of saying he was doing the right thing.

"I should've figured you'd be okay." A gruff voice startled Cosmic, who jumped up and threw a rock at the owner of the voice.

"Holy *shit* ! Don't scare me like that, Eraser." Cosmic huffed, sitting back down. "Almost made me pop a stitch."

"When are you going to be honest with me, problem child?" Aizawa asked, sitting next to him.

"I don't know what you mean."

"About why you're doing this. Why you're so damn stubborn you'd rather give yourself painful stitches than go to a hospital."

"You wouldn't get it, old man. Just like you don't get how to shower-" Cosmic quips, snickering at Aizawa. He received a slap to the back of the head, which Aizawa noticed he winched more than he usually would've.

"What makes being an anonymous vigilante mean this much?" Aizawa pressed again.

“When being unnoticed is what you’re noticed for, you take it to the next fucking level. Why have my identity even known by the hospitals? They don’t care. *You* don’t care. Nobody ever has. When you're different, that’s how it is. That won’t change.” Cosmic responded bitterly, looking off to the side. “Can we skip the whole trying to capture me thing? Got a pretty bad wound.”

Aizawa didn’t respond. He simply got up, gave one last look at Cosmic, before disappearing. Cosmic sighed out of relief. He looked at his phone, which had more worried and concerned messages from Izuku.

God I need a fucking coffee.

Cosmic slowly stood, before gently dropping his way down to the floor. He knew a place that was open. As he was walking, he shoved his hands into his pockets, kept his head down and eyes trained on the ground. When the noise around him became too overwhelming, he slipped on a pair of headphones. He hummed along to the classical music playing in his ears. He opened the door to the coffee shop, and walked to the counter.

He ordered a coffee before taking it to a certain section of the shop. He smiled when he felt purring against his leg. Yes, he had gone to a cat cafe. He sat his lidded cup down, and picked the cat up.

“Who’s a good kitty?” Cosmic asked softly, scratching behind its ear.

“…Cosmic?”

Cosmic turned around, looking up at who called his name. He blinked.

“Shinso, yeah? You come here?” Cosmic asked, standing up after letting the cat walk off his lap.

“I like cats. And coffee.” Shinso pressed his lips together as if the information was obvious. It was.

“…How’s your foster home going?”

“Foster parents told me someone else is planning to foster me. That’s all I know.” Shinso sat on the ground, Cosmic copying his movements.

“Did a new home open up?” Cosmic fought the urge to smile, even if it was covered by the mask. He was going to get Shinso out of that home, and he was pretty successful so far.

“I guess.” Shinso looked at Cosmic. “I don’t normally talk about personal things, but are you some kind of luck charm? Like is that your quirk.”

“Why do you say that?”

“After I met you, a new foster home opened up. One of the hero course teachers at UA is going to start training me so I can transfer into the hero course. And I actually got at least four hours of sleep the day after I met you.”

Cosmic blinked before smiling. “Guess I am pretty lucky, huh?” Cosmic looked down at the cat on his lap. He felt a sudden pain hit his heart, and he frowned slightly. He hated that he felt so comfortable with Shinso after only meeting him for the second time. He knew not to get his hopes up, Izuku was the only person who was remotely nice to him.

“Hey,” Shinso started. “What’s wrong?”

Cosmic paused, chuckling nervously. He looked over at Shinso. “..What- Uh, what are you talking about?”

“You’re upset.”

“No I’m not.”

“You’re bad at hiding it.”

“I’m not upset.”

“You’re clearly upset.”

“You’ve got no proof of that accusation.”

“Your eyes are dull.”

Cosmic went silent. He looked at the cat in his lap, gently petting its back. He was confused. How could Shinso see that? He was so good at masking his feelings, and for Shinso who he’d only met twice, it took a few moments to see through him. Unintentional to Cosmic, tears welled in his eyes. He looked away from Shinso and the cat.

“I don’t know what you mean.” Cosmic said quietly, his voice quivering.

“I’ll ask again,” Shinso said, his eyes trained on the kitten in front of him. “What’s wrong?”

“It shouldn’t be your problem. It’s my burden to carry.”

“You’re very hypocritical. You want me to be happy, safe and away from my foster parents. I don’t even know you that well, yet you care so much. Why can’t someone do that for you? What are you so afraid of?”

“I’m not *worthy* of that kind of love.” Cosmic’s mouth moved before his brain could tell it not to. He huffed softly, feeling a tear run down his face. *Didn’t mean to say that.* He thought to himself.

“Told you that you were upset.” Shinso smiled in victory.

“Shut up. I’m the savior. It’s my job to protect others, and help them.” Cosmic said, though Shinso wasn’t sure who Cosmic was trying to convince. Himself, or Shinso.

“You’re a person. Why can’t you have that same treatment? It’s not fair.”

“Life isn’t fair. Never has been, never will be.” Cosmic muttered. “I’m not upset, and I don’t want to talk about it.”

“I bet you feel alone.” Shinso started, glancing at Cosmic. “Like there’s no one you can turn to, or count on. Thriving on the ability to do whatever, but once the day is over you go home to nothing and nobody.”

“Stop it.” Cosmic warned. “I’m telling you, don’t get involved in my personal issues.”

“It gets tiring, doesn’t it? Being that person who saves everyone. Do you even get a break? A moment to be around people you love? Do you even have that?” Shinso felt bad for saying these things in such a harsh way, but he figured Cosmic needed comfort right now. Ever since he ran into Cosmic the first time, he’s been following a blog about his sightings and where he’s been. He was in Hosu, and the picture of Cosmic was devastating.

Cosmic had been covered in blood, and in the photo he was clearly holding his side and limping. Not a single person to lean on to help him walk, or someone to reassure he was going to be okay. Just Cosmic, a dull background, and pure emotional pain was all that picture held.

To Shinso's surprise, Cosmic was quiet. He leaned forward and tried to see his face, looking for any sort of reaction. It pained him to see that Cosmic now had tears streaming down his face. He never would've known he was crying if he hadn't looked at his face, and that worried him.

"No. I don't have that." Cosmic said softly. His voice was shaky, and he was trying to force it not to be. "I haven't had that in a long time."

"Then talk to me." Shinso told him. "I normally don't give a shit about other people. You saved me in a time of need, so it's only fair."

"No. I'm not burdening you."

"You can't be alone forever. You're just going to hurt others if you keep pushing everyone away."

Cosmic gently ran a thumb over his scarred eye. The memories of home hit him, and it only made his heart ache worse. Why couldn't he just talk? His heart was screaming at him to talk, but his mind denied it that luxury. Why was caring for himself so hard?

"I should go."

"Can't run from your feelings for long." Shinso said. "Think about it."

Cosmic got up and left, leaving his coffee behind. He just started walking to clear his head, his headphones drowning out any sounds from the outside. He dissociated most of his walk, consumed in his thoughts.

*

“You’re fucking pathetic!” His dad screamed at him, pointing at his face. Cosmic stood his ground, not flinching at the sudden movements. His body was stiff. “You brought a man into this house, with the intention of romantically loving him?! Are you trying to give us all fucking AIDS, faggot!?”

“No, dad.”

“Don’t call me that! I’m not your fucking father anymore. You’re stressing out your mother! She’s pregnant, that could fucking kill her! Whether the baby is a girl or boy, it’ll be a fucking improvement from you!” His dad raised his hand, and struck his face hard. A red whelp was left on Cosmic’s face, and the coolness of his tears soothed the pain ever so slightly.

“I’m sorry.” Were the only words that could come from Cosmic’s mouth.

The memory cuts, and restarts a few minutes after that interaction.

“..Mom? What are you doing..?” Cosmic asked quietly, backing into the wall.

“I never should've had you. I never want to see you again!” With a swift moment, she brought the knife from her back. She held it high before lunging towards her defenseless son.

The knife pierced his skin. She let the handle go, listening to her son, no, a ***stranger*** *, scream in agony.*

She wouldn’t let that disgusting boy have her eye color. So she stabbed him in the eye.

*

Cosmic snapped out of his thoughts when he realized he was standing in front of an apartment door. His hand had already made contact with the door. He blinked hard, looking

around slightly confused. He walked to the edge of the railing and looked over. The moon lit up the familiar streets.

Shit. Did I walk here? He thought.

The door behind him opened, and he looked over at the noise. A flash of green hair darted forward and wrapped him in a hug before he could even make a sound. Cosmic tensed, but slowly wrapped his arms around Izuku. He heard Izuku cry out about how worried he was when he never responded to his text. There was one thing on Cosmic's mind for the duration of the hug.

Is this what it felt like to be loved?

Chapter End Notes

i uploaded this at like 12:15am, i am kinda excited because cosmic's identity is gonna be revealed soon :D i've already got plans!! also i've been craving angst so..sorry :/

oh, and a big hint to cosmic's identity lies in this chapter ;)

updates every wednesday and sunday!

Chapter Nineteen

Chapter Summary

> Izuku and Bakugo take on the final exams head on, and Bakugo learns his idol isn't the best person.

Chapter Notes

> i will say this: for future reference, i don't usually have time to edit my chapters! i'm also dyslexic so please excuse any misspellings and what not <3

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Izuku was grateful that Cosmic's showed up on his doorstep. He knew his friend was struggling the moment he saw him standing outside his door. He never managed to get him to speak about what was bothering him, but it was clear being near Izuku helped him. Cosmic asked him if he wanted to do any training, changing the subject.

Unfortunately, Izuku didn't see that it was to distract him from asking what was wrong anymore. Cosmic enjoyed training with Izuku anyway, it was much more fun than talking about his feelings. Izuku mentioned the final exams coming up, and Cosmic took the opportunity to mention he would train Izuku for them.

Of course, Izuku regretted asking for training because Cosmic didn't hold back on him this time. He said that the final exams wouldn't be like every other exam. Izuku believed him, knowing him he's probably hacked into their database multiple times.

Izuku felt utter shock paralyze his body when the final exams were announced. They'd be fighting against their teachers. To make matters worse, Izuku was paired with Bakugo.

On a normal day, that'd be the *worst* case scenario. On today, the worst case scenario was which teacher he was going up against. All Might.

Izuku almost had a panic attack right then and there, and he had only managed to get his breathing under control after Uraraka put a supportive hand on his shoulder. He was thankful for her help, even if she didn't understand what he was afraid of. He was also thankful that she didn't ask questions.

Izuku slowly approached Bakugo, fidgeting with his hands. When he went to speak, he felt himself freeze. He looked at Bakugo, and felt his heart flutter. Bakugo had been staring off at a random object, but his face wasn't scrunched in anger. He had a relaxed expression, a *soft* expression. Izuku didn't see that anymore, even while walking the halls Bakugo looked pissed off. Bakugo looked at Izuku, and that scowl he knew so well came back.

"What the fuck do you want."

"I-I just..we should strategize.." Izuku gulped, "I know i'm not..um..the strongest in the world.."

"Shut up." Bakugo growled. "I'm taking down All Might by myself. You can do whatever the hell it is you do, but I'm not going to work beside you."

Izuku felt a spark of anger, but he understood. Izuku had no big quirk, and no matter the training, he'd never be able to take down All Might even with Bakugo's help. He'd fail.

Of course, when it was Izuku and Bakugo's turn, Izuku felt his lungs closing. He couldn't grasp his breath, but he didn't want to make it a big deal. The thought of All Might itself was making Izuku's knees want to buckle. Bakugo walked confidently down the road, the soft 'swish' sound emitting from his walking.

"Kacchan," Izuku's voice was shaky. "I.."

"Don't even try to give up, damn nerd." Bakugo interrupted Izuku. "How am I supposed to be better than you, if you don't even fucking try?!"

“Because..-!”

“Shut up, I don’t want to hear it!” Bakugo growled. “You have no reason good enough to back out.”

“Please just let me-!”

“I’m not letting you give up! I won’t fucking baby you.”

“Kacchan!”

“WHAT?!”

Izuku flinched, covering his head when he heard Bakugo yell. He whimpered softly when he realized he wasn’t going to be attacked.

“Please just listen..”

“Why the fuck would I?! You’re so fucking usele-”

“All Might told me I couldn’t be a hero and then left me on a rooftop. He told me it wasn’t possible.” Izuku blurted out, feeling tears reach his eyes. Bakugo chuckled.

“Yeah? Maybe he was right.”

Izuku stared. He felt that rage from before build in his chest. He grabbed Bakugo’s arm, making Bakugo face him.

“Take it back.” Izuku’s voice was soft. “Take that back, Kacchan.”

“You’re weak, Deku.” Bakugo said, shaking Izuku off his arm. “Being a hero is something that seems impossible.”

“Kacchan, stop it.” Izuku tried to force the tears back. “You’re being mean.”

“Whatever.”

A blast of wind blew down the street the two were standing on. It caught Izuku by surprise, and he almost tripped back. Bakugo grunted and held a hand up to shield his face. His other hand? It grabbed onto Izuku’s as soon as he saw the wind coming.

“That’s got to be him. I’ll kill him!” Bakugo blasted himself forward.

“Wait! We’re supposed to be a team!” Izuku ran after him.

It didn’t take long for the two of them to be thrown aside by All Might.

Within seconds, All Might had slammed Bakugo into the ground by his face, and approached Izuku. Izuku had quickly jumped and used his staff he was permitted to use to get back. Both him and Bakugo collided in the air.

“Get out of my way! I’ll fucking win this. I’ll be a hero.” Bakugo growled, walking towards All Might.

“Kacchan! We’re supposed to be a team. Let me help!”

“No! Mind your damn business, Deku.”

All Might moved first. He slammed a fence into the ground, blocking Izuku from moving. He then punched Bakugo in the stomach so hard, he puked.

“I know why you’re so angry, Bakugo. It’s because Young Midoriya had surpassed your expectations?”

“Shut up. I don’t need to get help from *him* . If I do, I’d rather just fucking lose!”

Izuku grunted as he freed himself from the fence. He sprung forward, and hit Bakugo in the jaw. His punch surprisingly knocked Bakugo pretty far. He ran after him, picked him up with a slight struggle and ran into an alleyway.

“The fuck are you doing?!”

“You said you’d rather lose. That’s not the Kacchan I know! That Kacchan I know would never settle to lose!” Izuku stomped his foot onto the ground, “You're better than just giving up! You’re a hero!!”

Bakugo gasped slightly in surprise, then his face turned to anger.

“Don’t fucking tell me what to do.”

“Stop being stubborn! We have to work together. Any hero could put it past them, so let’s just come up with a plan to get this over with!” Izuku felt his chest get tighter. He began to mutter under this breath. “Another ten minutes of this and I might just pass out from lack of oxygen.”

“What does that mean.” Bakugo interrupted, leaning down close to Izuku's face. “You talking shit about me, Deku?!”

“No,Kacchan..!” Izuku gulped, “I-I just..All Might makes me nervous.”

“Of course he does. He’s the symbol of peace! He’d make anyone fucking nervous!”

“No, you..you don’t understand.” Izuku whimpered softly. “I mean, I almost killed myself because of him.”

Izuku hadn’t noticed but, the last thing he said *wasn’t* a thought like he had thought it was. He watched Bakugo’s face twist in so many emotions he couldn’t read any.

“You’re lying. All Might is your favorite hero.” Bakugo furrowed his eyebrows. “All Might always has been. What’s fucking different now?”

Izuku interlocked his fingers nervously, rocking back and forth on his heels. He slowly looked towards Bakugo, swallowing hard.

“…You’re not lying.” Bakugo said softly, in self disbelief. “What the hell do you mean All Might almost made you-?!”

Izuku slapped a hand over his mouth. “Stop! He could hear you, and that's the last thing I want!”

“You better explain. And fast before I blow your ass up.”

“After you..um, told me to kill myself by jumping off of a roof,” Bakugo’s face flashed a hint of regret, before going angry again. “The day..you got attacked by that villain..I was attacked by the same one. But I was alone..a-and All Might saved me! I tried to ask him questions and..long story short, I ended up on a roof with him. I told him how much he inspired me and..then I asked if I could be a hero quirkless.”

Bakugo grinded his teeth together, almost like he knew what Izuku was going to say next.

“He said no. That- That didn’t bother me, but…he was really ugly about it. Um..and then he left me. On the roof, alone. He had just broken my dreams and didn’t even ask if I knew a way down. The ledge was right there, so..I-I jumped. Cosmic saved my life that day. That’s why we’re friends…”

Izuku didn’t look at Bakugo, but he felt a hand rest on his shoulder.

“Don’t think this means anything. You’re good, shitty Deku. Now get that brain of yours thinking, we need a fucking plan.” Bakugo growled. *I understand why some people say not to meet your idols.*

Izuku brainstormed, before coming up with the idea that Bakugo is a decoy distraction, and while Izuku is distracting All Might for real, Bakugo strikes. He had to repeat the plan a few times, feeling Bakugo lean so close to him to look at the notes made his heart flutter. Most people believed Bakugo smelt bad since his sweat made him smell like burnt sugar, but to Izuku he smelt comforting. Maybe it’s the subtle crush Izuku would never admit to having.

The two put their plan in action. Bakugo swung out, faking a surprise attack. Izuku followed, aiming the gauntlet at All Might. All Might turned at an inhumane speed and grabbed Izuku's arm. Izuku felt his chest tighten again as he gasped for breath. Bakugo must’ve noticed, because he made out a cry and blasted All Might with the best of his abilities.

Izuku felt a sharp pain filter it’s way up his back, paralyzing his legs. He fell to the ground, the world around him began to spin. He stared up at the sky, his lungs now seemed desperate for air. He saw a blurry outline for Bakugo, who was yelling at him. Izuku couldn’t make out what he was saying, but all he knew was panicking.

All Might had broken his back. Izuku figured it out once he went to force himself up. He laid there, limp, crying, and biting his tongue to stop himself from screaming.

Bakugo saw red. He felt an anger build inside his veins, the sparks in his hands grew. He dashed towards All Might, and winded his fist back. He punched All Might in the jaw, and

All Might's head tilted with the punch. Surprise hit All Might's face harder than the punch, and while he was stunned Bakugo turned to Izuku.

"Deku! The fuck, are you dead?!" He called, using a hand to support his head. When Izuku blinked slowly in response, Bakugo gritted his teeth in defeat. He would have to run. He swallowed his courage, recognizing that Izuku was already in a panic attack. He knew what they looked like from when Izuku and him were younger. And from when he caused them himself, but he's not going to admit that.

He cradled Izuku in his arms, running towards the exit. He heard All Might call after him, but his one goal was going to get Izuku away from All Might. It upset him that his idol was the reason Izuku didn't believe in himself, but he was also the cause himself. The thought of someone else hurting Izuku though, it pissed him off. He felt his blood run cold when Izuku went completely limp, blacking out.

Izuku's eyes fluttered open, and he saw his mother in front of him. He instantly began crying as he hugged his mom.

"Mom! You're here!"

"Honey, you..you have to stop getting so hurt..!" Inko cried into her son's embrace.

"I'm so sorry,"

"Izuku," Inko sighed, cupping his face gently as tears of her own rolled down her rosy cheeks. "You have to let me go, honey. Every time you're unconscious, you can't keep coming back to me.."

"I can't be alone yet. Mom, I..I miss you so bad.."

"I know, baby. You need to confide in others. You always found Mitsuki's son attracti-"

“Mom!” Izuku blushed.

“What? I’m just saying. You’re not alone, Izuku. I love you, honey. Please be safe.”

Izuku gasped, springing up into a sitting position. He collided with someone’s forehead hard, and he rubbed his own gently. He jumped back, yelped, and blushed when he realized it was Bakugo. His eyes grew angry.

“Kacchan..!”

“Glad to know you’re awake, you fucking dick.” Bakugo growled, rubbing his forehead. “Recovery Girl fixed your back. She said you’d be tired for a while.”

“I am kind of sleepy..”

The door to the nurse's office opened.

“Please take a seat dear, let’s finish your healing. Today should be the last recovery day.” Recovery Girl stated, sitting a student down. Izuku weakly reached over, but Bakugo moved the curtain for Izuku before he could.

Izuku smiles at the familiar face. “Healing almost done..?” He asked softly.

“Huh? Oh! Hi Midoriya! Let me guess, final exams?”

“Yeah..”

“You look rather good for being in here! I can’t wait to start training again.”

Bakugo growled. He pointed his finger accusingly. He spoke angrily.

“Shut the fuck up, pinky-pie! Deku needs his damn sleep, stop trying to distract him!”

Chapter End Notes

do you guys remember who bakugo calls pinky-pie? ;) that’s right, riso ain’t dead >:3
he’s too precious to actually kill!
updates every wednesday and sunday!

Chapter Twenty

Chapter Summary

Riso and Izuku go out for coffee after being stuck in Recovery Girl's office. They meet someone unexpected.

Chapter Notes

enjoy this time with riso! take it as an apology for making you guys think he's dead :)
riso backstory too!! man, this chapter is full of riso content :3

for reference, riso is about 6'2. he's not super well built or anything, he's just…tall.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

When Izuku woke up, Bakugo was gone. Riso was still in the room in his own bed, a bandage wrapped around his head. Recovery Girl said he didn't technically need it, but it was a reminder to him to take it easy. Izuku admits that the day Aizawa came to him about Riso being found, he thought the worst.

It was a miracle Riso was even alive. From what Aizawa said, he suffered blunt force trauma to the head and was bleeding out. He was stuck in the debris for a few days, but he hadn't bled to death. Recovery Girl wouldn't tell anyone how close he was to death, or how he survived. She told them to just let her do her job, and she would save his life. Izuku was beyond grateful for her.

The only problem about Riso's near death experience, he wasn't cleared to work in the support course for a week. Izuku had gotten to know Riso pretty well, and he knew how important his daily schedule was to prevent any breakdowns. Since the most crucial part of his routine wasn't available to him, Nezu had tea with him everyday. Riso had even taken up the responsibility of drawing all blueprints for the support course's requests. Usually, requests took a while to get out because the blueprint process was long and tedious. With Riso working on blueprints, his entire support course class ran out of requests to do.

His brain was fascinating to Izuku, and he wished he could study it. He mainly wanted to see how different Cosmic and Riso's thinking was.

"Midoriya," Riso said, putting his pen in his book and closing it. "You do know you're staring?"

"I'm so sorry!" Izuku apologized, blushing lightly. "I was..just thinking about how smart you are.."

"Awh, you think I'm smart?" Riso asked, watching Izuku sit up and look towards him. "I'm flattered!"

"I..Have a weird question."

"Of course!" Riso chirped, facing Izuku.

"What happened the night Cosmic saved you?"

Riso paused, and he gulped hard. "I guess we're close enough that I should tell you."

"You don't have to..!"

"No, no. It's about time I verbalize it."

"Thank you for sharing.."

"It was rough. Uh, family dinner. My boyfriend had been invited over for movie night, but had to leave before we all sat down to eat. They didn't know he was my boyfriend. But, my mom was pregnant, and my dad had just gotten a promotion at his job. I knew they didn't

support anyone in the LGBTQ+ community." Riso sighed, laying his back against the bed as he looked up at the ceiling. His right arm was behind his head, propping it up comfortably.

"I just felt like since everything was so..positive and happy, I would tell them. So I blurted it out, and the table fell silent. My dad started screaming at me, he even hit me in the face with a plate. I got up to go away, and my mom cornered me. I uh..she attacked me. Since that day, I secretly worked on my ability to get around quickly."

"I remember later that night, when my window was opened. I asked him who he was, and he shrugged and told me he was there to help. So, he helped me pack my belongings that night. I never questioned how he knew I was in danger. The next morning while everyone was out, my boyfriend helped me move out."

"Luckily, I had been accepted into UA already. My parents didn't even know I applied. I met with Nezu, and I explained I had just been kicked out and might not be in class. That's when he offered me an old teacher's break room as an apartment. I told him I couldn't, but he insisted. So once I found a place to stay, my boyfriend and Cosmic helped me move in."

"Then..A few days later, my boyfriend broke up with me. It was my fault, I guess. I had a freak out, and he tried to snap me out of it and I accidentally broke his arm."

"Wait." Izuku said. "You *accidentally* broke his arm?"

"Yes. Was that part not clear?" Riso asked, looking over at Izuku.

"His arm. You accidentally BROKE his arm."

"I told you it was dangerous to snap me out of it." Riso shrugged, "Any questions?"

"Would you want to meet Cosmic again?"

“..uh, sure. I guess.” Riso muttered. “Maybe not, though.”

“C’mon! I know him personally..!”

“Thanks for the offer, but I'm okay, Midoriya. I should get some rest.” He shifted in his bed, and shut his eyes.

“Maybe we can go out for coffee later, so we can continue our conversation we were having on the train..” Izuku said softly. “I know a cafe that has cats.”

“…I was pretending to sleep, but you had me at cats.” Riso smiled.

The two got permission to leave Recovery Girl’s office shortly after the conversation. They reached outside, and Riso stretched.

“Ugh, thank god. I don’t think I’ve stepped outside in at least a week.” Riso said, chuckling lightly.

“Oh, wow. That’s quite a while.” Izuku nodded. “Hopefully some coffee will help.”

Riso opened the door to the cafe, closing it once Izuku walked inside. Riso wasted no time getting to the cats, and instantly picked one up.

“Hi Fluffball! Who’s a good kitty?” Riso smiled at the cat, petting it gently. “Awh, you’re so cute.”

Izuku sat at a table close to Riso, resting his head on his hand. He watched Riso play with the cat. Fluffball, as Riso called it, trotted over to Izuku and rubbed against his leg as if it wanted attention. Izuku smiled and patted its head.

“Fluffball is the cutest, isn’t he?” Riso scratched behind his ear. Fluffball suddenly took Riso’s finger in his mouth and began leading him somewhere.

Izuku laughed lightly and trailed behind the two, carrying Riso’s drink as well as his own. He watched as Riso let Fluffball guide him to where he was going.

Riso gasped softly when he collided with someone else. He fell back after losing his footing. He looked up at the person standing over him as he gently rubbed his head.

“Sorry, didn’t see you there.”

Izuku recognized that purple hair anywhere. It was Shinso.

“It- It’s quite alright,” Riso was helped to his feet by Shinso’s hand. Riso looked at Shinso, to which Izuku noticed his ears began to redden lightly.

What’s that about? Izuku tilted his head.

“I see that Fluffball likes you.” Shinso muttered, fiddling with his sleeve nervously. “He hardly ever goes to anybody else. From what I’ve seen at least..”

“Huh? Of course Fluffball likes me, I come here all the time. Well, when I have the time. He’s one of my favorites.” Riso picked up Fluffball, who was staring at the two of them. “He’s so sweet. So cuddly too,”

“That’s true.” Shinso nods. He reached over and rubbed under Fluffball’s chin. Shinso’s black sweater was covered in cat hair, showing he clearly loved the cats here.

Izuku narrowed his eyes. He recognized that sweater. A small gasp escaped his lips, and he walked forward in a hurry.

“Shinso! I’m sure you remember me, but I have a question.” Izuku started, rocking on his feet slowly.

“I do. You beat me at the sports festival. What’s your question?”

“Your sweater, where..where did you get it from?” Izuku asked, leaning forward. He witnessed Shinso tense slightly as he placed a hand on the bottom of the sweater.

“A store.”

“You and I both know that’s a lie.” Izuku muttered, crossing his arms. “That’s Cosmic’s.”

Riso blinks, looking at Fluffball awkwardly. The tension in the room became intense, and Riso always felt awkward in these social situations.

“How would you know that?” Shinso tested.

“I helped patch that hole in the bottom. I had to teach him how to sew because he wouldn’t let me do it.” Izuku said in a matter-of-factly voice. He paused, realizing what he had said. “I-I mean-!”

“..So you’ve met him too.” Shinso looked off to the side. “Did he save you too?”

“Well..” Izuku bit his lip, thinking about everything he had done with Cosmic, and his identity as Nexus. “You could say that.”

Riso slowly began to step away, still holding Fluffball. He turned in his heel, beginning to walk away.

“Riso?” Izuku asked. “Where are you going?”

“Uh..nowhere. Just- going to get..more coffee.”

“But you haven’t even finished your first,”

Riso gulped, freezing in place. He didn’t have an excuse to get out of this social interaction without making a fool of himself.

“Is it my fault?” Shinso asked. “If anything, he’s probably scared of me. Most people are because of my quirk.”

Riso’s head perked up, and he let his arms fall. Fluffball jumped to the ground, and ran to Shinso’s ankles before rubbing against them purring.

“That’s not true at all!” Riso was in front of Shinso before he or Izuku could even blink. “I find you so incredibly fascinating, it’s not even funny! Your quirk is genuinely one of the most unique quirks I've ever come across and I’ve seen lots of quirks! I’ve been planning to approach you to talk about it but I get so nervous, and I don’t want you to think I’m weird. I adore your dedication to being a hero even though you’re constantly put down. Hell, I even got Aizawa to train you! You can hardly ever convince that man to do anything other than sleep, and I got him to take on another student! At the sports festival, I was shocked at how calmly you used your quirk. Sure, you panicked a bit when Midoriya came back towards you but you still managed to keep your composure pretty well for a general studies student! Gosh, the things I’d do to be able to study you and your quirk. I bet it could be a real help if you’re put through quirk enhancement training!” Riso’s words flew from his mouth, hardly even taking a breath. He smiled innocently, and hadn’t noticed but was leaning real close to Shinso’s face. Izuku was sure that if he could see Riso’s eyes, they would be gleaming and shining brightly.

Shinso blinked slowly, his face reddening slightly. He tilted his head back, and away from Riso. “…Was that even a human language?” He asked, looking at Izuku for an answer.

“Sorry, he gets excited.” Izuku offered nervously, pulling Riso back. Riso seemed to bite his tongue, and looked at the ground. He began muttering to himself, his shoulders dropping with his mood. He didn’t speak, and just held his head low. Regret consumed Riso, as he silently ridiculed himself for being overbearing.

“I should go.” His voice was soft, quiet, and almost went unnoticed. Riso turned towards the door. “I apologize for being overbearing.” He quickly walked out the door without another word.

He’s quick. I couldn’t even get a word out before he left. Izuku looked on sadly, before turning to Shinso. He went to speak, but was interrupted.

“So he’s just as annoying as the rumors say.” Shinso sighed tiredly. “Didn’t expect him to be so sensitive.”

“Hey! Don’t say that!” Izuku defended Riso. “He can’t help himself when he gets excited!”

“I meant it in a positive way. Did it not sound that way?”

Izuku blinked.

“..Uh, no. You sounded tired and over it.”

“Oh. Sorry.” Shinso shrugged, putting his hands in his pockets. “I should go tell him I didn’t take offense to that. I was just shocked.” Shinso began to walk out the door, not bothering to quicken his pace.

Man. He reminds me of Mr. Aizawa.. Izuku thought to himself.

On a bench outside the cafe, Riso sat quietly. Rain poured down onto his head, masking his tears that were streaming down his face.

“Stupid, stupid, stupid..” Riso muttered to himself, gritting his teeth as he felt more tears fall. He gripped at his legs, feeling his nails dig into his skin. The rain around him deafened his hearing. His mind seemed to echo as his thoughts ran wild. He felt his hands begin to shake, and he squeezed his eyes shut tightly.

To his surprise, he felt someone gently touch his hand. His eyes shot open and he looked over.

“Hey. Did you not hear me?”

Riso took a small breath. The sounds around him had returned to normal, and his heart rate slowed to the usual level. He wiped his tears, not like Shinso could tell the difference because of the rain. Shinso reached over and covered the two of them with an umbrella.

“I’m sorry.” Riso said first, “I shouldn’t have done that.”

“Don’t be sorry. I was surprised someone was interested in my quirk. Not..scared of it or hate it.” Shinso looked out into the street. “You said you got Aizawa to train me.”

“Oh, uh..yeah. You came up in conversation.” Riso bite the tip of his thumb. “I said you should be trained. You’ve got the potential.”

“Came up in conversation? You regularly talk with the teachers?”

“…It’s a long story, but we’re all very close.”

“I see. You’re a teacher's pet.” Shinso nodded. “Makes sense.”

“Wh- I am *not* a teacher's pet!” Riso turned to Shinso with his lips slightly parted in surprise. “You’re so mean!”

“You can’t tell me you’re close with the teachers and not expect to be called a teacher’s pet. That’s just how it works.”

“..Does not.” Riso huffs.

“Look, we should go inside. You’ll get sick. C’mon.” Shinso stood and held a hand out to Riso. “Fluffball is probably tearing up Midoriya by now.”

Riso smiled and laughed softly, taking Shinso’s hand. “..Probably.”

Shinso tilted his head a little, watching Riso’s smile. He smiled in return.

He seems like the type to smile with his eyes.

Chapter End Notes

ive decided im gonna stop worrying if this is “keeping up” with the anime because i was worried people wouldn’t like my ocs but honestly fuck anyone who doesn’t like it.

Chapter Twenty One

Chapter Summary

Shinso, Aizawa and Hizashi time >:3

Chapter Notes

this chapter contains heavy abuse mention, neglect mention, and just some rlly bad stuff. hope you enjoy! <3

See the end of the chapter for more notes

"Sho," Hizashi places two hands on his shoulders. "It's okay. It's just a conversation with his current foster parents."

"That's not what I'm worried about." Aizawa adjusted his shirt in the mirror. "I'm worried about them pissing me off. I did background checks. I don't even know how they *are* foster parents."

"I know." Hizashi sighs, rests his head on his shoulder, wrapping his hands around his waist. "We can't go punching them though, okay?"

"I'll decide that myself."

"C'mon, Sho. We should get going."

Hizashi and Aizawa both left the house, and set out towards the address given in the file about Shinso's foster parents. The closer they got, the pit in Aizawa's stomach grew larger. He had been in the area quite often during his patrol for villain attacks, and it made Aizawa sick knowing a student was only a wall away from such danger.

Aizawa also knew that ‘such danger’ was inside those walls. He really hopes these two can watch their mouth, he’d hate to have to do anything rash.

Hizashi stopped in front of the door, looking around.

“This is it? This looks like a crack house.” Hizashi muttered, before knocking on the door. A man in his 40’s opened the door. He wore a white tank top that was covered in stains, Hizashi and Aizawa don’t want to imagine what they could be from, and had a half-way done cigarette in his mouth.

“About time you got ho- You’re not that little freak. Who the fuck are you?” His voice was scratchy, imitating the sound of nails on a chalkboard or forks against glass plates. He flicked his cigarette ash towards Aizawa and Hizashi. Aizawa felt his eyes twitch, but Hizashi stepped forward.

“Hi. Are you Mister Zentai Ozomashī?”

“That’s me. Who’s askin.”

“I’m Yamada Hizashi. We’re here to talk about one of the foster children. The agency got your permission?”

“Oh. Right. You’re here about that purple hair freak. Come in.” Zentai turned around and walked inside the house. Aizawa and Hizashi hesitantly walked inside. It was a fucking nightmare.

Trash covered the tables, floor and any kitchen counter there was available. There were a few kids running around with trash bags and they cleaned up around the house. Aizawa tried to mask a face of disgust when Zentai sat in an armchair that was covered in what he hoped was sweat stains.

A younger, attractive woman who looked to be at least 25 walked in from the hallway. She wore a skimpy top that seemed to barely cover her, and a neon mini skirt. Her hair was disheveled, and had clear syringe markings on her forearm. She grabbed a cigarette pack from the coffee table and a lighter from her pocket.

Somehow, the way she dresses would disappoint even Nemuri. Aizawa thought to himself, looking at Hizashi who seemed to have the same thought.

“Oh, you’re a cutie.” She smiled, placing her hand on Aizawa’s chest. He pushed her hand off.

“Don’t touch me,” Aizawa tried to keep the words from coming out harshly. Hizashi elbowed Aizawa subtly. “…Ma’am.” Aizawa finished his previous sentence hastily.

“Aw, don’t be such a stuck in the mud.”

“We’re here to discuss Hitoshi Shinso.” Aizawa interrupted. “If you remember the call you got, we’re going to be rehoming him.”

“That’s the freak, right?” Zentai rolled his eyes. “About time. He gets on my fuckin’ nerves.”

Hizashi clenched his jaw. He took a deep breath, and looked at Aizawa.

“Look, Mister Ozomashī,” Hizashi starts. “We need any files relating to Shinso. Medical conditions, or anything the orphanage provided.”

“Kusuri! Go get the brats stuff. Hurry it up, whore. Actually, bring them with you. I need peace and quiet.” Zentai waved them off. Kusuri, who they assumed was the woman, began to lead the two of them further into the house.

Aizawa peered into each room as Hizashi tried to converse with Kusuri. He was surprised, most of the rooms were spotless compared to the living room. Aizawa stopped when he heard the front door open. He turned, feeling the smaller kids run past and in between his legs. If Aizawa were to guess, there were at least five younger children. Shinso must be the only teenager.

“Toshi! Toshi!” One of the kids called, running up to the front door. Aizawa walked down the hallway, and looked into the living room. He smiled softly when he saw Shinso being bombarded by the children.

“Where the hell have you been? Did you even get permission to take that fucking umbrella??” Zentai growled at Shinso, throwing a beer can at him. Shinso shook his head, and placed the umbrella by the door. He didn’t respond, but walked in the kitchen.

“Toshi! Did you get us dinner??” A different kid asked, holding onto his sweater as he walked.

“Of course I did, Kodomo. Would you like me to cook it the same as before?” Shinso leaned down, and ruffled Kodomo's hair. Aizawa watched on as Shinso interacted with the kids.

He’s probably the reason their rooms are clean. He must be taking care of them himself. Aizawa continued to watch as Shinso told the kids to go play in their rooms while he cleaned up. Shinso began to wash the dishes after pushing his sleeves up. Aizawa narrowed his eyes, looking closely at the sweater.

That’s Cosmic’s sweater, isn’t it? Aizawa leaned against the wall, crossing his arms. He knew Hizashi said Cosmic came to him about Shinso to begin with, but it was surprising that he gave his sweater to him. He could tell it was his sweater because across the arm there was a poorly done stitch job from when Aizawa had cut his arm with the capture weapon.

“Sho,” Hizashi nudged Aizawa, “I have the files. Where were you?”

“Watching him.” Aizawa motioned to Shinso. “He takes care of everyone here, it seems that way at least.”

“So much responsibility for a kid his age.” Hizashi frowned. “We’ll get all those kids into better homes too.”

“Oh, hey.” Kusuri walks up to the two of them. “Don’t forget this. The kid needs it with that damn quirk of his.” She held up a muzzle, swaying it in the air slightly. “It makes him bleed sometimes, it’s cute to hear him whimper and beg for us to stop.”

Utter disbelief was displayed on both Hizashi and Aizawa’s face. Aizawa clenched his jaw. Hizashi grabbed Aizawa’s arm before he could speak.

“We’ll be back tomorrow.” Hizashi says. He walks out the door with Aizawa.

Shinso looked towards the door when it shut. He raised an eyebrow and walked into the living room. He was met with another beer can to the face.

“Hey, freak. Those were your new parents.” Zentai sneered, “They didn’t even bother saying hello to you.”

New parents? Shinso felt panic run through his veins. *No, that can't be right. There’s no other foster homes close enough for me to continue at UA. Did they give me up? Those bastards.* Shinso growled. He walked back to the kitchen and began cooking for his temporary siblings. He huffs as he begins to stir the food in the pot.

He began to think back to the trip to the cat cafe. It had only been a few hours, but he couldn’t get Riso off his mind. Riso already had bright pink hair, so that was unforgettable. What captured Shinso’s attention was his smile. It seemed to tell so much, yet so little. It was warm, soft, and welcoming. Honestly, all things considered, Shinso was shocked. Riso had changed his life by getting Aizawa to train him, and he was willing to never speak about it or take credit for it.

“Toshi,” Kodomo tugged on his sweater. “I finished with my room.”

“Thank you, Kodomo.” Shinso ruffles his hair once again.

“Why did you look like that?” Kodomo asks, looking up at him with curious eyes. “You were smiling, and you looked at the plate like it was the prettiest plate ever!”

“…I was thinking about a friend, that’s all.” Shinso tried to hide the blush that crept up onto his face. “Remember how I told you I got a hero to train me?”

“Uh huh!”

“That friend helped me get that opportunity.”

“Woah! He must really care!”

“Yeah..” Shinso placed the clean plate down. “Must really care..” He repeated quietly.

Shinso gave the food to the children, letting them eat in their rooms. It was the cleanest place to eat food without contracting five different diseases. He began to think about what Zentai said about new parents. He didn’t know what to do. It’s not like he could tell them he *wanted* to stay with the god awful family he was with. They were horrible. But they were the only people close enough for him to stay at UA.

Shinso laid on his bed, and looked up at the ceiling. He turned in his bed, hugging one of his pillows tightly. He knew tonight would be restless, but at least he’d spend the night thinking of what happened at the cat cafe.

Shinso hadn’t realized it, but morning came faster than he wanted it to. He pulled himself out of the comfort of his bed, and walked to his bedroom door. He paused, rubbing his eyes. Under his eyes felt like they had been punched repeatedly. The burning sensation was comforting to Shinso, but it also made it hard for him to keep his eyes open. He shrugged it

off and went to the kitchen, where he poured himself a cup of coffee. He sipped the black liquid slowly, walking towards the living room to see if Zentai and Kusuri were gone.

That wasn't the case. In fact, the people that accompanied the two in the living room was shocking enough to Shinso that he dropped his coffee mug. It shattered the second it touched the grimy floor, the liquid spilling everywhere and splashing on Kusuri's shoes. She began to yell at him, but any noise to Shinso right now didn't matter. What did matter was the fact that two Pro-Heros, who were also teachers at UA, were standing in his living room.

Aizawa looked at Shinso, a tired glance but one that seemed soft. He crossed his arms slightly.

"We'll be homing you for now." Aizawa said, a ghost of a smile on his face. "Also. We're arresting these two under the charges of child endangerment. A few other chargers, but that's the main one. The kids here will be rehomed too."

Shinso felt his head spin. Everything he had dreamed of, every fantasy he had about getting these sick bastards put away had always been just that. Dreams and fantasy. But here was Shota Aizawa, his mentor, trainer, idol, and favorite hero making those dreams and fantasies come true. He hadn't spoke, his mouth hung open in shock.

Present Mic was there too, which slightly confused Shinso. He'd ask questions later. He felt the next few hours of his life fly by with a few blinks. He had moved most of his belongings into the car the two Pros were using, he had said goodbye to his foster siblings, and now he stood outside as he watched Zentai and Kusuri be taken away in a cop car.

Okay. What the hell just happened? Shinso finally felt the past few hours catch up to him. He hadn't said a single word, but his mind definitely wanted to ask questions. He looked to his right and saw Hizashi. He took a small breath, before rubbing the back of his neck.

"..Present Mic?"

"Oh! You can call me Mic, little listener!" Hizashi smiled brightly.

“…Why’d you come for me?”

Hizashi tensed. He laughed nervously, trying to play it off.

“Someone was worried about you. So they talked to me.”

“Who?”

“I can’t really tell you that,”

“Who was it.”

“Sho,” Hizashi looked at Aizawa for help. Aizawa sighed and stepped over.

“To be completely honest with you, Cosmic did. He came to us about him being concerned for you. I looked into your file more, and was mortified with what I saw. You deserve a better place to stay than that shit show of a house.”

“Oh.” Shinso gulped. “Sorry.”

“Don’t be. You’ve got nothing to be sorry about. I need to ask you a few questions, as your current guardian.”

“..Okay.”

“Would you be willing to go to therapy?”

“Why would I need that?”

“You’ve been muzzled most of your life.”

“I-I don’t know. I think. Maybe later.”

“Any allergies that weren’t in your file?”

“No.”

“I’ll need a list from you of any possible triggers, or sensitive topics so Hizashi and I can approach things with you in a comfortable, healthy way without sending you into a panic. I want you to feel welcomed and comfortable in our apartment, and the last thing I want is to bring up an unwanted subject. Is that clear?”

“Yes, sir.”

“Don’t call me sir. It makes me feel old. Now c’mon, we have a place and room to show you to.”

Okay, your teacher is now legally your foster dad. Apparently, he’s married to this other teacher. They’re both Pro-Heros. That you’re about to live with. For who knows how long. That’s great. Shinso told himself, trying to think over the situation on the car ride to his new home. Once they had gotten there, Shinso lazily followed Aizawa. Hizashi began to grab some of his belongings so it was just him and Aizawa for now.

Shinso felt something rub against his leg, and he smiled. It was a cat. A black one with a white spot, with a name tag attached to it. Shinso leaned down, and gently petted it under its chin before looking at the tag. Aiko was engraved into the silver. Shinso stood up, and

continued to follow Aizawa around the house. He motioned to each place in the apartment, before stopping in front of a bedroom.

“This is your room.” Aizawa looked at Shinso. “We do have another bedroom. And I will warn you, are you familiar with Riso Sakusei?”

Shinso nodded softly, feeling his heart tingle when the name was spoken. He forced away a smile that crept up onto his face. Aizawa deadpanned, looking more tired than Shinso felt.

“There’s a chance he might stay here occasionally. I won’t disclose any reason unless Riso does so it gives me permission. You’re welcome to do whatever, as long as it’s not drugs and drinking alcohol. Let us know if you need anything. Hizashi will bring in your things, I need a nap.”

“Me too.” Shinso muttered softly, walking into his room. He sat on the bed that had a simple white blanket. He glanced out the window, watching as it started to sprinkle a little. He smiled softly.

Okay, Riso. You’ve officially made me curious. How do you have everyone wrapped around your finger?

Chapter End Notes

updates every wednesday and sunday!

fun fact, most of the names i used were direct translations from words like gross, and kid (kodomo) because i’m unoriginal.

also please comment it gives me motivation :3

Chapter Twenty Two

Chapter Summary

> Riso spends some time with the Bakusquad, Bakugo has a realization, and Cosmic allows Bakugo to help with a certain daily activity! Shinso witnesses Riso's training for himself.

Chapter Notes

> enjoy this 5k chapter! hope you guys are liking this :)

See the end of the chapter for more notes

"No way." Izuku says, placing his chopsticks down on the table. "There's no way Nezu trains you like that." He furrowed his eyebrows, glancing at Iida and Uraraka with curiosity. In front of Izuku sat Riso, who was casually telling everyone his daily routine in detail.

"Yes way." Riso nods. "At first it was the simple things. Dodging, running, jumping, fighting. Just something to challenge my brain. That's mainly when my quirk evolved. Then it needed to be harder and more challenging. He blindfolded me and it took off from there. I mean, you don't think it was a struggle with all this hair in my face? That helped a lot with my skill." Riso tilts his head. "It's also Nezu we're speaking about here, Izuku."

"That's true." Uraraka nodded in agreement, "He's kind of a dramatic type. You guys saw what he did to Kaminari and Mina." She shivered in fear, remembering her classmates' final exams.

"I do not put it past our Principal to go to such lengths. My only question is why you and not a hero course student? No offense." Iida asked, "You said it yourself that you're not interested in hero work."

"I'm not sure. I think it's my IQ, or how we met. I really couldn't tell you, Iida." Riso shrugs, continuing to scribble in his journal. "I hope you don't resent me for it."

“What?” Izuku chuckled, not knowing if Riso was making a joke or not. Riso struggled with tone occasionally. “Why would he?”

“Because it’s not him?” Riso looked confused. “Is that not normal?”

“Uh, no.” Uraraka shook her head. “Honestly, only selfish people would be genuinely jealous. Sure it seems unfair that you're really the only one Nezu favors, but I personally think it’s well deserved. You’re super smart, Riso! It’s only natural you’re recognized. Everyone here has certain accommodations, why’s it unfair when you have them too?”

“Thanks, Uraraka.” Riso smiled softly, looking up from his journal. Although, his hair blocked any actual eye-movement from him.

“What’s that you’re sketching?” Iida peered over Riso’s shoulder. Riso jumped, closed the journal, and covered it with both his hands as if he were embarrassed.

“Nothing!” Riso’s voice squeaks. He hid his cheeks in his arms, feeling a blush crept up onto them. He buries his head into his arms more, using a hand to gently tug on a strand of his hair. He mentally curses himself for such a reaction.

“Is he aware his ears tint red when he blushes?” Uraraka whispered to Izuku quietly. “It gives him away.”

“Yeah, I don’t think he’s got that part yet.” Izuku snickered.

“Hey, hey, hey!” Kirishima walked over with a toothy grin, wrapping his arm around Riso’s neck the best he could considering he had his head down. “How’s my favorite upperclassman doing?!”

Riso groaned in response.

“C’mon, dude! That’s not very manly of you. Anyways, the Baku-squad would love to have you come chill at our table! Deku is always stealing you from us and it’s not fair. You’re our support course student too and we don’t even know anything about you!” Kirishima whined, tugging on his arm. “Pleaseee?”

“...Does Bakugo know you call your friend group that? The Baku-squad?” Riso sits up, raising an eyebrow.

“...No.”

“I’m in.” Riso stood, looking at the three sitting with him. “We can sit together tomorrow.” He offered a soft and kind smile.

Kirishima fistpumped in victory, and led Riso over to his lunch table. He plops down in his seat, and before Riso could even attempt to sit he was yelled at.

“No you don’t, pinky-pie.” Bakugo growled.

“Oh shut it.” Riso snapped. “I don’t take orders from an underclassman with anger issues and hair that defies physics.” Riso sat down, smiling sarcastically.

“Ohh! He told you!” Denki snickered, leaning back as he laughed loudly. “Nice one, Riso!”

“So, I wanted to ask.” Mina leaned forward, a smirk finding itself on her lips. “What’s your type?”

Riso felt the blush rise to his face, and he placed a hand on his cheek in a weak attempt to hide it. He looked away, and at the same moment he wished he hadn’t. Walking by was Shinso, who was lazily listening to a kid speaking to him. Riso felt his face turn even more

red, and he covered his face with both hands now. He let out a small squeak in protest to his inner battle with himself, and he sank in his seat. Mina squealed.

“Oh my goodness,” Mina’s smile was almost wicked. “You have a *crush* !” She clapped happily, and too loudly for Riso’s liking. Riso lifted his hands, covering his face with his arms, and waved them in dismissal.

“That’s not true, Mina!” Riso said quickly, “You’re misreading the situation!”

“I think she’s completely right. You got the same look Bakugo has when he looks at-” Sero was cut off with a blast to his face, which caused him to fall off his chair and to the ground with a thud.

“Look, pinky-pie.” Bakugo started, “I don’t want you here. Let alone listen to you be all fuckin’ sappy. Shape up, or go the fuck away!”

“Don’t yell at me.” Riso warned. “I know I’m nice most of the time, but I won’t hesitate to kick your ass.” He leaned close, whispering in Bakugo’s ear. He sat back down and smiled innocently.

“Fuckin’ pyschopath.” Bakugo felt his right eye twitch in anger, but he rolled his eyes to subtly calm it. With his eye roll, he locked eyes on Izuku. The green-haired boy threw his head back in laughter, holding a smile that could light up an entire facility. Bakugo blocked out the yelling and arguing coming from his table. He watched Izuku’s movements carefully.

This relatively innocent bundle of joy was the same boy he crushed not even a year ago. Bakugo broke him, beat him, and stripped him of any confidence he had. He wasn’t there for Izuku in his time of need, rather made that time even harder than it was. He doesn’t remember when he became an asshole to Izuku, only the deep and complete regret he felt for being such a horrible person. Izuku was there for Bakugo when his mother had hit him, or given him a cruel punishment.

Bakugo tried to think harder. What about Izuku is so different now that he felt butterflies in his stomach everytime the two shared eye contact? What made it so different that Bakugo

couldn't think about Izuku without wanting to sob and apologize until his vocal cords had been torn to shreds. He wanted to stand on the top of a building and scream out how sorry he was, and how bad he wanted to make up for it. Bakugo sat up straight when green eyes stared back at him. Bakugo huffed, looking off to the side hastily. He glanced back, and let a smile show when Izuku smiled big and waved at him. His eyes sparkled and reminded him of how his dad looked at his mom. Bakugo paused, feeling his eyes widen.

Oh.

Oh.

Oh, no.

Bakugo stood quickly, walking off to the bathroom without a second thought. Once inside, and confirmed he was alone, he looked at himself in the mirror angrily.

"Are you fuckin' kidding me? That damned nerd?!" Bakugo yelled at himself. "Are you some pathetic loser who can't even have standards!?"

The bathroom door opened, and one of the last people Bakugo wanted to see stepped in.

"What do you want, pinky-pie? Make it quick." Bakugo growled. Riso sighed, leaning on the empty wall that was next to the sink Bakugo was using.

"Do you like him?" Riso asked quietly. "Izuku, I mean."

"Why the fuck would," Bakugo paused when he felt the look and/or glare Riso was giving him. He couldn't explain it, but it made him uneasy. He sighed, feeling he should tell the truth. "Fuck you. I think so."

"You *bullied* him." Riso said once.

“I did.”

“Until he was ready to end his life.”

“I did.”

“You told him to jump off a fucking roof.”

“I did.”

“Who the fuck treats someone they like that way? Have you lost your fucking mind?” Riso grabbed Bakugo’s collar, pulling him off the floor slightly. Bakugo didn’t resist. It wasn’t like him, but Riso was right. He was a dumbass about how he treated Izuku. “He’s a kind, pure soul. You better fucking make it up to him or I’ll discet your body and use your lifless, *useless* , corpse for research purposes. I’ll make sure we run out of pain medicine beforehand, so you can feel the physical pain you inflicted onto Izuku emotionally.”

Bakugo simply nodded.

“Good.”

Later that day, Bakugo slipped a piece of paper onto Izuku’s desk telling him to meet him somewhere. Bakugo clearly felt nervous, and he fucking hated it. No, he loathed this entire thing. He hated being vulnerable. There was never any reason to be vulnerable to anybody. His mom taught him that.

“Kacchan?”

The world seemed to stop. Bakugo glanced over his shoulder at Izuku, and everything fucking stopped. Every noise that filled his ears suddenly disappeared, everything around them turned into nothing. It was him, and Izuku Midoriya. The distance between them showed hesitance.

“I..I got your note. What is it?” Izuku looked off to the side.

“I know this doesn’t mean anything to you.” Bakugo bowed his head in shame towards Izuku’s direction. “I’m sorry.”

Izuku choked. “What?”

“You fucking heard me, I said I’m sorry!” Bakugo clenched his fists. “I was- a fucking asshole. I did really bad things to you. I broke you.”

“Kacchan,” Izuku said softly, his voice sounding understanding and sad.

“Why aren’t you mad? Why don’t you fucking hate me with every bone in your body like you should?!” He shouted. “Don’t say you forgive me!”

“I do, Kacchan. I do forgive you. I always have.” Izuku smiled kindly.

“Stop! Stop being so fucking nice to me after all I’ve done!”

“No.” Izuku shook his head. “Your actions weren’t your own then. No one stopped you, no one told you any better. No one ever corrected that behavior, and that’s not your fault.” He stepped to Bakugo, and grabbed his hands. He ignored the feeling of sweat, and looked up at Bakugo. Instead of doing what anyone with a grudge would’ve, he hugs him. He wraps Bakugo into a tight, loving hug that lasts a few minutes. At first, Bakugo tensed and went to shove him back. But, he slowly accepted the hug.

“Kacchan, I know you usually like to yell and explode at things like this.” Izuku says, “But I really think you need a hug..Everyone does sometimes.”

“Tch. Whatever,” Bakugo pulled from the hug early. “I wanted to ask you something else. And be truthful, idiot!”

“What is it?” Izuku asked with a head tilt.

“At our final exams. You told me what happened between you and All Might.” Bakugo recalled. “And that’s how you became friends with scar-face.”

“That’s right..” Izuku nods.

“Do you take me for a fucking idiot? You’re clearly that vigilante that follows around scar-face like a lost puppy. Aren’t you? The fucking staff, the way you two right together so easily, why he cares so much about you.”

Izuku’s eyes widen, and he looks off to the side. “I can’t hide anything from you..Can I?” He sighed. “I-It’s true.”

“You’re a fucking vigilante?! That’s illegal, Deku! The fuck are you thinking??”

“I wanted to prove I was capable of- fighting! Doing things without a hero's help. That even if my quirk isn’t big, it’s enough to help me!”

“It’s dangerous!”

“So what?? I’ve only been stabbed once!”

“YOU WERE FUCKING STABBED?!”

“Stop yelling! Look, you can be mad about this. It’s my decision, Kacchan!”

“Your decision is stupid as shit!”

“Real low, Kacchan.” Izuku said, a surprising amount of fierceness and venom lacing his words. “Did you come out here just to ridicule me..? Tell me I’m helpless and need someone, no, *you* helping me all the time? That I’m not good enough for anything on my own??”

“What? Why the hell-” Bakugo was interrupted with a slap to the face. He blinked, placing a hand on his cheek that stung with the wind hitting it.

“Because why wouldn’t you?!” Izuku screamed at him, poking his chest accusingly. “You told me to jump off a building.” He hissed, keeping his voice low. It seemed although he was upset, he didn’t want anyone overhearing to see Bakugo any different. Bakugo kept quiet, letting Izuku rant and scream at him.

“I don’t understand why you care! You’ve been horrible to me, when you used to help me whenever I needed. You were there for me, then you became the problem! You know what, Katsuki?” Izuku’s eyes held a rage behind them. Bakugo saw Inko in him so much right now, it scared him into silence. First name basis with Izuku was never a good thing. “When you have a *real* apology, come back to me.” He turned on his heel to walk away. Bakugo swallowed his pride.

“Wait,” His voice was small, and cracked a little. “Let me help. Not to protect, but to not get caught.”

“What are you talking about?” Izuku looked back at Bakugo, who was hanging his head in defeat. Of course, it had to start raining. Bakugo hated the rain.

“As that dumb- fucking vigilgante persona.” Bakugo scoffed, “You don’t need to get caught. I want to help. Tell me how I can help.”

“That decision isn’t up to me.” Izuku trailed off. “You’d have to talk to Cosmic about wanting to help me.”

“I want to support you, idiot. I know you’re capable on your own. How else do you think I found out? Only you would do some stupid shit like this.”

“...” Izuku was silent, then he sighed. “Come over tonight. We’ll talk then.”

“Don’t tell me what to do.” Bakugo rolled his eyes. “Oi, Deku?” He began to confess his recently found feelings.

“Yeah?”

“Uh..” Bakugo felt his heart ache. “Nevermind. I’ll be at your house tonight, damn nerd..”

Bakugo knocked on Izuku’s door gently. Three simple knocks, soft and easy to not make Izuku jump from inside. He hadn’t been over in so many years, and he knew it would feel empty without Inko there. The door swung open.

“Son of a bitch.” Cosmic glares at the boy in front of him. “Zuku! Dipshits here.”

“Don’t call Kacchan that!” Izuku walked over. He was in a short sleeve shirt, but was shivering. Bakugo noted that the apartment was dark, most likely without power. He glanced at the window to the next apartment, seeing it was on.

Does he not have power? I thought his shit dad was paying for this place. Bakugo thought, but tuned back into reality when Izuku pulled him inside. Bakugo furrowed his eyebrows. *His hands are fucking freezing.*

“Deku,” Bakugo says, “You’re freezing.”

“No, it’s just a little chilly. My dads just a bit behind with the power bill-” Izuku shook his head, but Bakugo slipped off his jacket. He wrapped it around Izuku.

“Put that on, idiot.” Bakugo watched Izuku’s eyes widen and his cheeks redden as he snuggled into the warm jacket. Izuku sat on the couch, holding the jacket close to his body. Bakugo glanced at Cosmic, who was trying his best to make something for Izuku to eat without power.

“I’m sorry you had to come at such a bad time.”

“Shut up. Can we talk about what we were earlier?”

“Uh..Cosmic?”

“Yes, Zuku?”

“Bakugo wants to help.”

Cosmic went silent. He looked at Bakugo, then Izuku, then Bakugo.

“No.”

“Please?? He just wants to keep us from getting caught!”

“Okay and how the fuck would he do that? Actually?”

“You can tap him into any agency! And he can be at home and just telling us which hero is on their way and from where!”

“…So a guy in the chair.”

“Yes..?”

Cosmic looks at Bakugo and walks over. He leans down to examine his face.

“Fine.”

Bakugo pulled a surprise face. Honestly, he didn’t expect to be able to help the slightless. Yet here he was, able to help.

“Thanks, scar-face.”

“God, when will you learn fucking names.” Cosmic huffed and sat down two bowls of food for both Bakugo and Izuku. “Here. Eat.”

“Did you poison it? I’m not eating that.” Bakugo pushes the bowl forward.

“Eat the damned food, Bakugo Katsuki or so help me god your mother will think what I’ll do is too far.” Cosmic threatened, and Bakugo muttered under his breath but began to eat with Izuku. He’d never admit it, but it was good. Really good.

“Cosmic beat someone close to death for me when I got stabbed.” Izuku spoke to break the silence.

“Izuku!”

“What?? It’s true!”

Bakugo snickers. “Yeah? I would’ve gone through with it. Killed that bastard and his family.”

“This is why you’re not a vigilante.” Cosmic glares. “You’re too brash and murderous.”

“Oh fuck off.”

There was more silence.

“C’mon, Zuku.” Cosmic stood. “Finish your food, we need to leave.”

“Kacchan needs to be set up though!”

“Ugh. Okay, I’ll hurry.”

Cosmic pulled out a laptop that had an extra battery attached. The power was out, but he’d just use the neighbors wifi. After a few awkward moments of silence, Cosmic had tapped into each agency and was hearing their patrol and demands for crime. Izuku held out his hand to Cosmic.

“Gimmie.”

“Give you what?”

“An earpiece! I know you have multiple.”

“Fine, fine.” Cosmic placed an earpiece in Izuku’s hand, who passed it to Bakugo.

“Here, Kacchan! Now you’ll be able to hear and talk to us!” Izuku smiled as Bakugo placed it in his ear.

“C’mon. We gotta go.”

Izuku and Cosmic set out on their patrol. The two were waiting for some news or clear signs of criminal activity. Izuku jumped slightly when he heard the earpiece crackle to life.

“ *Oi, two streets over. There’s some robbery happening.* ”

“Since when did we ask you to-” Cosmic started but was interrupted by Izuku.

“Thanks Kacchan!”

“ *Don’t call me that, stupid! Anyone overhearing you would know it’s me and you.* ”

“I opt for calling him blasty!” Cosmic snickers as the two of them ran along the rooftops. Cosmic jumped onto the ground, Izuku following.

“ *Don’t fucking call me that.* ”

“You get to call me a dumb name, it’s about time you had one!”

Cosmic swung into the store, knocking the armed robber to the ground with a swift kick.

“Please stop fighting.” Izuku whined, using his staff to knock the robber’s friend unconscious. Izuku threw Cosmic a rope and zip-ties to tie up the two unconscious men.

“ *How important do these crimes need to be?* ” Bakugo asked through the earpiece.

“I think vandalism counts if it’s breaking windows, or throwing bricks. Just tell us if it’s something that minor and we’ll check it out.” Cosmic responds, scribbling down a note for Eraser.

Izuku was speaking to the shopkeeper, and assured her everything was alright.

“ *Got it.* ” Bakugo hummed, “ *There was a call to the police about screaming in an alley. It’s about a block away. Call came in about thirty seconds ago.* ”

“You’re irritating, blasty.”

“ *I said not to call me that!* ”

Izuku sighs, pinching the bridge of his nose. “Guys, please. Let’s just go.”

Cosmic and Izuku exited the store, and made their way to the alleyway. Cosmic was perked up on the roof above the alleyway, Izuku sitting next to him. The scene below them was slightly disturbing. There were two men who seemed to be arguing.

“You’re an asshole!”

“Maybe if you weren’t trying to shove yourself at others! You’re *my* boyfriend!”

“It’s called having friends! I’m sorry you don’t have any!”

“I don’t want you hanging out with them!”

Izuku looked at Cosmic, “Maybe we shouldn’t get involved.” The two of them continued to argue.

“You’re right. C’mon, let’s-”

“Go fuck yourself, Ikari!”

Cosmic pauses, then he looked at Izuku.

“Change of plans. You stay right there.” Cosmic handed Izuku his earpiece and jumped down.

“Wh- Cosmic!” Izuku called. “Kacchan, what’s he doing??”

“ *I don’t fuckin’ know, and stop calling me that! You’re gonna get caught!* ”

Izuku looked down at the alleyway. Cosmic was talking to one of the men, and the situation escalated when Cosmic punched him in the face. Izuku’s eyes widen and he scrambles to jump down.

“Cosmic! You can’t just punch him!” Izuku pulled Cosmic back, “Do you know him??”

“It’s not important. Bastard deserved it.” Cosmic glared at the body that laid unconscious on the ground. Only a few punches and he was out.

“ *...Three hits and he’s out* ?” Bakugo asked, chuckling. “ *You’re stronger than I thought, scar-face.* ”

“Let’s go.” Cosmic said casually. Izuku decided against asking questions with Bakugo present.

A few hours later, Izuku and Cosmic found their way back into Izuku’s cold apartment. Izuku sat on the couch with a sigh, pulling off his hood. Cosmic walked off into the bathroom to clean up his bloody hands. Cosmic forgot to tie his shoe and tripped off of a building, he had to use his hands to catch himself.

On the table were a few bags. Izuku furrowed his eyebrows softly, looking at Bakugo.

“..What’s this?”

“Food. Blankets, heater.” Bakugo said, closing the laptop. “Heaters solar powered.”

“Kacchan,” Izuku said softly. “You didn’t- You didn’t have to.”

“I did. I’m not going to let you just fucking- freeze to death.” Bakugo shakes his head. “It’s not charged because I just got it, and you’re still freezing. Cmere.” Bakugo pulled Izuku closer and wrapped him in a blanket.

Izuku stayed still, pulling the blanket closer to his body. He smiled at Bakugo.

“Aren’t you cold too?”

“I have my hands, I’m fine.”

Izuku opened his arms, the blanket opening with his movements. He threw his arms around Bakugo, resting his head against his right shoulder.

“Just share the blanket with me? Like we used to?”

“Fuck you.” Bakugo grumbled, grabbing the blanket and wrapping it around his left shoulder. He rested back against the couch, and Izuku pulled his feet up onto the couch. He rested against Bakugo, and within minutes he fell asleep. Bakugo looked down at him, sighing softly as he readjusted the blanket to cover the two of them more efficiently. He rested his head on Izuku’s, finding himself feeling restless and tired. He quickly fell asleep.

With Izuku resting on Bakugo’s shoulder, he slowly wrapped his arms around Bakugo’s arm to hold close. Bakugo didn’t stir in his sleep, but rather leaned closer to Izuku. Cosmic came out of the bathroom with bandages on his hands, stopping abruptly when he saw the two sleeping next to each other. He smiled softly, picking up a polaroid camera he had bought Izuku a few months ago. He snapped two pictures and placed them on the table, before walking out on the balcony. He stands himself on the edge, glancing back at Izuku’s apartment. He jumped off, and headed back home.

-

Shinso followed Aizawa to the gym after the school day ended. He glanced at his teacher, who was now his parent, and who was always apparently married to Present Mic.

“Why are we going to the gym?”

“Cementoss is helping today, and the cleanup is easier in the gym.” Aizawa opened the gym door. “Go in.”

Shinso complied, but his head snapped towards the center of the gym when a loud thud came from that direction. His eyes widened slightly at the sight in front of him.

Riso was standing above a broken piece of cement. He wore a gym uniform, and a white blindfold around his eyes. Cementoss was creating walls and things to fall from the sky for Riso, who was scaling each wall perfectly and dodging the falling objects. Nezu sat off to the side, drinking a cup of tea as he watched Riso.

Shinso blinked, looking at Aizawa.

“Is that normal?”

“Unfortunately, it is. We’re breeding a monster.” Aizawa sighed, walking up beside Nezu.

“Ah! Afternoon, Aizawa.” Nezu smiled. “It’s lovely you decided to stop by at this time.”

“Indeed.”

Shinso continued to watch Riso in pure shock. The way he moved so effortlessly, while blindfolded and only going off of his hearing and intuition, it surprised Shinso. This is the same boy who seems like he couldn’t hurt a fly. Riso landed on the ground and pulled his blindfold off.

“How’d I do?” Riso asked Nezu, waving to Cementoss.

“Very well. You’ve improved, but you could still work on it. Your footing was a little unsteady. But overall, amazing. Tea?” Nezu smiles.

“Yes of cour..Oh! I didn’t see you two there,” Riso rubbed the back of his neck gently. “Hi, Shinso.”

“Hey.” Shinso said quietly.

“Are you ready to train?” Aizawa asked Shinso.

“If it’s anything about what Riso ‘needs to work on’, I’m okay.” Shinso said, looking off to the side. He knew he couldn’t be thrown into something like that so early….right?

“We’ll just be focusing on your agility.”

Riso sat next to Nezu and grabbed his cup of tea. His hands were shaking slightly, but he could play it off as if it was the adrenaline rush from his training. He watched Shinso and Aizawa spar and then Aizawa began to help Shinso with his agility. Unfortunately, a piece of debris hit Shinso in the cheek and slightly cut him. Enough to make him bleed a bit, but not enough to leave a scar.

Once Shinso’s training was over, he sat next to Riso with a sigh. Riso pulled out a bandage, and turned to Shinso. He held up the bandage with a soft smile.

“Can I patch up that cut?”

Shinso nodded. Riso gently wiped the cut clean.

“You did really well,” Riso assured Shinso. “It was impressive to watch..”

“..You think?” Shinso asked quietly.

“Uh huh! I didn’t do that well my first couple of tries.” Riso gently placed the bandage against his cheek. “I was right about you.”

“Right about me?”

“Yeah, you being the one Aizawa trains!” Riso smiled brightly. “You’re very skilled.”

“You’re such a teacher's pet it hurts.” Shinso snickers, placing a hand on the bandage Riso put on his cheek.

“Wh- Take that back!”

“No.”

“I’m not a teacher's pet!”

“You are.”

“No!”

Shinso and Riso argued with each other. Nezu looks at Aizawa with a smile.

“They’re quite the pair.” Nezu says, sipping his tea. “What are your thoughts on their friendship?”

“As a teacher, I couldn't care less.” Aizawa replied tiredly. “As a foster parent, I want it to crash and burn.”

“Riso seemed fairly occupied. He hasn't had a single breakdown in a month.”

“He’s a good kid, I know. He just makes me so fucking tired.”

“Ah. Of course, what doesn’t?” Nezu chuckles.

“Oh!” Riso pulled out his journal. “I finished this support design for you.”

“I’m not officially a hero course student.” Shinso said, “…Why are you making me a support item?”

“I do it for everyone. I worked extra hard to make sure this one worked for you!”

“You have my interest piqued. What is it?”

Riso smiled and sat closer to Shinso. He opened the journal, showing him the blueprint and sketches.

“Since your quirk usually only works if people respond to you, when villains get knowledge of your quirk, they won’t respond to you. So, the support item is a mask. It has a few dials that can manipulate the sound waves when you speak to sound like a different person. So, while you’re talking you could make yourself sound like Aizawa, or Bakugo, or even Izuku!” Riso nods. “Though, it would be quite difficult for you if you couldn’t get the frequencies right. So, I also made sure to add a hologram only visible to you that shows the person’s voice waves and their specific frequency. That way, it’s easier for you to change to their voice!”

Shinso lets a small smile crept onto his face. “Okay, you’re smart. I’ll give you that.”

“Would you come and stop by the lab at some point? I need to take your measurements so it fits properly. It’ll need to be fitted to your face so it’s as comfortable as possible.”

“That works. Will tomorrow work for you?” Shinso fiddled with his fingers.

“Mhm! After school?”

Shinso looked at Aizawa. “Is that okay? To..uh..stay out after school.”

“Of course it is.” Aizawa nods.

Riso looked at Aizawa, then at Shinso.

“Maybe we can go to the cat cafe afterwards.” Shinso suggests. “Uh..for coffee. To see..Fluffball..”

Riso blushed, covering his face.

“I-I’d love to go,”

Shinso smiles softly. “Do you know when you blush, your ears turn red too?”

Riso looked at Shinso, then covered his ears. “They do-?”

Shinso chuckles and nods. “It’s..cute.”

“I-I need to go.” Riso stood up quickly. “See you tomorrow!” He quickly ran outside of the gym, disappearing.

“Shinso,” Aizawa says. “We need to go home.”

“Okay.”

The ride home was quiet. Aizawa glanced over at Shinso, who was looking out of the window. He sighs and taps his thumb in the steering wheel.

“So..Riso?” Aizawa asked.

“..I could ask you the same.” Shinso mutters.

“What do you mean?” Aizawa furrowed his eyebrows.

“Why’s he so important? I mean, everyone keeps mentioning breakdowns, and..how he hangs around the teachers.”

“Riso’s…a special case. His breakdowns are essentially his quirk overloading. He’s incredibly dangerous. He goes in this trance of creating, and anyone who tries to break him out ends up with an..injury. He’ll forget to eat, sleep, or take care of himself. If we keep him busy, it doesn’t happen.” Aizawa sighs. “He’s smart. We were never supposed to let him have a say in lesson plans, or let him hang around us as much. But, over time..the advice he suggested was good. Most of the staff grew attached to him and his ideas.”

“Nezu likes him, right? They have tea together.”

“That’s right.”

“Huh.” Shinso hums.

“Hey,” Aizawa looked at the road. “I know I’m not the best at this parent thing. When you want to talk about anything, I’m here.”

“I’m fine.”

“Are you sure?”

“Yes. I have nothing to talk about.”

The rest of the drive was quiet, but comfortable. Shinso watched the buildings and plants fly by the window carefully. He felt himself suppressed a yawn when the car came to a stop. He tiredly followed Aizawa to their apartment, and found himself in his bed by the blink of an eye. He had changed his clothes into something more comfortable before he laid down. His phone buzzed, he picked it up and read the text. It was from Riso.

hey sooo i didn’t ask. what colors would you like on the mask?? :p i have a few color designs, here’s some pictures!

****sent 3 photos****

Shinso looked over the pictures with a small smile.

i like the black and gray one, it’s simple and not flashy

cool! see you tomorrow after school <3

Shinso stared at his screen. *The heart. It can’t mean anything can it? Maybe it doesn’t. Shit. Why am I thinking so hard about this? I just need to try to sleep.*

Shinso, for the first time in a while, fell asleep.

Chapter End Notes

updates every wednesday and sundays! cosmic reveal soonnn also yes there are some very important hints in this chapter !

Chapter Twenty Three

Chapter Summary

> Shinso and Riso have a very eventful day as the two work on his support item together. Bakugo brings up his concerns to Aizawa about Izuku, and continues to help him and Cosmic avoid hero confrontations.

Chapter Notes

> super long chap hope you like it! this would've been up earlier but i fell asleep writing it lmao
>
> ALSO mineta gets expelled in this chapter and he says some sexual stuff about izuku so just beware and i really don't care if it sucked- personally i wanted him gone so i got rid of him

See the end of the chapter for more notes

> Shinso tiredly walked into the kitchen, rubbing the back of his sore neck. He walked to the coffee pot and poured himself a cup. He kept his eyes closed as he sipped the warm liquid slowly.
>
> "Morning," He spoke softly when Hizashi stepped in the kitchen.
>
> "Morning, kid!" Hizashi chirped. "Ready for today?"
>
> "No. I want a nap." Shinso grumbled, his ears tensing at the loudness of Hizashi's voice.
>
> "Ah, just like a little Sho." Hizashi chuckles. "Speaking of..he told me something last night."
>
> "Hm."

“You have a date with Riso?”

Shinso’s eyes opened wide as he spit out his coffee. A flush of red hit his cheeks, and he placed the cup down on the counter. He looked at Hizashi with shock and surprise written on his face.

“Wh..uh, what?” Shinso wiped his mouth, cleaning the spilt coffee.

“Sho told me,” Hizashi couldn’t contain his smile. “You asked him to go to the cat cafe after school.”

“Y-Yeah..so..??” Shinso turned away from Hizashi. “..We’re just going to a cafe.”

“On a date~” Hizashi teased. “Go get dressed for school before Sho wakes up.”

“Yeah.” Shinso placed his mug in the sink after rinsing it out. He found his way to his room, and opened his closet. He heard his phone buzz on the nightstand. He turned his head, grabbing his clothes. He laid them on the bed and picked up his phone. He smiled softly when he saw it was from Riso.

wish it was the end of the day already :(

Before Shinso could think of a reply, Riso texted again.

literally today is going to be so boring, nezu canceled our tea time

Shinso snickered, before typing a reply.

oh poor pity the teacher's pet

take that back !! >:(

never

yk what i'm going to pinch you on purpose when i'm fitting the mask

you wouldn't

i would! i've blown up a lab before, this is child's play

the more i talk to you the more concerned i get

awh don't worry about me! do you wanna meet up for lunch?

don't you have midoriya to sit with?

not anymore :p so wanna sit together or what

sure if you want

okokok! see you then <3

see you then

Shinso bit his lip softly after deleting his text. He looked off the side, gently moving his thumbs while debating if he should or not.

i'll see you then <3

Shinso quickly shut off his phone and threw it onto the floor. He shook his head and changed into his uniform, flattening it out in the mirror. He grabbed his things and walked out to the kitchen again.

"Good, you're ready." Aizawa nods. "Hizashi's going to drive you to school. I have some paperwork to finish before I head down to UA."

"Okay." Shinso turned to the door.

"Shinso."

"Mm."

"Take that coffee with you." Shinso turned and looked back at Aizawa, who had just sat down a coffee mug with a lid on the counter. Shinso took it slowly, nodding at Aizawa.

"Thanks."

In the car, Hizashi hummed along to the music that was playing from the radio. Shinso looked at the window, not wanting to admit Hizashi sounded really good. He couldn't get attached and go soft on them so quickly. Shinso sighed to himself. He looked at Hizashi hesitantly.

"Mic?"

“Yes?”

“How did you know you liked Aizawa?”

Hizashi paused, then chuckled. “Well, he was hard to like for a while. He was tired, blunt, and smelt.” He joked a little. “I was sitting in class one day, and he was being teased by..our mutual friend.”

Shinso noticed the sadden tone when he mentioned their friend, so he didn’t question it.

“We had been friends for a while, and one day I looked at him and he just..sparkled, I guess. All his imperfections became perfect to me. Loves a hard thing to explain, kiddo.”

“Oh.” Shinso huffed softly. “Did you ever get him gifts?”

“Sometimes, he never liked them though, at least I don’t think he did. He was hard to read most of the time, but he enjoyed more of the sentimental things. I used to get him flowers before we graduated, he’d act like he hated them but he would always smile at them when I wasn’t looking. I think everyone likes flowers, unless they’re allergic.” Hizashi chuckled. “Why, do you plan on getting Riso something?

“No!” Shinso said quickly. “I was just asking. Don’t try to look for a reason..”

“His favorite flowers are white roses and snapdragons.”

“…Thanks.”

“Of course, no problem.” Hizashi smiles brightly.

The two of them reached the school shortly after their conversation. Before Shinso got out, Hizashi stopped him.

“Since we’re here a little earlier than the rest of the students, do you want to hang out in the teachers lounge?”

“Is it quiet and is there coffee?”

“Yes.”

“I’m in.”

Shinso and Hizashi walked together, the halls were eerily quiet. Once he walked in the lounge with Hizashi, he could feel the eyes on him.

“Could you stop staring?” Shinso asked aloud to no one in particular.

“Not a morning person?” Ah, he recognized that voice. Midnight.

“Not at all.” Shinso sat at a table, placing his empty coffee cup from the house on the smooth surface.

“Just like Shota,” Nemuri snickered. “Would you like some more coffee then?”

“Please.”

Nemuri poured the coffee into his cup, and sat in front of him. She tilted her head slightly. She glanced over to Vlad, who nodded in return.

“What was that?” Hizashi asked Shinso’s thoughts. Shinso twirled his tie anxiously.

“Oh, y'know. Just the little pest problem we have.” Nemuri’s voice was lined with a jokeful tone. Maybe it was a joke Shinso didn’t understand.

“Right,” Hizashi chuckled. “I see.”

The teacher’s lounge door opened, and Shinso looked over. In the doorframe stood Riso, who’s hair wasn’t brushed, and his uniform wasn't on properly. Shinso felt Riso locked eyes with him. He gave a small wave, but Riso squeaked in surprise and slammed the door shut.

“..Did I do something?” Shinso muttered.

“Not at all, kid.” Snipe spoke up. “Riso usually doesn’t get completely ready until five minutes before school starts. You probably startled him by being here.”

“Snipe, I don’t think Shinso knows about his living arrangements.” Nemuri leans back in the chair, squeaking slightly.

“..living arrangements?” Shinso questioned, feeling the tension in the lounge growing.

“Riso lives here.” Nemuri was the first to speak. “There’s an old teachers lounge we had renovated into an apartment.”

Shinso blinks. He furrowed his eyebrows. “He lives here.”

“Mhm.”

“He lives at UA.”

“It’s to keep an eye on him, and to make sure he doesn’t blow anything up.” Snipe mentions, Vlad nodded in agreement.

“Kid can get pretty dangerous when overwhelmed.”

“What did his parents say about it?”

“Has he really not told you that either? He’s technically an orphan. Sho says not to say that because his parents aren’t dead, but they basically are.” Hizashi says. “They’re not around to care for him. Nezu came up with the solution.”

Shinso was quiet. Riso seemed to struggle with so much, at the same time he acted happy so often. That one night he helped him calm from a possible panic attack was definitely a sight, but from what he knows from others Riso never ever seemed genuinely upset. This bothered him, so he figured he’d get to the bottom of it.

The door reopened, and this time Riso’s uniform was in order and his hair was brushed. He walks in, hands tight on his messenger back. He avoided eye contact with Shinso as he walked over to get a cup of coffee.

“Remember, no more than half a cup.” Nemuri reminds, her smirk seemed to be more teasing than informative.

“Not fair.” Riso muttered, wrapping his hands around the cup. He sat at the table, next to Shinso.

“Morning, Riso.” Shinso said quietly.

“Hi. I-I mean, morning.” Shinso watched as Riso began to blush, and covered his reddened ears. He laughs softly to himself.

Does he think covering his ears makes it harder to see if he’s blushing? That just makes it more obvious. Cute.

“Rough morning?” Shinso gently shook his mug, watching the dark liquid swirl in the middle. He looked over at Riso with curious eyes.

“Heh, yeah. Didn’t know you were gonna be in here..” Riso placed his hands around his mug again.

“Mic let me up here. Since I was a little early.” Shinso replied casually, tapping his thumb on his cup. The white porcelain was cool to the touch, the steam from the coffee only seemed to warm the air. He felt his hands shake a little. Why was he so nervous?

“Have you seen the support course lab?” Riso asked with hopeful eyes, or what Shinso could assume was hopeful eyes since he couldn’t see them. Shinso shook his head, and as he went to reply the door burst open.

“I AM HERE…for coffee.” All Might said, in his muscle form. He began to smoke and he changed back with a poof. He sighed softly.

Shinso stared at him with concern, he was glad he didn’t drink any coffee because if he did, that would’ve been the second time he spit out it out today. His lips were parted in surprise, and his eyes were slightly wide. All Might had the same reaction, and he tried to put back on his muscle form.

“Don’t strain yourself.” Riso said, anger flowing nicely with the sound of his voice. “You still have a class to teach, don’t be stupid.”

Shinso looked at Riso.

“Riso-” All Might began.

“It’s Sakusei to you. I’ve said it before, and I *won’t* say it again without violence.” Riso visibly gripped the coffee cup. Shinso could basically see the anger rise up his body as if he were an animated character.

Before All Might could respond, Shinso stood abruptly.

“Can I see the support course lab?” He asked Riso softly. Riso looked up at him, his grip on the cup loosened. He smiled and stood up.

“Of course!” Riso grabbed Shinso’s hand. He waved to everyone but All Might before pulling Shinso out the room and down the hall. “It’s so great, it’s basically my second home!”

“You can’t possibly spend that much time in there.” Shinso tightened his grip on Riso’s hand so as to not fall behind. Riso walked faster when he was excited, apparently.

“Oh I do!” Riso laughed lightly. At some point, the two of them were basically running down the hall together. Riso stopped in front of a large door, and threw it open. On the inside was a support course student’s dream. There were parts everywhere, tables filled with materials and unfinished products.

“Holy shit. You guys live like this?” Shinso blinked, “It’s so cluttered. How can you even walk through this mess?”

“Usually it’s a bit cleaner, I’ll admit.” Riso pulled Shinso into the room, walking over to his area. Surprisingly, his was the most clean. He sat down on his stool, pulling one over for Shinso to sit on. “Sit!”

Shinso sat down, slowly looking around. There were probably about hundreds of small mock designs of support items. He grabbed one of them.

“Hey! That’s my design for Kaminari!” Riso smiled. “So Hatsume helped me come up with it! Hatsume works under me directly because our work complements each other’s!”

“Oh? What does it to do?”

“Well when I was talking with Kaminari he mentioned how he can never direct where the electricity goes. So, Hatsume and I came up with the brilliant idea to use these disks as a pinpoint location for the electricity to flow to if he’s within ten meters.” Riso began to spiral down a hole while he explained the gadget in detail. Although Shinso found out about halfway through, it’s still heavily in development. Shinso watched carefully as Riso moved his hands during his explanations, and followed along with any diagram he was being shown. Riso’s smile seemed to light up the room with how passionate he was for support items. Shinso admired it. The two of them had their time together cut short by a giggle and a few snickers heard behind him.

“ *There’s a boy actually talking to him?* ” One whispered.

“ *I bet he was paid.* ”

“ *He’s that kid from the sports festival. Maybe they’re both meant for each other.* ”

“ *You mean they’re both losers and don’t belong at UA?* ”

The whispers somehow were so loud. Riso stood, eyes trained on the ground and the smaller model of a support item he was explaining. He gripped it tightly, motioning to Shinso.

“You should go. Um..get ready for the school day. I’ll be fine..” Riso never looked up.

“I can stay,” Shinso began.

“No. Just..please go?” Riso swallowed hard. “It’s easier if you go.”

“Riso,” Shinso said softly, “Are you sure? If they’re making fun of you-”

“Go. Please.”

Shinso frowned slightly. “Okay. Text me if you need me.” He walked past the other second year support course students who were snickering, pointing and laughing at Riso. They stared Shinso down as he walked past, and followed him with their eyes until he was gone from their sight. Shinso noticed the hallway was much more crowded than before. How long were the two of them in there together?

Shinso shook his head and pulled out his phone. His hands hovered over the keyboard under Riso’s contact. He bit his lip, trying to find what to say without bringing up what happened before he left. He settled on a text after a few minutes of debating.

thanks for showing me the lab, i had fun. you’re really smart

Shinso watched as the ‘sent’ turned into ‘seen’ and his heart skipped a beat. He watched the three dots dance across his screen as he waited for a response.

of course! sorry about how it ended, my classmates can be kinda rude. don’t forget to come back later today so i can fit that mask ^-^

Shinso smiled. Riso always used the cutest symbols and emojis, it made him seem easier to talk to.

i’ll be there

Shinso shut off his phone and went into class.

Izuku's class was fucking chaos. Somehow, Denki got ahold of one of the two polaroids Cosmic had taken of the Bakugo and Izuku sleeping together. Izuku didn't think too much of it, he had thought maybe he took it with him and dropped it by accident. Unknown to Izuku, it was actually in Bakugo's bag, Denki had just gone through it and found it. Izuku was sure Bakugo was going to kill someone.

"I'LL FUCKING KILL YOU, YOU DAMN BASTARD" Bakugo yelled, a scowl on his face. He sparked a blast with his hand. Denki hid behind Kirishima, who had hardened his quirk.

"Aw but the two of you are so innocent looking!" Denki smirked, "I didn't know you two were so close!"

"WE'RE NOT!"

"Seems like you are~" Mina teased, Sero nodding and following her up with an 'Agreed'.

"Bakugo! Please calm down and refrain from using your-"

"SHUT UP FOUR-EYES."

Uraraka, Tsu, Hagakure, Momo and Jirou were all looking at the photo. Momo tilts her head, a small smile on her face.

"Yknow, I don't think I've ever seen Bakugo smile." She said in a low voice so Bakugo couldn't hear her. "He's got a subtle smile. See it?"

“You’re right!” Hagakure nods, then pauses when she realizes no one can see her head movements. “I see it.”

“That’s so adorable,” Uraraka smiles. “I knew they were childhood friends, but that’s just adorable.”

“Seems to be more than friends if you ask me.” Jirou twirled her headphone jack with her finger. “I don’t think friends cuddle like that. Not men at least.”

“I agree. It looks romantic, ribbit.”

Mina and Sero continued to tease Bakugou, as Kirishima protected the two of them and Denki. Mineta leaned over the girl's shoulders to look at the picture.

“He looks fuckable like that.” Mineta said with a twisted smile on his face. Jirou poked him in the eye with her headphone jack.

“Gross, asshole.” She groaned.

“But it’s true!! Why would you do that to me??” Mineta whines, holding his eye.

“Say that again.” Bakugo suddenly turned to Mineta, a murderous glint in his eye.

“..u-uh..”

“Say it again, small fry. I fucking dare you.”

“I’m- uh..no.”

Bakugo picked Mineta up by his shirt, ignoring his squirming.

“What the *fuck* is wrong with you.”

“You think so too!! I know you do, you-” Bakugo growled at Mineta’s comment and blasted him into the wall. It broke, and Mineta hit the ground unconscious.

No one said anything, but rather sat in their seats to wait for Aizawa to come in. Once he opened the door, he looked at Mineta in the back of the room.

“Should I ask?” He sighed.

“Mineta was being gross again and made a comment about Deku, then Bakugo blasted him into a wall.” Mina laid back in her seat. “Well deserved if you ask me.”

“…Yeah.” Aizawa nods. “I’ll have to talk to Nezu about him.”

During the class activity, that’s exactly what he did. He walked into Nezu’s office, hands stuffed in his pockets.

“Ah! Aizawa. What brings you in?”

“I want to expel a student.”

“Mhm. Then enroll them again?”

“No. Permanently.”

“Oh my, that’s quite unexpected. Of course, who is it?”

“Minoru Mineta.”

“Mm, I see. Is there a reason?” Nezu pulled out a file from his desk and put it in front of Aizawa.

“Sexual harassment and assault. The girls have told me he’s tried to look in their locker room as well. Just this afternoon he made a comment about Midoriya which caused Bakugo to blast him into a wall.”

“Okay. He’ll be expelled. Do any of the affected individuals need a sessions with Hound Dog?”

“I’ll ask, but I don’t think so.”

Aizawa swiftly walked out the door. He began to make his way back to his classroom when he saw Bakugo leaning against the wall waiting for him.

“Bakugo. Why aren’t you in class?”

“I needed to tell you something.” Bakugo leaned his head against the wall. “It’s about Deku.”

“Okay. What is it? Is it about the comment Mineta made earlier?”

“What? No. This isn’t about small fry. Look, I don’t think Deku’s eatin’ right.” Bakugo looked away from Aizawa. “I said I wouldn’t say anything but I’m..I just want him to be at his best so I can kick his ass!”

“So you’re worried about him.”

“No, shut up.”

“Bakugo, he lost his mom early this year. And you and your whole class went through something traumatic. It makes sense, but I’ll talk to him. He’s more than welcome to take food home from-”

“He’s living alone in that damned apartment.” Bakugo blurted out. He had gotten up from the wall, and his fists were tightly closed. “I went to see him last night about something, and he didn’t even have fucking power!”

Aizawa stared at Bakugo. “That’s not right. His father should’ve come back from America. That’s what the police agreed on.”

“Well guess fucking what? His piece of shit dad ain’t ever been there for him! He’s caused Deku more harm than good!” Bakugo’s hands began to spark. “I don’t want him living in a cold apartment, alone. My mom won’t take him in because she’s a fucking bitch, and I know he’s gonna hate me more than he already does for tellin’.”

Aizawa was silent as he processed the information just thrown at him. He sighed, putting a hand to his forehead.

“Okay, I’ll see what I can do about it. Thank you for telling me. I won’t say you said anything. Go back to class.” Bakugo scoffed and walked back to the classroom, Aizawa opened his phone.

zashi

yo yo! teaching but what’s up?

we have to talk about midoriya

oh shit

okay. after school then, sho?

yeah

Aizawa pocketed his phone. He paused, then turned to the side slightly.

“You keep quiet too.” Aizawa said. “I know you heard that, and you better not tell anyone. Understood, Riso?”

Riso came out from around the corner he was hiding behind. “How’d you know I was there?”

“I can basically sense you. Now I mean it.” Aizawa dismisses him. “Don’t say anything.”

“Okay, okay. I won’t.”

Riso pushed Bakugo into a wall after all classes had been dismissed. He was holding him by the side of the building. Bakugo grunted and lifted his arm to blast him.

“THE HELL?!”

“Quiet.” Riso growled. “Why the fuck would you do that?”

“What the hell are you talking about, pinky-pie?!”

“Telling Aizawa about Izuku! That wasn’t your place to say anything.”

“I’ve known him longer than anyone. Shut up. You don’t know anything.”

“You’re an idiot! Bakugo, there are no foster homes around here for him to go to! Saying that to Aizawa means he’s going to be placed around! He can’t take that??”

“What do you know, huh?? How do you know that??”

“Because we’re friends! I didn’t know his living situation was that bad, but it’s still not okay to say anything! I want him to have help but he’s doing what he can.”

“I’ll do what I fucking want!”

“You’re making it harder for him!”

“I’ll fucking kill you!”

“..Kacchan? Riso?” Izuku stood next to the corner, watching the two argue. “..What’s going on?”

“Nothing.” The two of them said in sync, and backed away from each other.

“It’s nothing.” Riso smiled gently. “Sorry.”

“Whatever.” Bakugo rolled his eyes. He walked past Izuku, who grabbed his arm.

“Kacchan, wait. Are..are you coming over today?”

“Why the fuck would I come over?” Bakugo growled. He saw Izuku motion with his hands, trying to be subtle enough to not alarm Riso.

Oh, right. Deku’s a vigilante.

“Yeah. I’ll be there.” Bakugo walked away, pulling his arm from Izuku. Izuku went to ask Riso what happened, but he was gone too.

“What just happened..?” He muttered to himself.

Riso walked the hallways, making his way to the lab. He felt bad for yelling at Bakugo, but he knew what it was like to have someone try to help you and it backfire. He wanted to avoid any conflict whatsoever, since Izuku seemed really happy around Bakugo. He sighed, picking at his fingernails as he walked. He noticed, and quickly placed his hands behind his back to prevent his picking.

Unfortunately for Riso, the same group of classmates from before began to laugh and snicker at the sight of him. Riso looked towards them when he felt his feet being swept from under him. He fell face first, and since his hands were behind his back he didn’t have time to catch himself. He hit the floor, his nose instantly began to bleed when it came in contact with the ground. He quickly forced himself to sit up, and he put a hand to his nose. He felt the blood seep through his fingers before he stood up quickly and ran into the lab. He hurriedly tried to grab a rag from his desk with a surprised voice coming from next to him.

“Riso? Woah! What happened to your face?!” Hatsume shouted, “Your nose is bleeding!”

“No, really?” Riso replied sarcastically. He grabbed the rag and pressed it to his nose. “What are you doing in the second year lab?”

“I came to ask for your approval for one of my babies, but now you’re hurt! Do I need to call Recovery Girl?”

“No, I have to meet someone. My nose can wait.”

“You’re bleeding, Riso. Doesn’t that count for something??”

“Oh I don’t want to hear it from you, little miss ‘I basically severed my finger off but let me finish my baby first’.”

“Hey!! It was time sensitive!”

“..Is this a bad time?” Shinso asked from the doorframe. Riso turned his back to him, and glared at Hatsume.

“No! Come in! Hatsume, get out.”

“You have a bOY OVER!?” Hatsume squeaked. “Oh my goodness this-!”

“I said go!” Riso whined and pushed her forward. She protested but left, and Shinso walked in.

“I didn’t know you were that close with her.” Shinso says, setting his bag down.

“Heh, yeah..We spend a lot of time together, especially on days off when we’re in the lab. Power Loader makes jokes about us being siblings because of our hair.”

“I don’t think it’s just the hair.” Shinso chuckled. He looked at Riso, who was still hiding his face from him. “Why won’t you look at me?”

“Um..-! No- no reason.”

“You’re going to have to look at me if you want to fit the mask.” Shinso placed a hand on his shoulder.

“I-I know..! You..just can’t see me like this.”

“Like what? Riso, look at me.”

Riso slowly turned to Shinso, his eyes adverted to the ground. Shinso gasped softly, cupping his face.

“What the hell? Why is your nose broken??”

“I- fell! That’s it, I fell.” Riso blushed, placing a hand on his wrist. “It’s okay, please leave it alone.”

“Just..let me clean it up. Then straight to Recovery Girl before we go to the cafe.” Shinso grabbed the rag that Riso had on the table, which was covered in blood. “Sit. I’ll be right back.”

Riso sat quietly. He nervously tapped his thigh with his index finger. He felt embarrassed getting taken care of. He had done it himself for so long it was out of his comfort zone to be taken care of by someone else. Shinso came back with a damp rag and a few other things. He sat in front of Riso and pressed the rag to his face.

“So are you going to tell me what really happened or pretend you just fell?” He asked softly with a sigh.

“I did fall..!” Riso said, glancing off to the side.

“Sure.” Shinso went to press the cool rag to the upper part of his nose when he paused. He gently placed his finger under his hair. “..Can I..?”

Riso froze. He slowly nodded. “Not too much.”

Shinso gently brushed Riso’s hair away from his nose. He saw light colored freckles cross the bridge of Riso’s nose. He paused, smiling softly.

“I didn’t know you had freckles.”

Riso blushed, slapping Shinso’s check. “Shut up..”

Once Shinso finished cleaning up Riso’s broken nose, he got up and put the things away. He sat back down and smiled tiredly.

“Okay. Let’s do what I came here for.”

“Okay!”

Riso began his work. He immediately went over the plans for the mask, and its limitations. It was hard to focus when Riso kept getting distracted and going on a tangent about his other inventions. It took Shinso by surprise when Riso suddenly grabbed his face and pulled it close.

Shinso felt his face turn rose red as Riso began to measure his face. Soon after, Riso was close enough that Shinso could feel his breath lightly.

“Okay! This works!” Riso presented Shinso with his mask. “Put it on!”

Shinso gently placed it on his face. It almost seemed to mold to his face with how perfect it was. He looked at Riso, who clapped excitedly.

“Okay so I changed the sound waves for it to sound like Aizawa! Give it a shot!”

“…Okay. Wh- this is really surprising.” Shinso was shocked to hear his voice as his foster parent. It sounded just like him, all Shinso had to do was mimic his mannerisms and then he’d be a clone of Aizawa.

“Right?? Oh I’m so glad it works!” Riso smiled. “I’ll tweak anything necessary but it’s basically yours!”

Riso took it off of Shinso, and put it aside. The two of them cleaned up and Shinso grabbed Riso’s hand as they went towards the entrance of the door.

“Recovery Girl’s office. Remember?” He said sternly. “Let’s go.”

Riso huffed and followed along with Shinso. As the two walked together, Riso spoke up.

“I’m sorry I didn’t make it to lunch.”

“It’s okay. I didn’t see you with anyone else, so I know you didn’t ditch me.”

“Yeah, I got busy trying to help Hatsume with an assignment. Time ran over and..I feel really bad.”

“I’m serious, Riso. It’s okay.”

“Are you sure it’s okay?”

“You apologize so much.”

“I know, I'm a hypocrite. I tell Izuku not to apologize so much but here I am.”

“You and Midoriya are close, why’s that?”

“Well..we both like cats. I dunno, we kind of clicked. He’s like..a brother, I guess. But not in the super brotherly way? Just in the.. ‘I’d kill for you’ way.”

“So best friends.”

“Yeah! If you can call it that,” Riso opened the door to Recovery Girl’s office. “Recovery Girl! I come bearing another bruise!”

“It’s broken. Not a bruise.”

“…I come bearing a broken nose!”

While Recovery Girl fixed Riso’s nose, Shinso texted Hizashi.

hey mic?

what’s up little listener?? aren’t you on that date????

it's not a date, and no we got held up. can i ask a favor of you?

sure what's up kiddo

can you get me flowers?

ayyy taking my advice huh? i am a men magnet you should always trust my advice 😎

with snapdragons and white roses

so it IS a date

please just do it, i'll pay you back later but i don't have time to pick them up myself

you got it!

After the trip to Recovery Girl, the two of them walked to the cafe together. Riso linked their arms, pointing at things he found interesting. Shinso added his own thoughts and even opened up and pointed out a few of his own. Apparently, butterflies are scary according to Riso.

"They're scary! Their faces are disgusting, their legs tickle my skin if they touch me, and they fly too fast." Were his words exactly.

Before they entered the cafe, Shinso told Riso he needed to do something really fast, that he would be back and to head inside without him. He approached the small floral shop Hizashi made the order at. He picked up a beautiful bouquet of snapdragons, white roses, daffodils and more little flowers. He thanked and paid for the bouquet and walked back towards the

cafe. He nervously glanced at the flowers, and went to open the door to the cafe. He paused when he saw Riso.

In front of Riso stood a man about as tall as him, talking to him. Shinso was going to shrug it off, until he leaned forward and hugged Riso. Shinso narrowed his eyes and kept watching. The man cupped Riso's face, his ears and cheeks reddening. Shinso stepped back, feeling the flowers slip from his hands. It hit the ground and the flowers barely slipped from the plastic wrap. The man kissed his cheek and that's when Shinso turned around. He walked away quickly, the wind from his suddenly movement caused a flower to roll out into the sidewalk as if it were trying to follow Shinso.

It was a daffodil.

Shinso got home and he face planted onto the couch. He didn't have the energy to make it to his bed.

"Hey, kiddo! Everything okay?" Hizashi asked, setting down his cup on the counter.

"No." His voice was muffled.

"What happened? Aren't you supposed to be with Riso?"

"I don't want to talk about it. Can you make me some coffee?" Shinso sat up and hugged the throw pillow. "And can we watch a movie?"

"Of course, kid. Sho's taking a nap, so he might come out a bit later." Hizashi walked to the coffee pot and started brewing some coffee. "Pick whatever you want to watch."

Shinso picked up the remote and smiled when Aiko came and sat next to him with a meow. He gently pet under her chin. He sighed, settling on some animated movie. He looked down at his phone, which had no notifications. He turned it off and threw it on the couch. He held the pillow tighter, and grabbed the cup from Hizashi when he handed it to him.

-

Cosmic swung through Izuku's balcony door.

"I need someone to beat up." He jumped over the side of the couch, sitting down. "Also I see you got power back."

"Cosmic, don't scare me like that!"

"Yeah, scar-face." Bakugo's voice came from behind Cosmic in the kitchen. Cosmic whipped around with a confused luck.

"Holy shit you scared me. Hey, wanna spar?" Cosmic had a wicked grin on his face, which was covered by his mask but Izuku knew that smile just by his eyes.

"You can't get beat up when you're frustrated."

"Says who? C'mon, blasty! Hit me."

Bakugo looked at Izuku, who gave him a disapproving look. He turned to Cosmic. He smirked and cracked his knuckles.

"Hah. Don't say I didn't warn you." Bakugo swung at Cosmic, who grabbed his arm and flipped him over his shoulder. He laid Bakugo out on the ground, twisting his arm back to prevent him from moving.

"I thought you were better than that." Cosmic huffed as Bakugo groaned in slight pain.

“Fucker, you didn’t tell me you were gonna attack!”

“You should’ve expected it, blasty! You really think I'm gonna let anyone get a free hit on me?”

Bakugo got to his feet, and took a fighting stance. He didn’t give an indication on when he was going to attack. But when he kicked to throw Cosmic off, he simply jumped to dodge it. Bakugo growled in frustration, and began to attack faster.

Cosmic dodged most of his attacks with ease. Until Bakugo managed to grab his face and set off a small blast. Cosmic stumbled back, placing a hand to his cheek.

“Okay, yeah. You got me.”

“I’m not done yet, scar-face!” Bakugo grabbed Cosmic’s collar and threw him into the wall, which crumbled lightly. Cosmic gasped for the air that was knocked out of him, but he seemed to smirk.

“Finally someone who can kick my ass.” Cosmic chuckled between a few coughs.

“Hey! I do pretty good!” Izuku whined.

“Sure you do! I’m just better. Alright, get ready. Zuku, we’re headin’ out!”

It only took the three of them a few minutes to get set up to leave. Cosmic and Izuku went out the balcony door and Bakugo’s voice crackled in their ears.

“ *Can you hear me?* ”

“Loud and clear, blasty!”

“ *Don’t fucking call that!* ”

“Don’t tell me what to do.”

“Kacchan, be nice!”

“ *Don’t call me that either. Dumbass, they’re gonna know it’s me and then you by process of elimination!* ”

Cosmic snickered. “Call him Kat.”

“ *Do not.* ”

“I think Kat is nice. Okay! Kat, where’s our first crime?”

“ *Near the market. Calls made to the heros state there's an intoxicated man threatening people with his quirk. Which is..some weapon quirk.* ”

“Thanks, blasty!” Cosmic and Izuku made their way to the market. Cosmic landed on the ground from the roof effortlessly, Izuku doing the same. They looked around and spotted the intoxicated man.

“Hey! I think you should go home, bud.” Cosmic placed a hand on his shoulder. The man turned around in a flash and punched Cosmic in the face. Cosmic felt his skin sting as his eyes watered from being punched in the nose. He stumbled back, holding it.

“Did you just fucking hit me with brass knuckles?!” He glared. “Oh you little bastard. Nexus, tase his ass.”

Izuku felt his relaxed posture turn into defensive. He lunches forward, using his staff to taste him. He stiffened, causing him to freeze for a few moments. In those few moments, Cosmic managed to get him on the ground and tied him up with rope and zip ties. Izuku put a capture net over him just in case. The net canceled quirks, so that asshole wasn’t getting out.

The two continued this for hours, with their new sidekick Bakugo to help lead them to and away from anything needed. Cosmic told Izuku to go home without him. For the first time in a while, Cosmic wanted to get home and sleep. He sighed, running across the roof of the buildings alone. He’d probably been punched so many times in the nose in the last twenty four hours it could probably be a world record. It was already broken from the first brass knuckles guy, but now it was just in constant pain. Cosmic arrived at his apartment window.

He slid it open, jumping inside. He closed it back and threw off his hood. He ruffled his hair in attempt to undo the insane hat hair his hood gave him. He took off his mask as well, throwing it to the side. He turned around and paused when he saw an on lamp near the couch. His eyes looked a little to the left and he froze when he saw a familiar person sitting on the couch.

“Ah, shit. Hey, Eraser.”

Chapter End Notes

fun fact, daffodils mean unrequited love. i wonder if that’s what shinso is thinking happened..?

let’s hope aizawa didn’t see cosmic come through his window either >:3

updates every wednesday and sunday!

Chapter Twenty Four

Chapter Summary

Shinso and Riso clean up what happened at the Cafe, as Aizawa confronts Izuku with an ultimatum to get out of his shitty apartment.

Chapter Notes

hehe i hope you guys like this one >:3

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Riso sat in the teacher's lounge, eyes focused on his empty cup. The teachers around him were talking, but everything was muffled. His mind was swirling with thoughts from the previous day. He slowly looked up when the door opened. In walked Aizawa, who was already holding a cup of coffee. The two stared at each other.

"Riso."

"..Mr. Aizawa." His voice was quiet and tense. The teachers around the two seemed shocked Riso used the term 'mister' when he hadn't in a very long time. The air in the lounge began dense before Nemuri stepped up to break the tension.

"Riso, honey." She sat in front of him. "You and I need to talk later. Okay?"

"I'm..going to my lab. Bye." Riso stood, walking out the lounge. Aizawa seemed preoccupied on his own thoughts, seemingly staring at the counter as if it was a movie he'd been wanting to see.

"Ah, shit. Hey, Eraser."

Aizawa stared at Cosmic, slowly standing to his feet. "Do you know how long it took to find you?"

"Uh, considering you showed up in my apartment just now…Ever since we met?" Cosmic shrugged. He slipped off his sweater and threw it onto a chair.

"You seem unbothered now that I know who you are."

"Eh. It was bound to happen. Besides, I've gotten punched in the nose too many times to care right now."

"Sho?" Hizashi's voice broke Aizawa's memory. "Are you okay? You're normally not this spacey. You've been like this since you came home last night."

"Hm? No, I'm fine." Aizawa sipped his coffee. "Work ran late, that's all." He made no attempt to speak about his encounter with the trouble-making vigilante who's been a pain in his ass as long as he could remember.

"If you say so..Make sure you check on Shinso. He still seems torn up from what happened."

"Yeah." Aizawa hummed quietly. He looked down at his mug and sighed. He placed it on the counter. "I'll be back."

Aizawa walked out and down to his classroom, where Shinso was sitting. He figured he'd be in there, it was probably the easiest place to hide. Aizawa sat down next to Shinso, leaning his head back against the wall behind them.

"You don't have to act like you care." Shinso muttered, pulling his knees to his chest.

“I’m not acting.” Aizawa looked at Shinso. “Whatever happened with him, you can talk about.”

“I can’t.”

“You can, but you don’t have to. Hizashi and I know it’s tearing you up. Just know we’re here to talk to.”

“Aizawa?” Shinso asked quietly. “Is it me?”

“Hm?”

“I mean..everything that always goes wrong? It’s because of me. So is it my fault?” Shinso looked up at Aizawa. His eyes were tinted red, and red dots speckled his face. He sniffled softly and wiped his nose with his sleeve.

“What? No.” Aizawa’s expression softens. “Shinso, it’s not your fault at all. I don’t know what happened, but it can’t be your fault at all. Do you understand me?”

“How could it not be? Think about it, who’d want to be with a kid who’s got a villainous quirk anyway..?” Shinso rested his head on his arms, looking away from Aizawa.

“God, Midnight, I’m so stupid!” Riso placed his head on his desk. Nemuri placed a gentle hand on his shoulder, giving a sympathetic face.

“You’re not stupid, Riso..”

“I am!” Riso picks his head up and then slams it on the desk. “I completely messed up everything. This is why I don’t talk to people!”

“Well, I’d like to know what happened so I can give my thoughts on the matter.” Nemuri sat next to Riso. “Is that okay?”

Riso tilted his head to look at her, before he let out a soft whine while lifting his head up.

“I think Shinso thinks I’m not interested in him.”

“But that’s clearly not true, you never shut up about him.” Nemuri chuckles softly. “You two were supposed to go on a date yesterday afternoon, so what happened?”

“Well..”

“Hey, I’ll be right back. I think I dropped something back there, I’ll be just a second.” Shinso said, motioning for Riso to go into the cafe alone. Riso nodded, and immediately went to go find Fluffball.

“Riso?” A voice came from the opposite side of the cafe, and Riso looked their way. He paused, feeling his body’s muscles tensing. “My goodness, it’s been forever.”

“Ikari,” Riso’s voice was quiet. “Hi.”

“You know, you were completely right about this place. Can’t believe we never came here together.” Ikari smirked and walked close to Riso.

“I’m..I’m waiting for someone, maybe you should go ahead and..-” Riso held Fluffball closer to his chest, petting his fur nervously.

“And what? Don’t tell me you’re still caught up about how things ended.”

“You threw me against a bookshelf, Ikari.. That’s not easy to get over..” Riso had his eyes trained on his shoes.

“Not my fault you were freaking on. C’mon, give me a hug.” Ikari opened his arms and wrapped Riso in a tight hug. Fluffball jumped from Riso’s arms and sat next to his foot. Riso felt his face flush red with anger and embarrassment. He shoved Ikari off of him.

He didn’t speak, but grabbed his things and headed for the door. He swung it open, his heart seemed to crumble when he saw Shinso walking away from the cafe.

“Ouch. That misunderstanding is probably hard to explain. I never liked Ikari.” Nemuri huffed, crossing her arms. “Did you try to text him?”

“No. I should've, but it felt unfair. Whatever he saw, I didn’t think it was okay for me to text him saying ‘it’s not what it looked like!’.” Riso fiddled with a screwdriver. “I never wanted things to end up this confusing. I want to talk to him but my brain feels so fried..”

“I can talk to him for you? Or maybe to Sho and Hizashi.” Nemuri gives him a reassuring smile. “I think we should maybe get you to Nezu, I’m worried your brain is under stimulated but overworking.”

“It’s okay. Um, can I just get back to working? Hatsume needs this prototype when class starts.” Riso looked down at his workspace. Nemuri nodded.

“Okay. Let me know if you need anything.”

Izuku stared at Bakugo, who had his arms crossed. He narrowed his eyes at Izuku.

“You and scar-face are supposed to be best friends. So you’re telling me you didn’t notice anything weird about him last night?”

“Of course I did! He wanted to get hurt, I got that. But he’s just like that sometimes.” Izuku says, “He does it when he’s really frustrated or just bored. Sometimes it’s incredibly hard to tell the difference.”

Bakugo grumbled and opened the classroom door. “Don’t be a fucking distraction today. Got it?”

“Why would I be a distraction, Kacchan?” Izuku asked innocently, tilting his head. Bakugo growled and put a hand to Izuku’s face. He shoved him back and walked inside the classroom.

“Deku!” Uraraka giggled and ran up to him. “Did you hear??”

“Hear what?” Izuku walked into the classroom.

“Mineta got expelled!” Hagakure clapped. “Apparently Mr. Aizawa took care of him!”

“Glad he’s gone.” Todoroki muttered. Ojiro looked over and nodded.

“He made everyone really uncomfortable.” Ojiro looked at Shoji. “I’m surprised it took this long.”

“He definitely wasn’t fit to be a hero. Ribbit.”

Aizawa walked into the classroom earlier than what he’s scheduled for, looking at Izuku.

“You. Come with me.” He turned around, and Izuku gulped. He looked at Bakugo, who rolled his eyes but gave him a supportive look. He sat his bag next to Bakugo and then quickly followed after Aizawa.

“U-uh..sir? What’s this about..?”

“We need to talk.” Aizawa opened a door to an empty, smaller lounge. “You’ve been hiding something from me.” He motioned for Izuku to sit. Izuku gulped, feeling his anxiety rise.

He couldn’t know about me being Nexus, right? Or maybe he knows I’m close with Cosmic?? Oh no, whatever it is he looks really mad..

Aizawa sat in front of Izuku and crossed his arms.

“Sir..what..what am I hiding..-?”

“You told the police,” Aizawa starts. “That your father was actively in the picture. You’ve been living alone, in an apartment that’s basically abandoned because your father doesn’t pay for anything.”

“..what?” Izuku furrowed his eyebrows. He was grateful it wasn’t relating to his vigilante life, but this wasn’t exactly good either.

“You can’t live alone at your age.”

“I can’t go anywhere else! It’s my mom's place, it’s one of the last things I have of her.” Izuku shook his head. “I can’t leave. I can’t leave my mom.”

“Midoriya.” Aizawa said cautiously. “I understand. I know it’s hard. You’re barely able to take care of yourself while juggling UA. It can’t feel good to go home to a cold apartment after a long day at school.”

Izuku shook his head again, feeling his hands shake. “No, it’s comforting. It’s my mom’s place.”

“Look, I’m legally obligated to report your situation. Your living conditions? They’re unstable and unsafe. If your father can’t step up, which I don’t want him to considering I read his file, you have to go into foster care.”

“I can’t leave..”

“Hey,” Aizawa’s voice was soft. “I know. It’s not ideal. I’ll tell you what,”

Izuku looked at Aizawa with sad eyes. Eyes that were screaming for someone to care.

“We will go on a class trip to enhance everyone’s quirks and train soon. When we get back, you’ll move out of the apartment. Each teacher, not including All Might, has an emergency foster license. Pick a teacher to move in with afterwards. Is that okay?”

“Mhm.” Izuku looked down. “Thank you..for..for giving me time.”

“Of course. Though, if you need anything, you let me or Present Mic know. Understood?”

“Understood..”

Aizawa dismissed Izuku, and looked out the window.

“I don’t understand.” Aizawa looked at Cosmic. “Why do you do this? Why be a vigilante?”

“Why not?” Cosmic walked to his bathroom, then walked out again. He held a damp rag and rubbing alcohol. “The Hero Commission just hates that they can’t control vigilantes like me. Held to no restrictions, just doing what’s right. Sure, morally not everyone agrees. But robbing an old woman, or threatening a woman’s life if she didn’t give what someone

demanded? That's just wrong." Cosmic placed a small cotton pad onto his nose which had an open wound.

"It's illegal."

"Yeah, yeah. Hey, why are you here?"

Aizawa stood up and walked out of the lounge. He shook off the memory of the night prior. He was going to focus on the day ahead of him.

Around lunchtime, Shinso was sitting in Hiazashi's chair in the teacher's working quarters. Aizawa sighed and sat next to him in his own seat, but turned to look at him.

"I've got to ask you something." Aizawa said. "I haven't ran it by anyone yet, but I wanted to check with you first."

"What?" Shinso asked, his voice small. His eyebags seemed to be worse than they were that morning.

"A student was kicked from my class. Would you be interested in taking his place?" Aizawa watched Shinso's eyes widen with surprise, and then go neutral. He noted this. He had learned how to do that himself, but seeing Shinso able to cut off his emotions like that worried him.

"I don't think I'm good enough." Shinso said with a sigh. "I'm not fit for the hero course."

"The entire point of the hero course is to learn. If you decide to join, the class is taking a trip to a forest training camp." Aizawa looked at his desk. "Now would be the time."

"You..really think I'm capable?"

“Of course I do. I’m the one training you afterall, I know you’re good enough.”

“But you said you had to run it through everyone else..”

“I don’t think anyone will disagree.” Aizawa looks at him. “Why aren’t you at lunch?”

“I don’t want to talk to..anyone.”

“If you say so..make sure you’re ready for training later.”

“..Hitoshi Shinso.” Nezu asked, looking at Aizawa. “As your new student?”

“That’s correct, sir.”

“I’ve been training him and he’s done surprisingly well. He also has the passion to become a hero. I’m training him this afternoon, if you’d like to come join us and make your decision there.”

“Mm, I think that would be swell. See you this afternoon.” Nezu nodded.

When training came around, Aizawa could already feel the sore back he’d have later that night. He helped set Shinso up at the gym, before guiding his actions. Originally today was capture weapon training, but since Nezu was coming to watch there was a slight change in plans.

Aizawa and Shinso sparred. Shinso was quick on his feet, but still hesitant with his movements. He moved with ease, his moves lined with eagerness. The two went back and forth until Shinso caught the upper hand and flipped Aizawa onto his back.

He laid on the ground for a moment, clearly trying to find the strength to get up and not fall asleep right then and there. He pushed himself to his feet, getting ready to spar again. Shinso made sure Aizawa was okay, and apologized saying he didn't mean to throw him so hard.

"I'd rather you throw me too hard rather than too weak." Aizawa said, his punch getting caught by Shinso's hand. "You're doing well."

"Thanks." Shinso muttered. He did his best to ignore it when he saw Nezu walk in and sit down. He told himself that people would see him fight all the time and his principal was no different. He felt a small amount of adrenaline pump in his veins, and threw his own capture weapon down. It hardened, and he used it to jump over Aizawa. He snapped the capture weapon, wrapping it around Aizawa with ease.

Aizawa huffed, slowly falling over and hitting the ground with thud. Shinso unwrapped him and the two shook hands. They began to talk to each other, Aizawa mainly offering advice and pointers towards his technique. While the two were busy, Power Loader walked in and whispered something to Nezu.

"Nezu," He started. "Riso's having an episode."

"Phase?"

"Three.."

"Very well..I'm very sorry, but an emergency came up." Nezu stops the two. "Aizawa, Riso's having an episode."

"Shit." Aizawa sighed. "I'll be there,"

"Episode?" Shinso questioned. "Do you mean a breakdown?"

“It’s easier to call them episodes. Stay here, you could get hurt if you follow us.”

Shinso paused. Sure, he was upset at Riso. He also didn’t want Riso to be hurt, or hurt someone he didn’t want to.

“Let me help.”

Nezu looks at Aizawa. “It might work. Shinso might be the only person who can de-escalate the situation without any injuries.”

Aizawa looked at Shinso. “Fine. Do you understand how dangerous this could be if it goes wrong?”

“He’s broken someone’s arm before, I know.”

Aizawa sighed, but nodded. “Okay. C’mon.”

The four of them made their way to the support course lab as fast as they could. Shinso was shocked at the state the lab was in. The tables were covered in mock designs and papers, all seemingly belonging to Riso. Riso stood behind the table, a notebook in his hand. His hand was scribbling faster than Shinso could comprehend.

“Shinso,” Nezu says. “Be very careful getting close to him.”

“I thought you just couldn’t touch him,” Shinso looked at Nezu, who shook his head.

“This is phase three. He’s at the point where his defense is on auto-pilot and he’ll take out any ‘threat’ to him or his ability to create.” Nezu crossed his arms behind his back. “His mind

is most likely working overboard. Once you break him from this, he'll probably pass out or feel extremely tired."

"It's his quirk, right? Why can't Aizawa just cancel it?"

"We tried that once, and he didn't wake up for two days. We'd like to avoid that, as we don't know what happens when his quirk is canceled."

Shinso turned to Riso, who was still scribbling his notebook.

"How did we find out he's in phase three?" Aizawa asked. Power Loader sighed.

"Hatsume tried to break him out of it. He..broke her back."

"Shit. He's going to feel guilty about that."

Shinso slowly stepped into the lab, looking among the papers scattered everywhere. He picked one up, reading it. It was for someone in Class 1B, but his handwriting was neat and composed. He sat it down and picked up another paper. This paper, the handwriting was almost unreadable.

Comparing the two…It seems the deeper he goes into this phase, the faster his brain is moving. He can't keep up with his quirk, and it's essentially overloading his brain. He most likely passed out from Aizawa's quirk for so long because it's similar to cutting off oxygen to someone's brain. Riso's quirk an addon to himself, it's a core part of his brain. When it starts to overwork, it takes him over. Whenever his brain is most vulnerable, that's when his quirk takes over… That's why he needs to stay busy.

Shinso thought to himself, slowly walking around the table. He sat in front of Riso slowly.

“What are you sketching?” He asked quietly. Riso didn’t seem alarmed at his presence. He didn’t respond verbally, but he ripped the page from his notebook and placed it in front of Shinso. Shinso knew this was progress. He was responsive, but not verbally. He must be non-verbal from his quirk overloading his brain. He needed to get him to talk. He also needed to break the cycle of creating, an interruption in his mind.

“Riso,” Shinso spoke. “What’s this one?” He picked up a piece of paper, showing it to him. Riso stopped writing, and went to grab the paper. Shinso quickly grabbed his hand, interlocking their fingers. Riso paused, freezing in place.

Good, it’s working.

Riso placed his notebook down, and transferred his writing onto a sheet of paper while using one hand. It seemed uncomfortable as he was using his non-dominant hand. His sketch slowly formed into something Shinso recognized. It was seemingly Bakugo’s gauntlets.

“Who are you making that one for?” Shinso questioned, slowly placing his other hand on the pencil. To his surprise, Riso spoke.

“Bakugo’s.” Riso’s voice was raspy, and dry as if he hadn’t had anything to drink in hours.

Bingo.

Riso’s body completely froze, his arm falling to his side while his other hand’s fingers were still intertwined with Shinso’s. His eyes turned white, his mind becoming blank.

“ **Relax.** ” Shinso’s voice was soft against Riso’s ears. His body relaxed, and he began to sway on his feet a bit. Shinso placed his hands on his shoulders to prevent him from falling. He gently shook him, trying to break the mind-washing. When he did, Riso took a shallow breath.

“..Shinso..?” Riso asked slowly, “What are you..?” His question faded as he looked around the room. His cheeks flushed red, and covered his face. “I did it, didn’t I?”

“Had a breakdown? Yeah. Phase three apparently.”

“Wait, but..how are you..not hurt?” Riso asked, gently rubbing his head. He seemed to be getting a headache.

“It’s not important. Do you need help cleaning up?”

“No, no..! I got it, it’s..my mess.” Riso shook his head and began trying to clean up. Shinso silently helped him clean up the papers that covered the lab. It took them a few minutes, and Shinso placed his stack of papers onto Riso’s workstation.

“Riso. Go to Recovery Girl, you get migraines after this.” Aizawa says.

“I’ll be okay..!”

“Now.”

“I’ll walk you.” Shinso looked at Riso. “In case you..pass out or something.”

“You don’t have to..”

“It’s what a hero would do.”

Riso and Shinso walked together in silence to Recovery Girl’s office. Their hand brushed against the others, and they pulled it away. The air was tense, but slightly comfortable

between the two. Shinso opened Recovery Girl's office door, and let Riso walk in. He shut it behind him. He noticed Hatsume fast asleep on the bed.

"Hi, Recovery Girl.." Riso frowned at the sight of Hatsume. "I did that, didn't I?"

"Oh don't be so dramatic, deary. Sit! Let's help that headache." Recovery Girl sat Riso on a bed, and grabbed an ice pack. She handed it to Riso, who pressed it to his forehead.

"Shinso, I..I'm sorry about the cafe." Riso spoke quietly. "I wish I had texted you after it happened, but I was..really scared." Shinso swallowed hard, looking off to the side.

"It's fine." *It's not.*

"It's not. That guy you saw, that was my ex." Riso sounded defeated and vulnerable. "You don't have to believe me, but he tried to hug me and I pushed him away from me."

"Your..ex? I thought he was the one who broke up with you."

"No. I..was. I tell everyone it was my idea so they don't ask questions. He threw me into a bookshelf, and that's when I accidentally broke his arm. I had to get stitches in the back of my head. I froze when I saw him, I know I'm at fault for not walking away. I ruined everything." Riso's shoulders dropped, he obviously felt sad and ashamed. Shinso shook his head.

"That's not true." Shinso said. "It was a misunderstanding, I'm glad you told me." He gave a soft smile.

"Um..could we..redo the cafe? Pick another day to go..? I promise this time I won't mess it up." Riso asked, covering his ears to hide the blush.

"Riso," Shinso said with a soft chuckle.

“Yes..?”

“You do realize that covering your ears when you blush just makes it more obvious you’re blushing?”

“But..I’ve got my ears covered?” Riso said, confused. Shinso simply just laughed and shook his head again.

“Nevermind, Riso. I’d love to redo the cafe with you. How about Saturday?”

“That works..! Maybe for lunch..? Twelve o’clock?”

“Sure, let’s do that.”

“Hey! Lovebirds,” Recovery Girl said, “That was sweet but this is supposed to be a place of healing. Riso, why aren’t you pressing that ice pack to your forehead while I ready this medicine?”

“Sorry..!” Riso laughed lightly with Shinso and pressed it to his forehead. He looks at him, biting his lip. “Shinso?”

“Hm?”

“Do you know how much you remind me of Aizawa? Are you sure he’s not your actual father?” Riso asks in a playful manner. Shinso rolls his eyes and crosses his arms.

“That’s exactly what Present Mic said! I think it’s because we’re both tired all the time, that’s it.” He cracks a small smile. Recovery Girl walked over, and clicked her tongue when she looked at Riso.

“You know I meant to put it against your actual skin, Riso. Why are you placing it over your hair?” She asked, holding a small medicine cup.

“I-” Riso was interrupted.

“Ah, don’t want to hear it.” Recovery Girl set the medicine cup down and stood on a stool. She took the ice pack from Riso’s hands, and flipped his hair up and pressed it to his forehead. Riso’s eyes widened slightly, and he nervously glanced at Shinso. Shinso blinked.

“Holy shit.”

The Previous Night

“Ah, shit. Hey, Eraser.”

Aizawa stared at Cosmic, slowly standing to his feet. “Do you know how long it took to find you?”

“Uh, considering you showed up in my apartment just now…Ever since we met?” Cosmic shrugged. He slipped off his sweater and threw it onto a chair.

“You seem unbothered now that I know who you are.”

“Eh. It was bound to happen. Besides, I’ve gotten punched in the nose too many times to care right now.”

“I don’t understand.” Aizawa looked at Cosmic. “Why do you do this? Why be a vigilante?”

“Why not?” Cosmic walked to his bathroom, then walked out again. He held a damp rag and rubbing alcohol. “The Hero Commission just hates that they can’t control vigilantes like me. Held to no restrictions, just doing what’s right. Sure, morally not everyone agrees. But robbing an old woman, or threatening a woman’s life if she didn’t give what someone demanded? That’s just wrong.” Cosmic placed a small cotton pad onto his nose which had an open wound.

“It’s illegal.”

“Yeah, yeah. Hey, why are you here?”

“To..check on you.”

“I don’t need to be checked on.” Cosmic took a hair band from his wrist and pulled his hair back out of his face. A strand fell from the small bun he made, but he could care less. He placed a bandage across his nose to mend the cut. He glanced at Aizawa, who just stared at him in surprise.

“What? Don’t look at me like that.” Cosmic huffed. “You’ve been dying to know who I am, and now that you do you’re all..shocked.”

“Why do you have so many nose injuries?” Aizawa asked, shaking the surprise off his face.

“Got punched? Maybe because I let them, but I had a rough day and it helped.” Cosmic gently placed a hand to his nose. “Sometimes, the pain grounds me. Helps me remember I’m still a human who makes mistakes.”

“That’s not healthy.”

“I really don’t want to hear this right now.” Cosmic sat on the couch, pulling out his phone. “Are you going to turn me in now that you know who I am?”

There was silence. The apartment was eerily quiet. Cosmic looked at Aizawa, who was deep in thought. He must've been thinking about whether to actually turn him in or not.

It's illegal. At the same time…he's saved countless lives. He's doing more good than bad, and if I turn him in a lot of people will be pissed. Nexus would come after me for certain…I don't think I can turn him in. I agree with all his crime captures, all his methods. That would be unfair of me, and against everything I believe in.

"No." Aizawa finally spoke. "No, I'm not." Cosmic blinked, looking at Aizawa. This time it was his turn to be surprised.

"What? But- It's illegal not to? If the Commission finds out, you're..fucked!"

"I know. But I agree heavily with your morals to turn you in. I won't say anything to anyone. You have my word, I'll keep your identity a secret."

"Oh c'mon! But now we can't have our little fake fights anymore." Cosmic pouted.

"We can still have those. You're a child, therefore I will always know more than you. I can still ridicule your decisions." Aizawa said, crossing his arms. "Who's Nexus?"

"Can't tell you that. Goes against my religious beliefs."

"Aren't you an atheist? You mentioned it months ago."

"You have no proof, old man!" Cosmic flipped him off, throwing a pillow at him. Aizawa caught it, and gently put it on the couch.

"You're giving me a headache."

“That’s my job. It’s literally in the job description. ‘Give Eraserhead, Shota Aizawa, a headache’. Only reason I got this job.” Cosmic snickered, but Aizawa didn’t budge or laugh at all.

“Very funny.”

“I know, right?”

“Does anyone else know you’re Cosmic?”

“Nope. Not even Nexus knows my identity. You’re the first! That’s..probably a first. Wow, you’re the first to know something for the first time! Isn’t that just wonderful?” Cosmic smiled sarcastically, teasing Aizawa.

“You just had to be annoying. Of all things. Annoying and a pain in my ass.”

“Hey, while you’re up, and groaning like an old man. Could you grab me something to drink?”

“No.”

“Aw, c’mon! Why not?”

“You have legs. Walk and get it yourself.”

“Pleaseeee?”

“No.”

“Pretty please?”

“No.”

“With a cherry on top?”

“No.”

“…Asshat.” Cosmic got up from the couch and walked to his fridge. He grabbed himself a water and opened it. “You want anything?”

“No.”

Cosmic sat on his counter, watching his feet dangle. He couldn’t help but feel slightly worthless now that his identity had been revealed to the one person he never thought would find out. He felt hopeless, knowing that this could only mean his downfall was near. Of course, he was lying when he said no one knew his identity. There was someone. He had to thank her for everything, knowing he’d never be where he was without her. It was bittersweet. Sure, Aizawa knowing who he was wasn’t the worst thing. At the same time, a Pro-Hero knew who he was.

He could be sold out at any time. He didn’t want to put Aizawa in that situation. He knew Aizawa had a soft spot for younger teens who’re doing their best. He knew Aizawa would have a hard time picking between himself and giving himself up. He shook his head, looking at Aizawa.

“I need to get going.” Aizawa said, walking towards the front door. “Promise me something?”

“Hm?”

“You’ll be safe?”

“Uh huh, yeah. Totally.”

“I mean it, Riso.” Aizawa said. “I want you to be safe.”

“Recovery Girl helps me recover from my wounds, I’ll be fine. Go home, Aizawa.”

“…We’re talking about this later.” Aizawa narrowed his eyes. “Goodnight.”

“Night!”

Chapter End Notes

BAM! anyways, i know this chapter was super all over the place but i need to start preparing for the forest training camp !! hopefully this was up to your standards <3

updates every wednesday and sunday!

Chapter Twenty Five

Chapter Summary

> Shinso and Riso talk, Bakugo and Izuku are attacked and Cosmic starts being more vulnerable around his friends.

Chapter Notes

> i'm so not happy with this chapter but i needed to kind of make things come to a close for the forest camp training arc! sorry the chapters super short :/

See the end of the chapter for more notes

"Holy shit."

"As much as I would love to freak out and act like I don't want you to know," Riso started, looking away from him. "Aizawa found out last night. Like father, like son.."

"Has Recovery Girl known?" Shinso asked, looking at Recovery Girl. "She didn't seem shocked."

"She found out like..a week in. She helped me fake a lot of stuff too." Riso sighed. "Like after the Hosu incident and I went missing for a few days? I got a really bad head injury that took a few days to heal but it couldn't interrupt the vigilante thing because then everyone would know. I feel bad for worrying people, but I lived."

"Oh my god." Shinso says. "That means Midoriya is Nexus."

"..Says who-"

“You’re like his best friend. Besides, you’re too much alike not to be. The journal note taking, the smarts, the self destructiveness.”

“I am not self destructive.”

“You are so self destructive.”

“I am not!”

“…Haven’t you willingly jumped off like three roofs by now?”

“I did it as a distraction.”

“I don’t understand how you handle your whole schedule plus being a vigilante.” Shinso changed the question, sitting next to him. “Aren’t you on a crazy tight ‘I’m always doing something’ kind of thing?”

“Yeah. Cause my quirk,” Riso motions to where they are now. “We see where that got us. It just wasn’t enough. When I’m supposed to be sleeping, and can’t? That’s what I do.”

“…How many hours of sleep did you get today?”

“Four.” Riso paused. “…In the past week.”

“Riso.”

“Yes?”

“It’s Thursday.”

“So?”

“Four hours of sleep- an hour a day. Even I sleep more than that!”

“It’s hard to sleep! Especially when all I can think about when I close my eyes is creating and blueprints and all the tragic shit I’ve seen.”

“Question,”

“Hmm?”

“When I brainwashed you earlier, did it stop your quirk?”

“I think so. I mean, that’s why we’re in her-…”

“**Go to sleep and rest.**” Shinso used his quirk, getting Riso to lay down and sleep. He jumped slightly when Recovery Girl spoke from next to him.

“That’s a very useful quirk, and very powerful if it controls someone like Riso.” She said with a smile. “I’m pleased you’re the one he chose to get attached to.”

“..Yeah, well..me too.” Shinso smiled softly down at Riso.

“The fuck are you doing, nerd?” Bakugo asked, walking alongside Izuku. “You won’t stop scribbling in that fucking book.”

“Cosmic asked me to try and find his identity but honestly I’m really struggling here.” Izuku whined. “I don’t know what I’m missing!”

“Give me that.” Bakugo grabbed his notebook, overlooking the information he had. “You don’t even have any suspects?”

“I did have one, but..i-it’s been disproven by a lot of things.”

“Like what?” Bakugo flipped through the pages.

“I thought he was Riso. I mean, it all made sense? Then he walked me home and Cosmic appeared right after him so that made me less suspicious cause it’s not impossible but pretty hard to do. Then, the Hosu incident..he was missing when Cosmic wasn’t.”

“If pinky-pie is scar-face..no wonder he covers his face. He’s hideous.”

“Kacchan!”

“What??”

“Don’t be rude!”

“Yeah, yeah, yeah. Fuckin’ whatever! You’re so dramatic.” Izuku wrapped his arms around Bakugo’s arm, looking into his own notebook.

“Do you see any connection?”

“Don’t touch me. And yes, It’s pinky-pie.”

“It is Riso..?? What makes you say that??”

“He had to have some form of medical treatment on hand. C’mon. Getting stabbed in the hand? The bruising and busted lips and noses. How do they just go away?”

“..Recovery Girl.”

“Pinky-pie is probably the only person who doesn’t get named as suspicious when going to her. We know he’s a dumbass who’s always getting hurt. And besides, if he hurt himself during class he probably had to go and she saw his other injuries.” Bakugo shrugs. “Gotta be him.”

“You really think so..?”

“Are you doubting me?!” Bakugo yelled, growling at Izuku.

“N-No..!”

“Good. Of course I’m right, I’m always right!”

“..Sure, Kacchan.”

“Are you gonna tell him?”

“..Tell him what?”

“That you know who he is, idiot!”

“Um..maybe. Will..will you be there?”

“Of course I will. You fucking nerd.”

Bakugo and Izuku continued to bicker back and forth with each other on the way to Izuku’s apartment. As they walked past an alleyway, Izuku was grabbed and pulled inside.

“Kacchan!”

“Hey, what the hell?!” Bakugo yelled, immediately running after them. He blasted in their direction, his explosion lighting up the surrounding area. Izuku kicked and screamed, biting the person’s hand that held his mouth shut. He ignores his brain telling him to stop biting so hard, and he bite harder. Izuju felt his teeth pierce the skin, blood spewing from the attacker's hand. He pulled his mouth back, and the attacker started screaming.

“That fucker bit my hand! He ripped my skin!” He also let go of Izuku. He stood, wiping his mouth which was dripping with red liquid.

“Of course I did. You tried to kidnap me!” Izuku yelled back, crossing his arms angrily. Bakugo was staring at him, in slight awe, disgust and surprise. “Which can I at least ask??”

“You looked the most vulnerable!”

“Well I’m not, so fuck off and die!” Izuku grabbed a piece of garbage and chucked it at the group of attackers. It hit one square in the forehead, and he stumbled back.

“Oh now you’re getting it, kid!”

The group launched themselves forward, running towards Izuku. Bakugo stepped in front of him, sparking his hands.

“Come and get us, motherfuckers!” Bakugo yelled out, grabbing an attacker by the face and blowing his face up. He fell to the ground, but then Bakugo felt something slice his back. He seethed in pain and turned around quickly, only to see Izuku take out the guy who did it with a single swing to the face with his staff.

“Uh oh, this is bad.” Izuku said, standing next to Bakugo. “..One of them is multiplying.”

“Then I’ll take them out!” Bakugo ran forward, shoving a large blast in front of him. He smirked as he felt the air around them get warmer. “Die!”

“Kacchan! Don’t kill them!”

“They tried to kill *you* ! Sorry it’s too much for you, Deku!”

Izuku came to Bakugo’s side, taking down the clones with his staff to the best of his ability. “Why do they even want me?! What about me is so interesting??”

“That you’re amazing, one of the smartest fucking kids at UA??” Bakugo calls, “Maybe they just wanted someone pretty and you being a badass was a great fucking plus! Maybe you also looked like an easy target! I don’t know, Deku, people are fucked up!” Bakugo blasted another group of attackers.

“Stop making clones, asshat! It’s annoying and overdone!” Izuku yelled. He slammed his staff into the ground and electrocuted the ground so the majority of the clones fell. Now that the clones were gone, the three original men stood there. They looked scared, unsure of where to go next.

“What the hell did you want?!”

“You have a healing quirk and we were gonna use your quirk to make something that can heal people to get rich!”

“…How did you know my quirk?”

“Public records aren’t hard to find!”

“But are morals hard for you to find?” Cosmic asked, jumped down. He grabbed one’s head and slammed it into the ground. He grabbed the other two and smashed their heads against each other hard enough to knock them out. “Gross. His hair was oily.”

“Cosmic!” Izuku smiled. “You came just in time!”

“I HAD HIM! YOU USELESS SCAR-FACE WHY DID YOU HAVE TO BE HEROIC?!” Bakugo screamed at Cosmic, stomping over to him. As he’s screaming and yelling at Cosmic, Izuku reaches out.

“Kacchan, look out!”

His cries were too late. One attacker was still awake, and lifted his hand and stabbed Bakugo in the back. Bakugo slowly turned, lookin down at him.

“Did you just fucking stab me?”

The attacker was silent.

“You’ve never lived with my mom. This? Is fucking nothing!” Bakugo stomped on his head. “Dumb fucking bitch.”

“Kacchan, be more careful! We need to go get that wound dressed..!”

Cosmic blinks, looking at Bakugo’s back. “You didn’t even flinch. Are you okay?”

“I’m fine, let’s just get to Deku’s dumb apartment. You two need to go on patrol later. Right pinky-pie?”

Shinso nervously walked into Aizawa and Hizashi’s study. He saw Aizawa and bit his lip.

“Aizawa?”

“Mm, yes Shinso?” Aizawa looked his way. He turned in his chair, resting his hands on his lap. “Is everything okay?”

Shinso sat down in front of Aizawa, bouncing his leg. “I know you know who Cosmic is.” Aizawa visibly tensed. He raised an eyebrow at Shinso.

“Where’d you hear that?”

“…From Cosmic.”

“Where are you going with this?” Aizawa asked tiredly, rubbing his forehead. Even thinking of Cosmic, of *Riso* , gave him a headache. The two most pain in the asses to him were the same person, which made him more of a pain in the ass.

“I know too. I..know that it’s Riso.” Shinso gulped, fiddling with his broken fingernails. “If..things between Riso and I continue to go well..would that be okay?”

“Are you asking me if you can date Riso?” Aizawa asks slowly, making sure he understood the question right.

“Don’t..put it like that!” Shinso blushes slightly. “I just..he’s a vigilante so I didn’t know if you..wouldn’t allow it.”

“Because I don’t. If you date Riso, don’t do stupid shit with him. Do you understand me?” Aizawa was firm, crossing his arms. He stared at Shinso, who nodded quickly.

“Okay! You don’t have to worry about that, I promise!”

“And if you need any more boy issues, go to Hizashi. He’s better at all that shit.” Aizawa turned back to his work, Aiko jumping onto the desk. Shinso went back into the living room, where he bumped into Hizashi.

“Oh, sorry..- I didn’t see you there..” Shinso muttered, rubbing the back of his neck.

“It’s okay, kiddo! Wanna watch a movie?”

“Isn’t it a bit early for that?”

“It’s dark outside! It counts. C’mon, you can pick!”

Shinso was dragged to the living room couch by Hizashi. He sat next to him and thought to himself.

I really shouldn’t get attached to these two..they probably don’t even like me..

“Oi! Fucker, watch where you put that!!” Bakugo yelled out, cleaning his jaw as Cosmic pressed a cotton pad with alcohol on it to his wound.

“I need to clean it, stop being a bitch!”

“Be fucking easier you dumb bitch!!” Bakugo growled. Cosmic glared at him and pressed it to Bakugo harder. He smirked in victory when Bakugo yelped in pain. Bakugo punched Cosmic in the face, but then Cosmic tackled him.

“Asshole, don’t punch me!”

“You’re the one who tackled me!” Bakugo shot a blast at Cosmic’s face. Cosmic blocked with both arms, and Bakugo flipped the two over. He lifted his fist to punch Cosmic again when Izuku entered the room.

“I leave for three minutes and here you two are, trying to kill each other! Stop it!” Izuku grabs a water bottle from his counter and sprays the two of them with it.

“I’m not a cat, asswipe!” Bakugo growls, swatting at the water and standing up. Cosmic stood up too, and he gently shoved Bakugo.

“We need to patrol. C’mon, Zuku!”

“Okay, okay. Be safe, Kacchan! Please let me know if you need help..!” Izuku waved and followed Cosmic out the balcony door.

“ *I don’t need anything, nerd. Just do your damn job and go to the tiny sandwich shop across from the park. There’s a robbery there.* ”

“It’s okay to say thank you, blasty!” Cosmic teased and he heard Bakugo start yelling at him through the earpiece. He laughed softly with Izuku.

Chapter End Notes

yes bakugo got stabbed. also i'm not sure if you guys remember, but riso's brother kaizen literally translates to "improvement" i think so i just thought that was funny LMAO. please make sure to look at my insta for story updates, i posted there yesterday letting people know this chapter might suck :/ love you guys!!
updates every wednesday and sunday!

Chapter Twenty Six

Chapter Summary

Mall trip + pool time + beginning of camp.

Chapter Notes

i hope you guys will accept this almost 9k long chapter as apology for the smaller chapter last sunday! enjoy :) (pls be mindful of any mistakes i didn't have time to even look over it)

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Cosmic and Izuku were sitting on top of Izuku's apartment building, both their legs dangling off the edge. Bakugo had left since it was a little past one in the morning, so now it was just Cosmic and Izuku. Cosmic glanced at Izuku.

"You know, don't you?" He asked, nudging Izuku.

"Kn..know what..?" Izuku gulps, picking at his fingernails. He kept his eyes trained on the ground as he felt an anxiety rise.

"My identity. You and blasty were being..weird." Cosmic pulled his face mask off. "It's okay if you know."

"Is it..?"

"Mhm. I just wanna see if you're right."

“..Um..Riso?”

Cosmic chuckled softly, looking up at the skin. “Yeah. That’s me.”

“Really..?? But-! That day you walked me home and then suddenly you reappeared-?”

“I wear majority of my vigilante outfit under my school uniform. I only had to put on my hood and mask, and I just left my bag by the stairwell. Besides, I came in through the front door.” Cosmic shrugged. “Recovery Girl knew too. But that might’ve been obvious.”

“Does..Power Loader know..?”

“Oh god no. He’d kick my ass, and then ban me from creating for a month.” Cosmic snickers. “Though..Aizawa knows. So does Shinso.”

“Wh- You told them?”

“No, Aizawa showed up in my apartment and I kind of took off my mask and hood. Shinso found out because Recovery Girl pushed my hair up to place an ice pack on my forehead. He saw my face so..can’t run from that one.”

“..So what do I call you now?”

“Whatever you want. In battle, just call me Cosmic but I think that’s obvious. Isn’t it, Nexus?” Cosmic smirked.

“I..Why aren’t you in the hero course? I-I mean I get you hate the hero commission- But you could really be something..!”

“Zuku, our goals are different. Your dream isn’t mine. I don’t want to be labeled as a hero. I want to be seen as someone people can completely trust. Heros have a protocol to follow, and sure some people find peace in that. But I’m a person ran on revenge and vengeance. Say someone does something horrible. Heros will just use the least amount of force to not hurt them. I don’t. They don’t deserve to not be hurt.”

“Wait..if you’re Riso..” Izuku thinks. “We ran into your parents!”

“Yeah.”

“I..I’m so sorry.”

“It’s fine. Really. They’ve moved on.” Cosmic looked away. “For the best, really.”

“If you want to talk..-”

“No, I’m okay. Thank you, Zuku. You get some sleep, yeah?”

“If you say so.”

“Oh, hey. I had a question.” Cosmic stood, placing his mask back on his face. “Is Bakugo okay?”

“Kacchan? Why wouldn’t he be?”

“He got stabbed and said it was nothing compared to his mom. I wanted to ask then, but I didn’t want him to go all…Bakugo on me.”

“Oh..Yeah, Auntie Mitsuki can be pretty mean sometimes..” Izuku frowned softly. “She’s always been really mean to him. I don’t like how she talks to him but Kacchan always says he’s fine..which I find hard to believe.”

“Huh. Okay. Sleep well tonight, Zuku.”

Bakugo sighed as he walked into his house quietly. He shut the door, picking it up softly so it didn’t creak. His footsteps were unheard as he made his way to his bedroom. He opened, and closed the door once inside. He threw his bag down and turned to rest on his bed. He felt his breath get caught in his throat when he saw his mother sitting on his desk chair.

“Mom.”

“Where the hell were you?!” Mitsuki stood up, anger dripping from her tone. “You’ve been coming home at ungodly hours for a fucking week now!”

“Like you even fucking care, you old hag!” Bakugo snapped back, crossing his arms.

“I would care if I had a son that fucking listened!”

“Then have another kid for all I give a shit! Get out of my room.”

“Don’t you dare talk to me that way.”

“Oh fuck off!”

“Katsuki!”

“I said fuck off and get out!”

Mitsuki stood, her eye twitching with obvious anger. She grabbed Bakugo by his hair, getting close to his face.

"You little shit. You don't fucking speak to me that way. Get ready for bed. Tomorrow, I want you here right after school or you're fucking grounded. Do you understand me, Katsuki? Here after school or you're grounded. Get the fuck to bed." She let him go and walked out. Bakugo placed a hand on his head where she was pulling at his hair and scoffed. He sat on his bed, pulling off his jacket.

"Tch..like she means it." He muttered to himself, wincing in pain when he felt a sharp pain in his back. Cosmic, or Riso, (he still wasn't sure how to think of him without confusing himself) had told him that Recovery Girl would fix him the next day at school if he went with him. He hated the thought of getting help but he didn't want to jeopardize Izuku's chance of proving himself with a stab wound.

He jumped up quickly when the window slid open.

"Calm down." Riso muttered, climbing into his room. "I came to talk to you."

"You shouldn't be here."

"Yeah, whatever." Riso sat on Bakugo's bed. "Sit." Bakugo growled but did it anyway.

"You've already warned me about Deku."

"That's not what I'm here for. I wanted to ask you something."

Bakugo paused and looked at Riso. "What?"

“Are you okay?”

“What kind of fucking question is that you piece of shit?!”

“You got stabbed. Then said you’ve experienced worse because of your mom.” Riso rubbed the back of his neck. “..So I wanted to check on you. Not in front of Zuku, though. Didn’t want him to think you’re weak.”

“Fuck off, pinky-pie.” Bakugo growled. “I’m fine.”

“You know that scar on my eye?”

“What fucking about it?”

“My mom did that.” Riso said, looking at him. “I want to know she’s not putting you in danger.”

“All she does is yell and just hits me sometimes. She’s never fucking stabbed me before.” Bakugo rolled his eyes. “What are you trying to get at?”

“Like I said, I want to make sure you’re..okay, I guess.”

“I’m fine.”

“Are you positive?”

“Yes, I’m fine!”

“Liar.”

“Fuck off!”

“Bakugo.”

“What?!”

“I’m not one to judge. Okay? If something ever happens, just let me know.” Riso stands and walks towards the window. “I’ll see you tomorrow at school, blasty.”

“Whatever.” Bakugo growled and watched him leave. He laid against his bed, grumpily rubbing his eye. His phone buzzed on his bedside table. He picked it up and looked at it. It was from Izuku.

meet in recovery girls office tomorrow?

whatever you fucking nerd

Bakugo shut off his phone. He let himself relax and began to fall asleep. He let one thought run through his mind before he slipped into a deep sleep.

Damn idiots, messing up my sleeping schedule.

The next morning, Izuku and Riso were waiting for Bakugo in Recovery Girl’s office. The two were mostly silent, barely speaking with each other. Riso seemed busy with trying to create more designs in his journal while Izuku was fidgeting with his fingers. Bakugo walked in after opening the door violently. He paused.

“Were you two fucking waiting on me??”

“Kacchan! You’re here!” Izuku basically ran over to Bakugo. “I’m glad you showed up!”

“Of course I fucking did, idiot. Why wouldn’t I? To jeopardize you?? I’m not a fucking asshole!” Bakugo looked at Riso, who didn’t bother to look at him. He growled and sat down on a bed as Recovery Girl walked over.

“Ah! I see Riso has roped his friends into this hobby of his.”

“We’re not fucking friends!”

“You were stabbed, yes?”

“Yeah, just hurry the fuck up.”

“Blasty. Be nice.” Riso narrowed his eyes. Bakugo could feel his glare, but couldn’t see it. “She’s going to help you more than you could know.”

“Fuck off, pinky-pie and don’t tell me what to do!”

“You woke up on the wrong side of the bed this morning.”

The two bickered back and forth while Recovery Girl did what she had to. Izuku watched the two of them with a small smile.

“Okay, deary. Try not to get hurt anymore. Off to class you go!” Recovery Girl gave a motherly smile. Bakugo scoffed and the three walked out.

“We’ll see you after school, right?” Izuku asked Riso, linking his arm with Bakugo hesitantly. He didn’t pull away, but rather grumbled in distaste.

“Actually, you’ll be seeing me in your heroics class. Aizawa wanted me there for something.”

“Oh..I wonder why.”

“Ugh, me too.” Riso whines. “That’s precious time to create!”

Bakugo rolled his eyes. “Shut up, pinky-pie.”

“See you later, Riso!” Izuku waves as Riso splits off from the two of them. Bakugo and Izuku walked to class in a bit of silence before Izuku spoke up.

“Is Auntie Mitsuki being mean again..?”

“Hah?” Bakugo looked at Izuku with slight shock.

“You tensed when I asked if Riso was going to meet us later. You can’t come, can you?”

“No. I can’t.”

“So Auntie Mitsuki is being mean?”

“It’s not your problem, Deku.” Bakugo growls. “Shut up.”

“No! I’m worried about you..”

“You and pinky-pie both.”

“So he talked to you?”

“I thought you sent him after me.”

“I actually told him not to..”

“Whatever, just shut up!”

Bakugo pulled his hand from his pocket and opened the door. He saw everyone staring at him and Izuku. His face twisted in anger as he tried to figure out why everyone was staring at him. He heard Izuku gulp and he looked his way. Then he realized his arm was linked with Izuku’s and he shoved him away and walked inside.

“Stop staring!”

He grumbled and sat down, covering his head. Izuku frowned softly and walked to his desk. He sat down and looked at the board. Today was going to be long, wasn’t it?

Before he knew it, heroics class was next. His class was complaining about the camp trip they were all going to take.

“Make sure you guys tell us all about camp,” Mina sobbed, holding onto Kirishima. He nodded.

“I can’t believe we won’t get to go.” He frowned and looked down. Izuku rubbed the back of his neck nervously.

“Maybe you guys will get to go because of an unexpected twist..?” He said, cheerful.

“Midoriya, don’t get them false hope.” Sero sighed. “Honestly I think I failed too. Before Mineta left, well..He did more than I did.”

“We’re going to be stuck at summer school..! Mr. Aizawa said it was literal torture!” Denki whined, crumbling into Sero’s arms dramatically. The door slammed open.

“You should all be in your seats and silent.”

Everyone scrambled to their seats before he could address them, and Izuku watched as Riso and Aizawa entered together.

“Riso, stand over there.”

“Yes sir.” Riso stood over in the corner, waving to the students who waved to him. He smiled fondly at Izuku, who waved back to him happily.

“I have three announcements.” Aizawa scratched his head roughly. “First off, you’re all aware training camp is coming up. You all passed the written exam, but five of you failed the practical horribly. Ashido, Kaminari, Kirishima, Sato, and Hanta.”

“Aw man,” Sero hung his head low. “I knew it..”

“You’ll all be going to camp.” Aizawa said, a smirk crawling onto his face. “All of the teachers gave you an opportunity to win and pass the exam.”

“But you promised they wouldn’t be holding back!” Hagakure called out.

“I lied. I told you that so you would do your absolute best. And you didn’t. Announcement number two.” Aizawa looked towards the door. “As you’re all familiar with, Mineta was expelled. So I’m replacing him with a student I feel fits into Class 1A. Hitoshi Shinso.”

Shinso opened the door nervously, and walked in. He waved his hand after a few seconds of silence.

“Oh no way! You’re the brainwashing guy!” Denki asked, “So cool!”

“Shinso, sit behind Izuku.”

Riso stared at Shinso with wide eyes. He wasn’t even aware of this decision. Usually he knew because he lived and held himself close to the teachers and Nezu. He felt himself blush and he covered his ears. He saw Shinso look at him, and smile. He pointed to his ears in a teasing way, and Riso turned away from him.

“Third announcement.” Aizawa looked at Riso. “He’s coming with us.”

“What?” Riso looked at Aizawa. “Wh- Why am I going??”

“You and I will talk later. Class dismissed.” Aizawa walked out, leaving Riso speechless.

“Oh my, I don’t think I have anything ready for camp..” Momo said, tapping her chin curiously.

“It says it’s for a week,” Iida read out from the pamphlet he grabbed.

“I’m gonna need a bigger suitcase..” Uraraka mumbled, looking at the pamphlet with him.

“I don’t even think I have a swimsuit!” Mina said, “Oh my goodness!”

“We should all go shopping as a class!” Hagakure cheers.

“Yeah, I don’t think we’ve ever hung as a class before..” Ojiro thinks. “I would be down for that.”

“We could all go to the mall. Ribbit.” Tsuyu said, and Jirou nodded.

“I could use some things too.” Tokoyami agreed.

“Yeah! What about you, Bakugo?” Kirishima asks, swinging his arm around his shoulder.

“I’d rather die.” Bakugo growled, nudging him off of his shoulder.

“What about you, Todoroki?” Izuku asked quietly.

“I visit my mom on days off.”

“Awh, party poopers!” Hagakure whined.

“Do you want to come with us, Shinso?” Momo asked softly, smiling at him. “You can come too, Riso!”

Shinso looked at Riso, who looked at him. The both of them then looked at Momo and nodded.

“I’d love to.” Riso smiles. “Thanks, Yaoyorozu.”

“Of course!”

“Oh this is gonna be so fun!” Uraraka smiled, hugging Tsuyu. “I can’t wait!”

Izuku felt claustrophobic around everyone when they arrived at the mall. They were all gathered together in the center.

“Oh my god, those are Class 1A students!” Someone said, pointing at them.

“They did amazing in the sports festival!”

“..Man, they sure do remember things..” Kirishima blushed in embarrassment. It didn’t take long for the class to get sidetracked.

“I could really use a duffel bag..” Jirou said, and Momo grabbed her arm.

“Yeah! Let’s go together.”

“I could use some new shoes! C’mon, Hagakure!”

Slowly, the class split off. The only three left were Riso, Shinso and Izuku.

“…So.” Riso starts. “Um..”

“You two should go,” Izuku said with a smile. “Enjoy some time together.”

“But then you’d be alone.”

“It’s okay, really..!” Izuku motions for them to go.

“..Okay, if you say so.” Riso hugged Izuku. “See you in a little bit!”

Izuku blinked, watching them walk away. He smiled softly and began thinking about what to do, or what to buy.

“You’re that kid from the festival,” A raspy voice said, the owner wrapping his arm around Izuku’s shoulders. “I’m a big fan!”

Izuku tensed, looking slightly annoyed as the apparent fan rambled on.

“You and your class are nothing but amazing.. You’ve been attacked multiple times, isn’t that right? Just so much strength and power..I do think I haven’t met you since the USJ attack..”

Izuku felt his eyes widen.

Shigaraki.

He thought as he felt his hand shift to his neck. He swallowed hard.

Riso paused in the shop, looking at Shinso.

“Something’s wrong.”

“..What? What do you mean?”

“I don’t know. Something doesn’t feel right..” Riso walked over to the railing outside the store. He scanned the floor. “Hey, who’s that?”

Shinso followed suit. “The guy in the black hoodie?”

“Yeah. I’m jumping down.” Riso rolled his sleeves up and grabbed onto the rail as he was about to holster himself up and over. Shinso grabbed his arm to hold him back.

“You can’t do that, if that is someone harmful you could put him in danger. C’mon, we need to run.” He grabbed Riso’s hands and then bolted to the staircase.

“I could kill maybe twenty,” Shigaraki said with a sick lightful tone. “Maybe thirty..or even forty. And they’re *allll* smiling because they think I have the same morals as them..”

“What do you want?” Izuku asked, nervously and angrily drawing circles onto his kneecap to calm his anxiety.

“Tell me. Why is it that *Stain* managed to capture everyone’s view? I invaded UA. I released a Nomu, yet everyone is so hung up on Stain. We both destroy things we want.” Shigaraki complained, tapping his finger on Izuku’s neck. “So tell me, Midoriya. Why is that?”

Izuku felt frozen, and he swallowed hard. He didn’t have any answer to this question. He didn’t know what to say. He did his best to look at Shigaraki.

“Stain, his morals I could understand. I don’t agree with him, but they were understandable. He destroyed things, yes, but he never ran away when things got tough. He didn’t do it just for fun, he had a goal.” Izuku muttered. “You’re childish, Shigaraki.”

“Are you asking to be killed, brat?” Shigaraki growled.

Riso and Shinso made it to the ground floor and ran towards Izuku. They slowed their running into walking to not alarm the man in the hoodie. Riso stepped forward carefully. He paused when he saw a glimpse of his face, feeling his legs almost freeze in place. It was Shigaraki. He couldn’t help but remember what happened to him at the USJ.

Cosmic jumped forward, aiming his attack on Kurogiri. He felt his breath catch in his throat when a portal opened in front of his face. A familiar, rather ugly, hand slipped through the portal. Cosmic’s eyes widened for a moment, realizing who’s hand it was. He was aware he couldn’t dodge this attack, and he committed to his morals of saving himself and the symbol of peace. His life for innocent ones.

Shigaraki’s fingers came into contact with his face. Cosmic clenched his jaw and winced in pain. From his fingertips, the decaying felt like a burning under his skin. The pain was enough to make anyone cry. He felt his skin begin to crack and fall, his head began to spin. He was thankful for the gunshot that was sent his way and took out Shigaraki’s hand.

Riso swallowed hard and stood his ground.

“Izuku..? Is this a friend..?” Riso asked, looking at Shigaraki.

“Everything is fine!” Izuku said, tears in his eyes as Shigaraki had begun to squeeze his neck moments before Riso and Shinso got there.

“Hey, man. Don’t you think you should let him go?” Shinso asked, his feet planted as if he was ready to spring forward and attack.

“You’re here with friends!” Shigaraki let Izuku go, a slight panic in his voice. “My, my. I didn’t know! Sorry for taking up your time.” He got up, holding his head down. He whispered to Izuku.

“Follow me, and I’ll kill you.”

Shigaraki began to walk away, and Izuku stood.

“Shigaraki, wait.” He growled. “You won’t succeed in anything.”

Shigaraki brushed him off and walked away, disappearing into the crowd. Shinso had called the police the moment he was gone, and Riso was checking on Izuku. When the police showed up, they did an entire sweep across the mall in search of Shigaraki. It seemed like he managed to get away easily, and stealthily as well. Tsukauchi had taken Izuku in for questioning to find anything out about the encounter. They wouldn’t allow Riso or Shinso into the room, and the two had to wait for him.

“Riso?” Shinso asked, placing a hand on his hand. “Are you okay?”

“I’m fine, Shinso. I just..maybe a little tired?” Riso’s statement came out more like a question. He didn’t want to admit he was scared, especially of Shigaraki, one of their biggest threats.

“You froze when you saw Shigaraki.”

“No I didn’t.”

“Riso. You clearly are traumatized by the USJ incident.” Shinso gave a soft, comforting smile. “And that’s okay. He almost decayed most of your face.”

“I don’t want to talk about this, I’m worried about Zuku.” Riso muttered. He felt tears coming to his eyes at the thought of Shigaraki. Shinso was right, he knew it was okay, but he hated it. He had been attacked before by the League of Villains before it was even fully recruited into a group. He didn’t remember not a single thing about it. He hated it. He hated not knowing, being scared. They were holding him back.

The door opened and Izuku stepped out, sighing softly out of exhaustion. Riso ran to him, wrapping his arms around him.

“You’re okay!”

“You knew I was okay-?” Izuku chuckled, hugging back. “I’m glad you stayed and waited for me.”

“I don’t think he’d ever let you end up being alone,” Shinso snickered. “Did they push you too hard in there?”

“Of course not!” Izuku smiled. “They were all really nice.”

“Good. I’d beat them all up if I could.” Riso rolled his eyes.

“Hey,” Shinso looked around, and out a window. “It’s pretty late out. I can ask my dad if he’ll let you guys stay over for tonight.” Riso and Izuku looked at each other, then at Shinso.

“..I don’t think he’d let me in his home after I took apart his stove.” Riso says sheepishly. “But you can try.” The three walked out of the police station while Shinso texted Hizashi.

Mic?

Hey hey hey! It’s pretty late, do you know when you’re going to be home?

About that, can Midoriya and Riso stay over tonight?

Uh, of course!!! I'll order takeout! Do I need to tell Sho to pick you guys up?

I think we can get there. Thanks Mic

Shinso put his phone down, and then opened his bag to reveal his captured weapon. He looked Izuku and Riso.

"...Wanna race?" He asked, his voice quiet and scared of rejection.

"Oh hell yeah!" Riso nodded, "C'mon, Zuku. Let's beat this idiot!" He smiled brightly.

"Wait but I don't know where he lives-" Izuku starts, but Riso and Shinso had already pulled themselves up onto the buildings above them. He pouted and did the same. "I'll just follow you!"

The three ran and swung across buildings, laughing with each other whenever someone tripped or messed up. It seemed like at that moment, nothing else mattered but each other.

Riso reached the apartment door first, and laughed.

"Ha! I beat you!" He smiled in victory. Next was Izuku, who was breathing heavily and trying to catch his breath.

"No fair." Shinso muttered, trying to untangle himself from the mess he made of the capture weapon. He laughed when Izuku snickered and knocked on the door for him. Hizashi opened the door almost too quickly, and clapped his hands together.

“Hey, little listeners!” He cheered, “Come in! Shinso, let’s get you cleaned up.”

The three came inside, and heard a groan.

“When you said he was bringing over friends,” Aizawa said, sipping a cup of coffee. “I didn’t know you meant *those* two.”

“You love me.” Riso smiled.

“Very far from the truth.” Aizawa petted Aiko, who jumped up onto the kitchen island.

“Is it okay if I take a shower?” Izuku asked, “I’ve had..a long day.” He mutters.

“Of course,” Hizashi nods. “I can show you the bathroom and Shinso can lend you some of his clothes.”

“I also have clothes here, Mic.” Riso crossed his arms, fake pouting.

“It- really does not matter.” Izuku chuckled.

“Let’s go, I’ll show you the bathroom.”

Shinso and Riso looked at each other. Riso couldn’t hold back a laugh, and he reached over.

“Let me help you.” He said softly, walking closer to Shinso. He began to untangle him, and the two shared a comfortable silence when Aizawa spoke up.

“Door stays open tonight.” Aizawa said, not looking their way. Shinso’s face reddened.

“Dad!”

Aizawa paused, the cool ceramic of his coffee mug pressed against his bottom lip. Shinso just called him dad. He didn’t expect it, especially so early. He smiled softly.

“I’m just saying.” Aizawa looked at them. “Riso, act right tonight.”

“Yes sir! I won’t take apart your stove.”

“Good.”

Izuku felt the warm water hit his back, and he took a breath. Everything was so surreal to him, and he couldn’t believe where he was. While he was in the questioning room, it hit him how far he had come. He had tried to kill himself roughly ten months before UA exams, but now he was a successful vigilante with his best friend and he realized he had a crush on his childhood best friend. He’d been wrong before, but he was starting to think maybe that childhood best friend liked him back. He remembered a dream he had of his mom the other day, where she told him something that’s stuck with him.

“Izuku, baby.” Inko said, cupping his face gently. “Don’t get discouraged.”

“But mom, I..I feel like I can’t save everyone.”

“You give people hope. That saves them. You do so..so well, baby. I’m proud of you.” Inko smiled.

“How am I supposed to know if I’m doing the right thing, mom?”

“Think of it like this, dear. You were saved by chance. But you became a savior for others by choice. That’s the mentality of a wonderful hero.”

Izuku sighed, rubbing his cheek. He got out of the shower and put on the clothes Hizashi had set out for him. It was a really big t-shirt, probably Riso’s, and a pair of sweatpants. He changed and walked out of the bathroom, still drying his hair. He walked into the living room slowly.

“Hey, kiddo! Dinner’s here, if you’d like to go get Shinso and Riso for me?” Hizashi offered a soft smile.

“Okay,” Izuku walked down the hall and slowly opened the door he heard laughing from behind. Shinso and Riso were on the floor, doing a puzzle together.

“No, idiot! That’s a side piece! Give me that.” Riso rolled his eyes playfully and took a piece from Shinso.

“Hey, lovebirds. uh..Present Mic said dinner’s here.” Izuku said. Riso looked at Izuku and blinked.

“You look so tiny in my shirt.”

“You’re a fucking giant, it’s not my fault!”

“I’m only like six foot, chill.” Riso stood, Shinso following suit. The three went into the kitchen and ate the food alongside Aizawa and Hizashi. Dinner seemed to go smoothly, and before they knew it, they were all falling asleep on the floor of Shinso’s room trying to do a three-hundred piece puzzle. Hizashi came into the room and laid blankets on all of them, and stood by the door next to Aizawa.

“He called me dad.” Aizawa said softly, looking at Hizashi.

“He did??” Hizashi asked, his smile so bright it could’ve blinded someone.

“Yeah.” Aizawa let a small smile crept onto his face. “I’m glad he likes it here with us.”

“So what do you think about Midoriya? He seemed overwhelmed by the parenty stuff.” Hizashi frowned. “I’m hoping he chooses us after camp, I’d love to see him live with us. He’s a good influence on Shinso.”

“Riso’s a bad influence on Izuku. Cancels out.” Aizawa waves his hand dismissively. “C’mon, Zashi. Let’s go to bed.”

“Alright, Sho. But only if I get to be the big spoon tonight.”

“Fine.”

A few days later, Denki had asked Izuku if he wanted to go to the pool with him for endurance training, but Izuku figured it was actually to look at the girls. He wasn’t as pervy as Mineta, but he still had his tendencies. He said yes, but only to invite the other guys with him to ruin Denki’s plan. Though, he’d never admit that outloud.

So of course when Denki realized Iida and everyone else was there, Izuku couldn’t help but laugh at him.

“I thought I’d invite everyone else along with us for training!” Izuku said innocently, smiling at Denki who crumbled in fake agony.

“That was cruel.” Shinso said with a slight chuckle, leaning against the wall that was hidden under a shadow. “But really funny.”

“What can I say?” Izuku looked at Shinso. “I’m good at being stealthy.”

“You’re just an asshole.”

“Alright everyone! Take your positions!” Iida announced, and Shinso emerged from the shadows. Across the pool where the girls were playing, Riso sat on the ground with a notebook in his hand. Shinso smiled softly, shaking his head.

He never lets himself rest.

While the boys of Class 1A trained and pushed their bodies, the girls were splashing and having fun. Uraraka turned to Riso with a frown.

“We invited you to have fun, Riso! Not sit under an umbrella and sketch.” She whined, resting her elbows on the side of the pool. “C’monnn!”

Riso looked up with a slight blush on his cheeks. He glanced at his notebook, and closed it. He wasn’t sketching a design or making another support item. He was sketching Shinso. He couldn’t help but admit to himself he liked him more than he’d ever want to believe. He tried to distract himself by sketching a design since he was across the pool, but ended up sketching him instead.

He shook his head. “I’m okay.”

“Don’t be a lameass.” Jirou rolled his eyes.

“Yeah, come join us! Ribbit.” Tsuyu waved Riso over.

“We’d really enjoy it if you swam with us, Riso.” Momo smiled. “We won’t tell anybody if we see your face either.”

Riso sighed and stood. “Okay, okay.” He walked over and sat at the edge. “I’m in the pool.”

Hagakure whined, throwing her arms around. (Not that anyone could see.) She then noticed the notebook in his hand.

“What are you drawing anyway?? Are you working on your day off?” She questioned, before snatching it from him. Riso’s eyes went wide.

“Hagakure!” He called, “Oh please don’t drop it in the pool-!”

“Is that Shinso?” She asked, tilting her head as she looked at the sketch.

“Oh my god I knew it. Kaminari owes me twenty dollars.” Jirou said, grabbing the book from Hagakure and held it for Momo to see.

“It’s not like that..!”

“You two are dating, aren’t you??” Uraraka asks with a squeal, and Riso shushes her.

“No..! We’re not. We’re just..friends.” Riso grabbed the notebook back and blushed. “Please don’t be so loud.”

“You guys aren’t?! But he looks at you so fondly!” Mina says, crossing her arms. “I’m going to talk to him and see what's up. Someone else could just snatch you up and he needs to know you’re not always available!”

“Mina, it’s okay. Really.” Riso nodded.

“I’ll fucking beat you, you damn nerd! You better be at your fucking best, do you hear me?!” Bakugo yelled, pointing at Izuku angrily. Kirishima stood in front of Bakugo, holding out a hand to stop him from stomping over.

“Sorry we’re late! Took a while for me to convince him to come out and join us.” Kirishima offered a smile.

“We *could* make this a swimming competition..” Iida says.

“That would be fun!” Sero nodded.

“Iida! Let us help you!” Momo walked over, the girls not far behind her. Riso also stood behind her, and locked eyes with Shinso. The two shared a look with each other, and Bakugo looked back at Shinso. He glared and looked back at Izuku.

“Let’s get this fucking over with!” Bakugo yelled out.

While a group of people were swimming against each other, Bakugo pulled Shinso off to the side rather forcefully. He pushed him into the wall and crossed his arms.

“Listen here, insomniac.” Bakugo poked his chest. “Explain your shit with pinky-pie.”

“What?” Shinso shook his head, confusion written on his face. “Why do you even care?”

“He’s Deku’s best friend. You fuck with him, you fuck with Deku. You fuck with Deku, you fuck with me. So fucking tell me now.”

“What an odd way to say he’s your friend.”

“He’s not my fucking friend! Now talk before I blast your ass.” Bakugo raised a fist, a scowl on his face.

“It’s not your business.”

“I don’t have time for this.” Bakugo grabbed his collar and pulled him closer. “If you ever fucking hurt him or even make him shed a *sinlge* tear, I’ll blast you to fucking bits small enough they’ll never be able to find your entire body. You understand that, insomniac?”

“You know you don’t scare me, right?” Shinso rose an eyebrow.

“I don’t give a shit if I’m scaring you or not. It’s a warning, take it to fucking heart.” Bakugo let him go and stomped away.

The swim race got cut short by Aizawa, who told everyone to go home. When Bakugo and Kirishima were walking home together, Bakugo kicked a rock in anger.

“Damn nerds, thinking they’re better than me.” Bakugo growled, and Kirishima laughed softly.

“You do realize that they’re not actually your enemies but your classmates? They’re our friends.” Kirishima said, resting a hand on his shoulder.

“I don’t give a fuck. I’m going to be the best hero with or without our dumb ass classmates.” Bakugo shoved his hands in his pockets.

“Yeah!” Kirishima flexed his arm. “We sure will!”

The two were silent for a moment. Kirishima watched Bakugo, before clearing his throat.

“..So, you and Midoriya?” Kirshima asked, nudging him.

“What about the damn nerd?”

“You two seem pretty touchy. And lovey. Do you like him?” Kirishima asked, hopefulness sparkling in his eyes.

“What? Fuck off, shitty hair!”

“I mean it, Bakugo!” Kirishima smiled at him, “You and Midoriya look at each other like you’re the only people in the world. Don’t hesitate, okay? Even Denki can see it.”

“Who?”

“Sparky, dunce face.”

“Oh. Whatever. I have to get home.” Bakugo looked away from Kirishima.

“Okay, man! See you later!” Kirishima walked off to go home, and Bakugo walked alone.

He knew that Kirishima was right, but he couldn’t just willingly confess his feelings after being such an ass to Izuku for the majority of his life. It was wrong to give such mixed signals to someone, and he didn’t want Izuku to leave him completely. He would rather be in pain and be around him as a friend, rather than lose Izuku completely. They’d be in UA together for the next three years, so he had all the time in the world to confess and admit his feelings. He had time.

When he got home, he went straight to his room. He pulled out his phone and opened his photos app. He scrolled through the photos, pausing at the photo he took of the polaroid of the two sleeping together. He swallowed hard, feeling tears prick his eyes. He closed his phone and let it hit his chest, placing both hands to his eyes. He choked back a sob, trying his

best to keep it together. He hated that he knew he had to wait. He hated that there was a possibility Izuku would hate him forever if he told him the truth. The truth of his feelings could ruin everything. Bakugo turned in his bed, grasping onto a pillow close to him. He pushed his head into the pillow and let out a scream. He was beyond frustrated, and there was nothing else he could do about it. He was stuck being hopeless, and alone until he could forgive himself for being the way he was.

He was held hostage by no one but himself.

-

Izuku stood in front of the buses waiting to board with the rest of his class for camp. He yawned, rubbing his eye.

“Camp! Camp! Camp!” Denki, Mina and Uraraka cheered and danced around together.

“I still don’t get why I’m supposed to be here.” Riso muttered, crossing his arms. “Aizawa never told me why.”

“Aha! Who’s this?!” Monoma stepped forwards, leaning back slightly as he laughed. “Class 1A had someone replaced and now you have an extra person joining you?! This just proves Class 1B is the superior clas-!” He was stopped by Kendo hitting him in the back of the head.

“I apologize for him.” Kendo said, dragging him away from Class 1A.

“No matter the reason, I’m glad you’re coming with us.” Shoji nods at Riso. “You’re wonderful to be around.”

“Aw..thanks. I like being around you too.” Riso smiled at him. Aizawa approached the class, a tired look on his face.

“The drive will be roughly an hour and thirty minutes. I hope you all didn’t forget anything. We won’t be turning back. Understood?”

“Yes sir!” His class cheered, and Iida stood up.

“Everyone line up in seat order!”

No one listened. They all got on the bus, and Riso stood there awkwardly. Aizawa motions to the seat next to him.

“Sit.”

“I’m sitting next to you? But-!”

“Sit.” Aizawa growled. “The whole reason you’re on this trip is because we’re at a shortage for heroes so the teachers have to work and can’t watch you.”

“I don’t need a babysitter!”

“Now that I know who you are,” Aizawa gave him a look. “I can’t trust you to stay out of trouble.”

“Not fair.” Riso sat next to Aizawa and crossed his arms. Aizawa went to tell the class to be quiet, and quickly gave up once he realized this would probably be the only time they’d get to have a moment like this to have fun.

“You drug Bakugo into your mess?” Aizawa asked Riso. “I saw him go to Recovery Girl for a stab injury. Is there *another* vigilante I need to look for?”

“What? No! Him and Zuku were walking home and got attacked and I helped him. He…does technically help though.”

“God damnit, Riso. You give me such a fucking headache.”

“Well! He insisted! Blame him, not me!”

“Just be quiet. I'm taking a nap.”

Shinso was sat next to Sato, Sero and Ojiro. He didn’t expect them all to make conversation with him. But they did.

“What you did at the sports festival was impressive.” Ojiro told him, “Especially since you weren’t in the hero course back then.”

“You’re..not upset about it? What I did was..pretty villainous.” Shinso muttered.

“Nah, man! Don’t sweat it.” Sero laughed. “Todorki totally went overboard when he defeated me, but I don’t hold it to him.”

“Nice try.” Sato says with a snicker.

“Hey! C’mon!” Sero whined.

“I’m not mad about it, no. It helped me be more aware of my surroundings.” Ojiro gave Shinso a smile. “It was a really good learning experience for me.”

“...Is your whole class this nice?” Shinso asked. “I’ve been here a few days and yet you..all seem so welcoming.”

“Bakugo’s the only asshole,” Sero starts.

“I heard that!!” Bakugo yelled, and Sero waves his hand in a dismissing manner.

“You’re our new classmate so we’re obviously going to find a way to be welcoming!” Sero finished. “It’s nice to have someone other than Mineta in our class. He was a nightmare.”

“We replaced our class’ token purple person with another purple person.” Sato said, “I think it’s just destiny at this point.”

“So is camp your first time being trained?” Sero asked, leaning back in his seat.

“Uh, no. Aizawa has been training me. For a while now.” Shinso looked at his hands. “I know it’s probably surprising.”

“Not really…You kind of look like his kid or something. I mainly think it’s the hair and tiredness look you have going on.” Sato mentions.

“Did Riso make you a support item?” Ojiro asked, “He’s our class’ designated support course student. You should have him make you something. I bet it’ll be really cool with your quirk.”

Shinso blushed. “He..already did. Uh, it’s a mask.”

“Ooo, you’re blushing.” Sero teased. “Got a crush?”

“I feel like I’ve been asked that a lot lately.” Shinso rubbed the back of his neck. “I..It’s complicated.”

“Complicated? You two are..pretty cute together.” Sato says. “Have you just not made it official?”

“Uh..no. I guess we haven’t. I don’t know if I even should.”

“Are you kidding?? I overheard him talking to Deku. He’s head over heels for you!” Sero says, shaking his head.

“He does-?”

“Riso doesn’t exactly talk quietly.” Sato chuckles. “You seem to have someone that really cares about you, Shinso.”

“I know. It’s scary sometimes.” Shinso let himself open up for a moment. “I’m always worried I’m going to mess something up. Love is delicate. It’s hard to achieve, even platonic love. He means a lot to me, and all it takes is for one thing to go wrong. I mean, you guys have people you care about, right?”

“Yeah. Having friends is pretty similar. One thing can ruin everything that’s been going on for a while. You’re right, love in every form is delicate.” Sero agreed.

“I think that’s why some people should act sooner than later.” Ojiro glances down the bus, “It’s hard to pinpoint how people feel, but telling them sometimes is for the best.”

“Like Bakugo and Midoriya?” Sato asks. “They’re both obviously crushing. But if no one makes a move, then what’s going to happen?”

“Disaster.” Shinso remarked. “Nothing but pure disaster. I think one or the other would go insane if they don’t tell each other soon.”

“Oh yeah, most definitely.” Sero nodded. “Bakugo is crushing hard on Midoriya. It’s all in the way he looks at him. Can’t get gayer than that in my opinion.”

“I CAN FUCKING HEAR YOU, TAPE ARMS.”

“Then close your ears!”

Riso looked at Aizawa when they suddenly stopped an hour or so into their trip.

“This isn’t a rest stop.” Riso says, tilting his head. “What are you planning..?”

“You keep your mouth shut.” Aizawa let the kids exit, and he stood outside of the bus with them. Riso was told to stand next to Aizawa and not move.

“This isn’t a very good rest stop.” Izuku complained, stretching slightly. Shinso stood next to him with an odd.

“Almost makes me suspicious.” Shinso muttered.

Riso turned to Aizawa with a disapproving look.

“You’re going to make them go through the forest. Aren’t you?” He asked, crossing his arms.

“Can’t you just mind your business, Riso?” Aizawa sighs.

“Nope.”

“Hey, hey!” Mandalay jumped out of the car with Pixie-Bob, and a kid stood off to the side.

“Oh my goodness,” Izuku’s eyes widened.

“We’re the Wild, Wild Pussycats!” Pixie-Bob smiled brightly.

“Do you see that area alllll the way out there, down the moutain?” Mandalay points down the mountain and an empty area. She earned nods and people saying they saw it. “That’s the camp you’ll be staying at with the pussycats!”

“Woah, that’s pretty far.” Kirishima said.

“It’ll take you about three hours to get there from here.”

Sero glanced around nervously. “Heh..right..”

“Maybe..let's get back on the bus.” Mina said, starting to back out.

“Ah, kittens that don’t make it there by noon won’t get any lunch!” Pixie-Bob smiled innocently at the group of kids standing in front of her.

“Crap! Everyone back on the bus and save yourselves!” Kirishima called out, turning around to run back onto the bus.

“Oh, no. I told your class camp was to train you.” Aizawa smirks. “Camp starts now.”

“Are you-” Riso starts, and then shuts up when he was glared at. Pixie-Bob threw her hands in the air and everyone fell to the ground below them. Aizawa looked over the edge.

“Make it there before sundown.”

“This isn’t fair, Aizawa!” Riso said, walking over to him.

“You’re joining them too. You’re not here to relax.” Aizawa shoved Riso off the edge. He turned on his heel as Riso landed on his back. He had managed to land where it didn’t hurt him, and maybe Aizawa put too much faith in the fact that he was Cosmic. Riso quickly looked up.

“You asshole!” Riso called, then turned around with a grumble.

“Come on,” Todoroki muttered and started to walk towards the forest. He instantly took a fighting stance when the ground rumbled.

“You’re kidding.” Uraraka said, looking panicked.

A large monster built from dirt and rock stomped towards them.

“Don’t attack, my friend!” Koda yelled, holding his hands out in an attempt to stop the monster. It didn’t. Bakugo growled and threw an explosion towards it. Izuku grabbed a stick from the ground and ran into action after Bakugo. He seemingly bounced like a rabbit when he jumped into the air, and he swung the stick. He knocked its head clean off its shoulder.

“We have obstacles too?!” Denki growled, jumping onto one's back. “One point three million volts!” He shocked the dirt monster until it crumbled under the amount of electricity it just endured. Across from him, Mina was burning their legs until it fell. Once it fell, Todoroki used his ice to pierce its body.

Riso had found himself perched onto a tree alongside Shinso, setting up a trap. He felt himself blush when he felt Shinso lean over his shoulder.

“This is going to work?”

“As long as they distract all of the monsters for now. It’ll cut them all in half and it’ll take Pixie-Bob longer to make replacements.” Riso jumped down from the tree. “Take this string down there. Hurry!”

Shinso ran to the tree Riso pointed out, and tied the string around the tree. Riso did so as well, before calling out.

“PINEAPPLES!” He yelled out, and the sound of feet and fighting scrambling towards them. Riso was picked up by Shinso and the two of them were pulled up into the tree by the capture weapon. As most of the class jumped over or slid under the string, the monsters came down hard against the string, They all got cut in half, like Riso planned, and crumbled to the ground.

“You did it!” Shinso looked at Riso. *I could kiss you, I’m so happy right now.*

“Run, guys! We’ll catch up, we have to take these down!” Riso called to the class, looking at Shinso. “Of course it worked. Help me take it down?” He climbed down the tree. He gently began to untie the string. He hummed softly to himself, glancing at Shinso. Shinso seemed to glance at him too, because they both looked away from each other embarrassedly seconds later.

“Riso? Can..Can I say something?” Shinso asked, walking closer to him while rolling up the string in his hand.

“Hm?” Riso looked at him, a small smile on his face. “Of course you can.”

“I..Well, I..like-”

Shinso was interrupted by a roar that came from behind Riso. His eyes widened, and he darted forward.

“Watch out!” Shinso called, tackling Riso out of the way from a monster that was coming for him full force. The two rolled and rumbled across the slight slant in the ground. Riso grunted in pain as Shinso rolled off from top of Riso. The two of them stared up at the sky before laughing. The laughter came to a stop when a foot came down between them. They both roll the opposite way quickly, throwing themselves onto their feet. Riso brushed himself off. He climbed the tree in front of the monster, and Shinso wrapped the capture weapon around its head.

Riso swung from the tree, kicking the monster back with a swift kick. Shinso pulled back on his capture weapon, and the head came off with a swift ‘pop’. Riso dropped onto the ground and bent over to catch his breath. Once he was recovered, he turned to Shinso.

“You were saying..?”

“It’s nothing important. Let's get to camp, okay?”

The entire class made it to camp before sundown. The pussycats seemed very pleased with the time they made it in.

“You said it would only take three hours!”

“Well..we kind of went based on how long it would take us to do it.” Mandalay said with a smile, and Pixie-Bob nodded.

“You still did incredible! You handled my creations with ease!” She clapped.

“I have a question.” Izuku raised his hand. “Who’s…kid is that?”

“That’s Kota. We take care of him..he didn’t really have anywhere else to go.” Mandalay said softly, her voice seeming sad. Izuku walked up to Kota and held out his hand.

“Hi. I’m Izuku Midoriya. It’s nice to meet you, what’s your nAME?” Izuku yelped when Kota punched him in the balls. Bakugo let a smile show and Kirishima snickered.

“Is that a smile?” He teased and Bakugo growled while glaring.

“Shut up!”

The class walked inside of the building and they met with Ragdoll.

“We’ve prepared a meal for all of you! Usually we wouldn’t cook for you all, but since you worked so hard we figured you could use it!” Ragdoll said with a smile, “Please enjoy!”

Everyone basically scarfed down their food, but Izuku and Riso stared at their food. They glanced at each other, then looked at the food again. Izuku began to eat slowly but Riso never did. He looked sick looking at the amount of food on the table.

“Awh man, this is so good!” Kirishima announces, shoving food into his mouth faster than he could think.

“It’s just as good as Lunch Rush’s food!” Denki agreed.

“Wow, Momo. You’re eating pretty fast,” Jirou said quietly.

“I have to, my quirk relies on lipids. The more I eat, the more I can create.”

“..Like how poop works.” Sero nodded, but was punched in the back of the head by Jirou.

“Apologize!!” She called out.

Off to the side, Kota was watching the group of future heros talk and he felt his anger build inside of him. He stomped off without a second thought.

After dinner, the entire class went to the bathing room. Riso had completely emerged himself into the water. He watched the rest of class talk and laugh among themselves. He wouldn’t deny that he was feeling slightly out of place and home sick. He just wanted to sleep.

“Riso! Did Mr. Aizawa ever tell you why you were here?” Denki asked. Shoji nodded.

“I’m also curious.”

“He invited pinky-pie because he can't be trusted alone.” Bakugo rolled his eyes, and Shinso looked at him. He snickered.

Definitely friends. He thought to himself.

“That’s not true, blasty!” Riso glared, “..Okay that’s what he told me. But! I can use it to observe everyone’s quirks in a greater light and watch as you use them and train! I can also learn your basic body movements and fighting style so whatever support items I end up using, I can make them fit with your fighting style the best! I see this as a potential learning experience.”

“You’re such a fucking nerd.”

“But it’s true. And be careful how you talk to me, because I make your adjustments. I can make it uncomfortable, and make it hurt. Try me, you bitch.” Riso narrowed his eyes at Bakugo.

“Are you kidding me? I will-!”

“Kacchan, please don’t threaten to blast anyone.” Izuku sighed, “I don’t want to have to help anyone because you wanted to be…explosion.”

“Ha! Nice one, Midoriya!” Denki snickered.

“We should be relaxing,” Todoroki said. “Not trying to murder each other.”

“Shut up, icy hot.” Bakugo narrowed his eyes. He stopped threatening to hurt people after that, though. Izuku smiled and thanked Bakugo for calming down.

“I wonder how camp is going to be. Mr. Aizawa said it would be hard. Do you really think he’s going to be tough on us?” Kirishima asked.

“Without a doubt. A few hours ago he shoved me off a cliff to prove a point.” Riso said. “Aizawa is a lot meaner than he is to you guys. I think it’s because of everything you guys have been through but don’t expect him to always be nice to you. His class last year hated him.”

“Should we be worried?” Aoyama asked.

“Yes. You should. Actually, you should be scared shitless.” Riso looks at his hands that were under the water. “He’s going to break you guys starting tomorrow. And I feel even worse for the bunch of you that failed. Don’t expect to have any fun.”

Eventually, everyone found their way to their room where they would sleep. Izuku was laying down by himself, struggling to find any way to fall asleep. He glanced towards Bakugo, who was looking at him. Izuku gulped and got on his knees and crawled over to Bakugo.

“I can’t sleep.” He whispered, laying in front of him.

“The fuck am I going to do about it?” Bakugo whispered back.

“Can you please hold my hand like how you used to, Kacchan?” Izuku asked softly, not meeting his eyes. He heard Bakugo sigh, and he pulled him close by his waist. He wrapped his arm around him.

“Shut up and just sleep. Okay? Do you still have those nightmares?”

“Sometimes..I-I feel like I might have one tonight..” Izuku muttered. His nightmares usually only happened when he was stressed or felt alone, or even in a new place. They were of his dad hiding him in places alone, or beating him and his mother in an attempt to make Izuku ‘worth it’. He looked up at Bakugo.

“I’ll help. But only for tonight. I'm too tired to argue with you.” That was the last thing that he said before falling asleep. Izuku grabbed Bakugo’s shirt and held him close. His smell was comforting to Izuku, and led him into a deep sleep almost instantly. He felt their breathing synchronize right before he closed his eyes for the rest of the night.

Izuku didn’t have a single nightmare that night.

Chapter End Notes

whoop whoop!! hope u guys enjoyed it!! love u guys <3
updates every wednesday and sunday!

Chapter Twenty Seven

Chapter Summary

> Bakugo dreams of a possible future, and quirks are put to the test. Is there an unusual, possible friendship brewing between two very different people?

Chapter Notes

> hi guys i hope u like this one!! lots of bakudeku content in this chap, but there is a mention of suicide early on so beware! love u guys <3

See the end of the chapter for more notes

It wasn't very often that Bakugo clung to something so tight in his sleep. He had many nights where he fell asleep in tears while hugging his pillow, but this time the 'pillow' in question had body heat and was breathing with him. The comfort was odd to him, but while he fell asleep he could feel a small smile crept onto his face. He felt at peace when his brain slipped into a dream.

Bakugo stood in a living room, the TV blaring with the latest news.

"Pro-Hero Red Riot defeats villain and saves hundreds!"

Bakugo went to scoff but two smaller children ran up to him. One had bright blonde curly hair with red eyes, and the other had green spiky hair with green eyes. They spoke before he could.

"Daddy, daddy!" The blonde one spoke, jumping up and down. "Did you see Uncle Kiri on the TV?!" She smiled brightly.

“He’s so cool! I wanna be strong and manly like him!” The green haired one smiled and his eyes glistened. Bakugo stared at him, narrowing his eyes. He knew those eyes.

“Kids, it’s time for dinner. Go wash up, okay?” Bakugo’s head turned so fast he could’ve sworn it popped. In the kitchen stood an older Izuku, wearing an apron covered in hand-sewn hearts. He blinked, then looked towards where the kids ran off too. He connected the dots and felt his face flush red.

“Kacchan?” Izuku called, and Bakugo stood slowly. He turned to Izuku and walked over. He glanced at his hand, and felt his breath catch in his throat when he saw a golden ring around his finger.

“We’re married?” He said in disbelief, “...and we have kids?”

“Uh huh,” Izuku nodded. “Of course we’re married, Kacchan. You love me, you told me during our time at UA.”

“..I did?”

“Mhm. It was so shocking, since you had been so mean to me before. You said that you were just confused and frustrated. But it’s okay! I understand, and I love you too!” Izuku leaned forward and planted a kiss on his cheek.

“I love you?” Bakugo asked, feeling his head begin to spin. “I..I love you?” He locked eyes with Izuku and felt his heart drop. The scene changed, and he saw four-year-old Izuku in front of him in tears.

“Wh..Why are you being so mean, Kacchan?” He said through sobs, wiping his eyes with his arm. “Do you hate me?”

“What? Deku, no, I-” Bakugo started, feeling a panic rise in his chest. The scene changed again, warping him to the top of the building. He felt his throat tighten as if it was trying to

swallow a bite of too much food. The subtle pain brought tears to his eyes. He watched Izuku turn around and face his back to the busy street below him. Bakugo stepped forward, Izuku's face scrunching in anticipation. He felt his feet begin to move, his body lunging forward when a gust of wind knocked Izuku over the edge. He let out a blood curdling scream, and Bakugo looked over the side in a panic. He felt a sob slip out when he saw Izuku had a hand out as if he was waiting for someone to grab him. He looked so, so terrified and alone. So Bakugo did the only thing he could think of. He thrusted his hand out quickly, their fingertips barely touching.

"Izuku!"

Bakugo's eyes shot open, tears streaming down his face. He felt his breathing slow when he saw Izuku's sleeping face, but at the same time he felt the same breath get caught in his throat. He slowly pulled himself from Izuku's grasp, who whimpered softly in a sleep-driven protest. Bakugo ignored it and sat up, placing a hand to his head. He stood up and tip-toed everyone and walked outside for a breath. He needed to get away. Apparently, he wasn't the only one.

Outside, Riso was laying on the ground looking at the sky. He looked over, his hair falling in front of his eyes.

"Bakugo?"

"Riso."

"Bad dream?" Riso tried to joke, but a sad excuse for a laugh came out.

"I made him jump off that building." Bakugo muttered, leaning against the cabin and wiping the dried tears on his face. "Right?" Riso sat up, a serious look on his face.

"You told him to jump off a building to be reborn with a quirk. I'd say yes, without a doubt." Riso was brutally honest, and it made his heart burn.

“I like him.” Bakugo didn’t know why he was confessing this to Riso. He figured maybe he was still half asleep, or maybe it was the intense feeling of guilt eating at him slowly. “I like him and I fucking don’t know what to do. I was so shitty to him, I don’t deserve to like him.”

“Got that right.” Riso muttered. “Look, if you expect me to tell you that it’s okay, and it happens – I’m not. You were horrible, Bakugo. I heard some of the stories from him. I could beat the hell out of you and it would be justified.”

Bakugo went to speak, but he interrupted him.

“But, love always fucking hurts. It’s painful, unforgiving. What you did was shitty, but god does Zuku give every excuse to defend you. He’s protected you, even from feeling like such a fucking asshole. If you truly like him, and feel a connection to him.” Riso starts, looking at him. “You better make this the best fucking shot you can. Do you hear me? I won’t let him waste his time on you twice.”

“..Yeah.” Bakugo looked off to the side. He recalled threatening Shinso basically with the same thing. He chuckled softly. “Yeah, I hear you.” The two shared a silence.

“Do you like the stars, Bakugo?” Riso changed the subject suddenly, looking at the sky. “They’re pretty. Unpredictable. We might be seeing what’s there, or what's left of it.”

Bakugo looked up, seeing the small lights in the sky. He nodded.

“Yeah.”

“Watch them with me?”

“Fine.” Bakugo walked over and laid next to Riso, crossing his arms behind his head. While staring at the stars, he watched as a shooting star flew past their line of sight. He felt childish, but he made a wish.

I wish that Deku will give me a second chance. A chance I won't fuck up.

The next morning, Izuku woke to his arms clung around a warm body. When his eyes opened and he looked up, he felt his face flush a bright red. Somehow, during the night, the two had shifted to where Bakugo laid flat on his back with one arm around Izuku while Izuku had his arms wrapped around his waist and head on his chest. He gulped, but his anxiety calmed when he felt Bakugo's heartbeat. He took a small and shallow breath, hugging Bakugo tightly. He figured that when he woke, Bakugo would shove him off and yell at him. It was selfish, but he wanted to enjoy this moment. He closed his eyes and almost fell back asleep when he heard hushed talking.

"Oh my god," Denki's voice came out in a whisper. "Kirishima..Kirishima, wake up! Look at Bakugo and Midoriya." Izuku heard some ruffling and groaning, then a small gasp.

"They're cuddling. Sero!"

"The sun isn't even up yet, Kirishima..what do you- oh my god."

"Guys, look!" Denki called as quietly as he could, and Izuku couldn't help but bury his face into Bakugo's chest to avoid them from seeing his blushing face. This stirred Bakugo, who lifted his free arm and wiped his eyes tiredly. He looked down at Izuku and let a small smile onto his face. He looked away from Izuku and met the faces of all his male classmates. He gave a short expression of surprise, then anger.

"The fuck are you all staring at?!" Bakugo growled, causing his classmates to scramble away from him. "Mind your fucking business!" From the corner of his eye, he saw Riso give him a knowing smile. He walked out the room a few seconds later.

Bakugo huffed and turned to Izuku, who had his eyes open now. Izuku gave Bakugo a nervous smile.

"Good morning, Kacchan."

“Morning, nerd. Have any nightmares?” He asked, slight concern peeking through his hard tone.

“No..I slept nicely..”

“Good. Now get off me, I need to get ready.” Izuku nodded and sat up. He ran his hands through his hair, wincing when his hair got caught in his hands. Bakugo watched him, and then sighed. “Talk to Mina. She’ll help you take care of your dumb hair.”

“She..will?”

“Yes.”

“Thanks..” Izuku smiled, feeling his heart pound in his chest. He felt something was different. His heart yearned for Bakugo now more than it ever did. He realized he had been standing still and scrambled to get ready to meet Aizawa outside for the first day of training.

Majority of the class walked slouched, yawning, and still wiping their eyes from waking up. The sky was still slightly dark, the sun was close to coming up. Izuku scanned across the class, taking note of everyone’s attitude toward the early morning wake. His eyes stopped at Bakugo, who had his hands stuffed in his pockets. He gulped, feeling his heart pound in his chest again. He slowly approached Bakugo, and just stood next to him. After a few moments, he glanced at him. He smiled, memorizing his face and each little detail. He yelped and turned away with a bright red face when Bakugo’s eyes snapped in his direction. Bakugo chuckled and barely smiled.

“Good morning class. Today we begin a training camp that will test and improve your strength. Our goal is to advance your skills so you each have the ability to get a provisional license. Those will help you deal with the real life dark forces we deal with.” Aizawa said, looking at Bakugo. “Look alive, Bakugo.” He threw a baseball to him.

“You want me to throw it.” Bakugo looked at him. “Like in the fitness test.”

“Yeah.”

“Alright, nobody blink.” Bakugo took a stance, before throwing it as hard as he could with his quirk. “GO TO HELL!”

“He’s probably going to get a mile this time!” Kirishima said, and Sero nodded. Aizawa held up his phone.

“That was 709.2”

“Huh?” Bakugo looked at Aizawa confused.

“You all have improved a lot as individuals. As far as quirks go, they haven’t improved much at all.”

“So..we’re gonna test our quirks?” Uraraka asked tiredly, but slightly more alert than before.

Aizawa nodded. “This training is going to be so intense that it’s going to feel like you’re dying.” He let a crazed smile appear on his face. “Let’s see if you survive.”

While most of the students in Class 1A began to talk amongst themselves in disbelief, Riso crossed his arms from next to Aizawa.

“That’s a bit harsh. You don’t have to make them fear for their life, you know.” Riso looked at Aizawa. “So what am I supposed to be doing? Taking notes of their quirks?”

“You’re participating in the training too.” Aizawa looked at him, “You’re not excluded from this.” He’d never verbalize it, but seeing the surprise and shock appear on Riso’s face made Aizawa feel happy.

“What? But I’m not going to be a hero!” Riso protested.

“You and I both know you’re the next best thing.”

“I already know you’re going to break their quirks, but that’s impossible with me. The closest is my breakdowns but-”

“You shouldn’t have breakdowns. Not like yours. That’s why I’ve paired you with Shinso. He’ll have to use his quirk to the best of his ability to control you so your brain doesn’t turn to mesh.”

Riso couldn’t help but stare at Aizawa like he was insane. Before he could speak, Aizawa smirked and nudged him forward.

“Let’s get started. Oh, and this?” Aizawa grabbed Riso’s journal from his hands. “Can’t have that.”

“Aizawa!”

“Go.”

The class was separated into groups, and then split off to work on their quirks. It was toture. Denki had been hooked to a battery that was constantly pumping electricity into him, Bakugo was overloading his hands, and Kirishima and Ojiro were sparring. Unfortunately for Shinso and Riso, their training could only really start once Riso accumed to his breakdown.

“You could try to use your quirk on me,” Riso said. “Before I go all crazy.”

“You don’t go crazy, and I’d never do that.”

“You’re going to have to. I mean, you can’t be scared to use your quirk. Besides, you should try to control me to do things that require thinking. I know your quirk can really instruct, but you should try to expand that.”

“You think I’m scared?” Shinso raised an eyebrow. Riso didn’t speak, but rather smirked. To his surprise, he began to make symbols with his hand. Shinso recognized it as JSL.

‘ *You really think I’d answer any question of yours verbally now?* ’

Shinso scoffed at Riso, and waved his hand dismissively.

“You got me. How am I supposed to train my quirk if you don’t let me?”

‘ *Be alert. Try to get me to talk. We should be sparring, so you can work under pressure.’*
Riso instantly swung at Shinso, who threw himself back. Shinso took a deep breath and before he could even get into a fighting position, Riso had jumped up and swung around – landing a swift kick to his face. He landed, and fixed his posture instantly. Shinso winced in pain, holding a hand to his cheek which had a distinct footprint on his face.

“You kicked me.”

“I did.”

“And so quickly.”

“Sure did.”

“How?”

‘ *You know that answer, Shinso.’* Riso snickered and launched another attack. He dashed forward, dodging a punch Shinso threw his way. He slid under him, and popped up behind him. He grabbed his waist and picked him up off the ground.

Riso felt his breath get caught in his throat when Shinso rocked his body forward, using the momentum to pick Riso off his feet and roll him forward. He hit the ground with a grunt, rolling into a defense stance.

“What? Did I surprise you?” Shinso asked, dodging an immediate attack Riso threw at him. He grabbed Riso’s fist, but Riso managed to get his hand back quickly. Riso didn’t speak.

“C’mon, don’t ignore me.” Shinso said, manipulation and lies lining his tone. Shinso swept Riso’s feet from under him, but Riso grabbed his shirt and pulled him to the ground with him. Riso was the first to move, and rolled himself and Shinso around until Riso was hovering over him. He smiled at him in a sadistic manner, and raised his hand to punch him. Shinso felt his eyes widen slightly, and he shoved Riso’s shoulders the best he could and took the split second of imbalance to throw him off himself. Shinso rolled away from Riso, and pushed himself onto his feet. He felt a bead of sweat drip from his face.

“You can talk to me! Don’t you want to know more about my quirk?”

Riso didn’t respond again. His chest rose and fell at a quickened pace, and between his strands of his hair his eye peered through. Shinso felt a shiver slither down his spine when he saw the glint in Riso’s eye. To describe it, his green eye glistened in the sunrise and there seemed to be this film that came over it. It wasn’t the innocent and soft eyes he saw when he looked at Riso *or* Cosmic. He also held a smirk that screamed ‘ *I know what you’re going to do next and you can’t do anything about it* ’. Shinso furrowed his eyebrows, but the realization hit him.

For once, Riso’s quirk had been activated in combat. His quirk was always working, but when his quirk uselessly overflowed it caused him to shut down and hyperfocus on creating. This was good, this was the progress Aizawa had wanted from Riso. His quirk wasn’t just good for creating.

Through Riso's eyes, he could see the calculations and path Shinso was most likely to take based on the information he knew about his fighting style in a blueprint view. He was going to throw a right-handed punch, but use his foot to get Riso onto the ground.

Sure enough, Shinso acted with the right-handed punch. Riso dodged with his head but grabbed his arm, and jumped over Shinso's foot that was meant to trip him. Riso suddenly twisted Shinso's right arm, and threw him over his shoulder. Shinso gasped for breath when his back came in contact with the ground. He looked up, feeling slightly dazed. He locked eyes with Riso, and he swallowed hard. Riso pulled him up by his shirt collar. Shinso glanced around for an opportunity to get away. His eyes lit up when he reached for the branch a few inches from his hand.

In a quick movement, he grabbed the branch and cringed softly when he swung it to hit Riso in the head. Riso held his hand up, and blocked the blow. A thinner stick coming off the branch dug into his skin and sliced it open. Shinso grumbled, hating that he would have to resort to his last possible option. His face flushed red as he placed a hand on the hand Riso was using to hold his collar.

"I..I like you!" It wasn't a question, but he forced all his energy into the statement.

Riso visibly paused, "What?" Riso's body went limp and he let go of Shinso, who hit the ground softly. Shinso took a breath, throwing his head back against the ground. He placed a hand to his forehead.

"Shit," He muttered, standing slowly. His body ached from all the hits Riso landed on him. He hadn't even got more than three hits on Riso. "**Sit.**"

Riso sat on the ground, looking at Shinso with blank eyes. Shinso tried to think and push past the daze of the fight.

"**Tell..Tell me your name.**" Shinso demanded through pants, holding his side. He didn't expect this to work since he couldn't control others to do something that required an advanced brain function. Speaking was one of those things.

“Riso Sakusei.” Riso’s words were bland, and stiff. Shinso looked at Riso confused, his heart racing.

That worked. Holy shit, that fucking worked! Shinso let a smile reach his lips, and before he could shake Riso he seemed to wake on his own.

“..Shinso?” Riso asked, shaking his head. “You got me..?”

“I did. I usually struggle with brainwashing with just a typical statement…a question mostly works the best. Here, you’re hurt.” Shinso said, leaning down and sitting next to Riso. He grabbed a bag that was placed not to far away from them, and pulled out a few medical supplies. Riso took a large breath, placing a hand under his chin.

“I feel so tired.” Riso muttered.

“You used your quirk in combat.” Shinso says, grabbing his arm and cleaning the wound.

“This reminds me of when you witnessed my training for the first time and you got hit by that one rock, and I had to bandage your cheek.” Riso mumbles softly, ignoring Shinso. “How the tables have turned, I guess..”

“Ah! You two kittens aren’t training!”Mandalay said, waving at the two. “Hurry it up!”

“Don’t try to kill me.” Shinso said, helping Riso to his feet.

“I don’t plan on it.”

“**Say ‘I won’t hurt you.’**” Shinso smiled in victory, but Riso instantly broke out of the brainwash.

“Gotta work harder than that, sweetheart.” Riso winked at Shinso, who blushed and froze. Riso tackled him.

When dinner time came around, Riso was one of the first people to start cooking. He and Bakugo happened to work well together in a kitchen setting. Both Shinso and Izuku were standing back, watching their crushes bounce off of each other’s energies. When Riso needed an ingredient, or even assistance, Bakugo seemed to be right on top of it and gave him what he needed. Same with Bakugo for anything he needed.

“..They’re incredible.” Izuku said, his grip loose on the knife he was holding.

“Unlikely friends, I guess.” Shinso muttered, distracted from his own chore.

“..How did your training go today?” Izuku tried to tear his eyes away from Bakugo.

“Eventful. I told Riso I liked him and then he beat my face in with a branch a few minutes later.”

“What?” Izuku looked at him with a smile. “Does he remember you confessing?”

“No idea. You can never tell with him..” Shinso looked back down at the plate he was using to cut ingredients. He sighed. “I saw you and Bakugo were pretty close last night.”

“I-It wasn’t like that!”

“Sure it wasn’t.” Shinso snickered. He paused, watching Kota walk off slowly.

“Do you..happen to know anything about him?” Izuku said. “I don’t think he’s eaten anything yet..”

“After we eat, you can always take him something?” Shinso offered, “I think the curry won’t be too bad.”

Shinso was right and wrong about the curry. The pots Bakugo and Riso made were fucking delicious. Everyone else struggled a bit, and their curry wasn't as good. Riso and Bakugo seemed to be one of the only ones who knew how to cook a meal from scratch. Riso set a bowl of it aside for Kota, practically reading Izuku’s mind.

Izuku couldn’t sit and eat, so he took the bowl of curry to Kota. While he was gone, Bakugo was eating at the table. He was quiet and keeping to himself when Denki broke the ice.

“You and Midoriya, huh? I saw you two sleeping together last night.” Denki asked through his bites of food.

“Shut up, dunce face.”

“Awh but *Kacchan*!” He teased, “Are you two a thing??”

“I said fuck off.” Bakugo growled.

Denki pouted, “C’mon, please?”

“It’s not of your god damn business now shut the hell up before I beat your face in!” Bakugo yelled, scoffing. “Can’t you stay out of people's business??”

“We’re just curious.” Kirishima placed a reassuring hand on his shoulder.

“Don’t be.” Bakugo stood. “I’m going to wash off and sleep.” He stormed away.

He was in bed before anyone, and the room was empty with Shinso slipped in. He looked at Bakugo, and he spoke first.

“Don’t you dare ask about Deku and I.”

“I wasn’t going to.” Shinso shrugs, sitting in his own sleeping bag. “Just treat him right.”

“Same goes for you, insomniac.” Bakugo rolled his eyes. “I saw you two sparring today. You and pinky-pie sure do know how to get on my nerves just by trying to kill each other.”

“Right, next time we’ll do it on the moon instead.” Shinso muttered jokingly, earring a subtle chuckle from Bakugo.

“Fuck off, don’t disturb me. I’m going to sleep.” Bakugo fell asleep not too long after. Shinso couldn’t sleep no matter how hard he tried. He happened to witness Izuku come in. Izuku saw his bag next to Bakugo and sat down. He gulped, and laid in the bed and curled up in the blanket.

Izuku let out a small squeak after Bakugo wrapped his hands around Izuku and pulled him closer to his chest.

“Kacchan,”

“Shut up. Just enjoy it.”

“..O-Okay, Kacchan.” Izuku’s smile was hard to contain, and so was his blushing. “A-and you were right, Mina helped me..My hairs really soft now..”

Bakugo had tried to decide against it, but he placed his hand on Izuku’s head gently. He was definitely surprised with how soft and fluffy it felt. Usually it felt dry and stiff, but not

anymore. Bakugo ran his fingers through Izuku's hair, twirling a few stands at the same time subconsciously.

"It feels nice, now go to sleep." Bakugo muttered. He almost thought he had Shinso's quirk, because Izuku fell asleep almost instantly. Bakugo held him tightly. He wasn't going to let him go a second time.

Bakugo did his best to cherish this happy and genuine moment. His intuition told him to hold onto it as long as he can because there wouldn't be another opportunity.

Chapter End Notes

does anyone happen to have a shipname for shinso and riso by chance?? i'm not that creative, so if you do, don't be afraid to share it! also give thoughts abt this chapter in the comments!! see u guys on wednesday!

(updates every wednesday and sunday)

Chapter Twenty Eight

Chapter Summary

More of the training arc!

Chapter Notes

had super bad writers block so i could only get out abt 3k words out :/ hopefull you enjoyed!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Riso had never seen so many tired and exhausted kids. He watched as Kirishima fell forward in exhaustion and Aizawa forced him to stand with his capture weapon. It's clear he began to ridicule the group, because they all looked as if their parents had told them to not touch something in a store. Mina whined loudly.

"I need more beauty rest." She said aloud, earning a soft chuckle from Riso. He shook his head and looked at Shinso, who was bandaging part of his leg. Riso had accidentally sliced his leg with a branch he picked off the ground. The amount of cuts and bruises Riso and Shinso had was too many to count, but Izuku was training to put his regeneration quirk into a weak healing quirk. It couldn't fit the Nexus and Cosmic trope better. An idiotic, risky leader like Cosmic with the concerning, healing partner Nexus.

Riso was craving to fight crime. He hadn't done anything in the past three days and it was driving him crazy. It was easier to switch his quirk on in combat because of it, sure, but it prevented him from sleeping well at night. He would've given anything to be able to punch a villain in the face with no remorse. Like they say, be careful what you wish for. Riso was taken out of his thoughts by Aizawa and Pixie-Bob.

"Don't forget why you're sweating." Aizawa announced aloud. "Remember where you started, who you are, and how you got here. You can all move faster."

“Meow, meow, meow, meow! But more importantly, tonight we’re putting you kittens against each other in a test of courage!” Pixie-Bob squealed, shaking her body in excitement. “I know how hard you all have been working and training! So we’ll be having fun!”

“Like that’ll be a good thing.” Shinso stood, his voice flat and unamused.

“Tell me about i-” Riso’s eyes went white, and his body relaxed. Shinso smirked.

“**Tell me a secret of yours.**” Shinso asked, and Riso seemed to resist the brain-washing.

“I’m Cosmic.” Riso spoke in a soft tone, before shaking out of the brainwashing. Aizawa was insanely smart for putting these two together. Riso was the only one who could resist Shinso’s quirk because of his own quirk, but it helped Shinso get stronger.

“You let your guard down.” Shinso snickered.

‘ *Shut up* ’ Riso signed with his hands, before launching an attack on Shinso.

Dinnertime came around, and Bakugo was chopping carrots next to Riso. He had been cutting ingredients for him, as the two worked together silently. They’d never admit aloud they were helping each other, but they both understood they were.

“Woah, you’re really good with that knife!” Uraraka said, watching Bakugo with amazement.

“Of course I am! How can you extras be so bad at it?!” Bakugo yelled at her, his face scrunching in anger.

“Look at that, Bakugo’s not blowing anything up.” Denki snickered, earning a sigh from Kirishima who muttered something about being too tired for that. Riso chuckled softly, looking off to the side at Izuku who was putting wood in the fire pit.

“Hey, Zuku.”

“Can I ask for some advice?” Izuku looked up at Riso, standing.

“Of course, what’s up?”

“Kota..He hates heros. The whole idea of superhumans and quirks. I..I don’t know what to say to him.” Izuku frowns softly.

“Meddling in other people’s business again?” Riso asked playfully.

“He does that.” Todoroki mutters from behind them.

“Sorry, Todoroki..” Izuku blushes.

“I think actions speak louder than words.” Todoroki started, “If you talk so proudly about heros, show him..what they are. Your actions mean more than words right now.”

“I agree with half-and-half.” Riso said, then paused. “Man, I’ve been hanging out with Bakugo too much.” He mutters.

Izuku looks at the firewood, pressing his lips together. “You’re right. I went about this wrong..” Kota would never understand why others look up to heroes, especially if he’s never seen heroic actions that didn’t result in death. He sighed, continuing to help with dinner.

“Alright! Now that we’ve filled our bellies, it’s time for-!”

“A totally awesome act of courage!” Mina said, jumping with joy.

“Yeah!” Sero and Kirishima jumped with her.

“Not the remedial group.” Aizawa’s voice cut like a sharp razor. “You didn’t impress me today in training today, so you’ll have extra lessons with me.”

“Wh-?!” Sato groaned, and Mina let out a surprised gasp.

“That’s not fair, Mr. Aizawa!”

“Let’s go.” He growled in response to her whining, and he wrapped his capture weapon around the five kids who were now moping. “I don’t want to hear a single complaint.”

The silence gave Aizawa a moment to breathe.

“You five won’t be the only ones. There’s one more student I’d like to join the extra lessons.” Aizawa said, adjusting his capture weapon.

Riso felt his ear twitch when he heard that, and instinctively jumped. Aizawa’s capture weapon flew underneath him, and Riso placed his feet on top of it when gravity brought his feet back to earth. He quickly looked back, to see a slightly angry Aizawa. He couldn’t contain his smirk.

“Oh,” Riso’s voice sounded sincere but held a lining of deceit and innocence. “I’m *so* sorry, Mr. Aizawa. It’s just instinct.” He teased in the deceitful tone. Aizawa tightened his fist around the gray weapon. He yanked it back, and it slipped from under Riso’s foot. Riso fell back, being unable to catch himself. “Ow! Not cool!” The capture wrapped Riso’s body, restricting any movement.

“Riso’s joining us?” Kirishima asked, furrowing his eyebrows. “And after he dodged your scarf??”

“He knows why he has to come with me.” Aizawa glared, tugging Riso to his feet. “Now let's go.” Riso muttered a few curse-words to himself, rolling his eyes and following behind him.

“Class 1B will be placed around the trail in certain spots, and they’ll use their quirks to scare Class 1A! You’ll leave in teams of two,” Pixie-Bob explained, smiling bright.

“The winners are the creative students who make the most people piss their pants!”

“Didn’t need that visual.” Jirou muttered.

“Take a slip of paper to find your teammate!”

Izuku absentmindedly grabbed a slip, then looked at the number. He paused, narrowing his eyes at the number. He looked around the groups, seeing the teams form.

Team one is Tokoyami and Shoji..Two is Kacchan and Todoroki..Three is Jirou and Hagakure, Four is Yaoyorozo and Aoyama, Uraraka and Asui..Ojiro and Shinso, then Iida and Koda. That’s seven..I’m eight. If..If my math is correct, I’m alone. Izuku felt a spit in his stomach. *Huh?! How is that fair??*

“Each team will be released every two minutes!”

Izuku gulped and watched as Bakugo tried to get anyone to switch with him. He smiled gently, and walked over.

“It..It’s okay, Kacchan. Todoroki won’t hurt you.” Izuku’s voice must have calmed Bakugo, because he only scoffed in response.

“I’m so happy we got put together!” Uraraka squealed, hugging Tsuyu tight.

“Me too, ribbit.”

“Hey, Midoriya.” Shinso approached Izuku, “Why..Why is Riso stuck with the kids that didn’t pass? If anything, I would’ve expected myself to be there..”

“I think Mr. Aizawa’s heart rate increases by fifty if Riso isn’t in his line of sight. You know how much trouble Riso can get into.” Izuku watched as Bakugo and Todoroki were let into the forest.

“Of course it does. That sounds like the two of them.” Shisno chuckles. “I hope he doesn’t cause too much trouble for him..”

“Because he’s basically your dad and you want him to get along with your crush?” Izuku looked at Shinso, a knowing smile.

“Is it that obvious?”

“Oh, yeah. Without a doubt.”

Bakugo grumbled as he walked through the forest, beside Todoroki. He forced his hands into his pockets, not paying any attention to the oblivious boy next to him.

“Not to pry,” Todoroki started. “But I have to ask. You and Midoriya, are you two-”

“Shut the hell up, icy-hot!” Bakugo growled.

“...So you *are* dating.”

“We are fucking not!”

“Oh.” Todoroki muttered. “I really thought you two were.”

Bakugo scoffed, shoving Todoroki. “Even if we were, I’d never fucking tell you!”

“Midoriya looks at you like how Mr. Aizawa and Present Mic do.”

“What?? You fucking creep!” Bakugo ignited his quirk, but Todoroki didn’t budge.

“If you two ever do start. Will you let me know?”

Riso stared out the window. He was given a worksheet along with the rest of the kids with him, but he could care less about it. He drummed his fingers along the table. He had gripped his pen, spinning the mental blueprint to observe how it was constructed. He hummed quietly to himself, placing the pen on the table. Riso felt someone tap his shoulder, then shake him when he didn’t answer.

“Are you okay?” Mina whispered, looking at him with concerned eyes.

“Mhm.” Riso nodded. “I’m fine.”

“You look upset.” She pouted, grabbing his hand. “You can talk to me.”

“No I can’t. Pay attention.” Riso wouldn’t admit it, but he did feel calm when Mina ran a thumb over his knuckles. It was comforting, and calmed his nerves he didn’t even know he

had. He felt his leg stop bouncing, and he took a breath. He turned and looked at Mina, offering a small smile. He felt his anxiety suddenly rise.

“Man, this is so hard!” Kirishima whined.

“Don’t interrupt Mr. Aizawa, man!” Denki slapped Kirishima’s chest. Riso chuckled softly as the two began to bicker while Aizawa glared at them.

Riso paused, abruptly standing. He blinked, mentally ridiculing himself for standing up so quickly and urgently. Aizawa looked at him with a stern look, telling him to ‘watch what you say next’ with his eyes. Riso nervously chuckled.

“..I- need to use the bathroom. I’ll be right back.” Riso said, earning a nod from Aizawa. He walked out, feeling his lungs tighten. He looked down the hallway, his head spinning violently. The hallway seemed to stretch out, the exit getting farther and farther away from him. His hands became clammy, and he throat tightened. He placed both hands on the cool metal that coated the door handles. He took a large gasp for breath when the air hit his lungs, spreading a coldness across his body. He took another deep breath. He looked at the stars, doing his best to collect himself.

He had no idea why his anxiety spiked so high, but he figured it might’ve been from the layer of smoke that hovered over the top of the trees. Riso bit his lip, wanting to run inside and tell Aizawa. He shook his head, tying his hair back and throwing on his hood from under his clothes. What? Hair in his face wasn’t practical for combat. That didn’t scream forest fire, mainly because it was accompanied by a thin layer of pink smoke. Riso picked up a rock, and pulled the lip off a sharpie he carried in his pocket (he wrote a lot of notes to Aizawa so he always had one ready) and scribbled the following message.

Sorry. You’ll know where to find me. -C

Riso ran beside the window of the room he was just in, and flinched when he heard a voice echo in his head.

“ *There’s been a villain attack! Everyone head back to camp immediately! I repeat, go back to camp and do not engage!”*

Riso threw the rock into the room, landing it at Aizawa’s feet. Seconds later, he disappeared into the forest. Aizawa squinted his eyes at the note on the rock and growled.

“Vlad, protect the students!” He sprinted for the door. He swung open the door and felt his heart drop when he saw the blue fire engulf the once green scenery. He felt worry set in his heart.

“Seems your worry has gotten you rendered defenseless.” A snarky voice said from beside him, blasting a field of fire towards Aizawa.

Izuku’s legs burned as he ran as fast as he could to Kota’s hide out spot. He gulped, ignoring the burning feeling in his lungs. Kota was alone, and he needed to be there. He had to be there for Kota. He wheezed out a breath when he reached close to the top of the climb. He felt his stomach drop when he saw the muscular build of a man, bigger than Izuku could take on alone. He shook his head and pulled out his staff. He flicked it open, and threw himself into the air. In a split second, he had dug the staff into the skin of the man. He pressed his finger down, sending an electric shock down his spine. Izuku yelped when the man grabbed him off his back and threw him at the feet of Kota. Izuku rolled and stopped himself. He grunted, forcing himself onto his feet. The training for the past two days made him sluggish.

“..Wh- What are you doing here?!” Kota asked, panicked. “He’s gonna hurt you!”

“I’m going to save you.” Izuku said, his voice radiated power. “I’ll do my best to protect you, Kota.”

Izuku had no time to listen to the villain rant and whine about how he was never going to hold that statement true. He darted forward, rolling under his legs. He flicked the staff again, clanking against his ankles. The firm steel bard fell slack, turning thin and slicing his achilles’ heel. Izuku ignored the feeling of blood splattering onto his face.

“Ah! You little shit. I’ll have to fucking kill you.” He growled, roughly grabbing Izuku, and throwing him into the nearby wall. Kota let out a gasp, feeling tears well in his eyes.

“Go to hell.” Izuku spit at him, trying to fight himself to not pass out. He could already feel his quirk working. He forced himself to his feet.

“That’s what irritates me about heroes.” The villain started. “They give false hope. Lie to innocent people. And lastly, they’re so god damn perisentent!” He hit Izuku in the middle of his stomach. Izuku yelped again, pain paralzying his body. He took a shallow breath, worried about the (definitely) broken rib he might have from the intense punch he received. Izuku looked at the villain.

“Heroes inspire hope.” He struggled to say, spitting out blood from his mouth. “I’ll never deprive someone of being hopeful. To put their trust into someone else is one of the main parts of being a hero!”

Cosmic didn’t focus on his feet as he ran on the ground, pulling his mask up. He flipped out his own staff, fiddling with it nervously. He had just heard an explosion, and immediately thought of Izuku. He was worried about what might happen if Izuku had been at the other end of that explosion. He ran faster.

He perched himself onto a tree to look at the scene in front of him. He held his breath when he saw a shaking Kota, and Izuku was laying on the floor. He had blood running down his head, and both his arms appeared to be broken. Cosmic saw red.

He growled and tightened his grip on his weapon. He felt his eyes glaze over and he saw the moves of the villain who stood over Izuku. In a flash, Cosmic jumped forward and landed in front of Izuku. He flicked his wrist and the staff collapsed into two gloves. He tilted his neck, feeling it crack under the pressure.

“Who the-”

Cosmic jumped up, and punched the villain in the face (like he had been craving to do for so long). Under the pressure for the protective “staff” glove, he felt the villain’s jaw crack. The

villains growled, his head snapping back in place.

“You fucking shit head.”

“Touché. And watch your language, there’s a child present.” Cosmic whipped, punching him again. This time, the glove enabled second impact that hit harder than the first time. Cosmic kicked off the villains’ chest and flipped to his back, clinging on like an irritating bug. He did it to dodge an attack.

He held on as the villain’s skin began to turn into muscle fibers. Cosmic smirked. Just what he needed. He grabbed out a device from his pocket. He bit his tongue and threw his arm inside of the mess of muscles. He spread his fingers, and the villain paused; clearing in a bit of pain. At Cosmic’s fingertips were edges that were sharp enough to cut skin. He bit his tongue harder and he flicked off the small device into the villain’s skin. He managed to pull himself from the muscles, he instantly turned and ran towards Izuku and Kota. He put out a protective hand, and as the villain went to speak his body froze. He fell back, his body unable to move.

“..Cos..Cosmic?” Izuku muttered, pulling himself from the ground. He swayed a bit, and Cosmic hugged him.

“Hey, it’s okay.”

“Did..Did you kill him?” Kota asked, his voice shaky.

“No, of course not.” Cosmic squatted down to Kota’s level. “I made a device that paralyzed him because it pinched his spinal cord. I’ll tell the doctors how to remove it later. C’mon, I have to carry you to camp.”

Kota gulped and nodded, getting on Cosmic’s back. Cosmic looked at Izuku.

“You can walk?”

“Yeah. He..They want Kacchan.” Izuku’s voice broke. Cosmic gritted his teeth.

“Then we have to hurry. I’ll kill him if he gets hurt.”

Chapter End Notes

whoop whoop!! just so it’s clear; cosmic/riso is to makeup for izuku’s lack of the ofa quirk. so him + izuku are supposed to be the equivalent to canon izuku or close to it. love u guys <3

updates every wednesday and sunday!

Chapter Twenty Nine

Chapter Summary

> The villain attack on the camp gets serious, and Riso's fears and trauma surface at a unforgettable time. Izuku watches Bakugo get ripped from his life.

Chapter Notes

> hi hi! sorry if this chapter is shit i had a fever over 100 Fahrenheit this week :/. this chapter does have some blood and gore mention so let me give you a key!
> * = start of bloody/gore
> ** = end of bloody/gore part
>
> enjoy! hehe

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Izuku felt his arms mending, healing themselves as he ran alongside Cosmic. He couldn't even feel the intense pain he should be, afterall not feeling two broken arms wasn't exactly normal. Izuku wanted to stop the negative thoughts about them wanting to take Kacchan. *His* Kacchan. He was snapped from his thoughts when Cosmic called out.

"Eraser!" Cosmic came to a sudden stop, kicking up dirt at his feet. He sat Kota down, nudging him towards Aizawa. "Thank goodness you're here! You have to get him to safety," Aizawa visibly glares at the two.

"You're all going back to camp. Especially you," Aizawa looked at Izuku. *That kid is running on pure adrenaline. He's going to crash the second it wears off.* Aizawa thought bitterly.

"No, we have to go. Thank you so much, and I'll pay for the window!" Cosmic turned to Izuku and threw him onto his back. "Hold on. I'm getting to Mandalay."

“Wait.” Aizawa said, picking up Kota. “If I can’t stop you, tell her to tell everyone something for me.”

The run to Mandalay was short. Cosmic’s legs moved faster than they ever have, feeling an unsettling anxiety rise in his chest. When Izuku told him that they wanted Bakugo, he didn’t know how to react. The two weren’t friends, but Cosmic cared. *A lot.* He hadn’t even realized he made it to her when Izuku called out to her.

“Mandalay! Kota’s safe, but I need you to send out a few messages for me!” Izuku’s chest pressed against Cosmic’s back when he tried to take a breath. Relief spread across her face when she heard Izuku speak those words, and nodded without breaking her battle stance.

“Lay it on me!”

“Mister Aizawa,” Izuku panted. “He said everyone can fight back! They have permission to use their quirks! The second thing, the villains are after Kacchan! They want to take him!” Her eyes widened, but her composure reminded calm. Though both Izuku and Cosmic could see the fear in her eyes.

“ *Kids of UA High! You have been permitted to fight back and use your quirks under the word of your teacher! I repeat he has permitted quirk use! Fight back!* ” Mandalay connected everyone’s mind. “ *I have also been informed of the villains’ target; Kacchan! He should avoid acting on his own, and not engage in combat!* ”

Bakugo stiffened when the thought hit his mind, wanting to feel embarrassed and angry that he was called such a childish nickname to everyone Mandalay could reach. His face scrunched in distaste, but was quickly replaced with a look of worry. That meant Izuku told Mandalay to call that out. He could only know that by interacting with a villain. He felt his veins run cold.

“I don’t need any fucking help!” Bakugo called out, “Telling everyone to fight but me, who do they think they are?! I’ll show them!” He charged a blast, but a knife flung straight towards his chest. Before he could move his body a sheet of ice flew up from the ground, deflecting the knife’s path and sending it flying in the opposite direction.

“Get over your head, Bakugo. And don’t use your quirk, you’ll set the forest on fire.” Todoroki responded, stumbling to Bakugo’s side.

“Shut up, I’ll attack whoever I want!” Bakugo pulled his hand back.

“I have to follow..I have to do my job..” The villain’s voice was hinting that he was having trouble controlling his actions, but his knives extended when Bakugo went to create a blast. The wind curved around the blades, and Todoroki stomped his foot on the ground. Ice shot up, covering Bakugo as a large shield. It deflected the knives once again.

“He’s good at moving in the forest with his quirk,” Todoroki said, grunting from the student laying on his back.

“Even if the asshole is a small fry. You bastard, fight me!”

The villain rose from the tree-tops, the knives shifting from the weight he was pressing onto them. He began to mutter about flesh as Bakugo’s hand sparked.

“Don’t use large flames!”

“I know, half-and-half! It’ll just make it hard for everyone to get out because of the fire! I’m not fucking stupid!”

Cosmic ran as fast as he could with Izuku tight on his back. Izuku helped lead him in the right direction, looking ahead of their path so Cosmic could focus on not tripping. The two couldn’t take a fall right now. Cosmic felt his ankles burn in pain as his foot came in contact with the soil below him. He felt his eyes widen as he tried his best to skid to a stop when he saw an object in his ‘blueprint view’.

Cosmic’s boot hitched on a stick, sending him forward and Izuku off his back. Izuku yelped as a flash of color grabbed him from the air. Cosmic gritted his teeth when hit the ground, feeling blood pool in his mouth. He spit it out, and forced himself into his knees. He held his

chest, but felt his stomach drop when something grabbed him. He instantly recognized the grab, it was Dark Shadow. He had no time to react before he was slammed into the ground hard, and then thrown back against a tree. It took only a few seconds for his vision to turn dark and his mind go blank.

"No, Cosmic!" Izuku yelled out, only to have a hand cover his mouth.

"Those injuries," Shoji mutters, out of breath. "You shouldn't be here. But you are. Helping your friend."

"..Shoji..?" Izuku asked, noticing the blood on one of his dupli-arms. "Your arm..!"

"It's fine. It was one of my duplicates."

"..Is..Is that who I think it is?" Izuku asks quietly, feeling his heart rate increase when he sees Dark Shadow screech.

"Yeah. Tokoyami." Shoji huffs. He glanced at Cosmic, whose head was busted open and limped against a tree. "We need to get him."

Cosmic, or Riso, was unconscious, but in a dream. His brain was overflowing with energy.

Riso stood slowly, the only thing that was seen in his field of view was white. White fog and smoke covered his feet as he stepped forward.

Riso.

What the fuck? Riso thought you himself, Uh..hello mysterious voice? Is this a lucid dream?

There was no answer. Riso slowly looked around, inching his way forward. After a few steps, Riso suddenly felt himself falling. He held his breath, feeling his head spin as he descended into nothingness. His feet connected hard to the floor, a familiar city breeze brushing against his face. He looked around, then at his hands. His ears tingled and burned so he looked up, squinting at the sun's bright rays. His heart dropped. He recognized this day.

It was the day he saved Izuku's life.

The small frame that once was Izuku stood shakily on the edge of the building. Riso's feet were bolted into the ground, unable to move. His breath was unsteady as he tried to move forward. He put his hands around his leg, and pulled on it to try and get it to move. No luck. He watched helplessly as Izuku fell back. His eyes followed the boy as his speed increased, and his mind didn't leave any room for imagination.

*

Izuku's body hit the ground, blood spilling from his head the second it came in contact with the ground. The blood covered Riso, his hands now glistening in the sun because of a dark red liquid that was on them. Izuku's limps had broken on impact, his scream was blood curdling and rang into Riso's ears. His feet finally moved. He raced to Izuku's side, apologizing as much and as fast as he could. He kneed beside him.

"I'm so sorry, Zuku." His voice broke as tears streamed down his face.

"You didn't save me." Izuku's voice was rasp, small, and barely audible. His tone cut like a rusted razor to Riso. "You're worthless."

His body melted into the concrete, his flesh and bones turning into the dark, red wine colored blood. Riso's throat was tight as he choked on tears. He tried to grab Izuku as he melted away and sobbed harder. A loud, deep voice rang in his mind.

**

You are a failure, Riso Sakusei.

"No, no..I- I'm not. I tried! I tried my best, I- I.." Riso's knees gave out and he slumped against the floor. "It wasn't my fault..!"

The city around him began to disintegrate. The floor turned back into the white smoke, and the horizon seemed nonexistent. Riso didn't stand, but forced himself to look at his hands. They were stained with blood. He felt tears prick his eyes.

He started falling again. This time, he collided with the floor. He gasped for breath and sat up instantly. He looked around panickingly, hating the scene he saw in front of him. Aizawa's head was held by the nomu from the USJ incident. Riso reached out, trying to make his way over to Aizawa.

*

Someone grabbed his arms, and held them back. He felt the fingertips of the culprit press against his skin. Burning ran threw his veins as he felt his skin flake off and his muscles turn to ash. He cried out to Aizawa, whose face was slammed against the concrete. A swift and loud 'crack' sounded and echoed in Riso's ears. The nomu smashed Aizawa's face once more, and his head cracked open. His brain spilled from his skull onto the floor in front of him. Riso's breathing fell short, as the nomu threw Aizawa to the side with no regard for his body. His lifeless eyes trained on Riso, and his mouth opened.

"This is your fault." The words stung like acid. "You did this."

Riso shook his head, unable to even get out any words. He felt his body tense when a familiar hand grabbed the back of his head. The burning sensation of decay smashed his head against the roughly textured concrete floor.

**

Riso shot his head back, gasping for breath. He was back in the white room. He felt around on the floor, his hands cold from the white fog on the floor. He crawled on the floor, trying to hold onto his sanity to the best of his ability. Suddenly, his hand dipped in water. It burned like boiling water, and he yelped as he pulled his hand back. He peered over the reflection and felt his heart turn cold at the sight. His face was nothing but red skin and muscle, his neck slowly decaying like his face already was. He placed a hand to his cheek when an arm came through the puddle at an alarming rate. It grabbed Riso, and pulled him in.

Riso hit the ground once more, this time he barely had any energy to roll himself over on his side. He blinked when he felt soft raindrops hit his forehead. He already began to panic, recognizing the night instantly. The reflection of street signs lit up the puddles of water in the alleyway. He tried to force back tears when he made himself stand. He held a hand to his chest, his body still burning from the boiling water he went through earlier. He limped towards a door that was lit up by an old light.

The door swung open, and a boy was thrown onto the wet ground. He scrambled to his feet, but the guy still in the doorframe forced him onto his knees by knocking him onto the ground. The boy held his head low, the rain causing his bright purple hair to stick to his forehead.

"Look at me, boy!" The man yelled, throwing a bottle onto the ground. The boy didn't flinch. "You're done. You hear me? DONE! No more living with us, you piece of shit!" His yelling was accompanied by a woman's crying. The interaction was empty, and the boy only softly nodded.

"Okay." He spoke, his voice breaking in a million pieces. The man picked him up by his collar in a fit of rage.

*

"I told you not to talk no more, you villainous child!" He punched the boy once, blood immediately running from his busted nose. The next punch busted his eyebrow, and the one after that bruised his eye. The man continued to hit the boy, and eventually threw him on the ground. He stomped on his head, smirking in a sadistic way when he heard and felt a crack under his boot. He kicked the boy in the stomach multiple times, before shutting the door with a slam.

*****

Riso couldn't stop the tears as he finally reached the boy, turning him over with all his might. He cupped his face, running his thumb over his cheek in a comforting manner.

"Hitoshi," He spoke softly, "I..I'm so sorry. I should've been here. That's what I'm supposed to do..I'm supposed to save you. That's how it's supposed to happen."

"...Riso?" Shinso barely could get his words out, tears lining his eyes. The rain came down harder, the raindrops felt like bullets hitting Riso's back.

"I'm here, I..I'm here, Shinso.." Riso sobbed out, watching as the rain sloppily washed away the blood that was trickling down Shinso's face.

*" **Stop breathing, you fucking monster.** " Shinso's soft expression changed into a wicked one. Riso felt his throat close as he put a hand to his throat. He fell back, and when he hit the ground the room changed to the white one. He gasped for breath, only to have nothing enter his lungs. His throat burned as if he were holding back tears and his lungs begged for oxygen. He felt his hands shake and his head felt light. His body fell back against the floor, the fog around him whistling out of the way from the wind his movement made. He felt his eyes begin to close, his hands falling to his side. In the last few moments they were open, he saw everyone he had grown to know dead. All those lives he saved, he saw what happened if he had been useless. A brutal scene of blood and body parts scattered, Riso at the center of all the chaos.*

Riso.

Riso saw nothing. Not black, or what he saw when his eyes were closed. He saw nothing . He heard muffled voices.

Riso.

He was so tired. He wanted to give up. He wanted to rest, fully ready to take accountability for the death around him. He felt a pressure on his chest.

"Riso!"

Riso's eyes shot up, as he took a long gasp for breath. His body had jolted forward, but his body fell back against the floor. He looked around, dazed. Straddling him was Bakugo, who had sweat beads on his face. Riso had never seen such worry on the angry boy's face before. He noticed the look of relief on his face, and Riso then saw his hands. They were on his chest, fingers interlocked with his other hand.

CPR. Riso thought, letting his eyes look behind Bakugo. Shoji, Tokoyami, Todoroki and Izuku stood there. Worry was deep in their eyes, and Izuku had tears streaming down his face. Riso tried to think, but a pain shot through his head.

It was silent. No one spoke.

"Hey, guys. Long time no see?" Riso offered, his voice hoarse. For a second, Riso could've sworn he saw tears in Bakugo's eyes. He stood up, his veins popping out above his skin.

"Damn pinky-pie. You're not supposed to fucking die before I can beat you!" He yelled, and Tokoyami helped Riso stand up slowly. Riso felt sick, and dizzy.

"I caused this," Tokoyami muttered, "I killed you, Riso."

"No you didn't." Riso shook his head, looking at Tokoyami. "I'm here, aren't I? It..It was just a nap if you think about it."

"We need to move," Todoroki said quietly.

"Do they know?" Riso looked at Izuku, who nodded.

“They know you’re Cosmic. I’m sorry, I..-”

“Shut up, Zuku. Todoroki is right. Let’s keep going.”

The group of six, excluding the unconscious person Todoroki was carrying, devised a plan to protect Bakugo, who seemed distant. They walked along quickly, unexpectedly running into two more of their classmates. Riso was distant most of the conversation, trying to wrap his head around what had happened to him.

“If you’re all..protecting Bakugo, um,” Uraraka started, looking around their group. “Where is he?”

Izuku looked behind them and his blood ran cold. He gulped.

“Kacchan?!” He called out in a desperate attempt to get him to respond.

“Awh, I’m sorry my loves. It was just a slight trick of the hand.” A villain in a trenchcoat said, floating above them all.

“It’s not just Bakugo, Tokoyami is gone too!” Todoroki said aloud, taking a battle stance. Riso looked to his left, seeing that Tokoyami was indeed gone. He cursed himself and tried to prepare himself for battle. He was still weak from literally *dying* earlier.

“It’s a shame,” The villain said, smirking behind his mask. He held up two blue marbles. “I managed to even capture another just for show. Right under your nose.”

Todoroki handed the unconscious boy to Uraraka, and slammed his foot to the ground. A large thing of ice shot up, covering his side in frost. The group gasped when the villain flew past the ice.

“Running and getting away is my speciality!”

“I won’t let you get away! After him!” Izuku yelled, and the group started after them. The group did their best to keep up, but the villain gpt farther and farther.

“We can’t let them get away!” Izuku cried out.

“Of course we can’t, but the mask guy is too fast!” Todoroki responded. “There’s no chance!”

“Human bullet.” Riso muttered, and Izuku perked up.

“Asui can use her tongue to throw us! Uraraka’s quirk will keep us light, and Shoji’s arms to direct where we’re going. We’ll trust Uraraka to let us go when the timing is right!”

“Ribbit?”

“You’re really gonna do that with your injuries still?!” Uraraka asked, worried for her friend.

“Right now, I don’t feel any pain.” Izuku grumbled as they all came to a stop to set up the ‘human bullet’ plan. Uraraka ripped her shirt.

“Here,” She said quietly, splinting his arms to the best of her ability. She touched the four of them and activated her quirk. Tsuyu wrapped her tongue around her friends.

“You get those two back.” Uraraka said quietly. “Good luck!”

Tsuyu spun around and threw the four of them towards the villain. They flew through the air, Shoji helping direct where they went. They felt gravity begin to increase on them the second they got over the villains.

They all fell to the ground, forcing the villain to hit the ground roughly.

“The fuck?” Another villain said.

“I know these kids! Who are they?!”

“Mister. Out the way.”

“Understood!” The masked villain disappeared.

The villain with purple skin threw a flame towards them, hitting both Izuku and Shoji. Todoroki called out to them, but shot a thing of ice at a villain that was spewing nonsense. He also had a tape measure.

Izuku hit the ground, unable to get up after dodging a metal wire coming from seemingly a highschool girl.

“I’m Toga, Izuku!” She called in a chipper tone. “You’d look *so* much cooler if you bled more!” She giggled and raised a knife to him. Shoji darted forward and knocked her out of the way, calling to Izuku.

Riso stood behind Todoroki as he shot ice towards the villain with the measuring tape, who was cutting the ice and claiming he should try harder. He felt his breath catch in his throat when he saw the villain that captured Bakugo and Tokoyami reappear.

“I can’t believe you did so much to follow me. Your ideas are far out!” He called out, limping towards his coworker.

“Where’s Bakugo?” The one with the fire asked, and the masked one reached in his pocket. He acted shocked, but Riso saw threw it instantly.

“Midroiya, Todoroki, Riso! We’re running away, I’m sure now because of what he just did-! I don’t know what your quirk is, but that right pocket you just kept flaunting to us. We’re these Tokoyami and Bakugo? Right, entertainer?” Shoji asked, holding up two blue marbles.

“That didn’t take long, for someone with six arms!” He laughed, “You're good at feeling around!”

The four ran away, Riso’s brain too fried to think otherwise. He saw a nomu in the woods, and yelled for those to reconstruct their course. They all came to a stop when a portal opened in front of them.

This guy was at the USJ..He’s the warp villain! They all thought.

“It has been five minutes since the signal. Let’s leave.”

“Sorry, Izuku!” Toga giggled and walked into the portal, as well as the other villain. The fire and entertainer’ villain stayed.

“Our goal isn’t complete,” The fire villain began to speak.

“Ah, they were happy to rush out of here. So I gave them a treat. When we entertainers flaunt something, it’s usually because there’s another thing we don’t want you to see.” He moved his mask to the side, and showed two blue marbles with Bakugo and Tokoyami inside. The group gasped, feeling dread wash over them. He snapped. and the marble from Shoji’s hand turned into Todoroki’s ice.

“My ice?!” He called out, angry.

“That’s right! During the attack you put on me, I prepared ummies and slipped them into my right pocket. I’d figure you’d go for it!” The two villains backed into a portal slowly as the group ran towards them. Izuku called out to them, trying to reach them before it was too late.

To their surprise, a laser shot from the tree line.

“Aoyama?!” Riso asked, seeing the masked villain spit out the marbles after being hit in the face by the laser.

Shoji and Todoroki darted forward, and Shoji grabbed Tokoyami’s marble. Todoroki almost wrapped his hand around the marble when the fire villain did it first.

“How sad,” He started. “Shoto Todoroki..” He smirked.

Todoroki rolled to fix his landing, as Izuku ran foward.

“Release them.” The villain said, smirking.

“My show’s been ruined!” The other cried and snapped. He went inside of the portal, disappearing.

“No problem.” He said, Bakugo rematerializing in front of Izuku. Shoji and Riso did their best to catch Tokoyami, who had also rematerialized.

“Kacchan!” He called, his voice lined with heartbreak and anger.

Bakugo looked at Izuku jumping towards the portal, and he could only think of one thing before the portal closed.

Don't come, Izuku.

Chapter End Notes

yep! that happened! hope u guys enjoyed it! i tried rlly hard this chapter.

updates every wednesday and sunday! (check my insta, eraserhkinnie, for updates on the story!)

Chapter Thirty

Chapter Summary

The aftermath of the attack at the training camp.

Chapter Notes

hey guys!! sorry this chapter is short, i'm preparing for hurricane ian lmao anyway, chapter 31 might be late, short or will be moved to wednesday of next week if i can't get it out bc of the hurricane! hope you guys in enjoy though :3

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Heartbreaking doesn't even begin to describe the scream Izuku let out. His body, which had done its best to hold itself together during the chaos of everything, finally gave out. His legs buckled beneath him, bringing him to his knees. He leaned over and rested his head on the ground. The splints Uraraka made prevented him from bending his arms, that was for the better. He couldn't control his emotions anymore as he sobbed to the ground. He let out another gut-wrenching scream. Swiftly after, he passed out. His face didn't hit the dirt only because Riso had grabbed him and rolled him onto his back. There was an unsettling silence between the five.

"C'mon," Riso said softly, noticing Uraraka and Tsuyu run into the clearing. "We need to get him to someone."

"Yeah." Shoji said dryly, helping Riso pick Izuku up. He looked down at Riso. "Are you-"

"Let's go." Riso cut him off, motioning to the group. "Not a word to anyone." He warned the five. The last thing he needed was people feeling bad for him, and Aizawa finding out. That he died, that is.

The walk back to camp was painful. Uraraka and Tsuyu didn't have to ask what happened, as it was written across each of their faces. The look of defeat. *Failure* . Reaching camp was

brutal, it was hard to walk through a forest when a classmate had been kidnapped in front of your eyes.

Todoroki felt guilty. He didn't grab the marble fast enough, and he blamed himself.

Shoji felt guilty. He fell for the entertainer's trick and grabbed the wrong marbles. He blamed himself.

Tokoyami felt guilty. If he hadn't lost control of dark shadow, they wouldn't have been put in danger like that. He blamed himself.

Riso felt guilty. His life had been saved by Bakugo, and yet he couldn't even manage to do the same for him. He hated himself.

Riso sat on the ground, eyes trained at his beaten up shoes. He felt tired, exhausted. He hated that he failed Izuku. He hated that he couldn't save Bakugo. A hand gripped his shoulder, and a gruff voice spoke.

"Riso. I need to speak with you." Aizawa said, "C'mon."

"Yes sir." Riso responded distantly, and Aizawa walked inside of an empty room in the building. He shut the door, and Riso sat on top of a table. Riso could already feel the glare coming from Aizawa.

"What the hell was that?" Aizwa asked, "You dipped right before the attack announcement. Do you know how fucking worried everyone here was about you?"

"Yeah. Sorry." Riso muttered. Aizawa paused, sighing. Not hearing any snarky remarks from the trouble-maker worried him.

"What happened out there?" Aizawa's voice was soft and comforting.

“You’re going to be angry.”

“I’m not. You’re not in trouble, kid.”

“I will be.”

“You won’t, I promise. No other teachers know that you’re Cosmic, and-”

“Bakugo’s gone.” Riso’s tone was empty. There was a hint of harshness to the statement.

“What?”

“Gone. Taken. Or, if you prefer, kidnapped.” Riso looked up at Aizawa, his hair being covered in mud, ash, and blood didn’t make it easy to see him. “We couldn’t save him. *I* didn’t save him.” There was no response.

“I’ll be back.” Aizawa hurried out the door, and left it cracked. Riso let his posture slack, and he placed a hand to his head. He cringed at the texture of half-dry blood on his face. He chuckled to himself softly. He really did always get a head injury.

“Riso?” The voice almost made him burst into tears.

“In here.” Riso called out, feeling a pressure in his throat. He kept his eyes down, and tensed when he heard the door creak open.

“Oh thank god,” Shinso muttered, rushing over. He pulled Riso off the table and hugged him tightly. “I thought you were *dead* , Riso.”

Dead. Riso thought. *I was dead.*

“I know. I’m sorry.”

“..You’re not making your remarks or..any jokes. That’s what you do in moments like these.”

“I’m fine, Shinso. I-”

“Hitoshi.”

“..What?” Riso looked at Shinso confused, “I..I know your first name. Damn, I didn’t get brain damage.”

“No, silly.” Shinso gently cupped his face. “You can call me that. We’re close enough now I’d think..”

“Hitoshi.” Riso muttered, his lips curling into a small smile. “I’m fine, Hitoshi. Nope, doesn’t sound right.”

“You’re not fine.” Shinso gave a sympathetic smile, tears reaching his eyes. He ran his thumb along Riso’s cheek, using his hand to gently push the hair from his face. “You’re hurt, Riso. You look so broken. I care about you.”

Riso’s lips were slightly parted in surprise, his eyes going wide. He stared at the shorter boy, feeling tears well up. He had felt seen for the first time in a long time. His lips began to tremble as he continued to stare, at a loss for words.

“Riso?” Shinso asked carefully, “Why are you looking at me like that..?”

“You,” Riso’s voice broke. He pulled himself from Shinso, and turned the other way. His arms crossed each other and he trained his eyes on the ground. “You should probably go see Zuku.”

“Don’t do this.” Shinso muttered. “Stop it.”

“What are you talking about?” Riso looked back at Shinso, arms still crossed. “Don’t tell you to check on your friend?”

“You know exactly what I mean.” Shinso walked closer to Riso, visibly upset. “Don’t push me away.”

“That’s not what I’m doing. I’m telling you to-” Riso was cut off by Shinso grabbing his hands.

“Telling me to check on someone else. Someone that’s *not* you.”

“Zuku’s condition is worse than mine.”

“But you’re still hurt.”

“I don’t need your pity.” Riso pulled his hands from Shinso. “I don’t need someone to watch over me and help me put a band-aid over every scratch I get. I’m fine on my own, I always have been! I don’t need a babysitter telling me when I fall.”

“Riso-”

“No! You don’t get to feel sorry for me! I’ve helped everyone I could, I’ve done everything to insure the safety of strangers! It hurt when I watched them get hurt or taken, sure, but having friends was the dumbest choice I’ve ever made! It hurts so much more to watch someone being taken or getting hurt when you can’t do anything to help! I’m not the one

hurt, ever! It's always someone else!" Riso ignored the angry tears that began to trickle down his face. "I don't need help. I'm fine. Go see Zuku. Okay? Make sure he's fine."

"..Vlad King told me there would be emergency services outside soon." Shinso put his hands in his pockets. "I expect to see you outside getting checked by an EMT." He walked out of the room, the door slamming behind him. Riso crumbled to the ground and let the tears flow.

Outside, Izuku was being put on a hospital gurney by a few emergency responders. Aizawa had been informed of his condition and was watching the unconscious and fragile boy be taken away to the hospital.

"Mister Aizawa?" Mina asked quietly. "Is Riso okay?"

"Yeah, don't talk to him." Shinso answered for Aizawa, stepping outside the building. "He's not exactly in a mood to talk."

"Wait, wh-"

"Is Midoriya going to be okay?" Shinso cut her off.

"He's in rough condition. They think his quirk will help save his life." Aizawa put a phone to his ear, dialing Present Mic.

" *Sho? Are you okay?? Are the kids okay? I'm almost there!* "

"Zashi, I'm okay." Aizawa held his breath. "The kids..most of them are in bad shape. We need to talk when you get here, okay?"

" *Is Shinso okay?* "

“Yeah. Uh..he looks upset though, I’ll have to talk to him. Promise me to keep the quirk usage down. The kids are already freaked as is.”

“ *Okay. I’ll try my best. I love you, Sho. I’m so glad you’re okay..* ”

“I’ll see you soon.” Aizawa hung up the phone, and looked at Shinso. “Okay, everyone you need to be checked out by some of the EMTS.” As the students walked off, Aizawa placed a hand on Shinso’s shoulder.

“..Yeah?” Shinso looked at Aizawa.

“You. Tell me what’s wrong.” Aizawa asks, “I can see it on your face.”

“It’s just..Riso’s being hardheaded.” Shinso muttered. “He’s not letting anyone care for him.”

“Yeah..the kid does that.” Aizawa sighed, ruffling Shinso’s hair. “Don’t think too much of it. He’s got a lot of unresolved trauma I haven’t been able to get to yet.”

“I..Dad, I care about him. A lot. I mean, I told him I was worried about him and suddenly he looked lost and confused like no one has ever put him first. And somethings wrong, I think something happened to him out there.”

“I know. He was different.”

Hospitals. If there was one thing Izuku and Riso hated most, it was fucking hospitals. Izuku hated them because they always asked too many questions and overwhelmed him. Riso hated them because he was being told what to do by some random stranger he’d never met. So why did he have to trust them? He didn’t have to, but being bed ridden for a head injury didn’t give him a choice.

“Subdural hematoma.” The doctor had told him. “Caused most typically from car accidents or falls. Sometimes violent attacks. You’re very lucky to be alive.”

Alive. God, he definitely didn’t want to be. He had been so distant recently, he felt like an outsider to his own body. Subdural hematoma would be able to be healed by Recovery Girl soon, but he had to wait a few days to monitor his activity. Meaning he was stuck in the hospital for the rest of the week.

While Riso was drowning in his own self pity, the door opened. Riso had kept his eyes shut to block out the harsh hospital lights, but did feel his hands shake slightly. He didn’t want anymore doctors, the IV and pulse oximeter hook up burned against his skin when he thought about doctors and tests. He pretended to be asleep thinking that would help get the doctor to leave him alone.

“Riso?” Tokoyami’s voice was gentle. “I know you’re not asleep.”

“Guilty as charged.” Riso muttered, feeling kind of surprised it wasn’t a doctor. He also felt surprised that Tokoyami knew he wasn’t asleep.

“Look, I-”

“If you’re here to apologize for what happened, don’t.” Riso sat up, fiddling with his hands. “I’m okay.”

“No, Riso. You’re not. I..I understand I don’t know you too well, but you died. You were pale, and…when he started doing CPR..” Tokoyami sighed. “I didn’t think you were going to live.”

“You can’t kill me that easily.”

“I feel horrible. If you weren’t okay and alive now, it would've been my fault.”

“Don’t hold that to yourself, Tokoyami. Please? You don’t need to be worried about some guy you killed that’s technically alive. Okay?”

“Okay.” Tokoyami nodded. The two shared a silence. “Riso?”

“Hm?”

“How did you feel when you died?”

Riso paused, recalling the dreams he had while unconscious. He gulped, looking to the side.

“I don’t know if it’s the same for everyone. It sucked for me. I would’ve done anything to stop it.” There was another few minutes of silence.

“Are you allowed to move around at all?” Tokoyami asked quietly, fiddling with his thumbs.

“No. I’m fucking bed-ridden. I wanted to see Izuku, and make sure he’s safe.”

“He’s awake, some of the class is there seeing him now.” Tokoyami said. “I just..I wanted to check on you.”

“Go see him, and..come tell me how he’s doing after.”

“I will.”

Izuku stared at his classmates, his heart aching. He shook his head and looked at his hands.

“I couldn’t save him.” Izuku muttered. “I couldn’t reach him..or help..”

“It’s not your fault, Midoriya.” Denki shook his head.

“Yeah..!” Uraraka nodded. “You guys did all you could..”

“It wasn’t enough..now he’s probably in danger because of me..”

“Don’t speak like that.” Iida said, “Knowing you, you probably did the best you could. And that’s a lot, Midoriya.”

“I just wish I could go get him.” Izuku sighed.

Silence crept among the students, an unfamiliar tension in the air.

“Then let’s do just that. Yaoyorozu..She attached a tracker onto one of the villains. She said it was a Nomu, I overheard her talking to the police about it.” Kirishima started. “So she knows where he is. Or her..tracker does.”

“You can’t be serious,” Iida started, looking at Kirishima. He had made the mistake before, trying to fight battles that weren’t his.

“You can’t do that,” Shoji started. “Isn’t it illegal?”

“So what? I couldn’t save my friend! I heard he was being targeted and I sat back and did *nothing* .” Kirishima said loudly, passion lining his words.

“Dude calm down, we’re in a hospital!” Denki shushed him, putting a hand on his shoulder.

“I’m bringing him back, with or without you guys.” Kirishima huffed.

“Hey, kiddos.” A doctor walked in, “I have to speak with Midoriya here. Mind if we get a second of privacy?” The kids nodded and began to shuffle out. Kirishima turned to Izuku.

“We’re meeting outside the hospital tonight if Yaoyorozu agrees to do this..Hopefully I’ll see you there. Think about it.”

Izuku watched as Kirishima walked away. He huffed, not looking at the doctor.

“Hey. How are you holding up? Any pain?”

“No.”

“That’s good..You know, your quirk did a lot to help you. It’s impressive, really. You came in with broken bones but now they’re healed.”

“They are?”

“Mhm. The only thing we had to treat was the bruising. Your open wounds are scars. You do have some muscle tears and rips but they repaired themselves also.”

“Oh..”

“You..your quirk is impressive. You’re allowed to leave after we finish some blood work.”

“Wait, um,” Izuku sat up. “..Can you explain my quirk’s abilities..? If..you can.”

“Of course.” The doctor says on the end of the bed. “It seems like your quirk can repair broken bones within hours. It’ll cause some bruising, which your quirk seems to struggle with. It helps them heal nicer. Any open wounds have almost instantly healed or closed, and if there’s an object inside it doesn’t close the wound until it’s out. You know how most people will tell you not to pull out something that’s stabbed you?”

“Uh huh..?”

“You’d be better off taking it out immediately.”

“Oh. Okay..” Izuku nods. “I-I understand..Thank you doctor.”

The doctor gave a smile and walked out. Izuku sighed and rested his head against the bed. He felt tired and exhausted. And he missed Bakugo.

Damnit, he just had to fuck up. Didn’t he? He tried so hard to save the, dare he say, love of his life and he failed. He pulled the thin blanket close to his body and curled in a ball. He forced the tears back as he thought about Bakugo. Holding his hand, cuddling with him, cooking and eating together. He missed it all and he felt responsible for it. But he could change that if he took Kirishima’s offer. Izuku had a choice to make, and he only had until the end of the day to make it. He had made up his mind almost immediately, though. He fell asleep with one thought in mind.

I’m coming, Kacchan.

Chapter End Notes

once again guys i’m so sorry this chapter is short :(i really hope i can get sunday’s chapter done in time! stupid hurricane >:(

Chapter Thirty One

Chapter Summary

Bakugo gets saved!

Chapter Notes

i accidentally deleted the original chapter so i crammed this all this morning :/ hope u guys liked it!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

“I’ll ask again, aspiring hero, Bakugo Katsuki.” The grating voice of Shigaraki echoed through Bakugo’s ears. “Will you join the league of villains?”

“Go throw yourself into traffic.” Bakugo sneered. He could feel his palms sweating from under the metal cuffs he had placed on his hands.

Tch. Idiots. Thinking I’ll join them. Are they that stupid? Bakugo thought to himself, subtly snickering when he watched Shigaraki’s eyes grow angry. His attention turned to the TV in the old, run down bar when he heard a familiar voice speak.

“We are here to apologize. A recent incident allowing and causing harm to twenty seven first year heros. We, the staff, were ill-prepared.” Bakugo froze. His veins ran cold and his lungs tightened.

Mister Aizawa hates being on TV , He swallowed hard, *Now he’s apologizing to the entire world.*

“We take full responsibility for any trauma caused by our negligence. It’s our duty to train heros, but also to protect heroes in training.”

“Since the beginning of the year, UA students have had four encounters with villains. This time there were students who were gravely injured. How did you explain this to the families? What are the steps you and the staff are taking to prevent something like this from happening in the future?” A random voice, seemingly belonging to a reporter, asked. Bakugo scoffed and rolled his eyes at such a dumb question. He looked around the room and got to know his surroundings while most of the villains in front of him were preoccupied with the TV.

As the familiar voice of his Principal came from the crackling TV, Bakugo felt his shoulders tense. They were treating his teacher, one of the only people Bakugo seemed to be able to stand, like a villain. Bakugo *hated* villains, but he hated people who were treated like one without reason. He so desperately wanted to break free from his restraints and beat every villain here senseless. He knew deep down he couldn’t, and shouldn’t. He’d only get hurt.

Normally, Bakugo wouldn’t have cared. For once, he longed for something more than violence. He longed for his childhood best friend, Izuku Midoriya. He felt a pain drive through his heart when the name popped into his thoughts. It wasn’t fair. It wasn’t fair that the moment he had finally grasped onto his feelings, he had to, literally, be ripped away from everything he loved. He understood that his actual odds of defeating the villains were slim. He would take those chances any day. But he couldn’t. Not without getting to see Izuku one last time. A time where he wasn’t broken and in a make-shift cast that was made from Uraraka’s shirt.

Bakugo wanted to see the same Izuku he saw that stuck up for him when he got stabbed. The one he fell asleep next to to prevent nightmares. The one who’s eyes shimmered under the moonlight, or the one who refused to admit he was smart. The same Izuku who had given him a second chance when he didn’t deserve one.

So, yes. Bakugo wasn’t going to lash out. He would have to sit back and endure whatever bullshit that was about to be thrown his way. He couldn’t help but snicker to himself when he saw Shigaraki’s face. It was hard *not* to snicker. The spoiled villain had no eyebrows and looked like a set of chapped lips on a winter day.

“Would you look at that,” Shigaraki snickered. “The heroes are turning into the bad guys! No one seems to be taking this seriously.”

Bakugo didn’t bother to listen to his long rant about how villains are superior or whatever the hell it is he was ranting about. He wanted out. He wasn’t about to hear a villain out, and consider his options. He made his mind up a long time ago. He wanted to be a hero, and no ashy, crusty young adult who probably flakes off when he showers was going to tell him otherwise. He did catch the tail-end of the rant.

“You like winning, right?”

Of *course* he liked winning. He loved it. The rush of it all was enough to keep him as a hero for another few years. But it was more than winning. It was about helping others, and being the best. Winning wasn’t the only thing but those villains were too stupid to realize that. He felt the eyes of the knock-off half-and-half burn into his skull as the other villain (whom has not earned a dumb nickname yet) uncuffed and released him from the restraints. Remember when I said Bakugo didn’t plan on doing anything drastic? Well, when the adrenaline began to flow through his veins, he couldn’t help himself. He felt his hands spark and he smirked. He threw a punch, and flipped over the body of the man before throwing a blast in Shigaraki’s face. He saw the hand that laid on Shigaraki’s face clink to the ground as he went stiff.

“Are you finsihed with your fucking whining yet? I’m sick of your stupid rants, do you ever shut up? Or do you just like the sound of your own voice?” Bakugo stood tall. “You bastards are getting on my fucking nerves.”

He didn’t know when, but the TV had been switched back on. He smiled when he heard his teacher defend his honor.

“As Katsuki Bakugo’s teacher, I take full responsibility for not taming his violent tendencies. However, his actions at the sports festival were born of his deep convictions. He's trying harder than anyone in his pursuit to become the top hero.” His voice and demeanor was calm, but the words coming out of his mouth told Bakugo he was thoroughly pissed at the press. “If the villains think they have a chance with him, then they are grossly mistaken. I can guarantee that much.”

“Hah.” Bakugo laughed. “Do you hear the teachers? I guess they know me better than what I thought. I’ll never join your league of bastards!”

They took their time planning such a large scale attack just to bring me back here, and they already told me what they wanted. They won't kill me. Amatuers. I need to take a few of them out, quick. Bakugo felt his hands twitch in anticipation.

"It seems he figured out he's of value to us." Magne muttered in annoyance.

"No, he's a fool." Dabi responded casually.

"Most experienced performers would act as if they're falling for the plan."

"Shut up. I'd never pretend to be something I'm not, no matter fucking what it is. I'm tired of being surrounded by a bunch of lame ass wannabes." Bakugo growled.

Chaos shortly erupted, most of the villains asking for permission to hurt or injure Bakugo. Kurogiri went to make his move when Shigaraki held up his hand.

"No one lays a finger on him." Shigaraki started, forcing his voice to be calm as he placed the hand on his face once again. "Master, lend me your power." He spoke as he looked back at the TV. The *Audio Only* displayed across the screen was harsh on the eyes. Bakugo rose an eyebrow in surprise.

"That's a great plan, Tomura Shigaraki." The deep, gruff voice that belonged to the user behind the screen.

"Master? I thought you were the boss of this." Bakugo sneered. "But you're just a sidekick."

"Kurogiri and Compress, it's time to put him back to sleep."

Mr. Compress sighed, "I can't believe you're such a bad audience member." He began walking closer to Bakugo.

“If you want me to listen, get on your knees and beg!” *Shit, I can’t blast them all away. That warp idiot is way too fast and I’d just get myself into more trouble. I need an opening. I have to create something to get to the back door!*

There was a loud knock on the door. The room went silent.

“Hello? I have a pizza delivery here.”

Everyone stared at the door silently. Seconds later, a wall busted in, sending a villain flying across the room.

“What the hell?!”

“Kurogiri! Now!”

Before Kurogiri could even start his warp, Kamui Woods trapped all the villains in his branches and held them tightly.

“That’s it.”

Gran Torino, who looked like an old man in a four year olds body to Bakugo, kicked Dabi in the side of the head before he could light a fire.

“Don’t do anything stupid.”

Bakugo watched as he stood frozen. The heroes began to talk and taunt the villains. He stared at All Might, who assured him that he was safe now.

“Fuck you, I wasn’t scared! I was perfectly fine!” Bakugo growled, rolling his eyes. He wanted to leave now. He wanted to go away and see Izuku, but everyone was here flaunting and talking about how their side would win. He just wanted to go now. He watched as Shigaraki began to freak out, and he felt something press against his lungs. He bent over and coughed out an unfamiliar liquid. He hated the taste and it made his mouth water; not in a good way. He felt his head spin and become light headed. When he opened his eyes, he was in a different place. He felt his heart skip.

Where the fuck am I? He thought, panic rising in his chest.

“What the hell?” He asked, coughing. He looked at the man in front of him and his stomach dropped.

“Hello, Bakugo. My apologies for the forced methods.”

Bakugo froze in fear and time seemed irrelevant to him. He felt his world spin as he listened to the tall villain talk to Shigaraki and mention that ‘he was an important piece on Shigaraki’s game board.’ He felt sick. He hated everything about this. He stepped back when All Might suddenly appeared and knocked the tall villain back. He stumbled back even more when he watched All Might get held back so easily. He hated the peace hero, but he admitted he was strong. He looked around and took notice that the other six villains could still give All Might trouble. If he wanted out alive, he’d have to fight these six bastards.

“This’ll be fun.”

Bakugo dodged and threw attacks to the best of his ability without getting hurt. He could feel his limbs becoming tired when he felt the temperature in the air drop. He looked behind him and couldn't help but feel a smile tug at his lips when he saw a large thing of ice. He felt his heart flutter when he saw Izuku.

“Bakugo!” Kirishima held his hand out, and Bakugo didn’t waste a single second. He blasted himself up and he reached out to Kirishima. Their hands locked together.

“You idiots!” Bakugo smiled.

“Bakugo! When I say-” Iida started.

“Don’t tell me what to do!”

Eventually, they landed on the ground. Bakugo breathed hard and could feel a borderline wheeze almost escape his lips. He felt two arms wrap around him tightly.

“Kacchan!” Izuku said, tears coming to his eyes. “You’re okay..!”

Bakugo looked down at Izuku, his heart fluttering the moment he laid eyes on him. The city lights lit up his face, and made him look angelic. Bakugo gently cupped his face, fighting the urge to yell at him.

“Of course I am I’m not stupid or anything.” Bakugo muttered, brushing Izuku’s hair out of his face.

“I was so worried, and I- I just- I didn’t want you hurt-!”

Bakugo was silent and listened to Izuku rant about how worried he was. He clenched his jaw slightly.

“Deku?”

“Yeah, Kacchan?”

Bakugo gently pulled him close, and tilted his head up slightly. Bakugo felt his heart rest when he saw Izuku’s eyes glisten in the light. He closed the gap between the two, and placed his lips to Izuku’s. He smiled into the kiss when he heard Izuku let out a surprised yelp. It only took a few seconds before he kissed back.

Chapter End Notes

WOOOO!! first kiss <3

Chapter Thirty Two

Chapter Summary

Riso struggles with the aftermath of dying and being brought back to life

Chapter Notes

i have had such bad writers block it's not even funny! if you guys have any ideas you'd like to see, lmk :D

sorry for such a short chapter :(

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Izuku sat on the roof of a building, letting his legs gently swing in the wind. He glanced at his phone, checking for messages. After he, Todoroki, Yaoyorozu, Iida, and Kirishima helped save Bakugo from the villains, they had taken him to the police station for any questioning necessary. He remembered the kiss in vivid detail, and he could feel his heart ache when he thought about it. He smiled into the sky, looking up at the bright moon. He almost jumped out of his skin when he felt someone plop down next to him.

"Hey." Izuku let out a breath when he realized it was Riso. "You look happy." Riso chuckled softly.

"The greatest thing happened." Izuku couldn't help but smile wide. "Kacchan kissed me."

"...Blasty kissed you?" Riso blinked in surprise. "Huh. Didn't know the bastard had the balls."

"I felt so..light. And all my worries were just..gone!" Izuku wrapped his arms around Riso's and leaned on him. "It was amazing."

“Everything you ever dream of?”

“And more.” Izuku giggled. “I..I feel bad for everything that happened with All Might and..that villain. I feel guilty for feeling so happy right now.”

“Don’t. Good things happen while bad things are.” Riso leaned his head on Izuku’s. “Wish I had realized that.” He sighed softly, closing his eyes. He sounded tired, and drained. It was unusual for him.

“Are you okay?” Izuku slightly looked up at him. “You sound exhausted.”

“Yeah, I’m fine. Just haven’t been sleeping.”

“Is it because-”

“Please don’t say it.”

“Riso,” Izuku sat up, and looked at him with a serious face. “You have to talk about it.”

“What? That I fucking died?” Riso sounded bitter, and he pulled himself from Izuku’s embrace. He stood, shoving his hands in his hoodie pockets. “I can’t do this right now.”

“Please,” Izuku stood up after him and grabbed his arm. “Please talk to me. This is clearly destroying you.”

“And Bakugo being kidnapped isn’t destroying you?”

“Kacchan is safe now. You’re hurting.” Izuku looked at him sympathetically. “You have to talk about it or it’s going to kill you.”

“Already died once.” Riso muttered sarcastically. “What’s a second time?”

“Please talk to me. I’m worried about you.” Izuku tells him softly. “Don’t push me away.”

“Look, I’m happy for you and Bakugo,” Riso stated, looking away from Izuku. “But I have to go.” He turned on his heel and pulled his arm from Izuku. He walked away quickly, holding his head down.

Izuku stared at Riso as he walked away from him, and he pulled out his phone. He bit his tongue as he scrolled for a certain contact. His finger shook as it hovered over the name.

Once Riso reached his apartment, he shut the door gently. He took a shaky breath before he sat on his couch. He pulled a blanket off the back of the couch and wrapped himself in it. He wasn’t actively trying to push away people that cared about him, he simply just didn’t want to talk about probably the most traumatic thing he’d ever been through. It especially hurt when he was talking to the people in his dream before he died. Could he even call it a dream? Whatever it was, it killed the people he cared about most. He couldn’t look any of them in the eye without feeling an immense amount of guilt. So of course he didn’t want to talk about how he saw someone die to the person he saw die.

Riso hadn’t noticed it, but he was beginning to fall asleep. He rested against the couch and his eyes fully closed. A few seconds into the deep sleep he desperately needed, he jolted awake. He sat up, his hands shaking violently. Every time he tried to sleep he saw what he saw that night. He didn’t want to, so he’d be avoiding sleep. The only downside, he was beginning to feel more exhausted than ever. He was still supposed to be in the hospital, but he escaped out the window. He couldn’t stay in that place. Riso shook his head gently and pulled out a journal and began to write in it. He had to keep himself awake, and creating was his best shot.

He had made it through the entire book when he looked up from the pages. His breath hitched when he saw the sun had risen and was shining into his apartment. He put down his book and walked out in the hallway. He wiped his eyes tiredly as he walked into the teacher lounge. He *would* have a coffee machine in his own apartment, but the teachers were worried he’d make it into a bomb…again. Hey, he was just curious.

Riso yawned slightly when he reached the machine. He poured himself a cup and Nemuri spoke up.

“No more than half a cup.”

“Yeah, yeah.” Riso muttered, putting the cup to his lips. “Wait, why are you here? Don’t you have the day off?”

“We need to talk about a few things, kiddo.” Nemuri smiled at him. “Take a seat.”

“I swear I didn’t blow up a lab again.” Riso sat down, running his finger along the rim of his cup nervously. Nemuri was hardly ever serious with him.

“There’s a few things.” Nemuri starts. “The first one, you can’t live here anymore.”

“What?” Riso almost choked on his coffee. “Where am I supposed to-”

“Hold on, kid. We’re putting in a dorm system. You can live there.”

“Wait, but..Is it going to be by class?”

“Mhm. Is that alright?”

“No, not really. My entire class fucking hates me. They think I’m a teacher's pet.”

“Well…Surprisingly, Aizawa has already started the process to get you to live in the Class 1A dorms. He wouldn’t say why, but he said he would rather you be with him.”

Because I'm Cosmic. That has to be it. Riso nodded. "The..other things?"

"You need to talk to Shinso. He's upset and he clearly misses you."

"I..kind of flipped on him. I feel bad for it, but there's no excuse so..he's just better off moving on."

"Riso."

"Yeah?"

"Midoriya texted me." Nemuri gently placed a hand over Riso's. "He told me what happened. About you dying."

"I really don't want-"

"I don't care. That was traumatic for you, and it makes your recent behavior understandable. I don't care if you try to deny it, or try to push me away. I'm here for you, and you are *not* alone, sweetheart. You deal with so much all the time, and it's time you actually let yourself feel." Nemuri said reassuringly, "Is that understood?"

Riso stared at her with wide eyes that had tears welling up in them. His lips were trembling and he let himself take a deep breath. A tear escaped from his eye, and rolled down his cheek. Nemuri instantly noticed.

"Oh, Riso.." She stood quickly, pulled him up and into a hug. Riso grabbed onto her tightly, trying to keep his tears from coming down. "It's okay, I got you now. You're safe."

That broke him.

Riso began to cry and he held Nemuri tight. He tried his hardest not to rely on her in any way, but he couldn't help but cry. He felt his head get light as he cried harder.

"Let it out, baby. It's okay.." Nemuri comforted him, running her hands through his hair slowly. Riso pulled from the tight embrace and he wiped his tears.

"Sorry, I-" Riso swallowed the knot in his throat. "I'm sorry. I didn't mean to-"

"No, you need to let it out. You can talk to me about anything, you know that right?" Nemuri smiled at him softly. "You're going to have to tell me what happened or you're never going to get past it."

"It was horrible." Riso said quietly, sitting down. "I was in a room and then..I just started falling. I..I saw Izuku, he..jumped from a building. Then there was Aizawa, at the USJ incident. I saw his brain come from his skull. And.." Riso took a breath.

"And what, Riso?"

"There was Shinso. He..was beaten real bad. He told me to stop breathing with his quirk and little after that, I woke up to Bakugo giving me CPR." Riso fiddled with his thumbs. "It was all more detailed than that, but that's really all I feel comfortable sharing with you. I..there's some things you don't know and I just..I'm not ready to tell anyone else." Riso looked at her.

"If it's about you being Cosmic," Nemuri chuckles. "I know about that, sweetie."

"Huh?" Riso blinks. "How-"

"You don't think I didn't notice the trips to Recovery Girl? Or all of your medical supplies in your mirror cabinet were going missing at an alarming rate?" Nemuri ran her fingers through his hair again. "It's okay. I know, and I don't plan on telling anyone. Who all knows?"

“You, Aizawa, Shinso, Izuku, Bakugo, Tokoyami, Shoji, Todoroki, and Recovery Girl.” Riso muttered. “I hate that the number keeps going up. I’m sure Nezu knows..”

“Oh most certainly.”

“..I said some mean things to Shinso,” Riso sighed. “Is there any way I can maybe..take it back? I..I don’t know what I’d say. I feel bad, and really shitty. I shouldn't have taken it out on him, but I did. If I could go back and do it over, I think I’d just take him into a hug and not let go. He means so much to me and he’s been the first person in a long time that’s been able to see me for me. Sure, Izuku has too but…I get so nervous around Shinso. I feel my heart begin to ache and when I look at him..everything about him just seems perfect. I messed it up, and I’d do anything to fix it.”

“Well..I think he heard all of that.”

“..What?” Riso looked towards the door and saw Shinso standing there, Hizashi standing behind him with a wide grin.

Shinso blinked, a subtle red blush on his face.

“..Did you really mean all those things you said just now?”

“I..I do.” Riso nodded, his hands shaking violently from how nervous he was. Shinso walked forward and pulled him into a tight hug. Riso hugged back, feeling tears prick his eyes once again. Shinso began to speak in a soft, gentle voice.

“I forgive you,”

Chapter End Notes

fun fact, when i originally made riso he was supposed to be autistic! i just didn't want to make that canon because i, personally, am not autistic and i didn't want to portray his character with any harmful stereotypes. love you guys!

updates every wednesday and sunday!

Chapter Thirty Three

Chapter Summary

> Riso goes to a well needed therapy session. Izuku, Riso and their love interests spend the day at a cat cafe, before moving into the dorms. Is there another possible vigilante on the rise?

Chapter Notes

> HEY GUYS IM BACK WOOO! gosh it feels amazing to put out a new chapter and i really hope you guys like it :3 i have so many plans!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

“So, you died.”

“Yeah.”

“And...from what I was told, you ignored that fact for a few days afterwards?”

A harsh silence filled the room as Riso fiddled with the hem of his sweater. He kept his eyes trained on the ground to avoid Hound Dog’s concerning stare. He swallowed hard, feeling his throat only get tighter. He took a small breath, then nodded.

“That sounds about right, yeah.”

“Do you feel comfortable sharing why?”

“Uh..Denial?” Riso offered, trying to brush off the severity of the question.

“Be serious, Riso.” Hound Dog spoke with a gentle tone, encouraging Riso to be open.

“It made people worry about me.”

“And that’s a negative thing?”

“Yes. Well...when you put it like that, technically it’s not. I just hate when people care about me to the point of worrying for me. I mean, I knew I had just died but I came back. Wasn’t that enough to stop them from worrying?”

“..I see.” Hound Dog wrote something on his notepad. To Riso, it seemed aggressive and screamed ‘you answered wrong’. He gulped.

“Did...Did I say something wrong?” Riso asked softly, looking at Hound Dog for an indication if he did. He looked at Riso with a puzzled look.

“No? What makes you feel the need to ask me that?”

“...You..wrote in the notepad kind of aggressively,”

“Oh. No, no. Those are just notes for me later. I promise you didn’t answer wrongly.”

“Okay.”

“My next question,” Hound Dog started, “It might cause some strong emotions. Do you think you’re mentally ready for that?”

“I should be, yeah.”

“I was told you had a dream, or vision, of some kind when you died?”

Riso’s breath caught in his throat and his head began to swirl. He blinked a few times to try and ground himself from the wave of emotions he was just hit with. Sorrow, sadness, confusion, anger. It was a lot. He began to remember the way it felt in those dreams and his stomach churned. He felt a feeling of panic and fear rise in his chest, his hands shaking slightly.

“Riso? Hey, look at me, kid.” Hound Dog said softly, gently tapping Riso’s knee to gain his attention and snap him out of the panic attack that he was starting to have. Riso looked towards Hound Dog, unaware he wasn’t breathing. “Breathe. Okay? With me. In..out..” He started a breathing exercise.

Riso followed and a few minutes later he calmed enough to speak. He looked at his hands in shame.

“I’m sorry. I..I didn’t mean to..freak like that.”

“No, no. Don’t apologize for that. Please be patient and nice towards yourself, you’re still healing.”

“Can..Can I still answer the question?”

“Of course. Tell me anything you feel comfortable with.”

Riso began to lightly explain a few of the things he saw, clearly hesitant with the information he shared in fear of letting another Pro-Hero aware of his illegal vigilante side job. Hound Dog listened intently, allowing Riso to feel comfortable in what he did end up sharing. He had noticed Riso’s hand shake more as he explained the graphic details of the things he saw

in the vision. If he hadn't had his hair covering his eyes like it always was, he'd have noticed the tears that were welling in Riso's eyes. Though, Hound Dog could hear it in his voice.

"And..that's it."

"I see..That's quite the dream, Riso."

"Uh..yeah. Do you know what it means?" Riso seemed nervous asking, but Hound Dog saw it as progress. Considering in the beginning of the session that started about thirty minutes ago he wasn't up for Hound Dog's opinion at all. Now he was being vulnerable and asking him for it.

"Well, you're a vigilante, correct?" He saw Riso tense.

"...You know?"

"Eraserhead and Midnight briefed me on that. They feared if I didn't know, I wouldn't be able to help you."

"..Oh."

"May I ask a bit of a personal question before I continue?"

"..Sure."

"What was your homelife like?"

Riso stared at Hound Dog, his legs bouncing in the armchair he was sitting in.

“..Not that good.”

“We can speak about that shortly. But most of your time in your house, with your biological parents, how did you feel?”

“...Helpless. Uh, useless too. Alone, I guess.” Riso muttered.

“Riso, I think the dream you had before your death, it was a representation that you feel the need to save people the way you wished you were saved.” Hound Dog’s words already felt like a sharp knife was being driven into Riso’s chest. “Although our staff here came to your aid, it was almost always purely academically. You’ve hardly let yourself keep in touch with your emotions, so you let your schedule be filled to the brim. You claimed and let others around you believe it was because of your quirk, but your quirk may be connected to your emotions more than you thought. When you have an opportunity to think, your brain shuts down in a way to protect itself. Coincidentally, your quirk takes this as an opportunity to overload your brain to try to keep those emotions blocked off. You picked up work as a vigilante that was active during the night because your schedule was free then, meaning you couldn’t avoid your feelings. In an attempt to cope, you started to help others. Like I said before, save them the way you were never saved. That dream, it was letting you see what you feared most. Since you never let yourself worry like that, it was overwhelming. This also explains why when you woke, you immediately felt bad that people thought you needed saving. Because you hadn’t ever been saved before.”

Outside the office was a lounge for people to sit as they either waited for the turn to speak with Hound Dog, or waited for someone to come out. This is where Aizawa and Shinso sat. After Shinso and Riso talked over a few sensitive topics and Riso opened up about what he experienced at the camp, Shinso convinced him to at least talk to Hound Dog.

“What happened to you out there, Riso?” Shinso asked, grabbing ahold of Riso’s hands.

“You can’t be mad.”

“No promises,” Shinso chuckled gently, earning a light laugh from Riso. He nodded.

“I..Me and a few others that were with Bakugo before he was taken,” Riso started in a soft voice. “Tokoyami had..lost control of Dark Shadow. I moved Zuku out of the way and..he threw me to a tree. I went unconscious and when I woke I saw Bakugo sitting there on top of me, doing CPR I think.”

“..Riso. Are..are you saying you died?”

“Yeah. That’s what I’m saying.”

Shinso wrapped Riso in a tight hug, “You have to talk to someone about this, please. I saw how upset and drained you looked that night. Please.”

“Okay.” Riso said quietly, hugging him back just as tight.

Shinso tapped his thumb on his thigh at a steady, fast pace. He checked his phone again for the time, noting Riso had been in there for almost an hour and a half. He felt a hand rest on his shoulder.

“It’s okay.” Aizawa said. “He’s in good hands in there, Shinso.”

“I know.” Shinso muttered, appreciative of the supportive gesture from his dad. “I’m really scared for him.”

“Honestly, I have been too.” Aizawa admitted. “Don’t tell anyone I said that.”

“I won’t.” Shinso looked towards the door, feeling tears begin to prick his eyes. “I don’t want to lose him.”

“I know, kiddo. C’mere.” Shinso was pulled into a side hug, and he let himself cry into Aizawa’s chest. He had been so scared when he found out the only reason Riso was standing in front of him was because he was brought back to life by Bakugo. He had been so overwhelmed with emotions ever since Riso opened up to him.

Another thirty minutes passed, and the door finally opened. Shinso stood even before his eyes could reach the door. Out walked Riso, and Hound Dog who stood behind him. Shinso practically ran over to Riso, pulling him into a hug. Riso slowly hugged back. His grip on Shinso felt different than normal. He held on tight, as if he came to realize he could have lost everything.

“Hi.” Riso muttered to Shinso.

“Hey,” Shinso said with a slight smile, and the two pulled from the tight hug but didn’t let each other go. Riso lifted his hand and gently wiped Shinso’s drying tears.

“You were crying.”

“I know. I was worried.” Shinso muttered, leaning into Riso’s hand. “Are you okay?”

“I think I will be.”

“So, how was it?” Aizawa asked, hoping for good news from Hound Dog.

“Realistically, hospitalization should be considered as an option for the future, but not necessary. After we talked about a few heavy things, I think he’s starting to let himself feel. From his past, many horrible memories and feelings can be brought up. He’s at severe risk for suicidalness, and it would be smart to watch him closely. I’d also recommend finding him a consistent therapist. I have a small inkinling of a few mental disorders he may have, but I’d have to have a few more sessions with him to completely confirm them. I’m willing to do that for the kid if he needs.”

“Is there anything I can do to help him?”

“Just be there for him. Having Shinso around will help a lot, but if you plan on placing him in the dorms with the students of Class 1A, I’d suggest having a room built next to yours for him.”

“Understandable. I’ll do that. Thank you again, Hound Dog.”

“Of course. Have him come see me again soon.”

-

Bakugo sat at a table in a cafe Izuku told him to meet him at. He didn’t care what Izuku had to say, but he was ‘just curious’.

That means he cares.

He tapped the table gently, looking at the tea sat in front of him in the small, porcelain white cup. He grabbed the teabag and gently pulled it up and down. He huffed, feeling frustrated with Izuku’s lateness. He rested his head on his hand and looked towards the other part of the cafe. A cat cafe. He hated it.

You’re supposed to eat and drink in a cafe, not play with animals that are known for knocking shit down. What’s he thinking? Their fur gets fucking everywhere.

He let a small gasp escape his lips when he saw the door swing open. Izuku had run in, and was resting his hands on his knees as he caught his breath. Sweat beads dripped down his face, to which he wiped his face quickly. He wore an oversized gray hoodie, its sleeves finding a way over his hands. He readjusted the satchel that laid across his chest, and spotted Bakugo. He smiled brightly and waved. Bakugo could’ve sworn there had been small flowers and hearts drawn around his face when he smiled. His eyes had nearly closed with his smile as he waved like a dork to Bakugo. Bakugo felt a small blush creep up onto his face.

“Kacchan!” Izuku ran towards Bakugo and the table he was at, sitting down in the booth across from him. He gently pushed up his hoodie sleeves when Bakugo noticed something peculiar. That was *his* hoodie he thought his mom threw out about a few months ago. He blinked, looking at Izuku. He tried to be angry, but Izuku’s innocent gaze made it impossible.

“That’s my hoodie.” He said, looking annoyed. But Bakugo would never admit that he found it cute.

“Yeah! It’s big on me but it's so warm,” Izuku giggled, “You don’t mind, do you?”

“You wore it so I don’t want it back.”

No, you look fucking adorable.

“I wanted to talk to you about the night we kissed,” Izuku started, and Bakugo nearly spit out his tea.

“That didn’t happen.”

“Yes it did! I remember it!”

“Nope. Never happened. You’re fucking delousional.”

“Kacchan,” Izuku pouted.

“What? We never kissed!”

“We did.”

“No,”

“Yes,”

“No.”

“Yes!”

“N- mmh!” Bakugo’s denial was muffled by Izuku grabbing his shirt. He pulled him over towards the middle of the table, and Izuku met him halfway. He forcefully smashed his lips to Bakugo’s. Bakugo instantly grew red, but couldn’t resist the kiss. He kissed back, cupping Izuku’s face. He pulled from the kiss, his face twisting in anger for a second. It immediately softened when he saw Izuku’s love sick smile and blushing face.

“..Don’t do that again.” Bakugo muttered, crossing his arms. Izuku got up from his seat, and sat next to him. He pulled out something from his pocket.

“Look at this picture I found while packing my stuff!” Izuku said in a cheerful tone, holding up an old photo. It was Bakugo and Izuku when they were kids, cuddled up next to each other.

“...Do you still drool when you sleep?” Bakugo asked, grabbing the photo from Izuku to inspect it closer.

“I dunno, probably sometimes. I brought more,” Izuku said, setting his satchel on the table. Izuku rested his head on his shoulder, wrapping his arms around Bakugo’s. “If you wanna look through them?”

“Fine.”

The two of them went through childhood pictures together for a few hours, and Bakugo felt his stomach fill with butterflies whenever Izuku laughed and squeezed his arm. He could feel a small smile on his face at almost all times, and everytime he looked at Izuku he couldn't help but want to kiss him again. Izuku sat up straight when someone called his name.

"Izuku!" Riso's voice came from across the cafe, and he walked closer hand in hand with Shinso. Izuku jumped up from his seat and hugged Riso tightly.

"Hi! I didn't know you two were gonna be here! Come, sit! Hi, Shinso!"

"Hey, Midoriya."

The pink and purple haired, unofficial, couple sat across from Bakugo and Izuku. Izuku sat back down, and cleared the table of the pictures and his satchel. He smiled at the two.

"Where were you guys coming from?"

"The school. Hitoshi helped me pack some of the things in my apartment." Riso said, and Shinso looked at him lovingly. Bakugo almost felt jealous of the look he gave Riso. It was filled with an overwhelming amount of support, patience, and love that it made him sick. He didn't feel jealous because he felt something towards Riso, but he felt as if only *he* could feel such a strong emotion towards someone. It wasn't fair that someone else could feel it towards someone so casually. He grumbled softly, and Izuku intertwined their fingers together.

"Oh! I just finished packing up some of my own stuff! I found old family photos of Kacchan and I." Izuku looked up towards Bakugo with sparkling eyes. "Right?"

"Yeah." Bakugo nodded. "It was dumb."

"That means he likes it."

Shinso chuckled, “I can’t wait to move into the dorms, honestly.”

“I’m not so excited.” Riso sighed. “They’re placing me in a room next to Aizawa’s.”

“Why?” Bakugo asked, surprising the three.

“Because I’m a vigilante with ‘possible suicidal tendencies’.”

“That’s stupid.”

“I know!”

“Hey, Riso!” Izuku stands, “Let’s go look at the cats! Will you two come with us?” He looked towards Shinso and Bakugo.

“No, I’d like to get some coffee first.” Shinso smiled and nodded the two on. “Go ahead.”

“Yeah, I don’t do cats.” Bakugo muttered.

“Okay, well..You know where to find us!” Izuku grabbed Riso’s hand and ran with him to the cats. Shinso looked at Bakugo.

“Bakugo, can we talk?” Shinso says, looking at him with a serious expression.

“The hell do you want, insomniac?”

“I wanted to thank you.” Shinso’s voice was quiet and delicate. “For saving Riso that night.”

Bakugo bit his lip, thinking back to the camp.

The chaos of the fight was over quickly, and Izuku ran towards Riso’s lifeless body. Bakugo was right behind Izuku, feeling his heart tighten when Izuku desperately felt around for a pulse.

“Kacchan, he doesn’t have one!” Izuku cried out, and Bakugo wasted no time. He gently moved Izuku to the side and straddled Riso’s waist. He placed his hands to his chest and began to start the CPR process. He cursed to himself, wishing Denki was here to give him an electric shock to bring back a pulse.

He took a breath and let his hand spark. His nose twitched when the smell of burning clothing filled the air. He realized it had gone dead silent, as he continued to make the sparks bigger and bigger. It was the best he could manage. To his surprise, it worked.

Riso shot up, gasping for breath. He took a deep breath and looked around dazed. He spoke.

“Hey, guys. Long time no see?”

Bakugo pressed his lips together.

“It wasn’t a big deal.” Bakugo said, looking at his tea cup.

“No. It was.” Shinso shook his head. “I don’t know how I could ever repay you for doing that. I know emotional-led conversations are not your thing. But I mean it.”

“I couldn’t let the bastard die. He’s..”

He's my friend.

"I understand." Shinso let a sad attempt of a smile hit his lips. "So you and Midoriya..Official yet?"

"Huh?"

"We know about you kissing him."

"I did no such thing!"

"Oh bullshit."

"Shut up."

"Fine, I'll just ask Riso to be my boyfriend before you. That automatically makes me better than you." Shinso taunted.

"No it doesn't."

"Then I'll go do it right now." He stood, fixing his shirt. Bakugo stood too.

"No."

"Oh?" Shinso challenged with a smirk. "You..don't want me to?"

"Shut up."

Shinso turned on his heel, and ran towards the cat section of the cafe. Bakugo growled and ran after Shinso. He reached the door at the same time, and shoved Shinso out of the way. He ran to Izuku, grabbing him by the arm.

“Go out with me.” Bakugo said suddenly, and Izuku looked at him confused.

“Huh..? Like a date?” He asked innocently.

“No. Be my boyfriend.”

“Holy shit.” Riso says from behind Izuku. Izuku’s eyes lit up more than a kid on Christmas.

“Yes!” Izuku jumped up and down happily, and Bakugo gave a soft smile. He looked back towards Shinso, who was smirking. He paused, realizing he fell for his plan.

He looked back at Izuku, who grabbed his collar and pulled him down. Izuku kissed him gently, and Bakugo kissed back almost instantly. He pulled him closer by his waist, making the kiss more passionate than he originally planned it to be.

Riso stood next to Shinso, looking at him knowingly.

“What’d you tell him?”

“That if I asked you out first, I’d be better than him.” Shinso leaned over and kissed Riso cheek, whose face and ears burned bright red as he stared off into the distance in shock. He gently placed a few fingers to where he was just kissed, and looked away from Shinso. Shinso chuckled and grabbed his hand. “You’re so cute.”

“Shut up.”

“Mm, never.”

“I hate you.”

“No you don’t.”

“You’ve got no proof!”

“Your ears are still bright red.”

“...Fuck off.”

The two shared a chuckle as Izuku and Bakugo pulled from their long kiss. Izuku smiled brightly and hugged Bakugo.

“Kacchan,” He muttered, holding onto his shirt. “Thank you..”

“Shut up, you damn nerd..”

-

Riso felt his hands shaking as he stared at the large dormitory that stood in front of him. He was informed it might’ve been smarter to come earlier to set up, since Aizawa had to watch him for ‘anything that raises red flags’. Feeling was new to Riso, and he hated that he was doing it. At the same time, he’s had a weight lifted off his chest since he sat down and talked with Hound Dog. Who knew therapy actually helped?

Riso nervously walked up to the door with his suitcase and a few boxes behind him. Most of those boxes are his unfinished/finished journals. He almost lost his balance when the door swung open. Nemuri stood on the other side with a soft smile.

“Hey, kiddo!” She leaned forward and ruffled his hair. “I’m here to set you up! Aizawa’s busy with a few more things, so I came to help.”

“I’m not suicidal.” Riso blurted out, then paused with a blush. “I-I mean, if that’s what Aizawa or Hound Dog said. Sorry, I really didn’t mean to blurt that out.”

“It’s not a problem, kiddo. Here, let's get you set up.”

Nemuri and Riso began to bring in the boxes, and started to set up his dorm room. He was appreciative of the size, it must’ve been bigger than the average dorm. He gleamed with happiness as he saw all of the potential hiding places for weapons. Sure, Aizawa and a few others knew he was Cosmic, but he didn’t want some Pro-Hero managing to snoop around and find them. Better safe than sorry, y’know?

“...Is this a bomb?” Nemuri asked as she pulled out a metal cylinder from a box.

“No, it’s a smoke screen. It has an option to be lethal or not.” Riso responded casually, pulling journals from a box. He looked at Nemuri after she didn’t speak. She was rummaging through the box, pulling out other various weapons. She locked eyes with Riso, who had temporarily put his hair in a ponytail.

“You can’t have these.”

“It’s for my job, as Cosmic.”

“First of all, are any of these even safe? Second of all, Aizawa told you no weapons.”

“Aizawa also said he hated kids, now he’s got one adopted and planned on taking in Izuku.”

“Listen here, you little shit-” Nemuri chuckled, but she walked towards Riso. She cupped his face in a motherly hold. “But I’m serious, Riso. You’re not permitted to have any weapons until Hound Dog deems your mental health better.”

“...Not even my staff?”

“Does it have more purposes than just a solid hit?”

“..Does a taser count?”

“Yes.”

“...Then, yeah.”

“I'm afraid so. If you can create a staff with no other powers, you might just be able to pass with it. All of theses traps, bombs, weapons…You can’t have these.”

“It’s not fair!” Riso says, huffing. “My quirk can only do so much, I rely on my gadgets to keep both Izuku and I safe.”

“Did Aizawa not tell you?”

“...I do not like that look on your face. What did he not tell me?”

“You’re not permitted to be Cosmic either. At least until you get better.”

“What?! But- what about all those people I might not save..??”

“Sometimes heroes have to make sacrifices.”

“I’m no hero, I’m not buying that bullshit.”

The tenison in the room was sliced by the sound of Nemuri’s phone buzzing. She picked it up and had a short conversation with the other person. She looks at Riso.

“Make a box to give to Aizawa later. Okay?” She smiled at him softly, “I have to go. The other kids will be here soon.”

Riso nodded, looking at his mess of a dorm. He needed coffee. He grabbed a journal and made his way to the common areas’ kitchen. He grabbed a cup after fumbling through the different cabinets. He began to brew a pot of coffee. He tapped his finger against the counter gently, waiting patiently for the coffee to brew. The soft dripping noise hitting the clear plastic began to irritate him slightly, before he felt his eye twitch. After the coffee finished, he poured it into the cup. He accidently spilled the burning hot coffee onto his hand that was holding the cup. He felt his body freeze when an unusual and unfamiliar memory came back to him.

Riso could barely see over the counter as he watched the dark liquid his mother hadn’t given him the name to drip into the oddly shaped plastic pot. He rested his arms on the counter, leaning his head to its side on one of his arms.

“Mama, what’s this called?”

“It’s coffee.” His mother's tone was cold, unforgiving, and passive aggressive.

“Coffee.” Riso marveled, “Can I have some?”

“Coffee's for grown ups. And not wussies.”

“I’m not a wussy, I promise!” Riso turned and looked at his mother. “Please let me have some!”

“Fine. You have to pour it yourself, then.”

“Okay!” Riso patiently waited for the coffee to brew. He pushed his stepping stool close to the counters and stretched his arms up high for a cup. He huffed in frustration, climbing onto the counter. He grabbed a small, brown mug with an owl decal on it. He smiled in victory as he got off the counter and reached for the pot. It was heavier than he expected, so he wobbled as he tried to pour it. The dark caffeinated liquid filled the cup, but when he wobbled it covered his hand.

Riso stared at his hand as the liquid ran down it, clearly away and showing his skin turning bright red. It took a few seconds, but he started screaming in pain.

“Mama!” He cried, setting everything down and running towards her. He held his hand out with a crying face, begging for her to help him. She simply sighed, stood up, and grabbed something from the freezer. She grabbed his hand gently, and placed an ice cube to the newly formed burn. He began to cry as the pain felt as if his skin was being ripped in half. “Mama, that hurts!”

“That’s what you get for making a fucking mess. Damn useless child.” She growled, her voice doused in toxicity. She held the ice cube to his burn until he passed out.

Riso blinked slowly at his hand, the coffee creating a sticky layer over it. He felt his breath catch in his throat when he noticed a small scar on his hand.

Is that where that scar came from..? He thought quietly, setting down the coffee pot and cup. He suddenly didn’t want to drink coffee anymore.

The doors slammed open, and the class of 1A ran inside. Riso smiled softly, wiping the counter to pick up the coffee spill.

“Riso! You’re here too?!” Mina asked in an excited voice, running over and hugging him tightly.

“Yeah. My class was…not liking the idea of me staying with them. And Aizawa is supposed to watch over me.” Riso hugged back, chuckling softly.

“Are you staying in Shinso’s room~?” She teased, Riso’s face turning bright red.

“No..! I- We never could-”

“But you wanna!” Hagakure said from beside Mina, “Oh it’s true love!”

Guess Izuku and Bakugo haven’t told the class yet. Riso thought as he smiled.

“Riso?!” Izuku ran over, basically tackling him in a hug. “I was worried when I didn’t see you outside!”

“Yeah, I’ve already started unpacking.” Riso said, slightly breathless as he was just tackled by a small green haired boy.

“Did you ever get your room changed??”

“Oh, I’m not sure. I doubt it though, since Aizawa seems to despise me. I haven’t asked.”

“I don’t even understand why he’s got to have you next to him.”

“He has to watch me, remember?” Riso muttered. “So my room is next to his.” He said in defeat.

“Oh. Ohh..’ Izuku nods in an understanding manner.

“Is your room close to blastys?”

“Ugh, no..” Izuku puffs out his cheeks. “I’m on the second floor and he’s on the fourth.”

“Guess that means no midnight trips to your boyfriend’s room~” Riso teased Izuku, who began to blush. He hit Riso’s chest.

“Shut up..!”

“Never.”

“Alright, everyone get settled in. Then you can chit chat with one another.” Aizawa said, internally sighing at the thought of dealing with twenty one children. He turned on his heel and went to his room.

“Hey, I’m going to help Shinso. Is that okay? Or do you want help first?” Riso asked Izuku, who smiled at him.

“No, go help your boyfriend.”

“We’re not dating.”

“You should be.”

Riso rolled his eyes and walked over to Shinso, who was looking around nervously. He seemed to relax when he saw Riso.

“Hey,” Riso said softly.

“Hi.” Shinso responded back.

“Need any help with your luggage?”

“Oh, I..I don’t have much to put away-” Shinso started, but Riso picked up a box that was labeled with his name.

“Well I’m helping regardless. What floor?”

“Second.”

“Hey, Izuku’s on that floor.” The two of them made their way to the elevator.

“He is? I wonder if we have rooms next to each other or not.”

The elevator was quiet, and just the two of them. The metal walls acted as a mirror that really only showed their silhouettes in color. Shinso glanced over at Riso, who was occupied watching the numbers change on the elevator. He gulped, looking down at the box in his own hands. Just looking at Riso gave him butterflies lately, ever since he tricked Bakugo into asking out Izuku. The thought of him officially being with Riso almost was enough to make his head spin. He was in a battle with himself.

Yes, Riso had proven himself to Shinso as trustworthy and he'd make the relationship work as much as possible. But the other part of Shinso begged him to not get involved romantically with Riso, as he would just disappoint or let him down like everyone else had. He wanted to let himself have feelings for Riso, but he also couldn't seem to force himself to.

"..Hitoshi? You coming?" Riso asked, holding the elevator open for him.

Hitoshi. Shinso thought to himself silently as he uttered a sorry and walked out the elevator. Just the way Riso spoke his name was endearing. Oh boy, he was lovesick.

Shinso pushed his thoughts back and sat his box in front of his dorm room. He pushed it open, and Riso walked in.

"...My dorm's bigger than this," Riso said aloud. "Huh. Not much bigger but,"

"It's because you're a teachers' pet." Shinso snickered, setting the box down again.

"I am not!"

"Are too~" Shinso opened the dresser drawer to inspect it. Hey, living at the shitshow house he was before Aizawa and Hizashi, you check for bugs just in case.

"Oh my god," Riso picked something up from the box he just opened. He held up a black sweater. "This is my sweater. From when we first met." Shinso's face flushed red and he dashed over, grabbing it from Riso.

"Yeah, well-" He gulped, looking up at Riso. He never minded the fact that Riso was taller than him, the boy was a fucking giant as is, but something in the way he had to look up at him just now made his heart flutter. "..w-well..it's mine, now. Sorry."

“Have you even washed it?” Riso asked, grabbing it back from Shinso and began brushing off the large amount of cat hair that was stuck to it.

“Um..” Shinso blushed even darker and looked away from him. He didn’t want to admit that he didn’t because then it wouldn’t smell like him anymore, but he wasn’t just about to *say* that. “...I-It’s a delicate material, so..I didn’t want to put it in the washer..and I haven’t had time to hand-wash it.”

“...I never hand-washed it, but hey- maybe that’s why I always need to buy new ones.” Riso shrugged, and ruffled Shinso’s hair. He placed the sweater on the bed, and went back to unpacking.

“Shinso?! Your room’s right next to mine!” Izuku peered into the room after about thirty minutes of unpacking. Shinso looked over to the door and chuckled.

“It looks like it,” He walked over and opened the door some more. He almost jumped when he saw Bakugo trailing behind Izuku. “Oh, hi Bakugo.”

“Blastys here?” Riso asked, walking over to the door. He smirked at Bakugo. “Helping your boyfriend?”

“Shut up, pinky-pie!” Bakugo growled, “Are you helping yours?”

“At least I’d be proud to admit it.” Riso teased, flicking Bakugo’s forehead.

“Hey! Oh, I’m going to-”

“Riso! I wanted to ask you if we could meet up later to talk about a few things?” Izuku asked. The question screamed ‘ *Vilignate talk* ’. Riso nodded.

“That’s fine, we can meet in mine or you dorm-”

“Mine.” Bakugo said. “Furthest away from Mister Aizawa. You know you’re not allowed to do any work, but it's not going to stop you.”

“Wait,” Shinso started. “...Bakugo’s in on this?”

“He’s our man in the chair!” Izuku says with a smile and wraps his arms around Bakugo’s arm.

“Bakugo..is your man in the chair. Is there any way I can help too?”

“Well..” Riso thinks for a moment. “You could always help Blasty filter out which crimes we check out.”

“...Orrr-" Izuku says, looking up at Bakugo. “I can stay with Kacchan and help him filter out the crimes, and you can have Shinso be your new partner for a while!”

“You just want to spend time with Blasty.” Riso snickers, “I mean, it would be smart to have you help filter out crimes, but..” He looks at Shinso.

“What?”

“We should talk about this later. See you guys in Blasty’s dorm at..ten?”

“I go to bed at eight.”

“You’ve stayed up until six in the morning to help us, shut up you big baby.”

Hours passed and ten PM came around faster than anyone expected. Both Shinso and Izuku knocked on Bakugo's dorm room door, curious to where Riso was. Once they were inside, Izuku and Bakugo shared a kiss. Shinso glanced around Bakugo's room, smiling softly at the pictures of Izuku he had scattered around. There was a knock on Bakugo's balcony door.

Bakugo walked over and opened the curtain, and sighed.

"I'm not letting you in."

Riso stood there, dressed in what everyone recognized as his Cosmic outfit.

"Please?" His voice was muffled, "Aizawa wouldn't just let me walk around anywhere. This is how I had to do it!"

"Fucking..fine."

Bakugo opened the door and Riso walked in, pulling off his hood and pulled his mask down.

"Let's talk business, yeah?"

Shinso felt his heart flutter. Everything Riso did lately flustered him, and seeing him control the conversation so easily was enough to make him blush.

"So, I opt for staying with Kacchan!" Izuku says. "Besides, it might be better to keep us separated for now. If you show up with a new vigilante, Aizawa will try to figure out who the new one is and focus less on the fact that you disobeyed his orders."

"I don't want Hitoshi to be put in a dangerous situation."

“He wants to be a hero.” Bakugo says, “That’s dangerous.”

“Look, I- Izuku has a healing quirk. It brings a bit of peace of mind when we’re doing things, because most injuries can be healed. Hitoshi doesn’t have that.”

“I can do it,” Shinso says. “I can help, and I won’t get hurt.”

“You can’t promise that.”

“I’m not promising, I’ll just do my best.”

“Hitoshi-”

“I got this, Riso. Okay?” Shinso smiled at him.

Riso stared, before sighing. He grabbed his bag that hung around his body and pulled out a full-face mask. He rubs the top of it with his thumb, before turning it over. Behind the mask, there was a mask just like Shinso’s support item. He hands it to Shinso.

“Here. I made this before I came here. I figured I might as well, if you becoming a vigilante partner was a possibility. It does the same as your support item. There’s a button on the side that collapses the inner mask, the one that distorts your voice, so it’ll lay flat against the original mask. In case you didn’t want to use a distorted version of your voice.”

“Woah..! A full face mask?” Izuku asks, marveling over it.

“Yeah. I want to keep his identity a secret as much as possible. Aizawa is technically his parent, I do not want to hear that conversation.”

Shinso looks up at Riso and smiles. He kisses Riso's cheek.

"Thank you, Riso."

"..N-no problem," Riso blushed. "Do you have a..name you'd want to use?"

"uh..It's kind of dumb. When word of you first came out, I..put together my own outfit for vigilante activities, a name too.."

"You were a fanboy." Riso chuckles. "Cute."

Shinso blushed. "It..It was uh, Comet."

"Comet? Cosmic and Comet…I like that. Go get dressed, we'll have our first patrol tonight."

"You mean it? You really trust me?" Shinso's eyes lit up.

"Of course I trust you. Just keep up, and you can stay doing this with me. Can you do that, Toshi?"

"..Uh-huh." Shinso smiled at Riso.

"God, just fuckin' date already!" Bakugo said aloud, covering his face in frustration.

Chapter End Notes

its an unlikely friendship that the four of them have, mostly they're all bonded by trauma LMAO whoops that's my fault! hopefully you guys enjoyed <3 updates every wednesday and sunday!

Chapter Thirty Four

Chapter Summary

Izuku and Bakugo spend the day together.

Chapter Notes

hope u guys like it! enjoy :)

See the end of the chapter for more notes

“Be careful, okay?” Izuku said, as Riso hopped over the railing to Bakugo’s dorm. Shinso followed suit, a little wobbly in his movements.

“I will, I’ll make sure this one doesn’t get into any trouble.” Cosmic snickered, “See you, Zuku.” He ruffled Izuku’s hair before jumping down onto the ground. He held his arms out for Shinso, who muttered something along the lines of,

“I'm so going to die tonight.” before he jumped. Bakugo and Izuku watched as the two ran off into the city from the deserted area where the dorms were located. Izuku leaned on the railing and smiled up at the sky. To his surprise, he felt a pair of arms wrap around his waist.

“..Kacchan?” Izuku muttered, appreciative of the warmth he now had.

“You looked cold. Shut up.” Bakugo muttered, resting his head on Izuku’s shoulder.

“Thank you,” Izuku placed a hand on top of Bakugo’s, and continued to watch the sky. It was peaceful, hardly any form of outside noise other than animals in the woods. He tried to take it all in the best he could, not wanting the moment to end. The way Bakugo smelled made Izuku want to hold onto him as tightly as possible.

“You’re mumbling.” Bakugo said, giving him a gentle squeeze. “Do you ever stop thinking?”

“Huh?” Izuku looked up at Bakugo. “Oh, I..I’m sorry, Kacchan. It’s just…I was worried about you. Losing you, I mean. Everything was perfect and then you got taken…You mean a lot to me.”

“Stop with the dumb sentimental shit.” Bakugo rolled his eyes, but he turned Izuku around so they were facing each other. “...I care about you too. Or..whatever.” He looked off to the side, but Izuku grabbed both sides of Bakugo’s face before pulling him into a kiss. Bakugo kissed back, leaning down to make the kiss easier for his shorter boyfriend.

“Hey, Bakugo! I heard you out he-” Kirishima’s voice cut the silence after he opened his balcony door. He had looked over to Bakugo’s balcony but paused when he saw something unexpected. He knew Bakugo was secretive, but he was kissing the guy he gave the most shit to. Kirishima hadn’t ever been more confused.

Bakugo pulled from the kiss almost instantly, looking over at Kirishima. His face flushed red and he crossed his arms.

“What the hell are you staring at?”

“...You and Midoriya- are-” Kirishima started, a glint of happiness in his eyes.

“Don’t you dare fucking tell anyone. I’ll blast your goddamn head off, you understand me?”

“Of course! I- I’m gonna leave now.” Kirishima ran inside and shut his balcony door. Izuku laughed it off and grabbed Bakugo’s arm.

“C’mon, Kacchan. We have to help Riso and Shinso.”

“Don’t tell me what to do.”

The two of them went back into Bakugo’s dorm room, and Bakugo opened the laptop Riso provided the two with. Izuku grabbed the earpiece from Bakugo’s hand with a smile, and Bakugo placed in his own.

“So you’ll be listening in on the reports, and I’ll be communicating with Riso and Shinso!” Izuku leaned on Bakugo to watch the laptop screen. “I’d like to spend more time with you anyway.”

“Of course you do. You’re into that mushy stuff.”

“So are you, you’d just never admit it.”

“You don’t know me.”

“Kacchan, we’ve known each other since diapers basically. Don’t tell me I don’t know you.” Izuku sassed, “Now give me that first report.”

“There’s a convenience store robbery a block from their location.”

“Their location?” Izuku gasped. “You’re tracking them! Wait, you were tracking me!”

“Scar-face likes to bounce around like a fucking monkey. Suprised he hadn’t realized it. There’s one in his clothing and on his weapon. Just in case he loses one or the other. You were easier to track. Didn’t want you getting kidnapped.”

“Hey!”

“Shut up and just tell them.”

“Hey guys! Kacchan says there's a robbery at a convenience store about a block from you!” Izuku chriped, looking up at Bakugo. “He also says don’t get kidnapped. Because he cares about you.” He teases.

“I did not say that.”

“ *Aw, blasty cares about us? How cute.* ” Riso’s voice came through the earpiece, Shinso’s following.

“ *Are you talking about the store with the broken fountain in the lot next to it?* ”

“Mhm!”

“ *Oh, I know that place. Let’s go.* ” From then, it was silent. The four continued on for what seemed like hours. Izuku ended up falling asleep on Bakugo’s lap, and Bakugo placed a pillow on his lap so Izuku wouldn’t have to be moved. Bakugo wouldn’t ever say it, but he played with Izuku’s hair until his phone lit up with a message.

hey blasty, i took hitoshi to his room and im in mine. make sure izuku gets to his room safely? thanks :)

whatever

Bakugo placed his phone down before looking at Izuku, who was fast asleep. He sighed, letting a soft smile hit his face. He couldn’t bring Izuku to his room, he’d be seen and he would definitely wake him up. He scooped Izuku up into his arms and laid him on his bed. He debated for a moment, but then decided to change Izuku out of his day clothes and into something more suitable for sleeping.

The next morning, Izuku woke up with a stretch. He rolled in the bed, pulling the blanket closer to his chest. He pauses, then sits up quickly once he remembered he fell asleep onto Bakugo. He sighs softly, and runs a hand through his hair. He felt a blush reach his cheek at the thought of leaving Bakugo's room and getting seen by his classmates. So, he only did what he knew was the best option.

He jumped off the balcony and found his way to his own balcony. He bit his lip as he unlocked his balcony door, and walked inside. He took a breath of relief when he was alone and closed the curtains. Izuku then fixed his hair and went downstairs.

He instantly was hit with the smell of a refreshing breakfast. He walked towards the kitchen in the common area. To his surprise, most of his classmates were up already and eating the food that was displayed on the kitchen counters. Izuku paused, wondering who made all the food.

"Oh! Hey Midoriya!" Kirishima said, waving at him. "Riso made breakfast! Come eat!"

Izuku smiled at him softly, still trying to make himself wake up. He walked towards the table and sat down.

"Cool shirt, Midoriya." Mina giggles, "Did you borrow it from someone?"

"Huh..?" Izuku looked down at his shirt and his face turned bright red. It was one of Bakugo's skull t-shirts. He didn't even think to check what he was wearing before he came downstairs. "I-It's not like that!" He squeaked.

"Oh, I think it is. That's clearly Bakugo's shirt." Sero snickered.

"Did the two of you-"

"God, Kamanari!" Jiro huffed, hitting him in the side of the face with her headphone jack. "Don't be so inappropriate!"

“I think the relationship was clear from the beginning.” Momo spoke, sipping her tea. “They clearly had feelings for each other.”

Izuku sank into his chair, covering his face.

“Alright, leave him alone.” Shinso said, who was sitting next to Izuku. “I think he’s about to explode.”

“Well then let’s talk about your obvious feelings for our cook!” Hagakure leaned on the table, and Mina nodded.

“Yeah! How long have you and Riso been a thing?” Uraraka asks, tilting her head innocently at Shinso. Now it was Shinso’s turn to turn red.

“I would also like to know.” Todoroki spoke up, which kind of surprised most at the table. “...What?” He asked when everyone was looking at him.

“..Well?” Denki asked, leaning on the table. “Go on, tell us how good your game is!”

“We..aren’t together. Okay? It’s not a big deal, so don’t make it one.” Shinso muttered.

“What?? But you two-”

“Hey, leave it alone.” Izuku said, “He said don’t make it a big deal.” Shinso gave Izuku a glance that read ‘thank you’.

Riso swiftly walked over to the table, holding a few more plates and bowls. He sat one down in front of Shinso, before kissing his cheek.

“Would anyone else like some more?” He smiled, and a few raised their hands.

“Not dating my ass.” Tokoyami muttered, earning a chuckle from Shoji.

After the class ate, Izuku was putting on his shoes when Bakugo opened the door. He was sweaty, and looked like he just came back from a run. Izuku smiled and waved at him.

“Hi, Kacchan.”

“What do you want?”

“Um..I-I think the class..knows..” Izuku rubbed the back of his neck nervously, “Did you enjoy your run?”

“The class knows about..?”

“Us..?”

“Oh. Come here.” His tone seemed harsh so Izuku walked over quickly, and he expected to be blasted in the face or something along those lines. To his surprise, Bakugo kissed him. Once the kiss broke, he gave a subtle smile to Izuku. “Then they won’t mind if we do that.”

“K-Kacchan!” Izuku said, covering his blushing face.

“I’ll see you later. I need a shower.”

“O-Okay..” Izuku held his hands to his chest as he watched Bakugo walk away. He felt his heart flutter and he looked at the ground with a smile.

Things really have changed, haven’t they?

Izuku almost jumped from his skin when he heard Aizawa speak from behind him.

“Midoriya. We need to speak. Follow me.” Aizawa wasted no time walking towards his office, and Izuku followed close behind him. He fiddled with his hands as he sat down in the chair Aizawa motioned to. “You’re not in trouble.”

“Okay.” Izuku gulped.

“Last night,” Aizawa started. “Did Riso go out?”

“Outside of his room?” Maybe playing dumb was the best for now, but the glare Aizawa gave him showed he wasn’t falling for it.

“Outside the dorm. To do vigilante work?”

“...No.”

“Midoriya,” Aizawa’s voice was stern. “Don’t lie to me.”

“Okay, okay..” Izuku sighed. “He did..”

“Did you go with him?”

“No sir.”

“...You didn’t?”

“I wanted to..spend time with Kacchan..”

“Alright, you can go. Thank you for being honest.” Aizawa dismissed him, and as Izuku stood he locked eyes with him. “Ah, one more question.”

“Yes, Mister Aizawa?”

“...Before camp, I told you to pick a teacher to house you until further notice. Considering those plans are obviously not…possible anymore, who were you going to pick?” Aizawa felt hope enginte in his heart, and he cursed himself for feeling it. Izuku blushed at the thought, and rubbed the back of his neck nervously.

“Uh..you, sir.” Izuku muttered. “I feel the most safe with you.”

Aizawa’s heart basically bursted into a million pieces, and he would never hear the end of this response if he told Hizashi. But then again, maybe he wanted to be teased about being the teacher the boy wanted. He watched as Izuku walked out the room, and he opened his phone. He thought about the kind of life he would’ve given Izuku if the dorms weren’t in place. The kind of family he would’ve had with him, Hizashi and Hitoshi. He wanted that kind family. He wouldn’t get that family now because of everything that happened. He knew he couldn’t tell the kids he wanted to take under his wing to not be heroes. He knew the hardships they would face and never wanted that to be a reality. He and Hizashi lost a friend of his own and that was the last thing he wanted to happen to Izuku or Hitoshi.

hizashi

Hey sho! You okay? <3

the kid wanted me

Midoriya?

yeah, he wanted to live with me

Guess nemuri was right about you being a dad now, huh? Just because he can't live with us anymore doesn't mean we can't adopt him. That's what we're doing with Hitoshi

let me think about it

Aizawa sat his phone down, resting his head on his hands. He couldn't think about these things now. He had to focus on trying to keep Riso from escaping from his room and doing things he wasn't permitted to. An annoying son-in-law. The one thing he had on his mind for the rest of the day was what it would be like to be Izuku's father figure. The one that cares. The one that gives him advice, and reassurance.

Chapter End Notes

aizawa on his dadawa arc tbh. updates wednesday and sundays!

Chapter Thirty Five

Chapter Summary

> A bonding experience for all parties, some of which are brotherly, romantic, and friendly.

Chapter Notes

> izuku and hitoshi need to be BROTHERS ALREADY!! ugh i wish i could just skip absolutely everything and make them brothers. anyway, enjoy!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

"No, no." Izuku huffed, shaking his head. He grabbed Shinso's hand to guide it in the right direction. "Up and over. Okay?"

"Why is sewing so difficult." Shinso huffed, wincing when the needle poked his skin through the fabric.

"You're the one who ripped your cloak." Izuku chuckles, "Was Riso too hard on you?"

"He's so damn fast." He whined, placing the black fabric and needle down. "I don't get how you were able to keep up with him so easily."

"He trained me for most of a year. It comes easy to me, really." Izuku smiled kindly at Shinso. "Speaking of Riso..When are you going to ask him out?"

"Wh-What?" Shinso's face turned beet red.

“It’s clear you both like each other! You have to ask him out,” Izuku huffed.

“No..! I..” Shinso looked away from Izuku, “I can’t.”

“Oh, c’mon!” Izuku tugged on his arm, “You have to! He’s not going to, he’s stubborn.”

“No, Izuku, I..I can’t. It’ll ruin the dynamic we have. He hates change, and changing what we’re considered can ruin how he looks at me. I’d rather have him this way, then no way at all.” Shinso muttered, looking at Izuku. “But you, on the other hand…How’s things with Bakugo?” He teased. Now it was time for Izuku to blush.

“F-Fine! We’re doing fine..!” Izuku covered his face. “Don’t talk about this!”

“Oh I’m going to,” Shinso pulls Izuku’s hand from his face. “You and Bakugo kiss a lot, huh?”

“Shinso..!”

“And you cuddle,”

“Please, stop!”

“And get all lovey dovey about each other,” Shinso snickered, shaking Izuku in a playful manner. “You love him..~”

“That’s not fair..!” Izuku whined, “You can’t tease me when you don’t even have the guts to ask out your crush..!”

“Hey!” Shinso said, gasping slightly. “Low blow! C’mere, you!” He wrapped his arms around Izuku and pulled him close, before ruffling his hair. The two began to laugh openly, and Izuku grabbed Shinso’s arm. He pulled him forward, straddling him against the floor.

“Now you’ve asked for it!” He says, smiling brightly. He started tickling Shinso, who’s eyes widened in surprise.

“Izuku, no!” Shinso burst into laughter, desperately trying to grab Izuku’s hands. He couldn't contain his smile as he fought the boy on top of him. They both froze when the door creaked open.

“Hitoshi, have you-” Aizawa’s voice came to an abrupt stop when he looked at Izuku and Shinso. He stared for a second, then the two instantly separated.

“Uh, sir?” Shinso asked, wiping the sweat beads off his forehead.

“...First, you don’t have to stop having fun when I walk in. I could hear your laughter from the elevator. Second, I came to ask if you had taken your melatonin gummies.”

Shinso’s eyes widened and his face went red. “I-! Dad! I’m with a friend, could you not..?” He whined, embarrassed.

“Friend or not, I asked a question. Did you, or did you not?”

“..I haven’t.” Shinso muttered, “Izuku and I were patching up some holes in some of my clothes and I didn’t want to get sleepy or anything.”

“Okay, that’s fine. Just make sure that you take them soon. We’re working on your sleeping schedule. In bed by at least midnight, got it?”

“Uh huh, I got it.” Shinso blushed again, looking off to the side.

“Same for you, Midoriya.” Aizawa said before walking out. Once the door was shut, the room filled with a comfortable silence.

“Do you think they’re going to adopt you?” Izuku asked suddenly, earning a confused glance from Shinso.

“...Mic and Aizawa?”

“Yeah. I mean, you call Aizawa dad, and you’ve referred to Mic as papa once before.” Izuku looks at Shinso. “Would you want them to adopt you?”

“I’d love for them to. I..don’t think I’ve had a loving family in a long time, and they give me that. It’s just…I don’t want to be a burden.”

“Hey, you’re not a burden. You won’t ever be a burden.”

“How could I not be, though? It’s another kid to worry extra about, on top of worrying about the wellbeing of the rest of the class.”

“I think Aizawa already sees you differently. He, the most tired person I know, is talking to the second most tired person I know, about fixing their sleep schedule.”

“...Oh.”

“Hitoshi Aizawa.” Izuku muttered out after a few moments of silence. “Hitoshi Yamada?”

“..What?”

“What name would you take? Oh, goodness. It could be really confusing for the class if you took Aizawa’s name.”

“Izuku, I think you’re getting ahead of yourself,” Shinso mutters. “They don’t want to adopt me.”

“Sho, I was thinking.” Hizashi started, “What if we adopted Hitoshi?”

Aizawa spit out his coffee, looking at Hizashi. “Where the fuck did that come from?”

“I don’t know, but I really like the kid. He seems to be good for us, especially you.” Hizashi walks over to Aizawa, kissing his cheek. “You’re actually sleeping at night now.”

“So I can be somewhat rested if the kid has a freak out. He needs someone there for him.” Aizawa ignored the subtle blush that crept onto his cheeks.

“See?” Hizashi smiles. “I think we should adopt him.”

“I don't know. What if he doesn’t want us to adopt him? We technically don’t even have to be his foster parents anymore. What if it’s just for the duration of his schooling at UA?”

“Sho..He calls you dad. I think he’d love it.”

“We can’t know that.”

“You’re being too anxious about this.” Hizashi wrapped Aizawa into a tight hug. “You know we talked about adopting a kid at some point. Well now’s the perfect time. We have a kid in need, who’s already attached to you.”

“I don’t want to rush it.” Aizawa sighs, letting himself melt into the hug. “I don’t want to scare him away.”

“We won’t. I’m sure of it.”

“Why are you in my room.” Bakugo growled, staring at Riso. He had just come in from a late night jog because he couldn’t sleep.

“I wanted to talk.” Riso said, “Just about some things. That’s all.”

“Make it quick. I need a shower.”

“Yeah you do, you fucking reek.”

“The fuck did you just say?!” Bakugo’s hand began to spark, and Riso snickered.

“You heard me, blasty.”

“I’ll fucking blast your ass!”

“Sure. If you can catch me.” Riso smirked. Bakugo growled and dashed forward, throwing a blast at Riso’s face. Riso ducked, and slid under Bakugo. He stood up behind him, blowing a raspberry at him.

Bakugo fell fast first into his bed, and he slung himself up quickly. He glared at Riso.

“You damn nerd! Come here!” He launched himself at Riso again, but he jumped over Bakugo. He came down on his back, and forced him to the floor. He grabbed Bakugo’s arm and twisted it to his back.

“Ha! Gotcha.” Riso smiled.

“No you didn’t.” Bakugo said, and Riso’s smile faded. Bakugo opened his palm towards Riso and shot a blast in his face. He stumbled back, patting his hair since it caught on fire. While he was distracted, Bakugo stood up and punched Riso in the stomach. The force of the punch knocked Riso back onto the bed, and he laid there.

Riso began to laugh, holding his stomach. “Okay, you got me.”

“Now what did you want?”

“It’s not that important, I’ll go.” Riso sat up, and went to stand.

“No. What is it? You snuck in here, like a fucking idiot, and then even pissed me off. So what is it?”

“I think everyone wants me to stop doing work as Cosmic. For the time being at least.”

“That’s dumb.”

“...Which part is dumb?”

“Stopping you from doing your work. Whatever the hell you wanna call it.” Bakugo sat next to Riso. “You’re definitely never going to stop.”

“Oh. Wait, you agree with me?”

“Shut up, don’t make it seem like I care.”

“Earlier today, I overheard Hitoshi and Zuku talking about how they were going to try to convince me to stop. I don’t mean to worry anyone.”

“Well you act like a complete dumbass sometimes.” Bakugo glares. “Constantly giving Izuku a damn heart attack.”

“...huh. I guess I do.”

“I don’t understand why you came to me.” Bakugo rolled his eyes. “We only take because you’re friends with my boyfriend, and I work with you.”

“Dunno. Felt like you’d understand. I could’ve gone to Midnight, but she probably hates talking to me.” Riso let himself fall back, and blew his hair out of his face.

“Well I could care less, really. I’m going to shower. If the rest of you damn idiots show up for tonight's patrol, don’t touch anything. I mean it.” Bakugo stood, going towards the door. “Wallow in your self pity quietly.”

“Yep, you got it.”

Not long after Bakugo left, Shinso and Izuku walked inside of his dorm room. They both paused when they saw Riso.

“..Riso? Why are you in Bakugo’s room?” Shinso questions.

“We talked.”

“...With violence?” Shinso cupped Riso’s face in concern, frowning at the sight of a charred face. It was clear that Riso and Bakugo fought. “You two always fight. What’s with that?”

“It’s just how we do things.” Riso smiled, standing. He ruffled Shinso’s hair. “So who am I leaving with today? Comet or Nexus?”

“I was gonna stay with Kacchan,” Izuku smiled, “Is that okay?”

“Of course, Zuku!” Riso turned to Shinso. “Let’s get ready, hm?”

Bakugo walked into his dorm room, smiling softly when he saw Izuku sitting on his bed in one of his larger hoodies. He had only a pair of shorts on, and he grabbed a shirt from his dresser.

“Kacchan! You’re ba- eek!” Izuku called to him, but began to blush when he saw Bakugo shirtless. He covered his face, shaking his head. “I’m sorry!”

“Oh, relax.” Bakugo pulled a shirt over his head. He walked over to his bed, and sat behind Izuku. He wrapped his arms around him, resting his head on top of Izuku’s. “Those two idiots gone?”

“Yeah, they’ve just taken down the first villain.” Izuku looked up, smiling at the sight of Bakugo. “Do you want an earpiece too?”

“Whatever.” Bakugo took the earpiece, and placed it in his ear.

“ *Oh my god, I’m not going to jump off the building! Relax! Alright, lovebirds. Where’s the next crime?* ” Cosmic’s voice came through the earpiece.

“Two alleyways to your right.” Izuku said, and Bakugo finished his sentence.

“It’s an assault, from what the report showed.”

“ *Thanks! Wh- Cosmic, don’t you dare!* ” In the background of the audio, Cosmic’s voice came through.

“ *Sorry, it was the fastest way down!* ”

The audio cut, and Izuku sighed. He grabbed Bakugo’s hand and intertwined their fingers. He let himself lean back against his chest, closing his eyes slowly.

“Hey, don’t fall asleep on me. You’re heavier than you look.” Bakugo said, chuckling lightly. He ran his free hand through Izuku’s hair.

“Mm, but you’re so comfy, Kacchan..”

“You can nap. I’ll wake you later.”

With those words, Izuku fell into a deep slumber.

Izuku opened his eyes, and he found himself in his old apartment. He felt his heart skip a beat when he heard a familiar humming.

“...Mom?” Izuku spoke, sitting up from the couch. He looked towards the kitchen. Inko visibly jumped, turning to look at her son.

“Baby, you’re not supposed to dream of me anymore.”

“I haven’t in a while. I..I’m sorry.” Izuku stood from the couch, he inched towards her slowly. “Can..Can I hug you?”

“Of course,” Inko smiled, opening her arms. Izuku hugged her tightly, the hug lasted about what felt like a minute long.

“Mom, there’s so much I need to tell you..” Izuku smiled at her. He no longer felt the need to cry at the sight of her. He missed her, sure, but he was accepting where she was.

“I know, I’ve been watching you. You’ve found yourself a strong boyfriend! You couldn’t have made your mom any prouder with your choice.” Inko laughed lightly, “Oh, Izuku..” She gently cupped his face and rubbed his cheek with her thumb.

“I really miss you, mom.” Izuku said softly. “But I know you’re gone..”

“Izuku, dear..You must promise me something.” Inko said, her demeanor turning serious.

“...You seem really serious..”

“Something really bad is going to happen.” Inko said in a hushed voice. “Your life is going to change when you wake up. I need you to promise me, no matter what, you’ll keep fighting.”

“What do you mean..? Mom, you’re scaring me. What do you mean by something bad?”

“I can’t tell you. Baby, promise me. Promise me you’ll stay alive.”

“I..I promise,”

“It’s time for you to wake up, Izuku. Please, don’t break your promise.”

“Wait, no, I- I’m not ready to go yet! Mom, please..” Izuku began to panic as he felt his physical body being shaken awake. “Mom, mom please!”

Izuku gasped for breath quietly when he woke, and he rubbed his eyes. He looked around and panicked, but felt Bakugo’s hand squeeze his.

“What’s going on..? How long was I asleep for..?” Izuku muttered, trying to look at the laptop screen.

“You were whimpering in your sleep. I thought I should shake you awake. You were out for about two hours.” Bakugo said. “I hope I didn’t dist-”

“ *Bakugo! Is Izuku there?!* ” Shinso’s voice came through the earpiece, his voice was frantic.

“Yeah, I’m here. Are you two okay?” Izuku felt his blood pressure rise. He was thinking about what his mom had told him in his dream a few moments ago.

“ *No! We followed a group of people to see if maybe we could find where their hideout was! They were dealing drugs all night long, and now that we’re here—we’re outnumbered! We need backup!* ” Shinso grunted, and now that Izuku was more awake he could hear the clear struggle he was in. He must’ve been fighting.

“Shit. Okay! I’m coming!” Izuku sprung up and threw on his hoodie and grabbed his cloak he used to mask himself. He ran to the balcony door, then went back to Bakugo. He kissed his cheek quickly. “I’ll be back.”

“Wait, Deku-” Bakugo started, surprised at the quick pace he got ready.

“Do what Shinso says!” Izuku darted out to the balcony and disappeared.

“Fuck. Hey, insomniac! Do I need to come too??”

“ *Um, I..Fuck! No, we need you to stay behind and monitor the Pro-Heros! I need you to do me a favor though, and fast!”*

“What is it?” Bakugo was prepared for just about any response. The only response he didn’t expect was what Shinso requested, and it made his stomach drop.

“ *I need you to go get my dad!* ”

Chapter End Notes

ohh the angst is coming :3 also starting from the next chapter, i’ll be using shinso’s first name as he will soon take on the last name of one of his foster parents! <3
updates wednesdays and sundays!

Chapter Thirty Six

Chapter Summary

What once was a harmless job, turns deadly and dangerous quickly.

Chapter Notes

i would like to formally apologize as this is going to change the entire course of the story. love you guys! <3

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Bakugo scrambled to his feet. He grabbed the bag that was used to transport the laptop, and threw the laptop inside of it. As he ran out the door, he grabbed a zip-up jacket from the rack closest to his door. He almost slipped when he made it into the elevator. The short descend down to the first floor felt like an eternity.

“Izuku, are you okay?” Bakugo asked into the earpiece.

“ *I’m okay! Guys, I’m almost there!* ”

“ *Good, we really need you, green-bean!* ” Cosmic’s voice came through, and he sounded out of breath. That wasn’t a good sign. It took a lot to tire him. Bakugo’s anxiety only got more intense. The elevator doors were barely open before Bakugo ran to his teachers room. He skidded to a stop, knocking on the door quickly. He rocked on his feet nervously as he waited for the door to open.

The door flung open to reveal a tired looking Aizawa, who had a scowl on his face. His face softened when he spotted Bakugo. Aizawa didn’t expect him.

“What is it?”

Bakugo began to explain as fast as he could, yet as clear as he could at the same time. He wanted to get it out fast, but his teacher had to understand him. Once he was finished telling him everything that had happened and all that he knew, Aizawa groaned.

“Riso, Midoriya, and Hitoshi are in trouble. Alright, give me a moment.” The door slammed in Bakugo’s face, but reopened less than a minute later. He was in his hero gear, and now he was ready to fight. “Let’s go.”

Aizawa and Bakugo managed to reach the warehouse at the worst possible moment. There were flames coming from mysterious substances that had been spilled on the ground, there were bodies scattered around on the ground. A net was covering most of the unconscious bodies. Currently, Izuku and Hitoshi were fighting side by side.

A villain, who’s quirk was now erased by Aizawa, went to grab Hitoshi. Izuku jumped onto his back, and extended his staff and placed it in front of his neck. He pulled back violently, causing the villain to throw his hands up and try to pull the staff from his neck. Hitoshi took out the villain's legs with his capture weapon, and Izuku jumped off his back before he hit the ground. From seemingly nowhere, a net was thrown on top of the villain. A swift hit to the head from Izuku’s staff knocked him out cold.

“Hey, Eraser, Blasty! Nice of you to join us!” Cosmic called, smashing two villain’s heads together. Aizawa cringed at the sight of the three. Izuku had blood stained to his face, probably from a wound that was no longer there. The full face mask Hitoshi wore was cracked, and liable to fall off at any given moment. His costume was ripped to shreds and the lighter material was covered in blood stains. Cosmic seemingly had more visible injuries than the other two. His mask wasn’t on his face, so all the injuries were clearly seen and displayed. A busted nose which had blood smears above his lip, several cuts and bruises were on his face. There was a large gash across his cheek, surrounding it was dried blood. Majority of his costume was ripped, sliced, and the material was missing. His legs and arms were visible, which also had wounds scattered around.

Aizawa didn’t waste anymore time and sprung into action with the rest of the villains. Bakugo felt anger boil inside of him when Izuku was hit in the face. He dropped the laptop bag and blasted the villain in the face.

“Don’t you fucking dare touch him.” Bakugo growled, and he turned around to help Izuku off the ground. He checked him for any bad injuries that hadn’t healed yet.

“Kacchan, you can’t use your quirk.” Izuku said, grabbing his hand. “You’ll get in a lot of trouble..!”

“I don’t care. We need to hurry and-”

An explosion erupted not too far from Bakugo, Izuku and Hitoshi. Bakugo, without even thinking, turned and protected the two from it. He turned around, looking for the source. He hoped it wasn’t another explosion quirk. He felt a second of relief when he saw a grenade flying through the air, which meant there wasn’t a quirk. He blasted himself up off the ground, grabbing the grenade. He threw it higher in the air, and shot it with a blast of his own. He let himself fall as the grenade exploded in the air. He felt a capture weapon wrap around his body and he was safely pulled to the ground. He looked over, expecting Aizawa. Instead, it was Hitoshi.

“You okay?!” He called, his voice barely reaching Bakugo’s over the chaos of the battlefield.

“I had that!” *Thanks, insomniac.*

“What’s the word on other heroes, blasty??” Cosmic’s yell wouldn’t have reached him if it weren’t for the earpiece.

“Shit!” Bakugo ran for the laptop, opening it. He gritted his teeth. “They’re sending a few this way to investigate the explosions!”

“Get out of here,” Aizawa calls. “All of you, get the hell out of here! Don’t be here when they get here!”

“And leave you to fight alone?! Absolutely not!” Hitoshi growled, throwing his capture weapon at someone who tried to attack Aizawa from behind.

“Yeah, you can’t get rid of us, Eraser!” Cosmic said.

Aizawa grunted, “I can’t afford to lose you kids, get out! That’s an order from your teacher!”

“You’re not my teacher,” Cosmic remarked. “Your theirs!”

“I’m not leaving either of you!” Hitoshi’s lungs burned as smoke from the surrounding explosions filled them.

“Come on.” Bakugo picked up Izuku, who was struggling to stand. “We have to go. I’m taking Deku!”

“Good! Get him far away!” Cosmic yelled. “Bring Comet!”

“No, I’m not leaving!”

The bickering group was stunned into silence when the warehouse behind them exploded. Flames reached tall heights as screaming could be heard from inside. Multiple people began to spill from inside, running to safety and away from the heat. Cosmic stared at the orange flames, his face growing hot. The noise from the explosion deafened his ears, and he didn’t hear anyone but the screaming from inside. For a few moments, he was paralyzed. The ringing in his ears quieted when someone grabbed his arm.

“Hey, Cosmic? Cosmic??” Hitoshi’s voice broke Cosmic out of his trance. “We need to go! The Pros are-”

“No,” Cosmic looked down at Hitoshi. He noticed Hitoshi’s mask wasn’t on his face anymore. “There’s people in there, villains or not they’re still people.”

“..What? You- You can’t go in there!”

“I gotta save those people,” Cosmic picked up his mask and went to put it on his face.

“No, stop. You’re not going in there.” Hitoshi pushed him back slightly. “You can’t.”

“Why not? I need to save thos-”

“Because I like you!” Hitoshi blurted out, feeling tears welling in his eyes. “I’ve basically been in love with you for a while and I can *not* lose you to a warehouse fire!”

Everything seemed to stop around the two of them, and for only a moment nothing else mattered. Cosmic locked eyes with Hitoshi, and gave a soft, but sad, smile. He caressed his cheek lovingly, wiping the tear rolling down Hitoshi’s cheek.

“I can’t lose you, Riso.” Hitoshi whispered, placing his hand on top of his.

Without a second to spare, Cosmic closed the gap between the two.

The kiss was bittersweet, conveying almost every emotion they both were feeling. There was a sense of desperation, hope, love, and worry. It felt like this would be the last kiss they have for a while.

Cosmic pulled from the kiss slowly, smiling. Hitoshi’s heart broke even more, watching as Cosmic put his mask on.

“I like you too, Hitoshi.” Cosmic turned and looked away from Hitoshi to hide his own tears. “But I’ve got a job to do. And you can’t follow me.”

Before Hitoshi could register his words, he found himself caught in a net. He struggled against the thick rope material.

“Don’t do this!” Hitoshi cried out, and Cosmic placed something in his hand.

“Don’t worry, Toshi. I’ll come back for that.”

In a flash, Cosmic had run into the burning warehouse.

Bakugo and Izuku rushed over to Hitoshi when they heard his cries for Cosmic to come back. Izuku flipped open a knife, his hands trembling. He cut the net, and helped Hitoshi to his feet. Hitoshi immediately tried to run into the warehouse, but Bakugo wrapped his arms around his waist.

“Let me go! I have to go help him!”

“We can’t let you, it’s too dangerous!” Izuku said, “There are water heroes on the way, we just have to hope he’ll be okay.”

Hitoshi fought against Bakugo’s hold. He stopped fighting when he saw a second explosion erupt from the warehouse. He felt tears slip from his wide eyes, and he let himself slump to the floor. The sudden drop Hitoshi took caused Bakugo to sit on the ground to keep hold of him. Hitoshi covered his face, and tried to keep his feelings at bay. Cosmic couldn’t have been that hurt, he was smart. There was one thing that was worrying him the most.

Cosmic hadn’t come out with anyone yet.

Izuku watched the flames carefully, hoping to see some sign of life from the inside. The more the building came crashing down, the more his heart began to ache.

The Pro-Heros arrived. From then, everything was a blur for the three. They were moved to an ambulance, where they were getting checked for injuries. Aizawa had apparently talked to the police and told a lie about why they were there in the first place. Hitoshi had a blanket wrapped around him, and he was looking at the object in his hand. It was a simple necklace with a flat, clear pendant. Inside the clear resin, were two flower pedals. One from a snapdragon, and a white rose. His breathing hitched when he realized where they were from.

The bouquet of flowers he had gotten him.

Hitoshi forcefully wiped his tears. He had seen Riso play with the necklace before, or flip it to calm his nerves. He had no idea it meant this much to him. He looked up and over when he saw a Pro-Hero approach Aizawa.

“We found a few bodies, all of which were grown adults. We didn’t…find the teen you were talking about.” They started. “We did find this.” They held out their hand. An earpiece, a piece of cloth, and a compacted staff laid in the Pro’s hand.

Aizawa gently took the items. “...The conditions of the surrounding area?”

“A lot of blood. I'm afraid, if it were that teen boy, he’s very likely to be unconscious or even dead if it’s his blood.”

“...Thanks.” Aizawa walked over to the three younger teens.

“Is he okay..? Did they find him?” Izuku was the first to speak.

“No.” Aizawa looked at Hitoshi slowly. “They..uh, they didn’t.”

Hitoshi covered his face once again, hiding his tears from the rest of the group. Izuku placed a hand on Hitoshi’s shoulder.

“I..I’m sure he’s okay, he..he sometimes disappears in moments like this.” Izuku tried to comfort Hitoshi, but it didn’t help.

“You two should go with the police, they’ll take you back to the dorms.” Aizawa said, “I’ll take him.”

A few minutes later, it was just the two of them. Aizawa sat next to Hitoshi, and he was immediately hugged. Hitoshi let himself cry into Aizawa’s chest. Aizawa gently brushed through his hair.

“Hey, let's get back to the dorms. Is that okay?”

“Mm.” Hitoshi gently nodded, trying to stop crying. Aizawa picked him up.

Once he was at the dorms, he sat on the steps outside. He had pulled his legs close to his chest, and waited there. He looked up at the stars, his eyes softening at the sight.

“It’s bad.” Aizawa says into his phone, watching Hitoshi from the window of his own room. “He said they found enough blood for someone to basically be dead where they found his things. Hitoshi’s broken up about it, and I hadn’t even told him that.”

“ *This doesn’t sound like Riso either. He’s always taking his staff wherever he goes. Do you think he’s..dead?* ” Hizashi’s voice came from the otherside of the phone.

“I don’t know. If he was, why wasn’t there a body? To take a six foot tall body out of a burning fire, that seems like a waste of time.”

“ *So he’s missing. Kidnapped, maybe?* ”

“Who would take him? It couldn’t have been the League. It makes me nervous, if they have some advantage over him..” Aizawa bites his lip. “He’s probably going to end up creating

something for them.”

“ *Riso wouldn’t do that.* ”

“If they’re threatening his life, or any one of us.”

“ *What could they be after? Just a bargaining piece for later..?* ”

“I don’t know. If he doesn’t show up tonight, well...I’ll have to inform the other students he’s missing.”

Aizawa did his best to try and ignore the reality of the situation he was in currently, and he turned to grading papers for the time being. A few hours passed, and he peered out the window. He let out a sigh when he noticed that Hitoshi had fallen asleep on the steps. Aizawa made his way outside, and gently picked Hitoshi off the steps. He walked him inside, taking him to his room instead of Hitoshi’s dorm. As he opened the door to his room, Hitoshi stirred in his sleep.

“Dad..?” He mutters, rubbing his eye with his hand.

“Hey, it’s okay. Go back to sleep..” Aizawa sat Hitoshi in the oversized bed.

“Mm,” Hitoshi hummed. “Wait,” His voice was slightly slurred.

“What is it?” Aizawa asked, pulling the covers over his son.

“Leave the lights on, please..” Hitoshi asked, his voice barely audible. “For when he comes back.”

Chapter End Notes

we crave angst around here LMAO hope u guys enjoyed this <3
updates wednesdays and sundays!

Chapter Thirty Seven

Chapter Summary

> Bakugo, Hitoshi, and Izuku attempt to find their missing friend. Izuku opens up to someone about his feelings.

Chapter Notes

> sorry this chapter is so short i'll make up for it with a longer chapter next week! a lot happened yesterday and i couldn't finish the chapter in time so i crammed the best i could this morning

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Aizawa looked around at the students as they sat in the common area. He fiddled with the inside lining of his pockets, trying to find the words to start.

"Mister Aizawa? Is everything okay?" Kirishima was the first to speak.

"Realistically, no." Aizawa admitted honestly. "Something happened last night." The look on his student's faces made his heart ache. They were too young for this.

"Last night, Hitoshi, Riso, Midoriya, and Bakugo snuck out past curfew. While they were out, they…were involved in a villain attack."

"What? Are they okay??" Mina stood, "Where are they?"

"Bakugo, Midoriya, and Hitoshi are all getting treated this morning for injuries."

“You didn’t say Riso.” Denki said, glancing at Sero nervously. “He’s okay, right?”

Aizawa sucked in a breath, looking away from his students. He built up the courage to tell the truth.

“No. He went missing.” Aizawa gritted his teeth. “We have reason to believe he was kidnapped, and…they believe there's a very strong possibility he’s either dead or severely injured.”

Class 1A was silent, the news of their friend going missing was definitely shocking.

“...Dead?” Jiro asked, her voice shaking lightly.

“Oh, man. I hope he’s okay.” Kirishima rubbed the back of his neck, trying not to show too much worry around his classmates.

“I, too, wish he’s well.” Tokoyami muttered, looking at his lap.

“If you hear, or see anything relating to Riso, tell either me, Present Mic, or Midnight immediately. Understood?”

“Yes sir!”

“Good. Now, get ready for school.”

Hitoshi was quiet as he stared at the floor in Recovery Girl’s office. He subconsciously fiddled with the necklace around neck. He couldn’t help but replay everything that happened last night. The kiss, the explosion, everything. He felt so overwhelmed. He gently ran his fingers along his lip, blinking away the tears that were forming.

“...Hey, you doing okay?” Izuku asked, sitting next to Hitoshi.

“Why was he so ready to save the lives of people who were trying to kill us..?” Hitoshi spoke, his voice soft.

“I..I don’t know.”

“I miss him so much.” Hitoshi covered his face, “I’m so worried for him.”

“He’ll be okay, we have no reason to think he’s in physical harm.” Izuku leaned his head on Hitoshi’s shoulder. “I’ve seen him go radio silent for days at a time when he’s trying to heal a bad injury..”

“I don’t think this is the same. She said she hasn’t seen him.” Bakugo said, coming back from talking with Recovery Girl. He sat next to Izuku, grabbing his hand. Izuku squeezed Bakugo’s hand, taking a quick breath.

“..Right. Well..we have..to think positive.” Izuku said, nodding, “We can do that, right?”

“..Wait,” Bakugo looks at Izuku and Hitoshi. “The tracker.”

“Tracker?” Hitoshi furrowed his eyebrows.

“The tracker! There’s one in his clothes!” Izuku’s dull eyes lit up. “Kacchan, do you have the laptop?”

Bakugo reached for his bag, and pulled out the laptop. He opened it, and it took him a few seconds to pull up the tracking system.

“What are you guys talking about? Trackers?”

“How do you think we knew how close the next crime was?” Izuku asked, a small smile appearing on his face.

“...I should’ve figured.” Hitoshi muttered, then leaned over to see the screen. “If it’s in his clothes, then it has to be attached to him!”

Bakugo loaded the screen, and he let a breath of relief escape his lips. He hadn’t even realized how worried he was for Riso. “It says he’s in an alleyway.”

“Do we have a kind of history on it? When was the last time it moved?”

“Um..It says three hours ago. That would’ve been what, five AM?”

“Let’s go, then.” Hitoshi stands, feeling the fatigue from Recovery Girl’s quirk hit him. “We have to go see if he’s okay.”

“Ah, you boys have school soon. You can’t skip.” Recovery Girl spoke up, and the three looked at her.

“We have to check it now, otherwise he could move! This could be our only chance.” Izuku pleaded. “Please, Recovery Girl.”

She sighed, shaking her head. “I’ll cover for you three, but only for the next two hours. That boy has certainly engraved his ways into you. Don’t come back injured either.” She knew that regardless of what she said, they would go.

“Thank you!”

Within minutes, they were set out to look for him. Bakugo had a hold on his phone, the maps app on his phone seemed to be their only hope. He glanced at Izuku, who was trying to calm Hitoshi's nerves. He felt himself let out a sad sigh looking at the two. They both had the same dullness in their eyes. For Izuku's sake, he'd do everything in his power to find and bring Riso back to him. Bakugo understood that he and Izuku were childhood best friends and nothing could ever change that, but the bond Riso and Izuku held was greater than any friendship he had before. Riso saved his life, gave him the power to be a hero, and was there in ways others weren't. Bakugo also would never admit this, but he wanted to see Hitoshi smile again. Not that they were friends or anything, don't get the wrong impression.

And Bakugo certainly didn't want to save Riso because he cared about him. It's not like Riso checked on him over small comments he made about his mom's abusive tendencies, gave him advice on how to reconnect properly with Izuku, and protected Izuku from his past mistakes and words. None of that meant anything to Bakugo, not at all. It definitely didn't mean they were friends either. They just both know Izuku.

Please be okay, Riso. Izuku thought to himself, when he felt Bakugo grab his hand and intertwine their fingers. He glanced at Bakugo and smiled softly. He really appreciated the support.

The walk in the side was long, and excruciating. The amount of people that were blocking the three from getting where they needed to be was almost an abnormal amount. It was just their anxiety overwhelming other senses in their bodies and minds. They were only a street away when they broke out into a sprint.

Bakugo reached the alleyway first, skidding to a stop as he faced the dark and narrow space. He huffed, catching his breath, before calling out.

"Pinky-pie, if you're in there, I swear to god I'm going to fucking kill you!"

Izuku and Hitoshi both reached the alleyway as Bakugo was calling out to him. Hitoshi stepped into the alleyway, and walked down it. He got about half-way when he noticed blood droplets on the floor. Izuku and Bakugo trailed behind the purple-haired boy. Izuku turned on a flashlight he carried with him. He shined the light on the ground, his breath getting stuck in his throat when he saw the dried blood.

Dried blood.

Hitoshi gently kneeled on the ground, picking up something that both Bakugo and Izuku couldn't see.

"What is it?" Bakugo asked, careful with his tone.

"His.." Hitoshi took a breath as he stood. "It's his cloak." He turned to look at the two. He held it open, and in the middle of the thicker fabric, was a tear.

No, that was a cut. A cut from a knife.

Izuku felt tears prick his eyes as he shined the light to it. Surrounding the cut, was a pool of blood. He blinked away his tears. He had to be strong right now.

"Shit." Bakugo muttered. *Holy shit, this is bad. This is really bad. He's disappeared without a trace, everything of his is showing up. He can't be dead, can he?* Bakugo thought silently to himself.

"Hey, it..we need to get to school." Bakugo says, "C'mon."

Izuku doesn't remember the rest of the day from that point. He had done his best to keep his emotions together and be strong for Hitoshi, but it was draining. He was so worried about Riso. He came back from the day-long dissociation to find himself on the floor of his dorm room. In his hands was one of the jackets he had stolen from Riso when his apartment was out of power. He felt his lips twitch, forming a frown on his face. He jumped when he heard a knock on the door.

"Ah, um..Yeah?" Izuku called out, looking down at the jacket that now rested on his lap.

"It's Aizawa. Can I come in?"

“..Yeah, sure.”

The door creaked open, and closed a few moments after. Izuku didn’t bother to look up. The silence between the two was so loud. Izuku pressed his lips together when he saw Aizawa sit next to him.

“Do you want to talk about it?” His voice was calming, and was lined with concern.

“What’s there to talk about?” Izuku asked, offering him a smile. “I’m okay.”

“You’re not.” Aizawa looked at Izuku. “You’re hurting. You’re angry, disappointed, depressed. I know you are.”

Izuku gulped, and clenched his jaw. “You don’t know how I’m feeling,”

“I do.” Aizawa ran a hand through his hair, sighing. “I lost my best friend.”

“What..?” Izuku questions, looking towards his teacher. “I thought that Present Mic..-”

“We both had another friend. The three of us had plans to open an agency together.” Aizawa found himself picking at the skin around his nails subconsciously.

“Can..Can I ask what happened?”

“He died during a battle with a villain. He saved lots of lives that day, but…he didn’t make it.” Aizawa looked at Izuku. “I don’t think Riso is dead, Midoriya. You have to have hope that he’s not. But I understand how you’re feeling, and how you’re keeping it so bottled up. I was like that. I acted just like you did.”

Izuku gulped, looking down.

“Kid, you can’t let this get to you how it is. Talk to me. Scream at me. Hit me if it’ll make you feel better. Just let it out.”

With those words, Izuku felt himself break. He covered his face with his hands as he began to sob, pulling his legs close to his chest. As the tears streamed down his face, Aizawa wrapped an arm around him and pulled him into a hug. Izuku grasped onto Aizawa’s shirt, letting himself cry.

“I..I’m just so worried..!” Izuku cried out. “He’s everything to..to me, and I..I failed him!”

“No you didn’t, kiddo. You did the best you could.”

Aizawa gave Izuku the comfort he’d been so desperately needing. He gently ran his hand through Izuku’s hair. His best friend, mentor, and partner in ‘crime’ was missing. Izuku told Aizawa about the cloak they found and how they found dried blood around it. Izuku told Aizawa about the amount of blood and cut in the fabric. Izuku told Aizawa he wasn’t ready to have his best friend die.

Izuku fell asleep clung to Aizawa’s chest. Aizawa smiled sadly at the sight of Izuku’s sleep form. He picked Izuku up and laid him in his bed. He covered Izuku with his blanket, tucking him in. He stood and walked out, closing the door softly behind him.

He could only hope that the pink-hair pain in his ass would hold out.

Chapter End Notes

just adopt izuku already!! anyways hope u guys like it :p
updates wednesday and sunday!

Chapter Thirty Eight

Chapter Summary

> Izuku works on advancing his quirk, and Bakugo finds ways to healthily distract Izuku from his missing best friend.

Chapter Notes

> ehh this chapter isn't too long, sorry guys i've been building a deck for a guy my dad knows and it's taking all my time

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Two weeks. It had been two weeks since Izuku broke down to Aizawa. A partneral concern and comfort was enough to give him the strength to make it through the half of the month. Izuku found himself in the gym, along with the rest of his class. He was focused on creating an ultimate move, but it was hard since his quirk made it difficult to be combat-based. His skills were fine, yes, but quirks usually help tremendously when it comes to ultimate moves. He stood in front of Ectoplasm, or rather one of his clones.

“Are you struggling to make a move, Midoriya?” He asked, his voice didn’t hold any aggression.

“Uh..yes sir. I know there’s a lot on my mind, but I can’t seem to think of anything. Minor healing quirks like mine don’t account for much.”

“That’s not true. Most healing quirks start minor. What is something you want to accomplish?”

“Saving and helping others.”

“Try to focus on your healing, then.”

“I don’t have any wounds, I..can’t.” Izuku looked off to the side.

A few moments later, Ojiro came onto the platform where the two were standing. He had a few cuts and bruises from his training. Ectoplasm looked at Izuku.

“A classmate of yours is injured, try to heal him. Try starting by thinking of something that gives you inspiration.”

“Hey, Midoriya.”

“Oh, um..Hey, Ojiro.” Izuku gently grabbed his hand. “I’m not sure how this..works too much, please bear with me.”

“It’s no problem.”

“Okay..Gotta think of something inspiring.” Izuku closed his eyes for a moment.

Izuku and Cosmic were sat on top of a building, their feet dangling and hitting against the wall below them. The sun was slowly coming up. Izuku watched as Cosmic tinkered with seemingly a bunch of scrap metal and old soda cans he picked up on the patrol.

“Okay, I’m curious. What are you making?” Izuku caved and asked, tilting his head in curiosity.

“A bunny.”

“A..bunny?”

Cosmic opened his hand, and inside his palm was a metal bunny. He gently touched the top of its head, to which it stood and it's ear twitched.

"Wh.." Izuku watched it with sparkling eyes, amazed at the craftsmanship of the small figurine.

"Cool, right?" Cosmic handed it to him. "Here, you can have it."

"But you-"

"I can just make another one."

"You create so much, do you ever get tired?" Izuku asked, holding the newly gifted bunny in his hands.

"Nah. It's always an opportunity." Cosmic began to work on something else. "It's a gift, my quirk. It lets me help others in ways unexpected. It's easy for me to create something accessible for someone in need. It's the same reason I give all the students of UA support items. It's similar to Aoyama, how his quirk needs a support item or it hurts him."

"...You already risk so much doing work as a vigilante, why are you always going the extra mile?"

"Who else is going to?" Cosmic turned to Izuku. "Our symbol of peace is dying, there needs to be a sense of calm in Japan. Even if what I do is small, I don't want anyone to fear their safety."

Izuku leaned his head on Cosmic's shoulder. "As long as you're careful. I can't afford to lose you."

“If I die, it better be from a failed support item.” Cosmic chuckled.

Izuku felt tears sting his eyes, remembering that conversation as if it were yesterday. Riso’s ideals were always inspiring to Izuku, and now that he was missing, his feelings were even stronger. He felt his fingertips tingle. His hand began to glow a soft green, and Ojiro’s wounds disappeared from his body.

“Woah,” Ojiro said quietly, looking down at himself and then Izuku.

Izuku felt his breath get caught in his throat, feeling areas on his body sting. Once he let go of Ojiro’s hand, he noticed he felt his healing quirk begin to work on himself.

“..Wait. Wait, you have my injuries.” Ojiro said, “Did you just transfer my injuries to your body?”

“...I think so,” Izuku looked at his arm, a bruise slowly forming. Ojiro had the same bruise on his arm and now Izuku had it on his. He watched as his own body healed the bruise and caused it to be nonexistent. Within a few moments, it’s like it wasn’t even there. Izuku was deep in thought when Ectoplasm spoke.

“See? That’s not a minor healing quirk anymore, is it?” His voice was monotone, but Izuku could practically hear a smile. “Now, the question is can you transfer injuries to other people?”

“I..That sounds so bad though,” Izuku mutters. “Logically speaking, I could immobilize an opponent, but at the same time…It could really hurt them.”

“Either way, let’s use the new-found information to help you create an ultimate move.”

Class ended and sent an exhausted Izuku to the dorms. His new ability to transfer wounds took a lot of him both physically and mentally. He reached his dorm room, and let himself fall flat on his bed. He forced himself to roll over, staring up at the ceiling. He sighed,

covering his face with his hands. The calluses on his hands softly scratched his skin as he drug his hands down his face. He sat up, grabbing a pillow and pulling it close to his chest. He looked at his phone, pressing his lips together as he stared at the phone screen.

His lockscreen was of him, Bakugo, Hitoshi and Riso. He set his phone down on the nightstand, picking up the scrap bunny he had thought of earlier. There was so much hurting his heart, but he couldn't find the labels to the feelings. He pressed his index finger to the bunny's head, it perked up just as Riso had shown him months ago. He frowned.

Izuku wanted to tell Riso so much. He'd give anything to have a talk with him right now. As the number of days he'd been gone for increased, the more his hope decreased. Riso was smart and strategic, but all the evidence found before was hard to give the impression he was alive.

Izuku forced himself onto his feet and found his way to Bakugo's dorm. He knocked on the door slowly, the door swung open seconds later.

"...What's wrong?" Bakugo asked.

"I can't sleep."

"It's not even six yet."

"I'm tired, Kacchan."

"You should be training."

"I've done enough of that. Can we please cuddle?"

"You expect me to cuddle with you just because you want us to?"

“Yes.”

“...I’m doing this because I want to.” Bakugo narrowed his eyes. He walked Izuku to his bed, lying down first. He opened his arms, and Izuku smiled brightly. He practically jumped into his arms, pulling the blanket around his body as Bakugo wrapped his arms around Izuku. He used one of his hands to run his fingers through his hair.

They shared a comfortable silence. Bakugo twirled Izuku’s curls in his fingers, and he felt himself jump slightly when Izuku began to talk.

“Kacchan?”

“Hm.”

“Do you think he’s alive?” His voice was small, and broken. The softness that lined his words made Bakugo’s heart ache. Bakugo swallowed hard, trying to think of an answer that would spare his boyfriend’s feelings.

“I..Don’t know.” Bakugo muttered, continuing to twirl his hair in between his fingers. “I think you need to rest.”

“I’m worried he’s gone.”

“Izuku,”

“Kacchan, I never got to thank him properly for saving my life.”

“Izuku.”

“If he’s dead, then he’ll never understand how grateful I was for him.”

“Jesus christ-”

“I don’t want to lose him,” Izuku’s voice cracked. He took a deep breath, trying to contain his tears. His throat burned.

“I know, I know.” Bakugo pulled Izuku closer. “But if you tear yourself apart because of this, I’ll lose you. I don’t want that.”

“I miss him,” Izuku let himself cry as he buried his face into Bakugo’s chest. “I miss him and his jokes, his creations, his challenges. I miss him so much.”

Bakugo didn’t say much, only comforted his boyfriend silently. He missed it too. But he couldn’t imagine how Izuku was feeling currently. He gently kissed the top of Izuku’s head, trying to lull him to sleep. He knew Izuku was prone to vivid dreams, but he figured it was better than the possible breakdown he was close to having. Once Izuku was sound asleep on his chest, he took a small breath of his own.

Bakugo tried to think, what was a good way to distract him? A healthy way? Working out is what he always did. Maybe he could take Izuku out on a date?

Would a date be ill timed right now? Is that what people do when others are going through a hard time? I would appreciate a date right now and I’m…missing a friend. But it’s not my best friend. Dates are overrated. Are they? No. They’re good. Maybe it’s just bad timing.

Bakugo chose to take Izuku on a date.

Before Izuku woke for the weekend, Bakugo had decided to take him on a picnic. It would be where Izuku offered a helping hand to Bakugo when they were kids. He’d never say this

aloud to anyone, but he went there when he needed to clear his head. Sure, it had a trespassing sign. When did rules stop Bakugo?

Once Izuku was awake, he was forcefully given one of Bakugo's hoodies. Then, Bakugo helped brush Izuku's hair and put in a product Mina gave him when he mentioned how knotted Izuku's hair was all the time. Izuku would lean into Bakugo's touch, smiling softly as he watched Bakugo bite his lip in concentration. He held Bakugo's hand the entire walk, but other than that they were silent.

"..Where are we going?"

"You ask too many questions."

"W- Do not!" Izuku stomps his foot.

"Do too. Now c'mon, this basket is a pain to carry."

"You won't even let me carry that!"

"Yeah cause I'm carrying it."

"…Why are you so complicated?"

"Shut up."

Bakugo continued to lead Izuku to the natural bridge, who softly gasped when he recognized the area.

“I remember here! You fell off and I came to help you,” Izuku pulled himself closer to Bakugo. “Then you got all mad at me.”

“Yeah.”

Bakugo sat down, letting his legs hang over the tree. The water below trickled after a piece of gravel fell from his shoe. Izuku sat next to him.

“You’re being really nice, Kacchan..” Izuku smiled, leaning his head on his shoulder. “You know you don’t have to be, right?”

“Why wouldn’t I be nice to you? You’re my boyfriend.”

Izuku felt his heart flutter. He hadn’t heard Bakugo call him his boyfriend so confidently in a while, and it honestly was quite a surprise to him. A nice surprise. He blushed lightly, covering his cheeks with his hands.

“..Kacchan,” He muttered.

“ *That* flustered you?” Bakugo blinked. “You blush so easily.” He teased.

“It’s not my fault..! I’m not used to you being so mushy around me..”

“Don’t call it that.”

“What, afraid it’ll ruin your reputation?” Now it was Izuku’s turn to tease him.

Bakugo scoffed. While the two nit-picked at one another, eventually Bakugo brought the basket between the two. He opened it, and Izuku instantly felt his mouth water.

“That smells so good,” Izuku said, feeling his eyes sparkling as he looked on to the food.

“I made it all this morning before you woke up.”

“..You made all this? For us to do this..?”

“Don’t start crying.”

Izuku started crying, mainly happy tears.

“Deku.” Bakugo muttered. “I hate when you cry.”

“Yeah, well..” Izuku went to wipe his tears, when Bakugo reached over and used his thumb to do it for him.

“Let’s eat, okay?”

“..Did anyone bother you in the kitchen?” Izuku asked, helping Bakugo pull out the food from inside the basket.

“...Um,”

Earlier This Morning

Bakugo stood over the stove as he cooked silently. The towel over his shoulder irritating his skin through the fabric of his t-shirt. He wiped his forehead, when he turned around and

almost jumped out of his skin. Aizawa was stood there, looming over him. He had what seemed to be a scowl of his face, glaring at Bakugo.

Bakugo gulped, feeling a soft panic rise. He pushed it down to speak.

“What.” He asked, using an annoyed tone. In reality, Aizawa currently scared the shit out of him.

“It’s four in the morning.”

“Yeah, I know.”

“Why are you cooking?”

“It’s for my date with Izuku later. You got a problem with that?”

Aizawa paused, smiling softly. “Date, huh?”

Bakugo felt himself blush. “..Um, yeah.”

“Do you need help with anything?”

“No, sir.”

“Are you sure?”

Bakugo paused, looking off to the side. “I could use help packing the basket.”

“I’ll help.”

Aizawa helped Bakugo wrap and pack the food into the basket, as they shared a comfortable silence with one another. Hiding behind the corner was Mina, Kirishima, Sero and Denki. They were all silently watching as Bakugo bonded with their teacher outside of classwork. They were *so* going to tease him later. Especially since they overheard that it was for a date with Izuku.

Present Time

“No. I had no interruptions.” Bakugo muttered, looking at the food Aizawa helped him wrap.

“Well, that’s good!”

The two began to eat. Izuku smiled as he ate the food.

“This is really good, Kacchan.”

“It’s not that good.”

“It is! And it’s not super spicy like you normally make your food!”

“Shut up. I don’t make it that spicy.”

“Last time I ate something of yours that was spicy, I actually almost passed out.” Izuku laughed, earning a small chuckle from Bakugo.

Yes, the date did what it was supposed to. It distracted them both from the reality of their life. They both tried to enjoy it as much as they could, as their lives would change come the following few months.

Chapter End Notes

hope you guys liked the fluff <3

Chapter Thirty Nine

Chapter Summary

Izuku takes and passes the first part of the Provisional License exam.

Chapter Notes

i literally felt like i was writing the transcript of the exam episodes LMAO i hoped you guys liked this very boring chapter

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Izuku felt groggy while he was on the bus. He didn't get much sleep the night prior due to his nerves overwhelming him. Today was the Provisional License exam, and he couldn't help but feel incredibly nervous. This could make or break his career, and sure, there's always retakes. Izuku needed his now. He couldn't risk falling behind in such an important moment for hero course students. He recalled Aizawa mentioning that it was rare for first years to actually take the exam, but considering all they had been through it should make it easier on them.

Izuku was broken from his thoughts when Bakugo placed his hand on top of Izuku's shaking one. Izuku looked at Bakugo, and took a sigh of relief. He always knew how to make him feel better.

"Calm down." Bakugo muttered. "You're overthinking again."

"Thank you, Kacchan." Izuku leaned against his shoulder. "I'm just really worried."

"I know you are. I can tell."

Bakugo let Izuku rest on his shoulder until the bus came to a stop. He helped Izuku up, and held his hand as they walked down the bus aisle. Once outside, Bakugo let go of his hand. Izuku glanced around, watching as other classes walked inside of the testing building. He

took another small breath. He could do this. He's done things most of these kids could never dream of.

Izuku flinched when a loud voice came from in front of them.

"AW YEAH, UA!" The taller man slung his head down into the ground in a bow. "I WISH THE BEST OF LUCK TO YOU! YOUR SCHOOL IS AMAZING"

"What the fuck-" Bakugo muttered, "You're from Shiketsu High." He scoffed.

"Shiketsu High?" Sero looked at Bakugo.

"Yeah. They're the only other school that can even compare to UA. Shiketsu is in the West, UA in the east."

"...So we're rivals." Mina looks at the group of students coming over.

"Inasa. Let's go." One said, and the guy who basically busted his head bowing, left with them. He said a loud goodbye.

"...That guy was weird." Hagakure mentioned.

"That was Inasa Yoarashi." Aizawa said. "He scored the most in the entrance exam for recommendations. For whatever reason, he declined his acceptance into UA. He went to Shiketsu."

"He said he loved UA, yet..he didn't go." Sero says. "Weird."

“Oh my god, Aizawa!” A female with green hair walked over. “It’s so nice to see you again, haha, marry me.”

“No.”

“Who’s that?” Hitoshi asked, glaring at her slightly.

“Ms. Joke, the smile hero!” Izuku interrupted. “Her quirk is Outburst, she can throw anyone into a fit of laughter!”

“Oo, you’ve got some smart ones in your class this year.” Ms. Joke smiles brightly.

“They’re UA students.”

“Mister Aizawa, you seem really close with her. Ribbit.” Tsuyu says, tilting her head.

“Our work study agencies were pretty close, and we helped each other out regularly! Eraser and I were lovers, just two young heroes in training trying to make it work!”

“We weren’t lovers.”

“Haha, whatever you say!”

Hitoshi blinked, looking at Izuku. The two didn’t even need to speak to agree on the fact that she was making them slightly uncomfortable.

“Alright! Class, go get changed!” Ms. Joke told her class, who listened and went inside the building.

Ms. Joke turned to Aizawa, and began to whisper to him. “Have you told your students what happens?”

“No. They don’t need to know.”

Once inside, Izuku felt his confidence depleting as he looked at the amount of people in the room. He gently grabbed Bakugo’s arm, pulling himself closer to him. He felt Bakugo tense, but he really needed the extra support and Bakugo understood that. He just didn’t want anyone to use it to bring either of them down.

Izuku felt his stomach drop when the announcer mentioned only a hundred students would go to the next round. A controlled chaos erupted and Izuku pushed down his feelings of nervousness. He couldn’t be nervous right now.

The walls around them drop and reveal that they’re already in the exam area. Each participant placed their targets and picked up their balls. The exam was about to begin when Izuku turned to his class.

“We need to stick together. We’ll most likely be targeted first, and we don’t want to get out immediately.” Izuku spoke up, “We know each other the best, and the bigger the group, the better chance we have of passing.”

“I’m not doing that.” Bakugo said, turning on his heel. “I’m better off on my own.”

“I’ll be going alone as well. My quirk could be dangerous to you all.” Todoroki began to walk away. Izuku huffed, knowing it was useless to try and convince them to stay. They both had quirks that were more difficult to use in large groups. He understood their method of thinking.

“Bakugo, wait up!” Kirishima ran after Bakugo, Denki following after the two of them. Izuku looked at the rest of the class.

“I have a plan.”

“I thought you liked your class this time.” Ms. Joke told Aizawa, sitting next to him in the stands. “Why didn’t you warn them?”

“They’ll be fine without the warning.”

“Every year, UA is the first to be taken out.” Ms. Joke shook her head. “That’s not fair to not warn them. Everyone knows their quirks and their abilities.”

“So would villains. Tell me, is preparing your students by telling them what they’re going to encounter really teaching them? Real hero work is unpredictable. Villains would know your abilities, what you’re good and bad at. You’re always at a disadvantage as a hero.” Aizawa looked down, seeing the battle between his class and Ms. Joke’s starting. “My kids know that. Do yours?”

“I know your quirks. It’s a pity to be at a disadvantage.” Shindo, a student of Ms. Joke’s, stated. “Now!” Shindo’s class suddenly appeared from behind the rocks and began throwing their balls at Class 1A. Unlike the rest of his class, Shindo isn’t surprised when he sees the quick reaction of the UA students.

Uraraka grabs Izuku by his hands and slings him in the air, who pulls his staff out and begins hitting the balls back with his staff. His accuracy was scary good. Sero was also suspended in the air by Uraraka, sticking the balls to his tape. Mina used her acid quirk to destroy the balls and stop them from coming down onto her classmates. Behind her was Tokoyami, who had Dark Shadow deflecting the projectiles coming their way. With the five of them, they easily blocked the ambush with ease. Aizawa smirked up in the stands, impressed with the team work his class was showing.

Shindo growled and commanded his classmates to use the second attack they planned. As the hardened balls, thanks to a classmates quirks, traveled through the ground, Shindo smirked. This was their advantage.

Wrong.

Jiro slammed her headphone jacks into her gloves, before burying them into the ground. She yelled out the name of her ultimate move, Amplifying Jack: Heartbeat Distortion, and broke the ground apart. It sent the Ketsubutsu's students flying. As Izuku was watching the unfamiliar quirks being used, Shindo gained his footing. He huffed in defeat, but placed his hands on the ground. An earthquake erupted, this time causing Class 1A to be thrown off their footing. They were easily separated from each other as ground spiked large pieces of rock out from it. Izuku gained his footing quickly, but noticed he was all alone.

He began to think to himself. He realized that the students of Ketsubutsu did their best to analyze his quirks beforehand. He knew that in order to not get taken down, grouping up with his class would be the easiest and smartest thing to do. He smiled as he felt his adrenaline begin to kick in. This was kind of exciting, and he lived for the rush it was giving him. He was snapped from his thoughts when he heard the target ding, indicating he was hit by a ball. He looked around in a defensive state, only to see a girl from Shiketsu High standing there.

"Spacing out in the middle of a battle? Not very smart, is it?" She giggled. "You're still managing to smile even though you're at a clear disadvantage. That's so cool," She beamed.

Izuku ignored her words as he dodged another one of her attacks. He breathed through his nose, trying to hold his ground. He was confused when Carrie, who's name he'd learn later on, suddenly disappeared the moment he took his eyes off of her. He looked around frantically, trying to spot her. He yelped when she kicked him to the ground, and pulled his arms behind his back. It didn't take long for his lungs to scream for oxygen, as she was pressing him against the rough terrain hard enough to almost break a rib. He took a shallow breath before he shot himself back with as much force as he could muster. To his surprise, she jumped back. He turned with a quickness he didn't know he was capable of, and threw a ball towards one of her targets.

He let out a frustrated sigh when his ball was taken out of the sky by someone else's quirk. Other students began to surround Izuku, and Izuku gulped. The worst case scenario happened. The only thing he knew he was capable of, was dodging any attacks thrown his way.

He perked up when heard Uraraka call out to him.

“Deku!”

She wouldn’t call out without a plan! Izuku thought, dashing forward to avoid the large amount of quirk attacks that were directed at him. He held his breath as he watched some of the participants approach Uraraka. She was caught off guard by this, and she took a step back. She began to fall as the ground below her foot was…well, nonexistent. As she fell, Izuku watched in horror.

He knew that the kind of fall she’s taking, she’d end up severely injured. As he ran to catch her, someone else suddenly appeared and caught her. Izuku came to a stop quickly, and a smile found it’s way onto his face. Hitoshi.

Hitoshi, who was now holding Uraraka, and Izuku followed each other as they ran off to hide from the large group of students that was once targeting them. Hitoshi gently placed Uraraka on her feet, and he squatted next to Izuku, who was currently looking around to see if there was any threat.

“That’s not Uraraka.” Hitoshi whispered to Izuku, his voice barely reaching Izuku’s ears.

“I know.” Izuku whispered back.

“..Hey, Uraraka.” Hitoshi asked, not looking back towards her.

“Oh, um..Yeah?”

“ **Why don’t you show us who you really are.** ” Hitoshi’s voice was cold, but it caused Uraraka’s eyes to gloss over and her skin began to melt. Hitoshi and Izuku turned to witness Uraraka slowly turn into Camie, the girl from earlier. Both of their eyes widened as they realized she had no clothes on, except for a hat. Izuku felt his face redden as Hitoshi covered Izuku’s eyes with one hand.

“I- you- You’re naked,” Izuku’s voice came out in a squeak, grateful for Hitoshi’s hand.

“If you knew I wasn’t her..” Camie twirled her hair. “Why did you save me?”

“I couldn’t just let someone fall and get hurt like that.” Hitoshi says, “It’s the same reason Izuku was coming after you as well.”

“I’m impressed.” Camie lunged forward, and Hitoshi removed his hand from Izuku’s eyes as he pulled him back. “I want to know more about little old Izuku!” She darted forward again, swinging her arm quickly. Her nails scratched Izuku’s cheek, to which he winced in pain.

Hitoshi grabbed one of his balls, and he aimed directly for her face. He needed to distract her to save Izuku from this mad-woman. To his surprise, she caught it with her free hand. Although, it did make her take a few steps back. She went to attack again, but a piece of tape came between her and Izuku. Hitoshi looked to the source, and felt his anxiety simmer when he saw Sero.

“..More people, that’s no fun.” Camie muttered, before slipping away.

“Was she naked?” Was Sero’s first question the second he hit the ground. The real Uraraka turned to chase Camie, but Izuku placed a hand on her shoulder.

“It’s no use. She’s without her clothes, and the targets.” Izuku awkwardly looked at Sero and Uraraka. “...You guys are real, right?”

“What kind of question is that?” Uraraka asked.

Izuku and Hitoshi took turns explaining how Camie transformed into Uraraka, and how she had a shape-shifting quirk. Or at least, that’s what they thought. Sero tapped his chin, trying to think.

“We should come up with a plan to take down some contestants.” Sero said, “We’ll need two people for each of us, so that’s..”

“Eight.” Hitoshi nods.

“Yeah, that might be tough. But with Uraraka and Sero’s quirk, we can think of something!” Izuku said confidently. He tried not to let it falter when he heard the sounds of more people coming to them.

As Izuku is forming a make-shift plan as fast as he can, Hitoshi stands up.

“I’ll be a distraction, it’ll give you time to do what you need to.” As Hitoshi went to run out, Izuku stood up too.

“Our quirks right now aren’t needed, but yours are! You two, do as planned. See you soon!” Izuku grabbed Hitoshi by the arm and ran forward with him. He felt his breath catch in his throat as he heard the yells of students around him. Izuku had to pass. He couldn’t let the nerves get the best of him right now. He needed this license to help save his missing best friend. He knew Hitoshi needed it just as much.

Hitoshi slung his capture weapon forward, grabbing onto a rock. He grabbed onto Izuku tight and let the gray fabric sling to two forward to avoid an attack. They dodged and used each other to avoid any balls or quirks being thrown their way. They both ended up taking a breath of relief when Sero and Uraraka screamed out.

“Uraraka, now!”

“You got it!”

Boulders suddenly came crashing down, many students getting caught in the tape that was stuck to the boulders. Izuku couldn’t help but smile. His classmates were amazing, and he was glad he worked alongside them.

Hitoshi walked towards Sero and Uraraka with Izuku, and he looked down at one of the many students that had gotten caught in the trap.

“Please, we gotta pass this time! You’re only first years!” He pleaded, but Hitoshi snickered.

“Should’ve thought of that before you got caught.” Hitoshi grabbed one of his balls and tagged the person out. The others followed suit. They couldn’t help but want to jump with joy when they heard the announcer.

“Three more examinees have passed!”

As they walked towards the building where they needed to be once passed, they ran into Bakugo, Denki, and Kirishima.

“You guys passed?! Heck yeah, Class 1A represents!” Denki clapped loudly before him, Kirishima, Sero and Uraraka began to all dance together as they shouted ‘Class 1A’ over and over again.

Izuku felt more nervous looking at Bakugo now than he did on the battlefield.

“Did you two shit heads pass?” Bakugo asked, looking surprisingly tired.

“Um..yeah,” Izuku nods slowly, feeling his face fluster.

“Of course we did. Didn’t think you’d beat us, did you?” Hitoshi teased, causing Bakugo to growl in response.

“Well I fucking expected you idiots to pass! Don’t talk like that to me, insomniac.” Bakugo then turned to Izuku, who smiled at him softly.

“Thanks, Kacchan.”

“Shut up.” Bakugo leaned down and gave Izuku a quick kiss. “That didn’t happen.”

“Of course it didn’t.” Izuku giggled, wrapping his arms around Bakugo’s. They all walked inside to be greeted by their other classmates who passed.

Bakugo had to admit. He was more proud of Izuku than he’d ever admit vocally. He knew that if Riso were here, he’d be beyond stoked to hear his best friend and his definitely-should-be boyfriend passed one of the hardest exams they’d ever face.

Chapter End Notes

next chapter will be the second part of the exam! love u guys
updates every wednesday and sunday <3

Chapter Forty

Chapter Summary

Second half of the exam, and Bakugo lets Izuku see some of his insecurities.

Chapter Notes

oh my gosh guys the week i've had has been INSANE. first i sliced my hand open on tuesday, so i couldn't type until thursday when it felt better. i had to skip wednesday's chapter because of this, and then i got super sick on thursday. i continued writing what WAS supposed to be wednesday's chapter on friday and by saturday my internet had gone out and over 2k words was GONE!! so i had to rewrite all of that yesterday, and i was supposed to add todays chapter onto wednesday but i had to wake up early to do it and you'll never guess what happened. my internet was still out, and i finished the combine chapter and it was about 5k words long. when i reconnected to my hotspot to upload it, it was all gone AGAIN! I even copied it but it didn't work?? so here's a 2k chapter with very lazy writing bc i've done it about three times now 😔 hope you enjoy!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Izuku felt his heart flutter when he heard the announcer start speaking again. He didn't feel well knowing he still had to prove himself for this license. He latched onto Bakugo's arm once again as the wall dropped a second time.

A rescue situation. The emergency units are unable to reach the current location and it's up to the heroes to save every life possible. It couldn't be the worst thing in the world, but then again, Class 1A never truly got recuse training. Aizawa knew this, and he was clearly getting nervous in the stands watching his class. The hundred students watched as the buildings they just fought in and around blow up.

Did they really have to go all out? Hitoshi thought to himself, shaking his head. He turned to Izuku.

"What's the plan?"

“We’ve never really had a lot of training for this, but I think the safest option would be to assess the situation further once we’re actually let into the arena. Then, based on our quirks, we can do our best to split our quirks where they’re truly needed. For example, Uraraka’s quirk would be good for getting those out of heavy rubble. Iida’s quirk would be useful getting high-priority victims with major to the first-aid station as fast as possible. But we don’t know the amount of high-priority victims until we get out there and start looking.” Izuku mumbled to himself out loud. Hitoshi snickered.

“Okay, Izuku. You gotta speak louder than that.”

“Oh! Right, heh..sorry. I think we just need to assess the situation and go from there.”

Once the exam started, Momo immediately started to help make a first-aid station with some other heroes (in training). Hitoshi and Izuku ran side by side as the rest of the class followed behind them. They rounded a corner and saw a younger boy with blood dripping from his head. The boy began to ramble about him and his grandfather who was stuck in the rubble behind him. Izuku spoke his inner thoughts aloud.

“Shit, this is bad.” He mutters, mainly trying to figure out a way to get the grandfather out without rattling the young boy.

Hitoshi nudged Izuku, but the young boy heard him anyway. He broke character, scolding Izuku.

“Are you serious? The first thing you say to someone who’s having the worst day of their life is ‘this is bad’?? How are you supposed to be a hero that calms victims when they arrive if you just announce how it’s bad! Not only that, you didn’t even take into account my own condition!” Izuku apologized as the man who played the young boy kept scolding him. Once he snapped back into character, Hitoshi leaned down to his height.

“We’re going to get you and your grandpa to safety, okay?” Hitoshi spoke in a softer voice. “But first you’re going to have to go with this hero. He’s taking you to a safer place where all your injuries are gonna get fixed.” Hitoshi picked up the actor with ease, handing him off to Izuku.

“It’ll be alright, we’re getting you help!” Izuku starts, then the boy started crying more.

Hitoshi motioned for Jiro’s help. “Hey, Earphone Jack! Can you listen into the rubble and see if you can hear the kid’s grandpa?”

“You got it.” She stuck her headphone into the rubble and listened for a few moments. “He’s in there, and breathing. I think he’s passed out! Tailman, Tentacole! Help him lift the rubble and get the old man out!”

“On it!”

Hitoshi, with the help of Ojiro and Shoji, began to lift the rubble.

“Sir! Can you hear us?” Hitoshi asked, working with his classmates to move as much rubble as fast as possible without being reckless. After a minute of moving rubble, Hitoshi could clearly see an older man in the rubble. He had blood covering his chest, and head. He was still breathing, but unconscious.

I can’t tell if he’s playing dead or if he’s pretending to be unconscious. Either way I can’t hesitate. Hitoshi jumped down easily. “Uravity! I need some help!” Hitoshi called to her. She jumped down, placing her hand on the old man’s fraile figure. He began to float, when Hitoshi grabbed onto him gently. He used Uraraka’s quirk to get on level ground again and not make any jarring movements that would hurt his body. He nodded at Uraraka, who canceled her quirk. Hitoshi gently handed the man off to Iida.

“Go! He needs to be looked at immediately!” Hitoshi motioned for him to go.

It didn’t take much time for the majority of the remaining examinees to get in rhythm with one another. They worked on helping each other more rather than being worried about their scores. No one knew how the scoring worked, so they put aside that winning mentality. Bakugo himself was trying his best to not be so angry, but it was difficult when everyone around him seemed to be idiots.

For instance, when Bakugo, Kirishima, and Denki found two low-priority victims, Bakugo might have yelled at them to move themselves. They didn't need to be babied and carried to the first-aid station. Bakugo had a hard time taking a gentler tone with the victims.

Hitoshi was helping Izuku check on some of the victims in the first aid station when a large blast shook the ground beneath them.

"Shit." Izuku and Hitoshi were in sync with their next few movements. They both watched as henchmen piled in next to the first aid station and made it their target. Hitoshi went to say something, but Shindo was the first to speak.

"Go! Get everyone to safety! I'll throw off the henchmen!"

Izuku didn't hesitate and turned around quickly to grab an injured person to evacuate.

"All alone, are you insane?!" Hitoshi spoke back, running into battle next to Shindo. He felt his stomach drop as Gang Orca appeared in front of the two of them. Shindo's quirk couldn't work against the number ten hero.

"He's right. You never send a lone hero to hold back an army! Nice try." Gang Orca said, using his quirk to knock Shindo unconscious. It was supposed to hit Hitoshi too, but he jumped as soon as he saw Gang Orca appear. Hitoshi's capture weapon wrapped around Gang Orca's body for only a second. He used the momentum to sling himself further back so it added more time before Gang Orca could reach him. He landed on his feet and wobbled slightly, breathing through his nose. He smirked when he saw a wall of ice go up in front of the 'villian'. It only died a little when he counteracted with a sonic wave. Hitoshi couldn't worry about them, he needed to do what he knew he was capable of. Taking down the men around him.

He sprung into action, using his capture weapon to render his opponents immobile. He had about five henchmen in the weapon, and he swung them around with ease as he knocked down the other men. He glanced over to the side, taken back to see his classmate arguing with someone from Shiketsu High.

In the middle of a villain fight? What are they thinking?

Izuku had stopped too once he heard the argument. He was glad he did. One of Todoroki's blasts was thrown to the side by Inasa's wind. The scorching flames were sent Shindo's wave, who was still barely even conscious. Izuku darted forward, grabbing Shindo. Before he could even start running, he could already feel the heat on his back.

"Izuku!" Hitoshi yelled out. His capture weapon wrapped around Izuku and yanked him from the flames course, saving both him and Shindo. Once they were safe, Hitoshi and Izuku turned to Inasa and Todoroki.

"What the hell are you two doing?!" Anyone could mistake the two for twins considering how often they've been speaking in sync lately.

Within only a few minutes, it seems as if Inasa and Todoroki put their differences aside. As they began to work together and create a trap made from fire and wind, Shindo instructed for both Hitoshi and Izuku to help take down the remaining henchmen. More of Class 1A and Shiketsu High students rushed in to aid Hitoshi and Izuku in fighting off the henchmen. Hitoshi looked at Izuku, who had the same idea he did.

They knew Gang Orca would most likely break from the prison that was the fire trap. They needed a backup for when the desperate plan failed.

Shortly after, Gang Orca used a sonic wave to blow the fire out. Hitoshi and Izuku activated their plan. Hitoshi wrapped Izuku in his capture weapon before spinning a few times to gain momentum, He released Izuku, slinging him into Gang Orca.

"Leave those two alone!" Izuku yelled out, swinging down hard with his staff. He heard the crack in Gang Orca's armor, surprised he could really hit as hard as he did. The second impact implemented into the staff helped more than Izuku could dream of. He felt relief wash over him as the buzzer went off. Izuku landed on his feet and took a long, deep breath. He'd definitely need to relax after this, he'd never been so tense in his life.

Once everyone had changed and been brought to an open area, the announcer pointed to the board behind him. He told the hundred students that if you passed your name would be up on the board. Izuku felt like throwing up as he read through the names. He felt like throwing up even *more* when he actually saw his name on the board. He passed. He passed the Provisional Hero Licensing exam. He jumped wth joy, next reading for Hitoshi's name. He hugged the tired tall boy next to him when his eyes came across it.

"You passed!" Izuku smiled brightly.

"So did you." Hitoshi laughed, ruffling Izuku's hair as he pulled from the hug. The two went quiet as they tried to read for Bakugo's name.

"Uh oh." Hitoshi muttered.

"...He didn't pass?" Izuku looked over to Bakugo, who was staring at the board shocked. There was a mix of betrayl, hurt, and anger on his face. Izuku slowly approached Bakugo.

"Don't." He spoke, looking away from Izuku. "I don't want to hear it."

"Kacchan," Izuku grabbed his hand. "I..I'm sorry."

"Whatever."

Later that evening, Izuku was in Bakugo's dorm room. He was sitting beside Bakugo, not saying a word. He wasn't sure what to say. He felt as if anything he were to say would just be taken as an insult since he didn't pass. He didn't want Bakugo to take this too hard, as it's not necessarily his fault.

"What do you think pinky-pie would say?" Bakugo spoke, looking at Izuku. His heart skipped a beat. He hadn't heard Bakugo bring Riso up first in a while.

“About..you not passing?”

“No, about my pores. Yes, me failing.” Bakugo scoffed. Izuku smiled just a little.

“I don’t know. He’d..probably tell you one of two things. If he was feeling nice…he’d say they cheated. If not, he’d..tell you you’re just a loud mouth or something.” Izuku leaned his shoulder on Bakugo’s. “Why do you ask?”

“How are we supposed to save him if we don’t all have the license? I’m just preventing our plans. And being a fucking idiot.” Bakugo was being vulnerable to Izuku right now, and Izuku wasn’t sure on how to handle it. He knew none of this was Bakugo’s fault, but he didn’t realize how important finding Riso was to him.

“Don’t tear yourself up about it, okay..? We..don’t have any leads or..-”

“That’s exactly it!” Bakugo stood. “If I got my license, I could’ve gotten into a good work study. I could’ve used my connections so you could find your best friend and you’d finally quit moping everywhere!”

“Kacchan-”

“No. You deserve every bit of fucking happiness there is on this earth, and for the first ten or so years of your life I destroyed any bit of that you had! I have been trying and trying to make up for my past actions but do you know where that’s gotten me? Unable to find pinky-pie! I keep letting you down again and again and I don’t want you to think there’s someone else out there who is more capable. There *is* someone who is more capable, but you stick with me!” Bakugo looked away, hiding the tears coming to his eyes. “I was almost the reason the world lost you, I can’t just lose you now because I’m an idiot who’s got nothing going for him!”

“Kacchan, please don’t be so mean to yourself.” Izuku stood, cupping his face (on his tiptoes). “None of this is your fault. What you did all those years ago is in the past and behind us. Finding Riso is not your lone burden to carry. You failed an exam, that’s not the end of the world. I’m so grateful for you, but it hurts when you beat yourself up like this.”

“But-”

“Ah.” Izuku cut him off, “I’m serious. My happiness at the expense of yours is not a fair deal for me. I want you to be happy too. Stop trying to do everything *just* for me. You have to do it for yourself. Okay?”

“...Fine.” Bakugo blushed lightly in embarrassment. He leaned down and kissed Izuku. He pulled from the kiss.

I’ll start doing things for me by choosing when to kiss you, Bakugo thought as he saw Izuku’s smiling and blushing face. *I can’t believe you’re the thing that calms yet overworks my heart. Would’ve thought it would be something I’ve covered in hot chili peppers.*

Chapter End Notes

i’m sorry if i miss-characterized bakugo, this last part much longer before it all got deleted but i was in a time crunch. i’m busy all day today so i only had about 3 hours to write this morning and UGH everything’s gone wrong!

also yes, bakugo is actually really upset riso is gone too but fuck you this is my story if you don’t like it kiss ass!

also also! hitoshi and izuku working together makes my heart so happy <3 brothers ur honor!!

updates wednesdays and sundays ^-^

Chapter Forty One

Chapter Summary

Hitoshi talks with an unexpected person. Sometimes things aren't what they seem.

Chapter Notes

hey guys! a bit of a different chapter today (stay to the end to find out why i say that) :) i would say towards the end of the chapter there is something that could possibly disturb or trigger paranoia in some people! so please just beware when you read! it's more towards those who struggle with derealization!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

The stars shined in the dark night, Hitoshi's eyes trained on the shapes he could make out with his imagination. His sweater, formally Riso's, was crinkled by the rough gravel-like texture he was laid back on. The soft and oddly comforting sound of city life below him was muffled since he was on the roof of a building. Ironically, it was the building where he used to live. He came up here from time to time to watch others below, or the stars above. He had a hand behind his head, preventing it from dealing with the harsh texture of the roof.

"That's Ophiuchus." Riso spoke from beside Hitoshi, who glanced at him.

"Oph- what now?"

"Ophiuchus. The name comes from Ancient Greek, it means serpent-bearer. It's supposed to be a man grasping onto a snake. Its snake is often closely associated with doctors, so most people take it as a sign of healing." Riso was looking up at the night sky, a soft smile on his face and a glint of happiness in his eyes. "The Romans associated it with Asclepus. He learned the secret of immortality while watching a serpent treat another one with herbs."

"...So he lived forever? This Asclepius guy."

“Nope. Zeus killed him, but that’s more greek myth than astrology.” Riso glanced at Hitoshi.

“You light up when you speak about stars.” Hitoshi muttered. “I don’t think I’ve ever seen you so happy.”

“Hah,” Riso snickered, looking at the stars once again. “When Stain happened, I used fishing string to sew my stab wound. I ended up laying on the roof for a while and watched the stars as my vision faltered.”

“You’ve got to stop doing that.” Hitoshi shook his head, reaching for Riso’s hand. Their fingers intertwined, slightly warming each others hands against the cool weather.

“Doing what?”

Hitoshi took a shaky breath. “Acting like you’re not hurting.”

“Not this again,”

“Yes this again.”

“Hitoshi,” Riso sighed. “I know you care about me. I know I don’t open up often. I just want to watch the stars tonight, okay?”

“..Okay.”

Hitoshi and Riso laid there quietly, analyzing the sparklingly delights that seemed out of their reach. Hitoshi rested his head gently on Riso’s shoulder, their fingers still intertwined. Hearing his breathing alone was enough to put Hitoshi’s nerves at ease. The two of them could sit in silence and not worry for a moment about the other.

“I passed.”

“The license exam?”

“Yeah.” Hitoshi’s voice was soft, and delicate. “Izuku did too. Bakugo didn’t.”

“Blasty didn’t pass?” Riso snickered. “Well..I’m proud of you, Toshi. You know that? I’m really, really proud of you.” He turned to Hitoshi, placing a light kiss on his cheek.

Hitoshi felt his heart jump in circles, a blush rising to his cheeks. He couldn’t help being flustered by Riso’s actions. He wasn’t sure if it was because he had never liked anyone the way he likes Riso, or if it was because Riso was being openly affectionate. Riso hated change. As Hitoshi had told Izuku previously, any sort of label change to their relationship could potentially ruin what was there. Hitoshi wanted Riso in his life, and if ‘best friend/crush’ was the label he had to live with, he was fine with it. Heroes make sacrifices, so Hitoshi had to make this one.

Yes Hitoshi wanted cute picnic dates, candle lit dinners, and late night convenience store runs. He wanted to hold his hand in public with a smile, kiss without any questions, and openly confess his love for Riso on a daily basis. He wanted Riso to *officially* be his. It was hard to be like that, as Riso could hardly ever put himself first. He’d reject Hitoshi just so Hitoshi could get with someone else without issue. Their love for one another was strong, but fear and anxiety was stronger.

“Toshi,” Riso said, “Are you okay?”

“Yeah, sorry. I just..feel really comfortable around you.” Hitoshi felt his heart rate increase. “I..”

“You..?”

“I think I love you.” Hitoshi confessed. “Or, I like you enough to confuse it for love.”

“Oh.” Silence. “Hitoshi..”

“I know.” Hitoshi turned from Riso. “I know you don’t want things to change.”

“That’s..” Riso’s words trailed off.

“I know you can’t do a relationship. I know you don’t think you’re good enough for me. I know you can’t even begin to process your regular emotions, let alone love. I know that if we try to make this work, you’ll have a hard time adjusting to the fact that things are different.” Hitoshi sat up, placing a hand on his chest. “I’m sorry. I’m sorry that I want things to change. I’m sorry that I want you to be with me! But I am *not* sorry for wanting you bad enough to risk it all to tell you. I want you to take this change and live with it, live with me for the rest of time. I like you, Riso Sakusei. I might even love you. If you don’t want to try to handle this change, I understand. If you can’t, don’t expect me to be the same. Either way, things will change. You decide if it’s positive or negative.”

Riso was silent, but sat up to look at Hitoshi. He let a small smile tug at his lips.

“Hitoshi.” Riso grabbed his hand once again. “I..I want to make this change. As long as you’ll be patient with me…I want to try.”

“Wait. Are you serious?”

“I know I’ve been difficult in the past. I can be a lot sometimes. I try not to be, and..my hate for change comes from things I need to work through. I don’t want to lose you because of a fear that can be dealt with. I want you in my life.” Riso sighed softly. “I’m sorry. I don’t know why you still try so hard with me.”

“I try because-”

Their conversation was cut short when the building shook violently, a loud blast coming seconds after. The two sprung to their feet. Another blast, but this time the sound following behind the chaos was screaming. Riso pulled his hair back into a tight ponytail, before looking at Hitoshi.

“Come on.” He muttered after a few moments, and then took a running start to jump off the roof.

“Riso, wait!” Hitoshi called after him, but he was too late. Seeing Riso disappear over the edge made his heart drop. He didn’t hesitate to follow after him this time. He watched as Riso grabbed ahold of a banner that was stuck to the side of the building and swung himself in through a hole that had just been blasted open. Hitoshi barely caught the banner himself, his adrenaline leading his every movement.

The hole led to someone’s living room, but the door had already been opened and seemingly evacuated. Riso looked around, shaking his head.

“I don’t understand. Where’s the cause of this?” Riso began to look through the apartment, Hitoshi began to help. After a few minutes, they concluded there was nothing.

“Okay. You focus on educating the people, I’ll try to find the cause. Go!” Riso pushed Hitoshi out into the hallway. He wanted to protest because he knew he couldn’t. He ran down the halls, knocking on every door he could while calling out.

“There’s been a villain attack on the building, you all need to leave!” Hitoshi felt his voice quiver. He knew that his former foster parents weren’t on the first floor anymore and in jail, but it’s not his fault for feeling nervous. He tried to push past those unwanted feelings as he made his way up the stairs to the next floor. “Please, tell anyone you see to leave immediately!”

He almost lost his footing when the ground shook violently. Another blast came from somewhere, and debris began to fall from the cracked ceilings. His anxiety rose more. He needed to focus but all the chaos was overwhelming him. That’s when he heard the sound of the building cracking change. It was a small change, but one that stated it wasn’t stable

anymore. Hitoshi rushed through the halls even faster, getting everyone out as fast as he could. He needed to find Riso.

He stormed back inside of the building. He knew it was going to come crashing down, but he would very much rather a building fall and crush him then leave without knowing if Riso was safe. He had just gotten everything he wanted, why did it have to fail now? None of it was fair, and Riso always seemed to be getting hurt way more than any human ever should. He found the original apartment the two started at, but no Riso in sight. He began to panic.

“Riso! Hey, I know you’re trying to find the cause but we need to get out!” His voice was met with a slight echo, and the soft city noises that were once calming only added to chaos. He soon heard police sirens and fire trucks at the base of the building. He couldn’t stand all this noise, as it was overwhelming. He tried his best to keep his brain from shutting down, but it was gradually getting harder. Why did it seem like he couldn’t move anymore? His feet were basically bolted into the floor where he stood.

“Hitoshi,” A voice came from behind him. He whipped around, his back now exposed to the hole the first blast created. “Hey, calm down.” It was Riso. He sounded weak, and he was hunched over, grabbing his stomach.

“Riso? Oh my god, you’re bleeding!” Hitoshi couldn’t step forward. He wasn’t sure what it was, but it kept him in place. He reached forward, pulling Riso into a tight embrace. Riso tried his best to hug the shorter boy back, but the wound on his chest was making it difficult. Hitoshi forced back tears before they could properly form. “What happened?”

“Some asshole.” Riso said through gritted teeth. “Look, I..I don’t think I can bounce back from this one.” He pulled from the hug. In the short time Hitoshi couldn’t see the wound, it had already stained his shirt almost completely in blood. From the wound directly, it steadily poured blood.

“No. You can’t go. You *cannot* leave me so soon,” Hitoshi’s voice cracked. Normally he’d feel embarrassed and shy, but he didn’t care. “Riso, you can’t leave me yet. It’s not time to go. You can’t let this be the death of you.”

“I’m sorry,” Riso placed a hand on Hitoshi’s cheek, wiping his tears for him. His hand was cold, and slimy from the blood that stained it.

“Stop it. You’re not going to die.” Hitoshi begged. To himself, to Riso, to even God. He begged *someone* to save him. He placed his hand to the back of Riso’s. “You’re going to be fine, and..and..we’re going to go the that cafe after this. We’re going to take Fluffball in, and..we’re going to be happy.”

“I’m sorry, Hitoshi. None of that..” Riso’s words began to slur. “None of that can happen. Not with me.”

“Please,” Tears couldn’t be held back anymore. “Please don’t go.”

“I have to tell you something, okay?” Riso said, trying to steady himself.

“No, no you’ll tell me after-”

“Hitoshi.” Riso looked him in the eyes. A smile crept onto his face, his eyes dull with not a hint of life. “You’ve got to wake up.”

“What?”

Hitoshi’s confusion was interrupted by a final blast. It shot him back, sending him out of the hole that his back was too. He felt his head spin as he began to fall towards the pavement. He watched as the building crumbled during his fall. He felt a breath get caught in his throat.

-

Hitoshi sat up with a gasp, his forehead colliding with someone else’s. He brought a hand to his forehead, rubbing it slightly.

“What the hell..?” His voice was hoarse. He desperately needed water.

“Jesus fucking christ.” Bakugo hissed, a hand on his forehead. “You and Izuku both. Why am I always the one to hit?!”

“Hitoshi!” Izuku’s arms wrapped around Hitoshi tight, holding him as if he was about to take his last breath. Well, if Izuku squeezed any harder it *would* be his last breath. Hitoshi stayed frozen for a second.

“That was a dream,” He whispered, looking at his friends. Sure, Bakugo was hard to get along with but they were friends whether he liked it or not.

“You wouldn’t wake up! Bakugo had to let off some explosions to wake you up!”

That explains the..unexplained blasts. Hitoshi thought.

“I..Can I get water before I talk about it?”

“Of course! Take your time!”

“...Actually,” Hitoshi looked at Izuku with sad eyes. “Let’s get coffee at the cafe. I..kinda want to see Fluffball.”

Chapter End Notes

yep! it was all a dream :p i really missed writing riso and he’s the easiest for me to write rn and with holidays and shit coming up i’ve had little to no time to get actual chapters out :(love you guys!

updates wednesdays and sundays

Chapter Forty Two

Chapter Summary

Hitoshi talks about his dream and miscommunication causes an argument.

Chapter Notes

this is basically a shittier version of when bakugo and izuku physically fight in the show because bakugo is all like “i’m the reason all might can’t work anymore” so enjoy

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Izuku watched as Bakugo stared hopelessly at the mountain of cats trying to climb up him. He let out a soft laugh, glancing at Hitoshi. He felt relieved seeing a smile on his face as well.

“The cats seem to like you, Kacchan!” Izuku said with a smile.

“I hate this.” Bakugo deadpanned, trying to ignore the claws sinking into his skin. “Why did we come here?”

“Hitoshi wanted to see Fluffball.” Izuku wrapped his hands around the warm mug. “He was going to tell us about his dream.”

“Why’s that stupid cat so important? They all look the same and do the same shit.” Bakugo crossed his arms, and shook his leg to make the cat currently climbing it fall. There was silence, before Hitoshi cleared his throat and spoke.

“Riso and I…it’s both our favorite cat.” Hitoshi looked down at Fluffball in his arms.

“Oh.” Bakugo looked away from the two of them. “Right. Uh, so that dream?”

“It was weird.” Hitoshi sat on the ground to rest his feet. “Riso and I were just..on a roof. Uh, my old apartment building. We just talked. About the stars, uh, his interesting medical history kind of? I confessed to him. Said I wanted to be with him.”

“Holy shit,” Bakugo snickered. “Finally got some balls?”

“Heh, yeah.” Hitoshi felt tears prick his eyes as he gently ran a hand through Fluffball’s hair. “Before he could respond there was a villain attack on the building. We went to help and..I lost him for a minute. When I found him, he was really injured and…a blast sent me flying from the building. For a second I thought it was all real.”

“Oh, I..I’m so sorry.” Izuku leaned forward and gave Hitoshi a gentle hug, “I know this has been hard on all of us..”

Hitoshi hugged back, nodding gently. “Yeah. We really need to find him.”

“We will.” Bakugo muttered. “He’s..fucking stubborn. He’s got to be alive. I mean, we haven’t exactly gotten a body.”

“...You guys don’t think they’re making him a nomu, do you? I..I heard that the nomu they caught at the USJ, his DNA matched someone who went missing..” Hitoshi swallowed hard.

“Let’s not think that.” Izuku looked at the ground. “I really don’t want to imagine that.”

“I’ll kill him if he fucking dies.” Bakugo grunted. “He’s too valuable to you idiots to be dead. I saved his life once, I don’t plan on doing it again.”

Hitoshi watched as Fluffball turned over, pawing the air. This cat was one of the only things that reminded him of Riso that wasn’t heartbreaking to look at. For example, Aizawa had

given him and Izuku access to Riso's room to help with any grieving process. Yes, he wasn't dead, but Aizawa was worried he would be the longer they couldn't find him. Besides there was no point in not letting them in. Maybe they could find something useful. Hitoshi unintentionally blocked out Izuku and Bakugo's conversation as he pulled out his phone.

dad

whats up kiddo?

can i have a cat

you live in a dorm

what do you think?

it's fluffball

the one you and riso never shut up about? the cafe cat?

yeah, they have a program to adopt the cats. i know it's a lot to ask but if i can i'll never complain again

that's unlikely you'll never complain again but let me talk it over with some people and see what i can do, okay?

thanks dad

On the other side of the phone, Aizawa stared at the screen with a pained expression. He hated this, and everything that was happening to his kid. Even if he was just missing, Aizawa

knew how it felt to have someone so close taken from you. He sighed, looking up from his phone. Currently, he was with Hizashi and Nemuri. They were doing their best to find any information on Riso or his whereabouts. He was surprised when he saw how hard Nemuri took the news of Riso missing. For a while he knew Nemuri took a maternal love over Riso occasionally. He just never pegged her as the type to be a mom figure.

“The amount of unidentified bodies that have appeared since his missing makes me sick.” Nemuri muttered as she flipped through a few files.

“How many match his description?” Hizashi questioned, looking up from his own pile of papers.

“..About six. The same height, age, weight, gender. Four of them are severe burn victims, the other two are pretty vague so I doubt they could be him. He’s got a lot of scars to account for.”

“This is stupid.” Aizawa muttered out. “I hate this. I hate this for us, the kids. What is it going to take to find this boy?”

“Sho,” Hizashi gave a sympathetic look.

“If they had just listened to me and-” Aizawa gritted his teeth. “And just stayed at the dorms, they’d be fine and home safe.”

“You know you can't blame yourself for anything. You hold yourself accountable for something you shouldn’t.” Nemuri set down a file. “If we’re putting this blame on anyone, it should be Riso himself. He’s reckless and has to learn he’s not invincible.”

The subtle pain in Nemuri’s eyes was enough to tell Hizashi and Aizawa that she didn’t truly mean it, but rather she’s frustrated that he always put everyone else first. Aizawa looked down at the few photos they had on the table of Riso.

“We’ll find him.” Aizawa said.

“You can’t be sure.” Nemuri looked at Aizawa.

“Then we’ll do our damn hardest trying to find the trouble maker.”

Later that night, Bakugo laid in his bed with his eyes trained on his ceiling. He recalled the conversation earlier with Hitoshi and Izuku, about Fluffball. Ever since he failed the license exam it’s like Riso has been brought up more than usual. He already was stressed enough about trying to prove himself as a hero, and this nagging pain at his heart was enough to drive him to insanity. Anyone who knew Bakugo and Riso, they knew their friendship was a strange one. Anytime they were trying to talk with one another, there would most definitely be arguing or physical contact. That was just their way of communicating.

So of course, the most recent time Riso came to him about his concerns with Hitoshi and Izuku trying to stop him from doing vigilante work, Bakugo hardly took the conversation to heart. He thought it was stupid as you can never truly stop someone who’s dedicated to their work or dream. Now, he wished he had agreed with his boyfriend and Hitoshi. Bakugo hated himself for not seeing that Riso coming to him with the fear was most likely a sign he wasn’t ready to hit the streets again. He found it hard to see how okay Riso was after he saved his life, but he only realized after he went missing that he wasn’t. He was just good at hiding the emotions.

Bakugo turned on his side, the moonlight peaking through his blinds. He felt a sharp pain fly through his heart when the stars twinkled in the dark sky. He remembered the night he confessed his feelings for Izuku to Riso. Bakugo sat up, slinging his legs over the side of his bed. He never realized that he was so close to Riso. He began to think about how he viewed the friendship he held with the pink-haired genius.

He confessed very complicated feelings to him, and was comforted for having them. When he made a comment about his mom, Riso showed up at his window to ask and check on him. Their bond was instantly closer when Bakugo saved his life. Bakugo couldn’t deny it. They were friends. Close friends.

And he let his close friend run into a burning warehouse.

Bakugo felt a simmering rage rise slowly. He couldn't believe he failed someone so close to him. He opened the curtains to his balcony, watching the stars. Tears pricked his eyes, but he violently wiped them away. His head snapped to the door when he heard a knock. He walked over, opening the door. His gaze softened when he realized it was Izuku.

"It's ten. What do you want?" His tone came out harsher than he wanted it to. He really regretted his tone when he saw Izuku's tear-stained face. His eyes were puffy and red spots covered his face.

"I'm sorry, I know it's late." Izuku gulped, using his hand to wipe his falling tears. "Can I come in?"

Bakugo didn't respond, but rather pulled him inside of his dorm by a tight hug. He gently caressed the top of his head, running his rough fingers through Izuku's matted hair. After the hug broke, Bakugo closed the door. He led Izuku to his bed, and rummaged in his drawer for a clean hoodie. He gave it to Izuku.

"Here. Yours is covered in snot."

Izuku gave a weak smile, and Bakugo sat behind him. He gently pulled off Izuku's hoodie. He slipped his hoodie onto Izuku's body. He wrapped his arms around his waist from behind, letting his head rest on Izuku's shoulders.

"Kacchan," Izuku sniffled. "Is it my fault?"

"Is what your fault?" Bakugo knew the answer to that.

"Riso." Izuku's voice broke. "I feel like I failed him."

“You didn’t.” Bakugo continued to run his fingers through Izuku’s hair. “None of this is your fault.”

“It feels like it.”

“It’s not.” Bakugo glanced over to the balcony. “You know you’re not at fault for this.”

“I should’ve told him to stop his work when I had the chance.”

“He knew you and insomniac were going to do that.” Bakugo said, “I think that’s why he tried to take on as much as possible.”

“What? How do you know that?” Izuku looked back at Bakugo.

“He told me. He said he overheard the two of you.”

“And you didn’t tell me?”

“..I was supposed to tell you that he came to me about stuff you were saying behind his back?”

“I wasn’t saying it behind his back.”

“...We all agreed we supported his decision to continue his vigilante work. Saying you were going to try to convince him otherwise-”

“Are you serious?” Izuku stood, turning to look at Bakugo. “You’re telling me that you think I was in the wrong?”

“No, I just think it hurt his feelings to hear you say that you and insomniac were planning to make him stop.” Bakugo looked at Izuku slightly confused. “You were kind of going against him by talking about it without him knowing.” Izuku stared at Bakugo in disbelief.

“I can’t believe you right now.” His voice was small. “I wanted him to be safe. Is that such a crime?”

“No, I didn’t say it was. You know pinky-pie, he wasn’t going to listen anyway. You don’t really enforce things with him alot, so it’d be hard to get him to listen to you.”

“..but he’d listen to you, right?” Izuku asked, looking away.

“Izuku-”

“No. It’s fine. You knew him better than me anyways.”

“Why do you suddenly have such an attitude? I know you’re hurting, and I am too. That doesn’t give you permission to be so-”

“So much like you?”

Ouch. That one hurt Bakugo more than he’d admit. Maybe his tone had been off, or something he said caused Izuku to lash out. He wasn’t sure. There was already so much on his mind.

“I’m not like that.”

“You always used to do that.”

“I’m not like that *anymore* .”

“Then why were you being so mean? I just wanted to help him and you’re telling me I’d never get him to listen.”

“You know I’m right though.”

“He’s *my* best friend! I know if he would listen.”

“He’s my friend too.”

“You two always argue and fight. How is that a friendship?”

“We’re closer than you probably realize.”

“Then why didn’t you reach out to stop him from running into that building? You just stood there!”

“What? We were both too far away! I could say the same to you!”

“He saved my life and-” Izuku forced back tears. “You're not acknowledging that I know him!”

“You know him but so do I!”

Kirishima next door was sound asleep when he heard voices through his walls. To slowly forced himself to sit up and wipe his the sleep from his eyes. He jumped when he heard

Bakugo's voice through the wall get louder. He sleepily turned to the wall, trying to listen in without being too nosy.

He jumped again with he heard the dorm door slam shut. Kirishima stood to his feet, slowly peaking out the door. He watched as Izuku closed the elevator. He stepped into the hallway, looking in Bakugo's room. The sight was a shock to Kirishima. Bakugo was sat on his bed, head in his hands as tears streamed down his face. He could only think that the two had just argued. He knocked on the door frame.

"..Bakugo?"

…

Izuku knocked on Hitoshi's door, trying to contain the tears as they spilled from his eyes. He waited for a moment, and instantly wrapped his arms around the taller male once the door opened. He began to cry into his chest, trying to explain what happened.

"Woah, woah." Hitoshi hugged back, but looked down at Izuku confused. "Slow down,"

"We fought." His voice was almost impossible to understand, but Hitoshi understood it.

"..You and Bakugo?"

"We..we were talking about Riso, and..we both got heated and said some mean things to each other." Izuku sobbed into Hitoshi's arms, "He said he didn't want to see me for the rest of the night."

"Come here," Hitoshi gently comforted Izuku in the hug, "Take a deep breath, okay? Big brother's here for you. Don't worry, Izuku."

Chapter End Notes

hope u enjoyed :)

updates wednesdays and sundays

Chapter Forty Three

Chapter Summary

Class 1A goes against Mirio, and Bakugo and Izuku make up! Izuku gets the opportunity of a lifetime.

Chapter Notes

hope u guys liked this one. my plans are being laid out nicely >:3

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Izuku expected the next couple of days to be a version of his own personal hell. Bakugo was mad at him the last time the two of them talked, and the talk they had just made him feel even worse about the situation with Riso. Needless to say, Izuku wasn't feeling the best. He cried himself to sleep the night prior, keeping both himself and Hitoshi up longer than usual. Probably more just Izuku, Hitoshi has a hard time sleeping as is. Izuku's eyes were slightly swollen and red, even after getting two-ish hours of sleep.

When he walked into the classroom, he kept his head down. He wasn't sure where Bakugo was, but it was quite a shock to find him not in his seat. He sat at his desk, tapping his thigh with his finger. He was anxious, unaware of what the day would bring to him. He was tired of being anxious, but it seems that's the only thing he's been good at lately.

Aizawa stood at the podium, a tired look on his face. That was normal, but Izuku couldn't help but wonder if he looked like that. He was halfway listening as his mind wandered, only catching pieces of Aizawa's talk.

He heard something about Hero Work-Studies, and that it was something first years normally never hear about or act upon. He was definitely brought back to reality when three students came in, two of them smiling brightly. He observed the three for a moment, realizing they were The Big Three. He glanced around the room, watching as his class lit up with excitement and began to talk about what they knew about them.

“I’ll let them talk about work studies with you. Introduce yourselves briefly. Let’s start with Amakjiki.” Aizawa motioned to the one who came in without a smile. He looked up, giving an intense glare to the students in front of him. Everyone tensed, feeling threatened by his stare. After a few moments, Amakjiki faltered and slouched his shoulders.

“I can’t do it. I’m imagining their potatoes, but I can still see their bodies. I know they’re still there. I..I want to go home.” He quickly turned and faced the wall.

“Aw, Amajiki. You need the heart of a lion, not a kitten!” The girl chirped, turning to the class. “This is our kitten, Tamaki Amajiki! I’m Nejire Hado. I’m supposed to talk about work studies, and you first years look like a promising bunc- Oh, hey!” Nejire leaned down in front of Shoji quickly. “Do you wear that mask because you feel sick, or is it to look cool?”

“I, uh..-” Shoji stuttered, surprised by her sudden movements.

“And you’re Todoroki! Say, how’d you get that nasty scar?”

“That’s none of your business.” Shoto deadpanned.

“Ashido, if your horns break off do you grow new ones? And can you wiggle them??”

Mina blinked, and covered her horns.

“And Shinso! Does your brainwashing work on animals too or just humans?” Nejire pondered, a curious glint in her eye. “Oh! Asui, you’re a tree frog right? Not a gross toad?”

Aizawa pinched his nose, probably wondering when he could take another nap. She was tiring him out.

Nejire squealed. “There’s so much I wanna know about you guys! Let’s have a Q&A!”

Denki seemed to smile widely at the sight of Nejire’s excitement, and Mina seemed to agree that her “air-headedness” made her seem younger than she was.

“Hey Ojiro, can you support your entire body weight on your tail?”

“I-..well..-” Nejire leaned closer to him.

“Cmon, tell me!”

Aizawa began to feel irritated, almost as if a red glow had been emitting from his body. The blonde turned and looked directly at Aizawa, and he calmed him. He tried to open with a joke, but it didn’t land. At all. Nothing but silence. The silence alone almost made Hitoshi snicker, but he didn’t. He began to ramble about a few things, mentioning how “everyone was most likely confused that random third years showed up to explain something that’s completely voluntary!” His classmates looked at him with a certain look that read nothing other than a ‘don’t do it’.

“I challenge all you first years to beat me in a fight!”

Before Izuku knew it, it was in the gym in his gym uniform. He really hadn’t registered what had happened before Tamakjiki started speaking again.

Nejire looked at Mirio. “They’re first years, Mirio. Don’t go too hard on them.”

“Yeah, don’t kill their spirits.” Amajiki says quietly, his voice barely audible.

“Nah, we can handle it! Don’t hold back!” Kirishima said confidently, smiling wide as his class agreed. The class then split up and put themselves in a formation where close combat was closer and those who did long-range in the back. They figured it would be the easiest and

most efficient option. Once they started, Mirio activated his quirk and his pants fell off. Mostly everyone was phased by this, blushing or covering their eyes. Izuku and Hitoshi glanced at one another.

It took a few seconds for Hitoshi to wrap Izuku in his capture weapon (he's permitted to have it, since he fights quirkless) and sling him forward. Izuku pulled out his staff, permitted to have for the same reason as Hitoshi, and prepared to strike. He twisted his body in the air, using the momentum to land a solid strike to Mirio's face. He paused when the staff went through his face with no resistance. He tumbled to the ground and rolled, springing himself up to a fighting position. Never let yourself be vulnerable. He watched as Mirio turned his attention towards him, but had gotten attacked from behind by his classmates. He took this moment to make his way back over to Hitoshi. At that time, he disappeared under the ground.

"He can just phase through anything." Izuku told Hitoshi, preparing himself for a fight. "Logically speaking, he's probably going to phase through the floor and jump out behind his opponent."

"I figured so. So we just have to be ready when he does this to us."

It took a few quick minutes to take down the majority of the class. He slipped under the ground and appeared behind Izuku. Both him and Hitoshi turned, predicting the move perfectly. Hitoshi threw his capture weapon, trying to wrap around Mirio's body. It went through. A swift punch to the chest sent Hitoshi flying back. Izuku had used his staff to throw himself in the air to be above Mirio. Mirio turned in the air, looking up at Izuku.

Izuku swung his staff down on Mirio, but as expected, no luck. Mirio trails his own arm through Izuku's, acting as if he was going to poke him in the eye. The second Izuku's eyelids came in contact with the other, Mirio punched Izuku in the chest.

With that, the entirety of Class 1A was defeated. As they were all groaning and in pain, Mirio spoke up.

"So? What'd you learn?"

“Um..It’s kinda hard to learn when you just keep punching us.” Izuku muttered, holding his stomach.

“Yeah, man, your quirk is really powerful!”

“That’s not it.” Nejire shakes her head. “His quirk is Permeation. He can pass through anything.”

“But just because I can do that, doesn't mean my fighting skills and strength came from that. I still trained hard, and focused on technique. Your quirk is essentially the strongest move you have. If you have a big, flashy power that you think can get you through anything, you’re wrong. You must learn to utilize every part of you and your body.”

As Mirio talked, Izuku could only think of one person. Bakugo. His heart ached for a moment, remembering the other night when they fought. He wished he could go to Bakugo now and just collapse in his arms. He missed him. It had hardly been a day, but he couldn’t help it.

If Bakugo could’ve heard what Mirio just said, he’d be pissed. His cheeks would puff out and his face would get flustered. Izuku thought silently to himself. He snapped back to reality once the third years left.

Once the school day was over, Izuku found his way to his dorm. He flopped onto his bed after pulling off his blazer. He rolled over, wrapping himself in his blanket. He snuggled his hands free and pulled his phone from his blazer pocket. He did struggle, but that wasn’t important. He opened his phone, staring at the background of him, Bakugo, Riso and Hitoshi. He let out a soft sigh. There was so much on his mind. He felt pretty alone right now, knowing the only person that was available to talk with is Hitoshi. After his fight with Bakugo, he truly saw him as a bigger brother. It seems Hitoshi thought the same. Izuku sucked in a breath. He couldn’t imagine the sort of pain Hitoshi was in from losing Riso. Sure, he himself was upset, but they were clearly in love with one another. Izuku knows what it’s like to lose a best friend, not a potential partner. It hadn’t even been twenty-four hours away from Bakugo, and he already felt like he was being tortured.

How did Hitoshi even mask the amount of pain that was in his heart? Izuku just couldn’t wrap his head around it. His own heart ached so much over a fight, knowing that Bakugo was

a few stories above him was a comfort to him. Izuku knew Hitoshi didn't have that. He had no way of knowing if someone he cared so deeply for was even breathing. Izuku clicked on his photo gallery, and began swiping. He had tried to avoid doing this since he went missing, but he couldn't not anymore. He missed Riso too much. Besides, he figured there might be something in the photos to help find him.

Izuku smiled at the memories captured on his phone, feeling slightly bittersweet. There was only one thing he could focus on. Hitoshi's smile. He never smiled like that anymore. He lost the twinkle in his eye, his eye bags were so much darker than they used to be. Izuku felt a pain in his heart. He finally got a brother, but he was almost at rock bottom. Izuku stopped on a certain picture of Riso and Hitoshi. They were both sitting on the cafe floor, petting Fluffball together. They both had a smile on their face, Hitoshi's eyes trained on Riso's face. Hitoshi's eyes could only be described as sparkling, and full of life. Izuku shut off his phone, trying to ignore the tears pricking at his eyes. He felt so selfish. How could he ever think he had it bad? How could he dare think he missed Riso the most? Izuku could see it as clear as day on Hitoshi's face. It wasn't fair to Hitoshi if Izuku felt as bad as he did. It was nothing compared to his pain.

His head snapped up when his dorm door opened. He let himself relax once he saw it was Hitoshi. They locked eyes, and Hitoshi gave him a soft smile. A soft smile with sad eyes.

"Hey."

"..Hi."

"How are you holding up?" Hitoshi asked, walking over to Izuku's bed. Izuku struggled but sat up, still wrapped in his blanket. "I can't imagine too well considering you're in a blanket burrito."

"I'm okay. It was just a small fight." Izuku looked at his bed, biting his lip nervously. "It's..really not a big deal. I'm being dramatic.'

"What? You had your first actual argument as a couple. You're not being dramatic."

“Yeah I am.”

“Okay.” Hitoshi crossed his arms. “Why are you being dramatic?”

“Cause I know he’s only a few floors above me.”

“...You lost me.”

“It’s not fair for me to be upset about not seeing Kacchan.” Izuku looked at Hitoshi. “I can see him any time I want, he’s only an elevator away.”

“You can still be upset even if he’s close, Izuku.”

“No. You…Riso isn’t just a door or two away like Kacchan. You have to go to sleep every night not knowing if he’s okay. You can’t see him like I can see Kacchan. You don’t have that chance, and I do, but I’m being an idiot.”

Hitoshi was quiet. It’s not that he agreed with Izuku talking bad about himself, but talking about Riso was salt in a wound. He did miss him, and he hated that he wasn’t a door away. But it also was upsetting that Izuku thought his feelings should be limited because of his situation.

“Izuku.” Hitoshi started, letting a soft sigh escape his lips. “I know things right now for me aren’t ideal. Riso also is *your* friend. Your best friend. You’re allowed to be in pain over his disappearance. It..probably is a different pain than mine, but it is still pain. And your relationship with Bakugo is not the same as mine and Riso’s. He might not be missing, or gone, but he is still far away…Figuratively. You two fought, and things are at odds. You are allowed to be upset.”

“But..-”

“No buts.” Hitoshi shook his head. “Don’t compare your pain to mine and then downplay your own. I care for you, and it hurts to see you do that. Can you do that for me?”

“..I can try.” Izuku nodded. “I’m sorry.”

Hitoshi let out a soft chuckle. “Ah! Not the ‘s’ word. What did I say about apologizing for things we can’t control?”

Izuku felt his eyes widen. He let out a laugh, tears spilling from his eyes. He remembered Riso saying almost the exact same thing to him. Hitoshi looked panicked, but Izuku kept laughing.

“You sound like him.” Izuku said once his tear-led laughter died down. “Telling me not to apologize like that.”

“Don’t do that, idiot!” Hitoshi hit the blanket burrito Izuku was wrapped in. “I was scared I hurt your feelings!”

“No, no. You didn’t. It just..sounded a lot like him. How do you do it?”

“..Do what?”

“Deal with him being gone.”

“Well..” Hitoshi glanced off to the side, fiddling with the bottom of his sweater. “I don’t, honestly. I struggle to fall asleep. My reaction time has been delayed. I’ve got so much on my mind it’s even hard to use my quirk. It’s been a real struggle to deal with it.”

“Oh, I..-”

“Don’t apologize. The only thing that keeps me going is knowing that he could be alive.” Hitoshi nodded softly. “It’s not a lot, but it’s enough. Enough to get me out of bed in the morning.”

“Does Aizawa know..?”

“No. I don’t plan on telling him. He’s already stressed enough.”

“But he could get you some help or something, I..what if you fall too far behind?” Izuku asked, worriedly.

“I won’t.”

Before Izuku could continue, his phone buzzed. He opened it, gulping when he saw it was from Bakugo.

Can we talk?

“..Was that him?” Hitoshi asked, leaning over Izuku’s shoulder.

“..Yeah. I..what do I say?”

“Do you want to talk to him?”

“Of course I do..!”

“Then say yes?”

“What if he wants to break up or something..?”

“He likes you too much.”

“I-”

“Give me the damn phone.” Hitoshi snatched the phone from Izuku, texting Bakugo back.

i’m in my dorm.

Hitoshi throws it back to Izuku. Izuku gasped, looking at Hitoshi with a playful betrayal.

“Hitoshi!! I look horrible!”

“Then just you better try to fix that ugly mug before he gets here.” Hitoshi snickers, watching as Izuku falls off the bed in an attempt to break free from his blanket. He sprung up a few moments later, rushing to a mirror to fix his hair. It was amusing to Hitoshi how fast he could move when he needed to impress Bakugo.

As Izuku was trying to run around and look presentable, there was a knock on the door. Izuku looks at Hitoshi.

“Don’t you open that door.”

“...What’s at risk here if I do?”

“I’ll..bleach all your clothes!”

“..Worth it.” Hitoshi makes a dash for the door, and Izuku clumsily chases after him. Hitoshi swung the door open and stepped out of the way. Izuku yelped, trying to stop. He fails, and crashes right into Bakugo. It was unexpected, so it knocked Bakugo down as well. Izuku landed on top of the blonde boy, and he felt his face flush red. He clenched his jaw when he heard Hitoshi laugh.

“I was just leaving.” Hitoshi smiled, and leaned down to Izuku. “Be cool, little brother. Got it?”

“I’m bleaching your clothes!”

“Whatever you say!” Hitoshi hummed as he walked away.

“..Little brother?” Bakugo asked, confused.

“Oh..um..he well..he sees me as a younger brother so..” Izuku gulped. He blushed even more when he realized he was ontop of Bakugo still. “I am so sorry!” He rushed to get up, feeling dizzy from how fast he sprung to his feet. He felt himself stumble but someone supported his body.

“Careful.” Bakugo said, then paused. “Don’t..be an idiot or something like that.”

“Thanks..” Izuku looked down at his feet, rubbing his arm sheepishly. “Do..you want to come in?”

“..yeah.”

Izuku led him inside, and sat on his bed. Bakugo did the same, and a few minutes of silence later, he turned to Izuku.

“Look. I’m sorry. I was really out of line, and I hate apologies but I want to sound sincere. I shouldn’t have yelled at you, or said the things I did. I’m stressed, you're stressed. We both have a lot to think about and we just lost a..friend.” The word friend was quiet as he spoke it. “So, I’m sorry. If you don’t want to forgive me, that's fine, I get it. I’ll go.” Bakugo stood, and turned to go out the door.

“Wait,” Izuku said. “..I’m sorry too. You weren’t the only one out of line. Um..thank you. For apologizing. Can..can you stay tonight?”

“I could get in a lot of trouble if-”

“Please.”

Bakugo sighed, and walked over. He sat next to Izuku again.

“Okay. Only tonight.”

They shared another silence. They glanced at each other, locking eyes. Both of their minds were running wild without anxious thoughts, until Bakugo reached his hand out. To any outsider looking in, Bakugo being gentle was something that was nearly impossible. To Izuku, Bakugo told himself he had to be careful. Izuku was fragile right now. There was a lot of change around him, and especially since their first fight he wanted to make up for it. It wasn’t fair for him to be mean right now. Besides, who could ever be rough to someone with the kindest eyes and the brightest smile.

Bakugo cupped Izuku’s face. He ran his thumb across Izuku’s cheek softly, soothing the boy subtly. Izuku leaned into the touch, letting a smile pull at his lips. Izuku’s eyes flashed down after a sorrow came over him, but Bakugo lifted his chin.

“Izuku.”

“..mhm?” Izuku locked eyes with his lover once again. “I’m sorry, I-”

“Would you just shut up?” Bakugo said, playfulness lining his tone. “I want to kiss you.” Izuku’s face flushed bright red as he smiled more.

“Okay.”

Their lips were only a few inches apart when the door reopened. The two teens turned to the door, looking like a deer in headlights. Izuku felt his heart skip a beat when he saw it was Aizawa.

“S-sir!” Izuku pulled himself from Bakugo. “Is..is there a problem?”

“...It’s after curfew. Why is he here?” Aizawa looked at Bakugo with a glare. Bakugo didn’t take it personally, surprisingly. It felt like a different kind of stare. It wasn’t a teacher being disappointed, it was a father being disappointed.

“We had a fight the other night,” Izuku began, “And..we just talked about it. I’m sorry, I tried to tell him that-”

“I want to speak with you tomorrow. Come to me once you’ve woken up. Wrap..whatever this is up. I want to see you in your *own* beds. Got it?”

“Yes sir..!”

“Right.” Bakugo pressed his lips together. “Past my bedtime anyway.”

AIzawa turned on his heel and shut the door, and Izuku let out a sigh. He looked at Bakugo, who was laughing lightly.

“Hey..! What’s so funny..??”

“Your reaction. You were like a deer in headlights.”

“You were too..!”

“Was not.”

“Was too.”

“Was not.”

“Was to- mm!”

Izuku’s argument was cut short when Bakugo leaned in and kissed him. His heart exploded, butterflies churning in his stomach. He melted into the kiss, letting his worried feelings wash away. Bakugo did have that effect on Izuku. Once he pulled away from the kiss, he stood up.

“I’ve got to go. I’ll..sneak back in here later. After Aizawa checks in on us.”

“Okay..see you later, Kacchan..” Izuku said, his heart still aflutter.

The morning came faster than Izuku wanted it too. He sat up in his bed, smiling at the Bakugo who was fast asleep in his bed. He found it cute, considering Bakugo currently had his mouth open slightly and was drooling. He laughed quietly at the sight of him. He got up slowly, to not wake Bakugo. He threw on a hoodie and changed into some pants. He walked out of his room and was met with Hitoshi’s face.

“AH-” Izuku jumped, putting a hand over his heart. “Don’t do that.”

“Dad wants to see you.”

“..I know. That’s where I’m going.”

“...Is Bakugo in there?”

Izuku slowly shut the door behind him. “No.”

“Liar.”

“Just- c’mon.” Izuku walked to the elevator. He gulped, feeling a bit nervous what this could be about. It was seven in the morning if his alarm clock was correct. Izuku began to think about how it was unusual for Bakugo to sleep in so late. Unknowingly to him, it was because Bakugo didn’t sleep much the night they fought. He needed the rest.

Izuku stepped out into the common area, giving a few brief “hello”s and “good morning”s. He stopped in front of Aizawa’s room, and Hitoshi gave him a supportive tap on the shoulder.

“It can’t be too bad.”

“..Right.”

Izuku knocked, and Aizawa opened the door. He motioned for him and Hitoshi to come inside. Izuku paused when he saw Mirio on Aizawa’s couch.

“..Mirio?” Izuku asked, then looked at Aizawa confused.

“Hi, Midoriya!” Mirio smiled at Izuku. “And Shinso, was it?”

“Uh..” Izuku was still looking at Aizawa for answers.

“You both passed the Provisional Hero License exam. This means that you..unfortunately, can do work studies. I was on the fence about even letting your class participate. Mirio, here, wants..” Aizawa sighed, shaking his head. “He thinks Midoriya would have a rather good chance in landing a place where he works, Sir Nighteye’s agency.”

“..Sir Nighteye??” Hitoshi said. “Holy shit, Izuku, that’s amazing!”

“..Wh- Why me??”

“Your skills were very impressive. Yours as well, Shinso. When I went to attack, you both were expecting this and acted accordingly. I use the element of surprise as a main weapon against my opponents. But, Midoriya, you were inspiring. Your reaction times were insane, and the ability you have as only a first year amazed me. I would love to invite Shinso in on this opportunity, but I..don’t think him and Sir Nighteye would be a good fit.”

“Definitely not.” Aizawa mutters.

“I..don’t know what to say. He, I..” Izuku gulped. “He used to work with All Might. I don’t have the best relationship with him, I wouldn’t want to offend-”

“That’s okay. It’s still a wonderful opportunity. I would really like to work with you and show you some of the things I learned.”

“Say yes, Izuku! This is big!” Hitoshi urged.

Izuku looked around at everyone. Hitoshi seemed proud and excited for him, and Aizawa seemed proud as well. He knew that Bakugo would be upset that he’s being ‘passed’ but would still be proud of him. He gulped. Riso would’ve been ecstatic. Sure, maybe it’s because he could finally have a way into an agency to cause chaos and make Izuku’s life

harder. But Izuku knew deep down if Riso could see him take this job, and actually *get* the position? He'd be so proud and happy for him. Riso would never let him live it down if he said no.

"...Okay. I'm willing to try."

Chapter End Notes

BAM also yes plot holes idk how izuku is gonna get this job but he is because i am unoriginal. love u! also so sorry for missing wednesday update, i had lost power and couldn't get the chapter to upload. so half of this chapter was supposed to be a chapter on its own but i put them together for u guys!

updates on wednesdays and sundays!

Chapter Forty Four

Chapter Summary

Izuku meets Sir Nighteye and takes on a challenge to work under him.

Chapter Notes

this chapter was so complicated to write!! this is probably one of the most difficult canon scene where i had to bend it to fit the story properly so if there are any plot holes regarding this chapter i apologize. i'd also like to note i've changed the amount of time riso's been missing. in a previous chapter i mentioned it was three days since izuku had been comforted by aizawa but i changed it to two weeks. anyways i hope you enjoy!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Izuku stared at the empty rails at the train station. Nervous was an understatement. Not only was he traveling almost an hour away, both Hitoshi and Bakugo couldn't come (as if they were even allowed), and he felt a ton of pressure being here alone with Mirio. There was a sort of tension that Izuku could feel, but not understand why. Izuku also felt very nervous for the fact that Sir Nighteye was and is a hardcore All Might fan. They used to work together, but had a falling out.

Izuku had managed to get over his immediate fear of the hero, but he couldn't imagine working with someone so close who respects All Might. All Might was still the symbol of peace, and Izuku can't deny that fact. Although he caused a lot of trauma and almost made Izuku lose his life that day, Izuku found it hard in his heart to hold such a gut wrenching hate towards him. All Might had technically saved his life before he destroyed it. Even if All Might was under the impression that quirkless individuals had no chance, Izuku could be that example. Expect, he..wasn't really quirkless anymore. Besides all this, Izuku was still willing to take this opportunity.

"Hey, are you okay? You're mumbling." Mirio asked Izuku, which caused Izuku to jump. He nodded and blushed slightly out of embarrassment.

“Yes, I’m okay. I..do that when I’m deep in thought.”

“Well,” Mirio smiles. “Whatcha thinking about?”

“It’s nothing, really. I’m just nervous about Sir Nighteye and his history with All Might.” Izuku admitted. “All Might…sort of did a few things to me a while ago. It’s complicated, and I’ll spare you the details, but I just hope that isn’t going to be a problem for Sir Nighteye himself.”

“...All Might?” Mirio questioned, raising a curious eyebrow. “He’s a great hero, and the symbol of peace.”

“He’s also a person. And people say hurtful things at the worst moments.” Izuku shrugged. “That’s what happened to me.”

“Oh, I-”

The train finally made it to the station, and the doors opened for passengers to board. Izuku walked onto the tree, trying to avoid the hard conversation he might have to have with Mirio. Mirio followed behind him, and the two took their seats. About thirty minutes into the train ride, Mirio turned to Izuku.

“I wanted to ask you something.”

“..What is it?” Izuku rubbed his hands together subtly, trying to soothe his growing anxiety.

“Your friend, Riso?” Mirio’s tone was soft, and cautious. “Have you heard anything about him..?”

Izuku froze for a moment. It makes sense why Mirio would know Riso, as he was technically a second year and was probably given opportunities to help all three grades. It was still hard

to talk about, especially since everything was at a standstill in his disappearance.

“Uh..” Izuku cleared his throat. “No. We..we haven’t gotten any more information. No bodies, no clues, no..indication where he could be.”

“It’s just really unfortunate that it happened. He used to periodically disappear, we would figure that out by the teachers' conversations. Those times were always short. Maybe a few days or something. It’s been..a while, hasn’t it?”

“Yeah.” Izuku looked at his feet. “I just hope he’s safe.”

“If everything works out, I’m sure Sir Nighteye will be willing to lend some resources out to you for help.” Mirio nodded. “He’s usually pretty understanding.”

The rest of the train ride was filled with small talk. Things about what they liked to do in their spare time, favorite heroes, all the conversations that helped distract Izuku from the task at hand. As they’re walking up to the agency, Mirio turns to Izuku.

“Sir Nighteye is big on humor. You’ve got to make him laugh at least once if you wish to work here.”

“...Oh. That’s…honestly unexpected.” Izuku began to strategize on how to be funny. He was aware jokes were not really his thing, and it was hard to be funny to someone so important. He hated to think about it, but he knew he was really good at making All Might faces before things with him went down. Were they even that funny? It’s not like he had any other option. It’s either risk making a horrible joke that even Denki would be disappointed in, or swallow his pride and make an All Might face. Man, it really sucked not being funny. What if it was offensive? Sir Nighteye and him worked together.

Izuku looked at Mirio. He gulped, wondering if maybe Hitoshi was a better fit for this opportunity. He also really wished that Bakugo was here. He had to face this alone for the most part.

Mirio led him to the door, and Izuku stood in front of it. He took a breath and opened the door. He was shocked with the sight he saw. Bubble Girl, who Izuku remembered as a sidekick, was restrained in a machine that had feathers on it. Was that supposed to be a tickle machine or a torture device? Either way, he had to make an impression. Sir Nighteye looked over at Izuku.

Izuku decided to do the All Might face. Although it didn't make Sir Nighteye laugh, he began to criticize the way he made the face. He mentioned how many wrinkles he had, and how his eyebrows laid. Izuku sighed, and retaliated with the specific incident he was replicating.

As they two talked about the All Might face, and it's origins, Mirio released Bubble Girl.

"So who's the kid?" She asked once she got a breath of air.

"That's Izuku Midoriya. He's an underclassman. I think he's got potential to work here."

"Alright." Sir Nighteye stood tall. "I assume you want to work here for your work studies."

"Yes sir..!" Izuku nodded, pulling out the contract. Sir Nighteye sits down and looks over the contract.

"You're aware that working here will not be easy? You'll have to work several days a week, stay for at least a month, and you'll be forced to take many absences." Sir Nighteye looked at Izuku. "Can you handle that?"

"I can, sir." Izuku tried to calm his shaking hands.

"I don't see how I would benefit from you working for me. I already have two sidekicks, and a student intern. We run fine with them only."

"I-"

“I’ll tell you this.” Sir Nighteye stands up, twirling the stamp in his hand. “If you can take the stamp from me, stamp the paper. Does that seem doable?”

“Um..yes sir.”

“Good. You’ve got three minutes.”

Mirio and Bubble Girl walk outside of the office, and shut the door behind them. It doesn’t take long for noises to start coming from the office. Mirio could hear Izuku and Sir Nighteye conversing as they were “fighting”. Thuds and crashes echoed in the silent hallway.

“You really think he’s going to get the stamp from him?” Bubble Girl asked Mirio.

“I have faith. He’s smart.” Mirio looked at the door. “He’s capable.”

“I don’t know. Especially with Sir’s quirk…”

“He has to at least impress him. He impressed me. I was going to bring another student, but I didn’t think he’d be compatible with him.”

“Not funny?”

“Not really. Also really tired looking.”

After three minutes, Bubble Girl and Mirio walk back inside. Mirio was surprised how much of a mess the office had become.

“You failed.” Sir Nighteye said. “I’m unimpressed.”

Izuku, who was on the floor, slowly stood up using his staff. “I only stopped moving because I was about to hit your All Might poster.”

Sir Nighteye paused. He glanced around the room, noting all the damage caused from the staff he had been using. The handprints and footprints also caused by Izuku’s moves were not on any of the All Might memorabilia he had in his office. He looked back at Izuku.

Izuku gave a nervous smile. Sure, anyone else in Izuku’s position would’ve definitely ruined them. But Izuku still couldn’t convince himself to not worry about Sir Nighteye’s All Might things. He knew that what happened to him was horrible, but if someone else was a fan he wasn’t going to make them suffer for it. Izuku just cared too much. Bakugo and Hitoshi have been telling him lately that he needs to learn how to hold a grudge. Deep down, Izuku didn’t ever see himself holding one.

“Hm.” Sir Nighteye walked over to the contract and stamped it.

“Wait, but- I..failed?”

“I never said that not getting the stamp would mean you wouldn’t get the job. I was planning on letting you work for me anyway. When you become a hero, people are looking for more than just a small light of hope. They want a dazzling light.” Sir Nighteye crossed his arms. “I’m going to turn you into that. Understood?”

“Yes sir..! Thank you!”

Mirio smiled. “See? Told you he would do it.” He nudged Bubble Girl, who smiled lightly.

Izuku was met with Hitoshi waiting for him at the steps of the dorms. He had a hopeful face, and Izuku couldn’t help but smile. He wrapped his arms around Hitoshi as soon as he was

close enough. He'd also be lying if he said he didn't want to burst into tears. Hitoshi hugged back.

"So??" Hitoshi pulled from the hug, his hands on his arms still. "How'd you do??"

"Well, he had me try to grab the stamp from him. He said if I could and stamp the paper on my own, I could get the job. I..didn't do that."

"Oh no. Izuku, I-"

"But he was impressed and he hired me anyway!" Izuku jumps happily, "He employed me, Hitoshi!"

"Oh my god!" Hitoshi smiled and hugged Izuku again. "Oh my god, I'm so proud and happy for you!"

"My first day is tomorrow!"

"We have to celebrate. I can ask Sato to bake us something?"

"Oh, we don't have to-"

"No! We must. C'mon!" Hitoshi pulled Izuku inside, and just as they were about to press the button for the elevator a voice spoke up behind them.

"Midoriya." Aizawa looked at the two. "...How did it go today?"

Izuku glanced at Aizawa, and he couldn't contain his smile. "He hired me."

“He did? That’s good, kid. I’m proud of how far you’ve come. Let me know when you’re going to miss school because of it.” Aizawa nodded. He turned on his heel and walked away. Izuku stared as he walked away, but he felt his heart flutter. He didn’t hear Hitoshi telling him to hurry up, but only because there was one thought on his mind.

He’s proud of me.

Chapter End Notes

you guys might hate me for the next chapter but :)

updates wednesdays and sundays!

Chapter Forty Five

Chapter Summary

Izuku's first day of his work studies turns sour quickly after he runs into a little girl.

Chapter Notes

there is a nightmare in here that can be considered triggering to some people so just beware. love you guys, enjoy :)

See the end of the chapter for more notes

It was dark out when Izuku felt someone shake him awake. He turned, pulling the blanket closer to him with a groan. They shook him again. Izuku opened his eyes, feeling annoyed that he had been woken when he starts his work studies tomorrow. That feeling washed away the second he recognized the red eyes staring down at him.

“Kacchan?” Izuku smiled at the sight of his boyfriend. “It’s really late, what are you doing here..?”

“I came to ask about your..work study thing.” Bakugo sat on the bed after Izuku sat up. “The…stupid exam shit took longer than I thought.”

“I got the job.” Izuku yawned, wiping the sleep from his eyes. He blinked slowly a few times, trying to properly wake himself.

“Of course you did.” Bakugo crossed his arms. “You’re always trying to be better than me and surpass me.”

“Is that your way of saying good job?” Izuku let out a quiet laugh.

“...Shut up.”

“I start my first day tomorrow. I’m nervous. I think I’ve been so used to how..Riso and I did things, this might be hard.”

“It’s been about a week since we’ve even done anything vigilante related.” Bakugo thinks out loud. “We’ve all been busy.”

“I know.” Izuku rested his head on Bakugo’s shoulder. “We’ll find time.”

“Besides that,” Bakugo wrapped his arm around Izuku. “I’m proud of you, or whatever sappy shit you say to people when they get their first big job.”

“Thanks, Kacchan.” Izuku smiled, feeling himself nod off. Bakugo let Izuku fall asleep and rest on his shoulder. Bakugo glanced at his sleeping boyfriend and couldn’t help but smile.

“You damn nerd.” Bakugo gently moved a piece of hair from Izuku’s face. He paused, admiring Izuku’s face. He was studying every mark, freckle, wrinkle, stress line he could. He wanted to memorize his face. Bakugo gently cupped his face, running his thumb along his cheek. “I love you, Izuku.” His voice was quiet, almost inaudible.

Izuku found himself in his old apartment. He awoke from the couch, and he looked towards the kitchen. He smiled when he saw Inko.

“Mom!”

“Oh! Hi sweetie, I didn’t expect you here.” She turned to him with a bright smile. “I see you landed that big job with that hero! I’m so proud of you.”

Izuku got up from the couch and slowly made his way to his mom. "Things have been..really bad lately."

"Oh, honey. I know…You've been worried sick about a lot of things. Especially your friend Riso. You know, I like him a lot. Although he did have you staying up past bedtime.."

"I'm sorry, mom." Izuku looked down at his feet nervously. There was a lot on his mind.

"Honey," Inko grabbed Izuku's hands. "I'm glad you're sticking to your promise."

"..Promise?" Izuku thought. Then he remembered. Before the warehouse fire, he had a dream with his mom who told him to promise to stay alive and be strong no matter what happened. "Oh. Right."

"I love you, darling. You're doing so good. I believe you'll be alright."

"..Why are you fading? Mom," Izuku tried to grab onto his mother. "Mom, don't go. Please don't go."

"You really have to stop coming to me when you're stressed, baby.."

"Mom don't do this to me. Please, please don't go." Izuku felt tears spill as his mom disappeared. He fell to his knees, holding his hands to his chest. He missed her so much, and his heart ached for her embrace. No matter how long someone's been gone, it will always hurt.

"Aw, it's okay Zuku." A familiar voice caused Izuku to look up. He paused and gulped.

"..Riso?"

“Hi.” Riso was sitting on the kitchen table, feet resting in a chair. Izuu found it strange that Riso had on his mask, but not his hood or in any of ‘Cosmic’ gear. “Been a while, huh?”

“...You’re not dead, are you?”

“Me? Please. You couldn’t kill me if you tried. I thought you knew that.”

“..Right. I forgot, I’m just dreaming.”

“Oh, don’t say that.” Riso says hushed. “They’ll come for you. They don’t like being figured out. Things get gross and scary.”

“They?”

“Yeah.” Riso tilted his head, resting his hand on his fist. His hair moved with his head, a bit of skin peaking out from the pink strands. Izuku’s breath was caught in his throat.

“Why don’t you have a face?” Izuku asked slowly, feeling his heart rate increase.

“Hm?” Riso’s tone was almost mockery. “I don’t know what you mean, dear Izuku. This is your dream, afterall.” His smirk could be heard through the dark fabric.

“Um..” Izuku stood slowly, the room around him darkening.

“Don’t tell me,” Riso jumped off the table. “Have you forgotten what I look like?”

“What?” Izuku looked at Riso. His anxiety peaked when Riso placed a hand on his mask. He ripped it off with quick speed, and he pushed his hair back. Izuku’s breath caught in his throat again when he saw nothing under the hair and mask. Riso, or whatever this thing that

claimed to be Riso, had nothing but a blank slate of a face. Skin ran over his nose, eyes, and mouth as if they were never there. Izuku was frozen in fear when Riso leaned down to him. He gulped when a mouth slowly shifted and formed on the skin, teeth covered in blood.

"Boo."

Izuku sat up in a panic, gasping for breath. He placed a hand over his heart, trying to calm his rapid breathing. Next to him, Bakugo also sat up.

"What?" Bakugo asked, wiping his eyes as he wasn't fully awake yet. "What is it?"

"He..I-I.." Izuku couldn't speak. He turned to Bakugo and hugged him tight, his hands shaking violently. Bakugo wrapped his arms around Izuku, gently running his hands through his hair.

"Hey, hey.." Bakugo whispered. "It's okay. It was just a nightmare, Deku. Calm down. I'm right here." He kept comforting Izuku to the best of his abilities, and eventually it worked.

"I'm sorry." Izuku said quietly, wiping his tears. "I'm sorry,"

"Oh shut up," Bakugo kissed his forehead. "I don't want to hear any of that. It's okay. I'm not saying that again. Wanna tell me what the dream was about?"

"At first it was just my mom. Then..I saw Riso and he was being weird and..he didn't have a face and asked if I forgot what he looked like."

"Oh, shit."

"The worst thing..?" Izuku swallowed hard. "I think I might be starting to."

“I don’t know what to say to that.” Bakugo looks at Izuku, still combing his hands through his hair. “Don’t you have pictures or something?”

“Not of his face, not his eyes at least.” Izuku sighed. “I try not to because he’s easily identifiable that way.”

“..We’ll find him before you can forget. Okay?”

“...Okay.”

“Now get some actual sleep, try not to have any nightmares this time. You sort of have a job to do tomorrow and I am *not* babying you.”

“Thanks...” The two of them laid back down. Izuku felt his heart flutter when Bakugo wrapped his arms around Izuku. “Goodnight, Kacchan.”

“Night, nerd.”

The following morning went by pretty quickly. Before he took the hour train to Sir Nighteye’s agency, he was seen off by both Bakugo and Hitoshi. They wished him luck, Izuku even got a kiss from Bakugo. Which was pretty rare considering they were in public. The entire train ride he was a nervous wreck. He couldn’t afford to mess this up. Not when he could finally get some real answers about Riso by his own means, and it not be an illegal method.

Once he was actually in the room with Mirio, Bubble Girl, and Sir Nighteye himself, he felt relaxed. Surprisingly, he didn’t feel the intense aura he did when he came there the day before. Nighteye placed a map on the table.

“We’ll be surveying and patrolling. We will also be split up, with Bubble Girl working with me. You and Mirio will be here.”

“We’re currently doing a secret investigation!” Bubble Girl said, looking at Nighteye.

“A smaller villain group that goes by the name of Shie Hassaikai. Their leader, Overhaul as people call him, has been making suspicious movements.”

“The Hassaikai? They..aren’t seen that much anymore.”

“Overhaul’s specific generation experienced a downfall. We think that he’s trying to reunite with everyone from the group.” Bubble Girl nods. “We’ve had evidence proving they’ve made contact with the League of Villains, but we have nothing on if they’re actually being villains.”

“We want proof he’s been involved in criminal activities.” Nighteye says. “Now get going.”

Before patrol officially began, Mirio and Izuku were walking along and talking.

“So what’s your hero name? You know, so we don’t have to use our real names in case of an emergency.” Mirio asked, looking over at Izuku.

“Deku.” Izuku smiled a little.

“...Deku?”

“Yeah, it’s something my boyfriend calls me a lot. Originally it was an insult, but not anymore.”

“Boyfriend, huh? Bakugo right?” Mirio chuckled.

“Yeah,” Izuku looked at Mirio. “He’s sweet when no one else is looking.”

“You two are pretty cute together. Definitely an interesting dynamic.”

“What’s your hero name?” Izuku rocked on his feet as he walked, trying to occupy himself. He had a lot of energy, more than he thought he’d have at least.

“Lemillion!”

“..Lemillion?”

“For the amount of people I want to save one day, A million people!” Mirio’s smile was unmatched. He seemed so ready and prepared to help others. It made Izuku feel warm inside. “Now don’t forget, we’re heroes as of right now. Don’t let your guard down.”

“Got it!”

Izuku and Mirio walked down the street, conversing about the basics of patrolling. The conversation was boring, but to Izuku it was fueling the high energy mood he was in. He was finally accomplishing his life-long dream. He couldn’t believe he was actually in Sir Nighteye’s agency, while a student at UA, and patrolling with one of the top three from said school. He was excited for things to start going in the right direction.

Unfortunately, in this world, things never seem to go right.

A girl with long white hair ran into the street, bumping into Izuku. She fell back and rested on her knees for a moment. Izuku leaned down, being gentle with his movements. He gave her a comforting smile.

“I’m sorry, I didn’t see..” Izuku paused when he saw the bandages around her arms and legs. “..you there. Are you okay?”

“Now, now..Don’t interrupt the heroes.” A voice spoke before the little girl could. Izuku looked up as the girl gripped onto him. He felt the world around him quiet when he locked eyes with the man identified earlier as Overhaul.

“Come on, Eri. We must be going now.” Overhaul said with a tone that was soaked in false kindness. Eri only buried her head into Izuku’s chest, her eyes closed tightly.

“Hey, it’s okay..” Izuku whispered to the girl, who he assumed was named Eri. *Why is she shaking so much?* Izuku thought as he looked back at Overhaul. He felt Mirio throw his hero mask on over his face.

“Oh, whoops! Looks like your mask fell!” Mirio’s cheery voice almost threw Izuku off, but he understood he made the mistake of keeping it down.

“I apologize for my daughter's behavior, she gets carried away with her fun. You know how it is.” Overhaul shrugs. “Say..I don’t think I’ve seen the two of you before. Are you newbies?”

“Yes, sir! We’re students interning at an agency. We’re trying to get experience. You’re from the Shie Hassaikai, right? I only say that because of the mask.”

“Yes, that’s correct. Though the mask is not important. I don’t like dirt.” Overhaul nodded. “Come, Eri.”

“..Alright, well..We should be going.” Izuku went to stand but Eri clung onto him as tears started slipping from her eyes.

“Please don’t go.” She muttered, her grasp so tight he wasn’t sure if he could even pry her off. Izuku tensed, holding Eri gently. He looked at Overhaul with an unintentional glare.

“...I don’t mean to pry, sir. But she seems really scared.” Izuku’s voice was firm.

“Ah, I just scolded her earlier.”

“..and the bandages?”

“She falls down a lot.” Overhaul noticed the glare and gave one back. “Shouldn’t you avoid pushing your ideals of what you find normal in families on strangers you don’t know? Doesn’t seem very heroic of you.”

Izuku bit his tongue. He knew that realistically, it’d be the best to leave them alone for a better chance to save her later. In his heart, he knew he couldn’t leave this girl alone. She was in need of help, and he couldn’t just walk away. No matter how much he knew he needed to.

“...What are you doing to her?” Izuku’s mouth moved before he could stop it. Overhaul sighed.

“Alright. It’s embarrassing, really. Follow me so I can explain.” Overhaul led the two heroes into the alleyway, Izuku’s hand locked with Eri’s. He looked at Mirio, who had a serious look on his face.

“See..having a child is difficult. My daughter defies me a lot. It’s hard to understand children, especially the kind of person they want to become.” Overhaul hooked his finger around his white glove.

The air became tense. Both Mirio and Izuku glanced at each other. Izuku knew Overhaul’s intentions were nothing innocent, but rather murderous. He didn’t know if Mirio could feel it too. Izuku felt Eri tug on his hand, before running to Overhaul. She grabbed his hand, keeping her head down.

“I’m very sorry once again for her temper tantrum. Thank you for listening to me ramble.”

Overhaul disappeared into the alleyway with Eri. Mirio grabbed Izuku's arm.

"We can't go after them."

"..I know." Izuku growls. When he squeezed his fist out of anger, he paused when he felt something in his hand. He brought the hand to his line of sight and opened it slowly. It was a larger hair clip, seemingly of poor material. To Izuku, it looked like it had been made from a soda can. Bits of the soda brand were visible.

A soda can.

Izuku's heart skipped a beat. He flipped it in his hand, flinching lightly when his finger ran over something that triggered it to open. He watched closely as it folded out into a comb. Mirio looked into Izuku's hand.

"What is that?"

"..A hair clip. It's also a comb," Izuku's words were caught in his throat for a moment. "...I only know one person who can create something like this out of an old soda can."

"...You do?"

"Yeah. Riso." Izuku couldn't tear his eyes away. He eventually looked in the direction Overhaul went. An overwhelming feeling of anger rose in Izuku's chest. "He doesn't only have that little girl, he's got my best fucking friend."

"What is it, Midoriya?" Aizawa asked, sitting on the couch of his dorm/apartment. He sat between Hizashi and Nemuri. He looked at Izuku with curious eyes. Izuku had called him in a panic a few hours prior, saying he found something on Riso.

Izuku placed the hair clip on the coffee table in front of the three Pro-Heroes. The three glanced between each other in confusion, but Nemuri paused.

“Is that a soda can?”

Izuku didn’t speak, but rather ran his hand along the clip once again. It flopped against the coffee table as it turned into the comb. Nemuri let out a soft gasp and covered her mouth.

“..Did that clip just turn into a fucking comb?” Hizashi asked.

“...Oh my god.” Aizawa looked at Izuku. “You said you found this on your work study?”

“Yeah.” Izuku nodded.

“Wait, I don’t understand.” Hizashi looked at Izuku, then Aizawa. “Why is this so important?”

“It’s Riso’s.” Nemuri said softly, looking away as she tried to hide her tears. “ That’s..that’s his work, Hizashi. The soda can, the practicality. If you took it apart, you’d find an R engraved in it. That’s how he makes-” She stopped herself before she burst into tears. They weren’t necessarily sad tears. She was overwhelmed, mainly. There was evidence Riso was alive, and healthy (or well enough to create something), but then again he had seemingly been taken by a very dangerous criminal.

“This girl you spoke of,” Aizawa said, “you said she had bandages?”

“Yes sir.” Izuku sat down in an armchair. “I know I’m not allowed to speak about it, but I just..I can’t not say anything. If I told anyone, I figured it..might as well be heroes. This guy *has* Riso. He has to! Eri put it in my hand.”

“You have to tell Sir Nighteye.” Hizashi said, “You told him right?”

“Yeah. He’s stressed even more. How am I supposed to keep this from Kacchan and Hitoshi? I’m just supposed to look them in the eye like I don’t know their friend, boyfriend I guess, is okay? That I got something of his?” Izuku ran his hands through his own hair. “I’m so nervous. I’m not allowed to speak about this, but I feel like they deserve to know!”

“...He’s right.” Nemuri glanced back at the three. “We can’t expect him to hold such a secret from the two of them.”

“We’d be going against Sir Nighteye specifically, Nemuri.”

“I don’t care. We have to tell the kids something.”

“At least Hitoshi.” Izuku said softly. “He’s losing himself.”

“I know.” Aizawa took a breath. “I find it ironic we’re sitting here, as we needed to talk with him anyway.”

“..About what?” Izuku looked up from his feet. Hizashi leaned forward slightly.

“Well, Sho and I were going to give him the adoption papers tonight.”

Chapter End Notes

ahh!! so many emotions in this chapter!!

updates on wednesdays and sundays

Chapter Forty Six

Chapter Summary

> Hitoshi gets adopted, but he asks for his new parents to do him a favor. Izuku feels the weight of his work studies, and Hitoshi has a bittersweet moment with himself. Sir Nighteye organizes a meeting to create a plan to get Eri and Riso to safety.

Chapter Notes

> oof i feel like i've been using a lot of the same terminology lately :(anyways enjoy!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Izuku had a lot of confusing feelings. His best friend, rather someone he saw as a brother, was getting adopted. Sure, it was good news. At the same time, he found out information about Riso and wasn't permitted to speak about it. It felt like the adoption would be just a huge cover up to hide the truth, even if that's not what it was. Izuku stood in front of Hitoshi's dorm door, both his heart and mind racing. He raised his fist to knock on the door but paused. He shook his head and the second his fist hit the door, it opened.

"Oh," Hitoshi said, looking at Izuku. "You- could've just texted me?" Izuku looked at Hitoshi, feeling his heart break a little. Hitoshi's eye bags were dark, and his hair was out of place. His eyes were tinted a light pink, and his cheeks were slightly swollen. He had been crying.

"...Are you okay?"

"Yeah, I'm fine." Hitoshi rested against the doorframe. "Are you?"

"..Mhm. Uh, Dad-" Izuku felt his face flush red. "Your, uhm..your dad wants to see you. Both- both of them. They said it was important."

“Okay.” Hitoshi chuckled and ruffled Izuku’s hair. “I was heading that way anyway.”

As they made their way to the elevator, Izuku mentally cringed and screamed at himself. He just accidently called Aizawa his dad. Maybe it was the stress that made him slip up. He shook off the feeling the best he could as the elevator ride ended. He walked with Hitoshi to Aizawa’s apartment.

“Hey, Tosh!” Hizashi smiled as he opened the door. “Midoriya! Come in, kiddos.”

“Am I in trouble?” Hitoshi asked, “This feels like I’m about to be grounded. Why is Midnight here?”

“Sit down. You worry too much.” Aizawa said, motioning to the couch. Hitoshi sat down, and Izuku sat next to him. Nemuri smiled softly. Hitoshi could tell she had been crying too.

“Is someone dead?” Hitoshi looked at Aizawa, then Hizashi.

“What? No. God, no.” Hizashi shook his head. He placed a folder in front of Hitoshi. “Open that.” Hizashi stood next to Aizawa, intertwining his fingers with the tired man’s. Of course he didn’t occupy the hand that currently had a coffee mug in it, Aizawa would’ve killed him.

Hitoshi raised an eyebrow as he grabbed the folder. He gently opened it, picking out the first paper he saw. Everyone watched as his eyes glided across the paper. Hitoshi’s eyes locked with Aizawa’s. Aizawa felt a smile tug at his lips when he saw a glimpse of hope in the sad eyes he was staring into.

“...This says adoption.” Hitoshi said aloud, his voice shaking.

“Mhm.”

“With..your and papa’s name on it.”

“That’s right.”

“...And my name.” Hitoshi gulped. “You guys want to adopt me?” His bottom lip trembled as he forced back the tears that so desperately wanted to spill.

“That’ll make me cry,” Hizashi says, tearing up. “Sho, I’m gonna cry.”

“Hitoshi,” Aizawa spoke hesitantly, “Hizashi and I would be honored to be your legal parents.”

Hitoshi covered his face as he leaned back into the couch. When Izuku leaned forward and went to ask if he was okay, Hitoshi held up a finger.

“Give me a minute.” Hitoshi was clearly crying. “I don’t like crying in front of people.”

A few minutes passed when Hitsohi finally removed his hands. He wiped his tears, and stood slowly. It was like he couldn’t move fast enough as he wrapped his arms around his new parents. He held them in a tight hug, to which the older men wrapped him in their arms. Hizashi was visibly crying, and Aizawa gave a soft smile. He was totally going to cry alone with Hizashi later. Hitoshi eventually pulled from the hug.

“I..I have one request.” Hitoshi muttered, looking up at Aizawa and Hizashi.

“Of course, kid. What is it?” Aizawa asked, his arm resting around Hizashi’s waist. Hitoshi looked back at Izuku, who was awkwardly twiddling his thumbs.

“You adopt him too.”

Izuku’s head shot up as he looked at Hitoshi. “What?”

“Yeah.” Hitoshi smiled lightly as he walked over to Izuku. He pulled him up off the couch. “Izuku and I..we’re really close. Our bond isn’t just super close friends. We take care of each other like siblings would. I see him as my brother, and..I want that to be official.”

Izuku stared at Hitoshi with wide eyes. Oh this just felt like a slap in the face. Here Hitoshi was being so kind to Izuku, yet he was going to have to hide something from him. Something that could change everything.

“...Well,” Hizashi looks at Aizawa, and then Izuku. “...Would you want us to?”

“..I don’t deserve that, I-” Izuku gulped. “It’ll probably be really hard since my biological dad is technically still alive..”

“Please?” Hitoshi asked softly. “I want you in this family.”

Izuku longed for a family. Ever since his mom passed away that’s all he wanted. Now that he had it, he felt guilty.

“I think it’s a great idea.” Hizashi smiles. “Sho and I can get the process started as soon as tomorrow.”

“Don’t make me regret this choice.” Aizawa muttered. “I don’t want my hair to gray so soon.”

Hitoshi pulled Izuku into a tight hug. “To being brothers!”

“..to being brothers,” Izuku hugged back.

That night, Izuku laid restless. He stared at the ceiling as he gently tapped his fingers on his blanket. He glanced outside, seeing the stars twinkle. He slowly got up, physically feeling the weight on his shoulders. He walked to his balcony door, before opening it. He set out, feeling the chill of the night run up his spine. He looked up, remembering the flat part of the roof above the 1-A sign. Wearing only a pair of pajama shorts and one of Bakugo's shirts, he began to climb his way up and over. He struggled for a moment, as he was trying to be quiet. He eventually got to where he wanted to be, and he let his legs dangle. He cursed himself, wishing he had maybe brought a jacket. He took a slow breath, and exhaled while relaxing his muscles.

"I knew something was up." A body sat next to Izuku. "You were acting differently." Hitoshi nudged him.

Izuku felt tears instantly come to his eyes.

"Woah, wait-" Hitoshi said, sounding beyond concerned. "I didn't mean to make you cry,"

"It's not you." Izuku sniffled. "It's my work study."

"...Are they being too hard on you?"

"No. I..can't even show you."

"Not even your brother?" Hitoshi's tone was playful.

"I'm not worthy to be your brother."

"Sure you are,"

Izuku rested his head on Hitoshi's shoulder. Hitoshi glanced down at him, feeling slightly worried for his soon to be younger brother.

“I want to tell you, I really do. But I can’t. It’ll get me in a lot of trouble.”

“I understand that,” Hitoshi sighed softly. “We’re becoming heroes, Izuku. We’re going to have to hide stuff from our loved ones. Don’t feel so guilty about it, okay?”

“I just don’t want you to hold it against me.”

“I don’t think I could ever do that. You mean too much to me.” Hitoshi looked up at the stars. He paused.

“..What is it?” Izuku looked at Hitoshi.

“That’s Ophiuchus. The star constellation.”

“I did not know you were a nerd about the stars.” Izuku let a small smile form on his face.

“I’m not,” Hitoshi chuckled. “It was in a dream I had with Riso. Same constellation. He gave me a lecture on its origins.”

“...Of course he did.”

“I miss him.” Hitoshi’s eyes were dull.

“I know.” Izuku gulped. “I know..”

“Hey,” Hitoshi turned to Izuku. “It’s late. You should head to bed, okay? You’ve got a busy week ahead of you. Work studies and all.”

“You’re right. Um, if you want to come to my dorm if you can’t sleep or something, you can.”

“Nah, not tonight. Had a date with my bed.”

“Oh shut up,” Izuku chuckled and stood.

Once Izuku had gone back to his dorm, Hitoshi found his way inside. He hesitated as he stood in front of Riso’s dorm door, not his own. He was going to come down here earlier, before he was told he was going to be adopted. He turned the doorknob, breathing in slowly when the smell that could only be pinned to Riso filled his nose. He closed the door behind him as he glanced over to a wardrobe in the corner. He sighed, walking over and opening it. He ran his fingers over the fabric, all with the same feel. Riso was big on texture. A red box caught his eye.

He leaned down and pulled it from the wardrobe. He sat on Riso’s poorly made bed, placing the box in front of him. He pulled a white piece of paper from under the ribbons, and opened it. To be fair, it did have ‘Hitoshi’ written on the front.

okay. im not good at this whole.. confession thing? Hitoshi, if you’re reading, this means i either am one of the following; dead, missing, finally worked up the courage to tell you and this was the result of a gift, or i left this in your room for you to find. either way, i’ve got something to tell you.

emotions are hard. i've never liked feeling, ~~or how it felt to feel~~ or what came with feeling. it’s always been hard for me to express my thoughts properly without being told i’m too blunt or harsh. you’re the only one who’s ever been patient with me and i think it’s why i like you more than i wanted to. when i first saw you, i think that was the first time my heart had ever fluttered the way it did. At the cafe, seeing you with the cats just sparked something in me. i’m not one to crush easy, but something about you was so different. i don’t like different. For some unknown reason, you make me like it. you, hitoshi ~~aizawa~~ shinso, make me want a change.

i was always incapable of changing. my schedule was important to me, i never strayed from it. Until you came. you changed everything about me. i became a little less careless on my nightly trips. i never want to see despair or heartbreak on your face. So being careful was the next best option. i don't know how i would feel if you ever cried over me.

and im rambling. im sorry. i guess what i want to say is that i like you. i want to be with you. im tired of looking at you and only being able to call you my friend. i want more than that. ~~be my boyfriend. be with me. date me?~~ so can we be more than friends?

-riso sakusei

Hitoshi covered his mouth, letting tears spill from his eyes. Riso had written him a love letter god knows how long ago. It was ironic, some of the things he said were relevant to Hitoshi's current situation. It tore Hitoshi apart knowing Riso never wanted to cause him any pain or make him cry, because he was sat in his room doing that exact thing. He hiccuped, trying to take a breath since the crying spell took most of his oxygen.

Hitoshi looked at the gift box, running his fingers along the edge. He lifted the lid, smiling through the falling tears. He pulled the contents out from it. It was a dark purple, which could be mistaken for black, hoodie with two cats on it. One was a light purple cat with obvious eyebags. The other was a bright pink cat, its fur fluffy enough to cover its eyes.. Their tails created a heart in the middle.

Oh my god. It's supposed to be us. Hitoshi frowned at the sight, and pulled the fabric close to his chest. He paused, smelling the hoodie. It smelt just like Riso. The waterworks began to work their magic again.

Once Hitoshi calmed from the crying spell, he put the hoodie on. The texture of the fabric was smooth. Hitoshi could only imagine Riso giving him a lecture on how important fabric is. It was also slightly oversized, the way Hitoshi liked his hoodies. Tight fit anything gave Hitoshi the feeling he was trapped. Riso must've really paid attention to what Hitoshi does and doesn't like. He set the box aside and laid down on Riso's bed, resting his head on the pillow. He curled in a ball, grasping onto the hoodie as he began to cry again.

Hitoshi finally slept, but not without crying himself to exhaustion first.

After a few long and excruciating days, Izuku surprisingly ran into his classmates on his way to his work study.

“..Kirishima?” Izuku questioned. “Are you going this way?”

“Yeah! Are you?” Kirishima smiled.

“..Yeah. For my work study.”

“That’s crazy, me too! We can walk together until we split ways!”

The same conversation happened again when they ran into Uraraka and Tsuyu. Once they reached the train station, Izuku looked at Kirishima.

“I thought you went the other way for your work study?”

“Me too, but I guess we’re meeting in a different location today.” Kirishima shrugged.

As they four walked together, they ran into some minor heroes.

“Hey, kids. You heading this way too?”

“Yes, sir.” Uraraka nodded.

“Us too. You can walk with us.”

“Okay this is weird.” Izuku finally spoke up once they were on the bus. He looked at his classmates.

“..Yeah, tell me about it.” Kirishima muttered.

“I hope we’re not in trouble.”

In front of a large building, the four got even more confused when they saw the big three.

“Oh, hey guys!”

“Even the big three is here!” Uraraka sounded distressed. “This must be something big..”

The lobby of the building was filled with heroes. Heroes like Rock Lock, Ryukyu, Fat Gum and even Eraserhead. Izuku felt his heart tighten. Any normal student at UA in a work study would love to see this amount of heroes. But when it came down to it, Izuku still had an illegal presence.

“C’mon, Ryukyu! Tell me what the big scoop is!”

“Calm down, Nejire. You’ll find out soon.”

“..Mister Aizawa?” Kirishima asked. He looked at Izuku, then Aizawa. “What are you doing here?”

“I was called in last minute for this thing. I think I have some idea of what this could be about.”

“You girls should too.”

Uraraka and Tsuyu gave each other an understanding look.

“We’re all here, Nighteye. We should get started.”

“Thanks to the information you all gave us, the investigation has progressed substantially. We’re here at this joint conference to speak about the things we now know about the yakuza group Shie Hassaikai.”

“Woah, wait. I feel like I’m missing something. Shie Ha-what now?”

“Some bad guys are planning to do some bad things, and we’re here to talk about it.” Fat Gum explains. “Trust me, the two of you are very much involved.”

Next thing Izuku knew, he was in a conference room. He was sat next to Mirio. His eyes ran along the line of heroes. Uraraka and Tsuyu were sitting next to Ryukyu and Nejire. Kirishima sat next to Amajiki and Fat Gum. He felt happy to a degree, knowing his friends were doing good.

“Alright, let’s get started.” Bubble Girl stepped forward. “For a while, we’ve been conducting an investigation against a small yet organized group called the Shie Hassaikai.”

“What prompted that?” A hero asked.

“It started with a gang of thieves who go by the name of The Reservoir Dogs. There was an incident regarding them.”

“Wait, I’ve heard about that.” Another one mentioned.

“Originally, the police deemed it just an accident. Though, the more they looked into the more things didn’t add up. So we began to look deeper and follow the trail.”

“As Nighteye’s sidekick, I began to follow leads to see what I could uncover. The Hassaikai has established contact or attempted contact with other smaller organizations. Some of which were confirmed to have less than reputable dealings. It seems as if they want to expand their demographic. Shortly after our investigation started, we confirmed contact with Twice, who’s real name is Jim. They were weary of being tailed, so I could not follow them. Although, a few days later, we found where they went and a clear conflict happened between the two groups.” Centipeder stated.

“That’s when they called Tsukauchi and I. They figured we’d be able to help.”

“Speaking of, where is he?” A different hero questioned.

“He still had to question some witnesses, cop stuff.” Gran Torino sighed. “I’ve got a bad feeling about all of this.”

“Go on, Bubble Girl.”

“We then requested help on the HN-”

“I think we can skip that part.”

“Sorry!” Bubble Girl shuffled her notes as Uraraka looked at Ryukyu.

“What’s the HN?”

“It stands for the Hero Network! It’s like a social media page where heroes ask for assistance and all other heroes can see it! It’s easier to find quirks that work for them without too much hassle.” Nejire explains, a smile on her face.

“Why do we got a bunch of high school kids up in here? We can’t keep stopping and explaining everything,” Rock Lock scoffed, rolling his eyes.

“Hey! These ‘highschool kids’ have some very important information!” Fat Gum stands.

“We do?”

“I wanna go home.”

“I see some new faces! For those who might not know, I’m Fat Gum! Who wants some candy?!”

“We believe the Hassaikai are gaining funds through illegal drug sales, so I requested someone who knew their way around that system.” Sir Nighteye crossed his arms.

“I’ve brought down enough drug dealers in my day, and at Red Riot’s debut fight he showed me he could too!” Fat Gum stood tall. “Tamaki was shot with a bullet that contained a drug I’ve never seen before. One that destroys quirks.”

“Woah, what?!” Mirio stood. “Tamaki, you’re okay, right??”

“Yeah, the stuff wore off while I slept. See?” He held a hoof.

“Well, at least we know what you had for breakfast..” Mirio muttered as he sat down.

“It’s good that it isn’t permanent. So this stuff doesn’t seem to zap a quirk for good.”

“No, it doesn’t. Eraserhead has something to say.”

“It’s not similar to my quirk. We have something called quirk genes, as our quirks are just an extension to our current bodies. I can temporarily block off the quirk genes, but I don’t cause damage to them.”

“When Tamaki was shot, we took him to the hospital. The tests confirmed his quirk genes took actual damage. Of course, they healed. But the bullet shattered, leaving us unable to review the contents.”

“So what *do* we know?”

“Well, Kirishima’s quirk is hardening. When he protected Tamaki from the second shot, the bullet bounced off his skin, leaving us with an undamage bullet.”

“Woah, I did that?!”

“Good job, Kirishima!” Uraraka gave him a smile.

“Once analyzed, I saw something that made me sick to my stomach.” Fat Gum took a small breath. “We found human blood and cells in the bullet.”

A silence fell among the heroes. More specifically, Izuku and Mirio were staring at the table in disbelief. The option was Eri’s skin. They both knew that, especially with all the bandages she had.

“So that wasn’t a drug. It’s a person’s quirk?”

“I’m not connecting the dots here.”

“The villain Kirishima fought used a drug to enhance his quirk. The disruption channels for drugs have shrunk over time, but we know for a fact that The Hassaikai has been in contact with one of the middle men.”

“Is that all we have on them?”

“Ryukyu’s team the other day broke up a fight between two villain groups. One of the giants are from the same organization Fat Gum just mentioned.”

“One of which was given a drug that did not last long.”

“There’s also been an increase in gang behavior and crimes. Most could be connected to them if we were trying hard enough.”

“Which is what it seems like you’re doing. Making them guilty. Don’t you have anything more concrete?”

A picture of Overhaul appeared on the screen.

“Their young head, Chisaki, quirk; Overhaul. He can disassemble things and then reassemble them. A quirk that can break down matter. And a bullet that can break down quirks.” Nigheye’s tone was intense. Shock spread in the conference room. “He has a daughter named Eri. There are no records of her birth or even her existence. Mirio and Midoriya found her covered in bandages.”

“..Could he really do such a horrific thing?”

“Unfortunately, in a super human society, if you can dream it you can do it.”

“Wait, hold on..” Kirishima looks around. “What are they talking about.”

“You kids really are getting annoying. I’ll say this once. We’re wondering if this bastard is turning his daughter into bullets and selling them.”

“To be clear, we aren’t sure if they are actually being sold. We think it’s still in the testing phase. We have no hard evidence, but we think he’s gathering allies by giving them out for free. If this works according to his plan, the devastation this would cause is too great to risk.”

“If these two had just gotten her away-” Rock Lock stared, glaring at Mirio and Izuku.

“I take full responsibility.” Nighteye looked at the two. “In their own ways, they acted to save the child. Which brings us to our next topic. Bubble Girl?”

“While attempting to soothe the girl, Midioriya was given a hair clip by the little girl.” As Bubble Girl spoke, Centipeder held up the hair clip.

“What’s so important about that?” A hero asked. “It’s a little girl. Of course she has a hair clip.”

“This is no ordinary hair clip.” Nighteye motioned for Bubble Girl to touch it. It flipped out into a comb.

“That doesn’t explain anything.”

Uraraka’s eyes widened. “Wait, I recognize that kind of technology..!”

“A second year support course student went missing more than a month ago, right before the suspicious activity started. His name is Riso Sakusei.” Bubble Girl glanced at Izuku, who hung his head low.

“What? Riso??” Kirishima asked, “No way! He can’t be wrapped in all of this!”

“What’s so important about this kid?” Rock Lock asked, shaking his head. “This doesn’t explain the hair clip.”

“Sure it does!” Nejire said, “Riso is super smart. His quirk is Mind Analyzation! He can hold any man-made object and see a holographic blueprint of it!”

“She’s correct. Midoriya informed me of Riso’s abilities. Nezu, the principal of UA, and Eraserhead have confirmed this.”

“Okay, so what. The kid is smart-”

“He made this hair clip out of a couple paperclips and a soda can. Its efficiency is quite remarkable.” Nighteye rested back in his chair. “While discussing the potential plan the Hassaikai might have, we came to a conclusion.” He glanced at Aizawa, who stood from his seat.

“We fear that they were going to force Riso to create the bullet for them. I’ve seen Riso’s progress over the past two years, and with the recent quirk training he’s undergone, he’s more than capable of perfecting a bullet with the materials given to him.” Aizawa looked at Izuku. “Riso’s quirk overwhelms his body. We’ve been working on finding methods to prevent this from happening. Once overwhelmed, his brain shuts down and his quirk and need to create and challenge itself takes over. If Riso were to go into one of these episodes, it would be almost impossible for him to restrain himself from creating. The current method we had was to fill his schedule to occupy him. I personally have been training him with another student to control these episodes. Since he’s been kidnapped and most likely isolated, he’s susceptible to these episodes.”

“He should be able to resist.” A hero said. “He can’t just create something for a villain.”

“Under these circumstances, he wouldn’t have much of a choice.” Aizawa glared. “He’s selfless. He’d put anyone over himself. Considering the abuse Eri is undergoing, Riso would do anything to prevent her from getting hurt. If he were alone, he’d let himself get beat to

death before doing anything for anyone else. Once other people get added into the picture, he's very careful and would do anything to insure their safety. Including creating a quirk destroying bullet. And I'd advise you to watch your tone. He is still a child, as well as Eri. Their situation is not ideal."

Izuku and Mirio stood. "We'll get them both, and this time we'll protect Eri!"

"I don't doubt it. That's what we've come to discuss."

The rest of the meeting went smoothly. It was the aftermath that was the hardest part. The big three, Uraraka, Tsuyu, Kirishima and Izuku were all sat at a table in the common area. Izuku had his head hung low.

"I can't believe that Riso is somehow wrapped up in this.." Kirishima mumbled. "And I hate that we can't even tell anyone!"

"I know..I feel like at least Shinso and Bakugo need to know. They were pretty close.." Uraraka looked at Izuku. "I can't imagine the amount of pressure you're holding."

"This whole situation just makes my stomach churn." Izuku whispered, his voice barely audible.

Aizawa walked through the doors, earning a look from all the students.

"Mister Aizawa!" Tsuyu says, slightly surprised.

"Call me Eraser outside of school."

"You're my man till the end, Eraser!"

“No.”

“Sorry!”

“Tone it down a bit, Kirishima..” Uraraka said softly.

“I hate that you’re all wrapped up in this.” Aizawa sighed. “Before this, I was going to cancel your work studies.”

“What?? Why??” Kirishima asked.

“You heard Nighteye, the league is involved. That makes things different.” Aizawa turned to Izuku. “Listen. I’m worried about you. Certain things make me want to stop you from being involved. But, I know if I do that you’ll find a way to get yourself involved. So, I’m watching you. Use your head, okay, problem child?”

Izuku nodded slowly.

“Cheer up, Mirio!” Nejire smiles. Mirio sighed.

“Listen, just because you two didn’t save her now, doesn’t mean you didn’t give her hope.” Aizawa says.

“Mirio?” Izuku looks at him.

“I know. We’ll save her next time and we’ll get your friend to safety.”

“No matter what.” Izuku nodded.

Chapter End Notes

things are happening!! if you guys didn't see my insta story (eraserhkinnie) i used an online wheel picker to decide on a VERY big thing! i'm sure you guys might not like the option it picked, ill make sure to leave a note when it occurs in the story. don't hate me haha

updates on wednesdays and sundays!

Chapter Forty Seven

Chapter Summary

> Izuku prepares himself as he waits for the call that the Shie Hassaikai Raid is happening. Unfortunately, nothing could have prepared him for what was to come.

Chapter Notes

> little nervous about this one ngl but hey im committed. trigger warning for blood btw! more towards the end of a chapter. also we stay in the pov of izuku the entire raid, so there won't be any specialized moments for tamaki or kirishima like in the anime! and idk if i mentioned this but mirio has one for all!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Chaotic. That's really the only word that's able to describe Izuku's week. He's been so busy with work studies and school work that he couldn't make time for anything else. Including vigilante work. Considering what had happened the last time he did something of that nature, tragedy occurred. No one could blame him for not doing it, but then again not a lot of people knew.

The reality of skipping vigilante work was brought to his attention when he overheard his classmates talking in the common area.

"Have you guys seen the article about Cosmic?" Jiro asked, motioning to her computer screen.

"..No," Tokoyami glanced at the screen. "What does it say?"

"He's been radio silent for a while. There's speculation he was badly injured or even killed. There hasn't been any sightings of Nexus or Comet either."

“Do you think they’re all okay?” Kirishima asked, peering over Jiro’s shoulder. “I think they did a lot for the city..”

“Me too,” Momo nodded. “Their skills were quite unmatched. With the decline of All Might’s presence, they really seemed to uplift the community.”

“Yeah they did. Y’know, I always thought Cosmic was pretty hot. Have you seen his scars?” Denki snickered. “My kind of guy.”

“You’re an idiot.” Jiro deadpanned.

Izuku blinked. That was a weird thing to overhear.

“What do you think, Midoriya?” Sato asked. “You’re kinda just standing over there. Come join us.”

Izuku made his way over to the group, nervously tapping his thigh.

“Think about what..?” Izuku questioned.

“Those vigilantes. Cosmic, Nexus, Comet.”

“They’re..” Izuku held his breath as the night of the warehouse played in his mind. “Brave.”

“Right??” Kirishima smiled. “So manly.”

“I think it’s interesting how Midoriya uses a staff like Nexus and Cosmic!” Mina mentioned, tapping a finger to her chin.

“Oh, I..just kind of a fan. It’s also useful since I don’t have a flashy quirk.” Izuku blushed. “Cosmic inspired me.”

“The fuck are we talking about scar-face for?” Bakugo growled, seemingly appearing behind Izuku.

“Kacchan..!”

“Bakugo!” Denki nudged him. “Is there a reason he’s got a nickname?”

“Too lazy to remember that dumb fucks name.”

“That’s harsh. Especially since he saved you at the USJ.” Todoroki spoke.

“Shut up!” Bakugo grabbed Izuku’s arm, “I gotta speak with you.”

“Oh, okay..!”

Izuku found himself in his dorm. Bakugo sat on his bed.

“Is everything okay?”

“You’re getting adopted?”

Shit, I totally forgot to tell him.

“Yeah, I..I’m sorry it slipped my mind.” Izuku sat on the bed, covering his face. “I’ve been so over the place, I feel like I’m just..being so useless.”

“Hey. Why the fuck are you being mean to my boyfriend?”

“...Kacchan, I *am* your boyfriend.”

“Did I ask if you were? Be nice to him or I’ll kick your ass.” Bakugo glared. “Now. Tell me about you being adopted.”

“I..” Izuku sighed and laid down, his head in Bakugo’s lap. “Mister Aizawa and Present Mic are adopting Hitoshi. Hitoshi said he’d only allow it if they adopt me too.”

“What a sentimental nerd.” Bakugo snickered. “Why don’t you want to? You’ve wanted good parents.”

“How did you know I was hesitant..?”

“I don’t know, it’s not like I’ve known you most of my life.” Bakugo shrugged. “Look, just tell me why you don’t want to.”

“I don’t feel worthy. I mean, I’ve done nothing but fail people. I failed my mom, Riso, and I’m failing you and Hitoshi because of my work studies. I’m failing the people of Japan by being too caught up in everything and I haven’t done vigilante work in forever,” Izuku took a breath. “I want to help people but I’m doing the opposite.”

“You don’t have to earn parents.” Bakugo’s eyes softened at his worried boyfriend. “Parents are supposed to love and care for you. Raise you to be the best you can, and support you as you experience life. If our shitty teachers want to do that, let them. Stop worrying you’re not good enough. You’ve been good enough. So let yourself have a family.” Bakugo had gently cupped Izuku’s face, rubbing his thumb along his cheek. Izuku stared up at Bakugo, before smiling softly. He placed his hand to Bakugo’s.

“If we were to get married, they’d be your father-in-laws.”

“Fuck everything I just said, don’t do it.” Bakugo couldn’t help but smile. He wanted to keep an intimidating demeanor around everyone, though he could hardly keep that up with Izuku anymore. Looking into his eyes alone was enough to make Bakugo’s heart melt.

“Oh!” Izuku sat up, turning to Bakugo. “If Riso and Hitoshi were to get married, Riso would-”

“...Don’t do this to me. Izuku- I can’t even think that.” Bakugo covered Izuku’s mouth. “I can’t stand that idiot.”

“Aww, you know he’s the closest thing to a best friend you have.”

“I have Kirishima.”

“Do you help Kirishima break the law after curfew?”

“...Shut up.”

“See!”

Bakugo turned to Izuku and kissed him gently, stopping the back and forth while he could. Izuku kissed back, leaning close to Bakugo. He placed a hand on his chest, as Bakugo placed a hand on Izuku’s cheek.

The door swung open. Bakugo and Izuku pulled from their kiss quickly, locking eyes with Hitoshi who was at the door. He blinked.

“...I’m gonna tell dad-”

“Hitoshi!” Izuku blushed.

“Why is everyone always walking in on us. Why don’t you lock your fucking door?” Bakugo looked at Izuku.

“Because..!” Izuku whined, and face planted on his bed. “I’m gonna die here, thanks.”

“What did you need?” Bakugo rose an eyebrow at Hitoshi.

“I can spend time with my brother, thank you. I should be asking *you* that. Obviously you’ve taken enough DNA from Izuku’s mouth, so I don’t think there’s anything else you could possibly need.”

“Shut the fuck up.”

“Try me, blasty.”

Later that night, Izuku heard his phone buzz on his dresser. He perked up, realizing what this meant. They had finally found Eri and Riso’s location. He slowly pulled himself from Bakugo’s grasp and found his way outside, where his other classmates were. They exchanged a few words, only to find their way to Nighteye’s agency for a briefing on the situation early in the morning the next day. Izuku tried to contain his nerves, but it was pretty hard with all things considered.

“They’re hiding this girl where?!” Rock Lock exclaimed.

“The main base of operations. The headquarters of the Shie Hassaikai.” Ryukyu huffed lightly.

“We did all that investigating for nothing.” Rock lock scoffed.

“How did you find them anyway?” Fat Gum asked.

Nighteye placed a toy on the desk. Gung-Ho! Glitter Squad 10 was written across the box. The heroes looked around confused before Fat Gum spoke up.

“How does that help us?”

“I saw one of the members of the yakuza ask about a girl’s toy. I recommended this toy and in the process I used my quirk on him. I watched as he found his way to Eri.” Nighteye intertwined his fingers.

“Anything about the other kid?”

“He was there too. He was close to Eri, trying to protect and comfort her.”

“His condition?”

“Seemed healthy, a few bruises were formed.” Nighteye looks at his sidekicks.

“We’ve gotten a warrant from the police and a time frame of when they will be there. All we have to do is get there.”

The students of UA were permitted to change into their hero uniforms. After that, everyone headed to the police station to be caught up on the plan. Izuku listened in, but he was trying

his best not to worry about what they might find. This fight was going to be an intense one, and he wasn't sure he was prepared. Once given a sheet of the quirks documented to those connected to the Hassaikai, Izuku paused.

Shin Nemoto - Confession

Izuku felt his heart drop. Confession. He turned to Aizawa, who seemingly had the same mindset.

If he has confession, Izuku thought. *They must've got Riso to tell them how to perfect the bullets.*

Eight thirty was the time they all had been lined up and waiting for the head of police to ring the doorbell of the headquarters. Before he could even press his finger to the button, someone busted through the gates. A few policemen who were caught in the way flew into the air.

"It's too early for this."

Izuku dashed forward to catch a falling officer, as Aizawa wrapped the others in his capture weapon.

"Are you okay??" Izuku asked the officer once he was on the ground.

"Yeah," He nodded, a hand on his head. "That was scary."

"The Ryukyu agency has him! Everyone else go inside!"

"Got it! Men, you heard her!"

The police and remaining heroes ran along the path, the head of the police holding out the warrant as he spoke. He stated that they had a warrant and were able to enter the premises without resistance. Of course, that didn't happen. Villains and criminals poured out from the door, fighting the large police presence.

Nighteye, Aizawa, Bubble Girl, Centipeder, Rock Lock, Fat Gum and the students of UA (minus Nejire) ran into the building. They stopped in front of the secret passage that Nighteye saw in his foresight. He muttered to himself as he opened the door. A group of men came out, while Bubble Girl and Centipeder took them on.

"Go! We can handle them!"

So, the group did just that. Now was not a time to hesitate.

"Good thing we used your foresight!" Rock Lock called out. He regretted his words when he saw the pathway was blocked. "There's not supposed to be a wall here."

"Hold on, let me check." Mirio stepped forward.

"Be careful!" Izuku called out. Mirio put his head through the wall and turned back.

"There's more back there. They put this here to stop us."

"Stand back!" Kirishima yelled. He jumped forward and swung a punch as Izuku pulled out his staff. Izuku jumped with him and with the combined force of both of them, the wall crumbled.

"...That didn't suck." Rock Lock blinked.

"They broke it before I could even move!" Fat Gum looked at Rock Lock.

“We’re wasting time, c’mon let’s-”

Izuku was cut off by the entire hallway moving like the basic laws of physics didn’t exist. He tried to balance himself like everyone else was trying to do.

“Is this Joi Irinaka?!” Rock Lock called out, “I thought he couldn’t move anything larger than a refrigerator!”

“Remember who we’re dealing with, Rock Lock! He’s probably using a drug to boost his quirk! Eraser-!”

“I can’t cancel the quirk if I can’t see him!”

“He’s stalling for time,” Tamaki muttered. “We all might die here,”

“I’m going ahead, this can’t stop me.” Mirio looked back, nodding to the group. Before anyone could protest, he disappeared under the floor. Speaking of the floor, it opened up. The heroes fell down, leaving the police up a floor above them.

“Wh-” Izuku looked around, confused. Before he can fully register everything, Tamaki stood in front of Fat Gum. That’s when Izuku noticed the three men standing before them.

“I got these three. Go! He’s only stalling for time, so don’t let him stop you!!”

“Sun Eater-!” Kirishima called, but Fat Gum turned.

“Come on, let’s go.” He started towards the door. Aizawa ran past Tamaki and knocked one guy down.

“Get them before they get you.” He told the boy, then following the heroes.

“Since it wasn’t my student, I was gonna let you make the decision. Are you sure that was a smart decision?” Rock Lock questioned Fat Gum.

“Yeah, how do we know he’s gonna be safe?” Kirishima sounded concerned.

“Listen up! Tamaki is a great hero! He’s better than all of you, really! The only problem is his self esteem, and if he says he can do it, I believe in him!”

“But-”

“A comrade has stayed back to fight against an enemy to give you an advantage. If you were a man, you’d have faith!”

“Yeah! He’s totally got this, I believe in him!”

“You changed your mind quickly.” Izuku muttered.

They continued to run. It felt like hours, but it was probably closer to five minutes. Eventually, Aizawa spoke out about a concern.

“Mimic hasn’t tried to distort our way yet. His quirk probably can’t control everything, only an area he’s in or watching over. That’s when he starts to manipulate it. Therefore, he must be busy with the police. Keep an eye out for his physical body, then I can stop this!”

It didn’t take long for an obstacle to appear after Aizawa spoke. A piece of the wall came out, and was about to push him into an empty room.

He must be upset I figured out how he worked. Aizawa thought to himself, noticing he was unable to move at all. Until Fat Gum jumped in his way, and threw Aizawa forward.

“Kirishima!” Izuku called. “Crap, he’s with Fat now..!”

“Stay focused kid.” Aizawa said, but Izuku looked at him.

“Are you okay??”

“Fine. Now stay focused.”

“Yes sir!”

Not too long after this attempt to take out Aizawa, the hallway began to shift again. Rock Lock set his hands out and deadbolted the walls. The walls stopped moving, but there was only so much room for them to move. Izuku saw a large wall of concrete come their way. He jumped in front of everyone, holding his breath as he discounted his staff. Now that his staff was in half, he threw one and it landed in the block of concrete. It took a second, but the entire thing cracked into nothing but small pieces of rubble. It returned to the other side of his staff.

“If Fat was here, this would be much easier!”

“I’m more annoyed that I can't see his damn body.” Aizawa growled.

“He’s weakening! He must be exhausted from controlling the basement for so long.” Izuku looked at the group. “We’re able to get from his grasp easier now!”

Suddenly, everything opened up. Once opened, Izuku jumped back as concrete shot up between the group. Aizawa and Izuku were stuck together, Rock Lock was alone, and Sir Nighteye was stuck with a few police officers.

“Why bother separating us now?” Aizawa let out a frustrated sigh.

“At least we can still hear each other,” Nighteye noted.

“What the-” A struggle was heard from Rock Lock’s section. Izuku looked at Aizawa, who nodded at him. Izuku placed the tip of his staff on the wall and pressed a button. The entire concrete wall shattered. Rock Lock was stabbed and on the ground with another Rock Lock standing over him.

“Guys! There was just this weird clone right here, be careful.”

“A stab wound..?” Aizawa looked down at the Rock Lock on the ground.

“Are you okay, Midoriya?” Rock Lock asked, and Izuku nodded.

“Yeah, I’m okay.”

Aizawa turned around. “That’s not Rock Lock!” He activate his quirk, and he began to melt. Toga stood there, the goop from her quirk being deactivated running down her body.

“Toga?!” Izuku exclaimed, ducking to avoid her attack. He couldn’t help but think about how similar she was to Camie, the girl at the license exam. Aizawa threw his capture weapon forward, but she grabbed it and used it to get behind Aizawa. She stabbed him in the shoulder blade.

“Mimic must’ve let the league in.” Aizawa grunts as Toga disappears.

“Are you okay??”

“Check on Rock Lock, he’s in worse condition.” Aizawa seethes in pain for a moment, before pushing down the pain. Izuku helped Rock Lock to his feet. Something shook the hallway, and Izuku could only assume it was Nighteye. A few seconds later, a yell of rage erupted. The basement walls turned into a frenzy. Concrete was flying everywhere as it made a spiral towards the center of something.

“Did you hear that?!” Aizawa yelled over the loud noises of concrete grinding against each other.

“Yes, sir! I can’t tell where it’s coming from!”

“We gotta do something or we’ll all be crushed!”

A second yell came and Izuku narrowed his eyes at the ceiling. He jumped up, bouncing off of multiple pieces of debris. He took his staff and drove it into the ceiling. It crumbled and exposed Mimic. Aizawa activated his quirk, and the walls returned to normal. As normal as they could be.

Izuku caught Mimic and gently helped him on the ground safely with the help from a few officers. Other than that, Izuku ran off immediately. He was going to stay and see what Aizawa told him to do since the league showed up. He got to thinking about Mirio and couldn’t help it. He had to get to him as soon as he could.

Izuku used his staff to bust any walls that came in his way. As he busted the wall that led to Overhaul, his body stiffened at the sight. Mirio was currently trying to fight off Overhaul, who had just thrown something to the other villain with him. His eyes widened when he saw Eri wrapped in Mirio’s cape.

Izuku jumped over the obstacles in front of him. He ran to Eri’s aid, grabbing her hands gently. She looked up at him with sad eyes, shaking her head.

“No, stop! He’s only going to hurt you!” Eri’s voice broke Izuku’s heart.

“Then I’ll have to go for what he really cares about!” Izuku heard someone yell. Almost as if it was slow motion, he turned to look at the source of the voice. The villain, who was actually Chronostasis, held a gun towards Eri and Izuku. The gun went off, causing Izuku’s ears to ring. He saw from the corner of his eye that Mirio was coming that way to block the bullet from hitting the both of them. Izuku then realized that it couldn't be just any ordinary bullet. It had to have been the quirk destroying bullet.

“Lemillion, stop!” Izuku yelled. “You’ll lose your quirk!”

For a second, Mirio hesitated. In doing so, the bullet barely missed him. Izuku felt an intense pain run down his right shoulder, his body being jerked back from the force of the bullet. Izuku brought his hand to his shoulder, feeling the dark red liquid coat his fingers. It was an unusual feeling. Izuku couldn’t describe it, but he could *feel* his quirk being destroyed. As if something was attacking every genetic strand of DNA in his body to get rid of the quirk.

Izuku turned to Eri and quickly picked her up as Mirio turned to Overhaul. Izuku found himself in a hallway. He walked as the whole place rumbled. His shoulder began to scream at him, so he gently placed Eri on her feet. He took a shallow breath.

“Eri,” The girl had tears streaming down her face. Izuku finally noted the drops of blood on her tan dress. “Eri, I need you to be honest with me. The boy who gave you the hair clip comb, where is he?” He hated to ask so much of her right now, but he hadn’t seen a trace of Riso yet. He needed to find him after he got Eri out.

“I’m so sorry,” Eri broke into more tears. Her voice trembled. “He’s..He’s in our room.”

“Okay, okay that’s good. I need you to come with me so I can get you out of here-” Izuku clenched his jaw, feeling a slight breeze hit his open gunshot wound. Where did that breeze come from?

“Eri.” Overhaul’s voice came from the original room. “Come back Eri. Someone else is going to die because of you!”

Eri looked at Izuku as she took a few steps back. She turned on her heel, and ran back to the room.

“Eri, don’t!”

Izuku moved forward and felt the pain in his shoulder spike. He winced in pain, feeling almost stunned for a moment. He figured by now Aizawa, Nighteye and a few policemen had to be there. He fumbled his way through the hallway, the abuse his body had taken up until now seemed to be pouring out at once. Peering in the room, it had become a total disaster since he left a few moments ago. Mirio seemed much more bloody now as well. Sir Nighteye was even struck by a piece of concrete.

“Eri. Do you think he can beat me?” Overhaul asked, using his former henchmen’s quirk.

“..No..” She answered truthfully.

“So what are you going to do?”

“Come back to you..” Eri whispered. “But you have to make them all better if I do! Please, I..I don’t want anyone else hurt.”

Izuku scanned the room for Aizawa. Not being able to see him raised his anxiety, but he shook it off the best he could.

“Eri-!” Izuku called. The ground began to rumble again, then the ceiling collapsed. He only got to see Uraraka, Tsuyu and Nejire along with some heroes jump down before a boulder blocked off his path. He flipped out his staff and went to press it to the wall. He huffed when he couldn’t apply enough pressure to the wall since his shoulder was shot. He could move his right arm, but it felt like just twisting the knife in a wound.

The bullet must be in my shoulder. As long as it's in there, anytime I move my arm it feels like it's pinching something. I can't use my arm. Izuku looked around. He blinked, recognizing the path. The room Nighteye had seen in his foresight was only a corner away. Izuku held onto his staff with his left hand as he ran down the hall. It felt like it was getting longer and longer and he couldn't catch up. He almost slipped when he came around the corner. The door had been slightly opened. Izuku reached it and swung the door open. His heart dropped.

Blood covered the floor. It had a few girl toys in it, but there were ripped soda cans and old bobby pins in the room. Izuku felt sick seeing the amount of blood splatter. A pair of chains attached to the wall had handcuffs connected to them. His line of sight followed the chains. His heart pounded against his chest, Izuku swore he could hear his heartbeat in his chest. A hand was still clasped in the handcuffs bracelet attached to the wall. Slumped against the wall, was Riso. The sight made Izuku nauseous.

Riso's black shirt had patches of blood soaked into it, Izuku only knew that because it looked wet in those spots. Blood ran along his arms, most of it dried to his skin by now. His pink hair was a deep red, the ends of it dried and clunk together. Since the hair was clunked together, Izuku could see his face. Although his head was tilted down, the wounds were still visible. His lips had been busted, blood stained his lips as it seemingly had run down to his chin. He had bruises forming on his face, his nose a dark purple. With the amount of blood trickling from Riso's hairline, Izuku thought the worst. Riso was dead. Looking at him as he was, he was dead. Izuku held his breath unintentionally as he stared on in shock.

He came back to reality as he ran forward, looking at the chain on the wall. He used as much force as he could with his left arm to pry open the handcuff, and he was grateful when Riso's hand slipped from it. Izuku then kneeled in front of Riso, lifting his chin slowly. Tears had come to his eyes.

"No, no, no.." Izuku whispered as he cupped Riso's face with his shaking hand. He held his head up. "No, you can't be dead. Riso, please. Please, you can't.."

The tears split from his eyes when he felt air come from Riso's nose. He was breathing. He was fucking breathing. Izuku couldn't help but smile.

"..Zuku?" Riso's voice was barely audible. His eyes opened ever so slightly.

“Yes! Yes, that’s me..I-I’m here. I’m so sorry, I tried so hard to-”

“..Hey, what did I say about the s word..?” Riso told him, a smile crackling onto his face.

“We..we don’t apologize for things we can’t control.” Izuku felt more tears coming. “I-I’m gonna help you..! I..We’re going to get you to a hospital and-”

“..Don’t you dare take me to a hospital.” Riso coughed lightly, his voice rasp. He tried to force himself to sit up more but he winced in pain. “You know I hate them.”

“Death probably isn’t much better..! That’s where you’re going. Okay?”

Riso didn’t respond, feeling his eyes flutter. He lifted his hand to the best of his ability and placed it on Izuku’s cheek. He shakily wiped his thumb across his cheek, wiping the tears that came from his eyes.

“Stop crying. I’m not gonna die..” Riso muttered.

That was the last thing he said before he went unconscious.

“Riso? Riso. Riso! Open your eyes, talk to me..! Please don’t do this to me!” Izuku shook him gently. “Riso!”

Chapter End Notes

HA izuku losing his quirk was a decision made by an online wheel picker lmao. sorry if this chapter sucked but it got the point across, didn't it?

updates wednesdays and sundays

Chapter Forty Eight

Chapter Summary

> Izuku awakes in the hospital. In an attempt to protect Hitoshi, Aizawa isn't truthful about Riso's whereabouts.

Chapter Notes

> the start of this chapter is a hint to a previous chapter, and i used basically the same introduction. no like i copied and pasted it. i did it like that because a, i wanted to, b, last time riso and izuku were in a hospital together riso had literally died and came back to life soo...yeah. anyway, enjoy!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Hospitals. If there was one thing Izuku hated most, it was fucking hospitals. He doesn't remember how or when he got put in a hospital bed, but he *does* remember the intoxicating smell of cleanliness. Hospitals had a smell Izuku couldn't stand. Sterile. There wasn't anything wrong with smelling clean, but it burned his nose. He was already so easily overwhelmed at hospitals. The noises, the constant russling from doctors and nurses, the coughing and screaming patients. He hated it all.

His eyes barely slipped open, expecting all of his other senses to open up to the usual hospital busywork. Instead, there was silence. Only distant talking, but voices he couldn't make out. They must've been outside. The lights were dim, which made it easier for Izuku to open his eyes. He squinted, trying to learn his surroundings. When he turned to his left, he was surprised to see Hitoshi next to him. He then realized Hitoshi had been holding his hand. His head was hung low, probably thinking of the negatives.

"..Don't look so sad," Izuku's voice was rasp, but Hitoshi's head perked up.

"Izuku! Oh my god, you scared me!" Hitoshi hugged Izuku tightly. "I'm so glad you're okay."

“..Too tight,” Izuku muttered. “..Have I been out long?”

“Since yesterday morning. It’s almost one in the afternoon.” Hitoshi let his hand go, and helped Izuku sit up.

“..I only got shot,” Izuku muttered.

“Only got shot.” Hitoshi blinked. “Yeah, *only* . The doctor’s said the bullet was pinching a nerve. You..technically had surgery to get it removed.”

“..What? I had surgery?”

“Once you came back, Recovery Girl was here and she used her quirk. You were out for so long because of that. You needed time to recover and rest.”

“Oh.”

“I’m going to get Dad from the hallway, okay? Bakugo is outside too. He kept trying to fight the doctors.” Hitoshi walked towards the door and peaked his head out. He said a few words before the door slammed open.

“You fucking nerd, why did you go and get shot?!” Bakugo stormed over. Izuku smiled softly as Bakugo grabbed both his hands.
“Don’t ever do that again!”

“Okay, okay..I’m sorry, Kacchan.” Izuku said softly. Bakugo closed the gap between the two of them for a moment, then pulled away.

“You can’t die before we become great heroes.”

“Hey, kid.” Aizawa’s expression was gentle. “How are you feeling?”

“..Thirsty?” As Izuku said so, Bakugo stepped out of the room. He assumed to get something for him to drink.

“Do you remember much? Like when you were shot?”

“..Yeah. Protecting Eri..” Izuku looked at his hands.

“...The bullet you were shot with.” Aizawa sighed. “Izuku, I hate to say this, but it was the quirk destroying bullet. You..no longer have a quirk.”

“..Oh.” Izuku gulped. “I remember that.”

“..Hitoshi, can you wait outside for a moment?” Aizawa turned to him.

“..No? I want to stay with Izuku.”

“Hitoshi.”

“Dad.”

“It’s important, Hitoshi. Now.”

Bakugo found his way back into the hospital room, and handed Izuku a cup of water. He took a sip, enjoying the cool feeling as it went down his throat.

“Bakugo, Hitoshi. I need to speak with him alone.”

“Oh, um. Before that.” Izuku looked at Aizawa. “Is Eri okay?”

“Yes, she’s recovering and has her own hospital bed right now.”

“What about Riso?”

There was silence. Okay now Izuku started to miss the uncomfortable hospital noise. Aizawa pressed his lips together as Izuku glanced around. By Hitoshi and Bakugo’s facial expressions, they didn’t know about Riso being found in the raid.

“..He..He is okay, right? I mean, why..do they look so confused?” Izuku locked eyes with Aizawa.

“Riso’s here?” Hitoshi asked. “In..In this hospital?”

“Hitoshi,”

“Dad. You didn’t tell me he was here. Why is he here? How long has he been here for?”

“..We found Riso in the raid,” Izuku answered quietly. “I..I found him.”

“He’s been here since yesterday?” Angry wasn’t the right word to describe Hitoshi’s feelings. “What room.”

“He’s not permitted visitors right now.” Aizawa wouldn’t look at Hitoshi. “I can’t tell you.”

“Dad. What room is he in.”

The tenison caused Izuku’s heart rate to increase, the machine had no problem exposing that to the three in the room.

“Hitoshi, you can’t see him. This is not my decision, if it was, I-”

“I asked what fucking room he was in!” Hitoshi glared at Aizawa.

“Hitoshi, please don’t talk to me like that.”

“How long were you going to hide the fact that he was here? I’ve been waiting for WEEKS to know that he’s okay, or breathing, and this is what I get in return? I don’t even get informed he’s in the fucking hospital?? That’s not fair!”

“I’m sorry. It wasn’t my choice.”

“I have the right to know! What if he dies in that room and I never see him? Even if he’s hooked to machines, o..or not there! If he’s barely breathing, I want to see it!”

“...Bay three.” Hizashi’s voice came from the doorway. “He’s in bay three.”

Hitoshi turned towards the door. Aizawa stepped out of his way as he basically ran out the door.

“Sir, I’m so sorry I didn’t mean to-” Izuku started.

“It’s not your fault.” Aizawa sighed. “It’s mine.”

“How?”

“I should’ve just told him. I’m his dad first, a Pro-Hero second. He’s..also in no condition to be seen in.” Aizawa looked towards the door where Hitoshi just left. “I was afraid it would cause Hitoshi to have a horrible and unhealthy reaction. I was only trying to protect him.”

Hitoshi’s shoes collided with the floor, the squeak echoing throughout the halls. He skidded to a stop as he read the numbers above each room. He turned, breaking out into a sprint. He ran past a few nurses.

“Young man, you can’t run in the halls!” A nurse called out to him, but Hitoshi wasn’t listening. He had one thing on his mind.

His hand landed on the door handle, and he pushed the door open. The sight in front of him was almost enough to bring him to his knees.

Riso, even though it was hard to recognize him, was laid in a hospital bed. A blanket was loosely tucked up to his chest, his arms on top of the thin fabric. They were covered in bandages. There were more bandages wrapped around his head, and a few laid across his face. That’s why it was hard to recognize him. His pink hair had been pushed back and covered, and his eyes were shut. A nasal cannula had been placed in his nostrils, and an IV was hooked to his right arm. A light beeping came from the monitor next to him, which seemed to be keeping track of his health.

His chest rose and fell slowly. Hitoshi inched forward, doing his best to take in the difficult sight in front of him. Taking a few steps had never been so difficult. Hitoshi reached his bed, looking down at him with tears filling his eyes. He shakily ran his fingers along Riso’s hand. Now that he was closer, he could see the new addition of scars to his face. His lip even had a small indent from a bad busted lip.

“Oh, Riso..” Hitoshi’s voice broke. “I..I’m so sorry. You’re..you’re going to be okay. You..you have to be okay.” He fell to his knees and rested his head against the hospital bed as

he began to sob. His hand wrapped around Riso's, crying even more when he didn't feel Riso's hand even twitch.

About twenty minutes after an emotional sobbing session, Hitoshi was now sitting in a chair. His chair was as close as it possibly could be to the hospital bed. He had his hands supporting his own chin as his leg bounced up and down consistently. He watched Riso breathe for a few minutes, before the door opened. His head snapped over, watching who walked through the door.

"Oh, I..wasn't aware anyone would be in here." A doctor walked in, smiling softly at Hitoshi. "No visitors are supposed to be allowed to visit this patient."

"Well, too bad." Hitoshi looked back at Riso. "I'm not leaving his side again. Not until he wakes."

"I understand he might mean a lot to you, but-"

"I said I'm not leaving."

The door opened again. This time, Aizawa was standing there.

"I'm sorry, Doctor. Let me speak with my son for a moment, is that okay?"

"..Of course. Be quick, please."

Once he left the room, the silence became loud. Hitoshi avoided eye contact. Aizawa sighed, and sat next to Hitoshi.

"I'm sorry." He started. "I know I should've told you. I was worried about your reaction to seeing him in..such bad shape."

“I don’t care.” Hitoshi’s tone was rough, and cut like a rigid sided blade.

“I know. It was wrong of me. You’re not young, you don’t need such protection. Do you want to know what I was told about him?”

“..Yeah.”

“Recovery Girl came after she saw Izuku. Riso’s injuries were…deadly. Recovery Girl healed his head injury as much as she could, but it was of such great scale that..he might be asleep for a while.”

“..Is he in a coma..?”

“It’s more complicated than a simple coma. Recovery Girl’s quirk usually makes the receiving patient use a certain amount of their own energy depending on how severe the injury is. Riso’s injury, if not treated by her, would have put him in one. But what she did manage to heal…it takes a lot from his body. He’s not technically in a coma, but..in a very deep sleep that he won’t wake from until his body has fully recovered. To ensure he healed completely, we had a minor hero use their sleeping quirk to make sure he stays asleep. He’s predicted to wake within the next week or two.”

“So he’s okay.”

“His vitals are fine. The only worry the doctors have is that when wakes, he could have memory loss.”

“..What?”

“That’s why I didn’t want you to know any of this. I know you deserve to know. There’s just…” Aizawa paused, memories of Oboro flashed in his mind. “I didn’t want this to be too

hard on you, and it ruin your spirits."

"I'm sorry. I think I was harsh." Hitoshi muttered. "I've just been so worried about him, I..I just wanted to see him again. It had been so long. And you hid it from me."

"I know, kiddo." Aizawa looked at Riso. "Why did you have to pick the most reckless kid I've ever come across?"

"There's something charming about him."

"There's always something charming about the loud and reckless ones."

"..That's right." Hitoshi looks at Aizawa with a smirk. "Paps is like that."

"You call him paps now?"

"Eh, too tired to pronounce the 'ah'."

"Of course you are." Aizawa chuckled. "Look, I'll talk to the staff. See if I can get you access to visit him sometimes."

"I don't want to leave his side."

"Hitoshi, you still have school."

"Please don't make me leave him alone."

“..Let me talk with Hizashi.” Aizawa stands. “I can’t promise anything.”

Aizawa gave a soft smile before walking out of the room. Hitoshi turned back to Riso. He watched for any sort of movement.

A week or two. That’s all it is. It’s not the worst. Hitoshi thought to himself, relaxing in the chair. *I can deal with that.*

“Kacchan,” Izuku looked at Bakugo. “..How’s Eri?”

“She’s fine. She’s being quarantined because of her quirk.”

“Are you sure?” Izuku picked at his fingernails. “I feel really bad for her. I mean, she..that’s a lot to go through.”

“I know, you idiot. Aizawa is the one who’s been checking on her.” Bakugo glanced down, grabbing Izuku’s hands to stop him from picking at his nails. “Are you okay?”

“What? Yeah, of course I-”

“Shut up. I’m serious. Are you okay.”

“...I’m really stressed.” Izuku admitted. “I’m scared, disappointed, worried.”

“Why?”

“I lost my quirk, Kacchan. I know I’m capable of being a hero still, I just..my quirk helped others! I lost that and..I’m worried that on my own, I won’t ever become anything.”

“That’s not true. You only just learned how to heal others, and even if you *did* use your quirk, it hurts you. You put the damage on yourself and heal them.”

“I was okay with that.”

“I don’t know why. It’s dumb and reckless.”

“...You just don’t want me hurt.”

“Is that a crime?” Bakugo scoffed. “Yes, I’m worried about you being hurt.”

“I can’t believe you admitted that.”

“You’re the one being reckless!”

“Oh, shut up-” Izuku rested his head against the hospital bed. “When can I get out of here?”

“I don’t know. Soon, probably. I can go ask.”

Bakugo left the room to find Aizawa or Hizashi. He paused when he saw them talking in the hallway.

“Sho, I don’t think it’s healthy for him to stay here the entire time.”

“I know. He’s not going to leave, but this will just be even..worse if we try to force him to leave.”

“You didn’t even want to tell him about Riso, so why let him stay now?”

“It’s hard on him. You should’ve seen him in there. Hizashi, it’s so..sad. He can’t tear his eyes from him.”

“He needs school.”

“So we bring it here.”

“You’ve never done this for someone before. Are you feeling alright?”

“He’s our kid now. I think we need to put him first, then school. He’s pretty advanced on his physical training. I’ll come by everyday after school to check on him and give him the assessments.”

“..Sho..”

“Please, don’t fight me on this.”

“He comes home Saturday evening. That’s all I ask.”

“Okay.”

“Uh..Not to interrupt or whatever.” Bakugo walked from around the corner he stopped at, hands in his pockets. “When can Deku leave?”

“The doctors said once they get the release papers to us. It should be an hour at most.” Hizashi smiled. “Does he need something?”

“Yeah. To get the fuck out of this damn hospital.” Bakugo glanced at the door the two Pros were standing in front of. The name ‘Riso Sakusei’ was written in smooth handwriting on a folder that was next to the door. He huffed, turning on his heel.

Damn pinky-pie, causing nothing but trouble for others.

Chapter End Notes

aizawa is trying his best to give hitoshi time because he dealt with oboro's death really poorly. even if riso isnt dead, aizawa just wants to protect his son. he's never had one before! and can you even blame hitoshi for not wanting to leave?

also!! Christmas is this weekend so i'll try to get a chapter out on sunday but it might not so don't expect it! i will try my best :D

roughly 143k words later and pink&purple (or galaxy/ShinRi) STILL hasn't started dating. talk about a slow burn (yes riso was kidnapped through most of it but shhh)

updates every wednesdays and sundays! <3

Chapter Forty Nine

Chapter Summary

> Izuku recovers and is finally permitted to leave the hospital, but he comes back everyday to check on Hitoshi and Riso.

Chapter Notes

> i am in the car on my way to my parents rn while uploading this! but merry christmas you guys! or whatever you celebrate <3 enjoy the chapter!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Izuku had been released from the hospital. Thank *god* . He hated them so much. Before he left to go back to the dorms, he decided to stop by to see Riso. He was definitely dreading it. He felt responsible, like he didn't get to him fast enough. Bakugo squeezed his hand gently.

"You're mumbling."

"Sorry."

"Don't be sorry."

"Sorry."

"What did I just-"

Bakugo was cut off by Izuku opening the door. He slowly pulled him into the room, squeezing his hand unknowingly. Izuku saw Hitoshi sat in the chair, talking softly to the

injured boy. Izuku took a breath and made his way to the bed, keeping a small distance. His eyes flickered from Riso's rising and falling chest, to the beeping monitor off to the side. He hadn't noticed, but his breathing turned shallow. He was so, so fucking worried Riso wouldn't come back from this one. He's lived through a lot, this couldn't be the thing that brought him down.

"..Izuku?" Hitoshi said softly, breaking the boy from his thoughts.

"..Yeah?"

"I love you."

"H-huh?"

"I..don't know if it's weird, but I love you. Seeing Riso like this, knowing you were just there with him…Especially when I saw you in your own hospital bed? I just wanted you to know that. You're going to be my brother soon, and I care a lot about you. Life is precious, and…I couldn't imagine life without you."

Izuku stared at Hitoshi, lost for words. He let go of Bakugo's warm hand and hugged Hitoshi. Their arms wrapped around the other tightly. Hitoshi gently placed a hand on the back of Izuku's head, his grip tightening even more on Izuku. He could've lost both Riso and Izuku, and he was so grateful Izuku could recover as fast as he did. Izuku sighed, feeling his shoulders drop once he was in Hitoshi's embrace.

"I love you too, Hitoshi." Izuku muttered into his chest. Once their hug broke, Izuku gave Hitoshi a small smile. He then motioned to his hoodie. "When did you get that?"

"Riso…had it in a box. Along with a letter confessing his feelings for me.." Hitoshi rubbed the back of his neck. "..Yeah."

"Wh- He had a letter for that??" Izuku gasped. "I feel betrayed! I didn't know about that!"

While Izuku and Hitoshi talked with one another, Bakugo's eyes were stuck on Riso. That sight scared him. He'd never admit that outloud, but it definitely scared him. Although Riso laid there in the best possible health he could be in, Bakugo imagined Riso laying just as relaxed while in a coffin. He felt something tug at his heart. He glanced at Izuku and Hitoshi, before quietly walking to Riso's bedside. He sighed.

"Idiot." Bakugo's voice barely came out. "Don't ever do this to m- Izuku ever again. You aren't weak, so why the hell are you letting me win?"

There was no response. Of course there wasn't, Bakugo wasn't expecting one. Riso was unconscious. Predicted to wake up soon. Bakugo made a promise to himself that he would ridicule Riso later.

"Kacchan?" Izuku asked sweetly. "Is everything okay?"

"He's added to his collection." Bakugo grumbled, walking over to Izuku.

"..Collection?"

"Of scars. On his face. Y'know, *scar-face* ?" Bakugo raised an eyebrow. "You didn't lose any brain cells when you got shot. Don't be stupid." The corner of his mouth twitched upwards.

"Oh, be quiet." Izuku sassed. He looked at Hitoshi. "Can I talk with him?"

"With Riso? Izuku, he's your best friend. Of course you can."

Izuku blushed slightly out of embarrassment, but stopped at Riso's bedside, taking the spot Bakugo was in a moment ago.

“Hey. Uh, this…is probably cheesy. Talking to you like you can respond. Aizawa..uhm, Dad. Dad tells me that Eri keeps asking for you. You saved her, y’know? You..risked your life to save hers. I-I know that’s your entire thing, but…this was different. Riso, you were a hero. I know, I know…You hate it. You hate the praise for saving someone who needed it. I just, you risked so much. You’re really hurt because of it. You were fine with dying for her. When you wake, if you can even hear me, she’s going to want you. You gave her hope, just like you gave me hope. You had disappeared and I realized that I never truly thanked you for that. So, thank you. Thank you so much for being my anchor, giving me hope and relighting that spark in me. Thank you for saving my life.” Izuku grabbed Riso’s hand. “I’m here. You have no choice but to let me be here. I’m going to look after you, the same way you did for me. There’s no point in fighting it.”

Izuku turned to Hitoshi, setting Riso’s hand down softly. “I was going to head back to the dorm. I really need a shower. Present Mic is gonna drive me.”

“You can call him papa. Or paps, whichever. I know they told you that you can decide when, so..I’m not going to rush you. But you can call him that.”

“Thanks, Hitoshi.” Izuku hugged him again. “I’ll come back when I can.”

“I don’t think I’m going anywhere anytime soon.” Hitoshi returned the hug, smiling at his brother.

“..Kacchan, join the hug.” Izuku glanced at him.

“No. I’ll die before that.”

“Kacchan.”

“No, I’m no-”

Both Izuku and Hitoshi grabbed his arms and pulled him in the hug. Bakugo stiffened for a moment, but sighs. He slowly placed his arms around the two of them.

“Don’t say a fucking word about this.”

“I’m telling everyone.”

“Deku.”

“Kidding!” Izuku laughed. “...I’m so telling Kirishima.”

The wholesome and pure moment between the three came to an end. Izuku was in a car now, Bakugo in the backseat. Izuku’s hands were trembling and he wasn’t quite sure why. Hizashi glanced at Izuku, an understanding smile came to his face.

“Hey, kiddo?”

“..Sir?” Izuku looked over.

“Are you doing okay?”

“...Yeah, I’m okay.”

“You aren’t a really good liar, you know.” Hizashi chuckled. “No one expects you to be okay, kid. Do you want to talk about it?”

Talk about the fact my quirk is gone? I was shot, let my best friend down? Was hardly capable of saving a little girl? No. No, I don’t.

“What’s there to talk about?” Izuku muttered, looking out the window.

“Getting shot is one thing, isn’t it?”

“It’s not a big deal.”

“..Okay, fine. What about surgery?”

“I came out alive, didn’t I?”

“Losing your quirk?”

“Thought I didn’t have one basically my entire life, it’s no news to me.”

“Seeing Riso minutes from death?”

Ouch. That one Izuku couldn’t counter as easily. It sort of stuck a needle in his heart, heat flushing to Izuku’s face. He was silent, his lips parted as he struggled to find anything to say.

“He..He’s okay now.”

“That’s not what I asked.”

“Well that’s my answer.”

“You need to talk to me, kid.” Hizashi sighed lightly. “Dealing with things alone is never the way to go. It’s going to eat you alive, I want to be there for you. I know in the hospital Sho and I weren’t in your room often but everytime I could be there, I was. I tried to keep the press at bay, and god, the amount of fucking paperwork we had to fill out. I want to be there for you and..your brother.” Hizashi hesitated, watching Izuku for a reaction to calling Hitoshi his brother.

“I’m sorry.”

“What? Why?”

“For making you do so much paperwork.”

Now it was Hizashi’s turn to be silent. He kept his eyes on the road in front of him. That was the last response he wanted to hear. Hizashi tapped his thumb on the steering wheel.

“What makes you think you should apologize for that?”

“You could’ve been doing something else. But you wasted your time on me.”

“Izuku, can I call you that?” Nod. “You’ve got nothing to apologize for. No time was wasted. We were just doing what was necessary for you and your safety. I would give up everything to make sure you have the opportunity to be safe.”

Izuku didn’t respond. He didn’t want to. He was tired, and wanted to sleep. To his surprise, he had drifted off without even noticing. Once he fully closed his eyes, he rested his head against the window.

“Hey.” Bakugo spoke up, his soft tone almost scaring Hizashi. “Is there anything I can do?”

“..What do you mean?” Hizashi glanced in the mirror, meeting Bakugo’s eyes.

“To get the nerd to open up for you and Aizawa.”

“You shouldn’t have to worry about it.”

“Shut up. Tell me what I can do. You’re good for him but he’s too stubborn to see that. He’s always been like that. This needs to be different.”

“I..There’s nothing you can really do. I want him to do it on his own, with maybe a little influence at most. I don’t want him to feel forced.”

“I’ll try to help as most as I can.” Bakugo muttered, watching Izuku sleep. He looked so peaceful and he wanted to conserve that. He wanted Izuku to be peaceful. He wanted Izuku to have a family.

“My, you sure care about him, don’t you?” Hizashi chuckled.

“Of course I care about him. He might be stupid, but it’s…Shut up, why am I talking to you?”

Hizashi smiled once Bakugo stopped talking. He was glad his future son had such an amazing boyfriend. The rest of the drive was quiet, Hizashi’s humming was enough to lull even Bakugo to sleep. Once at the dorms, Bakugo seemed to wake on his own. He wiped his eyes and looked at Hizashi.

“Hey, think you could grab his things?” Hizashi asked, “He’s really out, I was going to carry him to his dorm.”

“Tch. Of course I got his stuff. Get the nerd in his bed already.”

Hizashi opened the passenger side door, and unbuckled Izuku. He slid his arms under Izuku's legs and behind his back, before picking him up. He carried Izuku through the common area, earning the attention of his classmates. He entered the elevator, Bakugo tailing him with Izuku's things. Once the elevator dinged, Hizashi made it to Izuku's dorm. Bakugo opened the door to his dorm, and Hizashi sat Izuku down on his bed. He pulled a blanket over Izuku's body, who barely shifted. Hizashi leaned down and kissed his forehead.

"Sleep well, kiddo." He muttered.

Hizashi and Bakugo turned to head out the door, both of them almost jumping out of their skin when the entire class was standing outside of Izuku's door. Bakugo closed the door and crossed his arms.

"The fuck do you guys want?"

"Is Deku okay?" Uraraka asks, worry displayed on her face.

"Yes, we only wish to know Midoriya's condition." Iida somehow looked *more* worried than Uraraka.

"He's alright." Hizashi assured the worried kids. "He'll need a day or two to completely heal with Recovery Girl's quirk."

"Um.." Denki fidgeted with his hands. "Present Mic, did..did he lose his quirk?"

"..How do you know that?"

"In some of the news reports, it stated 'an unknown hero' was shot by a quirk destroying drug." Kirishima muttered. "We figured if it was a teacher or Pro, they'd give some indication."

“When they didn’t, we figured it was Midoriya..” Momo frowned. “Shinso told us that he had been shot.”

Hizashi sighed, cursing the kid’s detective skills. He couldn’t deny it.

“I think that’s something..he would like to discuss it with you once he wakes up. Please don’t disturb him.”

“Got it!”

“...Thanks, kiddos.”

The next four days were rough. Izuku couldn’t seem to stay awake, always falling asleep on or around his classmates. After the majority of the day was over, he’d go to visit Riso and see Hitoshi in the hospital. He’d bring the current work assignment to Hitoshi and work on his own with him. Izuku tried to go back to class, but he couldn’t stay awake. So, Aizawa and Hizashi gave him the same work they gave Hitoshi. Today, Izuku felt more energized than he had the past couple of days. Bakugo was busy with the remedial course for his hero license, so Izuku took off to the hospital. He slowly walked in, seeing Hitoshi talking to Riso again. He didn’t want to interrupt so he stayed by the door for a moment.

“I’m trying to adopt Fluffball.” Hitoshi started, hand intertwined with Riso’s. “I miss the little guy. I think he misses you too, y’know? He whines whenever I would see him. He really liked it when I wore your sweater. It’s like he knew you were away.”

Izuku stepped forward. “Hey, Toshi..”

“Oh,” Hitoshi looked over. “Hey! Got some more work for me?”

“Heh, yeah.” Izuku handed over a booklet. “The class keeps asking for you.”

“I figured.”

“You gonna come back next week?” Izuku took a seat next to him.

“I want to see him wake up.” Hitoshi opened the booklet. “I have to go home tomorrow evening regardless, since that’s what papa wants.”

“It hasn’t really been a week yet, do you think that hero’s quirk will last long?”

“..Riso has a way to break out of quirks faster than others. He trained it with my quirk.” Hitoshi glances at Izuku. “You’re starting therapy Monday right?”

“Don’t remind me, please.” Izuku huffs. “The last thing I want to do is talk about what happened.”

“Well it’s important you do, so you don’t get overwhelmed. You know dad and papa only want the best.”

“I know.” Izuku sighs. “It’s just…I don’t want to. I’d rather not talk about how traumatizing something was.”

“I understand.” Hitoshi hums.

“Are you going to start therapy too?” Izuku asked, picking at his fingernails.

“Pftt, for what?”

“The emotional warfare you went through while Riso was missing. Also the unresolved trauma you suffered in your foster homes. Oh, and for your nightmares.”

“...No.”

“If I have to go through therapy, I’m damn sure making sure you do.” Izuku cracked a smile.

“Let me be mentally ill in peace.”

“Uhhhh never.”

The two shared a laugh.

“..So..” Izuku started. “Are you going to ask him to be your boyfriend when he wakes up?”

“...That’s not too much?”

“Oh my god, Hitoshi. It has been *months* . I will go crazy if you don’t. I know Riso wouldn’t.”

“Yeah?” Hitoshi bit his lip. “I guess I’m a little worried that he might have memory loss.”

“..Aizawa told me about that.” Izuku paused. “Dad. Why do I keep messing that up-”

“He was kind of our teacher. It feels more natural than ‘dad’.”

“Speaking of..” Izuku tapped his pencil to his chin. “Are you going to change your last name?”

“I don’t know.” Hitoshi huffed. “I mean, even if I did..Who’s would I take? Aizawa? Yamada?”

“Hitoshi Aizawa, Hitoshi Yamada. Hitoshi Yamada-Aizawa?”

“Yamada-Aizawa doesn’t sound half bad. Izuku Yamada-Aizawa doesn’t either.”

“...What the hell would the class call us?” Izuku broke out in laughter. “Yamada-Aizawa number one, come here!”

“Hah,” Hitoshi snorted out a laugh. “I’m not sure. We’ll figure that out. Before then, I think I need help on this question.”

“Of course you do.”

Izuku helped Hitoshi with the question, and the two of them worked closely with one another. Despite all of the things that have happened, they could still rely on one another. Maybe they felt so comfortable with each other because they have the same coping mechanism, which was not talking about it. There was just a non-existent mutual agreement to not talk too deeply about things, and if they did, it was important. It’s almost as if they already knew how the other was feeling. They could have as many friends as they wanted, supportive lovers, loving parents. Regardless of who they talked to, they both felt emotionally relaxed around each other. A brotherly bond, as some would describe it.

There were just some things they knew. How twins can sometimes basically read the other's mind, or how siblings may fight but will always have their back. Izuku did always want a sibling, but he never expected to have found that sibling at his school. Izuku doesn’t even remember getting close to Hitoshi, it just happened. Hitoshi didn’t notice it either. It was complicated, sure, but comforting. Izuku would do anything for Hitoshi, and Hitoshi would do anything for Izuku.

The two of them finished their booklets. There was only a small silence before Hitoshi managed the courage to ask what happened that day, and the days prior. Izuku nervously explained everything to him. How he found Riso’s hair clip, the guilt he felt hiding it, why he

was being so weird that one day. He explained the raid and how he found Riso. Izuku teared up, not realizing how hard this was on him. The two were so busy listening and comforting one another that they almost forgot about Riso. He laid on the bed completely frozen and in the same paralyzed state he had been in for the past few days. Except for one minor thing that also went unnoticed by the two.

His pinky-finger twitched.

Chapter End Notes

gave y'all some happier stuff today :) riso is making progress it seems!

updates on wednesdays and sundays!

Chapter Fifty

Chapter Summary

Izuku and Hitoshi stay around Riso's bedside as they wait for him to wake.

Chapter Notes

ahhh!! this chapter is being updated at like 12:17am cause i couldn't wait. but hope you guys enjoy! also this chapter might be hard to follow but it essentially is in riso's pov?

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Darkness. Something similar to a never ending void with an inch of water on the ground that casted a reflection on the dark surface. There was no light source, yet everything was visible as if he had a bright, LED light shining on it. Not that there were many things in this void anyway. Riso laid in the lone hospital bed, the white and blue sheets seemed to glow against the darkness. His eyes were open, his body still unable to move.

Okay. This is seriously getting boring. Nothing is fucking working. Riso thought aloud, his eyes darting around for a sign of anything else. *I've been like this for like the past week. Am I dead or something?*

Not dead. This was a side effect of the hero's quirk that was used. When there was such strong resistance against the sleeping state, you'd stopped dreaming. From then, until the quirk *actually* wears thin enough for you to break it, you were in your own consciousness. For Riso, he was still bound to a hospital bed. He hated it. He hated hospitals in general. Something that made it bearable was Hitoshi. He had heard just about everything everyone's said to him, but Hitoshi was all he cared about. His soothing voice helped Riso relax, and almost even made him fall asleep. In the moments Hitoshi was either unresponsive, not in the room, or asleep, Riso would scream. He tried so desperately to open his mouth and yell for the purple haired boy. His mouth never opened. His thoughts would scream for as long as Hitoshi wasn't talking. In your thoughts, you don't need to breathe. Riso could scream for hours uninterrupted. Once he realized screaming wouldn't be of any use, he tried to move body parts. The first time he tried to sit up, his entire body instantly felt sluggish. He would hear the monitor attached to him to monitor his heart-rate beep, indicating his heart-rate increased. After that, he stuck to this method.

Everytime he tried to move his limbs, he would get hit with a wave of dizziness and that same sluggish feeling. The past day, Riso could feel the sleeping quirk weakening. He felt his heart jump in his chest when he finally managed to move his pinky-finger. It was only the slightest twitch, but he *moved* . He tried to move his finger again when he heard Izuku's voice echo.

"..Hitoshi?"

"Yeah?"

"His heart-rate is..spiking."

Holy shit, yes! Yes! Izuku, I'm so fucking close! I'm almost awake, I swear!

"It is. It's..way more than it usually is when it spikes. That…is he trying to wake up?" Shuffling could be heard, and Riso almost melted when he felt Hitoshi's warm hand connect with his. ***"Riso, hey. Are you trying to wake up? You can do it, I..I believe in you. Please wake up."***

"We're here, Riso. It's okay, we're here."

Riso didn't need words of encouragement. Well, maybe this time he did. He tried so, so fucking hard to squeeze his hand. He tried so hard to move *anything* . He hadn't been hit with that exhausting, sluggish feeling yet. He could keep trying. He had to keep trying.

"It's going back down." Izuku's voice was soft and quiet.

"I know you can do it, Riso. Please.."

No. No no. No, no, no, no! No, fucking please! Please I want to wake up so bad, I..! I have to wake up, damnit!

Riso didn't wake up.

He told himself he had given up on the screaming, but this time he didn't care. He was so fucking angry. He just wanted to open his eyes. He wanted to look around the stupid room he was in, he wanted his senses to open up to the hospital environment around him. Hell, he'd even make a deal with *God* that he'd never do vigilante work again if it meant he could wake up right now, and he was an atheist! It was frustrating for him. Why wouldn't it be frustrating? The love of his life was so close, yet so far away.

He had been screaming for god knows how long, but he knew it was long enough for it to be the next day. How does he know? Well, Hitoshi tells him every morning. He would hear Hitoshi's soft, yet deep morning voice tell him the day. Each day he sounded even more sad than the previous.

"It's Saturday." Hitoshi clearly had just woken up, because Riso could hear the shuffling of the shitty blanket the staff had given him. ***"I have to go home tonight. Shit. Riso,"*** There was a break in his voice, and Riso figured he started to cry. Hitoshi grabbed his hand and squeezed it tight, he always did that when he cried.

I'm here. I'm here, Hitoshi. Please don't give up on me.

Riso heard the door open, and a few unfamiliar voices. Must be the nurses or doctors again. He hated it, because he could feel his body to some degree. Whenever they changed his IV, he could feel his veins and that made him cringe. God he just wanted to wake up already.

"Did you know the little girl you saved made you a gift?" Hitoshi chuckled softly, and it made Riso want to smile. ***"It's a hair band. It's got painted flowers on it, and..I think that's a cat? I can't tell…She apparently said that your hair was always getting in your way so..she thought it would help. She also apologized that it wasn't as cool as yours."***

Oh, Eri. Riso wanted to cry. *I'd give anything in the world to see it.*

"It's purple. The base of it is. I was told you said it was your favorite color." Hitoshi let out a small breath, running his thumb along Riso's hand.

Of course purple is. It reminds me of one of the best things that's ever happened to me. Riso closed his eyes, relaxing his body. He had been so tense from yesterday from trying to wake up, he was out of energy to try. He just wanted to see Hitoshi, and Eri's gift. It wasn't fair to him. He had been so strong the entire time he was gone. He protected himself and Eri for a long period of time without letting doubt seep in. When was someone going to do that for him? When could he finally be the one protected?

Riso breathed through his nose slowly, too tired to even open his mouth. His face scrunched when he smelt the cleanliness of the room he was in. The stiff sheets, the latex from the gloves, the alcohol used to disinfect. He smelt it all and it made him sick.

Wait.

He smelt. He smelt the hospital. He *smelt* everything in the hospital room.

Riso took his next few actions slowly. He forced his eyelids open, his eyes aching from the overhead light. He couldn't move his head, but he slowly looked around the room. At first he saw the wall, then a few doctor things he really didn't care too much about. His heart fluttered when he laid eyes on Hitoshi. He could feel his head spin trying to force his eyes open even more to get a clear look at him. Hitoshi was holding his hand, his head hung low. Riso couldn't have been secretive if he tried, because the moment he got a glimpse of Hitoshi, his heart rate monitor ratted him out.

The increased beeping caused Hitoshi's head to shoot up. His eyes went wide and he stood up so fast the chair he was sitting in was knocked over from the momentum.

"Riso??"

Riso still couldn't open his mouth, but he managed a small smile. His eyes crinkled, and Hitoshi had tears come to his eyes.

"Oh my god, you're awake! Are you okay?? Do I need to get a doctor? Do you remember everything? Is something hurting??"

Riso blinked, and let out a shaky chuckle. Seeing Hitoshi so frazzled was cute, if he ignored the circumstances.

"...Are you laughing at me?" Hitoshi asked, staring in slight disbelief.

Riso barely nodded.

"Of course you are." Hitoshi gently cupped his face. "I'm so glad you're awake.." He ran his thumb back and forth on Riso's cheek. Riso stared blankly for a minute, before tears came to his eyes. He hadn't realized it, but he *did* have someone to protect him. Someone had been protecting him this entire time.

Hitoshi was protecting him.

"Hitoshi," Riso's raspy voice surprised himself, which then sent him into a coughing fit. Once it was over, he completely relaxed his head against the bed. Hitoshi kissed his forehead.

"Don't speak if it hurts. I..I'm going to go get a doctor, okay? And some water for you." Hitoshi says in a hushed tone. "Maybe turn down the lights too?"

"..Okay." Riso was glad he was gaining back normal functionality. Hitoshi left the room to do what he said just a moment ago, but he dimmed the lights before he left. Riso let out a soft sigh, rubbing the sheets under his hand in between his fingers. He was just glad he could feel again. He would be even more grateful if he could get up and walk, but he didn't expect to go

anywhere anytime soon. Riso figured his best bet was to lay how he was and not move. Last thing he wanted was to hurt himself more.

Riso didn't like how urgently the doctors opened the door. He followed their movements with his eyes, trying to calm the future panic attack he might have. A doctor grabbed the arm with the IV.

"Ah, let's see. How are you feeling?"

Riso suddenly wasn't in the hospital anymore. Those words sent him back to that small room. Chained to the wall, lifeless. He cringed when he remembered the pain from that night.

"Ah. Let's see." A voice said, grabbing Riso's jaw tightly, the gloved hand felt cool against his warm face. "How are you feeling?"

Shit. Sluggish. Suicidal. How are those answers for feelings?

"Go.." Riso gasped lightly, "Go to hell." He winced when a fist came in contact with his face once again. He already was basically slumped against the wall, unable to move. He could feel the amount of bruises and breaks in his skin weighing down his body. Blood dripped from his lips, and he used this opportunity to spit the pooling blood in his captors face.

"Now, now.." Overhaul hummed, wiping the staining liquid off his face. "We need to play nice, don't we? I'm the only one who can fix you. Unless..you want to die while slowly bleeding out? And what would dear Eri think.."

"Shut up." Riso growled, "Shut up. Why not just fucking kill me, you coward?"

"I have to make sure this bullet you've created is successful." Overhaul squatted, getting on Riso's level. He placed a hand in Riso's hair, pulling it away from his face. Riso's head tilted backwards, the warm lightning showcasing the amount of new wounds on his face. He scrunched his face in pain, knowing Overhaul didn't care how tight his grip was. "Hm. Eri?"

The door opened, a henchman walking forward with the little girl. A soft gasp escaped her lips when she saw Riso.

“Do I put him back together?” Overhaul asked, a sinister smile on his face. Though, it wasn’t visible due to his mask.

“Yes..!” Eri cried out, “Yes, I-”

“If I do, you’ll have to give up your healing. Yours to save him.”

“No.” Riso spoke, grunting. “No. She’s not giving anything for me. You sick bastard. Just leave me like this.”

“That settles it.” Overhaul stands. “Make him quiet.”

The last thing Riso saw was a fist coming towards his face.

Riso felt himself back in the present, mainly because Hitoshi was shaking him.

“Riso? Hey, are you okay?” Hitoshi asked softly, being gentle when grabbing his hand. “You..you kind of knocked out the doctor.”

“..I huh?” Riso looked to his right and his eyes widened, seeing a doctor beside his bedside held up by a few nurses and was actively being helped out of the room. “...Oh. I- I didn’t mean to,”

“At least now you’re sitting,” Hitoshi whispered. “Did..did you have a-”

“Nope. I’m fine. Just tired.” Riso interrupted Hitoshi, “Uh..where’s the thing Eri made me?”

“Oh! Right her-...Wait.” Hitoshi paused, looking at Riso. “You heard that?”

“Of course I did. I..heard it all.”

“All of it?”

“...Yeah. You know, if you really liked me that much,” Riso started, a teasing smile on his face. “What took you so long to say anything?”

“You do not get to say that!” Hitoshi huffs, “I thought you were gonna die.”

“You were literally told I’d wake up in at most two weeks.”

“You didn’t see how you looked, okay? You don’t get to tease me.”

“Oh yeah?”

“Yeah! I was really worried about you!”

“I know, you wouldn’t stop telling me that.”

Hitoshi paused and smiled. He let out a small laugh.

“I see your personality didn’t get lost.”

“Yeah, of course it didn’t.” Riso rolled his eyes. “C’mon, memory loss? What am I, a tragic story?”

“The doctors..They’re gonna need to check on you. I..is that okay?”

“I told Zuku to not bring me here,” Riso muttered, resting his back against the hospital bed that had been raised up for him. “I hate doctors.”

“I can be here the entire time?”

“..You should go home,” Riso glanced at Hitoshi. “Get a change of clothes or something.”

“Are you trying to get rid of me?”

“You haven’t showered in a week,” Riso rose an eyebrow. “You’re stinky. Go home and shower, heathen.”

Hitoshi laughed, squeezing Riso’s hand lightly. “Okay, I’ll go shower. I..I’m gonna be back, okay?”

“I have no doubt you’ll be back, Toshi.”

The world seemed to stand still for a moment. Although there was another doctor walking into the room, the two teenage boys had only one thing on their mind. Each other. Subconsciously, Hitoshi leaned forward lightly. His eyes flickered between Riso’s lips and eyes.

“Okay, kiddo. We need to start some tests.”

Hitoshi pulled back, almost startled. He cleared his throat. “I’ll..be back in an hour or two. Be safe..” Hitoshi waved, the door closing behind him.

Before Hitoshi could even pull out his phone to call Aizawa or Hizashi, he noticed Aizawa walking towards him.

“Dad? How are you here when-”

“The hospital informed me. I know you probably want to be back as soon as you can, so..I’m here to take you home. We have a stop to make first.”

Hitoshi found himself in the car, on the phone with Izuku. He was explaining everything he’d seen so far.

“So he’s heard everything? Is he okay though?? Does he remember us??”

“Yeah,” Hitoshi glanced out the window, watching the cars pass him. “He even said he told you not to bring him to a hospital so I think he’s a little upset at you.”

“...Of course he said that. Can Kacchan and I come with you when you come back to the hospital?”

“Stop acting like he’s not your friend. You can see him whenever.”

“I know, it’s just…I feel like there’s some unspoken words you two need to speak. You literally kissed before he went missing. Have either of you even said anything about that?”

“Um..” Flashbacks to when Hitoshi went to kiss Riso played in his mind. “No?”

“I swear to god, Deku- Give me the phone!”

“Kacchan, wait-”

“Insomanic, if you don’t fucking make a move on this guy, I’m going to lose my shit! You two are constantly fucking pinning the other, you share clothes, you fuckin’ kissed! What else is there to say, idiots?! Just make it official! Deku even told me about that dumb ass letter pinky-pie left you!”

Hitoshi blushed, covering his cheeks so Aizawa didn’t see.

“Don’t- I-”

“Hitoshi,” Aizawa looked over. “We’re here.”

“I gotta go guys. Sorry, we’ll be there to get you guys soon. See you then,”

“Bye!”

“Do it, insomniac!”

Hitoshi hung up, and as he was pocketing his phone he looked up. He paused, recognizing the cat cafe almost instantly. He glanced at Aizawa, who gave him a small smile.

“Well? Go get your cat.”

Hitoshi's eyes widened. He didn't waste another second as he ran into the cafe, and to the cat section. There stood a worker, who held Fluffball in their hands.

"Hitoshi?"

"Th-" Hitoshi cleared his throat. "That- is me."

"Here's your new cat!" They handed Fluffball over, and Hitoshi fought the urge to squeal. He held Fluffball close, petting his fur.

"Thank you so much,"

"Of course! I hope to see you and your boyfriend back here soon,"

Hitoshi blushed. "O-Oh, right, Heh. We'll do that-"

Hitoshi walked back to the car, mumbling compliments to Fluffball. He was *so* bringing him to see Riso.

After reaching the dorms, taking the well needed shower, and picking up Bakugo and Izuku, they were back at the hospital within two hours. Hitoshi carried Fluffball in his hands as he walked to Riso's hospital room. He didn't need to stop and get a visitor badge, since most of the staff had grown to know his face the past week.

He opened the door, only to see Nemuri talking with Riso.

"Oh! Sorry, I can-"

“IsthatFluffballohmygoodnesscomEHERE” (Is that Fluffball, oh my goodness comE HERE). Riso reached his arms out, and Fluffball jumped from Hitoshi’s arms. He jumped onto the bed, and curled into a ball on Riso’s lap as he pet him.

“Hey, kiddo.” Nemuri smiled. “I’ve been talking to him long enough. I’ll just be outside.”

“Okay. Thanks, Miss Midnight..!” Hitoshi waved as she walked out. He turned back to Riso, who was still looking at Fluffball.

“How’d you get him to come from the cafe? Do they allow that?”

“I adopted him.”

“Aizawa approved the request??”

“..Guess you heard that-”

“Of course I did!! Oh, so he’s ours now??”

“..O-ours?”

“Well, duh. He loves the both of us, so we’re clearly his parents.”

“..I..I guess so.”

…

“Hey, I-”

“Listen, we-”

The two spoke at the same time, and laughed when they noticed.

“You first,” Hitoshi said softly.

“No, what were you gonna say?”

“Um..Well, I..Riso, I think we should-”

“RISO” Izuku opened the door, and ran to his bedside almost immediately. He hugged Riso tight. “You’re okay!”

“Hey, Zuku..! It’s nice to see you..! Are you okay? I heard you lost your quirk..”

“It’s a long story, but that’s not why we’re here. We’re here for you!”

“Alright, alri-”

“DAMN PINKY-PIE, IF YOU SCARE IZUKU LIKE THIS AGAIN-” Bakugo stormed in, arms crossed angrily. Riso blinked.

“Sorry, who..” Riso glanced around. “Who are you?”

There was silence. Everyone in the room seemed surprised, and Bakugo was the first to speak.

“..You- don’t remember me?”

“I’m just kidding! How could I ever forget you, blasty?” Riso smirked, laughing. “Who could forget that ugly mug of yours?”

“Oh, fuck off!”

Chapter End Notes

i feel like this ending was crap but..on our way to recovery!

updates wednesdays and sundays

Chapter Fifty One

Chapter Summary

Riso is still stuck in the hospital when a nurse informs him on some of her concerns.

Chapter Notes

happy new year guys! hope u liked the chapter, it's setting up a few things for future chapters!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

The hospital was quiet, or at least Riso's room was. His eyes were cracked open as he tiredly counted the marks on the ceiling tiles. He hadn't slept since he woke up. He was worried that if he tried to sleep, he wouldn't wake back up. It was also the first night he was alone since everything happened. He made Hitoshi and his friends promise to go home now that he was safe, his main reasoning being 'If I can't leave, I at least want you guys too.'

He regretted that.

Even when Hitoshi left the room when Riso wasn't awake, he at least knew he was coming back. That wasn't the case this time. He was alone and no one would come to him if he called, not for at least an hour. Being alone had much more impact on him than what he thought. It reminded him of the nights when Eri wouldn't come back for the night, how it meant Riso was needed.

See, whenever they needed information from Riso, Eri wouldn't be pulled away right before. She was a smart kid, so they had to isolate her the day before. That became obvious to her as well, but there was only so much they could prevent her from figuring out. Something they wanted from him was how to make the quirk destroying bullets *faster* . The night he was kidnapped was the same night they had Riso come up with a model and a way to do it.

"It's only a hypothetical. If you tell us, we'll patch you up, then let you go after."

Some lie to fall for. Riso had sustained multiple injuries that made him unable to move on his own. The concussion he had also made it hard for him to properly think. So, of course Riso gave them a ‘hypothetical’ blueprint. He didn’t know he’d be the cause of a little girl’s greatest trauma. The only thing Riso managed to do was make the blueprint for something that would take at least a month to finish. He was capable of making the process much faster, but he didn’t want this villain to know that.

Although the quirk ‘confession’ was used on him, he still managed to restrain the information he knew. With the help of his own quirk, and training with Hitoshi to strengthen his brainwashing quirk, it wasn’t that hard. Riso had built up a resistance to a quirk’s ability to control him or his actions. He’d never be able to do that to quirks like Eraser’s.

Besides all of this, they still wanted a way to make the process faster so they could mass produce. So, Eri would be taken away. Riso would then be boarderlined tortured for a minimum of two hours. Not once did he give in and tell them what they wanted to hear to make the pain stop. The only time he ever cracked was when Eri’s life was threatened. He’d give anything for that girl’s safety, including access to something that could potentially cause world domination. He already felt responsible for her pain to begin with, so he would do his best to protect her anyway he could.

Being alone in the hospital was brutal. He was already worried about not waking up if he fell asleep, but as the night went on, he grew paranoid about whether Overhaul was going to walk in or not. He felt unsafe. He wanted to cry, scream. He wanted to be held and told he didn’t have to be afraid.

He almost broke out into a sob when a nurse opened the door. He let out a quiet, noticeable sigh as she walked over to him.

“Ah, rough night?” Her voice was soft and delicate. She obviously had been working a long shift.

“A little.” Riso admitted, glancing at the IV in his arm. “You too?”

“Yeah.” She looked at Riso with tired eyes. “I’m going to change your IV bag. Is that alright?”

“Mmhm.” Riso nodded. He was silent for a few moments.

“You’re that kid, right?” She asked, unhooking the bag from the stand. “That got kidnapped by the Hassaikai?”

“...Um,” Riso gulped. “Yeah. U-Unless you mean Eri.”

“I mean you. Riso Sakusei.” She chuckled. “I did your second set of vitals once you were stable. I..wanted to ask you something.”

“..Okay.”

“Your scars, the..ones on your face. The few on your chest.” She finished the IV. She turned her body to face Riso. “They’re all self-treated. Why didn’t you go to a hospital? You could’ve gotten a severe infection from them. Especially the one on your chest right here.” She gently placed her hand on her own stomach, showing him which wound she was talking about.

Ah, the one from his fight with Stain. One of the worst ones.

“Uh..Bad timing?” Riso offered. “It was just…inconvenient.”

“I..also read your medical file.”

Oh, shit. Don’t bring it up.

“Broken bones, burns, bruises, cuts. All from a young age, up until your teen years. Then you haven’t been since being found after Hosu’s incident.”

“Right. I was just a clumsy kid.”

“You and I both know that’s not true. I understand if you don’t want to speak about it, kid. I just..your last name seemed familiar. I saw a kid two weeks ago. Kaizen Sakusei. He had a mild concussion, and bruises were found on his arms.”

Riso sat up more. He looked at the nurse. “Kaizen? I..that’s my brother.”

“I believe what your parents did to you, are doing it to him as well. I know UA has a dorm system and that’s why you’re not at home. But before I made any report, I was trying to contact an existing family member. You were the only one I could find.”

Riso pressed his lips together. He wasn’t there when Kaizen was born, and he told himself he’d never get involved because of what his parents did to him. But his baby brother was going to have the same childhood he did. The same childhood he thought was normal.

“I- what can I do for him?” Riso tapped his fingers against the thin blanket.

“...Don’t worry about him right now, dear.” She gave a small smile. “I’ll figure something out, you just get some rest.”

Get rest after that? Yeah. Sure.

Surprisingly, he did. It wasn’t necessarily voluntary rest, he ended up passing out from exhaustion. He didn’t wake until after noon the following day. There was a note on his lap when he did wake.

Dad and I are going to get Fluffball checked out at the vet. Izuku wanted to come to, so he's with us. I'm sorry I wasn't there when you woke up. Bakugo should be there after he finishes his remedial course today.

- H♡

Riso sat up slowly. The nurse from the night before was writing on a clipboard. He cleared his throat.

"Um..excuse me," Riso said quietly. "I never caught your name."

"Oh! Good morning, Riso. My name is Mia," She looked just as tired as she did last night.

"So..Kaizen," Riso rubbed the back of his neck. "Can I..Is there any way I can get a file on him?"

"Well, you are family. I..can try. But I'm serious, this is something you should not be worrying about. Especially considering your condition."

"I don't care. It's still my brother. Please?"

"..I'll be right back." Mia promptly left the room. Riso rested his head against the bed. Subconsciously, he was taking to this situation so strongly because it was a distraction. It was a distraction from himself, his feelings, his pain. He always found a distraction. It was harder this time because he had been stuck in a hospital. The door opened.

"Alright, this..is everything." She handed him a manilla folder, "All his medical records from his birth."

"Why are you helping me?" Riso asked, "I mean, trying to help my brother so much.."

“Heroes now days really don’t take care of families or family abusive situations, and..I’m just trying to prevent something bad from happening.”

“You’re a kid of abuse, aren’t you?”

“...So were you. I guess we both understand what it’s like. You’d do the same if you could.”

“Of course I would.” *I already have.*

The door opened again, this time Bakugo stepped in.

“I don’t want to babysit you, but here I fucking am.”

“Oh shut up, you’re so dramatic. You know you love me.” Riso smirked, closing the folder. “How was class?”

“Shut up.”

“C’mon, I’m only curious.”

“Are you teasing me?”

“Maybe. The blasty I knew never would’ve failed such a big exam.”

“I don’t care if you’re in a damn hospital, I’ll fight you right now.”

“Sure you will! I bet I’m still better than you.”

“In your condition? No fucking way.”

“Oh yeah?” Riso went to stand from the bed, but Mia stopped him.

“Alright boys, you can fight with one another once he recovers.”

“Awh, no fun.” Riso pouted. Bakugo scoffed. Mia then left the two alone. There was a brief moment of silence.

“Deku was worried about you.”

“You know I heard what you told me, right? All those times you thought you were alone.” Riso glanced at Bakugo. “For your information, I wasn’t getting weak or letting you win. I was just resting for our next battle.”

Translating their complicated way of communicating, Bakugo was worried and Riso was reassuring him he was fine. That’s the only thing they needed to say to each other to understand. Sure, it seemed like all they did was fight, but behind those cruel words were nice ones. Bakugo would be lying to himself it he didn’t admit he was worried sick about Riso. He used Izuku as a way to say ‘I was worried’ without *actually* saying it. But, Riso knew what he really meant.

“Pinky-pie, when the hell are you going to ask out insomniac?”

“When you start calling him by his name, dumbass.” Riso couldn’t hide his reddening face.

“Fuck that.” Bakugo rolled his eyes. “But you two fucking pinning each other is pissin’ me off.”

“Uh huh.” Riso smirks. “Or..you just wanna see us happy?”

“Nope. Not it.”

“That’s exactly it!”

“No! God, you’re so fucking stubborn!”

Riso paused. He felt his head spin. He didn’t expect those words to send him back to his time at the Hassaikai. Some repressed memories come to him with only a simple phrase.

“You’re so fucking stubborn! Just tell us what the hell we need to know!” A henchman called out to Riso, who had him by the shirt collar. He was already bloody and bruising, he was unable to lift his head on his own.

“We gotta get the boss to put him back together again.”

“Good idea. We can beat him some more. C’mon.”

The men left the room, leaving Riso slumped on the ground. He used all his energy to roll onto his back. He tried to regulate his breathing, the last thing he needed was to cry or have a panic attack. He felt his heart drop when he recognized Eri’s footsteps coming towards the room. He heard the door crack open and there was a small gasp. He mentally cursed himself when he felt her little hands wrap around his.

“Mister Riso sir..! I’m so sorry..!” Her voice was enough to make Riso break out in tears.

“Eri,” Riso’s voice was hoarse. “It’s okay. Can you help me sit up, kiddo..?”

“Mmhm..!”

With Eri’s help, Riso was now sat up. He leaned against the wall, sighing. He was taken back when Eri wrapped her arms around his neck.

Riso was thrown back to reality with shaky hands and tears running down his face. He felt paralyzed. Sounds around him were amplified, his vision was cloudy.

“..so! Pinky-pie! Hey, can you hear me..? Did you just- have like a flashback or something??” Bakugo asked worriedly, standing as close to Riso as the hospital bed would allow him.

“Sorry.” Riso wiped his tears. “I’m so sorry, I-”

Riso’s words were cut short by Bakugo doing something completely unexpected. He had leaned forward, and *hugged* Riso tightly. Riso only tensed for a moment, but he wrapped his arms around Bakguo slowly. A few seconds later, Riso bursted into more tears.

He needed that hug more than Bakugo could ever know.

Chapter End Notes

bakugo and riso's friendship is fr one of my most favorite things! also love mia, she's a sweetheart. anyway hope u guys liked it!

updates wednesdays and sundays!

Chapter Fifty Two

Chapter Summary

Riso is finally released from the hospital!

Chapter Notes

oof- another early upload! posting this at like 2am cause i just finished the chapter. i would just like to say there's probably not going to be a lot of canon left in this story- i'll explain more at the end notes! love u guys and enjoy :)

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Riso was permitted to leave the hospital, as long as he was monitored frequently. Hitoshi had told him that the entire class had an after school training session, so he wouldn't be able to be there when he got out. Nemuri would be driving him to the dorms, whenever he was ready. He couldn't be ready enough.

He got help from Mia to stand, as he hadn't stood in a while. She also helped him change into normal clothing. He glanced at Mia, who was currently placing a few things in a bag for him to leave with. He noticed the manilla folder in the bag.

"Riso," Mia turned and looked at him. "You can't do anything drastic."

"Huh?" Riso locked eyes with her. "What do you mean?"

"You're still recovering. I don't want you to try to go find your brother to save him. You are hurt. I really don't want to see you back here any time soon."

"I wasn't going to do anything." *Damn, she's good.*

“You’re all set. Is there anything else you want to do before your guardian gets here?”

“Oh, uh..Midnight’s not-”

“Answer the question.”

“Uhm..I’d like to see Eri.” Riso glanced at the hairband he had been fiddling with. “If that’s possible.”

“Follow me.”

Riso walked through the hospital, hating how every person he passed turned to look at him. He wasn’t a miracle story, he wasn’t a hero, he didn’t want all this attention and looks. He gently tapped his fingers together in a pattern, trying to calm his nerves. The sound of whispers grated his ears. He wanted to go home.

Riso stopped in front of Eri’s hospital door. Mia motioned him to walk in, and he slowly opened the door. He was surprised to see that there were no doctors or nurses in her room. Why would they leave her alone? Were they so scared of a little girl’s quirk that they were treating her like some kind of villain? She’s a child, and she shouldn’t be alone during such hard times.

“Eri?” Riso asked softly, walking closer to her bed. He felt his heart fill with warmth when she looked up at him. Her eyes sparkled and she scrambled to get up from her bed. Riso squatted to be at her height, and by the time he planted his feet comfortably, she was running towards him. She wrapped her arms around his neck, holding him tightly.

“Mister Riso!”

“You don’t have to call me that, sweetheart.” Riso hugged back. After a few seconds, they pulled from each other. “Are you doing okay?”

“Um..” Eri rocked back and forth on her feet. “Yeah. Are you?”

“I’m standing, aren’t I?”

“Is your hair still in the way..?” Her voice was gentle. She looked up at Riso with curious, dull eyes.

“Thanks to you,” Riso held up the headband. “I don’t think it’ll be a problem.”

“You got my gift..!” There was a sparkle in her eye for a moment.

“Of course I did.” Riso ruffled her hair. “Say, I gotta go home now. But how about I come back tomorrow to see you?”

“..You don’t gotta do that..”

“For you, I will. Maybe I’ll bring Hitoshi around.” Riso gave her a small smile. “How about another cool gadget too?”

“Thank you,” Eri whispered, hanging her head. He knew she was grateful, but it was hard for her to show it. Riso gave her a quick hug, and said his goodbyes. He walked out to the hallway, following Mia to the entrance of the hospital. He motioned for her to leave, knowing all he had to do was just wait for Nemuri now.

He sat on the front steps, bag in hand. He placed it on the concrete, opening it after a moment of hesitation. He pulled out the folder containing all of Kaizen’s medical records. His thumb glided over the picture paper-clipped to the papers behind it. He slid it from under the thin

metal, closing the folder. He placed the folder back into the bag, his eyes focused on the picture.

Kaizen would be around two years old now. He felt guilty for not knowing exactly how old his younger brother was, but it wasn't his fault. He left when his mother was still pregnant, and when he saw Kaizen that one time with Izuku, he had to have been at least close to a year. It's been a while since then. It felt so long ago that he saw Kaizen in the hands of his mother. The Sakusei's, a perfect family, a great son. He was bitter that his mother, Anshin, decided to name her second born Kaizen, which meant 'improvement'. Of course. Riso's younger brother was an *improvement* . An improvement from the gay son they were given.

Riso studied the picture. His brother had his hair, a bright pink that stood out from the dark surroundings. Instead of the white strip like Riso had, he had something that looked like white highlights. His hair was still too short to be grown over his eyes like Riso's, but it sure had the same texture. Kaizen was clutching a stuffed animal in the picture, a smile on his face. His parents were off to the side, standing next to each other. They were smiling, and looked happy. After staring at it for a while, Riso noticed the small things in the picture.

On a countertop in the background, there laid a few broken mugs. There was a coffee stain on the light marble. A few picture frames were cracked and taped together with clear tape, that only barely had a glare. You would've missed them if the flash wasn't on. Kaizen's sweater was also torn, and way too big for him. The excess of the sweater was pushed behind him, but how it laid around his neckline showed it wasn't his size.

Riso froze. He remembered that sweater. It was his when he was eight, one he wore until he couldn't because he was too big. The sweater was in no condition to be worn by anyone. So why was Kaizen wearing it? Riso tapped his finger on the photo, furrowing his eyebrows. He also noticed slight bruising on his collarbone, which was barely visible from the oversized sweater.

"Riso?"

Riso's head snapped up, his adrenaline rushing through his veins. He takes a breath when he realizes it was just Nemuri.

"Yeah?" Riso pocketed the picture.

“You ready?”

“If it means I can get a cup of coffee and sleep in my own blankets? Yes. More than ever.”

Nemuri laughed lightly, shaking her head. Riso walked with her to her car, and the two sat in comfortable silence for the majority of the ride.

“..Hey, kid?” Nemuri asked about thirty minutes into the drive.

“Hm?”

“You doing okay?” Nemuri glanced at him. “I know you went through a lot.”

“I’m alright.” Riso leaned his head against the car window. “Do we have to talk about it?”

“Yes. You were kidnapped, tortured, and-”

“Forced to make a weapon that can wipe out the entirety of hero society?”

“...I..guess when you put it like that,”

“I’d rather just ignore all of that right now.” Riso muttered. “Focus on the positives.”

“Okay. We can do that.” Nemuri hummed. “Are you going to ask out-”

“Okayletsmoveon-” Riso’s face turned beat red.

“Aw, c’mon!”

“I..I want to. But everything is- just all messed up. It’s not right to ask.”

“I personally think there’s no better time than now. Yeah? Take a risk?”

“Says the old woman who can’t keep a person to stay.” Riso sassed.

Nemuri gasped. “You did not just say that to me!”

“I sure did!”

“I’m so offended! How dare you disrespect me in such manner?!”

Riso let out a laugh. A genuine one. His laugh instantly lit up the car, and Nemuri couldn’t help but smile at the sight. After a while, they finally reached the dorms. Nemuri helped Riso up the steps, since the doctors had told her over the phone that he needed to be careful. Riso had a firm grip on his bag when he pushed the door open. He squinted, trying to look into the dark common room. He fiddled for the light switch. He flipped it on.

“WELCOME HOME!” The entirety of Class 1A, and a few other Class 1B students, exclaimed. There was a long banner, and everyone was wearing light toned clothing. Party hats and streamers covered the room. Sato had even made a cake.

Riso stared in shock, dropping his bag. He felt his muscles tense when a confetti popper went off.

“...I’m gonna cry.” Was the only words he could get out of his mouth before he was tackled in a hug. First was Kirishima, who led the group hug. The pressure of over twenty kids helped calm the rising anxiety he had. He did his best to hug back. Once the hug broke, mostly everyone said a few ‘get well soon’ ‘glad you’re okay’ before running off to their own groups. Hitoshi and Riso were the last two standing in front of each other. Hitoshi held Fluffball in his hands, petting him slowly.

“..Here,” Hitoshi held his hand out. He opened his palm, revealing the necklace Riso had given him before he went missing.

“See, I told you I’d be back for it.” Riso gently grabbed it, flipping it in his hand. He placed it around his neck.

“..I got your letter.” Hitoshi admitted. Riso then noticed the custom hoodie he had made for Hitoshi. Hitoshi was wearing it. He saw the letter. *Oh fuck.*

“Toshi, we- should talk outside.”

Riso and Hitoshi walked out on the front steps of the dorm building, leaving Fluffball inside. The two stared at each other for a moment.

“Do you want to be together?” Riso asked, seemingly blurting it out. Hitoshi blushed, his gaze trained on the ground.

“To..Together?”

“As in, boyfriends. Um..dating. Do you want to go out with me? And..us be dating.” Riso picked at his nails, nervously trying to read Hitoshi’s emotions. He looked up, a soft smile on his face.

Hitoshi leaned forward, gently cupping the right side of Riso’s face. He pressed their lips together. Riso kissed back, the two of them melting into each other’s embrace. Kissing

without a life or death situation behind them was *a lot* better. The kiss lasted a few seconds, before Riso pulled away slowly.

"..Is that a yes-?" He asked, slight confusion lining his voice.

Hitoshi let out a laugh, pressing their foreheads together. "Yes, Riso. It's a yes."

"FINALLY. GOD DAMNIT YOU TWO WERE TAKING WAY TOO DAMN LONG!" Bakugo's voice came from a window behind the two, to which they looked. They then broke out in a fit of laughter.

"C'mon, we should get back to the others." Hitoshi says, intertwining their fingers.

"Right, of course." Riso nodded. He paused. "Oh crap, does his mean Aizawa could become my father-in-law?"

"Yep! You signed up for this."

"Damnit!"

The welcoming party went by smoothly. Riso talked and caught up with most of the class, doing the same with some of the teachers. It was an eventful night. He got released from the hospital, found out his brother's entire medical history, got a boyfriend, and managed to only have one panic-inducing flashback. Needlessly to say, he was exhausted. He laid in his bed, facing the ceiling. He groaned, turning on his side. His eyes ran over the clean room, the light of the moon illuminated the space. His eyes stopped when he spotted his Cosmic gear. He slowly sat up, looking at his hands, then the gear.

Riso brushed off his body once the gear was properly fitted to him. He pulled the picture of Kaizen from his clothes that lay on the floor. He grabbed his staff, twirling it in his hand. He smirked a little, throwing it into his other hand.

I'm only going to check on Kaizen. Nothing more! Just to check on my kid brother. I'm not gonna do anything dangerous. I mean, I can hardly feel the pain thanks to that stupid medicine they gave me.

Riso pulled the mask above his nose. This time, to push his hair back, he used Eri's headband. He threw his hood on, and he opened his window. He slipped through it, and started out in a jog. He let his speed increase, and just when he flipped out his staff he came to a quick stop. He was barely able to stop himself from running in the figure that was in his path.

"The fuck are you doing?"

"Blasty, hey..!" Riso rubbed the back of his neck. "..Funny seeing you hear."

"You just got out of the damn hospital. What are you fucking doing? Are you an idiot??"

"Look, I'm not going out to- help random people! My brother, he might be in danger." Riso reached into his pocket, pulling out the picture. He handed it to Bakugo. "I'm worried my parents are gonna turn him into…well, a 'scar-face' like me."

"...I don't care." Bakugo looked at the photo. He huffed, looking at Riso. "You should go back."

"I can't."

"Fucking- god damnit! Fine. But I'm coming with, you fucking hear me? Don't make me have to save you."

"Yes! Thank you. We'll just check in on them."

“I’m still telling your boyfriend about this.”

“..Fair enough."

Chapter End Notes

so!! to explain what i meant in the starting notes, i'm not gonna be writing the war arc in this fic. there's a lot of things i'd have to change but i'm not really up for that :p anyway! i was thinking of ending this fic sometime after the school festival when class 1A does that concert? so alot of the content from now won't have much canon activity, which means more riso time. i hope to see riso heal completely, or mostly, and i want to see the same for izuku also! maybe even a peek in the future before its officially over? i could even do like christmas or halloween stuff once it's over. idk, its up to what you guys want to see really!

ALSO THE BOYS ARE FINALLY TOGETHER?! AFTER SO LONG?!

updates wednesdays and sundays!

Chapter Fifty Three

Chapter Summary

Riso and Bakugo take a trip across town to check in on Riso's younger brother.

Chapter Notes

hopefully you guys like this chapter! if not, eh, oh well. enjoy!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

“Why are you making me walk? Running and jumping is so much easier-” Riso rolled his eyes, crossing his arms. He looked at Bakugo.

“It’s dangerous. You don’t need to be any more hurt than you are.” Bakugo adjusted the hood he had on. It sat uncomfortably against his hair, but he had to mask his identity to some degree.

“You’re killing me.” Riso whined.

“And you’re killing yourself by doing dumb shit.”

“Not true.”

“Do you honestly think you could jump from building to building right now?”

“Yes. I do!”

“Then you’re stupid.”

“No, you’re stupid.”

“Fuck off.”

The two bickered back and forth as they walked the streets, which were lit by the moon and a few streetlights. It was rather empty considering they left the main part of the city, and walking around a neighborhood full of smaller houses.

“Pinky-pie,” Bakugo started. “Why go after your brother? I thought you left all of your previous life behind.”

“The nurse showed me his medical records. He’s been severely abused, he’s only just learning how to talk I imagine. It’s not right. I..just wanted to check on him. You know? He doesn’t deserve that life.” Riso admitted, not looking at Bakugo. “I lived that life, and it..it’s pretty bad.”

“How do you plan on helping him? Throwing him in foster care? Won’t that just be more traumatizing?”

“I don’t know. I really don’t know.”

“..Look at that. You don’t know something. That’s a first.”

“Shut up.”

Riso stopped on the sidewalk, looking at the house to the right of him. The light on the porch was dim, and flickered occasionally. Riso took a small breath, when Bakuo placed a hand on his shoulder.

“I’m right here. We’ll kick your parents asses together.”

“Thanks, Blasty.”

Walking up the driveway was harder for Riso than he thought. Everything in his body was screaming at him to turn around and run for the hills. He inched closer, peering in a window. He was surprised to see his parents still up, since it was closer to one in the morning.

“Anshin, we can’t just get rid of Kaizen. He’s our miracle baby.”

“Everyday he looks more and more like that stupid- failure of a son we had! I can’t look at our baby and *not* see him. He talks just like him too! Oto I can’t stand the way he looks at me.”

“He’s a kid. You're his mother.”

“What if he ends up like him? And..and he destroys this family!”

“I don’t want that either, but we’ll raise him right this time. We won’t let him do other things he did.”

“..They’re talking about you.” Bakugo muttered, “They can’t even speak your name.”

“They probably forgot it.” Riso glanced at Bakugo. “They never liked me. I was smarter than them.”

“Damnit, Oto! I can’t stand him! Why couldn’t we have had a girl?!”

“I don’t fucking know. That’s not on me! And if it wasn’t for your mother’s intelligence quirk they inherited, we wouldn’t be here! We would have normal kids!”

“It’s not right. How could our son ever help someone if he ends up a homosexual? He can’t!”

“..Mama? Dada?” Kaizen’s body appeared in the doorway. “What’s a..homo..sexual?”

“A very bad person.” Oto growled. “The fuck are you doing out of your room?”

“Yelling..” Kaizen wiped his eyes.

“Yeah, because of you. You’re the cause of all of our fucking problems, you know that?”

“I..I sorry, mama. I try..to be good.”

“Well you’re fucking horrible at it!” Anshin walked over to Kaizen and roughly grabbed him by the arm. She pulled him over to the couch, and slapped him so hard she made his neck turn as far as it could. Tears welled in his eyes, but he didn’t let out a noise. The tear just slowly rolled down his cheek.

Riso was hit with a memory.

Riso sat in the living room, hugging a teddy bear as he stared at the broken TV. He had watched his father shatter the screen in a fit of anger, blaming Riso for it. He had sat still the entire time, his eyes forward. If he had looked in his direction, blinked too hard, or even twitched, he’d be screamed at. He held his ripped bear in his arms tightly, fidgeting with his shaky hands.

“You ungrateful little shit.” Oto said aloud, pacing back and forth. “Why the hell would you do that?”

“Do what, dad?” Riso’s voice was stiff, uneasy. He seemed nervous to even speak.

“You made me break the TV! If you had just listened to me-”

“I didn’t do anything.”

“You’re causing us so many fucking problems! We’re in debt because of you! Your mother is working hard and you’re being a fucking baby!”

“I’m six.”

“I don’t care. Start pulling your damn weight. Give me that damn bear.” Oto leaned down and slapped Riso, then took the bear when it fell from his hands. Tears reached his eyes, but Riso wiped them aggressively. He didn’t let a single one fall.

“The fuck? Did I give you permission to wipe your damn tears??”

“I-”

Oto backhanded Riso again, but this time grabbed both his arms. “Wipe them now. I dare you.” His grip was going to bruise his skin.

“Pinky-pie?” Bakugo asked, nudging Riso. “Hey, dude. You okay?”

“Yeah.” Riso blinked, not able to tear his eyes away from Kaizen. “Hold this.” Riso handed Bakugo his backpack.

“The fuck do I look like?” Bakugo asked, but took it anyway.

Riso passed a few windows, and then stopped at one. He used the crowbar that was still in his hands to pry the window open. He climbed in slowly, landing silently on the damaged wood flooring.

“What the hell are-” Bakugo was shushed.

“Stay there. I’ll be right back.”

Riso took a few steps into the hallway, staying low to the ground. He took slow and quiet breaths. He peeked his head around the corner, watching for his parents. He waited until they walked towards the kitchen. He let out a low whistle, causing Kaizen to whip around quickly. Riso pulled his mask down and smiled at him. He waved him forward. Kaizen glanced between his parents and Riso, before hurrying over to him.

“Hey there, little guy.” Riso says in a whisper. “Are you-”

Riso was almost knocked on his ass from Kaizen leaning forward and hugging him.

“Star boy!” Kaizen’s voice was nothing above a whisper also. “You..came. I knew-you..come! Save me. Yes?”

“..That’s right..” Riso hugged back. “Star boy is here to save you. Do you have anything you *really* want to take with you?”

“My bubba’s sweater! You gots to get it.”

“Is it in your room?” Riso stood, still holding Kaizen. “Let’s go get it.”

Riso walked into Kaizen's room. His heart instantly ached. His mattress was tattered and grimy, no bed frame keeping it off the ground. There were dirty diapers in the corner, which had to be at least a few months old. Riso reached his bed and picked up the sweater that was laying there. Kaizen reached towards a picture.

"..What? Do you want this?" Riso grabbed a framed picture. He paused. It was the press picture from when he won the sports festival. How does Kaizen even know he exists? His parents hated him. "Here you go."

Riso walked back to the hallway, and reached the window.

"Is that the fucking kid?"

"Watch your language." Riso warned. "Kaizen, this *nice* man is going to hold you while I come through the window. Okay?"

"Otay."

Once handed over, Riso climbed through the window. He shut it and grabbed Kaizen again. Bakugo glared at him, but didn't say anything. As they started on their journey back to the dorms, Riso did everything he could to distract Kaizen from the situation at hand. He jumped when the phone in his pocket buzzed. He pulled it out and cursed to himself. It was Aizawa.

"Hey, sir." Riso answered. "Is- hah, is there something wrong?"

"Where the hell are you. It's almost two in the morning."

"I couldn't sleep, so..I went out for a jog!"

"I'm supposed to believe that?"

“Blasty- I mean, Bakugo is here with me?”

“Oh, is he? Put him on the phone.”

Riso handed the phone to Bakguo, who looked ready to blow a fuse.

“What?”

…

“Yeah, we’re on a run.”

…

“No. We’re not doing vigilante shit. I wouldn’t let him if he wanted to.”

…

“We’ll turn around now. Sorry, sensei.” Bakugo hung up the phone, hanging it back to Riso. “I can’t believe you! I just lied to Aizawa for you.”

“For my brother.” Riso ran his fingers through Kaizen’s hair. He had fallen asleep a few minutes before the phone call.

“Whatever! You owe me.”

“I know.”

“Where are we bringing him?”

“To the dorms.”

“Are you crazy??”

“Shush!”

“..Are you crazy. You can’t bring him there.”

“I can. And I will. Taking him to the hospital does nothing. I take him here, Aizawa sees the abuse, he *can* do something. Get someone to look after him. A hero maybe? I don’t know. I can’t let him go back there, Blasty.”

“..Fine.”

Riso set Kaizen down at the tree line before the turn to the dorm building. He brushed some of Kaizen’s hair out of his face. He smiled lightly, rubbing his cheek.

“Hey, Kaizen. I..I need you to do me a big favor.”

“Uh huh..?”

“My partner and I are gonna leave you here. You have to go up to that building over there, knock on the door real loud.” Riso motioned to the dorms. “You have to wait just a little bit, okay? We have to get away so no one catches us.”

“But..I-I’ll be alone.”

“...Your brother is in there.” Riso said cautiously. “But you can’t run over there now, or you won’t find him. You also can’t say..say that Cosmic brought you.”

“I..I be brave!” Kaizen nods, pulling the bear closer.

“Okay. Thank you so much. You are already so, so brave. You have to say you followed two people here. You’ll see them walk by soon.” Riso and Bakugo hesitantly left Kaizen standing there. They began walking towards the dorms.

Before they got any closer to the dorms, Riso held his bag out in front of him. He dug through his bag, and began to pull off his Cosmic hood.

“I’m going to change. So it’s believable we went for a run.”

“Out here? Are you stupid?”

“...Yeah. Now put your hood in here.” Riso also removed his sweater and gloves. He threw the backpack into the trees, walking up to the doors. He opened the door, and there stood an angry Aizawa, concerned Hitoshi, and a worried Izuku. He opened the door a little more to reveal Bakugo. “See? I’m back.”

“You had us worried!” Izuku said, crossing his arms. “Especially Hitoshi!”

“I know, I’m sorry.” Riso was pulled into a hug by Hitoshi.

“Don’t scare me like that. I thought you had went out and did something stupid.”

“..I’d never.”

“That’s a lie, and you know it.” Hitoshi huffed, pulling from the hug. “C’mon, you guys get in here.”

Riso and Bakugo walked inside. As the two of them were hounded with questions, there was a soft knock on the door. Riso glanced at Bakugo, who was seemingly glaring at him. Aizawa opens the door, and paused.

“..Kid? How did you-”

“..Um..my brother. Here. He’s here.”

“Who’s your brother..? How did you even-” Aizawa squatted down to Kaizen’s level.

“I..I saw people. I follow! Brought me here..and..brother is here.”

“Kid, slow down. Who’s your brother?” Aizawa seemingly knew already, considering the kid’s bright pink hair. He glanced back, opening the door. Everyone looked over, and Kaizen’s eyes lit up.

“Bubba!” Kaizen ran past everyone, and hugged Riso’s legs.

“..Hey, Kaizen.” Riso squatted and hugged him. “You okay, buddy?”

“I am now..! I gots to tell you a secret!”

“Okay, not now. Why are you here?”

“Mama and dada are..bad. Being mean.”

“You’re okay, buddy.” Riso looked at Aizawa, who sighed.

“He stays here tonight, then goes to the hospital in the morning.” Aizawa pinched the bridge of his nose. “Everyone to bed.”

“Hey, can you take him to my dorm?” Riso looks at Hitoshi. “I’ll be just a moment.”

“Yeah, of course. Hey, kiddo? Let’s go to bubba’s room.” Hitoshi left with Kaizen. Riso approached Bakugo, and huffed.

“Look, I’m sorry. I don’t mean to make you lie, or..make you cover for me. It’s just- it’s my brother. And I’m trying so hard to prevent bad stuff from happening.” Riso put a hand to his forehead, without moving his hair.

“Hey.” Bakugo stopped him. “Shut up. I’ll do this once, so you’ll quit worrying. He’s family, blah blah, all that sappy shit. Just don’t make me lie again, pinky-pie.”

“..Thank you.”

In Riso’s room, Hitoshi was sat on the floor. He watched as Kaizen fiddled with the bear. He tilted his head slightly, smiling.

“How did you know Riso was here?”

“I was telled.” Kaizen lifted the bear's arms.

“Who told you?”

“Star boy! He saved me too.”

“..Star boy?”

“Uh-huh! He got the lines on his face.”

“..Cosmic. Cosmic saved you?”

“Yeah! He’s my favorite! I knew he save me.”

“..I’m glad you’re safe.”

Hitoshi stood as the door opened, watching Riso walk in. He followed him with his eyes as he sat on the bed and rubbed his temples.

“..Let’s get you down for bed, huh? It’s been a long day.” Hitoshi grabbed Kaizen, and looked at Riso. “Is he sleeping in your bed?”

“Hm?” Riso looked up. “Oh, yeah. He..he can sleep here.” Riso stood, watching as Hitoshi sat Kaizen on the bed. He laid him down and covered him with a blanket. Hitoshi comforted Kaizen to sleep as Riso chewed on his fingernail.

Was this the right thing to do? What if this just put him in more danger? What do I do? I can’t let him go back. He’s going to die if he stays with them. He doesn’t need to be covered in scars like me. Oh, fuck. Is he gonna be like me?

“Riso.” Hitoshi grabbed his shoulder. “Hey, we need to talk.”

“..What?” Riso barely pulled himself from his thoughts.

“Come on, let’s talk outside.”

Riso followed Hitoshi outside to the porch, before crossing his arms.

“Why did you go out as Cosmic tonight? And- Don’t lie to me. Kaizen told me ‘Star boy’ saved him. You are supposed to take it easy!”

“I did. I did take it easy, Toshi. I just-”

“You just what? You keep putting yourself in danger! When are you going to put yourself first?”

“He’s my brother. I saw- A nurse gave me his file and I had to save him! He was being so mistreated, and I was so fucking worried. I didn’t go out to fight crime, I went out to save him.”

“Riso,”

“You know how horrible it is to have abusive parents. I do too! I couldn’t let him experience that.”

“I know, but you should’ve asked for help.”

“I had Bakugo.”

“Bakugo *let* you do it. When he shouldn’t have!”

“Don’t blame him.”

“I’m not. You-”

“Do you remember when you asked why I cover my eyes not too long after you found out who I was?”

“..What does that have to do with anything?”

“I remember why. I saw Kaizen in the living room crying, and it made me remember. When I was younger, my dad would watch my eyes for emotions. He would see when they would tear up, when there was fear in them. He would watch my eyes, so I stopped showing them. If there is one thing I can not mask, it’s my eyes. My eyes show every emotion I feel, that’s how you caught onto me that one night.”

Memories of the conversation in the cafe came back to Hitoshi.

“You’re upset.”

“No I’m not.”

“You’re bad at hiding it.”

“I’m not upset.”

“You’re clearly upset.”

“You’ve got no proof of that accusation.”

“Your eyes are dull.”

“...That’s right.” Hitoshi muttered.

“I hide because of them, Hitoshi. I show my eyes as Cosmic because that is my outlet. I wanted to be brave for Kaizen. Like I want to be brave for you, for Izuku, Bakugo. For everyone.”

“I..” Hitoshi grabbed his hand. “I’m sorry.”

“Don’t be.” Riso glanced at their hands. Hitoshi used his free hand to push Riso's hair back and out of his face. He smiled softly at him.

“You can be vulnerable with me, Riso.” Hitoshi said softly. “You’re allowed to feel. Be in pain, be *angry.* That’s okay. I just wish you had come to me, darling.”

Riso’s eyes shook lightly as he tried to swallow the lump in his throat. His mask had fallen for just a moment, but in the moment someone took notice.

“You’re okay,” Hitoshi reassured. “It’s okay. You can cry.”

And that he did. Riso, for the first time in his life, he let himself be truly and genuinely vulnerable. It wasn’t like when he cried with Bakugo, or when he talked seriously with Izuku. He let everything out. From his past, long before anyone ever took notice of him. From the built up emotion from all the previous injuries he’s had. *Everything* . He found himself sitting against the building, crying so hard he could hardly breathe. Hitoshi sat next to him, reaching over to grab his hand. He let Riso lean his head on his shoulder. Hitoshi reached over and wiped the tears coming from Riso’s eyes. Hitoshi spoke a few words.

“Looking in your eyes is like looking into a galaxy. It’s so full of scary things, but there’s beauty even in the darkest parts.”

Chapter End Notes

riso finally opening up? i guess even he has a limit to how much he can take. poor kaizen too :(also i cannot write a child at all?? idk how kids works so like. bare with me on that lmao. love u guys!

updates wednesday and sundays!

Chapter Fifty Four

Chapter Summary

> Izuku deals with going to therapy while Riso and Hitoshi occupy Kaizen before he has to go to the hosptial.

Chapter Notes

> i've never been to therapy before so idk how it works really?? i hope i didn't completely fuck it up!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Izuku tapped his fingers against the fake leather that was wrapped around the arm of the chair. His eyebrows were furrowed as he stared at the carpet, noticing faces in the design. It was a typical, old rug design but he could make out faint smiley faces. He tilted his head, looking for other subtle designs that were in the rug. He could only form an angry face before someone called his name.

“Midoriya.”

Izuku looked up, meeting the eyes of his therapist, Mister Lewitt.

“It’s Aizawa now.”

“Izuku Aizawa, huh? Your adoptive father told me you might not be ready to commit to such a name. You didn't during our last session.”

“Well. That was last session. Uh, technically it’s Izuku Aizawa-Yamada. But..Aizawa’s easier I guess.”

“Did something happen?”

“No.”

“..Alright.” Mr. Lewitt offered a smile. “Let’s talk about the morning of the Shie Hassaikai raid.”

“I don’t want to talk about that.” Izuku muttered. “It’s not that big of a deal.”

“What do you mean?”

“I lost my quirk, that’s it. My best friend was basically found dead. So..I think he’s got it a bit worse.”

“..I see.” He wrote something in his notepad. Izuku watched as he wrote in the notepad, biting his lip lightly. “Is that the only reason you think it might be ‘not that big of a deal’?”

“..No. But, why do I have to share that?”

“Izuku,”

“What?”

“This is what therapy is about. You have to tell me things that make you uncomfortable.”

God, Hitoshi. Why did you make me do this alone?

“That seems..dumb.”

“It’s necessary. But, if you wish to not talk about that, we can always talk about your childhood. I understand that your mother passed away right around when you started going to UA?”

“..Yeah.”

“What was she like?”

“She was nice. She worked really hard for me to be happy, it was hard because her husband was away. In America.”

“Now..I noticed you referred to Hisashi Midoriya as her husband and not your father. Is there a reason?”

“He wasn’t a dad. Not to me.” Izuku began to pick at his fingernails. “It’s complicated, I guess.”

“Of course. Tell me more about your mom.”

“She’d make me breakfast on weekends, I got up pretty early for school. Um..she even made my first hero suit, before my..a classmate destroyed it in a battle.”

“Do you resent that classmate?”

“No. Not at all.” Izuku shook his head. “Even if I did, I don’t think I could still be mad at him.”

“Oh? Why’s that?”

“..He’s my boyfriend.”

“Boyfriend, huh? Do you two ever argue?”

“Not really. We did once but it was the stress of everything.”

“Of everything?”

“Riso, uh- my best friend. He was missing, and..we all felt responsible for it. We said some mean things.”

“Do you feel responsible for it still?”

“Um..” Izuku nodded slowly. “Yeah. Kinda.”

“Why’s that?”

“...Uh.” Izuku bit his lip. “I can’t tell you that.”

“Why not?”

“Um..I know these are supposed to be all ‘patient and doctor confidentiality’ but..this is a little beyond that. I just can’t really explain it.”

“You can tell me everything your heart desires.”

“No, I can’t.”

“Okay, we’ll move on from the subject. Do you want to talk about your childhood some more?”

“Not really.”

“Do you want to speak about what’s uncomfortable? Or not at all?”

“I..My ‘dad’ was mean. He would try to make a quirk appear. I don’t know, it’s..stupid.”

“It’s not stupid, kiddo.”

“He’d beat me. My mom too. Cause I didn’t have a quirk.”

“But you had a quirk in our system,”

“Minor healing quirk. I was training it to be a major healing quirk. It helped me recover from my dad’s abuse and I never really noticed until I got stabbed one night.”

“You were stabbed?”

“...I was not supposed to say that.”

“Who stabbed you? Do they not want you to tell?”

“No, it’s not like that. It..was kind of a villain attack. You..you know Cosmic?”

“That vigilante?”

“Yeah. He saved me, but I healed from the knife-wound pretty fast.”

“Huh. Are you grateful for Cosmic for saving you that night?”

Izuku paused. Although Mister Lewitt was speaking about the night he was stabbed, as he could think of was the night he tried to kill himself. He glanced at his therapist slowly, his lips parted as he tried to speak. Instead, he burst into tears. He could feel the confused look on his own face from the sudden outburst.

“Izuku?”

“I’m sorry. I-” Izuku wiped his tears. “I’m very grateful. Words can’t ever explain or describe how much I appreciate him.”

“Because he saved your life?”

“He did more than save my life.” Izuku wiped his cheek again. “He gave me a future.”

There were a few minutes of silence, Izuku not really answering any more questions. Eventually, Mister Lewitt stood to his feet. He smiled at Izuku.

“That’s all we have time for today, I’m afraid. Say, kid. I’ve got this journal here.” He handed Izuku a thin journal. “I want you to record heavy emotions you have in here, so we can talk about it in our next session.”

“Okay.” Izuku took the journal. He walked out of the office, smiling lightly when he saw Aizawa sitting in the waiting room. He looked over before coming their way, arms crossed. He exchanged a few words with the therapist before turning to Izuku.

“Ready to go?”

“Yes sir.”

“Good…Don’t call me sir. Makes me feel old.” Aizawa walked Izuku out to the car. Izuku sat in the front, next to Aizawa. He turned to the green haired boy. “So? How did it go?”

“I hate therapy. It feels so- violating.”

“..I’m sorry, kid.” Aizawa started the car.

“I can’t be completely truthful either.”

“..Why not?”

“...I-”

“You’re Nexus. Right. I’ll speak to him about that.”

“...Is it obvious?”

“Your best friend, the *biggest* pain in my ass, is Cosmic. There’s no way he didn’t get you wrapped into his problems.”

“..He saved my life.” Izuku admitted. “I tried to kill myself and he caught me.”

“..He caught you.” Aizawa says softly. “You jumped off of a building? How did you even get up there?”

“..All Might left me up there.”

Aizawa’s knuckles turned a pasty white (yes, even whiter than his skin) as he gripped the stirring wheel.

“All Might?”

“I had gotten attacked by a villain. He saved me. I grabbed onto him as he jumped because I was just curious about him. I asked if quirkless people had any chance of being a- hero. He said no. I had been told to jump off a roof earlier that day too. So..It was right there. I tried to do it. Riso- Cosmic, whichever. He saved me that day. He told me he’d train me. That’s how I got into UA. How I was able to fight my way around.”

“...Who told you to jump off the roof?”

“...You don’t want me to answer that.”

“Who was it.”

“..K-Kacchan.”

“What?!”

“Kitty!” Kaizen smiled as he grabbed ahold of Fluffball. He hissed, but turned around to cuddle him. He rested his head on Kaizen’s knee, purring softly.

“He’s so adorable.” Hitoshi looks at Riso. “Did you look like him when you were a baby?”

“Uh..no. I was much uglier.” Riso snickered. “Kaizen’s cuter.”

“Oh, I’m sure that’s not true.” Hitoshi leaned against Riso, “You’re cute now.”

“..Do not flirt with me when my baby brother is sitting right in front of me-”

“Bubba! Bubba!” Kaizen looked at Riso. “You kiss him?”

Riso’s face flushed red. “Yeah, I..I do.”

“Dada says it’s wrong.” Kaizen pushes his lips together. “But I know a secret.”

“..A secret?” Hitoshi asked.

“Dada jealous. You get pretty boys! He gets mommy.”

Riso snickered. “Yeah? I get pretty boys?” Riso looked at Hitoshi, who blushed.

“He’s pretty! I like purple.”

“I like purple too, kiddo.”

Hitoshi grabbed Kaizen and sat him in his lap, gently pushing the small amount of hair he had back. “Wanna know a secret of mine?”

“Yeah!” Kaizen nodded, a big smile on his face.

“I like pink.” Hitoshi smiled in return. “I really like pink when white’s involved.” Kaizen gasped lightly, squealing.

“That’s me!”

“It sure is!” Hitoshi gently tickled Kaizen, who laughed out loud. He attempted to squirm away from Hitoshi, but had no luck. Hitoshi paused when he heard Kaizen’s stomach growl. “Hey, buddy. Are you hungry?”

“Uh huh.”

“Well..do you want breakfast or lunch? It’s only about eleven,”

“Mmm breakfist!” Kaizen got up. “I know Bubba’s a really good cook!”

“How do you know that?” Riso asked, picking Kaizen up.

“Cause *I’m* a good cook!” Kaizen held onto Riso. “So you gots to be too.”

“...Good logic.” Riso chuckled as he took Kaizen to the kitchen. He sat him on the counter, and turned around for a moment. Hitoshi watched from the otherside of the kitchen island, putting both elbows on the countertop. Suddenly, there was a squeal.

“Is that a baby?!” Mina asked, running over. “Oh, he’s so cute! Hi there!” Mina jumped up and down slightly in front of Kaizen.

“Mina,” Riso looked at her. “Please don’t scare him.”

“Pink!” Kaizen’s eyes were wide and he made grabby hands at her. “Pink!!”

“I am pink! You’ve got pink hair! We match!” Mina smiled, picking up Kaizen.

“Why are we talking like babies in her- OHMYGOD” Denki stared at Mina holding the baby. “THERE’S A BABY”

Denki’s loud statement caused the majority of the students to come towards the kitchen to see Kaizen. Kaizen stared at every person with curiosity. He laid eyes on Tokoyami.

“Bird,” He said. “Pretty bird.”

“..I’m not- a-...Thank you, unidentified baby.” Tokoyami smiled lightly. Kirishima approached Mina slowly, afraid he was going to scare Kaizen.

“He’s so cute. Soft looking too. But he’s gonna become manly, isn’t he?” Kirishima ruffled his hair.

“Why is he even here?” Jirou asked, looking around.

“I don’t care,” Uraraka walked over, pinching Kaizen’s cheeks lightly. “He’s just so adorable!”

“Right?!” Hagakure smiled.

“Wait,” Denki looked at Riso, then Kaizen, then Riso again. “He looks like Riso.”

“Oh my god he does.”

“Riso do you have a secret child?” Todoroki spoke up, which caused Riso to snicker.

“First of all, I’m gay. Second of all, he’s my little brother.”

“You have a brother?!”

“Uh..Yes. I took him from our parents. He’s going to the hospital when Aizawa gets back with Izuku.”

“The hospital?” Mina glanced at Riso. “Is he okay?”

“It’s just a checkup. Then I have to find someone to take him in.”

“What about Miss Midnight? I mean she’s basically your mother already.”

“..She wouldn’t. She’s a..provocative hero. Could you imagine the hate she would get for taking custody of a two year old?”

“It’ll be fine! She’s not always like that.”

“I’m just worried about the media. And if he wants to become a hero. I love heroes, don’t get me wrong, but it’s a very risky job. What if his expectations are too high? And he hurts

himself? Beyond repair? What if when he's enrolled in whatever school, there's a villain attack but he's not as prepared as you guys were. He's unable to protect himself? What if-"

"Ookay," Hitoshi grabbed his hand. "Riso, calm down. Take a breath." Riso took a breath.

"Sorry."

"Don't be sorry. It's okay to be anxious." Hitoshi kissed his cheek. "You just seemed to be getting overwhelmed."

"Awh," Sero smiled. "You guys are so cute."

Denki and Kirishima started faking kissing noises to tease the two, but Riso rolled his eyes.

"Sorry you guys have zero game." Riso smirked.

"Wh- We have game!"

"Yeah, with your computers. I've never seen you successfully flirt with anyone."

"Not true!"

"Right, cause- flirting with me wasn't successful, Kamninari."

Denki's mouth was open in surprise. "You ass! You're so lucky you're hurt!"

"Pfft, lucky? I can still kick your ass even in my condition."

“Yeah right!” Denki laughed and nudged Kirishima. “You’re pretty useless with an injury like that.”

Those words were familar. Riso blinked, and once his eyes opened he was no longer standing in the kitchen of the common area.

He recognized the room immediately. He was back at the Hassaikai. He felt his limbs go heavy, as his eyes met the floor. Blood stained it, and fresh blood dropped from his head onto it. He tried to stand up, but the chains attached to his wrists made it painful.

“Aw, where are you going?” A henchmen snickered. “I’d say you’re basically useless if you got an injury like that.”

“Fuck off.” Riso’s voice was weak. “Stop being a coward and just kill me.”

“And give you that satisfaction? Absolutely not. Tell me how to make the process faster and maybe I will grant you that wish.”

Riso felt tears slip from his eyes, the pain burned in his chest. He shook his head, forcing the tears away.

“Or, I could find that boy you talk so much about with Eri. He’ll make you talk.”

*“Don’t you **dare** .” Riso looked up at the henchman. “You bring him into this, and I’ll find a way to fucking kill you.”*

“Aw, but heroes don’t kill people.”

“I’m not a fucking hero.”

“Oh? Then you’re a villain?” He snickered. “Guess you are considering you helped us build a quirk destroying bullet.”

“Go to hell.”

“I’ll follow after you, kid.” The henchman too the scorching hot metal and pressed it to his skin. Riso held back a scream, and let his head hang down. The henchman pulled his head back, and smirked. “Don’t hide. Villains take up for their actions.”

“Riso?” Hitoshi asked softly, hand on his arm. “..Hey, are you okay?”

Riso blinked a few times, looking at the stares he was getting. He gulped and looked at Hitoshi.

“Yeah, I’m fine. Why?”

“...You dropped the pan.” Denki said. “I- I’m sorry, man. If what I said was-...something. I was just playing.”

“..It’s okay,” Riso assured him, placing a hand to his chest as he felt for any existing burn marks. “I just..spaced for a minute. Mina, do you think you could watch Kaizen for a moment?”

“Uh. Of course? C’mon girls!”

Denki looked at Riso with apologetic eyes. “Really, I-”

“I said it was okay. I’m just going to the bathroom, I’ll be right back.” Riso went to walk away but turned back at Denki. “Your flirting game is still weak.”

“Hey!”

Hitoshi watched Riso carefully as he walked away. Riso closed his dorm door, walking past his in-dorm bathroom. He gulped and stopped in front of the full-body mirror he had. He slowly removed the shirt he was wearing, examining his chest. His breath was caught in his throat when he saw the burn scars. Guess that was one thing they never healed. He ran his hand over the largest one, which laid across his chest. He winched when he remembered how painful it was. He glanced up at his face, before he pushed his hair back.

God, his face was so scarred and ugly. There were more scars than what he could remember. His lip trembled as he tried to contain his feelings. It wasn’t fair. Between the scars on his chest, the ones on his face, he was hideous. There was nothing good to look at on himself. He hated everything he saw. He quickly threw his shirt back on when Hitoshi opened the door.

“..I knew something was wrong,” Hitoshi walked over. “What happened?”

“It’s fine. I just..had a- flashback or whatever.”

“Riso,”

“No, it’s fine. I’m fine. We need to get back to Kaizen.” He walked towards the door.

“I don’t believe you.”

“I know.” Riso’s grip on the door tightened. “I know you don’t.”

“So talk to me.”

“And tell you what? The same shit every time? I can’t do that. I can’t talk about me for that long.”

“...Okay. But I want to talk later about it. I care too much for you to see you hurt silently.”

“Okay, Toshi.” Riso walked out of the room, and Hitoshi’s phone buzzed. He looked down, seeing the text was from Izuku.

dad found out about some of the stuff kacchan used to tell me in middle school and he’s pissed

Of course he is, should i give him a warning?

probably yes. Actually, very much yes.

got it. how did therapy go?

i’m convincing one of our dads to put you in it. I can’t do it alone

if anything, riso needs it

You need it too! You’re not escaping this. Besides, you could benefit from it. anyway i love you and i’ll see you soon!

love you too dork

Chapter End Notes

yep! that's todays chapter! love you guys <3

updates wednesdays and sundays!

Chapter Fifty Five

Chapter Summary

> Izuku plans a small party for Bakugo and Todoroki as they pass their provisional license exam. Riso has tea with Nezu after a long while.

Chapter Notes

> i've been so unhappy with my chapters lately, ugh. writers block sucks u guys. anyway, love u!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Bakugo laid on Izuku's bed, looking up at the ceiling. He felt Izuku shift, accidentally tugging on his shirt. He glanced down at Izuku and smiled slightly. He moved a piece of hair from his face. He let his thumb gently rub against Izuku's freckled cheek. Although it was late, he couldn't sleep. He had been not sleeping a lot more than he was willing to admit. The stress of passing this remedial course was weighing on him. His entire future depended on this.

He sighed. He subconsciously fiddled with Izuku hair as he tried to think. Things were rough somehow. Izuku was in therapy, Riso was recovering, Hitoshi was finally able to focus on training, and the rest of the class was surpassing him. Why did he feel so stuck? Izuku mumbled something quietly.

"What?" Bakugo asked.

"Stop worrying," Izuku glanced up at Bakugo. "You're going to do great, you know that? I have no doubt."

"I'm not worried."

“I can tell you are, Kacchan. You keep twirling my hair.”

“Shit. Did that wake you?”

“No, it didn’t. Your loud ass thoughts did.”

“Oh. Shut up.”

Izuku sighed. “What is it that’s bothering you?”

“Nothing.”

“Kacchan.”

“I’m behind.”

“Not by much.”

“Still behind.”

“Kacchan, you’re one of the best students in the class. Following Yaoyorozu of course, she’s…yeah.”

“I know I’m the best in class, asshole. It’s not like that.”

“Then tell me what it’s like! I’m here for you, Kacchan. We’re supposed to talk, and..share our feelings.”

“Sharing feelings? Blah, gross.”

“I can always get my therapist to see you,”

“No. Definitely not.” Bakugo looks at Izuku. “Why do you have someone else? Isn’t Hound Dog qualified?”

“Dad says it’s different. I need to seek a completely fresh and new perspective.”

“Your dad is dumb.”

“My dad is your teacher.”

“Hey, as a dad, he’s dumb. Don’t make me the bad guy here.”

Izuku chuckled, resting his head more comfortably on Bakugo. He grabbed one of his hands and intertwined his fingers.

“Kacchan?”

“What?”

“Do you think we’re going to be together forever?”

“You want me to be stuck to you until I die?” Bakugo’s tone misled the joke, but Izuku understood it anyway.

“Oh, shut up. I’m serious. It’s..highschool sweethearts never really get that far.”

“We’re more like childhood lovers. Isn’t that something?”

“What if you have to leave on a really long mission? Like years? And..and you find someone better.”

“Seems like I wasn’t the only one with loud thoughts.” Bakugo snickered. “Idiot, I don’t want anyone else.”

“I just-”

“Izuku. I don’t want anyone else.”

“What if I’m too slow for you? And I can’t catch up?”

“What the hell is that therapist doing to you? Of course you can catch up. You went from nothing to something faster than I ever could. My childhood prepared me to be a hero. You had a traumatized kid and ten months to spare.”

“..Are you complimenting me?”

“No. Fuck off.”

“I don’t want me to be the reason you get stuck back.” Izuku admitted. “While Riso was missing, I would dream at night about how I could’ve saved him. Everytime, it wasn’t enough. What if I’m not enough to save you one day in the battlefield?”

“You’ll be fast enough. You become feral when I'm threatened.”

“What if people look down on you because of me?”

“I don’t care if they do. It’s none of their fucking business to begin with. Besides, you’re stuck with me. You really think I’m going to let you go? Not after pinky-pie told me so strictly I can’t fuck up with you.” Bakugo was still messing with Izuku’s curls. Mina’s advice on how to make his hair softer really was working, because it was easy to play with without getting knotted. “I don’t *want* to fuck up. You’re a good thing that’s happened, and I’d be dumb to ever ruin it over a hero rank.”

A soft snore came from his chest, and he looked down. He let a small smile tug at the corner of his mouth when he saw Izuku was asleep again. He pulled the blanket over the both of them, his eyes trained on the ceiling. Maybe he was overthinking. Either way, he knew Izuku would be there for him. With that thought, he fell asleep.

The next morning, Bakugo and Todoroki left for their final exam. It was predicted to take most of the day, so the class had a lot of time to prepare a surprise party for their success. Class 1A had no doubt they’d pass the second time, and it was Izuku’s idea to give them some kind of party. Each person in the class had a different job, Sato was in charge of any treats, Momo was making decorations, and most of the girls were decorating. Majority of the boys were busy cleaning, trying to make the place look good enough for the two test takers to actually sit and enjoy themselves.

“Wait,” Denki says, his hand on the standup mixer. “He’s here to stay for a little while?”

“Yeah. We can’t find anyone to take him.” Riso handed Seto the filled cake pan. “I need to talk to Midnight still, see if she can maybe take him.”

“Why is it so important he gets into a place you approve of?” Denki leaned against the mixer. “I know you’re his brother and stuff, but you weren’t there for him until now…That sounds harsh.”

“It’s hard to explain. I left my parents because it wasn’t a good place for me. Kaizen wasn’t born yet, so it’s not like I was leaving behind my little brother who needed protection then and there. I knew I’d care for him, but I just…It wasn’t my problem. I got away from them, I had no connection. A nurse asked me about him and I just..grew anxious. I really do care for him.”

“That’s not complicated. Or is it? I dunno. But I get it. You’re doing what you can. Besides, you can admit. Our boy Hitoshi is pretty cute with a kid.”

“...Yeah,” Riso smiled lightly. “He is.”

“Riso, Sato! How’s the baking coming along?” Izuku leaned on the counter, clipboard in hand.

“Good,” Sato responded. “Mostly everything is baking! We still need to frost the desserts.”

“Which is what I’m here to help with.” Denki smiled.

“Good, good. We’re on schedule.” Izuku went to walk away, but Riso stopped him.

“Hey, can we talk?”

“Uh, sure. Do you want to step outside or?”

“Yeah.”

There was a slight awkward silence once the two were outside.

“Look, Izuku.” Riso starts, “I feel like I haven’t been a very good friend.”

“What? Of course you’ve been a good friend.”

“I..I want you to know, when I ran into that warehouse that night,”

Izuku tensed.

“That wasn’t something you could’ve stopped. It wasn’t your fault either.”

“Riso,”

“No, I know. Um..I heard what you said. When you thanked me for- saving your life, and saying you’re going to help me regardless.”

“..Well..I just care about you.”

“I care about you too.”

“I know you do, Riso.”

“No, Zuku. I really, really care about you. I haven’t paid much attention to you since I’ve got out. I’ve been so wrapped up in my thoughts-”

“I get it. You don’t need to prove to me that we’re friends everyday. I know we are, you saved my life. That’s a bond nobody could ever break.”

“...Stop being so mature. It’s kind of sickening.” Riso smiled lighty. “You’ve grown so much from when I first met you.”

“You were the one who helped me grow.” Izuku nudged him. “I know you helped Kacchan with his feelings for me. I know the great lengths you went to protect me when we were doing vigilante work. You never rest, Riso. You never have, and I don’t think you ever will.”

Riso subconsciously rubbed his fingers over the scarred rigids in his face. He took a breath before smiling.

“I’m not capable of rest.”

“You should be. Everyone is capable of rest.”

“Not me, Zuku. But I guess that’s what makes me different.”

“Kacchan and Todoroki will be home in a few hours, and *you* have a lot of work to do. Let’s get back.”

“Right, of course.”

The rest of the planning went smoothly. Occasionally, Kaizen and Hitoshi would accidentally destroy something while they were playing. Denki had a point earlier. The way Hitoshi treated Kaizen was adorable. Riso personally knew Hitoshi used to take care of a few kids in his old foster home, but seeing how it was so effortless, it made his heart flutter. His baby brother had a smile almost the entire time he was around Hitoshi. Who knew Hitoshi Aizawa-Yamada would be good with kids? I guess it’s the same as Aizawa being good with kids secretly.

It was nightfall when Bakugo and Todoroki walked up to the dorm. They were sweating in their school uniforms as they did take down a villain right after obtaining their hero license. Todoroki wanted to be around his friends after that tiring battle, but Bakugo wanted to see Izuku. His need to see his lover always increased after a battle, he was always worried it would be the last time he ever saw him. He didn’t take life for granted, especially since he was in the hospital. That thought scared him.

He pulled open the dorm door, and both him and Todoroki almost jumped out of their skin. Class 1A was standing at the door, the same way they had done for Riso in his return.

“Congrats!” The class shouted, smiles all around. Bakugo scoffed as Todoroki nodded to give them thanks. Bakugo’s stern expression fell to pieces once he saw Izuku and his smile. He couldn’t *not* smile at Izuku. He looked so happy. He walked closer, grabbing him by his waist. Their foreheads were pressed together.

“Hi,” Izuku whispered, his voice barely audible over the chatter his class was making.

“Hey.” Bakugo whispered back.

“Did the test go smoothly?” Izuku was still whispering, but he placed his hands on Bakugo’s chest.

“Yeah. I had nothing to worry about.”

“See? I told you.” Izuku smiled. “I knew you’d pass.”

“I knew I was coming back to you either way.” The end of Bakugo’s mouth curled into a smile. “That was enough for me,”

Izuku gasped lightly. “Katsuki Bakugo, are you flirting with me?”

“Is it working?”

“...Maybe.”

“Then, yeah. I am. What are you going to do about it?”

“This.”

Izuku leaned forward and connected their lips, holding him tightly by his shirt. Bakugo kissed back, bringing a hand to Izuku’s cheek. Once the kiss broke, Bakugo spoke softly.

“I love you, Izuku.”

Izuku paused, staring up into Bakugo’s ruby eyes. They glistened. They were full of life, full of emotion, full of *love* . Love for him.

“..I..I love you too, Kacchan.”

Before they could kiss again, Kaizen ran between their legs. The two chuckled at the sight of the boy, who claimed he was hiding from Hitoshi. So, when Hitoshi approached them…

“Hey guys, I’m looking for a uh..fugitive. Have you seen someone with pink hair, a cute smile, and a stuffed bear?”

“Mm..Nope.” Izuku shook his head, a small giggle was heard from Izuku’s legs. “What’s his crime?”

“He ate the last oreo!”

“Oh, what a horrible crime.” Bakugo snickered. “..Hey, wait. That dude has pink hair.” He pointed at Riso, who was talking to Sero.

“..Must be him! I gotta go catch him!”

Kaizen audibly squealed, excited he ‘got away with it’. Hitoshi marched up to Riso, and turned him around.

“Excuse me, sir. But you are under arrest! Please put out your hands!”

“..Huh?” Riso looked confused. The confused expression escaped his face when he saw Kaizen watching. Then he smiled. “You’ve got no proof I did it!”

“Don’t resist!” Hitoshi pulled a pair of handcuffs from his pocket. They were cheap plastic ones that came from a crappy one dollar toy set. Riso put his hands out for Hitoshi.

“You realize how stupid you look?” Riso whispered, teasing Hitoshi.

“I’m doing it for *your* brother, shut up.” Hitoshi rolled his eyes. He placed the plastic around Riso’s wrists. When it clicked together, the plastic was cool against his warm skin. Riso paused.

The metal cuffs clinked around his wrists, pinning him to the wall. His hands were being pinned above his head, which would tire him out. They were too high for him to sit down and hold his arms, it would be too uncomfortable. He also couldn’t stand the entire time he was cuffed up. Eri would sit next to his dangling body when his legs gave out. She’d hold his shirt, trying to comfort him in ways a little girl could.

Riso looked at his wrists, the gray plastic was loosely wrapped around it. He tried to force the tears coming to his eyes away, as light scars were on his wrists. He wanted to forget about that. The rest of the night for him was a blur. He felt sluggish the entire night, almost as everything was in slow motion. He dissociated to force any thoughts he had away. He could not ruin Bakugo and Todoroki’s party because he wanted to be a ball of self-pity.

Now, Riso sat in an office. He held a teacup in his hand, gently sloshing the liquid in a circular motion. There was silence, a concerned one.

“Riso, it’s been a while since we’ve had our usual cup of tea.”

“I know.”

“How are you doing?”

“Fine, I guess.” Riso tapped his finger on the rim of the cup. “There’s been a lot of change lately.”

“Is that difficult for you?”

“A little.” Riso looked at Nezu. “Change is always stupid.”

“Hm. Yes, we’ve had this conversation before. You find it unnecessary and a stressor.”

“I just wish things could be normal again. Me going to school everyday, my friends not having to worry about anything regarding me.”

“You know you haven’t been cleared to attend school.”

“It sucks. I really want to create something. It’s been a while since I’ve seen the lab. Or Hatsume, really. How is she doing?”

“Extraordinary.” Nezu nods. “She’s the only student I’ve ever seen keep up with you.”

“Yeah? That’s good. I’m happy for her.”

“Riso,”

“Yes?”

“Do you know why you haven’t been cleared to come back to school?”

“..Cause I’m still recovering.”

“You’re not mentally ready. *I’ve* deemed you mentally not ready.”

“What?”

“You’re experiencing a lot of change, Riso. I know how change has affected you in the past. You have a boyfriend now. You’ve saved your little brother who you have to care for until a foster home shows up. Your best friend is in therapy, and his boyfriend and you are growing quite close. Not to mention, I’ve been informed you’ve been having flashbacks.”

“..So..?”

“Trauma is a harsh thing for a kid your age. You experienced something no one ever should. You were forced to build something for someone who could ruin and destroy all of your loved ones. Including your best friend.” Nezu sipped his cup. “Before this year started, you were such a happy student. You were willing to jump at *any* opportunity. Do you know what I see now?”

“..What?”

“A tired kid. A tired, dedicated kid who’s willing to do anything to make the pain stop. The thoughts stop. You just want to live in peace again.”

“I..”

“Here’s the thing, Riso. You were never truly that free. You were always struggling, but you hid it so much better the first time. We know you’re hurt this time. So, until you are better, you’re not going to come to school.”

“..Nezu,”

“You’re smart. You’re already ahead in your studies, so a few months of missed school isn’t anything.”

“But I-”

“I do wish you a swift recovery, but mental health will take time.”

“...Yes sir.” Riso nodded, looking at his teacup. His line of sight connected with the scars on his wrists from the cuffs. He endured literal torture for a month’s worth of time. But he didn’t care. There was one thing he wanted.

He wanted things to be normal again. He wanted to be looked at how he was looked at during the beginning of the year. He didn’t want to see pity or empathy in people’s eyes when they looked at him. He hated being the center of attention like that.

He hated it.

Chapter End Notes

cool cool cool, fun fun fun! hope you liked it, please leave your thoughts in the comments if you wish! is there anything you'd like to see?

updates wednesdays and sundays!

Chapter Fifty Six

Chapter Summary

> Bakugo, Izuku, Hitoshi and Riso have a nostalgic sit down at the cat cafe when things go south fast. But maybe it was for the better.

Chapter Notes

> i officially cannot see shit. it's been like three years since i've gotten new glasses so please excuse excessive typos LMAO. anyway hope u enjoy!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Izuku, Hitoshi, Bakugo and Riso were all sitting in a booth at the cat cafe. It was a Saturday, so no one had any school activities. Well, Hitoshi had training with Aizawa, but he skipped that to be with his friends.

“I don’t think we’ve really had time to sit down with each other like this for a while.” Izuku says, holding his coffee mug in both hands. “..How is everyone?”

“Tired.” Hitoshi nodded, “Can’t get any sleep.”

“Of course you can’t.” Bakguo rolled his eyes, “Tell us something we don’t know.”

“You're being friendly this morning.” Hitoshi narrowed his eyes.

“He also didn’t get any sleep,” Izuku chuckled, leaning on Bakugo.

“Oh?” Hitoshi snickered. “Welcome to the club of no sleep.”

“Shut the fuck up.”

“Moving on, how’s therapy been?” Hitoshi looks at Izuku.

“I..think it’s helping? I dunno, I’ve kinda felt better getting some of the stuff off my chest.”

“What about losing your quirk? Is..that still hard for you?”

“Eh, I thought it was nothing at first. But my therapist made me realize that..well, it’s reminding me a lot of my dad. My uh, biological one.”

“Hate that guy.” Bakugo muttered.

“I’m sorry, I didn’t mean to talk about emotional stuff so early.”

“It’s fine, besides I think this means progress!” Hitoshi smiled. “You’re talking emotions with us.”

“..Don’t remind me.” Izuku looks up at Bakugo. “He already hears it all.”

“Of course I do. You’re my boyfriend.” Bakugo looks at Izuku. “It’s a requirement.”

“You’re not required to do anything.” Izuku huffs.

“No, no. I like that. He needs to take care of you.” Hitoshi nods, “Listening to your issues *is* a requirement.”

A laugh was shared across the three. A silence settled upon the table. Izuku's arms were wrapped around Bakugo's arm, and Hitoshi was looking at the two. Hitoshi thought they were a nice couple, they complimented each other nicely. He'd also seen both Bakugo's and Izuku's moods improve over the past couple of months. Them being in love with one another was probably the best thing that has ever happened to them. It was difficult, though. Izuku had been through so much in his life, but never once did he ever let it get to him. He may have cried in front of others, but he would cry harder when he was alone. He had heard stories from Riso on how he'd be in the worst mental state, but would still want to help others. Izuku was selfless. But Bakugo changed that, along with a little therapy, Izuku cared more about himself. He'd still risk his life for someone else's, but he'd hesitate.

"Pinky-pie," Bakugo starts. "You haven't said anything."

"Huh?" Riso looked up, breaking the stare he had with the table. "Oh. Sorry."

"It's okay?" Izuku raised an eyebrow, confused. "..When are you coming back to school? Did any teachers say?"

"I had tea with Nezu. We talked then." Riso pulled his sleeves over his hands, then placed them in his lap. "I can't go back for a while."

"Wait, until when?" Hitoshi asked. "You haven't told me this."

"I have to be deemed 'mentally ready.' Nezu wants me to get over..trauma or whatever."

"...That's going to take a while." Bakugo blinks. "You could go the rest of the school year 'not ready.'"

"Yep. It's not that important, really." Riso shrugged. "More time to create, I guess."

Hitoshi glanced at Bakugo and Izuku, who shared the same concerned look.

“Riso,”

“Hm?”

“I can set you up with a therapist? Mine, maybe? He’s nice.”

“I’m okay, Zuku. Thanks, though.”

There was a second silence. This one was heavier. No one knew what to say. Things had changed so much since they all had met each other. Riso and Izuku’s friendship wasn’t necessarily affected, but they don’t look at one another the same. They had both seen each other at their absolute worst, and there’s some things you just can’t come back from. Riso had died once, and was on the brink of death a second time. Izuku was there for both. When he thought of his best friend, it wasn’t the image of this heroic person who saved his life. It was now a severely traumatized boy. Riso couldn’t picture Izuku as a smaller boy who needed guidance, but rather saw him as a strong individual who could hold his own in a fight.

Izuku and Bakugo clearly didn’t see each other the same. They were in a romantic relationship now. Izuku and Hitoshi always had a very clear image of one another. Maybe that was why they clicked so easily. Maybe even why they became brothers so fast. Hitoshi and Bakugo tolerate each other. Hitoshi used to view Bakugo as a hateful person who’s hate was misdirected towards his classmates when he was really just hating the world. Bakugo’s view of Hitoshi was different. He showed potential, but Bakugo never admits things like that. So, when Bakugo was responsible for saving Riso’s life, Hitoshi couldn’t be more thankful. They have a mutual level of respect for one another.

Bakugo alone grew as a person.

Hitoshi and Riso. A complicated development. Riso saw Hitoshi in the Sports Festival, and was instantly captivated by his skills. He saw Aizawa in Hitoshi, maybe even subconsciously. When he made a support item for Hitoshi almost immediately, he felt that he deserved a place with the heroes in training. That’s why he pulled every string he could to get that to happen.

Riso went after him to show him the design, but him getting turned down was the only reason he kept doing it…And he was cute. Hitoshi's view of Riso was never truly formed until later on, his view was mainly on 'Cosmic'. The mysterious boy who found and helped him in a desperate time of need. Hitoshi may never know about the conversation Riso had with Present Mic to get him in a better home.

Come to think of it, Riso did a lot for others. He was always the savior. He just wanted to help others how he wanted to be helped, and there was never anything more to that. He never wanted to get involved with others' lives so closely, never thought people would care about him. He was so closed off, he didn't even know *how* to open up to others. He's only broken down to a select few.

Riso and Bakugo's relationship was an interesting one. They fought each other all the time at first, but one day something just changed. They still bicker, but it's their way of talking. They both have personalities where talking to others is a much more difficult task. They were close friends, one would even say best friends. They just knew each other.

Bakugo stared at Riso intently, before whispering in Izuku's ear. Izuku stood up, looking at Hitoshi.

"Come get another coffee with me?" Izuku asked sweetly.

"Sure." Hitoshi kissed Riso's cheek and stood, walking towards the counter with Izuku. Bakugo definitely figured something was wrong when Riso had no reaction to Hitoshi kissing him.

"What is it?" Bakugo asked.

"..Hm?" Riso looked at him.

"You're being weird and distant."

“Sorry, I just-”

“Don’t give me a lame ass excuse. What the fuck is up with you?”

“It doesn’t matter.” Riso sat back against the leather booth seat.

“Bullshit.” Bakugo crossed his arms. “You and I both know something is up.”

“Stop it. Okay?”

“No.” Bakugo scoffed, “You don’t get to drown in sorrows. Not alone.”

“You don’t have to worry about me, I’m fine.”

“Fine. You’re fine?” Bakugo shook his head. “You’ve died. You were tortured for a month. You were forced to make something that destroyed Izuku’s quirk. You went out in the early morning to save your brother from your old abusive household. Something has to be bothering you to the point where you’re shutting down.”

Riso stared. His lips were parted in surprise, hating that Bakugo even spoke of any of those things. He tried to find words, but none came to his tongue.

“Shut up. You don’t get to play that card.”

“You don’t think I see it? You’re depressed.” Bakugo leaned forward. “For fucks sake, you’ve been deemed ‘mentally unready’ by our god damn principal. I’m sure you trust his word.”

“Stop it.”

“Stop what? Stop telling you that your subconscious cry for help is being noticed?”

“I don’t want to do this here. Not with them here.”

“You won’t do it any other time. Excuse, after excuse.”

“Bakugo.”

“Riso.”

“I’m telling you, quit it. I’m fine, end of story.”

“Nobody is fine after being tortured, dying. You aren’t fine.”

“Why do you even care? You have to take care of Izuku, that’s it. I’m not some person that comes in a package deal if you’re dating him.”

“I’m not doing this for Izuku.”

“Then why are you doing it?”

“...” Bakugo felt his blood boil. He was really going to make him say it. “You know why.”

“No, I don’t. I don’t see why anyone would ever care so much about me that they’re arguing with me in a cat cafe.”

“You’re my friend. You’re my friend and you hurting is hurting *all* of us. So man up and tell me what the fuck is wrong!”

Riso hesitated for a moment, before shaking his head. “You don’t want to be friends with someone like me.”

“Are you kidding me?” Bakugo furrowed his eyebrows. “At some point, you’re going to have to get over yourself.”

Riso stood, grabbing his bag. “I’m going home.”

“Running from your problems is something you can’t do every time. You also can’t leave without supervision.”

“Stop prying into my life, Bakugo. You’re Izuku’s boyfriend and that’s it.” He started to leave, and then turned. “And I’ll go wherever I want without being watched like a baby.”

Bakugo glared as Riso walked out. He felt bad for how the conversation ended, but he was also angry. Who gave him the right to speak to him like that? Hitoshi and Izuku approached the table.

“..Kacchan, where’s Riso?”

“He left. Hell if I care, though.”

“You weren’t supposed to let him out of your sight!” Izuku placed his cup down and looked out the windows for any sign of Riso.

“He was pissin’ me off.”

“I’ll call dad,” Hitoshi pulled his phone out as he walked outside. Chances were, Riso would be long gone. Especially since he just had an argument with Bakugo.

“Why did you let him leave?” Izuku asked, grabbing Bakugo’s hand.

“He doesn’t want help. You can’t help someone who doesn’t want to be helped.”

“That doesn’t mean-”

“Can we talk about this later?”

“..Yeah. We..we can.”

Once the three of them made their way back to the dorm, they met with Aizawa, Hizashi, and Nemuri. Aizawa tapped his temple as he began to think of where he would go.

“What was the argument about?” Nemuri asked, glancing at her phone.

“I told him he was visibly depressed. Then he got all pissed.” Bakugo was leant back against the couch, a visible scoff on his face. He was still upset from the ‘You’re Izuku’s boyfriend and that’s it.’ comment he made.

“It’s not his fault,” Hitoshi defended Bakugo. “He didn’t mean to trigger Riso in any way. Riso’s just..there’s a lot of change happening and he doesn’t like it.”

“I mean, I’ve seen it too. The..depression. Who wouldn’t be severely depressed after experiencing what he did?” Izuku said softly.

“He’s had a few flashbacks here recently.” Hizashi glanced at the kids in front of him. His heart pained that these kids were experiencing such trauma. “He’s got PTSD. He has to.”

“He doesn’t want help though.” Bakugo crossed his arms. “We can’t help him if he doesn’t want it.”

“He’s just a kid.” Aizawa finally spoke. “These emotions are probably too great for him to handle alone. When we find him, we’re going to have to get him emitted into a mental hospital.”

“Wait, I thought therapy could be enough. Do we have to send him to a mental hospital?” Hitoshi asked, looking at Nemuri. She shook her head.

“Hound Dog, before Riso was kidnapped, told Shota that Riso could possibly benefit from hospitalization. We’ve done everything else, and we can’t risk him being alone.” Nemuri looked at the ground. “We’re not professionals in mental health. We really can’t help him anymore.”

“We should go looking for him,” Izuku says. “I-I mean..Kacchan and I could go, Hitoshi and Midnight could go, and Dad and Papa could go. Search the city, maybe?”

“Izuku, we can’t just-” Aizawa starts.

“I think it’s a good idea. Riso’s reckless, and we want to prevent him from hurting himself. He might unintentionally be doing it.”

Aizawa thinks for a moment. “I don’t want us to spend our entire night looking for him.”

“It’s okay, I’m willing.” Izuku nods.

“Fine. I guess we can do that.”

Until dark, the group searched. They would call his phone and search, they explored places he used to frequent, asking civilians if they had seen anybody. There was no luck. Riso was good at disappearing, and that's what makes this so scary. Bakugo and Izuku were with the police, asking about any calls for villains or vigilante activity. That was a dead end. Aizawa and Hizashi were checking rooftops and alleyways, trying to be as thorough as they could. Aizawa figured he might know Riso's pattern, as he used to patrol certain ways every night.

Hitoshi and Nemuri were looking in places where he had been hurt or his life changed. First they tried where the warehouse used to stand. Empty. They then tried the alleyway Izuku was stabbed in. Also empty. The alleyway to Hitoshi's old foster home. Empty. It was like walking into a dead end each time. It was rough for everyone the longer they went without finding him. By now, Bakugo began to feel responsible. He was the one who let Riso walk out, but he had felt so hurt in the moment that he didn't care. Izuku could try to tell him it wasn't, but he knew it was. Bakugo would never let himself rest until Riso was found. He may have went about trying to help him the wrong way, but the thought was there. Bakugo truly cared for Riso. Hitoshi was communicating with Izuku through an earpiece about where he could be when Izuku suggested a place.

"What about the roof where he and I first met?" His voice had shaken lightly. "The building I tried to jump from? He likes to be high when he needs to think."

So, currently, Nemuri and Hitoshi were on their way there. Hitoshi really hoped he was there, Nemuri did too. They both hated that they didn't catch how bad he was hurting. They knew he was struggling, but it was a lot worse. Hitoshi never should have left him alone after he broke down that night. There had to be so much weight on Riso's shoulders. Between PTSD flashbacks, depression, insecurities, trauma, Riso was dealing with a lot on his own. Hitoshi knew it was time for professional help. He couldn't ever remember thinking of putting someone in a mental hospital for their own good, but there's a first time for everything.

"He'll be okay, kid." Nemuri assured Hitoshi.

"..I know," Hitoshi muttered. "I feel so guilty. I should've gotten him help. I should've stressed how important he is and how important his health is."

“None of this is anyone’s fault. We all could’ve done more, but what matters now is finding him. Okay?” Nemuri smiled at him.

“Okay.” Hitoshi nodded.

They climbed up the building. Nemuri pulled Hitoshi up onto his feet, and he looked around. He paused, seeing Riso’s sitting figure across the roof. Nemuri looked at Hitoshi and told him to wait, and approached him. Hitoshi watched on nervously, but respected that Nemuri was more equipped for this kind of conversation. He just had to be supportive, from afar. She could see that his hair was pushed back by a headband (which Eri made for him) as he observed the bustling night city under him. His feet were swaying off the edge and he was silent. Nemuri sat next to him, keeping the silence. Riso didn’t look her way, and Nemuri didn’t look his way. They just sat next to each other.

“Lovely night,” Nemuri finally spoke.

“Yeah.” Riso muttered, his shoulders dropping. He looked down, watching the small amount of cars drive by. “I’m sorry.”

“What for?” Nemuri looked at him, tilting her head.

“Everything.” Riso let himself lean against Nemuri. He placed his head on her shoulder, resting there. “I’m a bad friend.”

“That’s not true at all, kiddo.”

“But it is true.” Riso subconsciously picked at his hands. “I got angry at one of my close friends. For wanting to help me. Then I pushed everyone away like I always do.”

“..Do you want help?”

“Yeah.”

“What’s so hard about asking for it?” Nemuri grabbed Riso’s hand, resting them on her thigh.

“Because then it’s about me. I don’t like talking about me. I hate it when something is about me. It never has been, so why should it be now? I’m supposed to be this..person who saves and helps others.” Riso explained quietly. “I can’t be that if I’m the one asking for help.”

“It’s your mental health, sweetheart.”

“It feels selfish.”

“Sometimes you have to be selfish, even if it’s techinally not that. You need to put yourself first.”

“It’s all so scary.” Riso closed his eyes tightly. “I can’t get the feeling of blood off of me. I feel exhausted. Everytime I wake up, for a moment, I wonder if I’m back where I was. Loud noises send me back, certain pain sends me back, phrases send me back. I just feel so..vulnerable. Like he’s still there, controlling and manipulating everything.”

Nemuri wrapped her arm around Riso. “I’m so sorry. You shouldn’t have to deal with that alone.”

“Am I broken?” Riso looked up at Nemuri.

“..A little. But we can fix it. You just have to trust me. Do you want me to help?”

“..Yeah.”

“Then let’s get going. It’s late,” Nemuri stood, pulling Riso up with her. “Let’s go get you some help.”

“..Okay.” Riso looked down at their hands. “Thank you.”

“It’s not a problem,” Nemuri gave a smile to Riso. “I’m here for you.” Riso’s grip tightened on her hands, and he looked up at her with teary eyes.

“..No, I mean it. Thank you, mom.”

Chapter End Notes

yes, i finally feel bad enough to let riso heal...i think i've put him through enough. i also adore bakugo and riso's friendship? and just to let you guys know, bakugo is more to riso than just izuku's boyfriend, he was just shutting down. but yay our boy is making steps towards recovery!

updates wednesdays and sundays!

Chapter Fifty Seven

Chapter Summary

Riso experiences his first day at the mental hospital.

Chapter Notes

its so weird to actually give my oc mental help since i usually like putting them through a bunch of shit LMAO but here we are!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

White. There was a lot of white and beige. It was like someone had taken all life from the rooms. The only color were the dark blues that were used as clothing for the patients. It was almost degrading. Nemuri had accompanied Riso to the mental hospital to help him settle in. He went during the day, so his friends were unable to go with him to see him off. Sunday, the day prior, Riso had spent it packing. He was only allowed a small amount of belongings, meaning he had to pick what he brought. Even after he chose, it had to be inspected by Aizawa, then the mental hosptial's staff. He also spent the day hanging with Class 1A before he was locked away for an unspecified time. 'Locked away' might've been the wrong terminology, but that's what it felt like to Riso.

He followed behind Nemuri as the staff toured the facility. Although he was supposed to be listening, he couldn't. He had to face the reality that this would be his home for at least three weeks. The bright, fluorescent light gave him a headache. How was he supposed to get better here?

"Riso?" Nemuri looked back at him. "You okay?"

"No." Riso muttered, looking at her tiredly. "But that's why I'm here."

Nemuri gave him a sympathetic look as she grabbed his hand. "I'm sorry. I know this isn't ideal."

“It’s okay.” Riso shrugged, “You’re only trying to help.”

“Okay,” The nurse smiled at Nemuri and Riso. He had stopped in front of a door, which was open. Lining the halls were other doors. Inside were a few essential items for living. A bed, dresser, mirror, nightstand. Off to the side was a door, without a corner, which Riso assumed was the bathroom. Everything was smooth and slanted, which was supposed to prevent suicide attempts. Can’t hang yourself if there’s a slant. “This is your room.”

Riso blinked. He had curled his hand into a fist, digging his fingernail into his skin for relief. The inpatient clothes they gave him scratched against his skin. He stepped forward.

“..It’s..something.” He pressed his lips together. It looked bland. The walls were a sad beige, each piece of future had a cheap oak coating. The mirror bent weirdly from the right angle, signifying it wasn’t real glass. The bedsheets were stiff, only a single pillow with a thin blanket covering the hard-looking black mattress.

“I know it’s not much,” The nurse apologized. “Once your things get delivered to the room, you’ll be able to decorate some.”

No decoration could make this place better.

“Yeah, sure.” Riso looked at Nemuri. She had kind eyes, but they were full of pity. He hated that everyone was looking at him like that.

“We can visit-”

“From three to five on weekdays, and twelve to five on weekends.” Riso responded. “..It’s okay. You don’t have to do this whole emotional goodbye thing.”

“Riso,” Nemuri sighed, placing a hand on her shoulder. “This is going to help you. I promise.”

“I wouldn’t make promises of situations you can’t control.” Riso told her quietly, smiling at her. She could see the pain in the smile.

“I love you, kid.” Nemuri wrapped her arms around Riso tightly, and he hugged back. He held onto her like he’d never see her again.

“I love you too,” Riso whispered. “I’m sorry for making everything so difficult.”

“Don’t ever apologize for that.” Nemuri kissed his cheek, and pulled from the hug. “I’ve got to go now, or I’ll be late to teach my class.”

“It’s eleven in the morning. I’d say you already missed some of it.”

Nemuri smiled sadly, ruffling his hair.

“I’ll see you as soon as I can, okay?”

“Okay.”

“Bye, kiddo.” Nemuri waved to him and followed a different nurse for the way out.

“Bye..” Riso’s voice faded as she walked down the hall. He looked at the nurse.

“I don’t expect you to like it here, but it really is for the better. How about you and I set you up for your first therapy session?”

“Can you kill me instead?” Riso asked, fully intending it to be a joke. He paused when he saw the disappointed look on the nurse’s face. “..Okay. No suicide jokes. Got it.”

“That’s the spirit. Follow me!” The nurse guided Riso down the hall. “So, tell me about yourself.”

“...I’m tall.”

“..I meant more like..hobbies? Or any important people in your life?”

Hitoshi . Riso thought of him instantly. Hitoshi meant a lot to Riso. Have you ever seen a beautiful sunset and wondered what could make it prettier? Then the sun rays suddenly peak through the clouds and it makes the view *that* much better? Hitoshi was that. Riso thought life had been just right, but when he came into his life, he didn’t know how he lived before that. Hitoshi took up most of his brain. Hitoshi this, Hitoshi that. Hitoshi wants this, he’d like that.

“I see a smile,” The nurse nudged Riso playfully. “Who’s the lucky girl?”

“.. *His* name is Hitoshi.” Riso felt annoyed slightly. He hated when others just assumed you were straight.

“Oh! I see.” He smiled. “What’s he like?”

“...He’s nice. Compassionate. He likes to save people. Make them smile.” Riso tried not to press his fingernail into his skin. “He’s a bright light in a dark room.”

“I get what you mean. My boyfriend’s the light of my life too.”

Riso didn't respond. He wasn't really up for small talk. That didn't stop this nurse, though.

"How rude of me!" He suddenly said, "My name's Akuto. I'm one of the younger nurses, so I try to help newcomers."

"..I'm Riso. Though you know that. And the reason I'm here. Very fair share of information." Riso glanced at Akuto.

"Ah, that's fair. I just don't want you to hate it here, you know?" Akuto sighed. "It's hard as is living your daily life, but getting put in a place like this feels like you're admitting defeat. I promise it's not like that. You're not admitting defeat, you're just achieving victory differently."

Setting up a proper therapist was tiring for Riso. He didn't like the process it took, how everyone was talking about how fucked up he was so casually. All to find the 'right' one for him. He just wanted to sleep at this point. By the time he had gotten back to his room, his box of things were on his bed. He walked over to it, putting out the first thing he could see. It was one of his journals, one of the six he packed. He flipped open the pages and gave a soft smile at the sketch he happened to land on. It was the sketch of Hitoshi he had done that one day everyone was at a pool. He ran his fingers over the pen markings. He had drawn Hitoshi smiling, which he adored. That was one thing about Hitoshi that Riso enjoyed the most. His smile. It was intoxicating. He never could stop his own smile when he saw Hitoshi's.

He grabbed the rest of his journals and set them on the nightstand next to the bed. He then pulled out a blanket. He ran his fingers over it as he laid on it on the bed. Nemuri had given this to him as he was packing, saying she knew this material was sensory friendly for him. To be fair, he did like that material. He flattened it out on the bed. He continued to unpack, pulling out things he had been given by Class 1A. It was small things, yes, but they were thoughtful. Jirou had given him a mp3 player with a few mixes for him to listen to, Kirishima gave him a small notebook of workouts to do if he wanted, Denki wrote a thing of jokes, Uraraka made him a small plushie, Momo got him a locket necklace. He was appreciative of his 'class.'

The last thing he pulled out from the box was a hoodie. It matched the custom hoodie he had made for Hitoshi. Except, it was black. He ran a hand over the embroidery. He picked up the note that was taped to it. Wonder when he slipped that in the box.

Hi, Riso. I really hope you don't find this until you're..settled. I know things are going to be difficult for a while, and I'm here for you. I don't know if they allow hoodies, but I took the strings out beforehand. This is my way of being with you the entire time, even if I can't physically be there. I think this is really going to help you.

- Hitoshi

Riso slipped the hoodie on, pulling it close to his body. The door opened, Akuto stood there.

"Hey, kid. You got visitors. C'mon."

Riso nodded. He shoved his hands in the hoodie pocket, and followed Akuto. He felt his heart pounding against his chest as he walked the halls. His head was racing.

What if they see me differently? What if this is how they're telling me they want ***nothing*** *to do with me? They're going to leave. They stuck me here so they can leave and I can't do anything.*

He walked into the visitor room. It had a little more color. More neutral colors though. It seemed like a really big living room. Riso walked over to where Hitoshi, Izuku, Aizawa, Present Mic and Bakugo were. He stopped once he was there, rubbing his arm. Izuku was the first to move. He basically tackled Riso in a hug.

"How are you doing?" Izuku asked quietly, pulling from the hug. "Do you like it here? Are they being mean? Do we need to complain and get someone fire-"

"Zuku," Riso said. "I'm okay."

"..Good." Izuku hugged him again. Riso hugged back, looking over Izuku's shoulder at the rest of his 'visitors'. They're more like family. Well, if he and Hitoshi last, they *will* be

family. God, Aizawa as his father in law would kill him. Once the hug ended, Hitoshi initiated the next hug. He held him tightly. The two of them held a long hug, obviously not wanting to let go.

“I’m so sorry I can’t be here any other time,” Hitoshi apologized.

“It’s okay, Toshi. It’s not..It’s not a big deal. Or your fault.”

“I..I know. I just..I don’t want you to think you’re alone.”

“I know I’m not.”

“No, Riso. I don’t think you know you’re not alone. You don’t have to hide that pain anymore.”

“...”

Riso nodded slowly. Before their conversation could move forward, Aizawa spoke up.

“How are the nurses here?”

“Nice, I guess.”

“Did they set you up for therapy?”

“That and medication. Medication comes after the first few therapy sessions.”

“And if they mistreat you-”

“Yeah, yeah. Tell you or Mic. Blah, blah.” Riso waved his hand dismissively.

“I’m serious.”

“I know.”

“Riso.”

“Oh my god, everyone’s being so serious. It’s seriously killing me.”

“..This is a serious thing, Riso.” Hizashi said.

“I *know* . I just want to stop feeling like I’m some- charity case or a super serious case. I’m just me. I need a little help and that’s it.”

“Well at least you know now.” Bakugo said. The softness of his voice was surprising to Riso. He looked at Bakugo, and bit his lip.

“Can we talk for a minute? Off to the side?”

“...Yeah.”

The two of them stepped off to the side, and Riso was the first to speak and break the silence.

“I’m sorry. I acted like a total asshole.” Riso sighed. “And..you are my friend. You’re not just Izuku’s boyfriend. I was angry, and..let myself say stupid shit.”

“You were hurting.” Bakugo shrugged. “I get it.”

“No. I said some really messed up stuff and I don’t want it to affect our relationship at all. I know we constantly fight, and yell at each other. We don’t even say that we’re actually friends. But you mean a lot to me. I’d never thought the day would come where I would tell Katsuki Bakugo that I cared about him, but then again I never thought I’d be in a mental hospital. Bakugo, thank you. Thank you for saving my life during the camp situation, thank you for having my back, thank you for looking after Izuku while I was gone. I mean it.”

Bakugo stared blankly. It was rare to see Riso speak from the heart like that. It warmed his own heart, and he hated that it did.

“I owe a thanks to you too, dumbass. You’re the reason I’m even with that nerd. Those things were the least I could do, since you were there for me too. Now can we quit the sappy shit before I puke?”

“Heh, yeah. Sure, blasty.” Riso snickered. He stuck his hand out. “Frieneimes?”

“No. Enemies.” Bakugo shook his hand.

The rest of the visit went smoothly. There was a lot of physical contact between Hitoshi and Riso. Bakugo, Izuku and the two Pros didn’t know who had attachment issues more. When the time came for goodbyes, it broke their hearts to leave Riso behind. They weren’t leaving him permanently, sure, but it still stung. It stung that Riso was even in this position in the first place.

Riso got back to his room after a few other things were done and now he just wanted to sleep. He’s wanted to sleep since he got there. He plopped on the bed, not even having enough energy to even pull the covers over him. He curled himself into the fetal position as he grabbed his pillow and held it close. He felt tears slip from his eyes. Hitoshi was right. He *did* feel alone.

Back at the Class 1A dorms, everyone in the common area was talking about the school festival that was coming up. Someone suggested they do a concert, and everyone else loved it.

“Oh my god, and then we can all wear matching outfits!” Mina smiled. “I can teach everyone to dance and we can have a whole thing!”

“I don’t know,” Jirou shook her head. “I..really don’t want to play anything-”

“You can teach us! You play like, every instrument right?” Denki got close to her face, when she placed her hand to him.

“I do. But I’m not that good.”

“Aw, c’mon!” Denki started pleading.

“Jirou,” Momo started. “I think it’ll be fun.”

“..Fine.” She grumbled. “We’ll need-”

“Kacchan can play the drums.” Izuku blurted out, smiling. “He’s been playing since we were kids.”

“Izuku.” Bakugo growled.

“C’mon, let’s hear it!”

As the commotion in the common area only got worse, Hitoshi left to go to his room. It didn't feel right without Riso there. He found his way into his dorm and he got into bed after changing. He grabbed the sweater Riso had given him the first time they met. He held it close to his chest. He rolled onto his back, looking at the ceiling. He missed him so badly. Since Kaizen had been taken to the hospital a few days ago due to Hitoshi noticing he was getting sick, it was a lack of certain nutrients, he really had nothing of Riso around to comfort him. It fucking sucked. Hitoshi felt guilty for leaving Riso there. It's supposed to help him but Hitoshi can't help but feel like he 'pushed' Riso off to someone else because he 'was too much to handle.' It wasn't true, but he felt like it.

He closed his eyes to force himself to sleep, but it only made the building tears slip down his cheek. These next few weeks would be long ones. Then, after that, there's a possibility he'll have to stay even longer. He just wanted to hold his boyfriend.

Chapter End Notes

kinda parallels for how hitoshi and riso fell asleep the same way. sad and alone lmao. rememer to be nice in the comments btw :) tone can be misused through text and i'd hate to take something the wrong way. anyway, enjoy!

updates wednesdays and suindays

Chapter Fifty Eight

Chapter Summary

Bakugo takes Izuku on a date.

Chapter Notes

i wanna apologize i wrote like all of this in the middle of a disassociative episode and im still in it rn LMAO. also i had an allergic reaction to my sisters cats on my hands so writing is kinda hard. anyway, enjoy some bkdk!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

It's been a week. A week of planning for the school festival, a week of constant therapy for Riso. The week had been a long and exhausting one. It was rough for everyone, things were hardly normal.

Izuku and Hitoshi were going to be responsible for part of the act where Uraraka is lifted in the air. Together, they were strong enough to run along the support beams and hold her up. Sure, it would've been better to use someone like Sato, but he was too big to fit comfortably. Hitoshi was nervous for a different reason, though. The school festival was to happen in the following days. The days Riso was still in the mental hospital. He wanted Riso to experience it, but he had no idea on how to ask such a question. Izuku also planned on bringing Eri, but then there was no one to watch Eri. If Riso was there, he'd be able to watch Eri (and ultimately Kaizen) during the festival and everything would be fine.

It was a stressful situation.

"H'oshi! H'oshi!" Kaizen jumped up and down. "Dancing! Can I go too??" Kaizen pointed to the group of practicing classmates. Hitoshi chuckled.

"Let's go ask." He grabbed Kaizen's hand and walked over to Mina. "Hey, I don't mean to bother… Kaizen wants to dance with you guys."

“Aw! Of course, c’mere little guy. You can help me!” Mina held out her arm. Kaizen took it with a big smile. Mina twirled him as the group awed. Hitoshi stepped away and went to the kitchen to grab a thing of coffee. Mina was teaching two groups at different times, so more people were able to help with other things. They really didn’t have a whole lot of time.

“Hitoshi.” Aizawa started, “It’s almost two. Don’t you think you should lay off the coffee?”

“You have a cup in your hand.” Hitoshi shot back, grabbed a cup of his own. “Change your ways and then I’ll change mine.” He smiled lightly.

Aizawa cracked a smile. “Your dad and I were talking, do you want Riso to come to the festival? We think it’d be a good opportunity for him to be surrounded in a positive environment.”

“I do. Izuku and I thought that if he did come, he could walk Eri around! We want her to get out too, since she hasn’t been around anything happy before. We think Kaizen would be there too, but I’m..worried he might not be able to come out. I mean, they’re not supposed to be let out. Right?”

“..You’re right, under normal circumstances Riso wouldn’t be allowed out of the mental hospital. But, his therapist reached out to us…She wanted to give him a taste of how things used to be. She thinks he could benefit from it greatly, since he’s been pretty closed off.”

“...He can come out?” Hitoshi’s eyes widened. “He can come see us perform?”

“Yes, kiddo. He can.”

I can see him in the sunlight, not a sad, white visiting room. Hitoshi couldn’t force his smile away. The thought of seeing Riso outside, away from the visiting room, gave him so much joy. It could seriously help Riso’s mental health as well. Hitoshi leaned forward and hugged Aizawa tightly.

“Thank you,” He muttered.

Izuku was being taught the dance routine with one of the groups, when Bakugo pulled him aside.

“Get dressed, we’re going out.”

“What?” Izuku looked at Bakugo. “Wait, what do you mean?”

“You heard me, we’re going out. Now hurry up.”

Izuku looked at Mina, who nodded and motioned for him to go. Izuku grabbed his sweater and walked with Bakugo to his dorm room.

“How do I need to dress?”

“In..clothes?” Bakugo blinked. “How else would you dress?”

“That’s not what I meant! Like dress for something athletic, something indoors where it might be cold, or cozy?”

“..Uh. I don't know, just put on a pair of pants and a shirt. It’s not that complicated.”

“Fine! Wait out here.” Izuku shut the door in Bakugo’s face. Bakugo blinked, before deciding to just lean against the door frame. He waited for about five minutes. Bakugo didn’t understand why Izuku needed so much time to get ready. He was already perfect. He looked over when the door opened. Izuku stood dressed in a pair of cute tan overalls, a white shirt, and a white bucket hat. Bakugo blinked again.

He got it now.

"..C'mon." Bakugo grabbed his hand. The two made their way down and out of the dorms. They seemed to be walking somewhere, which Bakugo wouldn't say where.

"Kacchan," Izuku huffed. "Where are we going?"

"Can't you just shut up and enjoy this walk?"

"Of course I enjoy this walk with you!" Izuku squeezed his hand, leaning against his body in a burst of energy. "I love spending time with you! I just wanna know where we're going."

"Of course you do."

"Pleasee??"

"No."

"Kacchan!"

"Stop asking." Bakugo looked at Izuku, and paused. "No. No- Your puppy dog eyes will *not* work on me."

…

"Izuku."

…

“No! I mean it, I’m not saying anything!”

“Fine.” Izuku pouts. He looks up at the sky with a smile. “It’s a pretty day out.”

“I know.”

“Would it kill you to have a bit of small talk?” Izuku teased.

“Yes. It would.”

“Well..How’s this for small talk?” Izuku leaned over and kissed Bakugo’s cheek. He blushed lightly. Bakugo looked over towards Izuku, who had an adorable grin on his face.

“...I like that form of small talk.” Bakugo said, letting himself smile.

“Aw, so you *do* like my kisses!”

“Shut up,” Bakugo felt embarrassed. Yes, he liked getting kissed by Izuku. He just didn’t want to say that aloud.

“Kacchan?” Izuku’s voice filled the silence that lasted just a little too long.

“Hm?”

“Do you think we’d have a big wedding?”

“..Wedding?”

“I was thinking about it the other day,” Izuku hummed as he rocked on his feet. “I don’t know who’d walk me down the aisle. Even if I was the one being walked down the aisle.”

“...Aizawa?”

“That..seems cheap.”

“Well do you want him to?”

“..It’d be nice..”

“There. He’s walking you down the aisle.”

Izuku smiled. “You always know what to say.”

“It’s just common sense.”

“Yeah, but it’s meaningful coming from you!”

“..Right.” Bakugo began to think about a potential wedding. He suddenly remembered the dream he had when he realized he had a crush on Izuku. “..I had a dream.” He usually didn’t admit things like this, but he trusted Izuku.

“..About?”

“You. We had kids. We were married and Pros.” Bakugo looked away from Izuku. He didn’t want to look at Izuku right now. He was worried that he would be upset with him. Instead, Izuku let out a squeal.

“You had a dream about us having kids?!”

“I just said-”

“Were they cute?”

“..Yeah. They had your eyes. It was like I was looking into a..small version of you.”

“That’s so cute,” Izuku smiled.

The two continued to walk and talk between each other. There was a lot more flirting than Bakugo had thought he would’ve done, but he couldn’t help it. Izuku was just too cute. They got closer, and Izuku began to recognize the area. He wasn’t exactly sure why though.

Bakugo stopped Izuku and motioned in front of him. Izuku let out a small gasp.

“Kacchan!” Izuku looked at him with bright eyes. They were at the playground they used to play at as kids. On the grass, there was a picnic basket.

“I know I’ve taken you on picnics before, but..I know things have been..blah, blah. Just- go sit down.”

“Did you just leave it all here??” Izuku asked.

“No, I..had my dad set it out before we got here.” Bakugo admits. “I hope that’s okay.”

“Of course it is! Did he help cook it?”

“Mhm.”

“Oh, I love his cooking.” Izuku crossed his legs on the blanket. Bakugo did the same. “..So you did this to help distract me?”

“Not to distract. Just..healthy way of dealing with things.” Bakugo looked at Izuku. “..And I wanted to spend time with you.”

And that’s what they did. They ate the food Bakugo’s father made for the two of them. They talked. Not about anything specific, they just talked. They held each other as they listened to the other. At one point, Izuku had even gotten up and ran to the playground. He grabbed a fist full of sand and threw it at Bakugo. He stiffened, but he smirked in return. He grabbed a fist of sand, and chucked it at Izuku. The two had the sand battle for almost thirty minutes. They ran around like little kids. Kids who didn’t care about heroes, villains, laws or responsibility. Any passersby would think it was two teens trying to cause problems, but to themselves they were four again. Four years old and playing on a playground.

Covered in sand, they landed back against the blanket. The sky was fading to dark, a dim orange coating over it. Clouds were disappearing. It looked like a good night to watch the stars. Izuku took a breath, smiling wide from the fun they had just had. He laid his head on Bakugo’s chest. His nose scrunched when he felt the sand on Bakugo’s shirt. He lifted his head, and brushed the sand off his shirt. He then laid his head back down. He yawned, letting his bucket hat fall off his head. He was too lazy to reach for it currently.

“Izuku,” Bakugo asked, twirling his fingers in Izuku’s hair.

“Hm?”

“..Do you like the stars?” Bakugo glanced down at Izuku. He looked back up at the sky, which had gone dark. Stars twinkled in the dark sky. “I..think they’re pretty. And unpredictable. Ever wonder if we might be seeing what’s there, or what's left of it?”

“..I do. They are pretty,”

“..Let’s watch them.”

“Okay!”

Bakugo and Izuku laid there in silence. The wind was cool, gently blowing their hair from their face. The sounds of the land around them was soothing. Bakugo felt…peaceful. The stars gave him an unfamiliar comfort. He wasn’t sure where it came from, because it wasn’t always like that. He used to find them annoying, actually. They were distracting at night.

Psst, between you and I, it’s because they remind him of Riso.

It didn’t take long for Izuku to fall asleep. Between the silence, Bakugo’s breathing and heartbeat, Izuku couldn’t force his eyes open any longer. Bakugo hadn’t noticed he had even fallen asleep until soft snores escaped his lips. Bakugo glanced down at him and smiled. He was so lucky to have Izuku. There were so many reasons why they never should’ve been together, but somehow they were. Bakugo didn’t believe in god, but if he did, it’d be for that reason.

Bakugo pulled out his phone to text his dad. He told him he’d need help to take the picnic things back to the house. He’d also have to tell Aizawa he’d be staying with his parents. He was confident in his ability to protect Izuku, but he didn’t want to wake up. His parents’ place wasn’t far and carrying him wouldn’t be alarming for that long of a walk. He wanted to be responsible. He had a precious boy in his hands. Well, not *yet* .

Bakugo wiggled from under Izuku, and scooped Izuku in his arms. He almost jumped when his father’s voice came from behind him.

"..Cute," He teased. He grabbed the picnic things. Bakugo rolled his eyes.

Bakugo walked inside his house after a short walk. He looked down at the sleeping Izuku in his arms. He smiled lightly. He went to his bedroom and placed Izuku in his bed. He covered him in the blanket and he turned to his phone. He paused, his finger hovering over Aizawa's contact. He took a breath and texted him, instead of calling him.

Izuku and I are out later than what I thought we would be so we're at my parents house. Sorry, sensei. I just thought it was safer this way

That's fine. Get home in the early morning tomorrow.

Yes sir.

Bakugo placed his phone on his dresser. He laid next to Izuku, (getting under the covers) and brushed hair out of his freckled face. He placed a gentle kiss on his nose before wrapping his arms around him. He fell asleep soon after.

Bakugo would go on to have *another* dream about Izuku and having kids with him. They really shouldn't have talked about it.

Chapter End Notes

ahh so sorry it feels like this chapter seriously sucks. love you guys :(

updates wednesdays and sundays!

Chapter Fifty Nine

Chapter Summary

Riso continues to heal in the mental hospital with great progress.

Chapter Notes

had the worst day ever yesterday, sprained my finger so this was incredibly painful to write, my keyboard broke, my dog tore up my childhood plushie, and my pillow. I'm also getting sick. so this is a short chapter and i'm sorry. ill try to make up for it. love you guys

See the end of the chapter for more notes

“How are you feeling?”

The voice caught Riso off guard. He looked up from his journal, locking eyes with his therapist. Mx. Anderson smiled softly at him, encouraging him to answer honestly without saying a word.

“...Fine.” Riso pushed the stray piece of hair from his face. Lately, he had realized his hair was getting longer so he was wearing it in a pulled back ponytail. He originally hated the idea of wearing his hair in a ponytail, but it was a lot more freeing than he thought. His eyes locked with the journal in his hands. To no surprise, a sketch of Hitoshi laid inside it.

“You have to be honest with me, remember?”

“I know.” Riso looked at them. “I’m trying.”

“So let me ask again,” She smiled. “How are you feeling today, Riso?”

“..Um..” Riso always found the first few minutes of therapy hard. He would have Mx. Anderson pry into him until he finally loosened up and spoke to her. It wasn’t his fault, and he didn’t blame them either. He just couldn’t open up immediately. “I..am frustrated?”

“That’s progress. Why are you frustrated?”

“I don’t feel safe here.” Riso admitted. He paused. “Well, I *know* I’m safe. I have no reason to feel unsafe. I think it’s…I’m emotionally vulnerable here. And- I..don’t like that.”

“That’s incredible progress. I’m so happy you’re able to spot these things.” Mx. Anderson wrote in her notebook. “What is it about emotional vulnerability that makes you uncomfortable?”

“..I don’t know. Makes me feel weak.” Riso shrugged, rubbing his thumb over the pencil sketch in his journal. “...Just don’t really like it.”

“Your home life,” They started. “How do you think that affected you now? When you told me about what you remember, there was clear neglect from your parents. Them treating you the way they did when you showed emotion, probably caused you to shut off. It’s hard to unlearn those habits. But you’re safe here, Riso. You’re allowed to feel. Everyone is.”

“...I know.” Riso just hated it. Whenever he indulged in his emotions, it sucked. Feeling was just not something he was good at.

“Do you wish for some familiarity?” Mx. Anderson’s question was one Riso hadn’t expected them to ask.

“..Yeah. Who doesn’t?”

“Your school is hosting a festival. I’ve been talking to one of the teachers at UA, Shota Aizawa? He’d like for you to be there.”

Riso sat up normally. He had been lounging back in the chair in a relaxed position, but now he was listening.

“It wouldn’t be for more than a few hours, and we typically don’t let patients leave hospital grounds. We figured…you would benefit from that positive experience. Would you like to-”

“I wanna go.” Riso nods. “Can I?”

Mx. Anderson smiled lightly. “Of course.”

After that, therapy went smoother. Riso, who now had something to look forward to, found it easier to open up. They talked for slightly longer than the original session was supposed to call for, but Mx. Anderson took what they could get. Once the session was over, Akuto was there to walk Riso to the visitor’s hall. Riso always had visitors. Whether it be Nemuri, Hitoshi and Izuku, or classmates.

“How was therapy, kid?” Akuto asked as they walked together. “Any new developments?”

“I get to go to a festival my school is having.” Riso rubbed his arm, trying to regulate his feelings.

“Yeah? Excited to see that boyfriend of yours?”

Riso couldn’t force away the small smile that found its way to his lips. “..Yeah.”

“Well, I’m glad you’ve got something good happening. How have you found it here so far?”

“Helpful.” Riso huffed. “Don’t want to admit it, but it's really helpful. I..don’t feel so alone.”

“I know. You’ve got a light coming to your eyes.”

“It’s only been a week-”

“A successful week.” Akuto opened the door to the visitor’s room. Riso walked in. He knew not to expect Hitoshi or Izuku since they were training together today. But he did not expect Tokoyami, Shoji and Todoroki.

“..Hey, guys.” Riso walked towards them. “..Didn’t expect to see you three.”

“We wanted to see how you were doing.” Todoroki stepped forward.

“We’ve been worried about you since..-” Shoji didn’t have to say it.

Since they watched him *die* .

“I..I know.” Riso rubbed the back of his neck.

“Are you getting good enough help? I can demand my dad to get you better doctors.” Todoroki’s deadpan face made Riso laugh.

“No, no. They’re doing just great here, Todoroki.”

“Riso, I know I was the one who-”

“Ah. Not your fault.” Riso cut Tokoyami off. “It’s really not your fault. Don’t blame yourself.”

“But I can’t act like it didn’t happen. I caused it, Riso. You’re permanently scarred from that.”

“Listen, bird boy.” Riso pressed his lips together. “I don’t want you worrying that I’m upset or angry at you for what happened. You didn’t mean to. I don’t care. I know it traumatized me, but please don’t blame yourself. You’d never be able to rest if you lived your whole life regretting something you had no control of.”

“....”

The silence spoke a lot. Tokoyami, something out of character for him, hugged Riso. Riso stiffened for a minute before hugging back. Sure, Riso had talked to Tokoyami about it before, but this was therapeutic. Any tension the two had was just resolved. They pulled from each other.

“So what’s this about a school festival I hear? What are you guys going to be doing?” Riso didn’t want to mention he’d be able to go, but he still wanted to talk about it.

“A concert.” Shoji said. “We’ve got it all planned out.

“It should be fun.” Todoroki nodded.

“Well, I hope it all goes well. I believe in you guys.”

The four talked until the ending of visiting hours. It was a change in tone for Riso, he usually had more upbeat classmates come see him to make him feel better. But a mature, soft conversation with Shoji, Todoroki and Tokoyami was seemingly something Riso needed. Once he was in his room, he laid in his bed. He stared at the ceiling. He began to go over the

difficult things he's had to face alone, Mx. Anderson asked him to during one of their first sessions.

Before Izuku, there was a *lot* he dealt with alone. Injuries, traumatic villain saves, just rough days in general. His mind wandered to things like the Hosu incident, how he literally sewed up his wound on a roof. *Alone* . He had never even felt seen for years. He figured he should maybe talk about that in his next therapy session. He sighed, rolling over and curling himself in his blanket.

Since tomorrow was a Saturday, he could finally sleep in. He had therapy everyday except for Saturday. He let himself sleep until he was being shaken away by Akuto.

"Kid." Akuto's voice guided Riso awake. "Riso, you've got visitors."

"Huh?" Riso sat up, feeling groggy. *That* was a good night's sleep. "What time is it?"

"Twelve ten. C'mon, up you go. A different nurse has to take you down there, I've gotta help Mizu with the younger kids."

Mizu was Akuto's boyfriend. The two worked together, but Mizu was better with the younger kids. Akuto was too rough sometimes, but Mizu was always delicate. Riso had grown to like Akuto and Mizu more than the others.

"Oh. Okay, thanks." Riso stood up. He looked in the fake mirror, pulling his hair back. He grabbed his journal and walked out of his room. He was met with Kenny, another nurse.

"Ready?"

"Sure."

The walk to the visitor's room was different. Riso felt his heartbeat increase the closer he got. His battle senses were going berserk. Something was screaming at him to turn around and not take these visitors. He knew it had to be some of his classmates, or even the staff. He wasn't sure why his body was telling him to do everything opposite of what he was doing.

Kenny opened the door for Riso, and he stepped in. His eyes were glued to his journal, he needed to finish the sketch he had been working on of Bakugo….as a pomeranian. Hey, he needed to occupy his time somehow. He walked forward, almost like muscle memory. He froze dead in his tracks when he heard the sound of a familiar, gruff voice. He looked up and his eyes went wide, fear coating them.

"Hey, son." Oto smiled pathetically at him, Anshin holding his hand. "It's good to see you again."

Chapter End Notes

bam, twist at the end. did you really think i'd give you a happy chapter last update and NOT do sumn like this? love you guys thanks for reading (comments are appreciated) (also riso's therapist's pronouns are she/they) once again sorry for such a short chapter. this was supposed to be more thought out but haha life hates me yk. hopefully my finger heals soon

updates wednesdays and sundays

Chapter Sixty

Chapter Summary

Riso stands up for himself against his parents. It ends in blood.

Chapter Notes

DISCLAIMER!! THERE IS HEAVY HOMOPHOBIC TERMINOLOGY IN THIS CHAPTER! Oto and Anshin are seriously homophobic and say some horrible things. For the record, I myself am a trans gay man, so i'm not just some person using the slurs randomly. I don't use these terms lightly and i understand this chapter may be upsetting to some for that reason. so please read with caution. i love all of you and i'd never dream to make any of you upset. love you and please enjoy the chapter!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Uncomfortable silence. No. Not uncomfortable. The feeling of an itchy sweater in hot weather, nails on a chalkboard, forks scraping against a glass plate. That feeling. That feeling mixed with silence. Anger, not sadness, boiled inside of Riso as he stared at his ‘parents’. They didn’t even deserve that title.

“I..we’ve been so worried, I didn’t know where you were after you ran away.” Anshin stepped forward. Her voice was soft, and comforting.

“Son, your brother..He’s gone missing. We were wondering if..” Oto glanced at Anshin, then Riso. “Could you help us find him?”

“We want you back in our family, too! I really hope this place is helping you get over your disease.” Anshin smiled. Such an innocent smile. One of ignorance.

“I couldn’t stand seeing you suffer like that.” Oto shook his head. “You're our son. We’d never want to-”

Riso let a low chuckle escape his lips. His hands were shaking lightly, a heavy pressure against his chest. His whole world was spinning so fast it looked slow. He laughed again, tears slipping down his cheeks.

"...That's funny." He spoke. It sounded stressed, like his throat was closed.

"..What?" Anshin asked. Her demeanor was so sweet. So *motherly* . Her green eyes shimmered as tears pooled at her eyeline. No. Her green eyes were overflowing with resentment and hate. Her tears were nothing more than manipulation.

Eyes were a way into a Sakusei's soul.

"Don't what me." Riso's voice boomed against their ears even though he spoke softly. "You don't get this luxury."

"Luxury?" Oto asked. "Son-"

" **No** . I am ***not*** your son. I stopped being your son when you started hitting me. I stopped being your son when you abused me because I wasn't a girl. I stopped being your son when your wife stabbed me and kicked me out for being in love with a man." Riso felt his face flush red. "I have never been your son, really. You never cared for me like one, so why the hell are you acting like it now? So I can find the *improvement* from me? The kid you want to grow up to be just like you? Someone snagged him from his own fucking home and I haven't seen a slighter of worry or attempts to get him back."

"Riso-"

"Do not fucking call me that."

"I am your father, and you will listen to me."

Riso stepped forward, meeting Oto face to face. “I’m not scared of you.”

“Pfft. Like hell you aren’t.” Oto growled, raising his arm. He attempted to slap Riso, but he grabbed his wrist tightly.

“You are a part of my past, and I plan on keeping you there.”

“Baby, you know your father has a hot temper.” Anshin pulled Oto back, and she smiled at Riso. “Really, how have you been..?”

“You want to know how I’ve been?” Riso pushed his tongue to the roof of his mouth for a moment. “I’m still ‘sick’ with my disease. Matter of fact, I’m with another boy. You know that, Anshin? I’m in love with a boy. *Again* . He has made me happier than you ever fucking have!”

“Hey,” Akuto rushed over quickly, “Riso, security is on their way. Come with me and-”

“No.” Riso shook his head. “They need to hear this.”

“Riso,” Akuto says. “Come with me.”

“You made me who I am. You made me incapable of feeling. Incapable of sharing with others. You did this to me. You turned me into something I hate. I can’t even look at myself in the mirror because all I see is you two. I see you in myself and it’s fucking horrible.” Riso looks at his hands in disbelief. “You’re worse than villains. You are the reason I strive so hard to put others before me! Well, for fucks sake, once in my damn life I want it to be about me!”

“No wonder you’re stuck in a mental hospital.” Oto sneered. “You’re a useless, selfish, faggot.”

“Oto-”

“Stop pretending, *mom* .” Riso tilted his head. “Go on. Agree with him. You’ve stabbed me in the face. What’s a little verbal abuse?”

“Listen here, you fucking shit face. We’re finding Kaizen. You kidnapped him, didn’t you? We’re going to put you in jail. Maybe there they’ll treat you how you queers like it-”

Something snapped. Riso’s movements were so fast it took everyone by surprise.

Riso had punched his biological mother in the face so hard, she fell against the floor knocked out cold. He shook his hand, feeling his knuckles burn from the pressure of the punch. Oto lunged for him. Riso grabbed his arm, and flipped him over his back. He forced him against the ground, and he dropped to the floor just as fast. He was hovering over Oto, anger fueling his every move. He took a breath, just keeping him pinned against the floor. He didn’t enjoy hurting people.

“I knew I should’ve gotten rid of you and that other useless kid as soon as I could’ve. How much do you think I can get for Kaizen?” A sinister smirk displayed across Oto’s face. Riso didn’t even feel the hands of Akuto trying to pull him off.

Riso winded back his fist. It connected with Oto’s face, a crack was felt under Riso’s knuckles and echoed in the room. Blood began pouring from Oto’s nose. That didn’t stop Riso or his punches. Teeth were being knocked from Oto’s mouth, blood staining Riso’s knuckles. One hand gripped his shirt to keep his limp body in the right position to comfortably get punches in. He felt a second pair of hands pulling on his body. He couldn’t stop. Everything around him was blank. All the rage, sadness, and pain he’d felt was coming out onto the main problem. It wasn’t until he felt something tight wrap around his body that he stopped. He couldn’t see, his vision was blurred. Was it the tears? The anger? He didn’t know.

“Riso,” A comforting and soothing voice grounded him. “Riso, hey, look at me.”

Riso felt his head being guided in a direction. He blinked a few times. Once his vision cleared, he was met with a concerned face. Nemuri was looking at him. Her eyes were so soft and full of worry for him. His eyes flickered around. He felt his stomach drop when he saw the scene in front of him.

Anshin was on the floor, her face was starting to bruise. Oto looked…not like Oto. The deep red that coated his face made him almost unrecognizable. The missing teeth and crooked nose didn't help either.

"Wait," Riso started. Akuto and Kenny were both examing Oto, checking for a pulse. Unfortunately, he still had one. Behind those two stood Aizawa, and behind Aizawa stood Hitoshi, Izuku and Bakugo. Aizawa had a deadpan look, so it was difficult seeing how he felt. Izuku was squeezing Bakugo's hand tightly, the two both had a shocked and surprised face.

Hitoshi. Oh god, *Hitoshi* . He was staring at the limp, bloody body. His eyes were wide, his expression unreadable. Fuck. That's the last thing Riso wanted. The love of his life wouldn't ever look at him the same again, would he?

"Wait, no." Riso's voice was so small Nemuri almost missed it. "No, I didn't mean to." He looked at Nemuri. She cupped his face to get him to focus on her.

"I know."

"No, no..I..I didn't mean to, please I didn't mean to hurt him so bad." Riso's knees felt weak. He hadn't even realized they gave out until he felt the sharp pain sting his knees. He felt sick. His stomach churned. Oto had abused him his entire life, why didn't that revenge beating feel good? Why did it make him want to crawl from his own body? He deserved it.

So then why did Riso feel so bad about it?

"Riso!" Nemuri kneed next to him, a hand on his back. Riso didn't respond to her. He had both hands on the floor, his knees grinding against the cool floor. He placed a hand to his chest, forcing the sob that was threatening to come out down.

“Shit. Hey, c’mon kid.” Nemuri guided Riso to his feet. She helped him walk out into the hall, and sat him in a chair. “Look at me, Riso..”

Riso couldn’t hear her. His heart was pounding so loudly in his ears, he couldn’t hear anything but that. He squeezed her hand, unable to break the blank stare he had developed with the floor.

“Riso,” Nemuri hummed. “I need you to respond to me, baby. Can you do that?”

Riso hummed in return, mimicking the noise she made. He felt his eyes wobble as he pulled them from the floor. He looked at Nemuri, and she smiled gently at him.

“Hey,” She said softly, brushing the hair that had fallen from his ponytail out of his face. “Are you okay?”

Riso nodded. He couldn’t speak. He could hardly even see. He felt his chest rise and fall rapidly as images of his father flashed in his mind. He ruined his face. He beat him senseless. Riso didn’t like hurting people. He didn’t want to hurt anyone. But he did. In front of the people he loved.

He hadn’t realized he wasn’t breathing until he tried to gasp for air and nothing entered his lungs.

Oh no, no no. Please, I can’t do this.

Riso reached for Nemuri’s supportive hand. He didn’t feel her anywhere he reached. He shakily gasped, barely supplying his brain with enough oxygen. He could feel the tears falling down his cheeks. He needed someone so bad right now. Where was Nemuri?

“Riso!” Both his hands were wrapped in someone else’s. They held on tight. “I’m right here. Breathe in with me, okay? Four seconds. That’s all I need.”

Riso struggled. He could barely even open his mouth, but he slowly managed to breathe in for four seconds. His breath was shaky as he exhaled. He closed his eyes tight when he felt a hand on his cheek.

“..There you go..” He finally recognized the voice. He slowly opened his eyes. Hitoshi. He was looking at him with such kind eyes. Eyes that were so forgiving. “Let me see your hand.”

Riso held out his right hand to Hitoshi as he watched his every move.

“We should clean this..Did you get hurt, Riso?” Hitoshi looked over his body, searching for any wounds. “I thought you got hurt.”

You’re worried about me being hurt? Did you even see what I did to Oto?

“..Riso?” Hitoshi asked. “Can..you say something?”

As much as he tried, he couldn’t get a word out of his mouth. Although he was trying to, nothing happened. The same phrase passed in his mind but couldn’t force it out. Eventually, he shook his head.

“..I..That’s okay.”

‘Are you upset with me?’ Riso signed. Hitoshi shook his head.

“No. I’m worried about you. It was unfair to have your parents show up and not have a strong reaction. Personally, I would’ve done worse.” Hitoshi smiled.

‘I don’t know why I can’t speak. I’m sorry. I ruined everything.’

“No you didn’t. We’re here to help. Nemuri went to get your therapist and got me during your panic attack... You..won’t be in any trouble for what happened. He provoked you. They both did. Your nurses are vouching for you..Izuku is too. He’s hellbent on it.”

‘I’m sorry you saw me like that.’

Hitoshi grabbed Riso’s face by his cheeks and looked him in the eye. “Riso. I don’t mind seeing that side of you. It’s not pretty, but it’s still *you* .” He placed his forehead to Riso’s. “And I love every part of you.” Hitoshi closed the gap between them, the two sharing a quick kiss. Hitoshi pulled from the act of attraction and stood up.

“Let’s get you cleaned up. Maybe get some ice for your hand.” Hitoshi helped Riso to his feet. He held his hand tightly as he began to walk. A short walk later, they ran into Mx. Anderson. She immediately took the two of them into her office where she had a first-aid kit. They were cleaning Riso’s wound when they glanced at Hitoshi.

“You must be the boyfriend.” They smiled. “I’ve heard much about you.”

“..He talks about me?” Riso blushed as Hitoshi looked at him. “..Does he say good things?”

“I’d think he was an imposter if he said anything negative about you.” Mx. Anderson chuckled. “You’ve helped him greatly, you know.”

“I..I try. I really do.”

“He’s got a very complex mind. You seemed to have unraveled some of it yourself.”

Riso tuned out their conversation. He couldn’t help but think about what he did to Oto. It was complicated. Oto deserved that, but there was no satisfaction for Riso. He almost felt bad.

He'd never let anger fuel him but only once before, and that was when Izuku had been stabbed. He hated being capable of such violence. Sure, kicking a villain's ass was therapeutic sometimes. But Riso had never left them bloody and bruised like he did Oto. Should he even feel bad? He's got no reason to. He was just a kid who had been pushed over the edge.

He hated fighting himself over his own morals. Though, his actions had been seen by the entire staff. They could vouch that they were horrible parents and Kaizen could get rehomed easier. But then again, now Riso could be seen as aggressive. He didn't want that title. He was smart, not aggressive. But then again, he couldn't control how others saw him. There was no controlling how he was perceived after that.

"Riso?" Mx. Anderson called him back from the land of thoughts. "Are you alright?"

Riso nodded. He fiddled with his hands, picking at his fingernails. He hadn't noticed they were finished cleaning and icing his hand.

"Tell me what you're thinking." She asked.

'With Hitoshi here?'

"Yes. If he makes you too uncomfortable, we can ask him to leave. But I figured..you need his support right now."

Hitoshi reached around Riso's arm and grabbed his hand. He ran his thumb up and down his hand, soothing Riso's need to pick at his nails. He smiled at Riso softly. For a second, Riso pulled his hand away to sign.

'Am I wrong for hurting him?'

"You mean Oto?"

Riso nodded.

“Considering the things we’ve discussed previously, Oto was a very bad man. He was abusive and controlled every aspect of your life even if you didn’t realize. Out there, you just took back control. Sure, the violence was a little..overboard.” Mx. Anderson looked at Riso. “But realistically, no one can blame you for your actions. They can’t and shouldn’t.”

Riso let out a sigh, a relieved one. Now he doesn't feel so bad. He still hated seeing the scene play over in his head.

‘If he deserved it, why do I feel so guilty?’

“Well…You’ve told me before you don’t like violence. It was a main part of your childhood. You’ve stated that even though you do fight others, you’re not doing it with the intention of just fighting. You gave them a chance to give themselves up. Maybe you see this act as something Oto would’ve done, and that makes you upset.”

She was right. Oto *would’ve* done something like this. Riso didn’t want to be like his ‘father.’ He looked at Hitoshi, who was staring at him longingly. He nudged Riso.

“Don’t worry,” Hitoshi started. “You’ll never be like him. You’re so much better than he is.”

‘Are you sure?’

“Yes, Riso. I’m sure. I’m positive your therapist agrees.”

“I do.” They nodded. “Riso, you’re a good kid. You’re severely traumatized and it’s changing your day to day life. And I know you hate change. You have to be patient. Things won’t get better fast. This..hiccup in your healing process may even help later on.”

Riso looked down at his hands. Maybe he should stop feeling guilty. Oto had beaten him, maybe not this bad, before. Riso suffered broken bones because of him. He had no reason to feel guilty. Even if he hated violence, he could make an excuse for himself once. He defended himself after all these years.

So that’s what he did. He tightened his recently cleaned fist as he noticed the yellowing skin on his knuckles. A smile tugged at the corners of his mouth.

Oto couldn’t hurt him anymore. He was no longer a danger. Riso could have one small victory without feeling remorse.

Chapter End Notes

i can't say that wasn't well deserved. riso's hands are rated e, for everyone! yes riso does go non-verbal. I hope i didn't write it incorrectly as i asked some people i know who go non-verbal what it's like for them and went off their experiences. (comments appreciated)

also i sliced open my thumb. i feel like i keep getting finger injuries? AND im getting sick. theres no break for me. but don't worry, nothing ever stops me from getting a chapter out (unless ao3 is down or my internet is down)

updates wednesdays and sundays

Chapter Sixty One

Chapter Summary

Aizawa brings up concerns and Riso spends time with Eri and Kaizen.

Chapter Notes

i am so sorry for the late chapter i've been running a fever of almost 103 F the past couple of days so i tried to get something out! so sorry if it's bad. love u guys

See the end of the chapter for more notes

There were only a few more days until the actual school festival, so things were tense. Everyone was worried about it being perfect and nerves were getting to them. Aizawa himself could feel the gray-hairs coming in faster than he could keep track. He was especially worried when Riso would be let out and in the outside world again. Hey, could you blame him? Riso liked to escape.

Speaking of Riso, Aizawa's hands were currently both occupied by two kids. Kaizen and Eri. They'd been wanting to visit him for a while, but things weren't really working out that way. So he finally made time today to take them to see him. All the students were busy, meaning Hitoshi was also busy. Aizawa had to watch after the two on his own and now he really wishes he never agreed to this!

After Oto and Anshin showed up unexpectedly, Riso had been put under a 'possible violent' category. Aizawa found that to be bullshit, but also sort of true. Sure, he was capable of being violent, I mean..everyone saw what happened to Oto. At the same time, he'd never hurt anyone else without reason. Just don't give him a reason and you'll be safe. Aizawa turned to Eri and Kaizen, and squatted to their level once they were in the visitors room.

"Remember, he's not here forever. Okay? You only have a few hours to spend with him." Aizawa said softly. "It's not my rules, but the buildings."

Eri nodded. Kaizen scoffed.

“No fair!” Kaizen stomped. “I want to spend time with my bubba!”

“You will, Kaizen.” Aizawa sighed. “Just..-”

“Kaizen! Eri!” Riso’s voice came from the door. The two little ones looked over and Kaizen smiled wide. Eri just had a small twinkle in her eyes. Aizawa watched as Riso squatted and opened his arms for a hug. The two ran to him, and tackled him (as much as their little bodies let them).

Aizawa watched as Riso talked to Eri and Kaizen softly. The three of them looked content, happy even. Aizawa let out a sigh of relief. Everytime he had come to see Riso with either Hitoshi or Izuku, or even Nemuri, he looked better. The eyebags that once accompanied his eyes weren’t as dark. He looked fuller in the face, which meant he most likely was eating regularly. He felt proud of Riso. He’d never say that, but he was. It was hard to find help, and even harder to ask for it. Aizawa approached Riso and looked at him.

“I have to make a phone call. Can you watch them?”

“Of course, sir.” Riso nodded. “I can handle these two rascals.”

“..Good. I’ll be back in a few.”

Aizawa walked out of the visitors room and out of the building. He stood on the steps and dialed Hizashi.

“Yo! Is everything okay?”

“Yeah. Nemuri there?”

“Mhm. I can put you on speaker!”

There was some shuffling.

“Okay you’re on speaker! What’s up?”

“I’m here at the mental hospital.” Aizawa looked up at the blue sky. “When he comes back, how are we supposed to keep him from falling into old habits?”

“That..is a good question.” Nemuri’s voice was hesitant. *“I don’t want to give him a hard time. I want him to open up to us on his own.”*

“Isn’t therapy supposed to be doing that?”

“Only temporarily, Hizashi. I mean, you remember what happened when I stopped going to that one therapist.”

“..Can’t we just keep letting him see the same one?” Hizashi asked.

“I don’t know if they accept clients outside of the hospital.”

“We should ask.” Nemuri says. *“Mic’s got a point. We could try to keep the same one.”*

“What made you think of this anyway?”

“I see improvement in him. He just looks better. I want to keep him that way.”

“We can try to fill his schedule again.”

“Absolutely not. He was overworked.”

“But it kept him-”

“From breaking down. We solved that quirk problem, remember? There’s no reason to overwork him again. I hate that we even had to do that.”

“Maybe we can ask Hitoshi to keep an eye on him.”

“That doesn’t seem fair to him. We shouldn’t rely on Hitoshi to monitor Riso.”

“So what do we do?”

“..I don’t know.”

There was a short pause.

“Nemuri?”

“I don’t like that tone, what?”

“This is your decision.” Aizawa took a second. “Once he’s mentally okay again, are you going to let him do vigilante work again?”

"...I think so. He was good at what he did. He saved multiple lives."

"But it's dangerous, isn't it?"

"Did that stop you from becoming a hero?"

"...Shut up."

"I'm just saying."

Inside the building, Riso was sitting criss-crossed at a coffee table. He watched as Eri and Kaizen drew on paper in crayon.

"..Are you gonna draw with us?" Eri asked. Riso looked down at her. He smiled.

"Sure, darling. What do you want me to draw?"

"Um…A unicorn!"

"A unicorn?" Kaizen asked. "Dats stupid!"

"Kaizen, that's not nice. Unicorns aren't stupid." Riso said, "If Eri likes them, then that's okay."

"Dragons are better!" Kaizen crosses his arms.

"..Nu uh. Unicorns are pretty."

“Dragons can breathe fire!”

“Okay, okay.” Riso chuckled. “How about..I draw a unicorn that can breathe fire? How does that sound?”

“..A unicorn that can breathe fire?” Kaizen thinks. “Now dats pretty cool!”

“..Fire is scary,” Eri muttered, leaning closer to Riso. “Does it have to breathe fire..?”

Riso smiled at Eri. “I know it might be scary,”

Scary? It was terrifying. He knew Eri had seen fire be used against him in ways fire should never be used. But that’s not what scared him. The warehouse fire was what caused his fear of fire to brew. He wasn’t even aware of how frightened he was of it.

Orange. There was a lot of it. The heat was so intense it almost knocked the breath out of Riso. He looked around frantically.

“Hey! Is anyone stuck?!” He called out, covering his face when a support beam fell. Ash and flame was thrown up into his face. He coughed. His attention was caught when a yell was heard.

“Help! My leg is stuck!”

He ran forward, trying to avoid the smoke that was pooling at the roof. He kept his head low as he spotted the individual. He scanned the area.

“I’ll help, I just need to find a way to get this off your leg! Can you breathe??”

“Barely..! It hurts..!”

There was a support beam laid across their clearly broken leg. He huffed, and pulled his gloves off of his hands. He took a deep breath and put his hands under the wood. He cringed at the feeling of his flesh burning. He barely managed to pull it off before he dropped it again. He jumped over it and kneeled next to the downed person.

“I’m going to pick you up, okay?”

“...You really planned on saving me?”

“..What? Yes.”

“...I’m sorry.”

“..Why are you sorry?” Riso’s eyes trailed down to their hand. There was a grenade without a pin.

“Riso?” Eri nudged him. Riso blinked, ignoring the ringing in his ears as he looked down at Eri.

“..But fire can be really pretty sometimes.” Riso finished his previous sentence.

“Unicorn that can breathe fire!! Hurry and draw it, bubba!”

“Okay, okay. I’m getting to it!” Riso chuckled. He opened his journal and grabbed a pencil. He looked at his hands, which had scarring on them. He took a breath and focused on his drawing.

Chapter End Notes

im sorry if this doesn't make much sense i'm pumped full of meds LMAO. comments appreciated! see you guys on wednesday!

updates on wednesdays and sundays!

Chapter Sixty Two

Chapter Summary

The school festival happens with no problems! (I promise)

Chapter Notes

internet is still out but i went to the library to post this for you guys! can't update from my phone bc my doc crashes! but love u guys enjoy :)

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Riso wiped his eyes tiredly. He was dressed in normal clothes for once. He was relieved it wasn't just a hoodie and the irritating inpatient pants he usually wore. He was in pants that resembled jeans, but not jeans because he *hated* denim, and an oversized t-shirt. He anxiously waited on the bed. At six, Akuto walked in.

"Morning, Riso. How'd you sleep?" He asked, adjusting his clipboard.

"I didn't." Riso shrugged. "How could I?"

"Good point. Who's picking you up?"

"Mom." Riso said after a moment of hesitation. "...She said she'd be here before seven."

"Good. Come with me. I have rules to go over," Akuto motioned for Riso to follow him. He did as told.

"Are they dumb?"

“No. You need to follow them.”

“Oh, serious voice. Got it.”

“Rule one. No trying to escape.”

“Wasn’t going to.”

“Rule two. Don’t do anything that would get you put in here.”

“..Right.”

“Rule three. You’ll be expected to check in with an adult every hour.”

Riso listened to each rule, less impressed each time. He let himself drift from the conversation. He was only brought back to reality when Nemuri grabbed his shoulder.

“Ready to go?”

“Yes ma’am.” Riso followed her out to the car. He nervously fiddled with his hands as they started to drive. She glanced at him.

“What’s wrong?”

“What do we do if a villain appears?” Riso asks. “What if this just accidentally makes things worse for Eri? Then what?”

“..We have security measures for that, kiddo.”

“But those can still fail.”

“Riso.”

“I’m sorry.” He muttered, looking out the window.

“Don’t be sorry. I know you’re worried.”

“I can’t help it. What happens if she…just gets more traumatized? What if she thinks every good thing is going to fail?”

“That won’t happen. We’re going to make sure of it. Do you think you’ll be able to keep yourself together during this festival? I don’t want you more stressed because you’re overly worried for Eri and Kaizen.”

“..I’ll be fine.” Riso looked at his hands. His fingernails and the skin around them looked rough. He had picked up the habit of picking at them. He doesn’t remember when it started, but he noticed it every time he wanted to do it again.

“I need you to be sure. Remember, this is supposed to help you too.” Nemuri glanced at him, putting her hand on his knee. She smiled lightly. “Don’t let this ruin it for you. I promise we’re doing all we can. All the teachers are patrolling, we even got a shit ton of other Pros to come help. Nezu even told us if there’s even a single alarm, false or not, the entire thing gets shut down. That’s the only way the police were going to let us continue.”

That *did* make him feel slightly better. He knew the police were hardly any help, but other Pros being there would at least strike fear into whoever was going to try anything. If there even was someone. You couldn’t blame Riso for being so worried, though.

The car ride to the school felt like forever. The closer they got, the more nervous Riso became. He didn't want to mess this up for his brother or Eri. It wasn't fair to them they were put under his care, he thought. He was unstable. He didn't even deserve to be out here.

Or maybe that was just the mental illness coming from him. He found it harder to be happier the more he let himself feel, but he was seeing a difference in his behavior. The road to recovery was hard.

The car stopped. Riso got out with Nemuri, and he was met with a hug. Kaizen had run over quickly and tried to tackle him in a hug. He smiled as he looked up at Riso.

"Big brother!"

"Hey, Kaizen. Are you excited?"

"Uh huh!"

Riso looked over to Eri, who was standing beside Aizawa. She gulped and tightened her grip on her red overalls. Riso smiled at her, walking over.

"Hi, Eri." He leaned down to see her better. "I like your outfit."

"..Thank you," She said quietly after looking up at Aizawa for permission to speak.

"Riso," Aizawa started. He already sounded tired. "Are you sure you can handle them both?"

"Yes sir." Riso nodded. "I can handle them both."

“..Good. I trust you.” Aizawa leaned down to Eri. “You’re going to be with Riso all day, okay? He’ll protect you. Nothing will happen.”

I’ll protect her? Is she worried about the same thing I am? Riso wondered as Eri walked over to Riso. She looked up at him.

“No bad guys?” Her voice was so soft it made Riso’s heart tighten.

“No bad guys.” Riso nodded. “And if one shows up, I’ll do everything to protect you. Do you trust me?”

Eri nodded. She grabbed his hand and looked back at Aizawa. She waved slightly, which caused a smile to appear on his face. Riso grabbed Kaizen’s hand and guided the two into the festival.

“Eri’s beyond worried.” Aizawa said to Nemuri. “She said she was worried that someone would come for her and ruin the whole thing.”

“Riso too. He was worried it would ruin the experience for Eri.” Nemuri leaned against the wall. “I hope eventually they both get better. It hurts to see them so worried.”

“..Yeah.” Aizawa mutters. “It does.”

“How’s the adoption for her coming along?”

“It’s more difficult than what we thought. She has no records, so getting her has become quite the task. We did it for Izuku, so we’ll do it for her.”

“...Crazy to believe last year you would’ve laughed in my face if I told you that you’d have three kids.” Nemuri teased him. “You’ve just got such a soft spot, don’t you?”

“Shut up.” Aizawa grumbled. “Go do your job.”

There was *a lot* of people. Even though it was mainly just the students and maybe parents, there was still a lot of people. Riso hated that. He hated how when he looked into the crowd, he felt like there wasn’t enough air to go around. He tried to keep himself together as he walked through it with Kaizen and Eri. He told himself he’d be strong for them, but that was quickly depleting the more he walked around.

“Riso!” Hatsume’s voice shook him from the trance he was entering. He smiled at the sight of her.

“Hey, Hatsume.” Riso looked down at Kaizen and Eri, then at her again. “How’s your babies coming along?”

“Great!!” Hatsume stimmed, her voice going up in pitch. “I’m glad I ran into you! Your boyfriend told me you’d be here. Are you going to see the support classes use their gadgets?”

“Absolutely. I’m hoping to see yours mainly! I’ve been gone for so long, I’m sure you’re doing wonderful.” Riso nodded. “I believe in you.”

“I gotta go, but it’s great to see you! We need to work on another baby together again!” Hatsume ran off as fast as she appeared. Eri tugged on Riso’s sleeve.

“Baby?”

“That’s what she calls her inventions.” Riso responded. “Like the hair clip I made? She’d call that her baby. She takes inventing really serious.”

“...Huh.” Eri stuck closer to Riso.

“..Are there too many people?” Riso asked her. She nodded slightly.

“Let’s go over here, yeah? It’s getting closer to when Izuku and Hitoshi are gonna perform. Are you excited to see that?”

Eri nodded again, and Kaizen nodded as well.

“I can’t wait!!” Kaizen jumped with excitement. “They’re gonna do the dance!” Kaizen had watched them train, so he knew briefly what to expect. Riso, on the other hand, did not.

Once the three were off to the side, time seemed to fly by. Ten came by faster than Riso was anticipating. But regardless, he made it to the gym on time. He brought both Kaizen and Eri onto each of his shoulders. He’s help up crashing buildings before, holding two kids on his shoulders wouldn’t be an issue.

“Can you guys see?”

“Uh huh!”

The lights cut off. Riso was surprised to see Jirou standing at the center of the stage. He was happy for her though, she seemed to be letting herself be vulnerable to have fun. He knew she could sing, so he wasn’t surprised when she started to sing. He was proud and happy for her. Riso noticed that Kaizen was watching the stage intently, and Eri was watching Izuku. Riso followed Kaizen’s line of sight and paused.

Oh my god. Hitoshi looked so stupid in that outfit. It made Riso laugh. He looked cute too, and it made Riso’s worries wash away. As Hitoshi and Izuku danced along with the music, Riso felt his heart bubble in happiness. He hadn’t realized how sad he had been these past couple of weeks. Seeing Hitoshi, Izuku and their class was bringing up his spirits. His heart felt heavy, but in a good way. He didn’t even realize the smile that was forming on his face.

Riso was insanely impressed. The light work, the creative liberty of swinging Aoyama like a disco ball. All of it was so impressive. He was even more impressed when Uraraka was swung into the air by Asui and she started making people float. Riso paused when he looked up and saw the biggest smile on Eri's face. He felt tears pool at the bottom of his eyes. She was smiling. Eri, the girl who forgot how to smile, was smiling. Izuku would be so proud.

The rest of the concert was a blast. Riso had never enjoyed himself so much, both Kaizen and Eri were still smiling wide once it was over. It was a wonderful experience for all three of them. Riso definitely needed something like. It was good to see him smile without forcing it.

Riso almost jumped from his skin when Izuku and Hitoshi basically tackled him from behind. He felt a spike of panic, but it wasn't long-lasting. Eri was still smiling and Kaizen too. Kaizen jumped up and down.

"You guys were great," Riso said to the two. Izuku smiled wide.

"I'm glad you enjoyed yourself! It's nice to see you out of that place." Izuku hugged Riso tightly, who didn't break the hug until Izuku himself did.

"I was pretty impressed. Everything seemed so professional, it was almost..weird." Riso looked at Hitoshi. There was a small silence. Eri was lightly talking to Izuku, and Kaizen was basically vibrating with excitement next to her.

"Hi." Hitoshi spoke first. Riso wrapped his arms around Hitoshi tightly, trying his best not to let any tears spill.

"Hi." He whispered back, and Hitoshi held onto him tighter. They both didn't want to leave each other again. It was the hardest part of Riso being in the mental hospital.

"..Why don't you two go talk?" Izuku offered. "I can watch Eri and Kaizen for a minute."

"..Are you sure?" Hitoshi asked. "You don't have to,"

“I want to. Now go before I change my mind.”

Riso and Hitoshi walked off the festival grounds. There was nothing but woods around now, but they didn’t care. They sat on the ground. They both had their hands intertwined, and didn’t speak for a good three minutes.

“...I miss you.” Hitoshi’s voice was quiet. “I miss seeing you everyday. I know I visit you, but-”

“It’s not the same.” Riso finished. “I know.”

“I hate that you’re gone. I know it’s for the better. You’re getting better because of it! But part of me..just wants you here.”

“..I hate that I’m gone too.” Riso sighed. “I..I am getting better, but it’s so exhausting. I get little to no recharge for myself, but when I see you..it’s all worth it.”

“Don’t be so corny.” Hitoshi laughed and nudged him.

“I’m serious! It’s like I see you, and poof. Gone.”

“You’re so stupid.”

“You’re one to talk! You’re wearing a stupid- yellow outfit.”

“Oh shut up, I look fine.”

“You look stupid. But it’s a cute stupid.”

Hitoshi paused and blushed. “Shut up.”

“Never.” Riso smiled in victory. He loved teasing Hitoshi whenever he could.

“So what all do you..talk about in therapy?”

“A lot. Um, we’ve been talking a lot about how I used to act alone. The whole..disappearing and dealing with wounds on my own.”

“...It was very worrying when you disappeared.”

“It was so I could sneak to Recovery Girl. The give myself a day at most to recover. I never wanted anyone to see me weak. Especially you.”

“I’ve been able to tell how sad you were from the beginning.” Hitoshi gently ran his thumb over Riso’s hand. “You were so..distant. You were there, yeah, but you weren’t. You gave everything. When you helped me that night, I saw you as this strong vigilante that didn’t take shit.”

“I *was* a strong vigilante that didn’t take shit.” Riso pouts.

“But you weren’t. You were so fucking alone. I could just see it in your eyes, Riso. You wanted someone so bad. Izuku was there, but he was grieving. You didn’t want to rely on him.” Hitoshi looked at Riso with soft eyes. “You were alone and I saw that.”

“I’m not anymore.” Riso looked off to the side.

“You have us now. But that part of you who didn’t? It’s still not healed. You still struggle with realizing we *are* here. And..that takes time to learn after so long. But..you’re my boyfriend. I know you. At least, I’d like to think I know you.”

“You always get emotional and it makes me feel weird.” Riso mutters. “And now I’m gonna have to talk about this with my therapist. Do I wanna do that? No.”

“But you will?”

“Ugh. Yeah.” Riso looked up at the sky. “..God. I haven’t seen the stars in so long. I really miss them.”

Hitoshi looked up at the day sky. He’d move the sun for Riso if he could.

“..I had a dream when you were gone.” Hitoshi started. “You told me about this constellation. We were on the building of my old foster home. You told me how it was about..some guy, and..how it was more greek myth than astrology.”

“..Which one?”

“Ophiuchus.” Hitoshi hummed lightly. “I can tell it apart from the others now. It was such a wild experience because it was such a clear dream.”

“...Huh.” Riso thinks. “I would tell myself constellations to keep myself conscious for Eri. I..thought about Ophiuchus a lot. It was one of the first I learned.”

“..Really?”

“Yeah. I guess I was telling you I was alive. The poetic type shit.”

“Oh c’mon, that’s not really possible.”

“Wow, just crush my heart, yeah?”

“You know what I mean.”

“Hitoshi?”

“Yeah?”

“You’re going to be a great hero someday.”

“..Where did that come from?”

“I don’t know, but..I have no doubt. You’re going to do amazing.”

“...You think so?”

“I think so. Though, Blasty probably will beat both you and Izuku. Do *not* tell him I said that. The bastard’s a fucking heart throb with a flashy quirk.”

“I am so telling him you called him a heart throb.”

“I’ll kill myself.”

“You can’t make those jokes!”

“Says who? I’m free for about five more hours.”

“..You’re insufferable.” Hitoshi leaned his head on Riso’s shoulder. “It’s endearing.”

Riso gently kissed his forehead. “It’s apart of my charm.”

The two stayed like that until the next hour when Riso had to check in with someone. Hitoshi ended up falling asleep on accident, and Riso fell asleep too. Aizawa had to find them and wake them, but not before he took a picture. Hey, that was his kid being cute. He couldn’t waste the perfectfully fine teasing opportunity. He knew both Riso and Hitoshi needed that moment with each other. They were in love and it was so clearly obvious to Aizawa. It was similar to him and Mic when they were in highschool, though it did take a lot less pinning for him and Mic to get together. It was almost frustrating for everyone to see Hitoshi and Riso not get together for so long. It was like watching an unsatisfying show.

Aizawa was grateful though. His son ended with someone he could trust to protect him. He didn’t like putting that burden on Riso, but he didn’t have to. Riso was already willing since the day he met Hitoshi. Love usually made Aizawa uneasy since he didn’t like showing it, but for once it warmed his heart.

Chapter End Notes

last canon thing before i end this! i said before i can't do the war arc bc it hurts my brain trying to figure out ways to write izuku! so you guys probably only have a few more chapters until it ends! love you guys, comments appreciated, and have a good day!

updates wednesdays and sundays!

Chapter Sixty Three (END)

Chapter Summary

Life has changed a lot after nine years.

Chapter Notes

not gonna say too much here but please be sure to read the authors note at the end!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Nine years later . . .

Fire. Heat. Panic. Three words to describe the current situation at this bank. Screams of the innocent were heard from outside as a crowd gathered.

“Someone needs to call a hero, or the police!” A civilian called. There was murmuring in the crowd, but two silhouettes jumped into the building from seemingly nowhere. There was silence, before the two figures emerged from the burning blaze with people in their arms.

“Clear a spot!”

The familiar green hair whipped in the light breeze. He set down two individuals. The other hero sat the civilians they were carrying down gently before disappearing back into the building.

“Are you alright?”

“Uhm..y-yes..” A little boy responded to the hero’s question. He looked up. “Thank you, Deku..!”

“Don’t thank me. Is anyone else hurt?” Izuku glanced at the group of people. They were covered in a smokey ash, and all had terrified looks on their faces. A young mother raised her hand.

“My..My ankle,” She coughed. Izuku leaned down next to her, offering his hand.

“You’re going to be okay. How bad does it hurt, do you think you might’ve broken it?”

“Uhm..” She gulped. “I..I think. I don’t know, I- I can’t really feel it..”

“That’s alright. Can I see it?”

Inside the building, there seemingly were no more civilians. The rest must’ve gotten out before it went up in flames. The hero paused when a voice called out to him.

“Come on, Dynamight! You can’t do anything, can you?!” He laughed, the blaze surrounding his body. “Let’s fight!” Bakugo had no reaction and before he could even act, a figure came from nowhere. A swift kick to the face and the constant flames coming from the villain stopped as he fell unconscious. They popped up, throwing the villain over his shoulder.

“Don’t just stand there, Blasty. Let’s go!”

“Don’t fucking tell me what to do, scar-face!” Bakugo huffed as he quickly made his way out of the door.

As Bakugo exited the burning building covering his face with a light cough, the villain was dumped at the steps. Bakugo sighed and picked up the unconscious villain. He brought him out towards the crowd, where he was met with the police.

“Thanks! We really appreciate your work, Dynamight!”

“Yeah, yeah.” Bakugo waved him off. “Barely did anything.”

Well, he wasn’t exactly lying.

Bakugo looked at Izuku, who was still speaking with the young mother. He looked at her with such kind eyes. It was almost like he saw Inko in her. Bakugo held his breath for a moment. Izuku’s face had ash on it, but even with the slightly burned outfit he still looked good. Bakugo had only fallen more in love with Izuku as the years went on. Bakugo in high-school would be ashamed of how in love he was now. He could hardly ever say no to Izuku anymore. In fact, he planned on proposing soon.

He was snapped from his love-driven gaze by a news reporter shoving a microphone in his face.

“Pro Hero Dynamight! Can we have a world?”

“Hah?” Bakugo looked at her. “..What?”

“How does it feel knowing that you’re no longer Number One?”

“I don’t care.”

“Are you sure? Surely you must resent Deku for-”

“Look, lady. I don’t care. Deku worked hard to get where he is. I’m proud of him, or whatever.”

The last hero ranking was a few months ago. Bakugo had basically been number one ever since he made his official debut. Sure, he had to outrun Endeavor and even Hawks, but he climbed the rankings fast. Bakugo had lost a ranking and was put as number two, but Izuku passed him. Yes, he was upset about it jokingly for a few days, but he was overall proud. Izuku had run into a rather large villain fight and that must've officially pushed him over the edge to one. Expectations for heroes changed after All Might and Endeavor stepped down. It was no longer just a quirk, but you as a person. Hitoshi was number four. Riso had gone on to make his own support item company. He supplied more than just heroes, though. He helped make limbs for amputees, helped make medical equipment, and schools have better equipment. Japan's own David Shield.

Bakugo's attention was brought back to Izuku when he heard a few reporters call his name. The media frustrated him. They didn't even care if the fire was still going or not. Thankfully, a few other minor heroes put out the fire. He watched as Izuku stumbled over his words, before walking over. He grabbed his arm gently and pulled him away. He waved to the cameras and walked away with him.

"Kacchan," Izuku started. "That was rude."

"Rude my ass. They were bothering you. We need to get you home, you smell like shit."

"Hey!"

Later that week, Izuku sat on the balcony of his shared apartment. He hummed lightly, listening to the sound of the city below him. He almost spilled his cup of tea when someone landed on his balcony railing.

"Shit!" Izuku said aloud, pouting when he noticed the bit of tea that got on his shirt. He looked up and narrowed his eyes. "We have a front door, Riso."

"But I don't scare you that way!" He grinned, swinging his legs down. He pulled down his hood and mask.

“Anything happen tonight?”

“Nah. Saved a little girl’s cat from a tree. The only interesting thing.” Riso shrugged.

“What are you doing here, then? It’s late. You should go home.”

“I need to take you somewhere.”

“..Let me get dressed,” Izuku sighed.

“Nope! Sorry.” Riso picks Izuku up and slings him over his shoulder.

“Riso! Put me down!”

“Sorry!”

“Do not jump off of this fucking balcony I swear-”

“Then walk with me.”

“..Fine.”

Riso put Izuku down, and Izuku brushed off his shirt. Which..said t-shirt. The two of them walked through the apartment, to the elevator. Bakugo was working at the agency late, so it was just Riso and Izuku. It was pretty awkward though when some old lady walked in. Someone decked out in black attire with clear gadgets, and a hero in his pajamas in the same elevator must’ve been a sight for her to see.

“Where are we even going?”

“Don’t ask, just follow.”

A few days ago

“Hey, Blasty! It’s weird for you to come to my workshop like this. Everything okay?” Riso looked up from his journal, glancing at Bakugo.

“I have to ask you something.”

“I’m not going to just give your agency gadgets.”

“No, dumbass.” Bakugo crossed his arms. “I need your help.”

“..With?”

“I’m proposing to Izuku.”

“Holy shit.” Riso sat up. “Really?”

“Yeah. I know how to make it special, but…he’d never fall for it.”

“..And you need my help to lure him into it?”

“Basically?”

“Of course! Do we have a plan? I’ve been waiting for this ever since you asked him out!”

“..Shut up.”

Present Time

It was a small surprise when Riso walked Izuku to the cat cafe. Yes, the same cafe where Bakugo asked Izuku to be his boyfriend. Izuku smiled gently.

“Did you really just want coffee this late?”

“Maybe.” Riso smiled. He walked Izuku inside. There wasn’t a worker or customer to be seen.

“..Where is everyone?”

“Eh, it’s late. Let’s go see the cats.” When Riso opened the door to the cat section, Izuku got a full look at the room. It was decorated in string-lights, candles, and the only person who stood in the room was Bakugo. He wore a simple pair of jeans and a black shirt. Nothing too fancy, it was definitely more casual. He smiled nervously at Izuku. Behind Bakugo was a heart structure covered in roses.

Izuku stepped forward slowly.

“..Kacchan?” Izuku asked softly. “What’s all this?”

“..I..” Bakugo sighed. “Izuku, I’ve known you since I was a kid. You’ve stuck by my side even when you shouldn’t have. I’ve probably..fallen in love with you more than once. You’re my entire world. I want to spend the rest of my days with you, so..”

Izuku's eyes filled with tears as Bakugo got on one knee.

"..Will you, Izuku Midoriya, make me the happiest man alive and marry me?"

Silence. Izuku burst into tears, and walked forward. He nodded, barely even able to get the 'yes' from his lips. Bakugo stood and pulled Izuku close by his waist. The two shared a passionate kiss. Izuku pulled from the kiss as Bakugo slid the ring on his finger. He locked eyes with Bakugo as he wiped his tears.

"I can't believe you did this while I was in my pajamas." Izuku laughed through his tears.

"I can't either," Bakugo smiled. He pressed the two of their foreheads together, living in the moment. "I love you."

"I love you too, Katsuki." Izuku kissed Bakugo again.

-

"Toshi, I'm home!" Riso called, petting Fluffball as he entered the door.

"He's in the shower." A voice from the living room couch said.

"What are you doing up?" Riso asked as he set his things down.

"Couldn't sleep. Got a headache."

"Did you take anything for it?"

“No, but I ate an entire tub of ice cream.”

“Kaizen,” Riso said in a stern voice. “Whatever. Did you at least finish your school work?”

“...Yes.”

“Liar.” Riso ruffled his hair from the back of the couch, before jumping over the side and sitting down. Riso had taken legal custody of Kaizen when he turned eighteen, so now he lived with him and Hitoshi. Kaizen was eleven now, and he ended up developing an intelligence quirk like Riso did.

“Did Uncle Izuku finally get proposed to?”

“Yep, that’s what I did tonight. What are we watching?”

“Some old cartoons.” Kaizen leaned against Riso.

“..Yeah? Analyzing them?”

“Unfortunately, yeah.”

“Sucks.” Riso glanced over the back of the couch when he heard the bathroom door open. He smiled when he saw Hitoshi come from the door.

“Oh, you’re home.” Hitoshi walked over, using a towel to dry his wet hair. He smiled. “How did things go?”

“Wonderful. Zuku cried.”

“Of course he did.” Hitoshi kissed Riso’s cheek. “What’d you eat for dinner?”

“...A five course meal.”

“Liar.” Kaizen snickered.

“C’mon, I’ll make you something.” Hitoshi walked over to the kitchen.

“..Ugh, fine.”

“You love me.”

“I do.” Riso walked over to the kitchen.

Hitoshi glances at Kaizen. “You want something to go with that tub of ice cream you ate?”

“Uh, of course!”

Hitoshi smiled. He opened the cupboard to find a pan. He was grateful for where he is. He had his own little family, a healthy one. He wished he could go back and tell middle school him it would all be alright.

Chapter End Notes

THANK YOU GUYS SO MUCH FOR READING! ive had a lot of mental struggles and this has been the best months of my life. i don't want to keep you too long, but i wish i could've let this story go on forever. reminder, this is my first fic so im so sorry if this was not the ending you wanted! i tried my best and i even spent every hour awake since last sunday trying to make another chapter before the end but i literally couldn't. there were so many things i left unaddressed that i couldn't find ways to address in a chapter or two. after the canon story line ended, which i wasn't going to do the war arc, it was difficult to plan on my own. if i had an AU which was completely off the canon, it would be easier but i relied heavily on canon to get me here. 180k words later, and it's ended. i love you guys and thank you for sticking with me.

li hope you all enjoyed the journey i've taken you on since june of last year. thank you again, and i'll see you next story!

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